

SENIOR SCHOOL CERTIFICATE EXAMINATION (SSCE 1988 – 2015)

Past Questions with Solutions

English Language

(Theory / Objectives with Oral English) 1988

WASSCE JUNE 1988 ENGLISH LANGUAGE 2 OBJECTIVE TEST QUESTIONS

SECTION 1 PASSAGE A

Probably the Motorist saw the — 1 — lorry too — 2 — to be able to — 3 — disaster. However, he realized that if he kept to the — 4 —, a probably — 5 — head on — 6 — would be unavoidable. The only alternative was to take the lesser risk of leaving the road. With great care therefore, he turned sharply — 7 — the road and into the ditch by the — 8 —. The consequence was that, instead of being involved in a serious and probably fatal — 9 —, the — 10 — escaped with a few minor — 11 — and bruises, while the only — 12 — to his car was a bent mudguard. By — 13 — into the roadside ditch to avoid what could have been a collision with the approaching orry, he averted a — 14 — accident at the — 15 — of a few — 16 — to himself and the slight damage to his car.

- | | | | | |
|-------------------|-------------------|-----------------|--------------|-------------------|
| 1. A. incoming | B. oncoming | C. downcoming | D. offcoming | E. outcoming |
| 2. A. much | B. early | C. soon | D. often | E. late |
| 3. A. avoid | B. convert | C. reverse | D. rush | E. reverse |
| 4. A. road-side | B. traffic | C. way | D. road | E. level-crossing |
| 5. A. slight | B. fatal | C. mild | D. collision | E. fantastic |
| 6. A. collision | B. confusion | C. up | D. over | E. through |
| 7. A. road | B. level-crossing | C. pavement | D. alley | E. roadside |
| 8. A. casualty | B. cyclist | C. driver | D. rider | E. motor-cyclist |
| 9. A. transporter | B. collision | C. fall | D. accident | E. jump |
| 10. A. caught | B. cut | C. cut | D. cut | E. cars |
| 11. A. damage | B. collision | C. accident | D. racing | E. fall |
| 12. A. swerving | B. jumping | C. accelerating | D. notorious | E. serious |
| 13. A. huge | B. expensive | C. expensive | D. expensive | E. expensive |
| 14. A. injured | B. injuries | C. injury | D. injurious | E. injure |

PASSAGE B

A hotel is supposed to be a home away from home, but the one we — 17 — was hell away from home. Initially, we were deceived by the beautiful surroundings and by the manager's — 18 — which was warm and inviting. After the usual — 19 — and signing of forms, we were checked in. We later discovered, to our utter dismay, that the hotel — 20 — many facilities and that the few available — 21 — were either faulty or — 22 —. The rooms were somehow tolerable, but there was something we could not manage - food. We complained. In fact, we ate just to — 23 — alive since whatever was on the — 24 — gave no — 25 —. The services there were definitely — 26 —. By the time we were due to — 27 — the following day, everybody heaved a sigh of — 28 —. Maybe I heard the manager say: Did you — 29 — a nice stay? And thinking he heard somebody say yes, he quickly added: Please — 30 — again.

- | | | | | |
|---------------------|--------------|---------------|-----------------|----------------|
| 17. A. moved into | B. checked | C. dropped by | D. checked into | E. stood in |
| 18. A. reception | B. intention | C. rejection | D. conception | E. conviction |
| 19. A. filling | B. filling | C. filling | D. filling | E. filling |
| 20. A. lacks | B. failed | C. lacked | D. lack | E. lacks |
| 21. A. one | B. ones | C. warns | D. warn | E. ones |
| 22. A. unattractive | B. cheap | C. impressive | D. standardized | E. substandard |
| 23. A. stay | B. stand | C. stop | D. stop | E. stop |
| 24. A. menu | B. list | C. paper | D. table | E. table |
| 25. A. joy | B. sweetness | C. problem | D. fear | E. digestion |
| 26. A. opposing | B. appealing | C. appealing | D. oppressing | E. oppressing |
| 27. A. check in | B. check out | C. check up | D. check into | E. check off |
| 28. A. release | B. relief | C. relieve | D. relief | E. relieve |
| 29. A. had | B. have | C. hand | D. heard | E. has |
| 30. A. see | B. by | C. drop | D. return | E. come |

SECTION 2

In each of the following sentences, there is one word underlined and one gap. From the list of words lettered A to E, choose the word or group of words that is most nearly opposite in meaning to the underlined word and that will, at the same time, correctly fill the gap in the sentence.

31. Tunde purchased various articles at the big sale near Kingsway and, surprisingly enough, he..... them all before he reached home that day.
A. destroyed B. bought C. sold D. distributed
E. lent.
32. In this argument, Ade was my supporter even though he is often my..... in other matters.
A. opponent B. ally C. opposite D. proposer
E. opposite.
33. People who are normally..... often turn to be dauntless heroes in the face of real danger
A. unsteadily B. colourless C. cowardly
D. bashful E. unfriendly.
34. I encouraged my younger brother to take on Law as a profession while I..... my sister from doing so.
A. financed B. warned C. dissuaded D. persuaded
E. helped.
35. It is quite customary to introduce the guest speaker but....to insult him.
A. illegal B. impolite C. unusual D. useless
E. pointless.
36. Olu was able to kindle the fire which my father had to..... later
A. kill B. switch C. extinguish D. destroy
E. ignite.

After each of the following sentences, a list of possible interpretations of all or part of the sentence is given. Choose the interpretation that you consider **appropriate** for each sentence.

37. Mr. John has always managed to keep his head above water.
 A. keep his head above water when swimming
 B. like swimming
 C. know the techniques of swimming
 D. stay out of financial difficulty
 E. borrow a large amount of money from the bank and he is trying to pay it up.
38. The men eventually gained their freedom and decided later to get their own back on their oppressors.
 A. strike B. have their revenge on C. abuse
 D. get something from E. beat up
39. He went off the rails as soon as he heard of his failure in the last examination.
 A. became annoyed B. wept bitterly
 C. became disorganized D. became a man
 E. lost consciousness
40. She is eating her heart out for a sailor who is away at sea
 A. writing to B. longing for C. quarreling with
 D. fuming about E. hating.
41. How do you hope to do it? You can't make bricks without straw.
 A. use a straw for making bricks
 B. afford not to have all the necessary materials
 C. seek a leader
 D. find bricks and straw.
 E. erect a brick without straws.
42. Mary's classmates agreed to send her to Coventry
 A. send her to the Sisters at the convent.
 B. report her to the Sisters at the convent.
 C. ignore her
 D. train her to be the leader
 E. send her to the penitentiary.

SECTION 4

From the words lettered A to E below each of the following sentences, choose the word or group of words that is **nearest in meaning** to the underlined expression as it is used in the sentence.

43. My choice of a partner would be based on character, not looks
 A. visibility B. feasibility C. appearance D. stares
 E. posture.

44. Ade is very winsome yet his neighbour finds it difficult to put up with him
 A. stay with B. live with C. tolerate
 D. depend on E. rely on.
45. The girl has just come out of the fattening room and her waist is adorned with beads
 A. surrounded B. decorated C. besieged
 D. defaced E. bedraggled
46. There are some drugs that could exacerbate a particular illness
 A. heal B. ameliorate C. lengthen D. worsen
 E. detect
47. In accordance with the practice of his religion, Raman's body was interred the day he died.
 A. sanctified B. preserved C. cremated D. buried
 E. entered.
48. What you cannot avoid you try to endure
 A. cast off B. put off C. dispense with D. practice
 E. tolerate

SECTION 5

From the words lettered A to D choose the word or group of words that **best completes** each of the following sentences.

49. Adamu is a very good friend on I can rely
 A. who B. whose C. which D. whom
50. I ought.....the letter by now.
 A. to be sent B. to have being sent
 C. to have sent D. to have to send
51. Toyin's fever was so acute that she.....an injection
 A. had to have B. had to had C. must have
 D. ought to have
52. I know of a cow.....has only three legs
 A. whom B. which C. who D. of which
53. Ranti: This is not my key, Ayo: Then..... is it?
 A. of which B. whose C. who's D. whom
54. There was no meat in the market.....Shade bought some fish
 A. so B. unless C. since D. whereas
55. The police vehicles raced.....full speed with their sirens blaring
 A. on B. with C. at D. in

56. Tutu liked to read detective novels to take his mind.....his worries
A. off B. away C. out of D. from
57. I don't know what to do with these children. They are always fighting.....
A. themselves B. myself C. one another D. each of them.
58. Wale couldn't have said a thing like that.....
A. could he? B. did he? C. can he? D. would he?
59. If she had known, she wouldn't have come.....
A. would she? B. wasn't it? C. wouldn't it D. couldn't she?
60. Salary cuts could be the.....of the worker's protest
A. course B. curse C. cause D. coarse
61. Neither John nor Mary felt happy..... the incident
A. for B. in C. about D. By
62. Any parent would be pleased.....such impressive performance
A. at B. from C. with D. for
63. Stella wanted to show..... with her necklace.
A. off B. on C. over D. back
64. The woman.....daughter he married, is his mother-in-law
A. whose B. which C. her D. whom
65. He acts as if he.....a general manager
A. is been B. were C. has been D. is being
66. The National Essay Competition came.....on the 23rd of July 1986
A. out B. in C. by D. up
67. Mrs. Nwokolo had.....her breakfast before her friend came in
A. has B. have C. had D. been had
68. If the two boys.....been bitten by the snake, they should be taken to the hospital.
A. has B. had C. have D. is
69. The man.....missed death during the collision
A. extensively B. always C. narrowly D. amply
70. I started wilting at 9am. It is now 10am, by 11am. I..... writing for 2 hours
A. will be B. am C. wil have been D. have been
71. My.....to you, students, is to be good
A. advice B. advise C. adverse D. advance
72. The car couldn't keep pace.....the motor cycle especially in congested areas
A. along B. with C. down D. on
73. I want everybody to learn the last ten lines of the poem..... heart
A. with B. in C. for D. by
74. They went.....talking after midnight despite the fact that they all had to get up early.
A. by B. for C. on D. with
75. There was a lot of tension in the area and it was felt that a dispute might flare..... anytime.
A. up B. down C. in D. to
76. People are always afraid to visit Mr. Ade because he is.....
A. an army B. a soldier C. an army man D. a military.
77. I want that spoon washed, I can still see.....on it
A. oilness B. greases C. some oil D. greasiness.
78. Everybody has to do.....homework
A. his B. them C. theirs D. There
79. Having worked all day it is about time we.....back home
A. go B. goes C. went D. gone
80. At eighteen, Bose is.....to take good care of her sisters.
A. enough old B. too old C. older enough D. old enough.
81. Obi is.....troublesome than I had imagined
A. much less B. the least C. more less D. very less
82. This is not.....house in the street but it is certainly bigger than yours.
A. a big B. the big C. the biggest D. the bigger
83. I find it.....comfortable to travel by air than by road
A. quite very much B. much more C. quite much D. very much
84.sacrifice was it that people talked about it for years.
A. Much great B. How great a C. As great as

- D. So great a
85. The press must cater for the needs of the..... public
A. readers B. readable C. reading D. reader
86. I hate that habit.....
A. of nagging B. by nagging C. to nag
D. having nagged
87. After he had tried for sometime, he realized that all his efforts were going to be.....
A. festive B. futile C. fragrant D. fitful.
88. Mr. Dauda's two labourers work on.....days.
A. alternative B. optional C. alternate D. current
89. If she takes.....her mother, you can be sure of her efficiency
A. up B. on C. with D. after
90. Please, look.....my answers for me
A. over B. across C. after D. on.
91. Ali said that going..... an operation is not a pleasant experience
A. through B. over C. in D. by time
92. If pupils will abide.....school rules the tone of discipline will improve.
A. on B. with C. in D. by
93.inform her that I called
A. When she comes back
B. After she phoned
C. As she was coming back
D. When she arrived.
94. He knew.....
A. that they wanted B. what they wanted
C. if they wanted D. at where they wanted
95. The house..... is the most beautiful in that area
A. after Femi built B. in which Femi built
C. whose Femi built D. which Femi built.

96.we shall go together
A. If you had come early
B. If you came early
C. If you come early
D. Although you come early.
97. He said he forgot.....
A. what you said B. that you said
C. why you said D. when you said
98. I don't like my Maths teacher, well, he doesn't like me.....
A. too B. also C. quite D. either
99. Eze has not heard from his sister Ada since she..... to the United Kingdom
A. has gone B. had gone C. had been going
D. went
100. Ada has special love..... children, so she is going to be a teacher
A. in B. with C. of D. for

WASSCE JUNE 1988 ENGLISH LANGUAGE 2 OBJECTIVE TEST ANSWERS

1.B	2.E	3.A	4.D	5.C	6.A	7.B
8.E	9.D	10.C	11.B	12.A	13.A	14.E
15.D	16.B	17.D	18.A	19.E	20.C	21.B
22.E	23.A	24.A	25.B	26.C	27.B	28.D
29.B	30.E	31.C	32.A	33.C	34.C	35.C
36.C	37.D	38.B	39.A	40.B	41.B	42.C
43.C	44.C	45.B	46.D	47.D	48.E	49.D
50.C	51.A	52.B	53.B	54.A	55.C	56.A
57.C	58.A	59.A	60.C	61.C	62.C	63.A
64.A	65.B	66.D	67.C	68.C	69.C	70.C
71.A	72.B	73.D	74.C	75.A	76.B	77.C
78.A	79.C	80.D	81.A	82.C	83.B	84.D
85.C	86.A	87.B	88.C	89.D	90.A	91.A
92.D	93.A	94.B	95.D	96.C	97.A	98.D
99.D	100.D					

WASSCE JUNE1988 ENGLISH LANGUAGE I THEORY QUESTIONS

PART A

1. Write a story in your school magazine beginning or ending with the sentence: I wish I had never met the man.
2. You were an eye-witness to an incident in which a crowd of angry traders beat a suspected thief to death. Write a letter to the Divisional Police Officer in your area giving an account of what happened.
3. Write an article for inclusion in one of your local newspapers on the importance of immunization against childhood diseases in your locality.
4. You have been invited to lead the motion in a school debate for or against the proposition that the new 6-3-3-4 system of education will be beneficial to the youths of Nigeria'. Write out your speech.
5. You and a group of school mates were returning from an excursion when the bus in which you were travelling broke down in an isolated place. Write a report to the principal on the events that followed and how you got out of the situation.
6. One of your pen friends has written asking you to describe your favourite Nigerian dish to enable her to prepare it. Write back to her explaining how the dish is cooked.

PART B

SECTION I

COMPREHENSION

Answer all the questions in this part.

7. **Read the following passage carefully and then answer the questions which follow:**

At the beginning of the century also, the British administration, after the control of malaria by quinine and the resettlement of whites on high ground at Hill Station, decided to change its policy of appointing Krios to high posts and appointed Europeans instead, some of them with lower qualifications.

The religious societies also seemed to have lost faith in Krio leadership in the Church and sent out white missionaries to replace them in Sierra Leone and in Nigeria under the ageing black Bishop Crowther, the first black bishop since the Reformation.

Thus, with economic power lost to the British and Lebanese merchants, civil and religious leadership lost to the British and with a strained relationship between them and the provincial people, the Krios have been a beleaguered community since the 1900s. In 1926 they even lost the cherished control and mayoralty of Freetown which they had held since the 1790s regaining it only after about three decades of petitioning.

But their passion for education and protestantism remained. Their teachers and clergymen at the freetown seconda schools with degrees from Durham University with which the local Fourah Bay College had been affiliated in the 1870s maintained a high standard in Ereetown and were in demand in neighbouring territories in the Gambia, Ghana and Nigeria, especially in northern Nigeria, where they served under Lord Lugard as both senior and junior officers. A clerk there was the main character in a novel Mr. Johnson written in that era by the late author Joyce Cary.

(a) Give one word that could replace each of the following in the passage: (i) ageing; (ii) beleaguered; (iii) cherished; (iv) petitioning; (v) affiliated; (vi) era (b) in two sentences, state why it is necessary to resettle the whites on the high ground. (c) Give three areas in which the Krios found themselves discriminated against. (d) Give two reasons which show that the Krios were determined people. (e) Write down the clauses you can see in the first sentence of the passage.

8. **Read the following passage carefully and then answer the questions on it.**

It was Kola's first day at work. That morning, he woke up at exactly five O'clock. He had slept late the night before as he was getting ready for the D-day.

Securing a job was a relief to Kola and his parents. For two years, Kola had roamed the streets in search of work. He had finished his mandatory national youth service two years before after returning from America where he obtained his master's degree in Business Administration at the State University. During these years, he has been living on his parents. Of course they were happy caring for him as having him around was what mattered. They could not bear the pain of him returning to America after missing him for ten years. Kola detested this too much. He felt his freedom was being curtailed by his continued dependence on his parents for

survival. There was nothing he could do for the moment. He was not then a man.

Kola arrived at the office of the secretary to the Managing Director of Friendly Construction Company that morning full smiles. He was to start as the company's Personnel Manager. He was surprised to see the secretary already at her seat typin. She looked up from her typing with surprise. She wondered what could have kept the young man so late on the first day of the assumption of duties. She was sure the Managing Director would not take it lying down.

She was on the verge of asking him why he was late when the door to the Director's office opened and the director stepped into the secretary's office.

'Good morning Sir', Kola greeted him.

"Morning, Mr. Kola", replied the Director. "By my time" he continued, 'it is now two minutes after 9 O'clock. You are one hour two minutes late. This is a bad way to begin. Kola humedly checked his wiist watch. He wanted to speak, but he was stuck for words.

(a) Give one reason why Kola's securing of a job was a relief to his parents. (b) In one sentence, explain what the writ meant by saying Kola had been living on his parents. (c) Write a sentence to explain what you think prevented Kola from returning to America after waiting for two years without a job. (d) What in the writer's opinion was responsible for Kolas parents' untiring care for him? Quote a sentence from the passage to support this (e) State in one sentence why Kola was then not a man (f) in one sentence or phrase, give the meaning of each of the following words or group of words as it is used in the passage: (i) D-day (ii) Roamed; (iii) Mandatory; (iv) Lying down; (v) Stuck for words (g) (i) What kind of grammatical structure is "with surprise (ii) What is its function in the sentence?

SECTION II SUMMARY

9. *Read the following passage carefully and then answer the question on it.*

Katsina has for years been famous for different reasons. Certain qualities have recommended the town as an inland "port of call" for travellers. Katsina has long had an enviable record of possessing strong and resourceful farmers. Many of these have almost perfected the art of growing grains side by side with raising animals like goats, sheep, cows, horses and donkeys. Horses and donkeys are raised for their traditional role of keeping man's company and facilitating his movement from one point to the

other. The other animals have been kept as sources of milk, meat and economic strength.

Katsina as a focal town has for long prided herself on the presence of a good crop of artisans and craftsmen. Their depth of originality has formed the theme of folklore and songs. Most of these artisans engage in such activities as blacksmithing leatherwork and woodcarving. Their products, easily provide some explanation fr some of the queues of travellers who stream into Katsina. The elegance of these artisans' output both real and imagined provides an extra attraction for the undecided visitors. Many would probably have remained unimpressed even with the commonly heard lines. Those who can see admire the beauty of Katsina. Those who are blind simply inhale it'.

Stories about the artisans have for ages successfully swayed many reluctant passers-by to make a stop in Katsina. Some of such calls have been brief and business-like with the callers simply focusing on satisfying their curiosity. Other callers have stopped. Mixed with the people and forgetting to move on. This class of visitors would partly explain an interesting aspec Katsina's population. The town has witnessed moments of drought and famine but such have hardly left their mark on the population

Another segment of Katsina's population has always occupied itself with some unique form of commercial participation. Some of these men and women might never be visibly engaged in moving wares. Most of them merely engage in passing the word on the availability of this or that produce or item. Some go on to arrange contacts between sellers and their potential buyers. In certain instances these information carriers might choose the location of the meeting, the time of day or night and the individuals that would form the requirements for a particular trade contract. it is not uncommon to find a chance meeting opening up a temporary or enduring association between a young lady and a prospective suitor.

The beauty of Katsina has not been limited to its geographical and traditional eminence. The different groups of inhabitanace have also combined to give the town a character of its own.

In six sentences, two for each group, summarise the major contributions by the following to the eminence of Katsina: (a) farmers; (b) artisans; (c) traders.

PART A

1. THE MAN BEHIND MY MISERY

Can I ever forget that birthday party of my fiancée?

It was during the birthday celebration of David Frank, my first love that I met a young businessman who won my heart over with enticing material gifts, catapulted me to the top of the world, promised me an uninterrupted bliss in America, made me to jilt the man who really cared for me and later dumped me in eternal misery. I met this devil incarnate of a man called Ibrahim Gado on Saturday the 4th of December 1987 in my lover's party. Mr. Gado happened to be one of those early friends of Mr. Frank. They were in primary school and even college together. While Mr. Frank finished his college and went to university, Mr. Gado left for abroad half way in the college. He went to America where he claimed to have begun his business activities.

While my fiancée who I met during his national service year was still adjusting to his first post-service job, Mr. Gado was moving in and out of the country on business trips. He was bringing in a variety of articles—shoes, wears, second-hand cars, electric appliances and cameras. He has two flashy cars for his personal use. He was obviously in money. Indeed he was a dream man of most young ladies.

During the party, he saw me and made passes at me. I politely told him that the celebrant, who incidentally was his friend was my fiancée and that we were planning marriage in a year's time. He smiled and gave me his business contact address while he said we human beings are always looking for better life partners.

On my way to work the following day, he saw me and later drove me to the office and promised to come around again during break time to take me out for lunch. I felt he was only being nice. During this lunch time when two of us were together, he bought expensive wines and dishes. He went ahead to reveal all the secrets my fiancée had allegedly revealed to him about his plans for me. He said among all other things that Mr. Frank would not marry me and that he wanted only to use me and dump me later. He opened his briefcase and brought out passport and visa with my names on them. He told me that I would travel with him to America in two days time and I should not tell Frank because he would do everything to disturb me.

We got to America safely with few travelling bags. He became very fond of me and he treated me like a queen, he bought a variety of things for me. Unknown to me one of the boxes I carried contained some parcels of drugs which he sold and made money from. After six months in America, he bought some shoes and dresses in a large cargo and directed me to deliver them to one Alhaji in Lagos. I was arrested at the airport for concealing hard drugs in my cargo. Before I could say Jack Robinson, a tribunal had jailed me ten years. While I was awaiting trial, a letter came to me via a mysterious source telling me that I was not lucky the second time around. The letter revealed that the man I travelled with was not Ibrahim Gado but Jide Abayomi and that by Mr. Frank never revealed anything to him.

For a lady who in 1987 was a little over 27 years of age to discover now she is without a husband, a child, a career, a future, an ex-convict, faces a bleak future, could be quite terrifying. I cannot indeed fail to remember the one behind these miseries: I wish I had never met the man — Ibrahim Gado or Jide Abayomi.

**Ibrahim James,
SS 3A.**

2.

3, Abiku Street,
Itire Ajasa,
Badagry
5th March, 1983.

The Divisional Police Officer,
Nigeria Police Force,
Badagry South Division,
Badagry.

Dear Sir,

**THE LYNCHING OF A SUSPECTED THIEF AT
THE 03A MARKET**

I was at the main Oba Market on Monday the 4th of March 1988 to buy a few provision which I would take to the boarding school in a few days time. Halfway in my shopping, a fat woman who owned a big shop that deals on toys and other attractive gift items raised an alarm that one of the boys had stolen from her a purse containing N500 as she was wrapping an item for one of the customers. As she shouted ole! ole! '(thief! thief!) one of the boys about the age of seventeen began to run out of the market towards the busy road. Naturally and spontaneously, a large throng

of traders and would-be buyers chased after the boy. I followed the stampede too. I could see one boy wearing dark glasses, black shirt over a pair of dirty jeans trousers with a brown cap. As the suspected thief crossed the canal with deep flowing muddy water, he threw an object which I could not identify from where I was into it. He would have escaped but for the many trailers that were speeding along the busy express road in quick succession. He stopped momentarily to change his direction but the crowd was near. He brought a short pistol-like gun which he aimed at the surging crowd but out of nervousness, indecision or guilty feeling, he could not shoot at anybody. From nowhere somebody knocked off the gun from his hand from behind the boy. The gun turned out to be a toy one. Many people in the irate crowd began to beat and inflict a variety of injuries on him. He was shouting and vehemently claiming that he was innocent. This went on until some used tyres and petrol surfaced from the nearby vulcanizer's shop. The boy who fainted before the arrival of these items was set ablaze and he died.

This was the summary trial and execution of a suspected thief before some policemen came to the scene and arrested all those they could lay their hands on. Whether they actually stole the purse or not was and is outside what I know and can prove.

To avoid future occurrence of this type, if jungle justice, I suggest you post some policemen to the busy market area.

Yours faithfully,



Abubakar Baniye.

3. THE IMPORTANCE OF IMMUNIZATION AGAINST CHILDHOOD DISEASES

Without much ado, a definition of immunization is enough to bring home its importance in my locality or any other place for that matter. Immunization is a scientific means of making people, particularly children resist deadly or killer-diseases. Scientists have succeeded in getting vaccines or chemical substances which can be injected into a person's body to act as a protection against diseases.

About fifteen years ago a lot of infants who were not vaccinated or immunized died as a result of the attacks of whooping cough, measles, diphtheria, chicken pox and small pox in Agbado

my locality. A good number of children who survived these diseases were those whose parents took the nice decision and pains to inoculate. Most parents who did all they could to thwart the altruistic efforts of the health officials, who pleaded with them to bring their children for inoculation lived to regret their actions.

While children who were inoculated lived, their own children died in their dozens.

Immunization saves all parents from losing their children prematurely to deadly but preventable diseases. So, immunization has begun an era where parents can have children and boast that barring accidents and other ways of losing lives, their young ones will grow up into useful adults.

Children who are timely and properly immunized can enjoy good health in their infant years. This makes child bearing and rearing less cumbersome if not totally without tears. The convenience which inoculation enables parents to enjoy is almost incalculable.

Vaccinated children grow up into healthy adults. Their growth is not impaired or stunted by measles or any of those debilitating diseases. Some of the diseases are capable of impairing the mental faculties of children. Immunization thwarts all diseases that can stunt the physical and mental growth of children.

Another significance of immunization is that it gives the society the assurance that its young ones will soon grow up to replenish the labour force which old age and retirement of the adult persons deplete. A society whose young population is seriously threatened by widespread and unchecked killer-diseases is doomed for so many reasons.

My locality of Agbado which is trying to recover from the losses of virile men and women during the civil war now knows the advantages of inoculations against all killer diseases too well.

In conclusion, immunization programme, which our state ministry of health has been emphasizing has tremendously saved us from huge sums of money being spent on herbalists, sacrifices and fruitless hunting for so-called witches that are allegedly behind all infant deaths.

**Nnenna Anyaele,
Surulere, Lagos.**

4. THE NEW 6-3-3-4 SYSTEM OF EDUCATION WILL BE BENEFICIAL TO YOUTHS OF NIGERIA

The Principal and Staff, Mr. Moderator, Fellow Students, Ladies and Gentlemen. I say good morning to all of you. I am David Frank from Ikeja Grammar School. I am here this morning to propose the motion that the new 6-3-3-4 system of education will be of immense benefit to the youths of Nigeria.

To put the horse before the cart, an introductory remark or definition of the new system is vital. It emphasizes equally and blends basic theoretical teachings with practical training in diverse useful areas like bakery, auto-mechanics, woodworks, welding and computer studies and so on and so forth. Its superiority over the old system cannot be over-emphasized.

The system develops the non-academic talents or skills of our young boys and girls. By the end of the first three years in college, most learners would have been properly exposed to carpentry, bakery, welding and a host of other technical professions. This set of college graduates will not wait for paid jobs before they fend for themselves with their hands and tools.

The technical skills acquired in secondary schools can be easily further developed in higher institutions of learning like polytechnics and technical colleges because the learner technicians also have academic qualifications that will enable them to pass the matriculation examinations.

Even those who go to universities to be engineers, doctors, teachers, accountants and other professionals will find very useful in their adult lives the technical skills in farming, carpentry, tailoring, welding, carving, plumbing, auto-engineering, typing and so on acquired in secondary school. An adult lawyer, for instance, may easily do some plumbing repairs in his apartment without the assistance of the full-time plumber.

One big advantage of the 6-3-3-4 system of education is that it will reduce drastically the rate of youth unemployment and the disturbing or retrogressive phenomenon of 'area boys' in our society. The excuse that people can't feed themselves because they couldn't attend tertiary institutions will not be tenable.

My fellow debaters, distinguished audience, the new system of education will reduce our dependence on foreign technicians who troop into Nigeria to make a lot of money and only repatriate it while we are made poorer. We all know how many foreign carpenters, tailors, welders, shoemakers and menders, carpenters and so on who were in Nigeria prior to the introduction of this new

educational system. This exploitation by foreigners who are not more qualified than their Nigerian counterparts was made possible because they attended technical colleges similar to our new system.

The new system is beneficial to the youths because it gives technical training and skills to those that need them, and enables those who want to be professionals to do so without any setbacks or hindrance. It is a system of education that enables our youths to kill many birds with one stone.

I thank you all for your attention.

5.

Remo Secondary School,
P.O.Box 2001,
5th April, 1989.

The Principal,
Remo Secondary School,
Shagamu.

Dear Sir,

REPORT ON THE STUDENTS' EXCURSION TO ABEEKUTA

In my capacity as the president of the Geographical and Historical Societies of our great college and the leader of the just concluded excursion to Abeokuta, the state capital, I wish to report to you our experience on our way from the excursion town. Since brevity is the soul of wit, I shall save you the details of the excursion proper. But suffice it to say that it will remain memorable to all of us that participated. By the time we succeeded in visiting all the geographical and historical sites, institutions, monuments and paying courtesy calls to a few eminent personalities in the ancient town, we were already very tired, worn out, and hungry. Little did we know that this was the beginning of our problems.

About fifteen minutes journey out of Abeokuta, we had a flat tyre near one hamlet. We all came down. The driver, Mr. Ogundina and myself set about replacing the bad tyre. This took us some time because the jack was not functioning. As a result, the students were asked to raise the side of the car up for the wheel to be removed. That part of the car was wedged with a big stone. Using the same method, we were able to replace the punctured tyre with the spare one.

By 7.30pm, the replacement was through. We boarded the car again and continued the journey. After about some minuter drive, we saw a group of four youngmen and two ladies in what looked like school uniforms. They waved to our vehicle to stop. Since there was space in the vehicle, the driver stopped to pick them along. Immediately the bus stopped, they began to give orders. It dawned on us that they were young armed robbers. They held different dangerous weapons; cutlasses, clubs, arrows, a piece of iron rod and a gun. First, there was silence in the bus. The driver, the other officials of the society in the bus and myself were confused.

It was Mater Tunde Balogun whom God used to rescue us. Master Balogun is the leader of the college's man-o-war cadets and boys' scouts' master. During that moment of indecision and confusion, he cleared his husky voice and shouted sorn military - like orders: "Brave men and officers, this is the kind of moment we have been training and waiting for: I, Commander Balogun now and hereby command you all to rise, cock your guns and shoot all these enemies of peace and society' Like a magic formula, these miscreants and young hoodlums dived and disappeared into the nearby bush.

Quickly, the driver continued our journey home. Everybody was visibly shaken to the bone marrow. God, through the soldierly conduct of Tunde Balogun saved us from an unspeakable calamity.

These two negative incidents at the end of our excursion almost marred the success of the excursion. We thank God for his protection.

And we are very grateful to the school authorities for making it possible morally and financially for my society to make the excursion this year.

**David Frank,
President.**

6. Godwin's College,
P.M.B. 556,
Ovrode,
Isoko Lccal Government,
Delta State.
7th February, 1989.

Dear Dave,

I hereby acknowledge the receipt of your last letter which you wrote on the 15th of Jan'iary 1989. Dave, I sincerely appreciate your advice

and the little gift enclosed in the letter. It is with gladness and enthusiasm that I am going to presently satisfy your request that I should describe how we prepare one of our local recipes so that you can try your hand on it over there. This is a most friendly request because it brings you a step closer to my culture. Because Nigera is culturally diverse and rich, we have so many dishes. However, I want to describe for you how to prepare Ukwa Awil Porridge. Ukwa is a tropical fruit which is a unique food or snack for most Easterners in Nigeria. Ukwa can be served as snacks when its seeds are roasted and served with palm kernel or coconut.

Ukwa is very rich in carbohydrate and contains little fat, and when cooked with other ingredients, it becomes a highly nutritious and well balanced recipe. Ukwa has a peculiar tantalizing aroma. Efu seeds, a local spice and pumpkin fruit add to the taste of ukwa pomdge. This pomdge can be taken any me of the day and by anybody Indeed, most eldedy people prefer eating uk' to eating tice.

We have direct access to ukwa fruits in my locality. You can buy ukwa fruits from an Ibo seller of foodstuffs in your area. To prepare Ukwa Awii Pdr ridge for 3-4 persons, get 3 cups of breadfruits seeds, 1 pumpkin fruit, 1/2 kilo of liver or tongue, 3/4 milk tin of crayfish, 1 table spoon of salt, 2 kitchen spoon of red oil, 2 efu seeds, 2 red peppers, 1 onion, 4 pinch of thyme, water as much as possible.

Wash the pumpkin fruit, cut, remove the hard back and the seeds inside the fruit. Cut into desirable shapes and sizes.

Wash tongue or liver, cut into small sizes. Add onion, salt, thyme and seasoning. Cook till they are tender. Put the ukwa seeds in pot, add plenty of water, allow to cook for 36 minutes. Check whether the seeds are tender or not, add a pinch of potash. Allow to cook for another ten minutes. Remove as much of the water as possible into a flask. Add the pumpkin fruit, ground pepper, crayfish, efu seed, red oil and salt to the ukwa seed. Allow to cook for 10 minutes. Stir the food, taste it for salt then serve. The cooked Ukwa Awil Porridge will be served with some of the water which was earlier on removed.

**Your friend,
Ngozi Okoro.**

**1988 ANSWERS TO THE COMPREHENSIONS
PART B**

7. (a)(i) old (ii) trouble (iii) treasured (iv) complaining (v) attached (vi) period.
- (b) The whites were resettled on high ground to match their new posts. Secondly, this was done to remove them from the high density mosquitoes of the low lands
- (c) The Krios were determined in the economic, political as well as religious spheres.
- (d)(i) The Krios had a great love for education and spirit of protestantism which they still maintained.
(ii) They raised the standard of education in Freetown to meet the demand of the neighbouring country.
- (e) At the beginning of the century also, after the control of malaria by quinine and the resettlement of the whites on high ground at Hill Station, the British Administration decided to change its policy of appointing Krios to high posts, and appointed Europeans instead, some of them with lower qualifications.
8. (a) He had been living on his parents for food, shelter and clothing.
- (b) Kola has been depending on his parents and this will stop henceforth.
- (c) One thinks that he could not afford it financially and his parents may not approve such a thing.

(d) Kola's parents were glad caring for him because they could not, again, bear the pains of his return to America after missing him for ten years.

(e) He was then not a man because his dependence on his parents meant that his freedom as a man was being curtailed.

(f)(i) Memorable day (ii) Wandered about (III) Compulsory (iv) Kindly (v) Speechless (g)(i) Adverbial phrase (ii) Modifies "looked".

Note: The candidates are not required to provide many synonyms to words that appear in question like (f) above. The above alternatives are given to enable the would be candidates to know that a word can have correct possible answers or synonyms. A candidate should provide only one synonymous word or phrase.

SUMMARY ANSWERS

9. (a)(i) The farmers cultivated food crops (ii) They reared animals for food, trade and transport
- (b)(i) Artisans engaged in blacksmithing, leather works and wood carving that attract many tourists and traders. (ii). The graceful artistic output draws extra attention for the undecided visitors
- (c)(i) The traders advertised the available products. (ii). The traders go on looking for buyers, facilitating contact for both buyers and sellers and probably of personal interest.

SENIOR SCHOOL CERTIFICATE EXAMINATION (SSCE 1988 – 2015)

Past Questions with Solutions

English Language

(Theory / Objectives with Oral English) 1989

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WASSCE NOVEMBER 1989 ENGLISH LANGUAGE 2 OBJECTIVE TEST QUESTIONS

SECTION 1

Instruction: Choose the word **opposite** in meaning to the underlined word.

1. One of the armed robbers was as daring in his words at the stake as the other was
A. morose B. secretive C. reckless D. timid
E. rational.
2. His outspokenness contrasts with the of the father
A. humour B. sobriety C. deafness
D. dumbness E. taciturnity.
3. A gully, which is a natural phenomenon, could not be mistaken for a tunnel, which is
A. supernatural B. false C. artificial D. imitative
E. modern
4. It is curious how Bayo can be so carefree in his ways when his brother is so
A. meticulous B. eccentric C. easy-going
D. lovable E. indifferent
5. Personally, I give in rather easily when it comes to arguments, but Emeka will always to his opinions.
A. hold in B. hold on C. give out D. hold off
E. hold back
6. He intentionally threw the documents away and somebody burnt them
A. carelessly B. willingly C. accidentally
D. foolishly E. fortunately
7. The crops the farmer planted were by some naughty boys
A. sowed B. weeded C. destroyed
D. cultivated E. uprooted.
8. The man refused to accept the offer of a job in the rural areas; he preferred one in the area
A. local B. urban C. municipal D. township
E. zonal.

SECTION 2

After each of the following sentences, a list of possible interpretations of all or part of the sentence is given. Choose the interpretation you consider **appropriate** for each sentence.

9. The candidates were told that passing the examination wasn't a passport to getting an admission
A. a guarantee of B. a suggestion in
C. an equivalent D. a necessity for
E. an intention for
10. She tried to throw dust in my eyes
A. blow dust into my eyes B. fight me
C. rebuke me D. mislead me
E. make me blind.
11. Despite the different economic measures taken by the government, the country is not yet out of the wood
A. on the right path B. undeveloped
C. generating enough money from its forest resources
D. free from difficulties
E. above comfort
12. Our House swept the board in the inter-house sports competition
A. prepared the field B. came last
C. was completely successful
D. was only partially successful
E. won a consolation prize.
13. The preacher advised those who lost their property in the fire outbreak that every cloud has a silverlining
A. the loss is a common
B. everybody must witness misfortunes in life
C. every cloud has some silvery lines behind it
D. when there is life, there is hope
E. there is a good side to all misfortunes.
14. My father always advised me to take time by the forelock
A. use an opportunity promptly
B. take things easy C. be clever
D. always hurry up
E. think twice before I act

15. Soyinka has made his mark in the literary world
A. become rich B. become distinguished
C. scored high marks D. stressed his point
E. won the competition for authors
16. The runners-up trophy which our school ate won was cold comfort for all the efforts we made
A. befitting reward B. wet comfort
C. an affectionate consideration
D. well deserved E. a poor consolation.
17. Amina used to be hand in glove with her's boyfriend
A. cheat her boyfriend
B. admire her boyfriend
C. fight her boyfriend
D. wear her boyfriend's glove
E. be close relations with her boyfriend.
18. Chike escaped the accident by a hair's breadth
A. narrowly B. jumping C. seriously injured
D. holding on to another person's hair
E. crying for help.

SECTION 3

*From the words lettered A to E below each of the following sentences, choose the word or group of words that is **nearest in meaning** to the underlined expression as it is used in the sentence.*

19. The dedsion taken by the panel is irrevocable
A. irreversible B. unexpected C. acceptable
D. irresponsible E. unacceptable.
20. Death is inevitable for man
A. unavoidable B. essential C. necessary
D. immortal E. imminent
21. The superintend.ent was appalled by the attitude of some of the employees towards their work.
A. annoyed B. disappointed C. shocked
D. provoked E. depressed
22. The lawyer's argument of the case was exhaustive
A. interesting B. exaggerating C. exhilarating
D. thorough E. fascinating
23. The suspect was made to walk in front of the anxious crowds
A. surprised B. astonished C. engrossed
D. curious E. questionable.

24. The principal's orders are imperative
A. lenient B. authoritative C. genuine
D. necessary E. optional
25. It is absurd to suggest that Tunde should marry that saucy lady
A. pitiable B. hopeless C. humorous
D. untrue E. ridiculous
26. I am very proud to speak before this august assembly
A. ignominious B. undignified C. monthly
D. untrue E. popular
27. She tried to settle the quarrel but the man remained obstinate to listen to her
A. offensive B. angry C. stubborn
D. unstable E. impolite
28. Okon attempted to entice Eno with the promise of a handsome sum of money
A. deceive B. enchant C. force D. trick
E. tempt
29. The monk lived an ascetic life in order to discipline himself.
A. a holy B. a religious C. an enjoyable
D. a prayerful E. an austere

SECTION 4

*After each of the following sentences, a list of possible interpretations of all or part of the sentence is given. Choose the interpretation that you consider **appropriate** for each sentence.*

30. Despite their newness on the job, the workers were remunerated rather handsomely. This means that
A. the sum paid was poor
B. those paid were handsome in appearance
C. the system of payment was quite attractive
D. the sum paid out was quite attractive
E. the workers were paid by handsome officials.
31. The plan to upgrade the dispensary to a general hospital did not materialize. This means that
A. the arrangement did not work out as wished
B. the plan was badly executed
C. it was difficult to obtain the materials.
D. the materials purchased were not the right ones
E. the plan did not meet the required specifications.

32. When the principal was asked what his opinion was on the controversial issue, his reply was ambiguous. This means that the principal's reply was not
A. convincing B. audible C. intelligent
D. clear E. comprehensible.
33. Even though Susan was the last in the examination, her result wasn't too different from what had been expected. This means that
A. her result was a disappointment
B. her result was as expected
C. she had not been serious with her studies
D. her result was known early
E. her poor performance made her feel sad.
34. Despite their strangely unrefined behaviour, the foreigners were given preferential treatment. This means that the foreigners were
A. ill-treated because of their coarseness
B. cautioned before they were attended to
C. well-treated despite their rudeness
D. not attended to because of their behaviour
E. sorry for their unrefined behaviour.

SECTION 5

*From the words or group of words lettered A to D, choose the one that **best completes** each of the following sentences.*

35. Mrs. Adam's purchased.....
A. a pure leather bag imported
B. an imported pure leather bag
C. a leather bag imported pure
D. an imported bag pure leather
36. The students protested against the.....
A. thrice sports weekly practice
B. weekly sports practice thrice
C. thrice weekly sports practice
D. weekly thrice sports practice.
37. It was apparent that we were being.....by the heat as soon as the air conditioner was switched off
A. beaten B. stifled C. attacked D. bitten
38. The eldest son took a foolish decision which made him.....his claim to the additional chieftaincy title.
A. neglect B. yield C. disclaim D. forfeit
39. Jumai's stay in the hotel afforded her..... chance to do her writing
A. ample B. insufficient C. powerful D. opportune

40. If I.....what actually happened, I would have punished him
A. had heard B. have had C. had had
D. have heard
41. Itif the leader of the group had come with them
A. will have been better
B. ought to have being better
C. would have been better
D. shall have been better
42. It is time we.....for the party
A. leave B. left C. have to leave D. will leave
43. The suspect.....when I entered the office
A. has been questioned
B. have been questioned
C. was being questioned
D. is being questioned.
44. She.....before I entered the office
A. has to be questioned
B. has been questioned
C. have been questioned
D. had been questioned
45. The president's speech.....at 7pm yesterday
A. is broadcast B. has been broadcast
C. were broadcast D. was broadcast
46. You were punished because you..... last week without permission
A. ought not to have travelled
B. must not have travelled
C. ought not to travel
D. will not have travelled.
47. It has been rough so far,.....?
A. hasn't it B. hadn't it C. isn't it D. wasn't it
48. The Minister says he is accountable.....the president, and nobody else
A. from B. to C. with D. by
49. Nobody was surprised that the thief was convicted.....all the charges
A. on B. with C. of D. over
50. The PTA meeting did not adjourn until it had discussed all the matters placed.....it.
A. by B. with C. before D. over
51. My uncle is an expert.....Mechanical Engineering
A. at B. in C. with D. for

52.is the owner of this pair of scissors?
A. Who B. Whom C. Which D. Whose
53. My mother was pleased.....me when she learnt of my success
A. with B. at C. in D. for
54. Musa was disappointed and decided to take it.....Maryam
A. with B. at C. in D. out on
55. The students refused to appear before the..... panel set up to look into their demands
A. five-man's B. five-man C. five-men's D. five-men
56. He played.....than anyone else
A. worse B. badly C. more worse D. worst
57. She can't sing.....as I had thought
A. so well B. good C. well D. as well
58. Tayo was very obstinate; the more his mother insisted.....willingly would he do anything
A. the more B. as less C. the less D. so less
59. There was.....enough food to go round
A. scarcely B. a little C. almost D. little
60. That child.....nearly caused an accident.
A. rather B. just C. very D. fairly.
61. The students did the assignment, but not.....the way I had expected
A. so B. quite C. hardly D. as
62. Osaro told members of his club that the match would kick.....at 430pm
A. up B. off C. back D. on
63. Ngozi.....comes to see us now
A. scarcely never B. almost ever C. never more D. hardly ever
64. As the opposing parties would not agree, the peace meeting.....in confusion.
A. broke out B. broke through C. broke off D. broke up
65. Mallam Gana owns many.....on his farm
A. cattles B. herd of cattle C. heads of cattle D. head of cattle.
66. I want to know your religious.....
A. believe B. believing C. beliefs D. believes

67. He runs.....
A. rather much fast B. quite rather fast
C. rather too fast D. too rather fast.
68. The previous assignment was.....for me
A. much too difficult B. too much difficult
C. difficult too much D. much difficult too
69. The TV set.....was damaged last week has been taken to an electronics engineer
A. which B. who C. of whom D. of which
70. My.....house is by the side of the road
A. father-in-law's B. father's-in-law
C. fathers-in-law D. father-in-laws'
71. The students were advised to look.....difficult words in the dictionary
A. in B. on C. out D. up

SECTION 6

*In the following passages the numbered gaps indicate missing words, against each number in the list below each passage five choices are offered in columns lettered A to E. For each question, choose the word that is the **most suitable** to fill the numbered gap in the passage.*

PASSAGE A

In Nigeria, the idea of taking a vacation cannot be said to have—72—. This is not to — 73 — that Nigerians are not — 74 — of travelling. The people travel so — 75—that the frequency of the travelling could provide useful —76— for a — 77—census. The — 78 — of the year — 79 — matters — 80 —Nigerians are — 81 — studied, it will be — 82 — that they move across the — 83 — of the country at an — 84 — high rate. Such movements reach a — 85 — with the — 86 — of festivals. All such times, Nigerians troop out despite the — 87 — charges imposed by transport owners.

	A	B	C	D	E
72	sunk on	caught on	caught in	taken in	come on
73	think	withdraw	consider	suggest	disprove
74	disposed	found	kind	inclined	ford
75	always	quickly	uniformly	often	aimlessy
76	data	malice	subjects	items	date
77	stable	seasonal	traffic	regular	seasonal
78	duration	age	time	session	soon
79	rely	narrowly	always	regular	clearly
80	where	why	if	because	when
81	really	racely	quickly	scierctically	closely
82	known	discovered	uncovered	arrived	concluded
83	length and	length and	length and	length and	breadth and
	size	depth	breath	corner	size
84	amazingly	arguably	equally	endlessly	moderately
85	crescendo	rise	height	increase	peak
86	inherent	arriving	entire	about	adventure
87	unusual	excellent	expensive	exclusive	basic

PASSAGE B

When you desire to erect a building, you must — 88 — a plan that is — 89 — both from the point of view of — 90 — and that of — 91 —. The — 92 — must be — 93 — cleared. Having decided — 94 — the building materials to be — 95 — the foundation is then — 96 —. The builder then — 97 — to erect the building. He — 98 — that the bricks are of the — 99 — recommended by — 100 — builders.

A 88. work by 89. beautiful 90. cost 91. various 92. floor 93. thoroughly 94. in 95. built 96. pre-laid 97. continues 98. er sa to 99. rigidity 100. architectural	B work from commendable annual areas ground sandy will managed dig demands assumes flexibility commissioned	C work in admirable price control site rarely on headed levelled prepares assumes standard supervisory	D work on qualitative payment atmosphere bush commonly under needed heavy commences measures medium professional	E work for practicable pull environment etc gradely up used arranged requests presumes solidity pragmatic
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WASSCE NOVEMBER 1989 ENGLISH LANGUAGE 2 OBJECTIVE TEST ANSWERS

1.D	2.E	3.C	4.A	5.B	6.C	7.E
8.B	9.A	10.D	11.D	12.C	13.E	14.A
15.B	16.E	17.E	18.A	19.A	20.A	21.C
22.D	23.D	24.B	25.E	26.E	27.C	28.E
29.E	30.D	31.A	32.D	33.B	34.C	35.B
36.C	37.B	38.D	39.A	40.A	41.C	42.B
43.C	44.D	45.D	46.A	47.A	48.B	49.A
50.C	51.B	52.A	53.A	54.D	55.B	56.A
57.D	58.C	59.A	60.C	61.B	62.B	63.D
64.D	65.B	66.C	67.D	68.A	69.A	70.A
71.D	72.D	73.D	74.E	75.D	76.A	77.D
78.C	79.A	80.C	81.E	82.B	83.C	84.A
85.E	86.D	87.B	88.D	89.E	90.A	91.B
92.C	93.A	94.C	95.E	96.B	97.D	98.A
99.C	100.D					

WASSCE NOVEMBER 1989 ENGLISH LANGUAGE 1 THEORY QUESTIONS

PART A

1. Your school has been invited to participate in a debate on the topic: Co-education in secondary schools should be abolished. Write out your speech for or against the motion.
2. Write a letter to the Commissioner for Agriculture informing him of the invasion, by certain pests, of farms in your locality and asking for advice and help in controlling them.
3. There has been an outcry in the country against the desire to get rich qtiiekfy, bribery and corruption, embezzlement of public funds and other forms of mcal decadence. Write an article, suitable for publication in a national magazine, stating the causes of these social evils and suggesting possible solutions.
4. There has been a violent demonstration in your school in which damage was done to school property. Write a report for the pnpncipal stating the causes of the demonstration, and what you think shoud be done to prevent a recurrence of such an incident.
5. In a letter to your brother who has been studying abroad for the past five years, describe at least three ways in which the current economic situation has affected the way of life of your family.

6. Narrate an experience you have had or heard about which illustrates the saying: Honesty is the best policy'.

PART B

SECTION I

COMPREHENSION

7. *Read the following passage carefully and answer the questions on it.*

It was a sunny day in the month of May. The sun took its rightful position very early, lending credence to the general feeling that Andrew's birthday ceremony was going to be greeted with the blessing of a pleasant climate. The sky looked so bright that Andrew insisted on having an open-air party. The habitual doubting Thomases had no dissenting opinions to express. Andrew had gone to a great length to ensure a hitch-free party, a party which would remain the talk of the town. Although it was not intended to be free for all, a lot had been done to stamp the occasion on the memories of many people long afterwards.

The bright sun continued to smile. Andrew's face beamed with pleasure with every passing moment. Very few of his contemporaries have so succeeded in reaching the top of the ladder. Andrew in particular had been an orphan of storm. His father's death during his third year in the secondary school and that of his mother two years later were only two of this orphan's 'storms'. He suffered a physical misfortune when a stockfish

machine severed his left middle finger. But Andrew did not despair.

The courage to fail is very cheap. Every fool can afford to fail, but it raises one above the herd of cowards and never-do-wells to be up and struggling. The reward of forbearance in the end is resounding success.

And so it was for Andrew. Ever since he finished his university education, it had been success galore. He had got a good job in one of the country's insurance companies. His pay was good, his promotion had been steady and his prospects seemed bright. At forty, he had a good car and had already bought a house of his own. The world was at his feet.

(a) Give, in word or phrase, the meaning of each of the following words, as used in the passage:

(i) dissenting; (ii) stamp; (iii) contemporaries

(b) What figure of speech is The bright sun continued to smile? (c)(i) What kind of grammatical structure is the courage to fail? (ii) What is its function in the sentence? (d) What two hardships had Andrew gone through in life? (e) What is implied by the expression: The world was at his feet?

8. Read the following passage carefully and answer the questions on it.

The finest asset any child can have is a happy home. Such environment will enable him to develop strength and stability of character, thereby teaching him to face the future without fear or undue anxiety. It also will give him something worthwhile to live for. If he exhibits good judgement in later years, much of the credit must go to those who trained him. If he fails, it may have been due to troubles in his home, his school or unsympathetic and hostile relatives. A great percentage of juvenile problems can be traced to faulty home education and unwholesome influences in early childhood. Undoubtedly, there would be fewer juvenile delinquents if there were more homes where children learned to love and respect their fellow men.

Remember this: happy parents create happy homes; happy homes produce happy children; happy children make happy communities and happy communities make a happier world.

(a) Give **one** word that could replace each of the following in the passage: (i) asset (ii) stability; (iii) worthwhile; (iv) exhibits; (v) hostile; (vi) unwholesome (b) State in **three** sentences, **three** reasons given by the writer to support his view that a happy home is the finest asset any child can have. (c) What does the writer mean by: (i)

undue anxiety (ii) juvenile delinquents? (d) Give, from the passage, one: (i) abstract noun which means honour or praise; (ii) adverb which certainly; (iii) verb which means make or produce (e) In one sentence state why you think the author uses the word happy in the last paragraph.

SECTION II SUMMARY

9. Read the following passage carefully and answer the questions on it.

Most of the discussions in the newspapers today in Nigeria focus on the problem of corruption and its pervasive effects on our national life. It is a phenomenon which appears to have settled comfortably with us, for now regard it, in a rather casual manner, as a normal way of life. One may then wish to ask, what exactly is the complexion of corruption in Nigeria? Why is it so pervasive and how can it be minimized, if not completely eradicated? "

Corruption takes many forms in the country. Contracts are not awarded on the objective criteria of professional competence and results of good feasibility studies. It is a matter of personal relationships, club affiliations or the expectation of some kickbacks. Loans are not given out by banks on the merit of what you need them for; it is the kick-backs from the loans that decide the manager's approval. Those who need jobs either have to bribe their way through to get the jobs or they do not get any.

Limited opportunities, the fast declining state of the economy, poor awareness of the rights the state allows, dire needs and a host of others have often been cited as factors responsible for the picture painted above.

Many suggestions have been offered for the alleviation of the problem. Some of these suggestions are practical while others appear unrealistic especially in the context of the present orientation in the country. However, the view being held in this write-up is that the problem of corruption can only be tackled by the application of some practical solution. Thus, we have to start with our leaders. It is being suggested here that our leaders must learn to lead by example. It is not enough for them to condemn corruption; they themselves must not be seen to be involved in any dirty practice. This calls for a great deal of honesty from them coupled with an appreciable degree of integrity and the readiness to help others be cheaply rewarded.

Our educational system needs a serious overhaul to achieve some positive result 'be, teaching programmes must include subjects like Civics and Social Studies which normally expose students to their rights, the rights of such right and

the virtues of good neighbourliness. Moral instruction in the schools should be tilted in favour of those imperatives that emphasize justice, fairness and selflessness. In addition, we need a radical reorientation with regard to our value system in the country. There should be less emphasis on the acquisition of material things. Those things that help to uplift the glory and name of the country need to be promoted.

(a) In two short sentences, give the writer's reasons for the wide-spread corruption in Nigeria.

(b) In one short sentence, explain the common pattern that corruption takes in the country.

(c) In three short sentences, summarize what the writer considers to be the practical solutions to the problem of corruption in the country.

WASSCE NOVEMBER 1989 ENGLISH LANGUAGE 1 THEORY ANSWERS

1. CO-EDUCATION IN SECONDARY SCHOOLS SHOULD BE ABOLISHED

Mr. Chairman, panel of judges, moderator, ladies and gentlemen, fellow debaters and students, I hereby counter the motion which states that co-education in secondary schools should be abolished. First, it is necessary to define what co-education means for a better understanding of the topic. Co-education is an arrangement whereby female and male students are brought under the same roof for the purpose of learning and exchange of ideas during learning process. My contention is that such an arrangement should be encouraged in our educational system. The reasons are as follows: God created all animals male and female. This is more so in our human families where husbands and wives, brothers and sisters co-habit. Since the school is one of the most essential human institutions it will be an aberration for youngmen and women not to learn about themselves in the same school, society, and subjects that are supposed to increase their happiness separately. Co-education increases mutual understanding. Co-education promotes or enables unity among people particularly between men and women. Unity can only be promoted if different male and female students learn together and understand themselves better.

Co-education makes it possible for our future fathers and mothers to be exposed to the same and equal training devoid of discrimination and injustice. It is a truism that whatever is good for the goose is also good for the gander.

Separate schools for boys and girls is hypocritical. It generates suspicion and gender curiosity which is counter productive. Experience or observations have shown that girls from an all females school are always unduly or foolishly excited about boys whenever they occasionally meet them during extra curricula activities within their school or outside. Ditto for boys from an all boys college. This enables such boys and girls to do foolish immoral things during such meets at the expense of what they are supposed to be there for.

Co-education systematically and naturally gives practical and balanced orientation to the young boys and girls. The principal and the staff always teach the mixed students not to be excited about the opposite sex because they will soon be in positions to marry and live together in matrimony, work together as colleagues, live in the same town as neighbours, friends or fellow citizens. There is no basis for their separate training while in school because of some obscurantists or mysterious teachings of misguided religionists and moral bigots. It is better for young girls and boys to begin to study and know themselves under their teachers if we desire a society where peaceful marriages and happy homes will flourish.

Male and female students from mixed schools easily adjust themselves in the society, having acquired exposure and mutual understanding. Infact, the rights of women in the society emanate from the orientation received from co-educational institutions. Giving practical and balanced orientation to boys and girls at equal level makes co-education worthwhile.

2. 19, Johnson Anyaele Street,
Ikorodu,
Ikorodu Local Government,
Lagos State.
3rd May, 1990.

The Honourable Commissioner,
Ministry of Agriculture,
Ikeja,
Lagos State.

Dear Sir

THE THREAT OF PESTS TO OUR CROPS

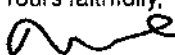
I on behalf of the entire farming community of Ikorodu Local Government hereby write to inform you about the unexpected invasion of a

swarm of locust-like pests which have been causing havoc this past one week.

This community as you are aware of is an agrarian one and we pride ourselves as committed farmers who have been contributing immensely to the annual rich agricultural harvests in the state. Because of the good early rains of this year, we are expecting bountiful harvests two months from now. This beautiful and rewarding realisation of our dreams will be thwarted if the menace of these pests is not curbed and controlled with concerted efforts of the local farmers and your ministry. The pests eat up leafy plants and even attempt to eat up fruits.

The uncontrolled invasion of these pests will affect us adversely in a number of ways. We may not be able to pay our taxes, rates and levies promptly. Secondly, it will reduce our harvests and thereby threaten our saleable produce and destroy the chances of preserving some quantities in the food storage silos which your ministry has just built. So far our local efforts at controlling the pests have not achieved much because they are limited individualistic solutions.

I kindly request you to use your good offices and resources to send for our immediate assistance pesticides with some equipment and effective spraying materials. After the pests must have been eradicated, we require your ministry's experts to teach us the farmers how to apply the chemicals, teach us how to prevent future occurrence and/or minimise their impact if they invade our farm sites again. We will appreciate your assistance in this regard.

Yours faithfully,

Alhaji Majeyagba.

3. THE EVILS OF MATERIALISM IN OUR SOCIETY

The desire to get rich quick, greed, insatiable love for materialism, power tussle and social malaise have almost caught up with every Nigerian. That is to say, the love for money is the root of all evils. Man and woman, young and old have new dimension of corrupt indulgence on daily basis. The main causes of corrupt practices are greed and insatiable love for materialism. Everybody wants to own and ride exotic cars at all cost. Every citizen wants to own as many houses as possible. Nowadays, it is very possible to hear people boast of having many chieftaincy titles and degrees, designer shoes, dresses and bags that are now in vogue. These endless desires lead to

different forms of moral decadence in our society. Corrupt practices are further fuelled by power-hungry politicians and military personnel who spend huge sums of money to acquire political power. Such money are got either by embezzlement of public funds or any other fraudulent means.

Another cause of this social malaise is traceable to societal value system in which diligence, honesty, honour and integrity are no longer accorded the respect they deserve. Material fortune speaks louder than such virtues these days. Who doesn't know the high rate of corruption in offices and public places? The dimension and language attached to it is viz: 'settlement', 'see me', and 'Egunje', which are popularly used. Bribery and corruption have eaten deep into the marrow of our society. The practice is now integrated into the normal way of life and is regarded as "fastness". This evil of materialism brought about the fast declining state of our economy and limited opportunity for the poor masses.

However, to alleviate the problem of social ills, all hands must be on deck. There must be total overhauling from those at the top. Our leaders must learn to lead by example. It is not enough for them to condemn corruption on the pages of newspapers and not show good examples. Secondly, if we have the fear of God, honesty, hardwork and the love of our country, we shall succeed. In addition, law enforcement agents must sit up against bribery and corruption. Above all, we must all discipline ourselves to live within our means and not to allow the frenzy to be rich to overwhelm us.

4. Prince Godwin Grammar School,
18/29, David Road,
Surciere,
4th August, 1991.

The Principal,
Prince Godwin Grammar School,
Surulere,
Lagos.

Dear Madam,

REPORT ON THE VIOLENT DEMONSTRATION IN THE SCHOOL

The violent and destructive students' demonstration which took place on Monday the 27th of July 1991 was unprecedented in the annals of this institution and it was triggered by three remote and immediate causes. It is a serious thing

that both the day and boarding students of this great college exploded on the same date due to many unaddressed known grievances,

The boarders have complained in the past that the quality and quantity of food served were small and bad. The students have in a variety of ways hitherto complained to the matron who controls the cooks. I as the senior prefect together with the food prefect had complained to the matron on behalf of the students. Promises were made to improve the situation and nothing happened positively.

The day students have always laid the blame of their late coming to school on the doorsteps of the school authorities who have refused to approve additional buses for their transport daily. The one bus approved is rickety, slow and small.

The rice and beans breakfast was burnt and consequently had a bitter taste. The boarders refused to eat it and instead marched round the compound singing solidarity songs. The aggrieved day students also joined the march.

Later they became violent and destructive, torching the quarters where the principal and his vice live. The matron's home, staff room, some teachers who were alleged to have been corrupt or partial in their assessment were not spared. The rickety bus was burnt. May be we should thank God for the absence of most of the staff and the families of the senior school officials.

I sincerely pray that you will use your good offices first to institute an investigative panel to find out more on the immediate and remote causes of the demonstration. They will also assess the damage and proffer solutions so that such an incident will not recur.

John Ahmed,
Senior Prefect.

5. 92, Adesegun Tokunbo St.
Ijeshatedo,
Surulere,
Lagos.
25th October, 1990.

Dear Ufoma,

How are your health condition and your studies? I hope your existence and legitimate pursuits are not affected by the recent racism-inspired anti-black demonstration by the racial bigots. By now you may be wondering what is happening back home. This letter is to put in the new picture of how the prevailing economic

climate in Nigeria is adversely affecting us directly and indirectly.

Since the deregulation of our national economy by the military administration, the naira has been depreciated and devalued beyond any previously foreseen level. Our currency which was exchanging \$1 to N 100 has gone down to \$1 to N 150.00. By now, you will understand why our old man has not sent any money for your legal scholarship. You can calculate by yourself how much naira Daddy needs to send you, for an ordinary \$500.00. Over here we have cut down drastically on slaughtering of goats, turkey, rams and the purchase of expensive fresh fishes.

With the exception of myself who am about sitting for my school certificate examinations in that private college in Ikeja, all the remaining children are now attending public schools. Can you imagine this? Inflation has made everything to be expensive. It is only the multi-millionaires that can do such things. The dwindling business fortunes of our mummy and daddy have informed their decision to sub-let the three flats in the ground floor of our house. They had to change their mind from reserving them for family use. Do you know what? Each flat is fetching us close to N10,000 monthly.

I thereby advise you to begin to look for more part-time jobs to earn more money to maintain yourself. And when you finish, please work for some time to earn some hard currency for yourself and may be for us too. Dollar has been inadvertently converted to gold in Nigeria: Please convey my warm regards to your friends and Lilian your girlfriend.

Your brother,
David.

6. HONESTY IS THE BEST POLICY

Mr. Rasaki is a professional driver, a poor one for that matter. Apart from his wife and few children, his worthiest property or belonging is his rickety Peugeot 504 salon car which he drives about in Lagos for taxi cab business. Quite often passengers would forget one item or the other in his car. He honestly and conscientiously takes such articles or money back to his branch of the taxi cab drivers' association office so that the owners of the discovered items could recover them. Each time he discovered any such items he would report and submit them to the officials of this association. He often told his wife and one of his close friends who incidentally is a taxi cab operator too. Mrs. Rasaki would scold her husband for the abnormal passion of her husband

of always wanting to be a perpetual poor man, as it were.

Mr. Segun Jinadu, Rasaki's friend, saw nothing wrong with keeping for his personal use items or money forgetfully left behind in his taxi cab. He never returned anything to his association. He always re-assured himself that after all God has many ways of blessing a person. So, whenever Rasaki told him that he returned one big parcel or some small amount of money to the lost and found section of their drivers' association, Mr. Jinadu would laugh at him and call him a big fool who would die a poorer man than he was then.

There was this day when a rich European businessman and his equally rich Ibo business friend forgot one of their suitcases containing money in Mr. Rasaki's taxi. He immediately took it to the drivers' park where the suitcase was opened and half a million naira was found therein. He went to the radio station where it was announced that the two men who forgot a suitcase in his cab earlier in the day should come to his house to retrieve their item and that he was waiting for them in a specific address. Mr. David Frank and Mr. Daniel Okafor who had been making frantic efforts to trace the driver, heard the announcement of Mr. Rasaki. They took two policemen and some journalists along to Mr. Rasaki's residence. The businessmen were extremely happy.

Out of gratitude, they gave him N50,000, while the press men took his photograph. He granted interviews to both the print and electronic media. He became a celebrity overnight. The Whiteman sponsored his trip to London for one week tourist's visit and he was even featured in the British Broadcasting Corporation (BBC). Some members of the public gave him different sums of money for his exemplary honesty in spite of his poor background. He even shook hands with the president who promised some assistance. Mr. Rasaki bought a new taxi cab and began to build a bungalow from this windfall which was a practical realization of honesty being the best policy.

7. (a)(i) Disagreeing (doubting, contradicting, opposing) (ii) register (record, impress, make the occasion ever fresh on people's memory. (iii) colleague (mates, peers, friends, people of his age).
(b) personification.
(c)(i) a noun phrase (ii) the subject of the sentence
(d) He lost his parents early in life and one of his fingers
(e) He has achieved many things in life.
8. (a)(i) Property (gift, resource, inheritance, gain) (ii) balance (moderation, equilibrium, uprightness, steadiness) (iii) worthy (good reliable) (iv) indicates (shows, points out) (v) aggressive (unfriendly, un-co-operative) (vi) unhealthy (unhygienic, bad, negative harmful). (b)(i) Happy home helps the child to face the future without fear or anxiety (ii) Gives the child something worthy to live or (iii) It reduces juvenile delinquency and creates joy to the parents and the society at large (c)(i) Unnecessary or premature fears of life (ii) maladjusted and useless children (d) (i) credit (ii) undoubtedly (iii) create (e) The word happy is used several times to emphasize the importance of happiness in a human society.
9. (a) Paucity of gainful employment chances cum bad economy is a factor of corrupt practices. Another reason is the citizens' near total ignorance of the rights which the state legally permits. (b) Corruption takes the pattern of personal relationships, kick-backs, rewards and not on professional competence or merit. (c) All our leaders must live and lead by examples and not by mere precepts. The educational system should be reformed and geared towards positive orientations. Things or achievements of national glories should be emphasized above selfish personal material gains.

SENIOR SCHOOL CERTIFICATE EXAMINATION (SSCE 1988 – 2015)

Past Questions with Solutions

English Language

(Theory / Objectives with Oral English) 1990

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WASSCE NOVEMBER 1990 ENGLISH LANGUAGE 2 OBJECTIVE TEST QUESTIONS

SECTION 1

Instruction: Choose the word opposite in meaning to the underlined word.

1. The young engineer is good at terminating other people's projects but has not been capable of..... any of his own
A. integrating B. finishing C. completing
D. initiating E. organizing
2. The manager who expected to be given respect was treated with.....
A. dignity B. scorn C. shame D. cruelty
E. disloyalty.
3. Those who had invitation cards were admitted to the party while those who had none were.....
A. barred B. repelled C. expelled D. compelled
E. restricted
4. Too many theories will not help us; we need to be.....
A. bookish B. hypothetical C. antithetical
D. shrewd E. practical
5. Nobody expects him to show.....for his children but he certainly bestows too much affection on them
A. love B. concern C. intimacy D. devotion
E. hatred
6. The challenger was crude and inexperienced in contrast to the champion who was.....
A. great B. exposed C. celebrated D. refined
E. strong
7. What should have been a source of motivation for him proved a terrible source of.....
A. failure B. harm C. discouragement
D. uncertainty E. disturbance
8. Ade is very conservative in his political ideas whereas Bala expresses.....views always
A. radical B. heretical C. conventional
D. fanatical E. impractical

9. The government has been spending more money on preventive rather than on..... medicine.
A. modern B. protective C. diagnostic
D. traditional E. curative

SECTION 2

From the words lettered A to E, choose the word that **best completes** each of the following sentences.

10. The fishermen threw a stone into the river and this caused a.....
A. sprinkle B. sparkle C. splash D. spring
E. storm
11. The play was so interesting that the.....clapped for quite a long time at the end
A. spectators B. watchers C. congregation
D. people E. audience
12. The building.....because of weak structural foundation
A. tumbled B. succumbed C. somersaulted
D. collapsed E. caved.
13. The magazine was.....by the government for an offensive publication
A. prescribed B. proscribed C. suspended
D. condemned B. persecuted
14. Many people reacted to the brutal murder of the popular journalist with strong.....
A. indignation B. demonstration C. mobilization
D. condemnation B. accusation
15. The governor frowned at the..... which slowed down the implementation of policy decisions.
A. bureaucracy B. autocracy C. opposition
D. convention B. insecurity
16. He doctor.....the illness as yellow fever, not malaria
A. prescribed B. examined C. discovered
D. announced B. diagnosed.
17. Since the writer did not indicate his name, the editor decided not to publish such.....article
A. a discourteous B. an anonymous
C. a scandalous D. a libellous B. a cowardly

SECTION 3

After each of the following sentences, a list of possible interpretations of all or part of the sentence is given. Choose the interpretation that you consider **most appropriate** for each sentence.

18. Mrs. Alabi was not around when her case was called and none of her colleagues was willing to hold brief for her. This means that
 - A. her colleagues were afraid
 - B. she was not trusted
 - C. her colleagues did not want to represent her
 - D. she had quarrelled with her colleagues.
19. Telling lies has become second nature to Kunle. This means that Kunle
 - A. rarely tells lies
 - B. always tells lies
 - C. tells lies only on second thoughts
 - D. learnt to tell lies from childhood.
20. For us to accomplish the task successfully, all hands must be on deck. This means that every body
 - A. should push with his hands
 - B. will have to travel by sea
 - C. must cooperate
 - D. Should take a test before continuing the task
21. The wedding was attended by the cream of the society. This means that the wedding was attended by
 - A. everybody in the society
 - B. only those who were invited
 - C. very important people
 - D. only the educated people.
22. I want you to keep an eye on that child. This means that I want you to
 - A. discipline the child.
 - B. keep the child busy all the time
 - C. punish the child if he misbehaves
 - D. watch the child all the time.
23. It appears Sade's success at the last examination has gone to her head. This means that Sade is
 - A. conceited
 - B. too happy
 - C. crazy
 - D. impudent
24. Little Sheila is always as lively as a kitten. This means that Sheila is always
 - A. wearing bright dresses
 - B. very realistic in what she does
 - C. moving quickly like a kitten
 - D. gay and cheerful

25. This masquerade appears once in a blue moon. This means that the masquerade appears
 - A. on very rare occasions
 - B. when the moon is blue
 - C. whenever a special request is made
 - D. once a month
26. Okon is quite hardworking but his problem is that he has too many irons in the fire. This means that Okon
 - A. is a blacksmith
 - B. takes on more problems than he can cope with
 - C. is very good at solving problems
 - D. is a very successful businessman

SECTION 4

From the words or groups of words lettered A to E below each of the following sentences, choose the word or group of words that is **nearest in meaning** to the underlined word or group of words as used in the sentence.

27. It takes a great deal of stamina to run the marathon race
 - A. courage
 - B. determination
 - C. energy
 - D. intelligence
 - E. cleverness.
28. But for the principal actor the play would have been dull
 - A. important
 - B. head
 - C. master
 - D. famous
 - E. main
29. An open car has no protection against the elements
 - A. weather
 - B. emergency
 - C. molecule
 - D. atoms
 - E. atmosphere
30. He was reluctant to grant my request
 - A. disposed
 - B. delighted
 - C. reticent
 - D. unwilling
 - E. agreeable
31. The detective was perplexed when the clues in the murder case pointed to at least a dozen different suspects
 - A. surprised
 - B. confused
 - C. excited
 - D. discouraged
 - E. disappointed
32. The Military Governor called for a concerted effort in solving the problems of the state
 - A. a dramatic
 - B. an agitated
 - C. a joint
 - D. a directed
 - E. an unfailing
33. My financial situation is so precarious that very soon I may be insolvent
 - A. borrowing
 - B. stealing
 - C. soluble
 - D. dependent
 - E. bankrupt

34. The chairman is of the opinion that accepting the proposal would be inimical to the objectives of the association
A. harmful B. relevant C. irrelevant
D. indispensable E. helpful
35. The famous politician was noted for his pragmatic approach to issues of national interest
A. idealistic B. romantic C. compromising
D. practical E. inconsistent
36. Kunle is very pessimistic about our chance of success
A. sad B. despondent C. unconvinced D. worried
E. concerned

SECTION 5

*After each of the following sentences, a list of possible interpretations of the sentence is given. Choose the interpretation that you consider **most appropriate** for each sentence.*

37. If Kunle hadn't been transferred to Kano his wife would not have resigned her teaching job. This means that
A. Kunle was not transferred yet his wife resigned her job
B. Kunle was transferred and his wife thought of resigning her job
C. Kunle was transferred and so his wife had to resign her job
D. Kunle's wife resigned though her husband wasn't transferred.
38. I'll call at your house this evening if it doesn't rain. This means that I
A. will visit you this evening if it rains
B. will only phone you if it rains this evening
C. will sleep in your house this evening if it rains
D. may not visit you this evening if it rains.
39. Though Ibrahim was provoked, he ought to have controlled himself. This means that Ibrahim
A. should have exercised some restraint
B. was the aggressor
C. took the provocation with calmness
D. was found guilty of committing the offence.
40. The members of staff told the principal that they took exception to his comments. This means that the members of staff
A. approved of the principal's comments
B. objected to the principal's comments
C. wanted to be exempted from the principal's comments
D. warned the principal about his comments.

41. Okon is too quiet for my liking. This means that Okon
A. is liked because he is very quiet.
B. likes people who are quiet.
C. is not liked because of his extreme quietness
D. behaves in a very queer and suspicious manner.
42. The teacher said all but one of the sixty candidates scored below a credit grade. This means that
A. all the candidates scored below a credit grade
B. only one of the candidates scored a credit grade
C. only one of the candidates scored below a credit grade
D. all the candidates scored a credit grade.

SECTION 6

*From the words or groups of words lettered A to D, choose the word or group of words that **best completes** each of the following sentences.*

43. He was charged with complicity.....the abortive coup
A. in B. for C. about D. on
44. He was convicted.....stealing some bags of cocoa
A. with B. in C. of D. for
45. Mary said she was acting.....the instructions of the principal
A. by B. on C. for D. through
46.normal circumstances, it is rare to get all registered voters to vote
A. On B. By C. In D. Under
47. Lekan has been trying hard to live.....to his parents' expectations
A. over B. on C. through D. up
48. The Minister's daughter boasted she would have her way, and she really.....
A. had B. has C. have D. did
49. As at yesterday, only nomination papers in respect of three candidates.....
A. have been filed B. are being filed
C. had been filed D. has been filed.
50. They embraced passionately as if they.....seen each other for years.
A. had B. had not C. have D. have not

51. You are not sure where you placed the book.....?
A. isn't it B. weren't you C. are you D. didn't you
52. We arrived when the hall.....arranged so we stood outside.
A. has been B. is being C. was being D. had been
53. She doesn't know you like your food hot....?
A. does she B. shouldn't she C. didn't she D. wasn't it
54. It's certain we shall travel by train.....?
A. shan't we B. shall we C. don't we D. isn't it
55.of what he said made no sense
A. Much B. Majority C. Plenty D. Many
56. That is not your book, it is.....
A. Johns B. John's C. Johns' own D. for John's
57. Nana Sawara is a queen and demands to be treated.....
A. like that B. like so C. as such D. that much
58. It is pretty difficult to choose.....those three boys
A. between B. over C. against D. among
59.of the five boys was able to show me the way to the zoo
A. None B. Neither C. Any D. Some
60. We will leave.....you are ready.
A. as B. whenever C. while D. until
61. This.....be David's handwriting: I know his handwriting well enough
A. may B. will C. ought D. can't
62. The book is not in this locker and it is not in that cupboard.....
A. neither B. again C. either D. even
63.things she had in the room were thrown out
A. So few B. The few C. All few D. Very few
64. The party had hardly started.....the lights went off
A. than B. then C. as D. when
65. There were five boys.....
A. of which two were beaten
B. whom two were beaten
C. two of whom were beaten
D. of whom two of them were beaten.
66. This is the man.....told me the story
A. whom I said B. who I said C. I said that he

D. Who I said he

67. I feel you are none.....for experiencing that shock
A. the worse B. worse C. the worst D. Worst
68. Many students find Mathematics.....than English
A. difficult B. too difficult C. very difficult D. more difficult.
69. Tunde is the.....qualified for that job
A. more B. most C. more than D. many more
70. It is such a bad place.....I will never dream of going there another time
A. therefore B. thus C. that D. then
71. He has not been seen by his parents.....seven days
A. since B. for C. getting to D. for last
72. He has not been seen by his parents.....last month
A. since B. for C. getting to D. since over
73. Please, let me.....you in your car to the Railway Station
A. go with B. move with C. follow D. Ride
74. The.....came here last week
A. handsome tall young man
B. young tall handsome man
C. tall handsome young man
D. young handsome tall man.
75. The activities marking the golden jubilee celebrations of the club were.....with a party
A. rounded off B. rounded over
C. rounded through D. rounded up.

SECTION 7

In the following passages the numbered gaps indicate missing words. Against each number in the list below each passage, five choices are offered in columns lettered A to E. For each question, choose the word that is the most suitable to fill the numbered gap in the passage.

PASSAGE A

For the working woman, the task of looking after the home and — 76 — up the children is not easy. Although the house may have every modern —77— there is still much —78 — to keep her — 79— cooking, cleaning, mending, washing and ironing. If she is lucky to have a — 80 — help her task is made somehow easier.

The working woman spends much of her income on beauty care. Share buys a lot of— 81 — and visits —82 — regularly. Most women are so occupied with the daily — 83 — that they need these things to — 84 — themselves up.

Thus the responsibilities of a — 85 — are quite demanding and she could be so busy as to have little time for — 86 —engagements.

76. taking	A	76. pulling	B	76. getting	C	76. pushing	D	76. bringing	E
77. convenience		77. necessity		77. assistance		77. conversion		77. auxiliary	
78. thing		78. engagement		78. work		78. labour		78. employment	
79. tied		79. duty		79. alter		79. ready		79. serious	
80. willing		80. fraternal		80. matrimonial		80. residential		80. domestic	
81. decorations		81. conditions		81. ornaments		81. cosmetics		81. brackets	
82. action		82. shop		82. trends		82. sales		82. studies	
83. events		83. chicken		83. trends		83. requirements		83. studies	
84. smile		84. encourage		84. cheer		84. long		84. housewife	
85. housemaid		85. housemistress		85. householder		85. housekeeper		85. entertaining	
86. social		86. official		86. personal		86. civilized			

PASSAGE B

For fixed fees, insurance companies will help a firm insure against — 87 — and provide some —88 —Most firms will seek— 89 — against fire, fraud and other — 90 — happenings for which they pay annual — 91 — to the insurance companies. The payments will vary according to the — 92 — to be — 93 —. Some of these happenings may be — 94 — sustained during work or 95 — business debts. A — 96 — number is given to the insured for proper — 97 — if you have just bought a new car, it is advisable to undertake a — 98 — policy than a — 99 — for

more risks are covered in the former than in the — 100 —.

A	B	C	D	E
87. events	87. accidents	87. fluctuations	87. occurrences	87. emergencies
88. money	88. loss	88. gifts	88. discounts	88. compensation
89. protection	89. provision	89. prevention	89. charges	89. aid
90. costly	90. unpleasant	90. unforeseeable	90. unknown	90. sudden
91. fees	91. sums	91. amounts	91. charges	91. premiums
92. dangers	92. claims	92. subjects	92. risks	92. items
93. agreed	93. entered	93. included	93. undertaken	93. covered
94. damage	94. loss	94. harm	94. injury	94. grievance
95. overclaim	95. unsecured	95. illegal	95. overdue	95. careless
96. policy	96. significant	96. particular	96. typical	96. contract
97. recognition	97. entry	97. identification	97. accounting	97. auditing
98. comprehensive	98. conditional	98. local	98. compound	98. third party
99. second hand	99. winning party	99. second party	99. third party	99. subsidiary
100. labor	100. previous	100. final	100. other	100. other

WASSCE NOVEMBER1990 ENGLISH LANGUAGE 2 OBJECTIVE TEST ANSWERS

1.D	2.B	3.A	4.E	5.E	6.D	7.C
8.C	9.E	10.C	11.E	12.D	13.B	14.D
15.A	16.E	17.B	18.C	19.B	20.C	21.C
22.D	23.A	24.D	25.A	26.B	27.C	28.E
29.A	30.D	31.B	32.D	33.E	34.A	35.D
36.B	37.C	38.D	39.A	40.B	41.C	42.B
43.A	44.D	45.B	46.D	47.D	48.D	49.D
50.D	51.C	52.C	53.A	54.D	55.A	56.B
57.C	58.A	59.A	60.B	61.D	62.C	63.B
64.D	65.D	66.B	67.A	68.D	69.B	70.C
71.B	72.A	73.A	74.C	75.A	76.E	77.A
78.C	79.B	80.E	81.C	82.D	83.B	84.C
85.E	86.A	87.B	88.E	89.A	90.D	91.E
92.D	93.E	94.D	95.D	96.A	97.C	
98.A	99.D	100.E				

WASSCE NOVEMBER1990 ENGLISH LANGUAGE 1 THEORY QUESTIONS

Answer four questions in all: one question from Part A, and questions 7, 8, and 9.

PART A

- You have been invited by a youth organization to speak on 'Indiscipline among youths'. Write your speech.
- Write a letter to the newly-elected chairman of your local government council congratulating him on his election and stating the priority needs of the people of your community.
- You have just spent your holiday in another part of the country with a friend. Narrate your experience to other friends describing what you found interesting about the customs, food, dress and way of life of your hosts.
- A friend of yours has been absent from the school for about a month due to illness. Write a letter to the friend describing some interesting things that have happened in the school during the period and expressing your wish for a quick recovery.

- Write an article, for publication in a national newspaper, on the dangers of drug abuse among youths.
- As the Senior Prefect in your school, write out the speech you would give on the occasion of your school's end-of-year ceremony. Mention some of the problems you faced and give suggestions on how they could be solved.

PART B SECTION I COMPREHENSION

- Read the following passage carefully and then answer the questions which follow.**

Though Hitler is dead, many mysteries about him remain unravelled, especially the mystery of how he was able to rise to supreme power. The source of his strength, the nature of his ultimate beliefs, and the workings of his fatal weakness, all these could be debated for many years to come. No final assessment could be made at the time, nor can we reasonably expect to reach a final

assessment in our generation. Hitler's verdict on himself was given in the testament he drew up the day before his suicide. It is an astonishing and revealing document. Having sacrificed millions of Germans to his own glory, he claimed that his actions had proceeded out of love and loyalty to his people. With perfect detachment and single-mindedness, he claimed that he had shown the German people the way which destiny had pointed out to them, and it was not his fault that they had proved unworthy of the task. He urged the Germans to continue the struggle.

While he was dictating these words, the Russians had encircled Berlin and the Chancellery was being bombarded by Russian guns at close range. Hitler wrote that he chose to die by his own hand rather than submit to cowardly abdication or capitulation. But the most revealing paragraph of his testament referred to his possessions, which he bequeathed to the party, if the party was no longer in existence to the state. 'Should the state too be destroyed no further decision on my part is necessary.'

(a) From the passage, what type of ruler was Hitler during his life? (b)(i) How did Hitler die? (ii) Why? (c) What was the last thing Hitler did before his death? (d) At the time of his death, how was Germany performing in the war? (e) What two options did Hitler give for disposing of his possessions? (f) For each of the following words, find another word or phrase that means the same and which can replace it in the passage; (i) mystery; (ii) verdict; (iii) astonishing; (iv) detachment; (v) submit; (vi) bequeathed (g) 'While he was dictating these words. (i) What is the grammatical term used to describe the above expression, as used in the passage? (ii) What is the function of the expression in the sentence?

8. Read the following passage carefully and then answer the questions on it.

When neighbours learnt that the Umorus' household had been raided by robbers, they were genuinely downcast because the easy-going Umorus minded their own business and had contributed immensely to the development of the area. Visitors early that morning were shocked at the way the doors were vandalized before the robbers forced their way into the living-room to make away with the radio, the television, the wall clock, and the video cassette recorder.

As some sympathizers discussed the perfection with which modern robbers strike nowadays, a few of them drove to the police station and soon arrived with detectives. Quickly, statements were obtained from the couple and a few neighbours, all in an attempt to pin down

suspects. From these statement it was learnt that the bushes and uncompleted houses nearby had not been searched. The officer ordered his men to come the bushes and the unfinished structures. While this lasted he stood over the culvert near one of the buildings.

Thoroughly, from room to room, from tree to tree, the searchers toiled. But it was a fruitless exercise. The help rendered by neighbours did not yield clues. At last, the police boss concluded that the robbers were beyond their reach, and so called off their chase. He blew his whistle and ordered his men into the jeep. Reassuring Mr. Umoru that the search would continue, he instructed the driver to move.

All the while in the culvert, their booty by their side, the two robbers snored on. Had a stray dog not given them away, later in the afternoon they would have escaped with their booty.

(a) Why were the neighbours concerned about the robbery in the house of the Umorus? (b) Identify the two types of sympathizers mentioned in the passage. (c)(i) Were the Police careful enough in their search? (ii) Why do you think so? (d) What finally happened to the robbers? (e) 'Had a stray dog not given them away' (i) What is the grammatical term used to describe the above expression, as used in the passage? (ii) What is its function? (f) Give one word that could replace each of the following as used in the passage: (i) immensely. (ii) vandalized (iii) pin down (iv) comb (v) structures (vi) chase

SECTION II SUMMARY

9. Read the following passage carefully and then answer the questions on it.

A study conducted in Nigeria recently recognized three varieties of spoken English. Speakers of the first variety exhibit characteristics of a very long and difficult process of 'internal interpretation' from the mother-tongue into English. Thinking and expression do not go closely together. A listener would notice this from the way the speaker pauses before expressing himself, apparently deciding which words to use and how to arrange them. Thus, thinking is exclusively through the medium of the mother-tongue and English is thus a poor shadow of the original thoughts of the speakers, utterances heard invariably have to be translated silently into the mother-tongue to be maximally meaningful, and then responses are translated from the mother-tongue into English. Consequently, the long, indirect routes make statements slow, halting and jerky.

The second variety speakers exhibit features described above but to a much lesser degree.

Internal translations from the mother-tongue to English still take place during the speaker's expression of opinions and complex concepts but the process now takes a shorter span of time. With ordinary words or simple ideas, internal interpretations need not intervene between the points at which the thought is conceived and the time it is given verbal expression. Discussions are quicker and smoother though these might not always be entirely free from minor halting gaps.

With the third variety speakers, thought is almost entirely in English and translation is not needed. The speaker has a wealth of linguistic weapons to choose from to express the minute distinctions between similar concepts and these come quickly and easily. Thus for instance, whereas speakers of the lower varieties have only the word 'rain', the speaker of variety III recognizes distinctions between 'shower', 'down-pour', 'drizzle', 'mist', 'deluge', etc., and uses each in the appropriate context. Also, his mastery of the sounds and features of the English Language equips him to express the utterances accurately and automatically without having to pause and think of the correct version of a sound since he masters the various distinctions in the pronunciation of each vowel and each consonant.

We need to recognize, however, that most Nigerian learners of English 'graduate' from one variety to another, from the lowest stratum of variety I to the highest stratum of that variety, and then to variety II, and so on until they achieve variety III. Length of periods of education, exposure to standard English and a personal conscious effort play major roles in deciding what variety a particular speaker uses.

Finally, we must recognize that most speakers of the higher varieties are still capable of reverting to the lower case, if they choose. Thus we can find even a Nigerian professor of phonology switching to the lowest stratum of variety I if he feels so inclined when discussing with a house-servant or a porter.

(a) In three sentences, one for each, summarize the distinctive characteristics of the speakers of the three varieties of English described in the passage.

(b) In two sentences, one for each, describe the conditions under which a person can

(i) move from lower varieties to the upper ones

(ii) switch from a higher variety to a lower one.

WASSCE NOVEMBER 1990 ENGLISH LANGUAGE 1 THEORY ANSWERS

1. SPEECH DELIVERED BY PRINCE GODWIN ON INDISCIPLINE AMONG YOUTHS AT A PUBLIC SYMPOSIUM ORGANISED BY THE YOUTH CLUB OF YABA ON THE 25TH OF APRIL, 1990.

The chairman, president and members of Yaba Youth Club, distinguished ladies and gentlemen. I heartily welcome everyone of you and thank you for making out time to attend the tenth year anniversary of this dynamic club. It is a great pleasure and honour that I am in your midst today to give a talk on the topic: "Indiscipline Among Youths" By definition, indiscipline is any action, behavioural pursuit, utterances or beliefs that are contrary to the laws, customs, convention and expectations of the society. There is no smoke without fire. For any action there must be a cause.

Examples of these negative actions are disrespect for elders or one's superiors in school, associations and place of work. Flagrant disregard for constituted authorities, indulgence in criminal activities, fraud, forgery, giving bribes to teachers, lecturers to get marks and promotion in schools, riots, violent demonstrations and molestation or assault of superiors.

There are certain factors that induce indiscipline among youths. Over-ambition is one of such factors. It is good to be ambitious. But it is ethically wrong for a schoolboy to want to own an estate, a plane and many things at the age of seventeen or twenty. Bad company helps to mislead some young boys and girls to commit crimes. It is completely, morally wrong for our young girls of between fourteen and twenty to be seen along the road junctions soliciting men and money, or our school teenagers embarking on armed robbery. Some young people misbehave because of bad parental upbringing and/or the young ones refusal to utilise the moral guidance which their parents, teachers and superiors have always tried to impart to them. We know some maladjusted parents go many miles to over-pamper their children - an act which later boomerang both on the parents and the entire society.

The inadequacies of today's religious and the practice of their adherents contribute to the prevalence of youth's indiscipline in our society. Ladies and gentlemen, why must our youngmen and women, the much expected and respected leaders of tomorrow dominate scenes of sexual immorality, prostitution, lesbianism, homosexuality, violent and destructive demonstrations, disregard for cultural heritage and civilised conduct and our political authorities?

The youths should know that even the Bible enjoins youths to respect parents and the elders so that they can live long. Most holy books frown at sinful conducts and consumption of drugs that distort peoples psyches and physiques.

Indiscipline must be jettisoned by our youths. All hands must be on deck to save the youths for themselves. It is dangerous and highly calamitous for the youths to destroy themselves before the mantles of leadership are handed to them in the near future. Parents and teachers must buckle up and intensify moral rearmament and disciplinary measures to whip and nurture the youth into the desired products. Our elders say that the untrained child will be the first to sell off the house built by his parents.

No elderly person or teacher in charge of youthful persons should spare the rod and spoil the child. Teachers must take adequate disciplinary measures as they deem fit to shape and mould our young citizens into better citizens.

A nation dominated by undisciplined youths and later undisciplined adult citizens is doomed forever. Ladies and gentlemen, we all here and outside this gathering must contribute our quota towards abandoning our uncivilised, fraudulent, uncultured, criminal and immoral behaviour, because disciplined conducts and practices exalt and prosper a nation. I thank you all for your attention.

2. 5, Prince Godwin Lane,
Ovode,
Isoko North Local Government
10th June, 1989

The Chairman,
Isoko Local Government,
Ozoro,
Delta State.

Sir,

LETTER OF CONGRATULATIONS

I hereby write to felicitate you on your recent electoral success which paved the way for your elevation to the exalted office of the Chairman of the newly carved out local government council. Once again, accept my profound and sincere felicitations for your well-deserved victory. Let me seize this opportunity to wish you a fruitful and purposeful tenure of office during which you shall lay a solid foundation for the rapid development of our locality in particular and Nigeria in general.

This letter will not be complete if I fail to utilise it to draw your attention to the three most important things that my community will want from your administration. First, we want our area to benefit from one of the three agro-based industries which you promised during the campaigns. I need not remind you that Ovode is the foremost agricultural community in this locality. The advantages of this industry are too well known to warrant repetition by me.

Secondly, we want a bigger community hospital and maternity centre. The one built by communal effort is now too small and ill-equipped to cater for the teeming population of Ovode town. You know how far the general hospital at Ozoro is from our town. Many lives have been lost due to inadequate health care.

The third area of our need is good road construction. Ovode as the food basket of this local government deserves a good network of well tarred roads. These roads will ensure that the products of the local cottage industries and the abundant farm produce get to the buyers and consumers outside our town fast and cheap too. This dream can only materialize when new roads are constructed and the existing one repaired to make them motorable all season. Another minor area in which you may assist the town is helping our ever-growing community college with more classroom blocks and science equipment.

We wish you success in your onerous chairmanship of this dynamic local government.

Congratulations again.

Yours faithfully,

Prince David.

3. For the first time in my entire life so far, I spent about two weeks in Warn town, a promising mini metropolitan city in the newly created Delta State. I went there to spend my Christmas and New Year break with an intimate college friend of more than eighteen years standing. Prince Oghene Edoh.

Prior to my visit and arrival in Warn town, the only thing I knew about it was that Warn is a small port town with an aerodrome, a few national industries like the iron and steel and petrochemical companies. One thing that thrills me about Warn is its metropolitan nature. The natives include the Urhobos, Isokos, Ijaws, Kwales and the Itsekinis. These distinct ethnic groups provide an interesting group of people. They differ in language but largely dress the same

way and eat the same types of food. Talking about food we will come to that later.

Within the first day of my arrival, my host took me to all the parts of Warn township, neighbouring towns like Ughelli, Sapele, Abraka, Ozoro, Oleh, Kwale, and other small villages. While we the Yorubas pride ourselves as the most culture-rich and conscious group of Nigerians my visit to culture-dominated Warn and environs has radicalised my orientation. Everywhere we visited, I was given kola, drinks (local gin) with different sums of money accompanying the kola. I was 'culturised' to always pocket the money while everybody present would share in the other items of hospitality and welcome.

In warn area, especially among the Urhobos and Isokos, only the younger persons are expected to kneel and greet the elderly ones first. The elderly don't ever genuflect, bow or kneel for the young ones. The young ones will say "migwo" or "digwo" (i.e. I am on my knees) and the senior person will respond thus: "vre nigwe" or "kpamanigwe" i.e. rise from your knees. Among these people too, all young ones present where an elderly person is eating must greet him as he is about to begin and after he must have finished. This is done whether the young ones are eating with him or not.

Their marriage ceremonies are very simple and cheap to begin and finish. The differences between how the ethnic groups in the Warri area marry and the Yoruba marriage ceremonies in minor specific details, not in substance. Because of cultural diversities, their girls boast of different shades of beauty. What I saw or even did in this regard is outside the scope of this narration. Suffice it to say that I enjoyed myself within reason and moderation.

My Isoko friends and hosts take special delight in preparing dishes, with assorted fresh fishes and bush meat. For the sheer variety and deliciousness of their dishes, one would have stayed at least six more months! They boast of different recipes.

It surpasses what we have back in my part of the country. Have you eaten starch and banga soup before? What about assorted types of pepper soup? Have you ever eaten what the Urhobos and Isokos call Ukodo? This rich dish can make one forget his name, wallahi! It was in my host's place that I discovered the oiled brand which I've been used to all my life before the visit.

Most of the people I interacted with during my stay in Warn were polyglots. Most people could speak three languages. This is influenced by a combination of factors especially ethnic inter-marriages and their penchant for good social

mixing together. A visitor or foreigner will not have any problem communicating with the Warn people. They are mostly literate and the illiterate speak rich, impeccable pidgin with English which one could not help but admire and learn. Even their aged ones speak n with admirable fluency!

I fell in love with their ways of life, rich variegated dishes and their easy-going attitude to life.

4.

St. Godwin College,
Igbuku,
Isoko Local Government,
Delta State.
18th May, 1990.

Dear Stephen,

How are you recovering after the successful surgical operation and removal of the tumor around the lower abdominal region? I got to know how serious it was when our school principal read part of the letter which your dad wrote on your behalf to explain why you were not back after the expiration of the one week permission to stay away from school for proper diagnosis and cure of your health problem. I really hope that you are regaining your health two weeks after the operation. However, you have missed a lot of things here in the college.

The annual great literary and debating society week had come and gone with all its fanfares, opportunities to make new friends and win nevi dancing competitions and beauty queen contests. You know what you have missed moreso when this year's week was exceptionally well organized with more schools in attendance. St. John's College, Asaba won the drama competition. The beauty queen crown went to Our Lady of Apostle, Sapele. Guess what? Your girlfriend won the debate and best speaker's award for our great college. I know you can't wait to give her a peck and may be a gift. She even dedicated it to you for your inspiration to her.

We went for our annual geographical and historical excursion to Benin City where we visited the ancient Benin Palace where we met the Oba in council briefly and visited the rich Benin Museum. We were at the Ogbe Stadium and the state daily paper the 'Observer'. We were well received by the editor and his editorial staff was impressed enough. Even now I want to be a professional journalist or mass communicator. Did I hear you sigh that you missed a lot?

We even staged Ola Rotimi's masterpiece adaptation: The Gods Are Not to Blame. We took

it to some big schools around and the town hall where we made some money from ticket sales. Lest I forget, I have just been elected the president of the College Press Club. It is not easy but I am coping fine so far.

Our school has qualified for the final annual football competition for the Jubilee Schools' Cup. The final will be played in a fortnight. Try to be back before then.

We all miss you in the debating society, press club and the football pitch. Our teachers and a good number of the students, not the least your sweetheart Uzezi, miss you dearly. They all send their good wishes and greetings.

Bye for now.

Yours friend,
Edoh.

5. THE DANGERS OF DRUG ABUSE

A drug is a combination of medicinal chemicals or substances formulated and prepared by chemists and pharmacists for the treatment or cure of different illnesses under the recommendation and supervision of medical doctors. Drugs are many, diverse in their simplicity and strength. There are drugs that people can walk into a drugs store (chemist's shop) and buy for use when attacked by minor illnesses. The commonest of these drugs are the analgesics - Panadol, Asprin, Pengo, Daga, Phensic and others like cough syrup, vitamin C and so on and so forth. But antibiotic capsules, poisons, tranquilizers, Indian hemp, cocaine, heroin and many more are not supposed to be taken without a doctor's prescription or in his absence a pharmacist's recommendation.

The dangers of self medication are very many and even common knowledge. The prevalence of drug abuse cases can be seen in more mental psychiatric cases. Some young and old people simply take some hard drugs just because they want to be 'high'. Cases abound of people losing their lives because of self prescription and wrong usage of drugs.

Continual use of hard drugs leads to the production of maladjusted citizens, if we have to take seriously what our medical experts in various specialist hospitals are saying daily. Drug abuse is one of the major causes of rampant tragic accidents on our highways. Some drivers take China capsule, cannabis which details their senses. Families and the society suffer from losses in this connection.

The prevalence of and improper consumption of hard drugs is behind the increasing rate of armed banditry. Fragile or frail-looking, cowardly youngmen and women become daring and ruthless after taking hard drugs and other strong stimulants. This way, the society suffers a variety of harm and losses.

Medical experts have been saying for some time now that drug abuse could induce Acquired Immune Deficiency Syndrome (AIDS) in some people. This means that wrongly used drugs can destroy the national immune system that guards one against certain infections.

Drug abuse is a key contributor to the humiliation of Nigerian citizens and our national officials in foreign countries who are subjected to scandalous search and scrutiny. At times dogs are used to scrutinize people. This destroys our international image and reputation.

Anti-drug abuse campaigns should be stepped up by the government and private citizens. The youth must be well enlightened on all the possible dangers of using drugs wrongly. Security efforts to detect and apprehend all illegal importers and users of hard drugs must be perfected. Religious organizations must contribute to building a drug - free society. It concerns us equally.

Solomon Olufemi,
Epe.

6. SPEECH DELIVERED BY DAVID OTIEDE, THE OUT-GOING SENIOR PREFECT OF DENNIS MEMORIAL GRAMMAR SCHOOL, ONITSHA ON THE OCCASION OF THE 1990 END OF YEAR CEREMONY

His Royal Highness, the Obi of Onitsha,
The Chairman, Board of Governors,
The Principals of all schools present,
Staff and students,
Ladies and gentlemen.

With a sense of humility and great respect to all my superiors and my fellow students gathered in this august occasion, I say good afternoon and welcome to this unique end of year ceremony. I feel honoured, indeed on top of the world to address such a great gathering.

Permit me to go on a memory lane. Exactly one year ago in a similar occasion in this particular hall, the school authority and the entire students elevated me to this responsible position of the senior prefect of the great Dennis Memorial

Grammar School. That was then. Today, I am giving my last speech in this exalted position. We are all familiar with the holy book which says that there is a time to be born and a time to die. Yes, this is the time to leave the scene for others. But as I step down, kindly permit me to shed some light on our stewardship, the ups and downs of the office this past one year. If our successors and the entire students should learn or gain anything from our experience, that will be a bonus or an additional feather to our cap. I have moved from 'I' to 'our' a few times now. You will want to know why. 'I' because my humble self was the only senior prefect, a primus inter pares, just the first among many other capable prefects on their parts. We all know that life is a stage.

The questions are two fold. Did we mark time in office or we made the difference? I will give account of our achievements, successes and touch on our failures and set-backs for you to be better judges presently. I thank God for the fact that during my tenure as senior prefect, there was greater teacher - student cordiality and a peaceful session than previous three sessions. During my tenure, my colleagues and I enforced a more strict, regimented reading period for boarders and day students alike. Anybody can cross-check. Students have shown better performances in their various exams. I am equally happy that my tenure has been associated with a lot of sporting activities and other extra curricula glories. We the students won the greatest number of trophies and prizes this past session.

I recall that we the students wrote separate requests to parents/teachers for a new bus and a generating set for the convenience of the students and staff. We wrote the letter and made the entire senior students to sign and it worked like magic. The result can be seen by everybody now.

These achievements notwithstanding, there were some nagging problems. My tenure witnessed so far the largest number of new students who obviously are from very rich homes where they had been over-pampered. Some of such students found it difficult to adjust to the traditional high disciplinary diets of the school. They enjoyed flouting school rules and disobeying their seniors with impunity and most times with the connivance of their guardians who are here to threaten prefects and senior students generally.

The problem of bullying surfaced from time to time. One is grateful to the principal for his stern measure which contributed largely to curb it. The college Boys Scout which I was a former head assisted me in maintaining an effective security system. The Girls' Brigade was not unco-operative. They all assisted me to keep

anarchists, bullies and chronic breakers of school rules and regulations in check.

On the other problem of students stealing library books and laboratory materials, I suggest that the college authorities employ more security guards to conduct periodic checks on students' bags and lockers. For quick detection and resolution of students' grievances, I suggest that more suggestion or complaint boxes be provided, and a students affairs committee comprising some students and teaching staff inaugurated.

On the problem of the over-pampered students, their parents or guardians should be talked to by the principal and officials of the PTA. More hostels should be built to ease the problem of decreasing boarding facilities. To bring this address to a close, I thank the school authorities, teaching and non-teaching staff and the students for giving me this golden chance to lead and gain a lot of experience from a leadership pedestal. I thank all the junior and senior members of our college community for their co-operation, advice and encouragement this past one year. I thank you for your attention.

David Otiede,
Senior Prefect.

7. (a) He was a nationalist, dictator and politician who wanted greatness for his people at all costs.
(b) (i) He died via suicide. (ii) Hated the idea of cowardly surrendering to his enemy.
(c) He wrote his will where he surrendered his property to his party or state.
(d) Germany was losing at the battle grounds
(e) Hitler wanted his party or country to inherit his property.
(f) (i) Secret (ii) Judgement (iii) Surprising (iv) Aloofment (v) Yield (vi) Bestowed
(g) (i) Adverbial clause of time
(ii) Modifies "had encircled" in main clause.
8. (a) The Umorus were peace-loving people and had contributed to the development of the area.
(b) Some of the sympathizers discussed the manner of modern day robbery operations and others went to bring detectives. (c)(i) They were not (ii) If they were, they would have seen the robbers snoring just in the culvert nearby (d) They were arrested after a dog discovered their hideout in the culvert (e) (i) a conditional clause (ii) functions as a subordinate clause to the main one.
(f) (i) greatly (ii) destroyed (iii) detect (iv) search (v) houses (vi) pursuit.

9. (a) The speakers of the first variety of spoken English exhibit tedious thinking or comprehension via their vernaculars. The speakers of the second variety show mild degree of thinking and translation from their mother tongues. The third category speakers exhibit a near native English speakers' fluency with a rich vocabulary and attempt at correct pronunciation always.

(b)(i) speaker can move from low to high variety of English if he undergoes a long duration of education with particular attention to good English. (ii) A speaker can revert to a low variety if his auditor or audience is of low educational or social ranking.

SENIOR SCHOOL CERTIFICATE EXAMINATION (SSCE 1988 – 2015)

Past Questions with Solutions

English Language

(Theory / Objectives with Oral English) 1991

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WASSCE AUGUST 1991 ENGLISH LANGUAGE 2 OBJECTIVE TEST QUESTIONS

SECTION 1

Instruction: Choose the word **opposite** in meaning to the underlined words. Answer all the questions.

1. The measures that were introduced to accelerate the process of national development have in actual fact it.
A. accentuated B. retarded C. promoted
D. neutralized E. revoked
2. I thought that the comments made by the secretary were quite innocuous but the chairman considered them
A. polite B. inappropriate C. antagonistic
D. unnecessary E. harmful
3. The.....of the few rich in our society contrasts with the poverty of the masses.
A. arrogance B. authority C. influence D. affluence
E. monopoly
4. Bola was vocal in protesting against the high-handedness of the police unlike Sola who was.....
A. mute B. shouting C. arguing D. sober
E. adamant
5. The rather insignificant effort he made yielded results
A. exorbitant B. absolute C. unimaginable
D. prohibitive E. tremendous
6. Ibrahim's flamboyant lifestyle contrasts sharply with Aminu's attitude
A. austere B. ostentatious C. senous D. lavish
E. severe
7. The youngman was advised to be and not jgjd on critical issues if he wanted to make a good career in politics.
A wavering B. evasive C. cautious D. flexible
E. constant
8. At the end of the crisis, the leaders declared that there was neither victor nor
A. winner B. oppressor C. vanquished
D. originator E. vanguard.

9. Rather than show remorse for his offence, he remained
A. calculated B. unpleasant C. apathetic
D. abrasive E. unrepentant

SECTION 2

From the words lettered A to E, choose the word that **best completes** each of the following sentences.

10. Many people died in the.....accident
A. serious B. wicked C. evil D. reckless E. fatal
11. Despite all our pleas, the manager remained..... in his refusal of our request
A. flexible B. pliable C. adamant D. unconvinced
E. curious
12. Poor feeding causes.....in children
A. maladjustment B. malfunction C. malediction
D. malaria E. malnutrition.
13. The shrill voice of the actor.....across the hall
A. rebounded B. reverberated C. rejuvenated
D. realigned E. rejoiced
14. It is a.....that the more you look, the less you see
A. wonder B. feat C. myth D. paradox E. magic
15. The meeting was.....indefinitely to reconvene at a later date.
A. adjourned B. commenced C. concluded
D. stopped E. postponed
16. Femi has a.....appetite
A. vivacious B. loquacious C. garrulous
D. suspicious E. voracious
17. His appointment was.....because of the irregularities discovered in his credentials
A. cancelled B. terminated C. suspended
D. postponed E. dismissed
18. The government has placed an.....on further recruitment of staff
A. infringement B. order C. embargo D. injunction
E. annulment

SECTION 3

After each of the following sentences, a list of possible interpretations of all or part of the sentence is given. Choose the interpretation that you consider most appropriate for each sentence.

19. The peace meeting nipped the crisis in the bud. This means that
A. the crisis was averted
B. the peace meeting was deadlocked
C. members disagreed on who should receive the flower pot
D. the crisis escalated despite the peace meeting.
20. Ugonna passed his examinations with flying colours. This means Ugonna
A. did very well
B. wore cloths of different colours
C. was helped to pass the examination
D. cheated to pass the examination.
21. Emeka has a field day at the dancing competition. This means that Emeka
A. performed woefully
B. fell down on the field while others were dancing
C. triumph in all aspects of the competition
D. withdrew from the competition at the last minute.
22. Femi's plans amount to building castles in the air. This means that Femi's plans are
A. beautiful B. practicable C. interesting
D. unrealizable
23. The appearance which the famous actor made last month was his swan song. This means that
A. the actor sang beautifully during the play
B. the play was postponed because of the actor's non-appearance
C. the play was the actor's last appearance before he died
D. the last play was the actor's best performance.
24. Akpan does not let the grass grow under his feet. This means that Akpan
A. does not waste time in doing things
B. is a very wicked man
C. cuts the grass in his field regularly
D. cares only about himself

SECTION 4

*From the words or group of words lettered A to E below each of the following sentences, choose the word or group of words that is **nearest in meaning** to the underlined words as used in the sentence.*

25. Edet will have to face the consequences of his rash action
A. results B. answers C. antecedents D. prognosis
E. accusations
26. You will incur your father's wrath if you do that
A. debt B. expenditure C. anger D. favour
E. pleasure
27. The devastation caused by the earthquake was shocking
A. devaluation B. dilapidation C. desecration
D. trepidation E. destruction
28. I have implicit confidence in Abass' ability to win the race.
A. partial B. absolute C. correct D. impervious
E. doubtful
29. The points he made are germane to the argument
A. irregular B. convincing C. helpful
D. unnecessary E. relevant

SECTION 5

*From the words or groups of words lettered A to D, choose the word or group of words that **best completes** each of the following sentences.*

30. He preferred travelling by road.....travelling by air
A. to B. against C. over D. than
31. The police are.....the trail of the suspect
A. in B. on C. after D. over
32.candidates passed in English Language than in Mathematics
A. Many B. Plenty C. More D. Much
33. Alhaji Musa owns fifty.....
A. herd of cattles B. head of cattle
C. herds of cattles D. heads of cattle.
34. Ameh.....to school nowadays
A. walk B. walked C. walking D. walks
35. He.....say it to my face that I did that
A. dares not B. dare not C. not dare D. dared not
36. One of his greatest achievements.....the restoration of order and stability to the company
A. was B. were C. have been D. are
37. If I had heard this earlier, I.....given him the job
A. would not have B. would have not
C. will not have D. will have not

38. Mr. Smith had worked here before leaving for the U.K.....?
A isn't it B. wasn't it C. didn't it D. hadn't it
39. Who saw the accused.....the purse from the complainant's handbag?
A. take B. took C. taken D. takes
40.bring a letter of authority before he can collect the money?
A. Needs he B. Need he C. He needs D. Does he need
41. Surely, he.....come in person if he doesn't want to!
A. need not B. does not need C. did not need D. need to
42. Fortunately my father the scene before the explosion occurred
A. has just left B. just left C. had just left D. is just leaving
43. The rainstorm did a lot of.....to the houses and trees in the area.
A. damages B. damaging C. damage D. havocs
44. You are not allowed to carry.....on this flight
A. much luggage B. many luggage C. few luggages D. more luggages
45. It is no longer easy for graduates to secure.....
A. employments B. many employments C. employment D. an employment
46. If you would listen, I could give you.....
A. a valuable advice B. some valuable advices C. valuable advise D. valuable advice.
47. That load is.....heavy for a child of his age to carry
A. very B. most C. much D. too
48. Tunji was.....hungry that he ate the food meant for his three sisters
A. so B. extremely C. very D. quite.
49. On my way to the post office, I.....my old classmate
A. stop to greet B. stopped to greet C. had stopped greeting D. stopped greeting
50. The celebrations were rounded.....with a novelty match
A. off B. up C. down D. out
51. As fresh fruits ere scarce in the day season, we had to.....tinned fruits
A. make do with B. make up for C. take out with D. take up with
52. They are.....new employees at the headquarters of the factory
A. taking up B. taking after C. talking on D. taking over
53. We all look forward to.....ourselves at the party
A. enjoy B. have enjoyed C. be enjoying D. enjoying
54. The messenger.....home until his boss leaves
A. dare not went B. dare not go C. dare not to go D. dare not going
55. Sherifat did not behave.....her parents' wishes
A. with accordance B. in accordance about C. with accordance in D. in accordance with
56. Are you keen.....joining me in this venture?
A. at B. in C. on D. about
57. Do you notice John and Comfort glancing at.....?
A. themselves B. the other C. each other D. theirselves.
58. The corrupt bank manager was arrested and convicted.....
A. on the long run B. at the long run C. in the long run D. after the long run
59. I cannot travel in an open car because I am allergic.....dust
A. with B. to C. with D. by
60. If you keep trying, you'll succeed.....the end
A. by B. at C. with D. in
61. For our Sunday lunch. Mother always cooked a....
A. large pot of thick, spicy groundnut soup B. large, thick, spicy pot of groundnut soup C. large, spicy, thick groundnut pot of soup D. large, spicy pot of thick groundnut soup.
62. Don't believe all.....he had told you
A. what B. which C. that D. there
63. He succeeded.....the odds he faced
A. after B. despite C. even on D. in addition to
64. Please let me have.....salt in my soup
A. a little B. few C. a small D. a few

SECTION 6

In the following passage the numbered gaps indicate missing words. Against each number in the list below each passage, five choices are offered in the columns lettered A to E. For each question, choose the **most suitable** word to fill the numbered gap in the passage.

65.

Not all insects are — 66 —, and amongst those which are, the honey bees. Besides the honey they — 67 —, they perform an even more important service by — 68 — flowers. The — 69 — method of obtaining honey in African countries is to allow wild bees to enter a — 70 — and then later to smoke out the bees with — 71 —. The food value of honey is — 72 — high: it is derived from 73—, which is merely a sugary solution in water. In honey most of this sugar has been changed into another — 74 — which, when eaten, is very easily — 75 — into the blood — 76 —. An — 77 — is the name of the place where the beehives are kept. Bees require water, and this should be provided if not — 78— available. A honey — 79 — is the place where the honey is stored and it is very important that the bees are not destroyed when the honey is — 80 —.

65.	A. necessary	B. useful	C. important	D. harmless	E. harmful
67.	produce	invent	deliver	large	create
68.	dispersing	beeskeeping	flavouring	colouring	pollinating
69.	scientific	mechanical	traditional	modern	technical
70.	shell	cell	hive	hut	tree
71.	rays	bees	honey	fire	light
72.	exceptionally	simultaneously	constructively	imaginatively	alternately
73.	acrenalin	sugar	glucose	nectar	glycerine
74.	energy	object	solid	liquid	form
75.	preserved	reserved	digested	assimilated	inhaled
76.	accessory	flow	mechanism	system	stream
77.	apery	equarium	incubator	insulator	moderator
78.	socially	naturally	economically	canonically	artificially
79.	with	nest	comb	aperture	house
80.	poured	sucked	siphoned	injected	extracted

SECTION 7

From the words lettered A to D, choose the word that has a **similar sound** with the underlined sound in the given word.

81. Splash.
A. measure B. buzz C. boss D. bash
82. Charisma
A. chores B. caricature C. machine D. cinema
83. Mate
A. at B. art C. eight D. hat
84. Work
A. girl B. wear C. walk D. dough
85. Those
A. do B. this C. think D. dough
86. Child.
A. chilly B. children C. cheek D. buy

87. Gear
A. jeer B. give C. gentle D. judge
88. Gnash
A. glutton B. jury C. nap D. gory
89. Pool
A. poll B. pull C. move D. foot
90. Dog
A. don B. dawn C. dam D. done

SECTION 8

From the words lettered A to D, choose the word that **rhymes with** the given word.

91. Cause
A. course B. pause C. course D. purse
92. Blood
A. flowed B. bled C. flood D. brood
93. Head
A. said B. heard C. sad D. bead
94. Brother
A. father B. broader C. mother D. brothel
95. Quicken
A. queen B. kitten C. kitchen D. chicken

SECTION 9

In each of the following questions, the main/primary stress is indicated by writing the stressed syllable in capital letters. From the words lettered A to D. Choose the one that has the **correct stress**.

96. agriculture
A. aGRiculture B. Agriculture C. agriCULTure
D. agriculture
97. economics
A. econoMICS B. eCONomics C. Economics
D. economics
98. democracy
A. domoCRACY B. democraCY C. deMOcracy
D. DEMocracy
99. photographer
A. phoTOgrapher B. PHOTographer
C. photoGRapher D. photographer
100. criticism
A. cntiClsm B. criTicism C. criticiSM D. CRiticism

**WASSCE AUGUST 1991 ENGLISH LANGUAGE 2
OBJECTIVE TEST ANSWERS**

1.B 2.E 3.D 4.A 5.E 6.A 7.D
8.C 9.E 10.E 11.C 12.E 13.B 14.D
15.E 16.E 17.B 18.C 19.A 20.A 21.C
22.D 23.D 24.A 25.A 26.C 27.E 28.A
29.B 30.E 31.A 32.B 33.C 34.A 35.D
36.B 37.A 38.A 39.A 40.D 41.B 42.A

43.C 44.C 45.A 46.C 47.D 48.D 49.A
50.B 51.A 52.A 53.C 54.D 55.B 56.D
57.C 58.C 59.C 60.B 61.B 62.B 63.C
64.B 65.A 66.E 67.A 68.E 69.C 70.C
71.D 72.A 73.D 74.E 75.D 76.E 77.A
78.B 79.C 80.E 81.D 82.B 83.C 84.A
85.B 86.D 87.B 88.C 89.C 90.D 91.C
92.C 93.A 94.C 95.D 96.C 97.D 98.A
99.D 100.C

**WASSCE AUGUST 1991 ENGLISH LANGUAGE 1 THEORY TEST
QUESTIONS**

PART A

1. A youth club in your country is organizing an essay competition for final year Senior Secondary School students on the topic: The lingua franca question: problems and prospects. Write your entry.
2. There was a terrible storm in your town during which many houses were destroyed. Your family house was among those affected. Write a letter to your uncle working overseas describing the disaster and requesting for his help in reconstructing the house.
3. Write an article suitable for publication in a foreign magazine on the traditional marriage system of your people.
4. The transistor radio you bought from a department store with a two-year guarantee developed a fault after six months. You took it to the technical section of the store where the foreman refused to accept it, alleging that the guarantee did not cover the fault reported. Write a letter to the General Manager of the store lodging your complaint, explaining the nature of the fault and requesting the store to fulfil its guarantee.
5. Tell a story that ends with the words: It was a bitter experience, but I learnt my lesson.

6. You have just ended your tenure as the President of the youth club in your community. Write a speech which will be delivered at the last general meeting before you leave office, recounting your achievements and expressing your hopes for the future of the club.

**PART B
SECTION I
COMPREHENSION**

7. **Read the following passage carefully and answer the questions on it.**

It has been found by researchers in education that the odds are stacked high against the learner from a deprived socioeconomic background. A learner, whose parents are illiterate, whose parents earn poor income, who has no access to the electronic media of information, and who has no educated siblings or peers to learn from, faces an uphill task in his educational career. The task is even more difficult if the learner lives in an obscure rural area for he is then cut off from modern civilization.

The learner from an academically enriched background, whose parents are highly learned and financially stable, and who has constant access to the electronic media, has a head start over his deprived counterpart from the village. Therefore, it is unfair that learners from different backgrounds should face the same competition for admission into higher institutions or for

employment opportunities since nobody determines their background.

Unfair as the practice may be, it is not easy to work out an alternative system. In the first place, distinguishing between students from academically enriched and those from educationally deprived backgrounds and reserving some places for the latter, would amount to double standard. Indeed, such a policy would inevitably engender a number of malpractices on the part of candidates. Moreover, formulating a policy by which learners from educationally deprived background are given special employment opportunities would tend to play down the practice of selection on the basis of merit. It does appear that the way out is to minimize the odds against which the less advantaged learners have to struggle. If rural communities are improved, and if conscious efforts are made to reduce the gap between the rich and the poor, much would have been done to help the socioeconomically disadvantaged learners overcome some of the odds against them.

- (a) Mention **three** factors that distinguish the **two** classes of learners described in the passage.
- (b) Which word in the first paragraph shows that the writer based the article on facts and not on speculation?
- (c) Why does the writer say that the present practice is unfair?
- (d) Give two reasons why the writer thinks that there is no alternative to the present practice.
- (e) Whose parents are highly learned and financially stable (i) What grammatical name is given to the expression? (ii) What is its function as used in the sentence?
- (f) Give one word or phrase which can replace each of the following words as used in the passage: (i) deprived (ii) career; (iii) counterpart; (iv) practice (v) distinguishing.

8. Read the following passage carefully and answer the questions on it.

With some ten hours journey before them, the professor and his men at first thought of heeding Pa Chukwuka's advice that they should stay till Monday morning. But the professor knew that his department would almost be paralysed for a whole day if he and his colleagues should stay on. That he did not like. So, the journey commenced and, a little later, the heavens were let loose.

Stubbornly, the five cars ploughed through. The Niger was crossed a little after 4pm, and Asaba was soon behind the travellers. In front was the departmental car with the professor, his

two kinsmen, and his bride. Their mission was the formal traditional marriage ceremony. At the rear was the secretary's car. Stealthily, against all the convoy crept on. Yet, for hundreds of kilometres, the rain persisted; lighter in some places, heavier in others but present in one form or the other throughout.

Darkness descended with a gentle suddenness over the landscape. The dark arrow of finality nearly struck Dr. Stephen Dimgba a few kilometres outside Aba. The on-coming heavy truck dazzled him with its powerful headlights. As it roared towards him, his bespectacled eyes were momentarily blinded. He swerved off the road for the devil of the long lorry. The muddy, side gutter helped turn the swerve into an exaggerated skid. By the time the monster roared past, Stephen and his four fellow travellers were struggling to get off the inferno that started after the accident.

- (a) What had the travellers been told before the journey?
- (b) Why did the professor and his colleagues decide to travel all the same?
- (c)(i) What was the mission of the travellers?
(ii) Quote the sentence that tells you this.
- (d)(i) Where did the accident occur? (ii) Give two reasons why the accident occurred.
- (e)(i) What figure of speech is the expression, the heavens were let loose. (ii) Give the meaning of the expression as used in the passage. (i) Give another word or phrase that can replace each of the following words as used in the passage: (i) heeding; (ii) kinsmen; (iii) odds; (iv) roared; (v) monster; (vi) inferno.

SECTION II SUMMARY

9. Read the following passage carefully and answer the questions on it.

It is now fashionable to hear discussions centering on the disproportionate representation of male and females in the population. It is indeed not uncommon to hear people say that for every man there are about two or three women, so, every man can marry more than one woman. This theory is, of course, more popular among adherents, who favour the seeming glamour of the polygamous way of life. The big question is: How correct is this theory? And, what are the facts?

The stark reality is that in any normal population, out of every one hundred conceptions, about fifty-three to fifty-five are for boys, and about forty-five to forty-seven are for girls. So, there are potentially more boys than girls in any normal population. However, because of many factors, some of which are not fully clear, the foetus of a boy is far more fragile than that of a girl. So, there are more miscarriages of male

children than of female ones. So, by the time the children are born, the ratio between boys and girls has been reduced to about fifty-two boys to forty-eight girls.

As infants, boys are more delicate than girls. Boys are less resistant to certain killer diseases and girls thus have a higher chance of survival. The result is that before adolescence, at about the age of between nine and eleven years, boys and girls are virtually at par in the population.

Throughout adolescence, from the age of twelve to nineteen years, boys continue to fall victim of many ailments at a much higher degree than girls do. Besides, boys' tendency to be more adventurous, more daring and more risk-taking, expose them far more to mishaps. Some of these do reduce their representation in the population. So by end of the age of adolescence, there are slightly more girls than boys. The reduction, thereafter, in the number of males continues progressively. Men are the breadwinners, the soldiers and the travellers. It is during their middle age that very many men die tragically, as soldiers in their boots, so to say. The net result of this is that by the time they are in the mid-thirties and forties, there are more women than men.

Finally, in their late forties and fifties, far more men than women die of cardiac diseases like hypertension, heart-attack and anxiety. This is the period when there are clearly more widows than widowers.

On the whole, therefore, there are more females than males but certainly not in the proportion claimed by adherents of polygamy. During their marriageable years, there are about eleven wives to ten husbands - that is husbands and wives of the same age. That in some communities one man could marry as many as fifteen wives is a result of the fact that men normally marry from among the ladies younger than they are. This, more than any other factor, allows some men who are inclined to polygamy to have their way. (a) In five sentences, one for each factor, summarize the factors responsible for the progressive reduction in the number of males as against females from conception to adulthood. (b) In one sentence, state why some form of polygamy is possible in a normal population.

WASSCE AUGUST 1991 ENGLISH LANGUAGE 1 THEORY ANSWERS

1. LINGUA FRANCA IN NIGERIA

A lingua franca is any language which a country which has different languages chooses to use for easy communication and interactions. A

lingua franca is needed in every multi-ethnic country like Nigeria, India, Indonesia and many other countries. A lingua franca is supposed to be one of the languages spoken in a country and that which all the native speakers of the other languages must subscribe and contribute to. Presently, Nigeria is still using English which was handed over from our former British colonisers - so it can be at best called a national language.

Having a lingua franca is desirable for some reasons. It makes communication and interaction easy among diverse people who find themselves in the same country. Language is the prime medium of communication. A lingua franca is good for national or patriotic reasons. When a group of people use another group or country's language for their official dealings they could be easily described pejoratively as a people that lack a well developed linguistic medium. It is through a people's or a country's language that the culture or civilization of the people can be effectively promoted. The adoption of a language as a country's lingua franca presupposes that there is already a large population of native speakers of it.

Adopting a lingua franca is fraught with many problems. First, the different peoples or speakers of their own mother tongues are wont to resist any attempt to deprive them of their linguistic autonomy by imposing another people's language on them. India, for instance, there have been violent and tragic language riots. In Nigeria, the various subtle attempts to adopt one of the three main languages as our lingua franca have failed.

What we now have in the 'wazobia' tripartite arrangement or promotion of the three languages nationally is a caricature of a lingua franca policy.

One of the main factors for choosing a language as a lingua franca is the large number of its native speakers cum their geographical spread. But in Nigeria, using this criterion is problematic because Nigerians show unusual interest in census matters and some groups will do anything to influence their numerical strength for certain advantages over the others. And most Nigerian ethnic groups are not in a hurry to surrender their linguistic cum cultural independence on the altar of lingua franca.

The desire for a lingua franca is desirable and good for Nigeria for some reasons, but pursuing dogmatically politically will only bring violent oppositions because no Nigerian wants to fight off foreign domination only to embrace local imperialism. However, a gradualist evolutionary approach should be encouraged.

Ajibade Adekemi,
S.S3A,

School of Science,
Imesi - lie.

2. Advice on how to answer this informal question appropriately. The writer can communicate all he or she wants to say to the uncle in an informal or semi-formal tone. Giving details of what is destroyed by the storm should not be a problem to the writer of the letter. The letter should end simply with either the first name of the writer (if the uncle is very familiar with him) or with the name and surname (if there is no much familiarity with his uncle or avoid ambiguity if many people in the extended family bear the same name).
3. Advice on how to solve or answer this question. This is an article. You must not address it to any editor. You should see the 1988 SSCE question number 3 as your model. The writer must know that the audience or readers do not know your culture or marriage terms or procedures. You must not take anything for granted that the readers already know. Your write-up should be explanatory, informative and descriptive. The writer should simply and his name to the end of essay.

4. 39, Dipo Olunbi Street,
Ikate, Surulere,
Lagos.
14th June, 1993.

The General Manager,
Leventis Stores,
103 Broad Street,
Lagos.

Dear Sir,

REPAIR OR REPLACEMENT OF MY TELEVISION SET

Six months ago, I bought an 18"JVC colour television set from your store. The model number is 0900, serial number 0245 - 721 3-99.

The first week it was connected in my apartment it only showed different channels in spite of the fact that accompanying brochure says it can show as many as seven stations. It has, however, worked perfectly well since then. But to my total dismay, it stopped showing on any of the stations. It is not working at all. On testing the electrical plug with another appliance, it worked and showed that there was nothing wrong with the plug.

On my way to work two days ago, I brought it along in my car to the technical section of your stores but the supervisor I met on duty, one Mr. Adetan, was very unco-operative when I requested for a repair. I had wanted to see you in person myself but your secretary informed me that you had gone out for an appointment.

I have been your customer for over four years now. I want either of the following things: a thorough repair and service of the set cost-free or an outright replacement with the same model. This should be so because at the time of purchase I was given a two-year guarantee.

Attached to this letter are the photocopies of all relevant documents pertaining to the television set in question. My driver will bring the original documents and the set to your office between 10am and 11am next Saturday after I have returned to Lagos at the end of the seminar I am attending at Abeokuta.

I am looking forward to an amicable remedy of this unfortunate incident in the interest of all concerned.

Yours faithfully,



Mrs. F.A. Fulani.

5. A narration of any sad, bitter painful personal experience or the one you heard about will help to illustrate this type of essay. Please see Part A question 1 of SSCE 1988 as your model.
6. See the 1990 answers to questions 1 and 6 two different models of speech or address essay. The writer is to think our possible achievements and problems and arrange them properly into a comprehensible write-up.
7. **COMPREHENSION**
 - (a) Different parental background, the poor and the rich, the literate and the stark illiterate parents. Accessibility to media information is not equal. Some students have and others don't have literate relations to learn from.
 - (b) Researchers
 - (c) The practice is unfair because the students from rich literate background have advantage over the students from poor background.
 - (d) Distinguishing students according to backgrounds is hard and even reserving place for the unprivileged students will lead to double standard.
 - (e) (i) Relative or adjectival clause (ii) Describing 'learners'

(f)(i) Less privileged (ii) Endeavour (iii) Colleague
(iv) Style (v) Differentiating.

8. (a) The travellers were advised to postpone their journey till Monday.
(b) To avoid paralyzing his department back in the university
(c)(i) They went for the formal traditional wedding ceremony of the professor (ii) 'Their mission was the formal traditional marriage ceremony'
(d)(i) A few kilometres outside Aboja. (ii) The bright headlights of a truck which blurred the driver's vision. The muddy side gutter which swerved the vehicle
(e)(i) Hyperbole (ii) It began to rain heavily.

(f)(i) Obeying (ii) Relative (iii) !isadvantages
(iv) Screamed (v) beast (vi) fire.

SUMMARY

9. (a)(i) There are more mutual abortions of male foetus 'an those of female. (ii) More infant boys perish from killer-diseases. (iii) More boys than girls die during risky indulgences. (iv) More men than women die in risk-prone professions (v) A greater number of men in their forties die from heart diseases than their women counterparts.
(b) Men prefer to marry women who are younger than themselves.

SENIOR SCHOOL CERTIFICATE EXAMINATION (SSCE 1988 – 2015)

Past Questions with Solutions

English Language

(Theory / Objectives with Oral English) 1992

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WASSCE JUNE 1992 ENGLISH LANGUAGE 2 OBJECTIVE TEST QUESTIONS

SECTION 1

Instruction: Choose the word **opposite** in meaning to the underlined words.

1. In many ways my parents are very conservative but there are times when they surprise me with their.....ideas on family planning.
A. orthodox B. critical C. modern D. new E. liberal.
2. My brother adores dogs but he has a very strong.....for cats
A. love B. annoyance C. attitude D. dislike E. criticism
3. On our way to Tarkwa Bay the sea was turbulent but fortunately it was quite.....on our way back
A. calm B. pleasant C. motionless D. placid E. rough
4. Though payment of the levy is voluntary it is.....for all students to pay tuition fees
A. essential B. important C. necessary D. mandatory E. optional
5. The director left strict instructions regarding the running of the office but his deputy was most.....in his absence
A. vague B. lazy C. lax D. accurate E. prompt
6. Emeka complained that while his colleagues were elevated he was.....
A. interdicted B. prompted C. suspended D. dismissed E. downgraded
7. The taxi driver pleaded that the splashing of water was accidental but the lady insisted that it was.....
A. thoughtful B. deliberate C. directed D. mischievous E. incidental
8. The government was accused of implementing policies that favoured the elite instead of the.....
A. masses B. oppressed C. executive D. worker E. jobless

SECTION 2

From the words lettered A to E, choose the word that **best completes** each of the following sentences

9. The earthquake that struck Mexico.....the city
A. confused B. devastated C. demarcated D. troubled E. demolished
10. After his defeat in the war, the General.....his army and went into retirement
A. fired B. retired C. disbanded D. executed E. disgraced
11. The notorious robber was finally.....by the police after a three-month search
A. surrounded B. overwhelmed C. arrested D. entangled E. located
12. Many students had good results in the examination but Kola's performance was.....
A. tolerable B. best C. fair D. unacceptable E. woeful
13. Besides being a qualified nurse, my mother is also good in accounting, hair-dressing and sewing; she is very.....indeed.
A. versatile B. skilled C. clever D. pushful E. hard-working
14. It is most.....that despite the huge amount spent on health care, most hospitals lack basic medical equipment
A. wonderful B. uflgrateful C. wicked D. astonishing E. remarkable.
15. The.....ceremony of the new Oba had to be postponed because of the sudden death of his mother
A. initiation B. coronation C. cultural D. remembrance E. resurrection
16. The local government election result was cancelled because of widespread...during voting.
A. offences B. accusations C. violence D. fighting E. irregularities.
17. He was.....to have escaped unhurt from the collapsed building.
A. fortunate B. brilliant C. agile D. unfortunate E. energetic

18. The out-going leader warned his successor to beware of.....who praise every activity of government, whether good or bad.
A. critics B. favourites C. enthusiasts
D. parasites E. sycophants
19. The officers pledged their.....loyalty to the new government
A. indefatigable B. complete C. questionable
D. unalloyed E. indiscriminate

SECTION 3

*After each of the following sentences, a list of possible interpretations of the sentence is given. Choose the interpretation that you consider **most appropriate** for each sentence.*

20. Though we lost the match, we will get even with our opponents in the next round. This means that
A. our opponents were just lucky to win
B. we will win the next match
C. we will not play again
D. the two teams are not evenly matched
21. He was retrenched last year and now he is only the shadow of his former self. This means that he
A. looks very well
B. is just like his shadow
C. is very thin and weak
D. is very fearful
22. Due to poor visibility all aircraft were grounded at the Kano Airport for two days. This means that
A. all aircraft had mechanical problems
B. the runway at Kano Airport was damaged
C. no aircraft could take off
D. there was a visible disturbance at Kano Airport.
23. Getting six distinctions in your mock examination is praiseworthy but do not allow it to get into your head. This means that the good result
A. has made you mad
B. has not bothered you
C. could be better
D. should not make you conceited.
24. When Mr. Ojo, the first principal, suddenly left the school it became a regular bedlam. This means that
A. there was noise and confusion everywhere
B. everybody started coming to school regularly
C. everybody was happy with his departure
D. discipline was restored to the school.
25. Segun held the audience spellbound with his superb performance. This means that
A. the play was a good one

- B. all the actors put up a good performance
C. all the actors, except Segun, performed very well
D. members of the audience were captivated by Segun's performance.

26. Matters came to a head when the man accused his wife of infidelity. This means that the
A. accusation worsened the relationship between the couple
B. couple were living peacefully before the accusation
C. husband hit the wife on the head because of her misbehaviour
D. wife had been proved to be unfaithful by the husband.
27. The way the young pupils were chasing the poor mad woman made my blood boil. This means that
A. the pupils were made to chase the poor woman
B. I was agitated about the action of the pupils
C. the mad woman was angry with the pupils
D. my blood was actually boiling because the pupils maltreated the mad woman.
28. The former chairman has no moral right to criticize the present chairman because he too has a skeleton in the cupboard. This means that the
A. former chairman has an unpleasant secret that is hidden
B. present chairman has not done anything wrong so far
C. former chairman maintained a very low moral standard during his tenure
D. former chairman kept a very terrifying skeleton in a large cupboard.

SECTION 4

*From the words or groups of words lettered A to E below each of the following sentences, choose the word or group of words that is **nearest in meaning** to the underlined word or phrase as it is used in the sentence.*

29. Femis comments were germane to the issue under discussion.
A. confidential B. redundant C. crucial D. critical
E. relevant
30. The testimony of the witness absolved the accused of the charges.
A. condemned B. implicated C. criticized
D. blamed E. cleared
31. The supreme court set aside the ruling of the High Court
A. upheld B. nullified C. agreed with D. justified

- E. rebuked
32. The ornament should be handled with care because it is fragile.
A. expensive B. uncommon C. golden D. imported
E. delicate
33. The minister announced that the government would soon make a law to prohibit the showing of obscene films.
A. violent B. dangerous C. immoral D. frightful
E. juvenile.
34. His approach to work is rather perfunctory
A. careful B. serious C. careless D. encouraging
B. bad
35. The retiring officer's contribution towards the growth of the company was invaluable
A. inestimable B. unnoticeable C. negligible
D. inconsequential E. measurable
36. The General's response to the question on whether or not he would retire from the army was evasive
A. clear B. undecided C. definite D. annoyed
E. elusive
37. He poured out a lot of invectives in a speech that was supposed to be a vote of thanks
A. praises B. requests C. denials D. curses
E. apologies
38. Her eloping with the man is a stigma to the family
A. disgrace B. pride C. calamity D. disappointment
E. disaster.
39. The politician was given a tumultuous welcome when he came to address the rally.
A. pleasant B. noisy C. discouraging D. strange
E. well-organized

SECTION 5

*From the words lettered A to D, choose the word or group of words that **best completes** each of the following sentences.*

40. Everyone must be..... bed by 9.00 p.m
A. over B. inside C. on D. In
41. Femi was told not to allow pleasure to interfere.....his duty
A. on B. ver C. with D. beside
42. He sent a card to his parents to congratulate them.....their diamond wedding anniversary
A. over B. on C. in D. about

43. The pupils were advised not to laugh.....mad people
A. at B. on C. with D. over
44. If you want to succeed in life, you will have to shake.....your lazy habits.
A. against B. if C. over D. off
45. You should take good care of your car.....buy another one.
A. for you may not be able to
B. suppose you cannot
C. due to the fact that you cannot
D. otherwise you cannot
46. Hardly had we arrived.....he left
A. so B. when C. then D. that
47. It is high time you.....smoking
A. stopped B. should stop C. must stop D. stop
48. The office.....he works is fully air-conditioned.
A. to which B. by which C. where D. that
49. I do not like to flatter people but I must say that Bisi is.....beautiful girl in the school
A. a B. a more C. very D. the most
50. He would have won the race.....
A. only if he could run fast
B. if he had run faster
C. if he can run faster
D. although he ran faster
51. Though we are friends, I.....
A. lent her some money
B. refused to lend her any money
C. will lend her some money
D. am lending her the money
52. There is no dispute about the ownership of this piece of land, but.....is that portion over there?
A. whom B. to whom C. of whom D. whose
53. Neither Adamu nor Musa.....at home when Idris arrived
A. was B. were C. are D. is
54. Both Ngozi and Ifeoma promised to attend the party but.....of them came
A. either B. all C. no person D. neither
55. He has stopped drinking.....?
A. does he B. hasn't he C. doesn't he D. did he

56. The labour leaders threatened a.....with the government if the subsidy was removed
A. show-off B. show-biz C. show-down
D. show-piece
57.of what he said was nonsense
A. Much B. Few C. Little D. Many
58. The utility player in the centre forward position meandered.....the defence of the opponent to score the winning goal
A. across B. through C. over D. under
59. If it.....rained. I would have completed the work.
A. had B. has C. hasn't D. hadn't
60.kept the bicycle in the rain?
A. Whom B. Whose C. Who's D. Which is
61.the owner of that dog?
A. Who's B. Whose C. Whom D. Which is
62. One of the pupils.....able to answer the question correctly.
A. were B. are C. was D. Can
63.way you look at it, Alabi's case is a very bad one.
A. Whatever B. Whichever C. Whenever
D. However
64. People were cautious about..... the sad news to her.
A. to break B. having broken C. broken
D. breaking
65. They were warned, so they have.....to blame for the problems they are now facing
A. themselves B. ourselves C. yourselves
D. their own selves
66.in his right senses will give shelter to a known thief.
A. Somebody B. Everybody C. Nobody
D. Someone
67. It was very clever of the students.....the problem so quickly.
A. to have solved B. having solved
C. to have been solving D. having been solving
68. The dress he wore was.....appropriate for the party
A. quite B. too C. much D. more

SECTION 6

*In the following passages the numbered gaps indicate missing words. Against each number in the list below each passage, five choices are offered in columns lettered A to E. For each question, choose the word that is the **most suitable** to fill the numbered gap in the passage.*

PASSAGE A

Teaching is one of the oldest —69— known to man. Every community from time immemorial must have had —70— known and respected for their ability to guide and —71— younger members of their community towards the —72— of the desired goals of their group. The —73— ceremonies for young adults common to many cultures are part of the —74— education process of those cultures: but there are very many informal ways of educating the young. When a young girl helps her mother in preparing the family —75— she is learning —76— skills in an informal set-up. One's —77— group also exerts a great —78— on individuals.

In the formal set-up of our schools today, education is highly —79—. There is the —80— of authority from the principal down to the class monitors. We have a fixed —83— plays an important role in shaping our attitudes and conditioning our —84— and responses to our society as a whole.

	A	D	C	D	E
69.	activities	roles	professions	callings	jobs
70.	men	women	groups	children	individuals
71.	concern	motivate	force	brake	incite
72.	attainment	evolution	creating	enforcement	preservation
73.	fathen	courageous	wild	incitation	secret
74.	true	formal	respective	good	praiseworthy
75.	dial	meal	meal	cooking	dishes
76.	modern	expert	culinary	beneficial	interesting
77.	sex	school	friendly	peer	neighbourhood
78.	pressure	action	attitude	behaviour	influence
79.	expensive	europenized	ocular	different	organized
80.	hierarchy	obedience	respect	power	enforcement
81.	calendar	ammanac	time-table	set-up	way of life
82.	study	gather	acquire	get	learn
83.	perfect	teacher	monitor	captain	leader
84.	behaviour	success	future	goal	objective

PASSAGE B

Mankind has been ravaged by many virus and —85— diseases such as measles, tuberculosis, diarrhoea and many others including —86— known also as the common cold. —87— outbreaks of many of these diseases have been brought under control in the last fifty years. Some—88— like measles and whooping cough still pose a great danger to younger children. The —89— of measles are more easily —90— than those of whooping cough. Unlike that of many others, the virus of measles are more easily remained —91— for hundreds of years. However, once you have had an —92— of this dreadful disease, you develop an —93— which is almost complete and long lasting.

Modern science has made available —94— to prevent many childhood diseases and this is the only guarantee of —95— from these scourges. More effective treatment of complications arising from these childhood diseases using penicillin and other —96— has also helped to reduce the —97— rate among children. It is universally accepted that good —98— is the right of every human being and children do not have to die from these diseases which wiped out whole —99—in the Middle Ages. We have today —100— drugs which give protection against most childhood diseases.

25. germ	26. bacterial	27. dirty	28. miasma	29. epidemic
30. common	31. sporadic	32. universal	33. regular	34. irregular
35. pains	36. symptoms	37. diagnosed	38. unchanged	39. epidemic
40. encounter	41. immunity	42. tablets	43. cure	44. antibiotics
45. killing	46. severe	47. schools	48. marvellous	49. super
50. bitter	51. lovely	52. areas	53. states	54. communities
55. potential	56. experience	57. assured	58. victory	59. pills
60. unbelievable	61. stature	62. status	63. communities	64. potential

WASSCE JUNE 1992 ENGLISH LANGUAGE 2 OBJECTIVE TEST ANSWERS

1.E	2.D	3.A	4.D	5.C	6.E	7.B
8.A	9.B	10.C	11.C	12.E	13.A	14.D
15.B	16.E	17.A	18.E	19.D	20.B	21.C
22.C	23.D	24.A	25.D	26.A	27.B	28.A
29.E	30.E	31.B	32.E	33.C	34.C	35.A
36.E	37.D	38.A	39.B	40.D	41.C	42.B
43.A	44.D	45.A	46.B	47.A	48.C	49.D
50.B	51.B	52.D	53.A	54.D	55.B	56.C
57.A	58.B	59.D	60.D	61.A	62.C	63.B
64.D	65.A	66.C	67.A	68.A	69.C	70.E
71.B	72.A	73.D	74.B	75.C	76.C	77.D
78.E	79.E	80.A	81.C	82.E	83.B	84.A
85.B	86.A	87.B	88.C	89.A	90.A	91.E
92.E	93.C	94.D	95.D	96.C	97.B	98.A
99.E	100.E					

WASSCE JUNE 1992 ENGLISH LANGUAGE 1 THEORY QUESTIONS

PART A

- Your school was tipped to win the final match of the inter-school football competition for secondary schools in your state, but unfortunately you lost to the underdog. Write an article for publication in your school magazine on that match, explaining why your school lost and the lessons to be learnt.
- Narrate a story to illustrate the warning: Look before you leap.
- There have been widespread complaints by students against the teaching staff: absenteeism, lateness to classes, failure to prepare lessons, and so on. As the senior prefect, write a letter to the principal, informing him of the situation and requesting him to take necessary action in order to avert a riot that is being secretly planned by students.
- The Political Science Students' Association in one of the higher institutions of learning has invited your school to participate in a debate on the topic: Civil Rule is Preferable to Military Rule. Write out your speech for or against the motion.
- You changed school recently and have been at the new school for six weeks. Write a letter to your uncle explaining why you left your former school

and describe at least three things you find more interesting in the new school.

- You were an eye-witness to a fire outbreak which completely destroyed the main market in your town. Write an article suitable for publication in a national newspaper describing the incident and suggesting measures that could be adopted to prevent a recurrence.

PART B SECTION I COMPREHENSION

- Read the following passage carefully and answer the questions on it.

Do the present policies on those who commit crimes reflect a class war? For long, people have alleged that certain laws discriminate against some members of the society while such laws favour others. Besides, some sociologists also claim that some members of the society are more prone to some specific crimes than others. So, our opening question is pertinent.

When we realize that armed robbery and similar offences require the use of the brute force, it immediately becomes clear that these are offences almost exclusive to the masculine world. The offences are thus sex-bound. Besides, the

need to be physically strong and agile tends to the working class, who at least have some financial returns to rely on, hardly ever have the urge to resort to violence. This tends to limit violent crimes to the unemployed, poor and desperate males in their late teens, twenties, or early thirties. Indeed, if elderly citizens are involved, they function as the barons, the financiers, who sit back at home while they let loose the dogs of vandalism and death. They provide the money and tools for the frontline criminals.

Similarly, drug pushing tends to be more prevalent among the weaker sex, especially ladies in their twenties. They are biologically more attractive, and hence more likely to wade through the airport and border posts while hiding deadly grammes of hard drugs within one or other of their bodily crevices. Again, if older citizens are involved it is more as the barons, shielding the carriers from prosecution if they are caught. So, this is another crime that is largely sex-bound.

Punishment for offences limited to the citizens on the lower rungs of the socio-economic ladder appear to be harsher. So, robbery with violence attracts death, and pushing hard drugs attracts long jail terms. Meanwhile, pen robbery and large-scale fraud, offences which are invariably specific to the high class officials, do not attract severe penalties. Indeed, most culprits at this level manage to wriggle out of the net of the law.

There thus appears to be sufficient reasons to answer our original question in the affirmative.

- (a) Mention any two yardsticks used by the writer to categorize those who commit violent crimes.
- (b) What two roles do the barons of the identified crimes play?
- (c) Among what group of people are violent crimes most common?
- (d)(i) Does the writer consider the punishment for the various crimes mentioned in the passage as fair? (ii) Support your answer with a brief description of the writer's argument
- (e) . . .they let loose the dogs of vandalism and death. (i) What figure of speech is the above expression? (ii) What does the expression mean?
- (f) For each of the following words, find another word or phrase which means the same and can replace it as used in the passage: (i) pertinent: (ii) agile; (iii) desperate; (iv) prevalent; (v) severe.

8. Read the following passage carefully and answer the questions on it.

Marriage as a human institution is facing its greatest threat ever in the twentieth century. Never, since the first man and woman were joined together, has the institution been beset by as

many problems as it is now. And this trend, which started in the Western world, has spread and is spreading to all parts of the globe.

The most disturbing problem is the high rate of divorce. It is no longer a social stigma for women to fill in forms indicating that they are divorced; men, too, proclaim their liberty from the shackles of matrimony somehow with pride. Little wonder that young couples resort to separation and eventually divorce, at the slightest disagreement.

The availability of an alternative aggravates the seriousness of the problem. Instead of entering into matrimony, very many couples simply decide to live together. Even the courts now recognize such common law marriages, and respect the rights of partners in such associations. The great advantage this accords the partners is the fluidity of the association, the ease with which one or both can call off the union.

Besides, very many countries now enact laws that recognize the rights of children born out of wedlock. This singular factor has helped to shoot up the number of such children in many civilized communities. A recent survey in an urban college shows that about forty percent of the students were born out of wedlock.

Not less among the factors hastening the death of the marriage institution is the progressively rising cost of living. Nowadays, it is essential for both partners to be gainfully employed to be sure of a reasonably decent level of existence. The marriage ceremony itself costs so much that the young men simply remain single, raising one or two children from ladies who themselves are often willing collaborators against the institution of marriage.

- (a) What does the author mean by referring to marriage as an institution?
- (b) What do the words liberty and shackles mean, as used in the passage?
- (c) (i) What, according to the passage, is a common-law marriage? (ii) Mention one advantage of this system
- (d) Mention any two factors that are seriously threatening the marriage institution.
- (e).....who themselves are willing collaborators against the institution of marriage. (i) What is grammatical term used to describe the above expression as used in the passage? (ii) What is its function?
- (f) For each of the following, find another word or phrase that means the same and which can replace it as used in the passage: (i) globe; (ii) stigma; (iii) an alternative; (iv) enact; (v) survey.

SECTION II SUMMARY

9. Read the following passage carefully and answer the questions on it:

On a global basis, no statistics are adequate to suggest the magnitude of the revolution in education today. In the United States Information Service's library in the third world, about thirty million people annually use the facilities provided. The agency distributes eight million books every year. The Soviet Union also distributes over one hundred and fifty million books to developing countries all over the world. But together, these programmes do not come near to meeting the world demand.

Mere facts and figures cannot convey the human passion for learning. In the English-speaking teaching programmes mounted for children in Latin-American countries, children have been known to have sold the shoes off their feet to pay their way to classes. In Africa a tribal chief was turned away from enrolling in a class because there were no more chairs. The next day, he and a contingent of his fellow chiefs were waiting outside the door, each carrying his own chair.

This revolution is not limited to the developing world. In the United States there are more than fifty million students attending more than 185,000 public and private schools at all levels. There are more students today in the United States than there were city residents only forty years ago. We have entered an age in which education is not just a luxury which gives some men an advantage over others. It has become a necessity without which a person is defenceless in this complex industrialized society. Levels of education which were once regarded with awe have now become common place. And jobs which once could be filled with possession of strength and native intelligence now call for a college degree. We have truly entered the century of the educated man.

It is a mistake, however, to confuse skill with education. A man who has been taught only to hold a job has not been educated; he has only been trained. And the man who was merely been trained is not fully qualified to take his place in a free society as a fully participating citizen. An all-round education should equip the learner for any challenges he may encounter.

Education, of course, is not something that is acquired just in college. It is a life-long task and when I think of death, I think of it as the moment when I am called to inquire and expand.

(a) In four sentences, one for each, summarize the instances given by the writer to show that education is spreading at a very rapid rate.

(b) In two sentences, one for each, state the reasons given by the writer to support the view that education is changing fast.

WASSCE JUNE 1992 ENGLISH LANGUAGE 2 THEORY ANSWERS

A SHOW OF SHAME

1. We have never had it so bad in the history of football competition among the colleges in Lagos State. How are the mighty fallen before the lilliputians! Last Saturday will go into the college annals that the great Rainbow Bombers of St. David Grammar School were subdued by the unheard of Oba Akran Memorial College from Ojo. The fact that we lost to the beginners college footballers is now a fact of history. It is disturbing that we were subdued by the footballing underdogs called Oba Akran Babes. What now appears to be an autopsy or postmortem examination of the competition, one should put in black and white the few main reasons or factors why we lost by scoring a single goal and they coasted home with the state trophy lesson we all have or ought to have learnt from this shameful performance.

Over-confidence was our major undoing. Because the Oba Akran Babes are beginners, both our school coach and even the footballers neglected adequate coaching and preparations. Our poor display, unco-ordinated movement of our players during the match drove the message home that even a brilliant student could fail his exams if he ignored his studies for too long.

Another factor for our shameful performance was the last minute dropping from the school team of our few tactical players who had been with the team since the football season started in an attempt to effect discipline against those students for some mysterious offences against some staff and the school. It was glaring that the players hurriedly introduced into the team at the eleventh hour could not relate to the other players well enough at the football pitch.

There is an element of truth in the rumour that our boys were drugged by the host school. This was done through the separate drinks which the Oba Akran catering department gave our boys on their arrival in the afternoon. Some of our striking players merely managed to play lazily throughout the match.

There was the rumour that some of our opponent school's beautiful girls were unusually 'friendly' to our boys. It is really painful and shameful that all the strong teams were jeering and booing us during the final competition not essentially because we had defeated them but

because of the caricature our opponents made of us.

I hope we will henceforth realise the importance of adequate preparations and arming ourselves against all manoeuvres that are not associated with football matches but could nevertheless be employed by the opponent to undo our side.

Adeyemo Peter,
SS 2B.

2. How to answer this question any story which illustrates any bad, painful, regrettable or shameful experience will suffice before one can give the advice, 'Look Before You Leap' The candidate-reader should once again refer to part A question 1 of SSCE 1988 as a model.

3. St. David's Grammar School,
Igbuku,
Isoko North Local Government Area,
Delta State,
18th June, 1992.

The Principal,
St David's Grammar School,
Igbuku.

Dear Sir,

TOWARDS CONTINUED PEACE IN OUR COLLEGE

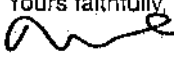
I wish to alert you, the entire school authority that we all are sitting on a keg of gun powder if the grievances of students are not properly looked into and assuaged. I will be failing in my duties if I shy away from reporting the present disposition of the students. For a better part of the second term, the students' representatives in the various classes have complained about the non-challant attitudes of a good number of the members of staff to their work. You will recall that I gave a verbal situation report to you earlier about the dwindling commitment of tutors early this term.

You have often taken stern measures to curb students' truancy. But it is like the school authority is somewhat soft on teachers' lateness to work these past two months. Some of the classes like two, four and five are the worst hit. Most teachers are now guilty of not forming and giving their students note. This is an additional dereliction of duty, together with irregular lectures and outright absenteeism on spurious reasons. Teachers

now commonly adopt the lecture method which we are made to believe is the common system used in tertiary institutions. In these days of scarcity and high cost of college texts, refusal to prepare and give notes is inimical to the ambitions of the young scholars.

Some teachers seem to lay too much emphasis on excessive or high-handed corporal punishment to effect routine disciplinary control of students. This will sooner than later prove counter-productive.

The students, from intelligence reports at my disposal are planning a violent show down with the school authority to drive home their legitimate grievances and draw urgent attention to the situation. I presume that you know that you don't teach a thief how to run. Please do everything within your administrative powers to inject sanity and the dignity of labour into your staff.

Yours faithfully,

Adeniji John,
Senior Prefect.

4. CIVIL RULE IS PREFERABLE TO MILITARY RULE

Government is any highly organised group for men and women that make execute and interpret laws for the individual and general benefits of the citizenry in a country. There are two main forms of government: one by civil personnel commonly called politicians and the other by military personnel. The former comes in form of democracy or monarchy and the latter is forcefully imposed on the citizens after a successful military coup d'état.

The most popular form of civil rule is democracy which Late United States president- Abraham Lincoln defined as a government of the people, by the people and for the people. There are many models or variants of democracy in the world today but the main essence of it runs through all its models, the people especially the political adult group known as the electorate exercises their right to vote for their leaders in various countries and they are free themselves to contest for any political offices available.

The right of the citizens to choose their representatives in the legislative and executive arms of government is not all there is in democratic rule. The citizens control the excesses of their leaders and can even remove them whenever they go against the constitution which they have sworn to defend. The populace can use

impeachment and recall and voting powers to remove an unpopular representative or government.

Under a democratic rule; a generally accepted body of laws called constitution guides the conduct of political activities and governance. It is not dependent on the arbitrary whims and caprices displayed by military rulers whenever they are in power.

Civil leaders derive their powers from the people and are therefore answerable to the masses during and at the end of their leadership tenures. This makes the popularly elected to be careful in the formulation and implementation of policies and programmes.

Another advantage of civil rule is that the politicians are men and women of diverse professional and occupational expertise or competence who bring their wealth of experiences to bear on governmental administration for the betterment of the citizens. The civil elite is more foresighted and more often than not engage in positive projects which the citizens will benefit from on the long run. The military rulers are short-sighted and interested in building fanciful white elephant projects from where they can collect enough kick backs. This is informed by the fact that counter-coup d'etats can take place at any given time. Who does not know that in Nigeria, successful coup plotters hurriedly promote themselves because of post retirement benefits.

Democracy is more stable and conducive to the enforcement and enjoyment of all the fundamental human rights enshrined in the constitution. The moment coup plotters overthrow a well constituted democratic government they suspend the constitution and begin to bombard the terrified citizenry with a barrage of despotic and draconian ill -conceived decrees. Some of these decrees and edicts muzzle the law courts and the fourth estate of the realm - the Press. This the ruling military class does to frustrate the efforts of these two noble institutions within the society from exposing the corrupt and criminal activities by our misguided, selfish, short-sighted, over-zealous lovers of violence and military messiahs who proclaim their government as a corrective regime. Their meaning of corrective only becomes clearer after a few months when even ordinary majors and captains become millionaires. You can imagine what the senior officers will become.

Democratic rule promotes the freedom of speech, movement and association. The reverse is the case with military rule. Harassment and detention of innocent citizens, closure and banning of media organizations, high - handed

maltreatment of civil protesters and summary trials in extra - judicial tribunals will become the rule rather than the exception.

During civil rule, the politicians give priority attention to viable sectors like agriculture, health, roads, water, housings' electricity, education and the economy generally. Military dictators prioritise the expending of our resources on the accumulation of arms and ammunition to our harm.

Civil rule is greatly preferable to military rule because there is variety of personnel, talents, expertise geared towards the services of the people and there is a sense of belonging because every adult participates in one form or the other in a democracy. This cannot be said of military rule.

5. Igbuku Community College,
Igbuku,
Isoko North Local Government,
Delta State.
20th June, 1992.

Uncle John,

I am sorry for my failure to write you before and/or immediately I changed from Ashaka High School to Igbuku Community College. I hope you and your family are fine. I am very fine in my new school. I thank God that the transfer to my present school was effected for me without much difficulty. You know what uncle? This my new school is better than the former one in three essential areas. I agree with your opinion that it is more distant from home than Ashaka High School. You will also agree with me that it is not how nearer home I am but how qualitative the education I'm receiving. Now to the three things that I find more interesting in my new school than the other one: presence of more qualified graduate teachers here, better equipped laboratory and library and the ample sporting facilities and time.

The school laboratory is good for the effective teaching of the sciences - Physics, Chemistry, Biology, Integrated Science and Agricultural Science. It is second to none in the whole state. Our science teachers in the other school who had taught here before made reference to it while I was still there. Ditto for our large and well stocked library. And the authority and various teachers encourage the students to maximally utilise the library facilities.

Another thing I find interesting and of tremendous relevance is the large crop of qualified graduate teachers who take us in all the

subjects. All subjects are well handled by these tutors. This must be the secret of the great number of candidates coming out in flying colours every year.

My new school does not de-emphasize sporting activities. There are enough sporting facilities for a variety of games - volley ball, basketball e.t.c and there is a mini stadium for football matches and athletics. Apart from the school athletes, all students go out daily for about ninety minutes to take part in one sporting event or the other to keep every student physically fit and mentally alert for vigour of scholarship.

Uncle, you will again agree with me that these areas I have just pointed out are useful for one's academic moral and physical growth and ultimate success in life. And there other minor areas.

Yours nephew,
Jacob.

6. THE FIRE OUTBREAK AT TEJUAJE MARKET

What a destructive and calamitous conflagration at Tejuaje Main Market of Lagos! This is the second time in five years of this kind of most unexpected fire outbreak occurring in a market which is the commercial nerve centre of this state. Goods and valuables worth ₦50 million might have been destroyed. This is my estimation. It all started when I entered the market last Saturday when I went for my monthly shopping.

I had hardly finished my hopping when I was surrounded by everybody, sellers and buyers, scampering for safety. The immediate cause of the explosion and fire outbreak was not known. But a reliable source, a trader, who was very close and also volunteered to speak, told everybody from a safe distance what actually happened. One of the care-free window shoppers or even layabout had thrown a stub of cigarette into a collection of refuse near where some traders parked their cars and lorries. Inside one of the buses were few jerry-cans of petrol bought and stored to avoid the incessant scarcity of petrol and its attendant effects.

Unknown to the smoker and all the people moving about that section of the market where electronic appliances and clothes were sold, some petrol had soiled the area from the leaking container. The glowing cigarette ignited and exploded into a big furnace. The clothing materials and the burnt electric wires only worsened the whole tragic outburst of fire.

The hectic traffic situation around the market zone and the many junctions contributed to the delay in the arrival to the fire brigade men. More than half of the market was destroyed in the inferno. Traders, buyers were affected in a variety of ways. Prices of goods in other small markets sky-rocked. Many lives were lost while others were maimed for life. To avert future occurrence of fire outbreak in this very important market in the state, enlightenment campaigns on safety measures to be taken by the traders and buyers should be stepped up.

The state government should consider as a matter of urgency the situation of fire brigade men and vehicles very near the market. The government can at least enforce the 'no smoking in public places edict' in and around the market. All avoidable fire outbreaks that cost the state and citizens a large amount of money and goods must not be allowed to occur. Petrol and other highly inflammable substances should be kept from the market arena.

It is high time emergency evacuators of persons and property from the scene of such fire outbreaks were put in place. We all must refuse to toil for and lose valuable items to a good servant but a bad master called fire.

David Oghene.
Lagos.

7. (a) The yardstick used by the writer are sex, age, social status, earning power or economic status
(b) The barons of the crime. (i) provide money/means/look for the criminals (ii) give them protection
(c) violent criminals were common among the poor and unemployed
(d) (i) no (ii) the punishment given for crimes that are committed by lower social class is harsh while that of the higher social class is mild
(e) (i) metaphor (ii) they send the killers and armed robbers to destroy and kill
(f) (i) pertinent - relevant (ii) agile - smart (iii) desperate - hopeless (iv) prevalent - common (v) severe - harsh.
8. (a) He means that marriage is a long established custom or system which has stayed for a long time
(b) liberty - freedom. shackless - restriction
(c) (i) A marriage in which a man and woman live together without being formally legally married. (ii) The marriage can easily be terminated by one or both partners

- (d) The marriage institution is being threatened by
 (i) government laws which recognise children born out of wedlock (ii) the harsh economic factors like the rising cost of living
 (e) (i) Relative or adjectival clause (ii) qualifies the noun "ladies"
 (f) (i) globe - world (ii) stigma dishonour (iii) an alternative - another choice (iv) enact - make (v) survey – study
9. (a) About 30 million persons use the USA Information Agency facilities in developing countries. Only the United States and Soviet

Union distribute over 158 million books in developing countries. An African chief could not get a chair in a crowded lecture hall due to lack of enough seats. Today's United States boasts of more students than the census of city dwellers forty years ago.

(b) Levels of education regarded as a few people's privilege is now common achievements. Jobs hitherto which could be done by people of strength and natural intelligence require academic qualification.

WASSCE JUNE 1993 ENGLISH LANGUAGE 2 OBJECTIVE TEST QUESTIONS

SECTION 1

INSTRUCTION: Choose the word opposite in meaning to the underlined words Answer **all** the questions

1. The students were advised to register for all the compulsory subjects before considering any.....ones
 A. unimportant B. optional C. easy D. fundamental E. negligible
2. The shopkeeper will reject your offer if you do not.....his terms
 A. allow B. request C. accept D. condemn E. commend
3. Abbas was completely sapped after running the marathon race so he needed something to.....him
 A. relieve B. enliven C. release D. nourish E. invigorate
4. Most people thought the accused would be convicted but surprisingly he was.....
 A. acquitted B. released C. sentenced D. jailed E. pardoned
5. While Emeka received a.....for doing his work well, Eno was given a reprimand for poor performance
 A. gift B. scholarship C. promotion D. compliment E. punishment
6. His review of the new book was a blend of condemnation and.....
 A. recommendation B. renunciation C. commendation D. criticism E. eulogization

7. The leader denied that he held very rigid opinions and mentioned instances when he had been.....
 A. tolerant B. compromising C. friendly D. democratic E. flexible
8. The economy that was once buoyant is now.....
 A. bleak B. gloomy C. unfavourable D. depressed E. difficult
9. The old car is durable while the new one looks.....
 A. haggard B. fragile C. strong D. unreliable E. delicate

SECTION 2

From the words lettered A to E, choose the word that **best completes** each of the following sentences

10. We returned home late in the night because our car had a.....
 A. break through B. breakdown C. break off D. break-in E. break out
11. Cosmetics are sometimes used to cover the.....of nature
 A. difficulties B. deficits C. defects D. defaults E. demands
12. After their meeting, the two presidents issued a.....calling for peace in the war-torn area
 A. bulletin B. memorandum C. dialogue D. notification E. communiqué

13. He alleged in court that he had been.....by certain utterances which the accused made at a rally
A. slandard B. assaulted C. defiled D. defrauded
E. charged
14. The match was virtually a.....for the home team as the visitors offered little or no resistance
A. walk up B. walk-about C. walk-over
D. walk-away E. walk on
15. The meeting was held under the.....of the social dub
A. jurisdiction B. arbitration C. agreement
D. influence E. auspices
16. Don't be so.....as to push your nose into other people's affairs
A. concerned B. inquisitive C. intolerant
D. disrespectful E. overbearing
17. The wife insisted that she should also be a..... to the family's joint savings account
A. signature B. withdrawer C. payee D. signatory
E. guarantor

SECTION 3

After each of the following sentences, a list of possible interpretations of the sentence is given. Choose the interpretation that you consider appropriate for each sentence.

18. When asked to state her side of the story Bunmi started by beating about the bush. This means that Bunmi
A. went straight to the point
B. was lost in great thought
C. followed a bush path
D. approached the subject without coming to the point
19. The amount he donated was small. He said it was his widows' mite. This means that
A: he was a widow B. he was miserly
C. it was all he could honestly afford
D. he could have given more
20. The friendship between Segun and Shehu has turned sour. This means that Segun and Shehu are
A. no longer friends
B. still friends
C. better friends now
D. getting to understand each other
21. The driver smelt a rat when the policeman asked him to stop. This means that the driver was
A. reckless B. suspicious C. careful D. offensive
22. The students were advised to face their studies and let sleeping dogs lie. This means that the students should
A. obey the authorities
B. organize themselves properly
C. leave matters as they are now
D. be as watchful as sleeping dogs.
23. From the way Ngozi behaves, it is obvious she is a greenhorn. This means that the students should
A. arrogant B. cautious C. inexperienced
D. uncivilized
24. The economic situation is so bad that many wage-earners are hardly able to make both ends meet. This means that
A. people's income exceed their expenditure
B. most people are extravagant with their income
C. people's earnings are not sufficient for their essential needs
D. most people engage in activities that bring them extra pay.
25. Since I found out his hypocritical nature, I have been keeping him at arm's length. This means that I
A. avoid being familiar with him
B. ignore his advice
C. report him to the authorities
D. stop visiting him
26. I knew Okoronkwo's father very well and I must say that his son is a chip off the old bdk. This means that Okoronkwo
A. has chosen the same career as his father
B. is very much like his father
C. is an extremely different sort of person from his father
D. has taken up a different profession from his father's
27. The debating team was warned to make convincing points and not to play to the gallery. This means that the team should not
A. be selfish
B. underrate the opponents
C. be over-confident
D. attempt to win cheap popularity
28. Anyone who thinks that he can succeed in life without working hard is living in a fool's paradise. This means that such a person
A. is having an illusion

- B. thinks other people are fools
- C. thinks that working is merely a joke
- D is on the verge of insanity

SECTION 4

*From the words or group of words lettered A to E below each of the following sentences, choose the word or group of words that is **nearest in meaning** to the underlined word or group of words*

29. As a result of the terrible sufferings he had undergone, he became very despondent about the future
A. mischievous B. agitated C. desperate
D. aggressive E. hopeless
30. The boss has an aversion for smoking
A. an inclination B. a distaste C. a lust
D. a desire E. a habit
31. The champion was admitted for his doggedness
A. success B. humility C. vigour D. tenacity
E. mildness
32. One of the complaints against the former chairman was that he was inaccessible
A. unapproachable B. unfriendly C. strict
D. stubborn E. autocratic
33. The bride wore a very resplendent dress to the wedding
A. expensive B. conspicuous C. burdensome
D. superfluous E. dazzling
34. The execution of the projects has been hampered by lack of funds
A. revoked B. accelerated C. accentuated
D. forbidden E. hindered
35. We could not understand why Fatima declined the invitation to our wedding
A. refused B. stopped C. declaimed
D. objected to E. delayed
36. The government has earmarked a large sum of money for the construction of feeder roads
A. expended B. set aside C. accumulated
D. retained E. invested
37. Soon after the accident, the driver came out of the wreckage of the car unscathed.
A. unconscious B. seriously injured
C. slightly injured D. bleeding E. unhurt
38. The evidence of the witness corroborated that of the accused

- A. contradicted B. prosecuted C. confirmed
- D. sentenced E. suspended

39. The court restrained the company from laying off the striking workers
A. compelled B. ordered C. prevented D. cajoled
E. persuaded.
40. This year's budget was designed to consolidate the gains of the economic recovery programme.
A. support B. protect C. reclaim D. strengthen
E. diversify

SECTION 6

*From the words or group of words lettered A to D, choose the word or group of words that **best completes** each of the following sentences*

41. Okoro.....to the occasion when he was asked to propose the toast to the bride
A. stood B. rose C. lifted D. climbed
42. The architect did not..... where the lights were to be put in each room
A. construct B. specify C. arrange D. inform
43. Mary is a friendly sort of person, I took..... her the first time I met her
A. on B. for C. after D. to
44. Yisa and I asked Ahmadu to allow both of us to put.....in his house for one night
A. up B. on C. over D. down
45. The boy was seen hitting the girl, but the teacher merely cautioned him and let him.....
A. down B. on C. through D. off
46. They often quarrelled during the day but they.....before night
A. set it over B. made it up C. passed it over
D. put it off
47. The new President and members of his cabinet.....on a familiarization tour of the corporations
A. are B. are being C. have being D. was
48. The President, with members of his cabinet.....visiting our establishment this afternoon
A. are B. was C. were D. is
49. It is high time we.....complaining about our unfortunate situation
A. stop B. shall stop C. should stop D. stopped

50. You had better..... it otherwise you will have yourself to blame
A. do B. to do C. to be doing D. done
51. Whenever the baby cried, the mother.....
A. sighs B. will sigh C. shall sigh D. sighed
52. Bode and Tunji are very selfish, they care only about.....
A. each other B. one another C. themselves D. them
53. Neither John..... Mary was found suitable for the job
A. with B. or C. and D. nor
54. With.....more patience, you will overcome your trouble
A. much B. a little C. little D. less
55. At that time when the economy was good, a young school leaver.....easily get a job
A. could B. can C. should D. them
56. I had occasion..... Abuja last month
A. for visiting B. of visiting C. to visit D. in visiting
57. There are eight chairs in your room.....?
A. aren't they B. aren't there C. are they D. isn't it
58. We need not take the matter so seriously.....?
A. needn't we B. need to do C. do we need D. need we
59. Have you any objection.....him to lunch?
A. to invite B. with inviting C. for inviting D. to inviting
60. The teacher sent for you and the class prefect but.....of you was in the class
A. both B. each C. neither D. two
61. The students bought the nre Atlas.....the advice of their Geography teacher
A. on B. by C. with D. at
62. I've forgotten.....told me that story
A. whome B. who C. by whom D. which
63. The bo is.....big for him to carry
A. too B. so C. very D. much
64. When I was coming back from Lagos, I saw.....
A. one-legged youn mad man
B. young one-legged mad man
C. one-legged mad man young

D. mad man one legged young

65. The students have not came back from the school farms.....?
A. isn't it B. hadn't they C. didn't they D. have they
66. Kunle told me that.....had gone to see the bank manager for the cheque
A. himself B. him himself C. he himself D. him
67. His idea appears..... odd for people to accept
A. little B. little too C. too little D. a little too
68. In this form you are asked to.....what does not apply
A. cross with B. cross out C. cross in D. cross over
69. Many affidavits have been..... as evidence in this case
A. sworn in B. sworn with C. sworn for D. sworn to
70. Bennin.....is reputed to be an historical city, is the capital of Edo State
A. what B. where C. that D. which

SECTION 6

*In the following passages the numbered gaps indicate missing words. Against each number in the list below each passage, **five** choices are offered in columns lettered A to E. For each question choose the word that is the **most suitable** to fill the numbered gap in the passage.*

PASSAGE A

Locusts have from time to time been the cause of terrible —71— of farms. —72— of locusts can, in a few hours, strip vast areas of green and fertile country of all signs of —73—. They are —74— or periodic —75— After a heavy —76— of an area, they may not reappear for ten or fourteen years. Now that more is known of the life of locusts, there periodic —77— are better understood and, consequently more —78—•

Scientists now know the regions in which the gregarious phase of lucusts may occur, and can even sometimes —79— when an —80— will take place. By modern methods of dusting and —81— the young locusts, such as the —82— can be destroyed on a large —84— before they do much —84—. The D.DT —85— has proved particularly effective

PASSAGE B

government is able to raise —94— with which it carries out its —95— which include administration and the —96— of social services.

Besides, it is able to control the country's — 97— by imposing taxes sometimes to prevent — 98— or by altering patterns of — 99— through the raising of —100— against certain foreign.

	A	B	C	D	E
36.	production	revenue	development	reserve	capital
37.	planning	budgeting	taxation	exportation	investment
38.	income	profits	services	salary	wealth
39.	amortization	surplus	sales	reflexes	services
40.	produced	supplied	distributed	bought	permeated
41.	communications	benefits	to/tails	gratifies	royalties
42.	charges	debts	bullets	formless	telic
43.	investments	banking	interests	saving	lawgiving
44.	loans	capital	money	goal	telic
45.	jobs	necessities	investments	fracture	scholastic
46.	effortment	provision	working	commitment	execution
47.	accounts	budgets	plans	product	economy
48.	definition	merchery	inflation	depression	dumping
49.	cost amplification	production	development	growth	exchange
50.		subsidy	price and order		

WASSCE JUNE 1993 ENGLISH LANGUAGE 2 OBJECTIVE TEST ANSWERS

[illegible]

SENIOR SCHOOL CERTIFICATE EXAMINATION (SSCE 1988 – 2015)

Past Questions with Solutions

English Language

(Theory / Objectives with Oral English) 1993

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WASSCE JUNE 1993 ENGLISH LANGUAGE 1 THEORY QUESTIONS

1. The topic of an essay competition organised by the Young Writers Club for final year students is: Our traditional marriage system is more suitable for the present generation of Nigerians than the English system. Write your entry for or against the topic.
2. You were one of those arrested by the police at the scene of a crime. Write a letter to the Commissioner of Police giving details of the crime, pleading your innocence and requesting to be released.
3. You witnessed the campaigns that preceded a local government election in your area in which the favourite candidate was defeated. Give a vivid account of the events before, during and after the election to your friends, explaining why you think the candidate lost.
4. You have changed school and after a few months, you discover that your present school is not as good as the former. Write a letter to a friend of yours in your former school giving at least three areas in which the new school does not measure up to the old one.
5. Write an article for publication in the science magazine on the topic: Science and Technology in National Development.
6. Write a story in which you were personally involved, ending with, 'if I knew he was that kind of person, I wouldn't have gone out with him.'

PART B SECTION I COMPREHENSION

7. *Read the following passage carefully and then answer the questions on it.*

When Chief Obinwa read the note and absorbed its terse content, he nearly collapsed. For minutes, he stared at it in utter disbelief. But much as he wished otherwise, the message was clear - the robbers had indicated that they would visit him very soon, and that 'no force in the world' would stop them from carting away all he had. The note ended by warning him in his 'own

interest' not to be funny by informing the police or other law-enforcement agents.

As a wealthy businessman, Chief Obinwa had seen enough of life to know that the gang meant business. He could recall at least half a dozen men who had got such sinister notes in the past, and who had been robbed as planned. One of them had contacted the police which then guarded his house for weeks. But the robbers struck all the same - they attacked him in his expensive car on his way to another town, thrashed him thoroughly, and relieved him of the car.

So, contacting the police was out of it, he decided. But what could he do? He confided in his closest friend, who had been his business associate for thirty years. The latter advised him to vacate his house for a while as it was necessary and seek refuge in a hotel. After giving this much thought, Chief Obinwa checked into Exclusive Hotel. But he stayed only for a night. He reasoned that leaving his retinue of wives, servants and relatives behind was not the best solution. So, emptying the water in an over-head tank, Chief Obinwa turned the tank into his refuge every night. His powerful double-barrelled rifle in hand, he hid in the tank late in the night, waiting.

Then, one night, the robbers came in a lorry. They were about a dozen. As they were forcing their way in, Obinwa aimed at their leader, and brought him down with a loud report. Another shot, and a second man fell. Surprised, the others fled, with Chief Obinwa's shots seeing them off. By day break, the news spread fast - the body of Chief Obinwa's friend and business associate was found in a pool of blood at the entrance to the chief's house. He was the leader of the gang!

(a)(i) What message did Chief Obinwa receive?

(ii) Why did he decide not to call in the police?

(b) Why did Chief Obinwa's friend give the kind of advice he gave?

(c) Why did Chief Obinwa drop the idea of continuing to hide in a hotel?

(d) Why was the chief able to repel the thieves single-handedly?

(e).....leaving his retinue of wives, children, servants and relatives behind.....

(i) What is the grammatical name given to this expression?

(ii) What is its function?

(f) For each of the following words, find another word or phrases that could replace it as used in the passage (i) absorbed; (ii) sinister (iii) associate (iv) refuge (v) report.

8. *Read the following passage carefully and then answer the questions on it.*

When you come to think seriously about it, you cannot but conclude that the only permanent factor in international relations is national interest. This, at least among the advanced nations of the world, is very clear. A few instances would suffice.

Take the issue of political ideology. The world used to be, and is still to some degree, divided into distinguishable ideological camps. A nation is ruled either by a democratic or a dictatorial regime. From the way these two ideological camps launch verbal attacks on each other, one would assume they would never have anything to do in common. But there are numerous instances when a democratic regime had been drawn into the open embrace of a totalitarian regime. So it was during the two world wars when democratic and totalitarian regimes found themselves on the same side.

Consider also the factor of economic policies. We know today that capitalism and socialism, as economic policies, are poles apart. The two systems, at least in theory, cannot tolerate each other. But in actual fact, there has been cooperation between capitalist and socialist states when they learn they can be interdependent economically. Trading, after all, does not know one ideology from another, and money is used for the same purpose whether in China or in America.

From the foregoing, it would be correct to claim that there is no country in the world which is democratic in all respects, nor is there any which is exclusively dictatorial. Even more correct than this is the claim that there is no wholly capitalist state, nor is there a completely socialist nation. Therefore, definitions must be made cautiously, and recognition must be given to the fact that each capitalist state embraces a certain degree of socialism, and every socialist nation accommodates some degree of capitalism. So, why need we be rigid in our political and economic inclinations?

(a) What does the writer consider the most important factor in international relations?

(b) Identify the two political and the two economic systems mentioned in the passage

(c) According to the passage, under what condition has there been cooperation between capitalist and socialist states?

(d) Why should we be flexible in our political and economic inclinations?

(e)they would never have anything to do in common (i) What is the grammatical name given to the above expression as used in the passage? (iii) What is its function?

(f) For each of the following words, find another word or phrase that means the same and can replace it as used in the passage: (i) advanced (ii)distinguishable (iii) numerous (iv) ideology (v)cautiously.

SECTION II SUMMARY

9. The food and oil crises demonstrate the extent of our interdependence. Many developing nations need the food surplus of the few developed nations. And many industrialized nations need the oil production of a few developing nations.

Energy is required to produce food, and food to produce energy - and both to provide a decent life for everyone. The problems of food, and energy can be resolved on the basis of cooperation - or can, I should say, be made unmanageable on the basis of confrontation. Runaway inflation, propelled by food and oil price increases, is an early warning signal. Let us not delude ourselves. Failure to cooperate on oil, food and inflation could spell disaster for every nation.

The United Nations must not, and need not, allow this to occur. A global strategy for food and energy is urgently required. It is my belief that four principles should guide a global approach.

Firstly, all nations must substantially increase production. Just to maintain the present standards of living, the world must almost double its output of food and energy to match the expected increase in the world population by the end of the century. To meet aspirations for a better life production will have to expand at a significantly faster rate than population growth. Second, all nations must seek to achieve a level of prices which not only provides an incentive to producers but which consumers can also afford. It should now be clear that the developed nations are not the only countries which demand and receive adequate returns for their goods. But it should also be clear that by confronting consumers with production restrictions, artificial pricing and the prospect of ultimate bankruptcy, producers will eventually become victims of their own actions.

Third, all nations must avoid the abuse of man's fundamental needs for the sake of narrow material or bloc advantage. The attempt by any country to use one commodity for political purposes will inevitably tempt other countries to use their commodities for their own purposes.

Fourth, the nations of the world must ensure that the poorest among us are not overwhelmed by rising prices of the imports necessary for their survival. The traditional aid donors and the increasingly wealthy oil producers must join hands in this effort.

(a) Summarize in one sentence, how the developed and developing nations are interdependent in their needs

(b) In one sentence, show what the inevitable result of confrontation among nations will be

(c) In four sentences, one for each, summarize the writer's suggestions for effecting smooth global interdependence.

WASSCE JUNE 1993 ENGLISH LANGUAGE I THEORY ANSWERS

1. OUR TRADITIONAL MARRIAGE SYSTEM IS MORE SUITABLE THAN THE ENGLISH SYSTEM

Marriage as we all know is the legal union of a man and woman for the purpose of life companionship and procreation. It is not surprising that Nigerian and the English people adopt different marriage systems, the differences in cultures is one of the main causes. But because of English colonization of Nigeria for about a century, the English legal and church marriage methods are commonly used side by side with our different indigenous marriage system(s). The traditional marriage system was and is still far more suitable for today Nigerians than the English system due to some advantages.

The traditional marriage gives ample room for the parents of the would-be couple to be morally and financially involved. The parents and relations from both sides ensure that their children are marrying the right person and they give frank assessments. This is not so with the English system. The English does not stress the involvement of the parents so far as the bride and bridegroom have both agreed to marry each other. This extreme individualistic attitude to marriage is one of the high rate of crumbled matrimonies.

Secondly and equally important, traditional marriage ceremony is relatively cheaper than the English societal wedding which observes many rites, protocols and have to cater for the large audience at the church and at the reception venue. Besides the above points, there is too much publicity, pomp and pageantry that go with English wedding. This makes it possible for too many people to be unusually close to the new couple who will sooner or later contribute in one

way or the other towards the falling apart of the couple. There are cases of would-be husband and wife who will begin to attend a particular church three months before their church wedding. The hypocrisy of their religion will be visible when the marriage will begin to disintegrate even before the honeymoon period expires.

The English marriage system is parochial in nature. Polygamy is out of their system. Any white man that practices it commits bigamy and is liable to a jail term. It is in contrast to Nigerian marriage system where a man can marry as many wives as he desires. The worrisome trend of many unmarried ladies in English societies is absent from many Nigerian communities.

Socio-economically, the cost of living is very high in Nigeria today. Under this situation many men can't afford the exorbitant cost of white marriage, while the traditional marriage option is cheaper, simpler, practical to go through by a would-be couple, who earn as little as ₦1,000 monthly.

2.

44, Ahmadu Lane
Apapa
17th June, 1993

The Commissioner of Police,
Lagos State Police Command,
Ikeja.

Sir,

APPLICATION FOR MY RELEASE

I hereby write you personally to request for your intervention to facilitate my release after a week in detention for a crime I did not know when and how it was committed. Your men came to my residence early morning of last Sunday and arrested me with the customs officer who lives in one of the flats in my house. By the time I was rudely woken up by some men and the customs officer in agitated controversy amidst threat of lives being lost, there was little I could do. Apart from the officer who lives in my house there were two other customs officers with two other men in trendy French suits. This was around 3 a.m I could not give an accurate account of the issues at stake but from the little that filtered into my hearing, I can say that the two men who were in French suits are businessmen who had given over ₦200,000 to my tenant for him to facilitate the clearing of their container at the port. The men had come that night to retrieve their money because the customs officer kept the money for himself at the expense of other customs officers,

who in annoyance confiscated the container. This confiscation was a huge loss to the businessmen.

This dispute led to physical combat among the four men and before the police which I phoned could arrive the scene I heard some gunshots. When the policemen arrived eventually, we discovered that one customs officer, one businessman were mortally injured and my tenant, the second businessman and one of the customs officers who accompanied the businessmen were seriously wounded, in the pool of blood but were still alive.

The policemen requested me to accompany them and these men to the station. After I had given a statement, they detained me. I don't know what exactly is happening to the other people who were the real people the police are supposed to have a case with.

They have refused to grant me bail. All my relations that came to effect my bail have been turned down.

Your timely intervention is necessary so that I don't suffer unnecessarily for my attempt to avoid bloodshed when [telephoned the police station. Criminals are not known to phone the police for their arrest!

Yours faithfully,

Mr. Okon Edet.

3. POLITICS IS A DIRTY GAME

I have often heard people say that politics is a dirty game. The import of this declaration dawned on me recently during the last campaigns and moreso after the announcement of the result. How are the mighty fallen! It was unbelievable that the favourite candidate, Alhaji Dr. S. Jumbo lost to a caricature of a politician called Alhaji M. Saka.

In spite of the rumours which went round the Sabe Local Government Area, it was obvious that Dr. S. Jumbo was the favourite choice of the people for the chairmanship post. He is educated, sociable, articulate, generous and had been an excouncillor who had a good record of performance in his previous three-year term, Alhaji M. Saka on the other hand was a colourless politician who had the singular achievement of being the secretary of the aboriginal Ikoto Itira Community Development Association (CDA) within Sabo Local Government. In addition to this qualification, he was and is still a religious zealot of the Islamic religion.

During the campaigns, posters and radio jingles were visibly used to put their messages

across to the electorate in the mosque and inside the house of members of the CDA.

At the general mosque supporters of Alhaji Saka openly reminded the worshippers why they should never vote for Dr. Jumbo as chairman. The chief reason was that he was a Christian, an infidel who should never be allowed to rule a predominantly Muslim community. Another rumour which the party and supporters of Dr. Jumbo ignored at his own detriment was the wicked rumour that he hails from Kogi in spite of the fact he was born and brought up in Sabo Local Government. So, the opponents and detractors of Dr. Jumbo reasoned that a non-indigene should not occupy such an exalted position of the chairman.

When the voting and the counting of votes were done, the popular Dr. Jumbo scored only 509 votes, Alhaji Saka scored 5,600 votes. The green party of Saka masterminded a grand rigging against Dr. Jumbo. This they did almost successfully by bribing the electoral officers who agreed to substitute the genuine ballot boxes with the one brought by Saka's men at the end of voting. They even drugged the drinks which they gave to the agents of Dr. Jumbo. At the time of swapping the box they were snoring like Jonah.

Though Alhaji Saka has been sworn into office, Dr. Jumbo has gone to court to contest the result because the votes allegedly cast on the Election Day were and are more than the 5000 registered voters.

4. HOW TO ANSWER THIS QUESTION

This is a simple straight-forward informal letter to a friend. There are many areas of your new school which you can compare and indicate deficiencies - laboratory, library, quality and quantity of teachers, sporting facilities, boarding facilities, discipline. The choice of any three areas will simply be a matter of your emphasis and detailed description or information so that your friend will understand you. You simply end your letter using any of the informal complimentary closes: Your friend, Yours sincerely, Yours truly, Your best friend etc.

5. SCIENCE AND TECHNOLOGY IN NATIONAL DEVELOPMENT

Science and technology is one of the areas where our modern world differs from the ancient peoples. Science and technology which dovetail into each other are essential tools for rapid development in our present society. This explains why countries which have high calibre science develop materially than those that lack or have an insignificant or ineffective personnel. But what is

science? It is the systematic study of nature and its law under Physics, Chemistry and Biology and other semi- science subjects. And technology is the practical application of scientific knowledge or inventions to the solving of everyday problems or facilitating hitherto tedious human activities.

Products of science and technology are everywhere being used in our modern world: electricity, automobiles, aircraft, computers, telephone, radio, television, plants, and machinery for production and modern scientific medical processes for the diagnosis and treatment of diseases, infections or illnesses. America, Britain, France, Germany, Russia, Belgium, Korea, China, Japan are developed or in fact industrialized, because they have benefitted from the fruits of science and technology.

Africa and Nigeria in particular are largely undeveloped because science and technology are not being accorded their rightful place and priority in the scheme of things. Science courses are underfunded and even graduates in these fields are either not utilised or under-utilised and unappreciated. If Nigeria wants to be developed in all facets of modern life, we must give science ample attention. It is the key to development.

Ajibade Thompson,
Ile - Ife.

6. HOW TO ANSWER THIS QUESTION

This narrative essay is not substantially different from other similar questions in past years' questions. The candidate simply tells a story involving either a man or woman who ruined one's career, life marriage, etc. There are many regrettable circumstances which a candidate can associate his/her relationship or partnership with

somebody. The candidate may or may not put his name at the end of the story.

7. (a)(i) That the armed robbers will visit him
(ii) The police will not prevent them from robbing him
(b) So that he will not be recognized as the gang leader
(c) He remembered his duty as the head of the family to protect his wives and children
(d) His gun and his courageous vigilance in a good hideout helped him to undo the armed robbers single-handedly
(e) (i) Noun phrase (ii) Object of the sentence
(f) (i) Absorbed-comprehended (ii) Sinister - evil
(iii) Associate- partner (iv) Refuge-protection
(v) Report-Noise
8. (a) National interest
(b) Democracy, totalitarianism, capitalism and socialism
(c) During the two world-wars, democracy and totalitarian governments co-operated
(d) Because capitalism requires some socialist approaches and socialism embraces some degrees of capitalism
(e) (i) It is a noun clause (ii) object of sentence
(f) (i) developed (ii) identifiable (iii) many
(iv) inclination (v) carefully.
9. (a) Countries must enhance the production of whatever they are good at. All countries should aim at producing and selling their products at moderate prices. Cut-throat profiteering and political ideological influencing of economic activities should be eschewed. Concessional or discount prices of imports or even donation from rich to poor nations should be encouraged.

WASSCE JUNE 1994 ENGLISH LANGUAGE 2 OBJECTIVE TEST QUESTIONS

SECTION 1

Instruction: Choose the word **opposite** in meaning to the underlined word

1. Polygamy is very common in Africa, were as the only acceptable form of marriage in Europe is.....
A. bigamy B. celibacy C. polyandry D. ordination
E. monogamy

2. The principal wants us to.....the moltion, so don't oppose it
A. sustain B. support C. defame D. applaud
E. deride
3. He denied that he ever.....committing the offence in his earlier statement
A. admitted B. argued C. emphasized
D. negated E. colluded

4. The brevery of the Guest-of-honour's address contrasts with the.....of the Chairman's opening remarks
A. intensity B. propensity C. solidity D. affinity
E. verbosity
5. The long trek exhausted him so he needed to rest to.....himself
A. repose B. remake C. recuperate D. replace
E. rejuvenate
6. The motorists said the splashing of the waters was.....not deliberate
A. incidental B. intentional C. accidental
D. avoidable E. unnecessary
7. One of the aims of the structural adjustment policy is to make us.....rather than consumers
A. parasites B. developers C. designers
D. prodcers E. founders
8. The computerized services of the new bank contrast with the.....operations of the old ones
A. mechanical B. electrical C. aerial
D. condensed E. manual
9. Tunde says he always looks sober because there is nothing to be.....about
A. serious B. excited C. happy D. witty E. worried
10. I felt as if I was in an oven throughtout my stay in the sahara, while our room here in Jos is like a...
A. freezer B. chimney C. ventilator D. furnance
E. delta

SECTION 2

*From the words lettered A to E. Choose the word or group of words, that **best completes** each of the following sentences*

11. The prices of cars have become.....
A. painful B. unbearable C. stringent D. harsh
E. exorbitant
12. I had.....trust in the boy before he woefully disappointed me
A. essential B. flagrant C. absolute D. effective
E. fruitful
13. We need to.....our resources in these hard times
A. squander B. economize C. minimize
D. retrench E. withhold
14. Ngozi's soothing remarks were made to.....
Femi's anger
A. rekindle B. incense C. accommodate D. mollify
E. petrify

15. The poor boy was.....when he stepped on live wire
A. blazed B. electrified C. radiated D. burnt
E. electrocuted.
16. The politician ran to another country to seek.....
A. refuge B. safeguard C. retreat D. safety
E. privacy
17. The governor ordered that the work done by any contractor should be properly.....so as to know the correct amount to pay
A. processed B. investigated C. accounted
D. probed
18. The University awarded.....doctorate degrees to four distinguished members of the community
A. honourable B. expensive C. ceremonious
D. ceremonial E. honorary
19. The students threatened to embark on a.....of lectures if their demands were not met
A. condonation B. suspension C. rejection
D. strike E. boycott

SECTION 3

20. *After each of the following sentences, a list of possible interpretations of the sentences is given. Choose the interpretation that you consider most appropriate for each sentence.*
21. When the striking workers were threatened with dismissal, they decided to make a virtue of necessity. This means that they
A. all resigned
B. continued the strike action
C. had to call off the strike
D. accused some of their colleagues of treachery
22. The students stuck to their guns even after the principal had appealed to them to go back to their classes. This means that the students
A. went back willingly
B. refused to go back
C. went back reluctantly
D. attacked the school authorities
23. The sudden death of his friend made Etim have his heart in his boots. This means that Etim
A. becamegreatly discouraged
B. was a good footballer
C. was very excited
D. took the matter very seriously
24. The last promotion exercise was the bone of contention between the two friends. This means that the last promotion exercise

- A. was the cause of their dispute
B. forced them to reason together
C. made them to become enemies
D. united them in their fight against their common enemy
25. When Ibrahim was asked to state his case, he started to beat about the bush. This means that Ibrahim
A. started clearing the bush
B. failed to go straight to the point
C. went to the bush
D. stated his case very clearly
26. The workers suspect that the boss has a skeleton in his cupboard. This means the boss
A. is a very wicked man
B. has a skeleton hidden in his room
C. is not liked by the workers
D. has an ugly secret
27. The chairman's explanation threw a new light on the matter. This means that the chairman's explanation
A. provided fresh information on the matter
B. showed a bias against the matter
C. used his veto to rule against the matter
D. convinced everybody to accept the matter
28. Halima decided to make a clean breast of everything. This means that Halima
A. said that her breast was clean
B. remained firm in her earlier assertion
C. denied any knowledge of the matter
D. told the whole truth
29. By embarking on that journey, he intends to kill two birds with one stone. This means that he
A. promises to bring his children two birds
B. engages in double dealing
C. intends to achieve two aims at once
D. attends to two people at the same time
30. Ajala earns a fat salary but cannot make both ends meet. This means that Ajala
A. keeps two lucrative jobs
B. does not live within his income
C. lives very comfortably
D. quarrels very often with his wife

SECTION 4

*From the words lettered A to E below each of the followed sentences, choose the word or group of words that is **nearest in meaning** to the underlined word or phrase as it is used in the sentence.*

31. Though corruption is very prevalent in the society, there are still some virtuous men around
A. intelligent B. clever C. devious D. loquacious
E. upright
32. Chinua Achebe is a renowned novelist
A. wonderful B. famous C. trustworthy
D. fascinating E. witty
33. He was kept in solitary confinement
A. quite B. inimical C. harsh D. lonely E. idel
34. Nelson Mandela surmounted all the oppressive measures to break his will
A. overcame B. fought C. renounced D. accepted
E. embraced
35. The guest speaker was described as a man of very alluring personality
A. tempestuous B. mercurial C. charming
D. voluble E. intricate
36. The comments of the host further incensed the angry man
A. calmed B. incised C. pacified D. challenged
E. infuriated
37. Corruption is inimical to the progress of any nation
A. harmful B. predominant C. unavoidable
D. inevitable E. necessary
38. The task before us is enormus
A. great B. awkward C. heavy D. ominous
E. serious
39. The professor showed much erudition in the lecture he delivered
A. quotation B. learning C. ostentation
D. acclamation E. tautology
40. The outcome of the matter has vindicated my earlier stand
A. invalidated B. nullified C. disproved D. negated
E. justified

SECTION 5

*From the words lettered A to D, choose the word or group of words that **best completes** each of the following sentences*

41. You will need to commit the formual.....
memory
A. to B. by C. on D. in
42. His journey.....life has been rough
A. around B. over C. across D. through

43. The old woman has been ill.....many months now
A. before B. for C. since D. through
44. We came.....rail
A. on B. with C. by D. in
45.he is learned, he is fraudulent
A. Since B. Even C. Although D. When
46. There is a serious conflict.....the two of them
A. between B. amidst C. across D. among
47.I am your junior does not mean you should order me about like a houseboy
A. Even B. That C. If D. Though.
48. Fatimat kept quiet all the.....
A. period B. where C. whole D. while
49.rich has its own problems
A. On been B. Being C. On being D. Been
50.stolen the goods, the thief ran away
A. Having B. On C. After D. Since
51. The boy.....his father in everything
A. makes after B. makes for C. takes after D. takes for
52. We have to.....for lost time
A. make up B. make with C. take up D. take with
53. Time is really.....so let's hurry up
A. moving through B. running out
C. moving out D. running through
54. We haven't confirmed.....signature this is
A. what B. whose C. who's D. which
55. The issue on.....I disagreed with him is very simple
A. what B. whom C. which D. whose
56.that can happen is that he'll be suspended
A. The worst B. Worst C. The worse D. worse
57. Jide was absent for.....time
A. much B. most C. the most D. most of the
58. How did you arrive at.....wonderful idea?
A. that a B. such a C. a such D. that such
59. The.....of all the states in the Federation are having a meeting at Abuja
A. attorney-general B. attorneys-generals

C. attorneys-general D. attorney-general

60. The local governments are authorized to pass.....
A. by-laws B. byes-laws C. bye's laws D. bys-law
61. Hammed's ideas are.....wrong
A. almost always B. almost often
C. always almost D. often almost
62. John was Mary yesterday.....?
A doesn't she B. wasn't she C. was she D. didn't he
63. I said John saw Mary.....?
A didn't I B. didn't he C. hadn't he D. wasn't he
64. The story he told me can't be true.....?
A. can he B. can it C. could he D. could it
65. Yours is to command.....is to obey
A. theirs' B. their's C. their D. theirs
66. That book belongs to the.....lady
A. tall American black
B. American tall black
C. tall black American
D. black tall.American
67. The boys are.....for the match
A. all fully set B. fully all set C. set all fully
D. fully set all
68. Ngozi is by far.....of the girls
A. a most brilliant B. the most brilliant
C. the more brilliant D. more brilliant
69.you wish to do, do it properly
A. Whenever B. However C. Whoever
D. Whatever
70. We have started operating the.....
A. national new education policy
B. new education policy national
C. new national education policy
D. new national policy education
71. The lady.....here tomorrow
A. arrive B. arriving C. arrives D. arrived
72. It's high time you.....seeing her
A. stop B. stops C. will stop D. stopped
73. Elaho enjoys.....soccer
A. to play B. play C. playing D. to be playing

74. Miss Onassis was a.....
 A. young rich lady B. rich young lady
 C. lady young rich D. young lady rich
75. Did Aminu come here as he promised?
 A. No, he did B. Yes, he didn't C. No, he didn't
 D. Yes, he doesn't

SECTION 6

In the following passages, the numbered gaps indicate missing words. Against each number in the first below each passage, five choices are offered A to E. For each question, choose the word that is the most suitable to fill the numbered gap in the passage

PASSAGE A

A nation that wants to —76— her citizens cannot rely on traditional methods of —77— but a large scale —78—. Rather than depend on simple —79—like the hoe and the cutlass, it is high time we thought in terms of—80—. Large areas of—81-- land must be opened up, and aid must be given to young farmers to acquire their own —82—. The effort must start from schools, where students need to be taught both —83— of crops as well as animal —84—. To make arid available to more people, the land —85— practices in most parts of the nation need to be revised. Above all, —86— should be generated through loans with reasonable —87— rates

	A	B	C	D	E
76	groom	fallen	lead	loot	rich
77	barren	peasantry	draining	lowering	gardening
78	horticulture	plague	slugs	husbandry	agriculture
79	instruments	facilities	machines	implements	tools
80	harvesting	mechanisation	tools	automation	computerization
81	fallow	waste	arable	arable	ranch
82	appliance	vehicles	armies	arms	tractors
83	digging	sowing	weeding	ploughing	cultivation
84	husbandry	economy	warfare	land	farming
85	purchase	holdings	array	land	resources
86	labour	capital	debenture	resource	profits
87	credit	loan	resistant	premium	interest

The —88— to have children is deep rooted in the hearts of both men and women, and on entering into —89— union they regard the —90— of children as the first and most —91— duty. A childless marriage in an African —92— is practically a failure, for children bring joy not only to their parents but also to the —93— as a whole. The —94— of a family brings with it a rise in social —95—. The social position of a —96— who has children is of greater importance and dignity than that of a bachelor or —97—. After the —98— the first child, the married —99— becomes the object of higher —100— among their fellows than they were before.

	A	B	C	D	E
88	lust	attraction	desire	passion	desire
89	fraternal	dicretness	matrimonial	polygamous	bigamous
90	marriage	procreation	cooperation	tendering	involving
91	honour	voluntary	eminent	necessity	importance
92	congregation	community	guild	region	society
93	kingdom	establishment	company	region	society
94	rearing	nursing	grooming	governing	raising
95	value	rank	cadre	status	promotion
96	peasants	ducal	capricious	learn	status
97	scholar	girl	virgin	man	maiden
98	launching	commencement	celebration	down	birth
99	swain	pair	twain	company	sympathy
100	adulation	influence	affluence	regard	position

WASSCE JUNE 1994 OBJECTIVE TEST ANSWERS																			
1 F	2 B	3 A	4 E	5 C	6 C	7 B	8 F	9 B	10 A	11 E	12 C	13 B	14 D	15 F	16 A	17 C	18 E	19 C	20 B
21 E	22 B	23 A	24 A	25 B	26 E	27 A	28 A	29 E	30 C	31 A	32 D	33 B	34 D	35 C	36 E	37 A	38 B	39 E	40 C
41 A	42 D	43 B	44 C	45 C	46 A	47 C	48 B	49 A	50 C	51 A	52 D	53 A	54 B	55 D	56 C	57 A	58 B	59 E	60 A
61 A	62 D	63 A	64 B	65 D	66 C	67 A	68 B	69 D	70 C	71 C	72 D	73 C	74 B	75 C	76 C	77 A	78 E	79 D	80 C
81 E	82 B	83 E	84 A	85 D	86 C	87 A	88 E	89 B	90 D	91 C	92 D	93 B	94 E	95 C	96 C	97 A	98 B	99 E	100 B

SENIOR SCHOOL CERTIFICATE EXAMINATION (SSCE 1988 – 2015)

Past Questions with Solutions

English Language

(Theory / Objectives with Oral English) 1994

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WASSCE JUNE 1994 ENGLISH LANGUAGE 1 THEORY QUESTIONS

PART A

1. You are about to leave school after spending six years as a student. Write a letter to the principal, expressing your candid views on the strengths and weaknesses of the school and giving suggestions for improvement.
2. Write an article for publication in a literary magazine on the need to promote the study of the indigenous languages of your country.
3. You are the main speaker in a school debate the topic of which is: Bribery and corruption are worse enemies of our country than armed robbery. Write your speech for or against the topic.
4. You have been involved in an incident in which very many of your friends criticized your role. Narrate the incident to a close friend and defend the role you played.
5. An elder sister of yours who has left school had confided to you in her last letter that she plans to elope with her lover whom your parents do not approve of. Write a letter to her advising against such action and suggesting steps she could take to obtain your parents' consent.
6. Write a story which ends with the words I really agree that a patient dog eats the fattest bone.

PART B

SECTION I

COMPREHENSION

7. *Read the following passage carefully and answer the questions on it.*

Learning to speak one's language comes naturally to a human being; we learn it without formal instruction. But writing is an unnatural activity; it must be taught formally and studied deliberately. Indeed, many of the problems that arise in learning to write are simply problems of finding proper written equivalent for the various features of speech. The spelling of our words is a clumsy, attempt to reproduce the sound of our voices. The punctuation of our sentences and the settings of paragraphs designed to give some approximation of the pauses and intonation we

use automatically to give shape and point to our speaking.

The writer of English (or any other language) loses a whole world of gestures, facial expressions and tone of voice the minute he decides to write something rather than say it aloud. He loses the immediacy of direct contact with his audience. If there were no compensation at all for all these disadvantages, then communicating with other people through the medium of squiggles on paper would be as unsatisfactory as trying to wash your feet with your socks on.

Writing takes more effort than speech, but the effort we make simply to capture our words on paper can also lead us to compose things that are worth the effort. The unusual energy that goes into achievement in any art or sport can and should function finally to help the individual increase his own powers and perfect his abilities. Three hundred and fifty years ago, a clever man pointed out that practice in speaking makes a man 'ready' or quick in his responses, while practice in writing makes a man 'exact', helps him to polish and perfect his thoughts.

(a) Why did the writer say that writing is an unnatural activity?

(b) Give two specific examples of problems encountered in learning to write

(c) Mention any two disadvantages that arise in written communication

(d) What important advantage comes from the acquisition of good writing skills (e) that goes into achievement in any art or sport (i) What grammatical name is used to describe the above expression? (ii) What is its function?

(f) For each of the following words find another word or phrase that means the same and can replace it as used in the passage (i) deliberately (ii) equivalent (iii) designed (iv) compensation (v) responses (vi) polish

8. *Read the following passage carefully and answer the questions on it.*

I am a foot taller than the tallest girl in my village and twice the weight of the fattest. On my only visit to a beautician, the woman said she found my face a challenge. Yet, despite these social disadvantages I feel cheerful, happy, confident and secure.

Several years ago, I visited the city for the first time, and I saw something there that made me realize the stupidity of trying to conform or trying to be like everybody else even with particular physical disadvantages. There was a small plump woman, all dressed up but looking really stuffed and funny in the fashion Wear. She also carried a shooting stick. But because she was so plump when she sat on the stick it went deep into the ground and she couldn't pull it out. She tugged and tugged, tears of rage in her eyes. When the final tug brought it out, she crashed with it to the ground. I saw her walk away. Her day had been ruined. She had made a fool of herself in public. She had impressed nobody. In her own sad eyes, she was a failure.

But hardly anyone took any notice of her and her misery in the busy street. I remember well when I was like that in the days before I learned that nobody really cared what you did. An watching that miserable small woman as she walked away gave me renewed inspiration

- (a) Briefly describe two physical characteristics of the writer as shown in the passage
- (b) Why is the writer not bothered about her social disadvantages?
- (c)(i) How did the woman with the shooting stick feel after the incident? (ii) Why was the feeling unnecessary?
- (d) when she sat on the stick.(i) What grammatical name is used to describe the above expression? (ii) What is its function?
- (e) For each of the following words, find another word or phrase that means the same and can replace it in the passage: (i) disadvantages; (ii) conform; (iii) tugged; (iv) miserable (iv) inspiration.

SECTION II SUMMARY

9. *Read the following passage carefully and answer the questions on it.*

Between 1921 and 1930, the population of Jos town rose from 8,000 to 11,000. These were very important years in the history of Jos town. It was in 1921 that the administrative headquarters of Jos Division was transferred from Naraguta to Jos. In 1926, Plateau Province was created with its headquarters in Jos also. The new province was carved out of the then Mubi, Nasarawa and Bauchi provinces. Jos, therefore assumed dual administrative functions as the divisional and provincial headquarters. A crop of new employees and labourers started moving into the city to serve the two administrations respectively. During the same period, the tin mining industry was experiencing a boom.

The boom was further buttressed by other developments in the area. In 1927, the Eastern

Railway Extension reached its Jos terminus, via Kafanchan. A new era was in sight with promises of plenty for all, because the mining industry was passing through its greatest moment of prosperity. The said administrative change, the boom in the tin industry, the new communication network and similar developments on the Jos Plateau, created a myth of the wealth and prosperity in Jos. However, the boom was short-lived. By 1929 it receded, and then collapsed in 1931. The mine labourers were thrown out of employment and most of them trooped into Jos in search of food and shelter. During this depression, Jos was likened to a ghost city. The population of Jos shrank from 11,000 in 1930 to 9,000 in 1933.

By the mid 1930s, the price of tin rose in the world market and the tin industry was about to pick up once more. A new characteristic feature of the growth of Jos came into sight. This was the influx of Indians and Levantines into Jos. This continued and increased after the Second World War in 1945. These were mainly traders, transporters and middlemen who, like their European counterparts, contributed in no small measure to the exploitation of Nigerians and the economy of the country.

The number of Europeans, up to the eve of independence in 1960, was second only to that of Lagos throughout the English-speaking West Africa. These white elements addressed themselves to the building of luxurious hotels for their exclusive use. The African elite, in their tradition as copy-cats, were not left behind. The European policy of segregation, however, ensured that the Africans and the Europeans never mixed.

The European quarters were far removed from those of Africans. The provision of social amenities followed the same pattern. Thus, there were separate African and European hospitals, schools, clubs and the like. It is interesting to note that the situation has barely changed quantitatively since independence. The Nigerian elite in the civil service and the private sector have merely moved away from their own people into the positions formerly occupied by the Europeans.

- (a) In four sentences, one for each, summarize the factors that were responsible for the growth of Jos as described in the passage
- (b) In two sentences, summarize the common features of the organization of social life in Jos as described in the passage.

**WASSCE JUNE 1994 ENGLISH LANGUAGE 1
THEORY ANSWERS**

1. St. Gregory's College,
P. O. Box 441,
Yaba, Lagos,
5th September, 1994.

The Principal,
St. Gregory's College,
Yaba-Lagos.

Sir,

PERSONAL VIEWS OF OUR GREAT SCHOOL

In exactly a month's time, we, the present SS III students will be bidding good-bye to this great school, having spent almost six years. Right from the time I entered this school, I have been very keen in watching all activities around, and personally taking part in some of them. For instance, having served as a prefect, I see myself as in a position to say a few things about the school. With collective effort of staff and students, our school has achieved much these years. However, there are areas that need to be reviewed, where, to my mind, we have not excelled. As a concerned student, I seek your permission to make an overall assessment of the school, so as to put the authority in proper perspective to improve, at least for the sake of the students we are leaving behind.

Over the years, we have performed very excellently in the area of sports. This is evident in the numerous trophies we have won in soccer, basketball, volleyball and lawn tennis. Even in athletics, we have excelled. This success can be attributed to the provision of enough sports facilities in the school as well as hard work of both the staff and students. I wish to commend the school again for its leading position in general sanitation. I recall the commendation by the Minister of Education, when he visited us last year, for which he ordered the promotion of the sanitary master. We are very happy over the sanitary condition of the school. This goes to buttress our conviction that "Cleanliness Is Next To Godliness" as contained in our motto.

Worthy of applause, as well, is the decision of the school authority to build more hostels in the school to reduce the acute accommodation problem that has been the lot of this school. At least, students can now feel comfortable to read and play around, rather than the choking situation we have always known. While commending the authority on the issues raised above, I also wish to point out that the feeding condition here is poor, hence I appeal to you sir, to redress this.

We have not done well in the area of learning. Though our results over the years in the Senior Secondary Certificate Examination have been on the average, I still hope we can do better. I appeal to you to prevail on government to send us more teachers, to handle, especially, the sciences. My dream is for our school to be the best in this state, if not in the entire federation.

While addressing the issue of learning, I also wish to plead with you to take another look at the library. The books there are very few and do not cover the entire subjects in the curriculum. A school without library is like soup without salt. Infact, if we wish to improve on our studies, then the issue of well furnished library should be a priority. I suggest a fund-raising ceremony, for the library project. This is in view of the fact that government alone cannot satisfy all our needs.

Tied to the issue of a good library is that of a laboratory. To be candid we do not have a laboratory. All we have is just a collection of four dead and preserved reptiles which we call a Biology laboratory; and two bottles of hydrochloric acid which we call Chemistry laboratory. Apart from a fund-raising, I suggest the formation of an old students association, to whom the school authority can table some of our problems.

Sir, before I end this letter, I wish to re-state that my aim is not to castigate the school, but to marshal out the strengths and weaknesses, so that based on these, the school can rise to greater heights, while we are gone.

Thank you for indulging me. Thank you for all you have done for us. We will never forget this school. God bless you and our school.

Your student,
Joy Eze.
SS III, A.

**NEED TO PROMOTE THE STUDY OF THE
INDIGENOUS LANGUAGES OF NIGERIA**

2. Nigeria is a large country of about 88 million people. Perhaps the largest country in Africa and indeed, in the whole black race. Situated in West Africa, it is larger than the whole of the subregion. Nigeria boasts of over 250 different ethnic groups found across the length and breadth of it. But there are three major ones. Hausa in the North, Ibo in the East and the Yoruba in the West, each having its own language. However, the general language of communication in Nigeria is English

Language bequeathed to her by her former colonial master - Great Britain.

Even though English is the language of communication in Nigeria and used in teaching students in schools, the government and indeed leaders of thought have made concerted efforts to promote the study of the Nigerian languages in schools. Few years ago, government saw need for they **alici** tailored the education curriculum towards the study of indigenous Nigerian languages.

To this end, the Ministry of Education at the federal level made it compulsory for every student to study and register at least one Nigerian language at Senior School Examination. Besides, the federal government went ahead and established at Aba, Abia State, the Federal Institute for Nigerian Languages. These are all geared towards the study and promotion of Nigerian languages.

Why then is it very necessary to study the indigenous Nigerian languages? The answers are indeed not far-fetched. There are many of them but few will be mentioned here. If a foreigner is in the midst of Nigerians of different ethnic backgrounds and they want to discuss an issue the foreigner is not supposed to know, how would they go about it? Obviously, it is impossible. Thus, the need to adopt a particular indigenous Nigerian language which all Nigerians must learn as a lingua franca, irrespective of their tribes.

Alternatively, the federal government can modify the school curriculum in such a way that a student must study one language other than his own. This is a unifying force and will go a long way in bringing about the much needed peace, unity and brotherhood amongst Nigerians. The beneficiary can therefore reside in that part of the country where he understands their language, in comfort, since the acquisition of the language is a prelude to mastering their culture. Languages is tied to culture, you cannot learn the culture of a people, without learning their language. Talking about culture, studying the indigenous languages of Nigeria is another way of promoting Nigerian culture, hence as I earlier said, culture and language are inseparable. By studying our indigenous languages, we will get to understand and appreciate the culture of not only our own tribes but that of others, This too, will in turn promote tolerance and peaceful co-existence.

More than anything else, the study of our indigenous languages will enhance the standard of education. Educational psychology has proved that a child of pre-school age understands more, what he is taught in his mother tongue than what he is taught in a second language. This is

because, at birth, the mind of a child is totally empty and whatever values he is taught then, will register automatically in his mind. Thereafter, anything in his mind becomes indelible.

It is common knowledge that a child learns to speak, using his mother tongue. For instance, he learns to speak calling "Mama" or "Iya" (mother in Ibo and Yoruba respectively). It therefore follows that at school age or pre-school age (nursery), he will learn faster and better if he is taught in his mother tongue. If the government rolls out a legislation mandating nursery schools to teach infants using their mother tongues, the effect it will have in our fallen standard of education will not take long to manifest. If the government implements this, it should back it with the training of teachers of indigenous languages who will teach them at all levels of education, hence, the study of indigenous languages by students, cannot be realistic without trained teachers in such languages.

The numerous ideas, as contained in this article, if complemented will certainly help in building a great Nigeria of our dreams.

Seyi Omotosho,
Kings College,
Lagos.

BRIBERY AND CORRUPTION ARE WORSE ENEMIES TO OUR COUNTRY THAN ARMED ROBBERY

3. The Moderator, Panel of Judges, Time-Keeper, Co-debaters and the audience. I stand before you to speak against the above - named topic. Foremost, what is bribery and what is corruption? Both words are in most cases used side by side. They connote literally an attempt to give favour to someone, in place of an anticipated favour from the receiver. However, it is an offence in every enlightened society.

Armed robbery on the other hand, is another crime in every society. It is simply stealing while armed with any weapon that can kill or maim. In Nigeria, both bribery and corruption and armed robbery are serious crimes. Both are enemies to our society, but I am of the view that armed robbery is a worse enemy to our country than bribery and corruption. My reasons are as follows:

Nigeria has lost so many of her citizens through robbery. This is because out of every five robbery incidents, one must involve the loss of lives. The country loses her human resource as well as material resources through armed robbery. Even the government recognises the fact that armed robbery is more of an enemy to us than

bribery and corruption, hence the death penalty on the former, and a term of imprisonment for the latter.

The society looks at an armed robbery with disdain. His friends keep away from him as much as possible because of the stigma armed robbery carries with it. This is not so with bribery and corruption. Even the Holy Bible condemns armed robbery. The book of Exodus Chapter 20 teaches us not to kill or "steal" both of which are attributes of armed robbery. Armed robbery has helped to weaken the economy of Nigeria. The country is notorious before the international community because of armed robbery. Foreign investors are all running away from the country so that their properties or their companies will not be vandalized by robbers. They see it as a waste of resources investing in the Nigerian economy for fear of insecurity.

Armed robbers have made life very uncomfortable for Nigerians, who now live a life of perpetual fear. Who knows when they will strike? This is the question in the lips of every Nigerian. Thus, we are almost refugees in our own land. It is undisputable that the greatest fear is fear of the unknown. One living in fear is as good as dead.

The amount of loss the government has suffered as a result of armed robbery is unquantifiable. It is difficult to put into statistics the frequency of bank robberies in Nigeria. Indeed, armed robbery is a drain pipe, into the nation's purse, than bribery and corruption. Monetarily and otherwise, armed robbery is a worse enemy. Nigeria has lost so much human resources through death via armed human resources were available and changed into production the manpower is enough to revive the economy which is already in the woods.

This is not to say that bribery and corruption are not enemies of our country, indeed, they are thorns in our flesh and clogs in the wheel of social and economic progress of our country. But it is difficult to determine who is not corrupt since corruption is relative and open to numerous interpretations.

Armed robbery on the other hand, carries a terrible stigma. No one wants to be identified with a robber. Apart from the killing that accompanies armed robbery; it puts a check on freedom of movement as people can no longer go about their businesses, say in the night for fear of being waylaid.

The activities of robbers have even forced some state governments to curtail the movement of people by imposing curfews, all in an effort to curtail armed robbery which has claimed lives of so many security men.

The government loses so much revenue through the money it votes towards the eradication of armed robbery. Such money could have been channelled into other ventures.

With the above points, I still maintain that armed robbery is worse enemy to our country than bribery and corruption. Thank you.

P.O Box 641,
Victorial Island,
7th September, 1994.

4. Dear Chris,

I am very fine here, except for what I intend telling you in this letter, for which I am very much worried. How are you and your work? How are the rest of our people over there? I have the hope you all are doing fine.

Chris, like I was saying earlier, I have been under pressure, and under severe criticism by almost all my friends, over an incident in which I feel I played a good role. As I write, I hardly have anyone to talk to as I have been literally ostracised by friends over their perceived wrong role I played. As my good friend whom I confide in I want you to judge and vindicate or condemn me. But to me, I continue to say that what I did was right. I have no apologies or regrets.

It was last week that I was drinking in a beer parlour near my office, when I overheard some people discussing among themselves over what they called an act of betrayal to them by my elder brother. They however did not know I was related to their "villain" as I pretended not to know whom they were discussing. All they said centred around a dubious business they wanted to do and my brother was said to have blown the lid off the bottle.

They, six altogether, had planned to dupe a multi-millionaire businessman five million naira. My brother, whom they claimed was one of their members, allegedly disagreed with them over their choice of the businessman who happened to be my brother's boss sometime ago in a manufacturing company. According to them, my brother suggested their duping another multimillionaire, to which they refused, hence my brother pulled out totally.

Whereupon, he went ahead and tipped the businessman off and the deal flopped. They therefore planned to eliminate him. Intact, that was what they were planning when I walked into the beer parlour. As soon as I left the place, I went straight to my brother and told him everything I had heard, whereupon he alerted the police and

the culprits were arrested and charged for attempted murder.

Chris, this is just the summary of all that happened, it is the news making rounds in the neighbourhood right now. Everybody is blaming me why I had to leak the secret to my brother. Including all my friends. They now call me "amebo" (gossip). They say I am the brain behind the whole episode. Some of them have even threatened to deal with me should the suspects be jailed. So my dear friend, you judge that.

Like I told you, I do not have any regrets for what I have done, neither do I have any apology to tender to anyone. I don't owe anyone any explanations. Infact, under similar circumstances, I will do the same thing again and again. Tell me, why are people so stupid? So, I should have kept quiet only for my only brother to die for nothing? Infact, as at the time they were planning to kill my brother, they were being hunted by the police.

Can you keep quiet in such a situation for fear of being called names? Well, for me, I don't care at all. Even if they are all sentenced to death and executed, I have no fears at all. Even if I die in the process I won't ever regret saving my own brother from the hands of murderers who are so lazy to work, who only have duping as a means of survival. Even though my brother could be one of them I don't see why they should kill him for saying no. After all he also suggested another target.

Chris, you are somebody I respect a lot and who has good sense of judgement. Look at the case very critically and see if you would have done otherwise if you were in my shoes. I swear, all I have told you here is the dilemma I have found myself in. Right now my life is in great danger, but I can't sacrifice him in the altar of good name. If saving my brother's life is gossiping, then I am a gossip, and I don't care. Period,

Besides, if my action will help to curb the rampant killings and even the swindling that have become the bane of our society, then the better. However, I appeal to you to write back and tell me your opinion on the issues raised herein. This is wishing you the best in all your endeavours. I am waiting for your response. I hope you will not join the bandwagon of my detractors?

He laughs. Take care.

Yours friend,
Charles.

5.

P. O. Box 831,
Lagos,
8th September, 1994.

Sister Rose,

It is with a mixture of joy and sadness that I write this letter. You know, I am very blunt and do not believe in pretence. I say my mind, after which I get going. That is to say, even though all is well at home, I must not fail to register my displeasure over what you hinted me in your last letter. However, before I proceed on that, I wish to ask you how you are faring. Hope you are getting on fine. Your recent journey must have been a relief to you after the strains of examination. Have a nice time.

Yea, Rose, you are someone I respect a lot among my sisters, I have always seen in you a good sense of judgement, decency and decorum. Even our parents and indeed all, attest to this fact. How dare you plan such in your mind? Haba! Rose do you know what you are doing? How can you ever think about eloping with your lover, after our parents disapproved of your marriage to him?

You know, I am your younger brother whom you can confide in. I must not fail to tell you my mind. In all honesty, I condemn your idea totally. It is not only crude, insulting and primitive, but downright out of tune with tradition. Think of the insult that will bring to our family, who will now be an object of ridicule before all. Who has ever done that in the entire history of our community? Pardon me if my words are insulting and abusive to you, but I must use them here.

Though you are a woman, you know the culture of our people, perhaps more than me, since you are my elder. Tell me, is your planned action in line with our cultural values? Is it not an abomination? I beg you Rose, think twice.

In any case, I do not even see the wisdom in marrying someone your parents disapprove of. You should know that the blessings of parents is vital to the success of every marriage. Do you now want to marry without their blessing? Who will sign your marriage register? Okay that apart, if there is a quarrel between you and your husband, (which is bound to be) whom shall you run to for settlement? Spirits?

Honestly, I see you as someone who should have risen beyond sentiments especially at your level, educationally and otherwise, I condemn your idea totally, and urge you to have a rethink. Your idea is at variance with any known norms anywhere. Our world is very dynamic, never static. One therefore has to move with the time.

Even in the olden days, your action was still unheard of. Even the Holy Bible condemns it. If you must marry, you must be joined together to the approval of all.

Nevertheless, Rose, I do not intend to insult you here. Maybe my language has been harsh, but that expresses my feeling. Your problem is not hopeless. Infact, it is a simple one which can also be settled amicably. I believe in one marrying out of love, which is your own case. I see you love Eric so much. Infact, both of you will make a good couple.

I have had the privilege to discuss your problem with our parents. What informs their disapproval is Eric's family background. In short, Papa says Eric's family has a history of Witchcraft. But I have tried to convince him that witchcraft is not hereditary. Therefore if his father is a wizard, it does not follow that Eric too is one. Intact, I have also convinced them, especially when I impressed on them the need to marry out of love.

Right now, I have a plan. Come back home immediately. Together, we will meet some of our elders, both paternally and maternally. We will beseech them to collectively visit Papa and Mama and prevail on them to give their approval. With my own effort so far, you will be happy at the outcome. These days, our people have come to realise that a girl needs a free hand to choose her partner. Yours will not be an exception.

So Rose, that is about all I have to say. I hope you will listen to me and let us do as I have said here. I thank you for confiding in me and I assure you of my brotherly love and care.

Greetings to your well-wishers.

By the way, how is Eric? Heard from him lately? Look, Rose, just take it easy. Meanwhile have a nice time. Cheers.

Your brother,
Jerry,

6. THE FIVE PATIENT FRIENDS

Once upon a time, five beautiful ladies gained admission into the same university. They did not know each other prior to entering the university. But they took interest in one another. Soon, they became friends, eating and reading together. For four years, they maintained this relationship, even till they graduated.

However, during the national youth service, they were posted to different states, though all in the western part of Nigeria. This gave them the opportunity of visiting each other. One day, towards the end of their service, one of them saw

an advertisement in a national daily, calling for application from job seekers.

Luckily, the job fitted all the five friends since they all studied the same course. Thus, the one who saw the advertisement decided to inform the rest. Coincidentally, all of them took interest in the job and filed applications.

Few weeks later, they all received their letters of interview. They prepared for it. A day to the day of interview, the four travelled to Lagos to spend the night with the one living in Laogs since the job was in Lagos.

On the part of the advertisers, they had set the stage and were ready for the candidates. However, the advertisers had made up their mind that patience was the most crucial pre-requisite for any lady who would eventually be employed. They needed five ladies, and the job entailed being patient.

Thus, they tailored the interview to test patience, and their strategy was thus the interview was to be deliberately postponed thrice, to see if any of the candidates will withdraw voluntarily out of impatience and frustration.

By 9.00am, on the appointed day, all the candidates came, numbering about twenty, including the five friends. They waited until 10.00 am. But members of the interview panel did not show up. 12.00 noon, 1pm, 2pm, yet they did not show up. Four of the candidates got annoyed and left in anger, leaving the other sixteen.

However, at exactly 4.00p.m the panel arrived and apologised for their lateness. The interview was rescheduled. On the rescheduled day, only ten candidates came, including the five friends. The same thing happened, except that the panel came 12 noon instead of 9 a.m, when three candidates had gone after cursing the panel leaving only seven, including the five friends. All of them left, all in annoyance. The following morning two bolted away leaving only the five friends. At exactly 9.00a.m the panel came, only to announce that "owing to unforeseen circumstances, we will not be able to interview you now. Kindly come back at 400pm". Instead of getting angry, the five friends laughed themselves wild, vowing to see the end.

They all went home, cooked, ate, cracked jokes and by four, they came back to the company premises, venue of the interview. This time, the panel was already seated, waiting for the candidates. At exactly 4 p.m the candidates (only the five friends), saw themselves sitting face-to-face with the panel. However, what they expected was not what they saw. Instead of the usual questions and answers session, the panel

members only took credentials of the five friends, scrutinized them and served them drinks.

At the end, the panel revealed their game plan to the candidates to their amazement, telling them they had undergone the interview without knowing it, by being patient in the midst of dribbling. They were all congratulated and given appointment letters to begin work the following week. They went home with joy. One of the lucky girls narrated his incident to me. Even as I write, I really agree that the patient dog eats the fattest bone.

7. (a) It is because writing involves formal teaching and intentional studying.
(b) The first problem is that of matching the sound of the voice with the spelling of words. The other is the matching of our uses and intonation with the punctuation of sentences and paragraphing.
(c) The first is that the writer loses so much of gestures, facial expressions and voice tone. Then, he immediately loses the direct contact with his audience
(d) Acquiring good writing skills makes one to be very accurate, smooth and perfect in thinking
(e) (i) It is an adjectival clause (ii) It qualifies the noun energy
(f) (i) deliberately—intentionally (ii) equivalent—semblance (iii) designed—fashioned
(iv) compensation—relief (v) response—answer
(vi) polish—smoothen.

8. (a)(i) The writer is extremely tall and fat, but cheerful, happy, confident and secure (ii) The writer was one so much interested in others and trying to be like them before he realized the stupidity in this
(b) It is because of an experience with a tall plump woman, who failed in trying to impress others. That is, the writer discovered that no one cared what others did
(c)(i) She felt sad, disappointed and miserable (ii) It is because no one really cared about what one did
(d) (i) An adverbial clause of time (ii) Modifying plump'
(e) disadvantages-shortcomings, conform be similar, tugged-pulled; rage-fury, miserable - depressed, inspiration - strength.
9. (a) The assumption, by Jos, of two administrative functions as divisional and provincial capital. The movement to Jos of new employees and labourers to serve the two administrations. The boom in tin mining industry. The reaching of Jos, of the Eastern Railway Extension and similar developments on the plateau
(b) There was the exploitation of Nigerians and the economy by immigrant Indians and Levantines. There was segregation perpetuated by Europeans on Africans especially in hotel use and in provision of social amenities.

SENIOR SCHOOL CERTIFICATE EXAMINATION (SSCE 1988 – 2015)

Past Questions with Solutions

English Language

(Theory / Objectives with Oral English) 1995

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WASSCE JUNE 1995 ENGLISH LANGUAGE 2

OBJECTIVE TEST QUESTIONS

SECTION 1

*In each of the following sentences, there is one word underlined and one gap. From the list of words lettered A - E, choose the word that is **most nearly opposite** in meaning to the underlined word and that will, at the same time, correctly fill the gap in the sentences*

1. Ibrahim was full of admiration for Amina but she treated him with.....
A. amusement B. freedom C. disdain D. restraint
E. disgrace
2. The economist argued that the apparently inconsequential rise in the price of petrol had a..... effect on the cost of living
A. captitious B. frivolous C. dangerous D. bright
E. drab
3. The exotic bird looked resplendent its bright plumage contrasted with the rather..... undergrowth
A. immobile B. foreign C. extraneous D. bright
E. drab
4. Femi is very presumptuous quite unlike his late father who was a rather.....man
A. chaste B. pure C. honest D. modest E. kind
5. The new manager found the bustle and excitement of city life difficult to adjust to after living for almost a decade in a relatively.....village
A. lively B. quiet C. rustic D. beautiful E. distant
6. The policeman's statement was explicit while that of the suspect was.....
A. vague B. suspicious C. illogical D. wicked
E. clear
7. The post-war generation were born in an era of scarcity but grew up in a period of.....
A. abunaance B. accumulation C. poverty
D. affluences E. austerity
8. The minister warned his officers to be frugal and avoid.....expenditure
A. gigantic B. capital C. recurrent D. unplanned
E. wasteful

9. The deputy's loyalty to the boss unalloyed but the confidence of the boss in him is.....
A. creditable B. half-hearted C. incredible
D. certain E. ridiculous
10. The eventual implementation of the plan deviated much from the..... conception
A. consequent B. subsequent C. initial D. final
E. agreed.

SECTION 2

*From the words lettered A to E, choose the word that **best completes** each of the following sentences*

11. The kidnappers demanded a.....of N50,000 before they would release the rich businessman
A. levy B. condition C. penalty D. freedom
E. ransom
12. The governor scolded the contractors for the poor.....of the project
A. prosecution B. installation C. investigation
D. execution E. foundation
13. His decision to terminate the agreement was..... as he did not consult the other party
A. unilateral B. unconditional C. unquestionable
D. unanimous E. unequivocal
14. More often than not, the law.....on individual freedom,
A. exudes B. encroaches C. oversteps
D. outstrips E. impedes
15. Because of the hard time, many workers now live in a state of.....poverty
A. unpardonable B. imaginable C. affluent
D. object E. repulsive
16. The threat that he would be expelled from school if he failed his examination again.....him into seriousness
A. coaxed B. lured C. jolted D. hypnotized
E. incensed
17. It is really a..... the more you look, the less you see,
A. metaphor B. miracle C. hyperbole
D. movement E. paradox

18. The new car is strikingly attractive but I very much doubt its.....
A. durability B. style C. harmony D. longevity
E. complexity
19. Bunmi should not have taken offence at Emeka's seemingly.....comments
A. innocuous B. notorious C. ridiculous
D. ludicrous E. raucous
20. As Siaka was a first offender, the magistrate merely.....and discharged him
A. penalized B. reprieved C. remanded
D. cautioned E. sentenced.

SECTION C

*After each of the following sentences, a list of possible interpretations is given. Choose the interpretation that you consider the **most appropriate** for each sentence.*

21. The accountant falsified the records in order to feather his own nest. This means that the accountant tried to
A. deceive his boss B. put a feather in his cap
C. make himself rich
D. avenge a wrong done to him by his boss
22. The cashier wanted to pull the wool over my eyes by making me sign for the money I didn't receive. This means that the cashier wanted to
A. deceive me
B. blindfold me
C. rub my eyes with cotton wool
D. have my support
23. The taxi-driver smelt a rat when the policeman waved him to stop and so he sped off. This means that the taxi driver
A. suddenly saw a big rat
B. had killed a rat
C. committed an offence
D. became suspicious
24. The proscription of the students' union was to nip the planned demonstration in the bud. This means that the proscription was meant to
A. keep the students on the alert
B. prevent the proposed demonstration
C. disorganize the students
D. punish the students
25. The man's decision to withdraw his daughter from school because of her misbehaviour really amounts to cutting off his own nose to spite his face. This means that

- A. the decision will not affect the daughter
B. it will cause the man much pain to his nose and face
C. the decision does the man no good at all
D. the decision will make the daughter sober

26. When the managing director promised to increase the wages of the workers in the New Year, everybody knew that he was talking with his tongue in his cheek. This means that the managing director
A. was very sincere
B. spoke courageously
C. was not sincere at all
D. hid his tongue while speaking
27. The officer urged the soldiers to gird up their loins for the task ahead. This means that soldiers should
A. wake up early the next morning
B. guard their hungry loins
C. wear new battle uniform
D. be on full alert
28. The government introduced belt tightening measures in the budget for the new year. This means that the measures were
A. stiff B. inflation-free
C. employment-generating D. costly
29. Jimmy is good company, but he sometimes blows his own trumpet. This means that Jimmy
A. enjoys music
B. disregards others
C. praises himself
D. is an expert in playing the trumpet
30. The teacher was reprimanded for turning a blind eye to the acts of rudeness of his pupils. This means that the teacher
A. did not pay attention to the pupils
B. behaved like a blind man
C. was responsible for the rudeness of his pupils
D. ignored the behaviour of his pupils.

SECTION 4

From the words lettered A to E below each of the following sentences, choose the word that is **nearest in meaning** to the underlined word as it is used in the sentence.

31. The journalist refused to divulge the source of his information
A. confirm B. inform C. disclose D. extract
E. affirm

32. As soon as Shehu realized that he has made a mistake, he did everything to rectify it
A. destroy B. erase C. eradicate D. relieve
E. correct
33. Ada was sceptical about the story Ifeoma told her
A. ignorant B. doubtful C. confused D. happy
E. convinced
34. It appears that this government is not ready to tolerate any adverse criticism
A. unfavourable B. destructive C. unconvincing
D. unreasonable E. constructive
35. The lawyer remarked that the fact that the accused did nothing when the innocent boy was being lynched made him culpable
A. liable B. untrustworthy C. guilt D. unreliable
E. blameworthy
36. The mineral resources of the country are yet to be fully tapped
A. assessed B. discovered C. cultivated
D. invested E. exploited
37. The boss is quite flexible once she has made up her mind
A. wicked B. relaxed C. unyielding D. excited
E. permanent
38. Spain was once a very powerful nation but her influence has waned over the years
A. disappeared B. repealed C. echoed
D. diminished E. re-appeared
39. The labour leaders described the newly-introduced economic measures as obnoxious
A. offensive B. prudent C. inevitable
D. unpredictable E. shameless
40. The politician made very scurrilous remarks about his opponent
A. mild B. intolerable C. false D. sharp
E. abusive
43. Ahmadu would have arrived earlier but he was.....in heavy traffic
A. held up B. held down C. held off
D. held about
44. Bola is a good friend of mine, but I am sometimes..... by her careless attitude
A. blown off B. forced out C. turned out
D. put off
45. Customers are advised to settle their electricity bills promptly, otherwise supply may be.....
A. blown off B. cut out C. blown out D. cut off
46. The boy needs a broad piece of paper and..... to practise his drawing
A. some crayon B. crayons C. crayon
D. much crayons
47. Mr. Johnson instructed his driver to ensure that the tank of the car is filled with.....for the long journey the next day
A. petrols B. much petrol C. petrol D. a petrol
48. The policeman has gathered.....to complete the investigation
A. few information B. many informations
C. sufficient information D. an information
49. Udoh was.....hasty in his decision to resign
A. much B. somewhat C. such D. enough
50. Doctor: 'How is the ulcer patient?' Nurse: 'He's recovering.....faster than we expected'
A. very B. much C. too D. so
51. Chukwu's appraisal was one of the.....in the department
A. worse B. better C. worst D. greatest
52. There were.....infant deaths in the town last year than in previous years.
A. fewer B. few C. more few D. less few
53. The last book is the.....interesting of the books we have read this term
A. very B. much C. more D. most
54. The uncompromising politician remained..... a political wilderness for almost a decade
A. for B. into C. in D. by
55. It was revealed that the drainage system of the town has been.....of use since it was constructed
A. in B. out C. inside D. outside

SECTION 5

*From the words or group of words lettered A to D, choose the one that **best completes** each of the following sentences*

41. The new bakery will.....one thousand loaves of bread daily
A. turn over B. turn out C. turn up D. turn in
42. The old man's illness was so serious that he was not expected to.....
A. pull off B. pull over C. pull through D. pull down

56. The young man came to Lagos.....the intention of staying with his friend
A. for B. by C. on D. with
57. The school boys were told to refrain.....smoking
A. from B. with C. in D. for
58. He is a very brilliant student so it is not surprising that he got a.....
A. first-class result worthy
B. worthy first-class result
C. result first-class worthy
D. result worthy first-class
59. The children inherited many houses from their father but they have sold off.....
A. them of nearly all B. them nearly all of
C. nearly all of them D. all of them nearly
60. Mrs Coker had an accident because she was.....
A. rather driving carelessly
B. rather carelessly driving
C. carelessly driving rather
D. driving rather carelessly
61. I found out recently that one can enjoy.....without drinking
A. myself B. yourself C. oneself D. herself
62. The two cats are so similar that I cannot tell whether that one is
A. yourself or myself B. yours or mine
C. my or you D. your's or my
63.all the contestants, the judges then announced the winner
A. To see B. Seen C. Seeing D. Having seen
64. His clothes were not only tattered but also.....with oil
A. were dripping B. is dripping C. have dripped
D. drip
65. I.....at the hotel for two days when I was suddenly asked to leave
A. have stayed B. was staying
C. had been staying D. stay
66. Dupe.....to have spoken so rudely to her mother
A. shouldn't B. aren't C. oughtn't D. wouldn't
67. Perhaps what Ade told us.....true after all
A. must not be B. may not be C. shall not be
D. should not be

68. To have gone through a civil war..... a terrible experience
A. must have been B. was to be
C. might have been D. was being
69. Umar and Yusuf went hunting today.....?
A. isn't it B. haven't they C. is it D. didn't they
70. Bose shouldn't have interrupted the teacher.....?
A. didn't she B. did she C. should she
D. could she
71.are seven female teachers in our school
A. They B. There C. Their D. Those
72. The principal sent them home because they did not pay.....school fees
A. they B. there C. them D. their

SECTION B

*In the following passages, the numbered gaps indicate missing words. Against each number in the list below each passage, five choices are offered in columns lettered A to E. For each question, choose the word that is the **most suitable** to fill the numbered gap in the passage.*

PASSAGE A

Farming is a very common—73— among the rural dwellers in the West African sub-region. Most often, this is practised at — 74— level with little if any—75— outlay involved. Year in year out, the farmers eke out their —76— from the land tilled with hoes and such other simple implements. Many of these rural dwellers have never heard about —77— farming let alone the prerequisites for the successful operation of such —78— enterprises. —79— cultivation is widely practised. This is a process where farmers abandon their parcels of land for a period of four to five years to allow such land to recover its natural —80— for better —81—

—82— such as yam, maize, rice, cowpea which serve as —83— food are planted on —84— basis, while —85— crops are hardly grown. Invariably the —86— are inherited and passed from one generation to another. Where —87— are paid at all, they are usually in kind.

	A	B	C	D	E
73	preoccupation	pastime	hobby	job	occupation
74	sustenance	primary	advanced	substantial	substance
75	labour	capital	monitory	economic	land
76	level/hood	security	income	savings	wages
77	automatic	mechanical	traditional	mechanized	technological
78	medium-sized	public	large-scale	indigenous	small-scale
79	Arable	Shrilling	Staccato	Annual	Manual
80	softness	talent	riches	wealth	richness
81	croplings	yields	surplus	surplus	harvest
82	Grains	Foodstuff	Seedlings	Crops	Seeds
83	ordinary	expert	staple	delicious	novelty
84	rotation	alternative	circular	regular	periodic
85	foreign	fruit	profitable	useful	cash
86	plots	gardens	yields	grain	farmlands
87	fees	bill	rents	charges	honoraria

PASSAGE B

The —88— has just completed his —89— into a case of —90— brought by a —91—, but was undecided as to whether or not there was enough evidence to —92— the —93—. However, his inspector felt that there were sufficient ingredients in the case to warrant—94—. Not only were there witnesses to —95—the evidence of the complainant but the accused had virtually confessed to the offence.

The courtroom was filled to capacity during the ensuing —96—, as the accused had employed the services of a legal luminary for his defence. During the —97— it became clear to all present that the—98— relied upon by the prosecution was very weak. The defence counsel successfully tore the evidence of the witnesses into shreds. The presiding —99— had no choice but to —100— and acquit the accused for want of evidence.

88.	due	game	match	battle	trial
89.	prosecution	processes	sessions	settings	proceedings
90.	alibi	material	evidence	for	truth
91.	magistrate	counsellor	counsellor	legislation	solicitor
92.	dismiss	discharge	caution	detain	liberate

WASSCE JUNE 1995 OBJECTIVE TEST ANSWERS

1.C	2.E	3.E	4.D	5.B	6.A	7.A
8.E	9.B	10.C	11.E	12.D	13.A	14.B
15.D	16.C	17.E	18.A	19.A	20.D	21.C
22.A	23.D	24.B	25.C	26.C	27.D	28.A
29.C	30.D	31.C	32.E	33.B	34.A	35.E
36.E	37.C	38.D	39.A	40.8	41.B	42.C
43.A	44.D	45.D	46.B	47.C	48.C	49.6
50.B	51.C	52.A	53.D	54.C	55.B	56.D
57.A	58.B	59.C	60.D	61.C	62.B	63.D
64.A	65.C	66.C	67.B	68.A	69.D	70.C
71.B	72.D	73.E	74.E	75.B	76.A	77.D
78.C	79.B	80.E	81.B	82.D	83.C	84.D
85.E	86.B	87.C	88.B	89.B	90.A	91.D
92.C	93.E	94.A	95.D	96.E	97.E	98.C
99.A	100.B					

88.	A	B	C	D	E
89.	decide	police	office	minister	judge
90.	research	investigation	search	study	investigation
91.	accuse	indict	abuse	trouble	quarrel
92.	illegitimate	witness	defendant	complainant	prosecutor
93.	imprison	accuse	prosecute	implicate	sue
94.	eremy	miscreant	ruffian	coups	accused
95.	prosecution	execution	attention	celebration	intention
	strengthen	validate	tear	concoct	suppress

WASSCE JUNE 1995 ENGLISH LANGUAGE 1 THEORY QUESTIONS

PART A

1. Your younger sister in SS II has written for your advice on what subjects she should study for the SSC. Examination. As someone who knows her ability in the different subjects, write a letter to her giving advice on why she should choose certain subjects rather than others.
2. There has been an outbreak of an epidemic in your area. Write an article for publication in a health magazine stating the causes and effects, and suggesting what should be done in order to check it.
3. The topic of a debate organized by the Directorate for Mass Mobilization for senior secondary schools is: The open ballot system is better than the secret ballot system for Nigeria. Write your contribution for or against the motion.
4. You were an eye-witness to a fight in your dormitory in which a junior student was given a black eye and the principal had threatened to expel the boarders unless the facts of the matter were made known to him. Write a letter to the principal stating what actually happened.

5. Recently, there was a rainstorm which caused a lot of damage in your locality. Write an article for publication in your school magazine, describing the rainstorm, the damage caused and its effects on the people.
6. Tell a story which end with the words.....'and I have had to live with this stigma for the rest of my life'.

PART B SECTION I COMPREHENSION

7. Read the following passage carefully and then answer the questions on it.

The death last month of Chief Dende has opened my eyes. Throughout his life, we were very close friends. We grew up together, attended the same primary and secondary schools, and joined the civil service the same day. Although we benefited from different in-service training programmes and at different times during our respective careers we were never too distant from each other. And we were installed chiefs the same day. Above all, his wife, Adanma, and mine have been good friends over the years.

All these years, I believed that my friend kept no secret from me. I could, and did occasionally defend his integrity. Anywhere people discussed him in my hearing, I was ready to take up his case vehemently. Predictably, people stopped discussing him any time I was around. I had assumed, erroneously as it turned out, that people had stopped discussing him because they were sufficiently educated and sincerely convinced about his integrity. Happenings have since shattered that assumption.

The first shock came day after his death. The major national newspapers carried his obituary as advertised by 'his wife Ngozi Dende and her three children'. If the timing of the advertisement a day after the event was strange, particularly more puzzling was the advertiser. All my life, I had known only Adanma as his wife and her five children. Besides, the names of 'his' three children in the advertisement were entirely different from those of his five children by Adanma.

Before I recovered from the first shock the bombshell fell. Members of the Apata Fraternity, most dreaded secret cult, which Dende and I had despised while he lived, announced in the dailies that they had the exclusive right to bury their departed colleague'. The announcement warned all uninitiated persons to keep off in their own interest'. And so it was that members of the fraternity, supporting their claim with a hand-written Will by Dende, collected his body from the hospital, performed the last rites on him and buried him in their sacred grave.

I have learnt, and I am still learning. I have reached the unpleasant conclusion that his critics were most probably right after all.

- (a) Why was the writer always defending Chief Dende?
- (b) Why was the writer puzzled about the advertisement by Ngozi Dende?
- (c) Why was he also surprised about the advertisement by the Apata Fraternity?
- (d) What lesson can we learn from this passage?
- (e) the next bombshell fell. (i) What figure of speech is the above expression? (ii) What is its meaning?
- (f) that his critics were most probably right after all
- (i) What grammatical name is given to the above expression? (ii) What is its function in the sentence? (g) For each of the following words, find another word or phrase that means the same and can replace it as used in the passage (i)careers, (ii)integrity; (iii)vehemently, (iv)erroneously (v) shattered (vi) exclusive.

8. *Read the following passage carefully and answer the questions on it.*

Years after he had left home for the capital, first as a student and later as a struggling businessman. Oliha returned to his village, having been informed of his father's failing health. He was amazed that not much had changed since he left as a youth. Every experience shocked him: the coloured water with a strong taste, the eye-sore of a dung-hill on which everyone excreted: the absence of electricity and so on.

As he went to bed late in the evening after a meeting with his younger brothers on how he would pay his own share of their father's medical expenses, he prayed for the early arrival of the morning. He decided to leave early and put the trying experience behind him.

But morning brought him the greatest shock of his life. Informed by his niece that there was a bucket of water for him in the bath, he hurried down there, half-dressed, holding a towel. The bathroom, located by the side of the building, was an improved rectangular enclosure made of palm fronds. Hissing to himself, he went in and used his clothes and large towel to cover some openings in the enclosure. He started bathing. Then it happened. With every inch of his body thoroughly covered with soap lather, hardly able to open his eyes, he heard someone removing his clothes and towel. With the corner of his half-opened eyes, he saw a man making away with the clothes and towel. Hardly giving the matter a thought, naked except for the covering of soap lather, he ran out and gave the thief a hot chase.

As he ran after the thief, he heard everyone shouting — The lunatic has broken loose again!. But as soon as the people saw him, everyone shouted, 'Ah, another mad man has broken loose!' Men, women, children all ran away, seeking refuge in their homes, slamming their doors. By the time he realized what was happening, daring men were after him, Just as Oliha was about to beat a retreat, he was held by strong, muscular men who overpowered him and carried him to the quarters of the village's foremost occult healer who alone knew how to cure lunatics.

- (a) Why did Oliha return to the village?
- (b) Mention two basic facilities lacking in the village
- (c) What was the subject of the meeting which Oliha held with his younger brothers?
- (d) Why was it possible for the thief to remove the clothes without Oliha stopping him?
- (e) (i) Why was Oliha taken to the occult healer rather than to his father's home? (ii) What is the irony of the entire event in the passage?

(f) who alone knew how to cure lunatics (i) What is the grammatical name given to the above expression? (ii) What is its function in the sentence?

(g) the early arrival of morning (i) What figure of speech is the above expression? (ii) Why do you consider it so?

(h) For each of the following words, find another word or phrase that means the same and can replace it as used in the passage (i) shocked: (ii) trying; (iii) thoroughly: (iv) refuge: (v) foremost

SECTION II SUMMARY

9. *Read the following passage carefully and answer the questions on it.*

The history of warfare reveals that man has come a long way. In the beginning man contented himself with simple hand- V hurled missiles. Man threw the stone at other animals and, in warfare, at his enemies. Destruction was minimal, as this was determined by the size and roughness of the stone and the energy of the thrower. Even when man later invented the catapult, destruction was only slightly higher. The primitive catapult was made out of a tough rope at one end of which was tied a big stone. Its most limiting factor was that such a missile, no matter how strong the force behind it, could kill only one person at a time.

Things were relatively easier for the assailant with the invention of the bow and arrow. For the first time, man utilized very little strength to bring down his enemy, even at a fairly distant position. The size of the bow, the elasticity of its string, and the sharpness of the arrow, much more than the rude energy of the thrower, determined how far and fast the arrow travelled. The weapon became even more significant when man later learnt to fix a sharp metal to the tip of the arrow. And when that metal was dyed in highly lethal poison, it became even more effective in killing a man.

With the coming of metal, farm implements were developed. But man soon turned some of these, especially the machete, into weapons of combat. The sword is thus a very close cousin of the machete. Used in combat, the sword, especially when carried by a very skilful fighter on a horse, could wreak far more havoc than the bow and arrow. It is hence understandable that the foremost conquerors of the classical period, from Alexander the Great to Julius Caesar, used this simple hand-borne instrument of combat. And this, in its simple Scabbard, reigned for centuries.

Things took a dramatic turn with the invention of the gun and the bullet. The arrival of the gun introduced destruction of human lives at an unprecedented rate with the most elementary gun. In the hands of foot soldiers, it became

possible to count casualties in hundreds in a single encounter. With practically no physical effort, apart from the moving of a finger on the trigger, the highly lethal bullet is sent through the barrel at a speed much faster than that of sound. The enemy, at a considerable distance, may thus be brought down without even hearing the sound of the shooting or seeing his assailant.

The development of grenades, bombs, missiles, nuclear and chemical war-heads have made all previous weapons appear little more than toys. With bombs delivered by fast-flying aeroplanes, and nuclear or chemical war-heads borne to their distant destinations by unmanned missiles, destruction of cities and in fact, whole countries within a matter of hours is now a great possibility. Today, man doesn't need to be physically present to haul the stone, or throw the spear, or send the arrow. The missile has now replaced all these, and it does not need to be physically sent by an individual. Electronics and computers do the launching, and men die in hundreds of thousands.

In six sentences, one for each, summarize the six different types of weapons of warfare and their relative effectiveness.

SSCE JUNE 1995 ENGLISH LANGUAGE 1 THEORY ANSWERS

1. 2, Godwin Otiede Lane,
Apapa, Lagos.
28th July, 1995.

Dear Esther,

Congratulations on your promotion to the graduation class. I have seen the detailed results of the ten subjects that you have been offering since the time you entered Senior Secondary One. Your letter asking my advice came at the right time. Now that you will sit for next year's May/June School Certificate Examinations, I believe that you should concentrate on the subjects that will lead you to good subject combinations that will facilitate your career choices.

I know you have been studying English, Mathematics, Biology, Agricultural Science, Economics, Government, Accounts, Home Economics, Yoruba Literature and Bible Knowledge. I know you once told me that you would like to be a lawyer or a mass communicator. I still remember how many prizes you have won as your college debater. I am also aware that you are the outgoing president of your college press club. It is a fact that you have a

natural flair for talking well and writing beautiful essays and stories.

Out of the two careers that you like, I personally will advise you to consider the legal profession as number one. As a barrister at law you can work in any office even if you decided not to practise. You can still be a journalist with little or no additional training after you must have graduated as a lawyer.

The following subjects are most suitable for either Law or Mass Communication: English, Mathematics, Government, Literature, Economics, Bible Knowledge, Commerce and Biology. The Biology simply fulfils the one science subject expected of you.

And even if you change your mind after leaving school, you can conveniently go for Accountancy or Business Administration. You can also study Economics and Statistics if you have relevant credits in those subjects.

You must work diligently and meticulously towards coming out in the flying colours. I wish you goodluck

Your brother,

David.

2. THE CHOLERA OUTBREAK IN OSHODI

Long before this disturbing moment I and others and myself have been raising alarm over the deteriorating sanitary conditions of Oshodi area of Lagos where I live. The cholera outbreak, which started early last week, has already claimed over one hundred victims - men, women, young and old, and of course children.

The causes of the cholera epidemic are not far-fetched. The air and the environment are polluted with many heaps of refuse which the relevant state or local government authorities have continuously refused to clear off. There has been buckling in that sector as to which agency of government is supposed to be saddled with the responsibility of evacuating refuse. Another major cause of the cholera disease is contaminated water. Most water pipes are leaky. Some few Nigerians urinate, defecate and pass a variety of impurities into gutters and channels of pipe network. The treated water that most people drink in Oshodi area is contaminated, and so detrimental to health. Another cause of the cholera outbreak is the contact which most of our food items have with bacteria, viruses and other harmful germs. Most people buy and eat unsterilized fruits. The effects of this cholera

outbreak are obvious and many. Some of the effects are immediate, others are remote.

Some victims of this outbreak who don't receive quick and appropriate medical attention will die. Some young ones will have their growth stunted or vital organs impaired. The society will lose a lot of able-bodied men and women.

My suggestions are few and could be effective. Personal hygiene, good environmental laws should be maintained and enforced in Oshodi. The heaps of refuse must be cleared.

Sanitary inspection officers must be sent to all markets and shops to enforce sanitation edicts. The government can quickly step up advertisements on all media fronts to increase basic health awareness campaigns.

More hospitals should be built near the people and the old ones should be well equipped, staffed and basic drugs provided to meet normal and emergency demands. In conclusion, immunization programmes or measures must be stepped up too. The government and all relevant health centres should put all hands on deck to tackle this epidemic before it does more harm and/or spread to other areas.

John Orodio

Oshodi, Lagos.

3. THE OPEN BALLOT SYSTEM IS BETTER THAN THE SECRET BALLOT SYSTEM FOR NIGERIA

Good day the moderator, panel of judges, the time-keeper, my fellow debaters and the attentive audience. I am here this morning to vehemently oppose the motion which states that the open ballot system is better than the secret ballot system.

Before I adduce reasons for opposing the motion, it is only pertinent that I clarify the two major concepts first. The Secret Ballot System requires that one votes secretly behind a closed room during elections for one's preferred candidate. The open ballot system on the other hand entails that voters vote openly by queuing or otherwise, indicate their preference for a candidate. The secret ballot system is better than the open ballot system for Nigeria. Nigeria has tried the two systems. The evils or disadvantages of the open ballot system surpass those of the secret ballot system.

The secret ballot system enables every voter to vote confidently and secretly without the candidates being in a position to maltreat or intimidate him at the end of the election or during it. The secret ballot system insulates the voters

from all forms of animosity from those who lose election, Secondly, the secret ballot system makes it easy for re-counting in case there are legal disputes about the eventual winner - the ballot papers can be recounted. The open ballot voters can't be recounted the moment they disperse at the end of the voting exercise.

The secret ballot system makes it possible for tenants of a bad politician or employees of a wicked industrialist to vote against him without him actually discovering that people that are close to him dislike his tactics or person as a political leader.

The secret ballot system thwarts the desire of politicians who always wish to use money to influence people voting for them on the election day. During open ballot voting, voters are lured away to vote for the candidates offering bigger money. And those who collect such bribes always vote sheepishly for their pay - masters because failure to vote accordingly will spell almost immediate threats and injuries to their persons.

That critics say that the secret ballot system is expensive is not a serious setback. Any good or quality thing or process would be costly. The open ballot system disenfranchises some eminent members of the society who will not like queuing in public to cast votes when some of their friends are the contestants. The secret ballot system saves this category of people from embarrassment and making of enemies among their fiends.

The open ballot system can't be organized in a limited building space, but the secret one can. To conclude, the two systems have merits and demerits, but the secret ballot system is far better because of its advantages over the open ballot system.

4. St. Godwin's Grammar School,
Warn.
11th August, 1995.

The Principal,
St. Godwin's Grammar School,
Warn.

Dear Sir,

REPORT ON THE FIGHT IN THE DORMITORY

It was in the afternoon of Saturday 23rd of July 1995 when we were observing our siesta. Earlier in the day, Senior Tokunbo Falade had requested James to wash his clothes for him. There was no empty bucket that he could use so Senior Tokunbo told James to remove Tunde's

soaked clothes from his bucket and use it for the washing.

When Tunde came from the field and saw his clothes in the broken and wretched plastic bucket under the tree he became very furious and went to James, and turned Senior Tokunbo's dresses into the mud. Senior Tokunbo was not at the scene because he had gone to read.

James and Tunde who are in class two fought each other bravely with both sustaining some injuries. When Senior Tokunbo came back from class and on being told what happened he became very annoyed. His clothes were seriously stained and spoiled. Tunde had more injuries than James, the owner of the bucket that caused the fight. Senior started to flog James at the buttocks, palms, body and back at random. It was during this flogging exercise that part of the cane touched James eye and he developed black eye from it.

Senior Tokunbo and the other seniors warned us not to tell our housemaster or any of the college officials about it. The health prefect however, had since applied first aid treatment but I was highly surprised at seeing how the supposed minor injury has turned to be very serious.

Yours faithfully,



Emeka Okeke (3A)

5. THE WORST RAINSTORM IN MY LOCALITY

It was a fortnight ago on a Saturday afternoon. The sunny bright day suddenly started changing with the advent of a heavy wind carrying along all light objects, sand and material particles. As if the electricity distribution board people had prepared for it, they quickly cut the power in the whole locality of Ijanikin.

Within an hour the afternoon had turned into a semi-night situation. Amidst this darkness, thunders and lightnings had put both the young and the old on an agitated and prayerful mood. While the wind, thundering and signals continued and increased in intensity, the heaviest and longest downpour in many years took place. Many electric poles fell on houses, roads and some unlucky passers-by on their way to some places.

The number of houses destroyed now stands at 50, and over 1000 houses were flooded. The occupants of such flooded houses lost valuables but none lost his or her life. But some occupants of the destroyed houses either died, were maimed or injured seriously. Even the general hospital in

the area was so flooded that it couldn't offer medical services for about two days.

The electric poles, wires and those of telephone were adversely affected. As I am writing now, these facilities have not been restored and may not be restored fully for time to come. Frozen fish companies, hair-dressing salons, business centres and other businesses which require electricity for their operations are still counting their losses, inconveniences and incapacitation which the rainstorm occasioned.

The farmers were no exceptions among those who lost heavily. Either their new crops were washed away or the ones due for harvest were destroyed outright. It was a natural disaster which one prays doesn't happen again. One also wish that we have a more equipped meteorological department that is capable of giving helpful signals. Even the absence of emergency aid workers compounded the effects of the rainstorm.

Joseph Okon,
SS3A.

6. THE STIGMA OF MY LIFE

It was when I was in form three that my sister who was and still married to a businessman brought me to Lagos. I was fifteen years old then. The things that informed my elder sister bringing me into her matrimonial home in Lagos were mainly three: to help look after the young ones; continue my college education and act as the keeper of their shop near our house in Ebute Metta.

Since my sister is a nurse and my brother-in-law is an international businessman, I lacked nothing. He often brought good dresses and shoes from Italy where he frequented for business activities. My brother-in-law was very strict with me in spite of his generous disposition towards me in gifts, dresses, shoes and jewelry. He even found time to visit me in school whenever I and others had cause to stay a little longer than the normal closing time.

One day while I was in form four and my sister had gone to night duty as a nurse, my in-law told me that he liked me and would want me to make love to him since I was no longer a baby. I politely reminded him that he was my sister's husband and

I didn't know about such a thing. He merely told me that he understood my attitude and that I should not tell anyone since he was merely teasing me. His generosity towards me increased. I didn't see the need reporting the matter to my

sister. I feared she would not believe and could go ahead to suspect me seducing her husband. I heard something like that happened to a girl who was staying with her sister in a nearby street before my arrival in Lagos.

Almost a year after his first approach when my sister had gone home to visit our parents for about a week, he forced me into making love to him. He continued few more times to force me to do it with him until I became pregnant. He was more vocal in saying, that the pregnancy belonged to Emeka who was befriending me and who had actually shown interest in marrying me. He encouraged me to quickly marry Emeka and generously helped Emeka and myself to speedily get through the wedding ceremony.

I know within myself that my first son doesn't belong to my present husband and that he is physically different from my other children, boys and girls, that are naturally Emeka's. Only my sister's husband and myself know that my first son belongs to him and not to my 'second' but real husband. Many years have passed and nobody will believe my story so I have had to live with this stigma, and may continue like that for the rest of my life.

(a) He defended Chief Dended because the latter was his intimate friend and he kept no secret from him

(b) The writer was surprised about Ngozi Dende's advertisement because he had never known or seen her before the death of his friend as a wife

(c) The writer and the deceased Chief had always hated and condemned the Apata Fraternity

(d) We have learned that human beings should not be totally trusted and that there are elements of truth in some rumours

(e) (i) Metaphor (ii) a devastating news or occurrence

(f) (i) noun clause (ii) object of the sentence

(g) (i) Careers — Professions (ii) Integrity — Honesty (iii) Vehemently — Strongly

(iv) Erroneously — Incorrectly (v) Shattered — Destroyed (vi) Exclusive — Special.

Mr Oliha returned to the village because of his knowledge of his father's illness

(b) There were no pipe-borne water and electricity in the village

(c) The subject of the meeting was how to pay their sick father's medical bill

(d) Mr Oliha's eyes were covered with soap foam and he was taking his bath.

(e) He was thought to be another mad person in the village (ii) It was ironical that a man who came to pay the medical bill of his sick father was taken to the native doctor for cure

(f) (i) It is called adjectival clause (ii) Qualifying
'occult healer'

(g) (i) It is personification (ii) 'Morning' is treated
as a person who goes or arrives

(h) (i) Shocked — Surprised (ii) Trying — Painful
(iii) Thoroughly — Completely (iv) Refuge — A
place of rest (v) Foremost— Most important.

The stone as a combat weapon could only
harm or kill one person depending on the power of
the thrower. The primitive catapult had slightly
little more effective destructive power. The bow
and arrow yet had more destructive advantage

than the catapult as the poisoned arrow
surpassed the ordinary arrow in destructiveness.
The sword welded skilfully destroys more than the
cutlass. The advent of the gun and bullet weapon
has since meant more easy mass destruction of
lives within a shorter time than previously.

Bombs, nuclear bombs and lethal chemicals
are the easiest and most effective destructive
instruments or annihilation.

SENIOR SCHOOL CERTIFICATE EXAMINATION (SSCE 1988 – 2015)

Past Questions with Solutions

English Language

(Theory / Objectives with Oral English) 1996

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SSCE JUNE 1996 ENGLISH LANGUAGE 2 OBJECTIVE TEST QUESTIONS

In each of the following sentences, there is one word or group of words underlined and one gap. From the list of words lettered A to E, choose the word or group of words that is most nearly opposite in meaning to the underlined word and that will at the same time, correctly fill the gap in the sentence.

SECTION 1

1. There is no doubt that pride is less desirable a quality than.....
A. arrogance B. honesty C. tenderness
D. efficiency E. humility
2. Few people prefer the rural the to.....the areas
A. urban B. pastoral C. rustic D. central E. modern
3. Emeka is quite refined in his manners but his colleague is rather.....
A. arrogant B. crude C. courtly D. cultured
E. unskilful
4. Instead of helping to preserve our culture, the youth engage in activities that.....it
A. denounce B. alter C. conserve D. destroy
E. remove
5. We should regard donations as..... and not compulsory
A. mandatory B. necessary C. voluntary
D. gratuitous E. obligatory
6. The affluence of the politicians contrasts with theof the masses
A. poverty B. paucity C. misery D. plenty
E. suffering
7. The importation of rice is permitted while that of wheat is.....
A. allowed B. suspended C. licensed D. inhibited
E. prohibited
8. The goal lifted the team from the agony of defeat to the.....of victory
A. hope B. desire C. celebration D. ceremony
E. ecstasy

9. One species of the animal has gone into extinction while the other is still in.....
A. antiquity B. execution C. oblivion D. irrelevance
E. existence
10. The Council ratified the controversial recommendation which we thought would be.....
A. refuted B. rejected C. authenticated
D. corroborated E. reviewed

SECTION 2

*From the words lettered A to E, choose the word that **best completes** each of the following sentences*

11. He was sent to the Remand Home in the hope that the place would.....him
A. reform B. amend C. improve D. renovate
E. commend
12. Since there was no further comments the chairman called for the.....of the minutes of the last meeting
A. objection B. resolution C. admission
D. adoption E. correction
13. There was a ten-minute.....during the stage-performance of the play
A. interim B. interview C. interlude D. interplay
E. intercession
14. The judge restrained the landlord from..... the tenant
A. ejecting B. sacking C. dismissing D. punishing
E. attacking
15. The soldiers pledged their.....loyalty to their commander
A. divided B. unalloyed C. enormous D. effective
E. remarkable
16. Many children are suffering from.....because of poor feeding
A. maltreatment B. meningitis C. hepatitis
D. conjunctivitis E. malnutrition
- 17.
18. The audience gave the actor a standing for his beautiful performance
A. proclamation B. appraisal C. ovation

D. reward E. clapping

19. If the customer fails to honour his pledge again, his will surely be in doubt
A. responsibility B. validity C. credulity
D. credibility E. ability
20. The judge warned that he would not tolerate any interruption of the of the court
A. proceeds B. deliberations C. debates
D. proceedings E. processions

SECTION 3

*After each of the following sentences, a list of possible interpretations of the sentence is given. Choose the interpretation that you consider **most appropriate** for each sentence*

21. I can make a little out of Tolu's story. This means that
A. I don't understand Tolu's story
B. I quite appreciate Tolu's story
C. Tolu's story is unreliable
D. Tolu's story is biased
22. Bola promised to pay Sade in her own coin. This means that Bola
A. will return Sade's coin
B. defaulted in the repayment of a loan from Sade
C. took a loan from Sade
D. threatened to take revenge on Sade
23. Contrary to our expectations, the principal rose to the occasion. This means that the principal
A. was the chairman of the occasion
B. made the most beautiful speech at the occasion
C. proved himself able to handle the situation
D. was invited as the guest-of-honour despite our objection
24. The workers accused the manager of lying to take the bread out of their mouth. This means that the manager
A. wanted to deprive them of their means of livelihood
B. was very selfish
C. did not tolerate lazy workers
D. did not show enough sympathy with problems
25. The journalist said his story on the minister was made from observation at close quarters. This means that the
A. journalist wrote the story within short notice
B. story was based on an interview conducted in the minister's quarters

C. journalist had access to certain confidential materials

D. journalist observed the minister intimately

26. Amaka was the cynosure of all eyes at the party. This means that
A. everybody looked down at her
B. everybody was surprised that she attended the party
C. she was notorious for her behaviour
D. she attracted everybody's attention
27. Olu often goes about with a chip on his shoulder. This means that Olu
A. behaves in a very rude manner
B. looks exactly like his father
C. moves about with the injury on his shoulder
D. walks with an air of pride and defiance
28. Adamu just can't help giving alms to the poor. This means th'antAdamu.
A. gives alms to the poor compulsively
B. thinks poor people do not deserve pity
C. helps the poor only
D. does and give alms to the poor
29. On a crucial issue like this, I am sure that Peter, as usual, will sit on the fence. This means that Peter will
A. speak out his true feelings
B. not commit himself to any side
C. be relaxing in his house instead of speaking out
D. sit on the wall between the two parties.
30. When Nosa applied for a loan, the bank manager requested him to put his cards on the table. This means that
A. the bank manager requested for a bribe
B. Nosa should show that he has the ability to repay the money
C. Nosa should state openly and honestly what he needed the loan for
D. the bank manager is unwilling to grant Nosa any loan
31. Considering that he earns a very fat salary, the engineer ought to have built a house by now. This means that the engineer
A. has not built a house because he is still considering his salary
B. has not built a house though he earns a handsome salary
C. will spend all the money he earns if he wants to build a house
D. wants to build a house but he has not earned sufficient money.

32. John is too courageous a man to be dispirited by that setback. This means that John
 A. experienced some difficulties but is still determined to succeed
 B. gave up after the setback
 C. lost the will to continue after the difficulties he encountered
 D. gave up the struggle because he did not have enough courage
33. Hassan should have had that promotion. This means that Hassan
 A. has had the promotion
 B. will have the promotion
 C. will not have had the promotion
 D. did not have the promotion
34. By December this year, I shall have moved from Ibadan to Port Harcourt. This means that I will
 A. move from Ibadan after this December
 B. be in Ibadan until the end of December
 C. be in Port Harcourt this December
 D. move to Port Harcourt after this December.

SECTION 4

*From the words or group of words lettered A to E below each of the following sentences, choose the one that is **nearest in meaning** to the underlined word or group of words as it is used in the sentence*

35. The minister explained that the execution of the project had been impeded by lack of funds
 A. terminated B. suspended C. banned
 D. cancelled E. hindered
36. The clerk was dismissed for dereliction of duty
 A. insubordination B. irresponsibility C. laziness
 D. dishonesty E. negligence
37. We had to prevail upon to accept the offer
 A. persuade B. over-rule C. cajole D. provoke
 E. force
38. He worked very hard all through his life but he died in penury
 A. affluence B. disillusionment C. poverty
 D. disappointment E. sickness
39. Mountaineering is really an arduous exercise
 A. a troublesome B. a strenuous C. a severe
 D. a heavy D. an enjoyable
40. He was so engrossed in his reading that he didn't notice when I entered
 A. absolved B. excited C. thrilled D. absorbed
 E. fascinated

41. All that were left after the riots were the charred remains of vehicles and houses
 A. broken B. burnt C. n'tten D. ugly E. looted hat
42. The manager warned the workers that the company would no longer tolerate their incessant demand for salary increase
 A. unnecessary B. irresponsible C. discourteous
 D. unreasonable E. frequent
43. The social critic was asked to recant the allegationshe made against the government
 A. withdraw B. confirm C. substantiate
 D. elaborate E. recount
44. The politidan has an inordinate ambition to rule the country
 A. incredible B. unwarranted C. erratic D. obtuse
 E. excessive
45. The robber's two jail terms are to run concurrently
 A. consecutively B. conspicuously C. consistently
 D. alternatively E. simultaneously

46. A journalist would do well not to express prejudicial view
 A. unbiased B. coloured C. biased D. hostile
 E. spiteful
47. A reasonable man will never refuse to review his action if it becomes necessary
 A. re-examine B. inspect C. reverse
 D. recapitulate E. visualize.

SECTION 5

*From the words or group of words lettered A to D, choose the one that **best completes** each of the following sentences.*

48. His account of the incident isn't true, he just.....
 A. made it up B. made it out C. made it on
 D. made it off
49. The newly married couple are not.....with each other
 A. getting by B. getting along C. getting through
 D. getting fine
50. Ibrahim is gradually.....his problems
 A. pulling over B. pulling off C. pulling through
 D. pulling out
51. Jide was absent from the meeting yesterday
 A. didn't he? B. isn't it? C. wasn't it?
 D. wasn't he?

52. He got into trouble in an attempt to conceal the truth.....me
A. to B. against C. for D. from
53. He was accompanied.....his friend to the party
A. with B. by C. over D. around
54. My father said he once saw snake.....a chicken
A. having swallowing B. swallowed
C. being swallowed D. swallowing
55. Mary.....passed the examination without the extra lessons she had
A. might not B. couldn't have C. would not
D. will not have
56. Many people are now used to..... without lunch
A. have gone B. be going C. going D. to
57.round the house, I observed that there were more broken louvres than had been reported
A. Moved B. In moving C. To move D. Moving
58. The beleaguered soldiers skilfully.....themselves out of trouble
A. dispatched B. catapulted C. manoeuvred
D. proceeded
59.so dejected, he decided to stay at home,
A. Been B. Having being C. Being D. Having been
60. How wish she.....the note in time
A. has seen B. sees C. has seen D. see
61. The principal, with all the teachers and students
A. has arrived B. were arriving C. have arrived
D. were to arrive
62. What.....these last three years?
A. are you doing with yourself
B. have you been doing with yourself
C. you have been doing with yourself
D. had you being doing with yourself
63. The government has been urged to provide more facilities for training.....
A. physically disableds and mentally retardeds
B. the physically disableds and mentally retardeds
C. the physically disabled and mentally retarded
D. physically disabled and mentally retarded
64. I am looking forward.....from you before long
A. of hearing B. to hear C. for hearing
D. to hearing
65. The road cannot be constructed without
A. those huge earth-moving machines
B. huge machines those earth moving
C. those earth-moving huge machines
D. machines those huge earth-moving
66. It was reported that he stole the radio
A. didn't he? B. wasn't it? C. doesn't he?
D. wasn't he?
67. He willed his property to the poor
A. isn't it? B. didn't he? C. didn't it?
D. doesn't he?
68. I would think Sam is.....to join the senior football team
A. so much good B. good enough C. more good
D. as good
69. Tolu: I like playing table-tennis Yemi:
A. So am I B. Also I do C. I am too D. So do I
70. The bicycle.....on the wet grass for several days
A. has been lying B. has laid C. is been lying
D. have been lying
71. Didn't I give Ada the pen a while ago?
A. Yes you didn't B. No you didn't
C. Yes, you did D. No she didn't
72. You didn't knock before you entered
A. did you? B. isn't it? C. is it? D. were you?
73. Our tour of London came to an end all..... soon
A. very B. much C. rather D. too
74. Ranti: 'Must we finish cracking all the nuts before noon?' Ike: No, we
A. mustn't B. needn't C. shouldn't D. couldn't
75. Each of the players.....to receive a gift of-
₦10,000.00
A. are B. were C. is D. have

*In the following passages the numbered gaps indicate missing words. Against each number in the list below each passage, five choices are offered in columns lettered A to E. For each question choose the word that is the **most suitable** to fill the numbered gap in the passage.*

PASSAGE

If the advantages of international trade and division of labour are as strong and —76— as economists assert, the student of international trade may well be puzzled by the —77— to which governments impose —78— on their —79—

trade. The actions of governments, however, are not swayed entirely by economic —80—. When a country aims at economic self sufficiency, the reasons are generally --81—. For example, a country may wish to —82— its farming industry in order to be able to feed itself in time of war, or it may try to build an iron and —83—industry as part of an —84— programme.

If a conference is called to consider a reduction of —85—, a country that had imposed no restrictions on imports would find itself at a —86—, since it would have no —87— to offer.

he was carried on a —97— to the special care —98— where those under —99— care are kept. The doctor asked the nurses to keep the patient under close —100—

68. A	69. d	70. C	71. D	72. E
Military	Psychiatry	Paediatrics	Zoology	Casualty
drivers	vicarines	microtisis	comitids	culprits
examined	inspected	tested	consulted	healed
biological	shotgun	scientific	clinical	pathological
barometer	odometer	speedometer	ammeter	thermometer
microscope	heliotrope	stethoscope	horoscope	telescope
xerox	x-ray	xylophone	heat rays	sun rays
Antimalaria	immunization	Pathological	Antibiotics	Catalina
decorated	plastered	rinsed	bathed	dressed
sketcher	policy	bird	coffin	room
house	ward	coll	compartment	intensive
critical	fetal	potent	serious	confinement
restriction	diagnosis	observation	inspection	

WASSCE JUNE 1996 ENGLISH LANGUAGE 1 OBJECTIVE TEST ANSWERS

1.E	2.A	3.B	4.D	5.C	6.A	7.E
8.E	9.E	10.B	11.A	12.D	13.C	14.A
15.B	16.E	17.A	18.C	19.D	20.D	21.A
22.D	23.C	24.A	25.D	26.D	27.D	28.A
29.B	30.C	31.B	32.A	33.D	34.C	35.E
36.E	37.A	38.C	39.B	40.D	41.B	42.E
43.A	44.E	45.E	46.C	47.C	48.A	49.B
50.C	51.D	52.D	53.B	54.D	55.B	56.C
57.D	58.C	59.D	60.C	61.A	62.B	63.C
64.D	65.A	66.B	67.B	68.B	69.D	70.A
71.C	72.A	73.D	74.A	75.C	76.A	77.E
78.E	79.B	80.D	81.E	82.C	83.A	84.E
85.A	86.B	87.C	88.E	89.B	90.A	91.D
92.E	93.C	94.B	95.D	96.E	97.A	98.B
99.E	100.C					

PASSAGE B

I made a visit to the University Teaching Hospital the other day. At the —88— Department where accident —89— are treated, the doctors were battling to save the life of a man who had just been knocked down in a road accident. They —90— the injured man thoroughly with the aid of several —91— instruments such as the —92— used in measuring body temperature and the —93— used in listening to the sound of the heart and the lungs. By using —94—, several internal parts of the patient's body were photographed —95— and pain-killing injections were given. His bleeding was stopped. The nurses —96— his wounds and

WASSCE JUNE 1996 ENGLISH LANGUAGE 1 THEORY QUESTIONS

- You are the chief speaker in a debate on the topic: Female children are more beneficial than male children to their parents. Write out your speech for or against the motion.
- The performance of your country in a recent international sports competition has generated a lot of comments. Write a letter to the editor of one of your national newspapers discussing the factors responsible for the level of performance and the lessons that should be learnt.
- A foreign magazine has requested articles on some traditional ceremonies of your people. Write your contribution describing any one ceremony such as marriage, funeral or child-naming.
- You had a quarrel with a very good friend of yours sometime ago and since then both of you have not been on speaking terms. Write a letter to him

or her expressing your regret at the break in your relationship and your desire for a reconciliation.

- You were among a group of students from your school who went on an excursion to places of interest in your country. Narrate to your classmate who did not go what you saw in at least two of the places visited and how you have benefitted from the experience.
- Write an article for publication in a national newspaper discussing the causes and consequences of the excessive desire for material wealth among Nigerians.

PART B
SECTION I
COMPREHENSION

7. *Read the following passage carefully and answer the questions on it.*

We are today faced with a great ecological problem for which we are largely responsible. The planet, Earth, the only home of man is bathed in a steady rain of the sun's rays. Most of these rays supply us heat and light, but a small percentage is deadly. These are the ultraviolet - B rays (or UV-B). If these were to get to the surface of the earth directly, they would kill us off. Luckily, the earth surface is shielded from these rays by the ozone layer, but sadly enough this ozone layer is being destroyed by man.

The ozone layer is formed from a kind of oxygen with three atoms (O_3) instead of the normal two (O_2). Ozone occurs naturally in the stratosphere, several kilometres above the earth's surface. It absorbs the dangerous UV - B rays but allows the much needed and safe light to pass through. There in the stratosphere, it is constantly being created by the sun's ray, thus it is a self repairing shield. But man is now gradually destroying this vital shield with his industrial gases. The most lethal of these gases are the chlorofluoro-carbons, or CFC, which are used in making all kinds of foamed plastic products, propellants in spray cans, coolants in air conditioners and refrigerators and solvents to clean electronic equipment.

Down here, they are not lethal. But after they have leaked from air conditioners, plastic foam, cups, etc., they slowly drift up to the stratosphere where, bombarded by ultraviolet rays, they break up at last, releasing chlorine, the real ozone killer. Sadly, one chlorine molecule may remain active for a century, destroying thousands of ozone molecules.

- (a) What is the greatest ecological problem which man faces today?
- (b) (i) What is the ozone layer made of? (ii) Where is it normally found?
- (c) Describe the importance of the ozone layer,
- (d) How is man destroying the ozone layer?
- (e) Give the name of a gas specifically mentioned as very dangerous to the ozone layer
- (f) What kind of figurative expression is: The planet Earth, the only home of man, is bathed in a steady rain of the sun's rays?
- (g) which are used in making all kinds of foamed plastic products (i) What grammatical name is given to this expression? (ii) What is its function in the sentence?
- (h) For each of the following words, find another word or phrase that means the same and can

replace it as used in the passage (i) shielded (ii) absorbs (iii) vital (iv) lethal (v) active.

8. *Read the following passage carefully and answer the questions on it*

What is efficient reading? Basically, it involves the ability to read through a passage fairly quickly and the ability to understand what has been read. It is a mark of intellectual immaturity to hold on to a passage for hours without being able to make meaning out of it. Also, it is a mark of bad reading not to be able to recall and discuss what has been read.

The foregoing has however, put the issue rather too simply. The ability to read through a passage at a good rate can be attained only after a mastery of the grammatical structures of the language. Without a sound mastery of words and how they function under various situations, and understanding how sentences are generated, one cannot read even the simplest passage efficiently. Rather, failure would ever dog one's footsteps.

Considering the issue from another perspective, merely mastering the vocabulary and structure of the language is not enough. The reader's frame of mind is equally important. Think of a man who is disturbed by the death of a dear one. Such a man would not be able to concentrate on the reading task. If the death of the dear one is still fresh, he might read through a passage several times without understanding it. On the other hand, if the reader is too excited, he might not be able to concentrate.

Take the case of a man who has just read in the newspaper that he has won a handsome sum of money. If he has to read a passage, he may not be able to concentrate.

Furthermore, the physical state of the body affects one's ability to read efficiently. So also does the presence or absence of distractions. This is why it is best to read when the body is still fresh, and in a place far from noise and other distractions.

- (a) According to the passage, what is efficient reading?
- (b) State any two language skills that are essential for efficient reading?
- (c) State any two other factors that affect a reader's understanding of a passage
- (d) The reader's frame of mind: (i) What grammatical name is given to describe the above expression? (ii) What is its function in the sentence?
- (e) What figure of speech is the expression 'failure would ever dog one's footsteps'?
- (f) For each of the following words, find another word or phrase that means the same and can

replace it as used in the passage: (i) immaturity
(ii) sound (iii) generated (iv) perspective (v)
handsome.

SECTION II SUMMARY

Read the following passage carefully and answer the questions on it.

Of all the banes confronting the economies of developing nations, not in the least in seriousness is inconsistency in policy. Apart from the quite obvious factor of frequent changes of governments in these countries, a phenomenon which invariably tolls the death knell of existing policies each time a government is swept out of office, even stable government themselves seem to have a knack to modifying policies frequently. A leader of government is often regarded as radical and hence popular, when he shakes up his cabinet. Such shake-ups often lead to a change of policy.

Quite often, such avoidable changes reflect the shifts in the leaders' friendship patterns in the third world countries, a position at the top attracts large number of friends, a phenomenon which engenders keen rivalry for attention among the friends. Back-biting is hence not uncommon, and a favourite who is today regarded with an office may easily get the boot tomorrow.

Besides the poor economic situation, a common cause of social unrest, brings about frequent changes in policy. An economic policy which does not produce the expected result within a short time is usually thrown out, often with the initiators of the policy. Sadly though the fault lies not so much with the policy as with factors both within and outside, beyond the operators. The truth here is that failure tends to rush leaders into taking rash actions which result in further damage.

Finally, quite a number of the sharp changes are dictated, or at least influenced from outside. In a situation where a weak country decides to embrace a stronger one, it has to contend with some dictation from the stronger partner. To reach an agreement with another country necessarily means modifying operations at home in so far as the agreement affects activities

Frequent changes in policy harm development far more than is realized. Apart from the financial wastage brought about by the sudden abandonment of projects when new rulers assume office, the resulting sense of insecurity scares off foreign investors. Besides, inconsistency of policy hinders the concentration of effort on specific projects. Moreover, the frequent abandonment of projects mid-stream, especially those being executed under international agreements, tends to suggest to aid

donors and leaders that the beneficiaries are not serious. And potential donors and leaders prefer dealing with serious-minded and committed leaders.

(a) In three sentences, one for each, state the factors responsible for frequent changes in policy

(b) In three sentences, one for each, state the results of the frequent change in policy

WASSCE JUNE 1996 ENGLISH LANGUAGE 1 THEORY ANSWERS

1. FEMALE CHILDREN ARE MORE BENEFICIAL TO PARENTS THAN MALES

Mr Chairman, Distinguished Listeners, Ladies and Gentlemen, good day to you all. I stand before you at this august occasion to propose the motion which states that: Female children are more beneficial than male children to their parents. The reasons for my stand are discussed below.

Firstly, female children are more useful to their parents than male children from the domestic point of view. From the age of two, female children begin to show traits of industry. They start to help their parents in domestic chores such as cooking, fetching water, washing plates, washing clothes and dresses, ironing and mopping of floors. On the other hand male children are not helpful to their parents at all. This is because they are fond of playing football about. They only return home to eat when they are hungry. But the food they eat is prepared by female children.

Secondly, parents in some parts of Nigeria receive huge amount of money as 'bride price' on their female children. In some parts of the Middle Belt and Eastern Nigeria, over one hundred and fifty thousand naira is paid on a single girl by the suitor. In most cases, the money is spent by the parents to provide accommodation or to educate the younger members of the family.

Perhaps such parents would have never attempted to build a house of their own if not for the large sum of money they get as 'bride price' on their girls. The opposite is the case for the parents of the groom who pay heavily to bring a female child to their homes. Such, if not well done can cause the groom's parents financial difficulties. Who says female children are no assets to their parents?

Thirdly, female children are more sympathetic to parents than male children, particularly at old age. Once a male child is married, it is believed that he has got a family of his own therefore he is less interested. When interested in the affairs of his parents.

He considers such a secondary importance. A female child even when married is still much sympathetic to her parents. She knows what to do to get money from her husband to cater for her parents. From time to time she goes to see to the welfare of her parents. However, when a male child sees his wife and children, he believes he is complete, that is why men travel for years without checking their parents' welfare.

Furthermore, female children are more beneficial than male children to their parents. Male children are open to danger and risk. They often embark on dangerous activities such as violence, secret cult and so on. Such activities are easily detected by the law enforcement agents and the repercussion is mass arrest. When arrested, the parents are thrown into confusion, they begin to borrow to bail out their male children from detention. On the other hand, female children are different. They comport themselves, and do not engage in risky ventures and never put their parents in financial difficulties. So from the above analysis one will know that female children are more beneficial than male children as the former give rest of mind to their parents than the latter. That is the more reason why parents of mostly male children are afraid of going on long journey due to mischievous activities of their boys, not girls.

Ladies and Gentlemen, my learned opponent submitted that male children are more beneficial than female ones because they retain their parents names after marriage, but I beg to disagree. This is so because there is nothing so special about names. I think that the concept of a 'compound name' is now gaining ground all over the world. This is the combination of a female's maiden name and that of the husband family such as Mrs C. O. Banjo - Coker, Mrs Kuforiji - Olubi, etc. Essentially, highly educated Nigerian women now combine their maiden names with their husbands' family names.

Mr. Chairman, Distinguished Ladies and Gentlemen, there is no iota of doubt in my mind that I have convinced the audience, including the doubting Thomases, beyond every shadow of doubt that female children are more beneficial more, sympathetic, more generous and less troublesome than their male counterparts to their parents.

Bunmi Omole,
Ifako International School,
Agege.

2.

P.O. Box,
Agege,
Lagos State,
1st July, 1996.

The Editor,
The Guardian,
Lagos.

Dear Sir,

PERFORMANCE OF NIGERIAN SPORTSMEN AND WOMEN AT THE LAST OLYMPIC GAMES

There is no gainsaying the fact that Nigeria had her best outing in the 1996 Olympic Games in Atlanta, Georgia, United States of America. Of course, the whole world turned its attention towards the success story of the Nigerian contingent particularly the soccer squad that did not only win the gold medal but defeated the two soccer giants of the world. They wallopped Brazil and I Argentina in the semi-final and final respectively. Also, for the first time in the history of Olympic Games Nigeria won gold, silver and bronze medals in many field and track events. It is now on record that Nigeria is not only a force to be reckoned within international sports but that she has come of age. Many factors largely contributed to the success story of Nigeria.

Firstly, availability of equipment and materials needed for training by foreign-based athletes. Most of the medals won were by foreign based professional sportsmen and women. They were those based in USA, Italy, Germany, Britain and other European countries where training facilities are at their best. T-here was no single locally- trained athlete that won any individual medal.

Secondly, the successes of Nigerian athletes were made possible due to technical expertise of foreign coaches and technical advisers in various sports. The foreign coaches and technical advisers are better exposed than their local counterparts to modern techniques in coaching. The foreign-based coaches also have better and modern facilities to train athletes than their local counterparts who rely soley on out-modelled techniques and facilities.

Thirdly, Nigeria recorded her victory at the last Olympics due to large number of able athletes. Nigeria is thickly populated, so there are good number of sportsmen and women who were discovered during national and international competitions prior to the actual Olympic Games. The sound preparations availed the country to field her best during the competitions.

Nigerians learnt a lot of lessons from the last Olympic Games. Topmost of them is that sound preparation is the main key to success in international sporting engagements and this is best realised through availability of technical knowhow such as qualified, dedicated and exposed coaches and technical advisers. We have now known that it is high time we had ultra modern stadia with modern equipment and facilities to train our athletes locally.

Also, we have learnt that no country in the world, no matter how powerful, has absolute monopoly of sports. The countries which in the past were regarded as unbeatable in some sports were not only beaten but disgraced by Nigeria. Moreover Nigerians have learnt that dedication and will-power are needed to achieve excellence in sports and not necessarily extravagant spending to entertain or lure athletes.

In conclusion, there is no doubt in my mind that our leaders will learn a great deal from the last Olympic Games, in terms of sound preparation, availability of experienced and tested coaches, provision of standard stadia with training facilities and organisation of local and international meets in games and sports. If well done and the suggestions adhered to, Nigeria has, come of age to lead the world in international sporting activities.

Yours faithfully,
N. R. Odu.

3. MARRIAGE CEREMONY AMONG YORUBA

The Yoruba people live in the South Western part of Nigeria. They number about thirty million people. The Yoruba people are very ceremonious indeed, they celebrate every event from birth to grave. They are very lively and homogenous. This write-up will focus on marriage ceremony among the Yoruba people.

Marriage is one of the important ceremonies in Yorubaland. The people are traditionally polygamous in nature, except few of the educated elite who practise monogamy. Marriage ceremony itself can be divided into three stages. They are the pre-ceremony stage, the introduction and the actual marriage ceremony. Even those who ignore traditional marriage cannot but undergo certain traditional steps before their marriage can be complete.

The first step is when a young man sees a lady of his choice. Then he informs his own father who will in turn contact a respectable member of the lady's family to break the news. This is behind

the stage action as the two of them (lovers) cannot face each other to utter a word. After the contact, if the latter's family agrees, then the two will now see and talk to each other for the first time. At this stage the family of the boy will bring a gourd of palm wine with three heads of kolanut to the lady's family. Their acceptance of this gift is an indication that the girl has agreed to marry the boy. Regularly, the family of the boy goes to help the lady's family to farm.

After some years, then comes the introduction. The introduction to the would-be spouse in itself is a great ceremony when the family of the man comes with a large number of people to that of the lady. They will bring with them a lot of things which are traditionally symbolic. These include yam tubers, salt, fruits, palm oil, alligator pepper, kolanut and so on. The most symbolic of the gifts are kolanut which pushes evil away, alligator pepper which has hundreds of seeds that symbolise fertility for the wife. The family members of the man are introduced first while those of the lady follow. The family of the bride prepares a special delicacy - pounded yam with 'bush meat' to feed their guests. Here the lady is formally asked whether she will marry the man thrice. If she says 'yes' the whole family of the groom, irrespective of the age, will prostrate flat on the ground thrice. This is an indication that they begged the parents before she was given to them. The actual marriage ceremony lasts seven days. Usually in the night, the bride may not be aware, she would be tempted to come out of her house and the special age grade grip her and carry her up in the sky. If she does not struggle with them, they allow her to walk on her own till she reaches the husband's house but if she proves recalcitrant, they punish her severely before they get to her husband's house. The following morning a large number of housewives from the bride's family will bring her personal effects for the ceremony. The new wife is to enjoy seven days of grace, during which she cannot do anything by custom. They bathe her and feed her as well. The bride dances while the groom too dances. It is a daily affair.

On the third day of marriage ceremony, the groom ceeps with the bride for the first time. If the bride is a virgin, some cotton wool is used to soak the blood of virginity and sent to the family of the bride. Virginity is a pre-condition to honouring father and mother - in-law in the olden days. A lot of gifts are sent to show that the parents kept their daughter intact; but if not a virgin, disgraceful gifts such as half-filled keg of palmwine, half-filled match box are sent to the bride's family, a symbol of being over used before giving them. On the

seventh day the bride dances with a large number of admirers from her husband's house to her father's house.

Another feast is made by her parents to entertain the large crowd that follow her. This is supposed to be her last journey to the father's house. This time she carries all her personal effects and other valuables back to her husband's place at night while going back. It is customary that on her return she should never meet her husband at home. It is an age-long tradition which has no rational explanation.

In conclusion, traditional ceremony, if well handled, is by far more interesting than the modern wedding which is alien to us as Africans. In Yorubaland, a woman does this once in her life time, whereas the man can do it as many times as he can afford as polygamy is the order of the day in traditional Yoruba society.

Toyin Ogunmodede,
Ifako International School,
Box 22,
Agege.

4. P.O.Box 1,
Ikeja,
Lagos State,
10th July, 1996.

Dear Fred,

It's a pity we have kept each other at arm's length since our misunderstanding started some six months ago. You see we've allowed Satan to rule our hearts. By the way, who ever knew we could be at daggers drawn at each other? I have tried as a good friend to put the past behind us by writing to you a letter to explain my action but I've not yet got any reply.

I'm writing this letter to express my regret at the break in our relationship. You see, I never knew the worth of our friendship until its collapse. I've seen a lot and I've heard a lot as well since the problem began. The new boy I move with now is not only a deceit but a rogue. He's trying to teach and initiate me into series of vices such as lying, stealing and truancy. Of course, bad company corrupts good manner. He teaches me how to cheat to pass any examination by hook or crook. Indeed I'm tired of his company.

My association with this stupid boy has landed me in detention twice in three months. For over six years of my friendship with you a similar dangerous occurrence never reared its ugly head. You see, it was the boy who misinformed me about you and this has made me

a victim of circumstances. I'm now lonely and have nobody to revise or study with. Since our problem started, my performances in my studies are nothing to write home about. There's nobody to help me in difficult subjects like Physics and Further Mathematics. Indeed I've lost a great deal from our sour relationship.

Fred, I've slept over the matter and I've come to the conclusion that I should first tender my unreserved apology to you for the ugly incident that led to your indefinite suspension in your school. I've finally found out the truth that you're not in any way connected with the misfortune that befell me.

Furthermore, I now desire a quick reconciliation to end the deadlock. We should not allow Satan a chance, otherwise it will create everlasting enmity between us, thus becoming bitter enemies. As soon as practicable I want everything to come back to normalcy so that we can both enjoy good companionship which has eluded us for months.

I will take this golden opportunity to invite you to my forthcoming birthday party which comes up on 3rd August 1996 at my father's compound. Let us take the opportunity afforded by the birthday to bury the hatchet once and for all.

I do hope your parents are doing fine in Jos. Will you go there for the next long vacation? As for me I will stay in Lagos to attend extra mural classes as part of the strategies to pass my final examinations in flying colours. Once again let bygones be bygones. See you during the birthday party. A reply to this letter is highly necessary to enable me plan ahead.

Your loving friend,
Babs.

5. THE WONDERFUL EXCURSION

I was among the Geography students who travelled on excursion to places of interest between June 1 and 4, 1996. The excursion though the first of its kind in my life but the echoes will linger on in my memory for a long time to come. A week before the excursion I had begun to dream about what to see and experience. I was the first of the fifty excursionists to pay the fees of five hundred naira. I couldn't sleep on the eve of the excursion as I was gripped with anxiety about the trip to Wonderland.

At seven O'clock in the morning of June 1 1996 we assembled in front of Mr. J. O. Babalakudi's house, our senior Geography master. Two chartered Coaster buses drove in. The teacher gave us a lecture to prepare our mind

about the journey. He mentioned Kainji Dam, Ajaokuta Iron and Steel Industry and Sugar Factory at Bacita among other places to visit. After a short paper the journey commenced at eight on the dot.

Of course, that was my first time of travelling on a long journey of this type, so everything was new to me. Our students in the two buses were busy singing melodious choruses as if we were on sacred pilgrimage to the holy land. I couldn't sleep in the bus at all as all of us joined in singing the songs. The first thing I discovered was the disappearance of forest towards inland. In less than two hours we had passed Ibadan, the largest town in black Africa. The traffic congestion at Ibadan was chaotic. Infact, worse than that of Lagos. It was as a result of a road accident which involved two trucks which has a head-on-collision. It took us two hours to get out of the traffic mess. Between Ibadan and Ilorin we saw some important towns like Iwo, Ogbomosho and Oyo. We had a brief stop-over at Ilorin to have our lunch at Kwara Hotel. The food there was cheaper by far compared to Lagos. It was only thirty naira a plate for students and fifty naira for others. At six O'clock in the evening we arrived at New Bussa Hotel where we lodged for the night.

On Tuesday after our breakfast of egg, tea and bread we made straight to Kainji Dam, a journey of less than thirty minutes. At the dam, we were conducted round by their public relations officer Alhaji Dodo. The man was very jovial and highly experienced in his job. He conducted us round the major units of the dam specially built in 1968 for generation of hydro electricity. We took numerous photographs. It was a multi-billion naira project. He took us to the power house where eight large engines are installed to generate electricity to Nigeria, Niger and Chad. We asked various questions which were systematically answered by the PRO. He later conducted us round the irrigation project, a subsidiary of the Kainji Dam Authority. At the end, the PRO took us to a large hall where he gave us an hour lecture on the dam and its major functions. He explained why we always have power failure. He attributed it to fluctuating level of water in the dam. We returned at five in the evening when everyone was tired. We had to rely on the snacks supplied by the dam's authority as our lunch. We later took rice and beans as our dinner.

On Wednesday we woke up early to continue our trip to Bacita Sugar Company. At first we were conducted round the sugarcane plantation which I think should be more than seven square kilometres. The plantation was irrigated, we saw clearly how most of what we had

learnt in Agric. Science were practised. We were given some sticks of sugarcane. They tasted better than the ones we used to buy in Lagos. The farm manager called it a special name which I have forgotten. We later drove to the Sugar Factory Complex. It was where about 80% of sugar consumed in Nigeria is manufactured. Producing fifty tons a day. I never knew Nigerians consume so much sugar.

In numerous ways, I benefitted from the experience I had during the trip. Firstly, I saw how many of the laws in Physics were put into a practice particularly those in electricity. Secondly, I knew why we experience power failure often. Thirdly, I knew the history of Niger Basin Authority comprising Nigeria, Mali, Niger and other West African countries. Finally, I saw the various stages of sugar production. Generally, the excursion afforded me first hand information on many things our teachers have taught and what I have read especially in subjects like Geography, Social Studies, Physics, Chemistry and Agric. Science. The experience I had us during the excursion is worth it as it has benefitted me in no small way.

Olufemi Ogunmodede,
SS IIIB.

6. EXCESSIVE DESIRE FOR WEALTH AMONG NIGERIANS

In Nigeria today excessive desire for material wealth is undoubtedly the greatest social ill confronting all - young and old. It is a social disease that has eaten deep into the flesh of our nation. An average school boy in Nigeria is fond of saying he wants. In have private jets, limousine cars, houses with internationally acclaimed architectural designs. Ask him what he intends to do to gain his desires, he has no definite answer. Excessive craze for wealth has given Nigeria a bad name in the comity of nations.

The topmost on the factors responsible for this problem is corrupt leadership. Both civil and military leadership are corrupt. A minister who hardly has a personal car can boast of numerous private jets in less than a year in office. Yet, they are the ones who will condemn excessive desire for material wealth in their speeches at public functions.

Furthermore, greed is another notable factor. It is sheer greed that makes a man have billions of naira through fraudulent nactices. He has private jets, fleet of cars, numerous mansions, has all his children in the most expensive schools on earth.

You ask a question — how many rooms does he want to sleep in at a time? How many vehicles does he ride at a time? Vanity, all is vanity.

Moreover, lack of security is also responsible for excessive acquisition of wealth. In a country where there is no security for the aged, children, women, handicapped and the like, the only alternative is rat race for acquisition of wealth even through dubious means. The government has no plan for anybody, so, everyone has taken it upon himself to struggle for his family. This is not so in advanced countries. In the world where there are securities for all categories of citizens - young, old, widows, unemployed, educated, name them.

The consequences of this excessive desire for material wealth are inimical to the interest of our nation. First, it has led to armed robbery which is now the order of the day in the country. The major targets are the financial institutions like banks. Also, his problem has led to rise in assassinations. This has become a major profession all in the name of acquisition of material wealth. An average Nigerian is now a drug trafficker.

Furthermore, it has given rise to the growth of the popularly called '419' in our society. Young boys and girls now specialize the art of defrauding people through false pretence to acquire wealth at all cost. This has led to falling standard of education as most students now have lukewarm attitude to anything academics but the short cut to become a millionaire. Honesty is no longer a virtue but an act of foolishness. Nigerians now sell their bodies for money. The effects are great as it has brought heart diseases and only a radical revolution can reduce it not theoretical approach at all.

The media houses and the governments at various levels should embark on a nationwide campaign to educate the citizens against excessive desire for material wealth. The public officers should live exemplary and honest life. Anyone found guilty of any act of financial impropriety should be made to face the music. The government should look into how the rich, on individual basis acquire their ill-gotten wealth. To a large extent heavy taxation should be imposed on the propertied class.

In conclusion, I hope the steps will be aimed at correcting the impression that wealth is everything in Nigerian society. Any rich individual should be able to account for his wealth. Finally the state should provide adequate securities for all categories of citizens in our country. With these,

the problem will be drastically reduced if not totally exterminated from our society.

Omodara Yetunde,
Fagba Grammar School,
Agege.

PART B

SECTION 1

COMPREHENSION

7. (a) The greatest ecological problem which man faces today is the exposure of each to ultra violet rays of the sun
(b)(i) Ozone layer is made up of a kind of oxygen with three atoms (ii) Ozone layer is normally found in the stratosphere
(c) The Ozone layer protects the earth from the ultra violet sun rays
(d) Man destroys the ozone layer through industrial gas
(e) Chlorine
(f) Metaphor
(g) (i) adjectival or relative clause (ii) It qualifies the noun "Chlorofluoro carbons" or 'CFCs'
(h) (i) shielded - protected; (ii) absorbs - takes in (iii) vital - beneficial, (iv) lethal - dangerous (v) active – strong
8. (a) Efficient reading is the ability to read through a passage quickly and ability to understand what is read
(b) Two language skills that are essential for efficient reading are:- Mastery of words and how they function;- Understanding how sentences are generated
(c) The two other factors that affect a reader's understanding of a passage are - reader's frame of mind;- the physical state of the body
(d) (i) Noun phrase (ii) Subject of the verb 'is'
(e) personification
(f) (i) immaturity - underdevelopment; (ii) sound - good (iii) generated -formed; (iv) perspective-view point, (v) handsome -large.
9. (a) The factors responsible for frequent changes in policy are (i) frequent changes of government (ii) frequent changes in cabinet (iii) poor economic situation
(b) The result of the frequent changes in policy are: (i) it harms development (ii) financial wastage is experienced (iii) foreign investors are scared off.

WASSCE JUNE 1996 ENGLISH LANGUAGE 3 TEST OF ORALS

(OBJECTIVE TEST)

SECTION 1

From the words lettered A to D, choose the word that has the **same vowel sound** as the one represented by the letter(s) underlined. An example is given below:

Example: seat. A. sit B. cite C. set D. key

The correct answer is D because only key contains the same vowel sound as the one underlined in seat. So answer space D would be shaded.

[A] [B] [C] [D]

Now answer the questions that follow

1. alone. A. heater B. back C. plank D. crawl
2. says A. say B. said C. day D. days
3. coup A. book B. cough C. curve D. who
4. hollow A. fallow B. allow C. follow D. below
5. course A. curse B. cot C. coarse D. worse
6. dull A. doll B. poll C. call D. cull
7. aunt A. pant B. cart C. dont D. ant
8. coin A. lawn B. coy C. alone D. corn
9. sew A. soon B. soar C. so D. soothe
10. they A. there B. their C. day D. den
11. favourite A. kin B. write C. fight D. keen
12. people A. quay B. leopard C. shone D. pip
13. apple A. cater B. fatal C. fact D. fable
14. flour A. flow B. floor C. flush D. flower
15. town A. round B. too C. toe D. low

SECTION 2

From the words lettered A to D, choose the word that has the **same consonant sound(s)** as the one represented by the letter(s) underlined. An example is given below

Example: vice A. cat B. dress C. show D. chalk

The correct answer is B because only dress contains the same consonant sound as the one underlined in vice. So answer space B would be shaded

[A] [B] [C] [D]

Now answer the following questions

16. thing A. thin B. song C. bin D. thigh
17. seize A. sees B. cease C. rush D. talks
18. comb A. home B. rugby C. bubble D. bright
19. cough A. boug B. rugby C. bubble D. bright
20. thought A. taught B. though C. those D. thob
21. Prestige A. ridge B. camouflage C. rebag D. freeze
22. father A. fatter B. murder C. further D. hunter
23. marry A. cart B. bark C. river D. hurl
24. Psalm A. flame B. salt C. physical D. calm
25. watch A. character S stomach C. ritual D. champagne
26. yain A. bane B. faint C. vest D. pain
27. date A. this B. den C. then D. soldier
28. home A. honour B. hour C. heir D. hover

29. get A. ghastly B. gesture C. engine D. neighbour
30. time A. thyme B. dime C. thing D. length

SECTION 3

From the words lettered A to D, choose the word that **rhymes** with the given word. An example is given below:

Example: detain A. obtain B. detail C. claim D. relay.
The correct answer is A because only 'obtain' rhymes with detain. So, answer space A would be shaded

[A] [B] [C] [D]

Now answer the questions that follow

31. catch A. lash B. match C. mast D. harsh
32. home A. roam B. come C. horn D. born
33. born A. money B. bonnet C. home D. run
34. invent A. repent B. invite C. apart D. import
35. reign A. foreign B. morning C. herring D. rain

SECTION 4

In each of the following questions the main! primary stress is indicated by writing the syllable on which it occurs in capital letters, From the words lettered A to D, choose the one that has the **correct stress**. An example is given below

Example: democratic A. DE-mo-cra-tic
B. de-MO-cra-tic C. de-mo-CRA-tic
D. de-mo-cra-TIC

The correct answer is C because, the main! prim stress of the word democratic is on the third syllable. So answer space C would be shaded. [A] [B] [C] [D]

Now, answer the questions that follow

36. humility
A. HU-mi-li-ty B. hu-mi-li-TY
C. hu-MI-li-ty D. hu-mi-LI-ty
37. motivation
A. mo-ti-VA-tion B. mo-TI-va-tion
C. moti-va-TION D. MO-ti-va-tion
38. perishable
A. pe-ri-SHA-ble B. PE-ri-sha-ble
C. pe-ri-sha-BLE D. pe-RI-sha-able
39. perishable
A. pe-ri-SHA-ble B. PE-ri-sha-ble
C. pe-ri-sha-BLE D. pe-RI-sha-ble
40. impossible
A. im-POS-si-ble B. IM-pos-si-ble
C. im-pos-si-BLE D. im-pos-SI-ble

SECTION 5

In the following options fettered A to D, all the words **except one** have the same stress pattern. Identify the one with the different stress pattern and shade your answer in the usual way. An example is given below:

Example: A. away B. apart C. behind D. river
Options A, B, C, are all stressed on the second syllable wh4 option D is the only one stressed on the first syllable. SoD the correct answer and answer space D would be shaded.

[A] {B} [C] [D]

Now, answer the questions that follow:

41. A. remark B. conclude C. command D. number
42. A. public B. concern C. centre D. people
43. A. discomfort B. aggressive C. quality D. dependable
44. A. execute B. exhibit C. exercise D. exodus
45. A demand B. madam C. supply D. request

SECTION 6

In each of the following sentences, the word that receives the emphatic stress is written in CAPITAL LETTERS. From the questions lettered A to D, choose the one to which the given sentence is the appropriate answer. An example is given below:

Example: My mother's FRIEND hates pets A. Does your mother's boss hate pets? B. Does your mother's friend love pets? C. Does your mother's friend hate toys? D. Does your fathers friend hate pets?

The correct answer is A because My mother's FRIEND hates pets answers the question, Does your mother's boss hate pets?

So, answer space A would be shaded

[A] {B} [C] [D]

Now, answer the questions that follow

46. She WORKS at the hospital
A. Who works at the hospital?
B. Where does she work?
C. Does she work at the Post Office?
D. Is she a patient at the hospital?
47. John's watch is made of GOLD
A. Is John's watch made of silver?
B. Whose watch is made of gold?
C. What is made of gold?
D. Is John's necklace made of gold?
48. You must play the tape twice now
A. How many times should I play the tape?
B. Should I play the disc twice?
C. When should she play the tape?

D. Should he play the tape twice?

49. My sister is LEAVING for Jos today?
B. Is my sister arriving from Jos today?
C. Is my sister leaving for Zaria today?
D. Is my sister leaving for Jos tomorrow?
50. The FINAL match of the hockey competition was exciting
A. Was the final match of the hockey competition boring?
B. Was the final match of the football competition exciting?
C. Was the preliminary match of the hockey competition exciting?
D. Was the final football match boring?

SECTION 7

From the words lettered A to D, choose the word that contains the sound represented by the given phonetic symbol. An example s given below:

Example: / ɔ i / A. yell B. holy C. boy D. idiot

The correct answer is C because only boy contains the sound represented by the given symbol. So answer space C would be shaded

[A] {B} [C] [D]

Now, answer the questions that follow:

51. / ɔ i / A. work B. warn C. flog D. wane
52. / æ / A. pack B. perk C. cart D. port
53. / D / A. monday B. cot C. course D. over
54. / I / A. price B. should C. could D. lice
55. / t / A. machine B. cash C. search D. chauffeur
56. / i: / A. rice B. split C. raise D. seal
57. / a: / A. bad B. person C. Clerk D. dock
58. / V / A. phase B. orphan C. off D. or
59. / r / A. worry B. woolly C. curly D. liver
60. / d / A. target B. gesture C. gear D. saboteur

WASSCE JUNE 1996 ENGLISH LANGUAGE 3 TEST OF ORALS OBJECTIVE TEST ANSWERS

1.A	2.A	3.D	4.D	5.C	6.E	7.E
8.E	9.E	10.D	11.B	12.A	13.C	14.C
15.D	16.A	17.C	18.B	19.B	20.D	21.A
22.A	23.C	24.D	25.D	26.C	27.B	28.D
29.C	30.A	31.B	32.A	33.A	34.A	35.B
36.C	37.A	38.A	39.B	40.D	41.D	42.B
43.C	44.A	45.D	46.C	47.A	48.A	49.B
50.C	51.D	52.B	53.A	54.D	55.C	56.D
57.D	58.C	59.B	60.D			

SENIOR SCHOOL CERTIFICATE EXAMINATION (SSCE 1988 – 2015)

Past Questions with Solutions

English Language

(Theory / Objectives with Oral English) 1997

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WASSCE JUNE 1997 ENGLISH LANGUAGE 2

OBJECTIVE TEST QUESTIONS

SECTION 1

*i C in each of the following sentences, there is one word or group of words underlined and one gap. From the list of words lettered A to D, choose the word or group of words that is **most nearly opposite in meaning** to the underlined word and that will, at the same time, correctly fill the gap in the sentence.*

1. The minister was accused of making utterances that could increase rather than.....anxiety among the citizen
A. modify B. diminish C. intensify D. remove
E. inculcate.
2. At the end of the crisis, the leader declared that there was no victor and no.....
A. winner B. rebel C. patriot D. opponent
E. vanquished.
3. I was impressed by the man's eagerness but was rather put off by his wife's.....
A. anxiety B. impatience C. indifference
D. negligence E. calmness
4. He is a famous artist but has a.....drinking habit
A. remarkable B. admirable C. notorious
D. wicked E. hostile
5. The first twin is so vain and the second so..... that one would think they were not brothers
A. proud B. complacent C. selfish D. humble
E. harmless
6. Mary: I wonder why armed robbers are so hard-hearted John: "The fact is that to be an armed robber you cannot be.....
A. considerate B. intolerant C. revengeful
D. softspoken E. grateful
7. To ascend this steep hill is the problem, to..... is quite easy
A. depart B. decline C. drop D. descend
E. disengage
8. Working in the field is easy when your machete is sharp and not when it is.....
A. jagged B. coarse C. sound D. keen E. blunt

9. The gradual process of transition to civil rule came to an.....end
A. unnecessary B. anticipated C. invidious
D. unhappy E. abrupt
10. The exterior and the.....parts1of the fruit remain very hard even after it is ripe
A. inward B. inner C. intrinsic D. peripheral
E. Extraneous

SECTION 2

*From the words labelled A to E, choose the word that **best completes** each of the following sentences*

11. The committee set up to investigate the cause of the riot has called for.....from the public
A. witnesses B. agenda C. reports D. memoranda
E. confessions
12. The Satellite maintains a constant.....round the earth
A. path B. orbit C. circle D. route B. chart
13. The chairman called him to.....when his comments were getting off the point
A. order B. command C. rule D. stop E. question
14. His.....came through only a few days before he was to be executed
A. excuse B. remission C. clearance D. discharge
E. pardon
15. The power failure.....normal services for days
A. activated B. energized C. paralyzed
D. deadened E. frozened
16. The interest of the students should be of..... importance to any school administrator
A. paramount B. super C. superior D. dominant
E. pre-eminent
17. My father wanted to buy a car but the prices of those available were not within his.....
A. limit B. target C. scope D. range E. reach
18. The robbers.....all the rooms, looking for jewels
A. raked B. ransacked C. explored D. sought
E. sacked

19. We reasoned that the kidnappers might kill the young girl if we didn't pay the.....
A. money B. charge C. deposit D. ransom
E. settlement
20. The players would expect some form of.....
after working hard to win the cup
A. compensation B. gain C. reward C. premium
E. fees

21. The surgeons.....the operation successfully
A. transplanted B. executed C. diagnosed
D. transacted B. performed
22. The old man took his sons to the zoo as a special New Year.....
A. treat B. feast C. discourse D. covenant
E. banquet

*After each of the following sentences, a list of possible interpretations of the sentences is given. Choose the interpretation you consider the **most appropriate** for each sentence.*

23. Although Etiebet had earlier insisted that he was right, he later ate his words. This means that he later
A. denying so
B. admitted that he was wrong
C. apologized for being so rude
D. realized that he was more correct he taught
24. The young girl swept the board at the recent competitions. This means that the young girl
A. came last in the competition
B. cleaned the score-board very well
C. won some of the competitions
D. won everything that could be won
25. The listeners were swept off their feet by the politician's arguments. This means that the politician
A. failed to impress the people
B. completely impressed everybody
C. confused all the people
D. told them things they didn't expect
26. I was struck by the broad sweep of her argument. This means that her argument
A. covered all parts of the subject
B. focused only on a specific aspect of the subject
C. was well presented and in good language
D. was poorly presented and not well focused.
27. The party was really going with a swing when somebody called me out. This means that when I was called out the party was

A. just starting B. almost ended C. about mid-way
D. very enjoyable

28. She started the game poorly but later turned the tables on her opponent. This means that, she
A. remained a poor player and lost
B. changed her position of play and so won
C. suddenly improved and won
D. disorganized the whole competition
29. The boys ran away with their tails between their legs. This shows that the boys left
A. as great winners B. completely defeated
C. utterly confused D. after destroying so much
30. He said he was a master of electronics, but I knew he was talking through his hat, This means that I knew he was
A. relying on someone else's ideas
B. merely relying on what he had studied
C. talking very modestly
D. claiming what he knew nothing about
31. My brother's driving could make one tear one's hair out. This means that his driving could make one
A. get very worried B. enjoy one's journey
C. feel very bored D. feel very relaxed
32. It is really hard to come to terms with going blind. This means that if one goes blind one
A. finds it easy to accept
B. has no choice but to adjust
C. finds it difficult to accept
D. gradually gets used to it

*From the words or groups of words labelled A to E below each of the following sentences, choose the word or group of words that is **nearest in meaning** to the underlined word or group of words.*

33. Climbing great heights terrifies me
A. threatens B. annoys C. shocks D. startles
E. frightens
34. Flight WT509 from Lagos terminates in Maiduguri
A. closes B. concludes C. lands D. ends
E. ceases
35. Her terse remarks brought the conversation to an end
A. curt B. abusive C. studied D. gentle E. polished
36. The prison officials usually torture the inmates
A. lynch B. murder C. torment D. destroy
E. humiliate

37. I would regard what he has done as a treacherous act
A. noble B. reliable C. commendable
D. dangerous E. deceitful
38. I don't agree that the problem is intractable
A. easy B. insoluble C. baseless
D. understandable E. unusual
39. This problem may prove rather tricky for the government
A. deceitful B. trivial C. mischievous
D. unexpected E. difficult
40. The long war ended when an armistice was agreed upon
A. a truce B. a recess C. a sun'ender
D. an intermission E. a declaration
41. The assassination of the statesman threw the country into a state of turmoil
A. inactivity B. mourning C. confusion
D. revolution E. anxiety
42. To become an artisan one has to undergo a period of apprenticeship.
A. directorship B. testing C. tutorship D. practice
E. training

SECTION 5

*From the words or group of words labelled A to D, choose the one that **best completes** each of the following sentences*

43. This is an improvement.....your last essay
A. on B. with C. by D. for
44. The team has suffered defeat.....defeat
A. before B. with C. over D. After
45. Unemployment has been.....the increase since last year
A. of B. at C. on D. in
46. Cats sleep.....day and hunt at night
A. at B. by C. in D. during
47. I don't want anything to Interfer..... my project
A. with B. on C. over D. by
48. The two brothers came in.....the back door
A. within B. along C. across D. through
49.the terms of the agreement with your landlord, you should not sub-let the house
A. On B. Under C. Upon D. By

50. Nigeria's economy was buoyant.....the 1970s
A. through B. on C. in D. with
51. The musician.....waxed that record died fifty years ago
A. who B. whom C. which D. Whose
52. The author.....book you are reading now, won the Nobel Prize for Uterature last year.
A. which B. that C. whose D. whom
53. The lady.....you were talking about yesterday is here now
A. which B. whom C. who's D. whose
54. The pencil.....you gave me yesterday is lost
A. whose B. whom C. that D. who
55. I honestly don't undersand.....you hate that man
A. when B. where C. why D. How
56. I'd like to know.....he 'll wriggle out of this case
A. how B whenever C. where D. what
57.of the two pencils is yours?
A. Where B. Who C. Which D. Whose
58.university is.....institution of higherlearning
A. An an B. An a C. A a D.A an
59. I'd give up somking, if I.....you.
A. am B. were C. was D. are
60. It is high time you.....visiting that friend of yours
A. should stop B. stopped C. stop D. Must
61.had he entered when it started to rain
A. Hardly B. Nearly C. Almost D. Fairly
62. All your.....like you very much
A. brother-in-law B. brothers-in-laws
C. brother-in-laws D. brothers-in-law
63. I'm sure this bucket is.....
A. her's B. hers C. hers' D. Her
64. That uncle of.....ought to see you through this
A. your B. your's C. yours D. yours'
65.of what he said is incorrect
A. Many B. Much C. Few D. Plenty
66. He comes here.....often
A. much B. ever C. quite D. rarely
67. He is always asking for more.....?
A. isn't he B. doesn't he C. was he D. does he

68. It was he who said he didn't fear death.....?
A. didn't he B. wasn't he C. isn't he D. wasn't it
69. He said he didn't fear death.....?
A. didn't he B. wasn't it C. doesn't he D. was it
70. The government has a special programme for.....
A. the poor B. the poors C. poor D. poors

SECTION 6

*Instruction: In the following passages the numbered gaps indicate missing words. Against each number in the list below each passage five choices are offered in columns labelled A to E. For each question, choose the word that is the **most suitable** to fill the numbered gap in the passage.*

PASSAGE A

"Now speaking seriously, ladies and —71—" continued the speaker, "it has —72— a tradition for us to welcome new —73— into the administrative —74— of our civil service. This is because of the role which —75— plays in society. It is not only in the civil service that administrators are —76—. Administrative work is going on constantly in the business —77— in the army, the church and in every organization, where human —78— decide to organize themselves for a —79— purpose. Even among doctors, engineers and on the —80— much administration is going on and in fact you cannot be —81— doctor lawyer, engineer or teacher —82— being a good administrator. And now to my young —83— who have newly joined ranks of administrators in our service. I say the sky is the —84— for those who are —85—

	A	B	C	D	E
71.	contemporaries	gentlemen	friends	comrades	well-wishers
72.	formed	seemed	constituted	became	being
73.	directors	applicants	entrants	workmen	operators
74.	cadre	post	group	force	department
75.	dedication	technology	governance	administration	requested
76.	wanted	necessary	needed	demand	world
77.	category	environment	society	community	pe-farmers
78.	honing	people	constitutes	activists	peculiar
79.	private	particular	special	separate	artisans
80.	officers	workers	technicians	professionals	lucky
81.	prosperous	successful	fortunate	victorious	through
82.	without	unlike	unless	except	contemporaries
83.	companions	collaborators	classmates	colleagues	frontier
84.	terminal	and	limit	boundary	industrious
85.	indolent	aggressive	lecherous	busy	

PASSAGE B

When he had finished sweeping the sitting —86—, she took up the slightly moist —87— and used it to wipe off the —88— from the surfaces of the table, chairs, stools and window —89—. After that she adjusted the —90— on the windows and doors and —91— the few books and other items on the table and stools. She then moved to the —92— where the dishes from the previous evenings—93— remained piled up, unwashed. She turned on the —94— and started washing. It took her thirty minutes to turn the dirty plates and —95— into gleaming pieces. She lit the —96—, filled up the —97— from the running tap and put it on the fire. That was for tea. She took a tuber of—98— peeled it clean, and cut it into neat —99—. Then, she commenced the process for making omelette. She cracked open four —100— on to a plate and mixed them thoroughly.

	A	B	C	D	E
86.	room	apartment	corridor	chamber	parlour
87.	sweeper	wiper	cleaner	mop	cluster
88.	mould	mist	dust	sands	powder
89.	frames	bars	glasses	sheets	panels
90.	clothes	curtains	dresses	coverlets	covering
91.	read	wrote	rearranged	compiled	remade
92.	toilet	bedroom	store	pantry	kitchen
93.	breakfast	supper	lunch	food	snacks
94.	tap	switch	knob	handle	key
95.	instruments	implements	cutlery	furniture	utensils
96.	fire	heater	antenn	lamp	stove
97.	plate	kettle	saucepan	frying-pan	warmer
98.	banana	corn	lettuce	yam	cabbage
99.	slices	cubes	chutneys	portions	fragments
100.	coconuts	tomatoes	eggs	onions	palm nuts

WASSCE JUNE 1997 ENGLISH LANGUAGE 2 OBJECTIVE TEST ANSWERS

1.B	2.E	3.C	4.C	5.D	6.A	7.D
8.E	9.E	10.B	11.D	12.B	13.A	14.B
15.C	16.A	17.E	18.B	19.D	20.C	21.E
22.A	23.B	24.D	25.B	26.A	27.D	28.C
29.B	30.D	31.A	32.C	33.E	34.D	35.A
36.C	37.E	38.B	39.A	40.A	41.C	42.E
43.A	44.D	45.C	46.B	47.A	48.D	49.D
50.C	51.A	52.C	53.B	54.C	55.C	56.A
57.C	58.D	59.B	60.B	61.A	62.D	63.B
64.C	65.B	66.C	67.A	68.B	69.A	70.A
71.B	72.D	73.C	74.A	75.E	76.C	77.E
78.A	79.B	80.D	81.B	82.A	83.D	84.C
85.E	86.A	87.A	88.C	89.E	90.B	91.C
92.E	93.B	94.A	95.E	96.E	97.B	98.D
99.A	100.C					

WASSCE JUNE 1997 ENGLISH LANGUAGE 1 THEORY QUESTIONS

PART A

1. Narrate to your classmates an experience you have had or heard about which illustrates the saying: "You reap what you sow".
2. Write a letter to the Commissioner for Agriculture in your state deploring the low level of food production in the state and suggesting measures which the government should take to ensure that there is sufficient food for all.
3. During the last holidays, you had the opportunity to travel to another state and to witness some of the traditional festivals in the area. In an article suitable for publication in your school magazine describe one of these festivals.
4. You have noticed a decline in the level of discipline and morality in your society. In an article suitable for publication in a national newspaper, discuss some instances of this decline and its probable causes, and suggest ways in which the trend can be reversed.
5. You have received information that your younger brother, who is schooling in another part of the country, is playing truant and keeping bad company. Write a letter warning him of the consequences of such behaviour and urging him to turn over a new leaf.
6. A vehicle in which you were travelling was involved in an accident and several passengers including yourself were injured. Describe to sympathisers, who have come to visit you in hospital, how the accident happened and what followed.

PART B SECTION I COMPREHENSION

7. Read the following passage carefully and then answer the questions on it.

Returning home after a decade and a half abroad, our Geography master remained incurably addicted to foreign ways and ideas for years after landing here. He would for ever stick to his theory of Africans suffering from a curse inflicted on them by the Almighty God for some heinous sins committed centuries ago. He would in support of this theory ask listeners: Why would our mosquito inflict deadly malaria? The British mosquito does not bite? Why aren't there poisonous snakes in Britain whereas here most

snakes are deadly? Why should the deadly sickle cell disease be peculiar to the black race?

Of course, he hardly waits for answers to these and similar questions jumping to the same inevitable conclusion. However, he met his match one day when a new student joined the class and heard the litany we were used to. The new boy calmly said, "Sir, I happen to know a few white men who suffer from the sickle cell disease, some are Italians and some are Spanish. The mosquito is equally deadly in India, South-east Asian countries and South America. The United States and some other South American countries have their deadly snakes. And, Sir, I know many white men some of them British, who would prefer our brilliant sunshine to their horribly cold winter, "And he sat down.

I had never before that day, seen our master so consumed with anger. He directed a burning look at the poor boy, who had no answer to this new battle. Without as much as saying a single word, the master stalked out of the classroom. Needless to say, our anger was turned on the new boy who had decided to rock the boat without taking the time to sound the water. A delegation was sent to the master to apologize to him. He was appeased. But we all noticed something rather unusual thereafter - never again did he dwell on the issue of Africans being the accursed people.

- (a) What point of view is the geography master fond of advancing?
- (b) Mention the three arguments he uses to support this view.
- (c) What extra argument did the new boy offer after countering each of the master's points?
- (d) Why do you think the master fought back with his look rather than with further argument? "rock the boat"
- (e) (i) What figure of speech is this expression (ii) What does it mean as it is used in the passage?
- (f) who had no answer to this new battle (i) What grammatical name is given to the above expression as it is used in the passage? (ii) What is its function in the passage?
- (g) For each of the following words or phrases, find another word or phrase that means the same and can replace it as it is used in the passage (i) addicted to: (ii) heinous (iii) inevitable (iv) brilliant (v) stalked.

Read the following passage carefully and then answer the questions on it.

8. We are interested in the various kinds of injury that can occur in road traffic accidents, how to prevent them and their first aid management. Most of us have probably witnessed one form of road traffic accident or another. The universal reaction of eye witnesses is panic as they rush to the scene and stand there looking in dismay. Road traffic accidents are great crowd-pullers as everyone wants to stop and have a look. However, the three most useful things you can do if you are at the scene of a road traffic accident are to assist in the rescue of the trapped victims; to render first aid treatment to victims; and to help in conveying injured people to the nearest hospital.

Road traffic accidents have a great potential for causing injury to the human body. The high velocity at which the motor vehicle is travelling, the sudden deceleration on impact and the hard rigid nature of the motor-car body, all contribute to increase the potentials of injury. Probably, the most risk-laden road traffic accidents are those which involve motor-cyclists as they do not have a solid motor-car body to protect them from the direct impact of an oncoming vehicle on the road. Road traffic accident involving motor-cyclists are the cause of high mortality as the human skull is often fractured on impact with the hard surface of the road.

Road traffic accidents involving cars and their passengers can cause some serious problems as the wreckage of the car may trap some people inside. This may mean that the crumpled car body needs to be cut away before the victims can be saved. If the road accident results in a fire, then this can be disastrous as the fire will prevent rescuers from coming near, thus resulting in the quick demise of the victims from burns. This is why every car-driver must possess a fire extinguisher in his vehicle. The little device may save lives in some situations.

- (a) What, according to the writer, do eye-witnesses usually do as soon as an accident occurs?
- (b) What three things does he suggest that eye-witnesses should do?
- (c) Mention two of the factors that can increase injury during accidents.
- (d) Why are motor-cyclists more at risk when accidents occur?
- (e) Why does the writer suggest that every car driver should have a fire extinguisher in his vehicle?
- (f) "If the road accident results in a fire" (i) What is the grammatical name given to the above

expression? (ii) What is its function in the passage?

(g) For each of the following words find another word or phrase that means the same and can replace it as it is used in the passage: (i) universal (ii) conveying (iii) velocity (iv) potentials (v) disastrous.

SECTION II SUMMARY

Read the following passage carefully and answer the questions on it.

9. Every child, whether he comes to his family by birth or adoption, discovers what a family is through the experiences of family life. The newborn infant has no way of knowing which of the many faces that hover above him belongs to a parent. He has no way of knowing what a parent is. He only knows that he is comfortable or uncomfortable, hungry or satisfied.

Gradually, as the months go by, he begins to know who brings comfort when he is uncomfortable and food when he is hungry. He comes to know the feel of the arm that holds him close when he eats and holds him safe in his bath. He knows the voice that soothes him and sings to him. He grows to know who responds to his needs when he cries out. This is the special person in the whole strange new world who belongs specially to him. This is his first recognition of a parent. The mother and father who care for a child, who listen for his voice and try to interpret what he means, who comfort him, feed him and play with him discover for the first time what it is to be parents. They do not become parents by virtue of conception and birth alone. They grow to be parents just as the infant grows to recognize them as such. They come to know the developing personality of the child in a way that no other person really can. They recognize whether he is a lusty eater or a nibbler, vivacious or reserved, adventurous or cautious. By observing his intellectual and physical abilities, they also get to know what he may become in future. They are concerned with meeting his needs and wants; and fostering his growth to maturity.

Sometimes because of their responsibility to their child, parents have to do unpleasant things. They have, for instance, to take him for injections. He can have no choice about taking medicine when he is ill. He must learn quickly, and not necessarily at his own pace, that fire is not a plaything in the intimacies of daily living, the child and the parents learn the bitter and the sweet of family relations. It is through the experiences of family life that a child and his parents grow to be a family. For every parent's biological or adoptive, it is the daily loving care of the child and his parents that

build up to parents feelings. For every child, it is being loved and being cared for that produce family closeness.

(a) In two sentences, state how the new-born infant perceives his environment

(b) In one sentence say what an infant first learns about its parents

(c) In two sentences, say what parents learn about their child as he grows up

(d) In one sentence, summarize what a responsible parent often has to do in the interest of the child.

WASSCE JUNE 1997 ENGLISH LANGUAGE 1 THEORY ANSWER

THE WICKED STEP-MOTHER

1. Once upon a time, there lived a man called Alhaji Ajase who had two wives named Alhaja Kudi and Alhaja Khadijat. Kudi, the first wife had only a son ten years after their wedding. Perhaps, that motivated the man to marry another wife. The second wife had six children; three boys and three girls. The two wives lived a cat and dog life. The Alhaji was a wealthy man with fleet of cars, houses and industries. He was indeed a man of affluence.

Alhaja Khadijat who had six children hated not only the first wife but her only son. In a short while, she concluded arrangements to eliminate the first wife for no just cause, other than that she was jealous. She contacted a herbalist in their neighbourhood to do her act. The herbalist requested for the first wife's name a strand of her hair and her saliva. Khadijat got these before long without Kudi knowing. One day Kudi slept and died in her sleep. Khadijat was busy shedding crocodile tears; she wept for days, so much so that nobody ever suspected her as the killer of Kudi.

After a year of Kudi's death, she started maltreating Olubu, the only child of the deceased. The boy was only in primary four, but the wicked Khadijat made life unbearable for him. The boy became the family house help, but she hid this entirely from her husband as he would not take it kindly with her. This woman and her children took unique advantage of the death of Kudi to unleash terror on the 'hopeless' boy. He was denied comfort, food and other things of life despite his father's riches. More often than not, Olubu was made to sleep in the pantry, where he had to battle with mice, mosquitoes and cockroaches. Despite all these inhuman treatment meted out to him, he never fell sick for one day. Though, he was denied educational facilities by the step-mother, he always came first in all examinations.

It then came that Olubu and two children of Khadijat wrote National Common Entrance Examination. Despite thousands of naira spent by the step-mother to aid her two children, it was only Olubu that passed in flying colours. In fact, he was awarded a scholarship as he came first in the examination in the entire country. The step-mother thought that the only masterstroke was to wickedly eliminate the boy as she did to his mother, otherwise her own children would become his errand boys and girls in future.

Alhaja Khadijat contacted the same herbalist who killed the boy's mother to give her the same charms that killed his mother to kill him too, but the herbalist replied that the poison he had was not the same as the one of the past but it was equally effective. She got it and it was to be sprinkled on the boy's food. She did it as she was told and travelled out of town so that nobody would suspect any foul play. She warned her six children secretly not to eat the poisoned food before she travelled out on her fake journey'. At school, all the children were ordered to wait and do some manual labour, but Khadijat's children being highly disobedient and wayward defied the order and went home. Olubu had no alternative, but to wait and complete the assignment before going home.

On getting home, Khadijat's six children, at first, obeyed their mother's instruction not to eat the poisoned food. However, after finishing their own food and still not satisfied, they went ahead and ate out of the poisoned food reserved for Olubu. They quickly ate it and even fought each other in the process. Thereafter, they all entered their room and slept and all died in their sleep. Khadijat arrived from the market journey and met her six children dead instead of Olubu. She cried, cried and cried and confessed that she did herself, that she killed Olubu's mother out of jealousy and decided to kill her son too and that the whole exercise backfired. She was immediately reported to the king who asked the villagers to meet at the market square. Khadijat was sentenced to death by hanging. She pleaded for pardon but the people replied 'you reap what you sow'. She was hanged at the market square.

2.

P. M. B. 1,
Agege,
Lagos State,
6th March, 1997.

The Honourable Commissioner,
Ministry of Agriculture,
Alausa,
Lagos State.

Dear Sir,

LOW FOOD PRODUCTIVITY IN THE STATE AND SOLUTIONS

I write this letter with deep sense of commitment and responsibility, first, to commend your efforts for the job well done and secondly to highlight the various difficulties facing food production in the state and suggest some lasting solutions. There is no doubt in my mind that the state can in no distant time become the food basket of the nation if the land resources are well harnessed.

The state government seems to pay lip service to food production despite its teeming population that grows at a geometrical rate. Take for instance; there is no faculty of agriculture in both the state and federal universities located in Lagos State. Also, Agricultural Science is not taught in both the state college of education and polytechnic. I think this leaves much to be desired if food for all by the year 2000 AD is to be guaranteed. This has led to absence of specialists and extension workers to educate farmers in the state towards achieving massive food production.

Moreover, Lagos school leavers are discouraged from farming which in actual sense is more lucrative than any white collar job in the state. Perhaps, due to poor awareness, young men and women shy away from farming as it is viewed as a work meant for drop-outs. Consequently, even drop-outs, in order not to be stigmatized prefer learning trades such as welding, driving fashion-designing and a host of other professions instead of going into farming. This is an age-long wrong notion which is yet to be corrected among Lagosians. However, farmers in advanced countries are among the richest citizens.

Furthermore, lack of co-operative farming is equally responsible for low productivity of food in Lagos State. A good number of farmers operate at subsistence level which is a crude stage of agricultural development. Each farmer embarks on subsistence farming which is just sufficient for his family instead of pooling their resources

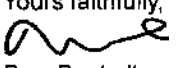
together to raise large capital in order to go into commercial farming.

Also, farmers in the state are not aided to terms of loans and inputs. Those who eventually benefit from the so-called agricultural loans in the state are not farmers but businessmen who collect such loans and run back to other industries. Such fake farmers' present a long list of farmers, claiming to be their spokesman and collect several millions of naira before they bolt away to their original line of business. This attitude leaves much to be desired.

In view of the problems facing massive food production in the state, the government in association with the mass media in the state should embark on mass education of citizens as regards the need for massive food production and involvement of all and sundry in production of food. Similarly, each tertiary institution in the state should be compelled to open a faculty of agriculture. Practical agriculture should also be made compulsory in both secondary and post-secondary institutions in the state. Also, extension workers should be encouraged to live among the farmers in rural areas of the state to boost production.

The state government should increase its annual allocation to agriculture so that enough loans can be given to real farmers. Moreover, they should be encouraged to pool their resources together through co-operative societies to enable them buy modern machines to boost food production. Chemicals and other inputs should also be sold to farmers at subsidized rates.

All things being equal, there is no doubt in my mind that large food production will be achieved in the state if my suggestions are looked into and systematically implemented.

Yours faithfully,

Ben Benbella.

3. NEW YAM FESTIVAL IN EDA EKITI

During the last holiday, I had the golden opportunity to travel to Ede Ekiti to spend my holiday with an uncle. The holiday perhaps was the most enjoyable in recent years. It was a two-week holiday early in July. The period of the holiday coincided with the new yam festival in the village. My uncle Mr. J. O. Didemola is a teacher in the village secondary school. The village itself has about two hundred houses and over ten thousand people. It is located in the newly-created Ilejemeje Local Government Area of Ekiti State.

Indeed, the new yam festival, otherwise called Ogun Festival celebrated on 12th July will forever remain green in my memory. It was my first time of spending my holiday outside Lagos and I have vowed not to spend any in Lagos city again as people lose much touch with traditional values and beauty by not visiting the countryside.

The new yam festival at Eda Ekiti is an annual event celebrated in honour of Ogun the Yoruba god of iron and war. The people are deeply traditional in that nobody is allowed to eat the new yam or bring it home until the festival is over. Although the people of the locality are all christians of various denominations, the Ogun festival unites them all. Their sons and daughters in their thousands travel home from far and near to share in the goodwill of the festival. I was but a visitor to the area but I felt like a true 'son of the soil' during the period as the said, 'there is no stranger in the house of Ogun.

On the eve of the festival, I was fortunate to have followed my new friend, Babayo to his father's farm. He too came for the festival from Lagos. On getting to the farm, some big tubers of yam were harvested and the wives and children who were in the happiest mood washed the tubers, singing some traditional songs. My friend later told me that they were singing in honour of Ogun for the bountiful harvest brought and that the period of scarcity was gone. The staple food of the people is 'Iyan' (pounded yam) with 'egusi' (melon) soup. Before we left the farm, my friend's father divined through four slices of kolanut at the end of which he warned his household not to fight during the period of the festival. He warned seriously that Ogun ordered him to warn all of us present to avoid fighting. We ate some pounded yam before we left the farm for home. People in that part eat much; what a single person ate is enough for a family of six in Lagos. No wonder they are strong and muscular. I was given five large tubers as a gift. They were so large that I hardly could carry them home.

At about nine in the night, the celebration proper began. It was time for singing abusive songs on those who have done bad. Usually, they start with the king and the high-ranking chiefs. The king was said not to have done much when there was drought early in the year. They believe the king is the mediator between them and their ancestors. After this series, abusive songs were directed at those who had committed offences such as abortions, stealing, adultery and so on. The most surprising aspect of it was that the 'culprits' gave the singer (youngmen and women) a lot of gifts such as plamwine, kolanut et cetera. It was so fantastic that people danced to tunes,

including those against them. This they did till dawn. Singers there were highly talented though they sang in their local dialect but I got the message.

In the morning, it was eating galore. It was that area I noticed that people eat pounded yam as breakfast, lunch and dinner continuously for days with joy. At about ten in the morning, all were gathered at the market square with the king presiding. A male dog was sacrificed to Ogun. The neck of the dog was cut at once by a priest of Ogun and the blood sprinkled on the metallic objects. At the end, the king and his chiefs danced round the village. It was the most memorable of all holidays I have ever spent. Like others in the village, I too paid the ritual and customary homage to the king.

Sunday Dada,
SS2A

4. GENERAL DECLINE IN THE LEVEL OF DISCIPLINE AND MORALITY IN NIGERIA

The major problem confronting our nation, Nigeria, today is the general decline in the level of discipline and morality. Gone are the days when morality and discipline used to be virtues. Today, it is the exact opposite. We now live in a decadent society where morality and discipline are thrown overboard. It is a pity our society which was once upright and which moral values were standard can become decadent.

The problem is not limited to the secular aspect of our society, even the religious circle. Imagine a situation where a church pastor puts a female member of the church in the family way and calls for extravagant ceremony when she gives birth to a baby! What about a school teacher who puts his own sixteen-year-old female student in the family way because of undue assistance sought by her in a promotion examination? Bank loans are not granted to customers with good intention but the bad ones whose aim is to borrow and never pay back. However, the bank managers aid and abet such cases because such loans 'are shared' equally between the borrowers and the managers even without any physical collateral. The managers themselves use fictitious names and documents to steal millions of naira from our banks.

Today it is an open secret that the November/December SSCE is fought with malpractices, as university graduates write the examination as 'expert mercenaries' for the candidates who are born with silver spoon in their

mouth. The Joint Matriculation Examination is worse. The candidates at times see the questions, days to the examination itself. The question is who are those responsible for such examination malpractices? No doubt, it is the highly placed officials examination supervisors and invigilators. The story is the same in employment cases. Job are not given to deserving and competent applicants, but to those who offer large bribes and women who can sleep with those in charge. The story is similar with our law enforcement agents. They are not only corrupt, they now join robbery gangs to operate. A good number of them have lost their sense of moral decency. Most of our rich men are drug barons.

The major cause of this general problem is poverty. A university graduate-teacher in Lagos State earns just N2,200. He is married with three children apart from large number of dependant relatives. His salary alone can hardly take care of transportation and accommodation. The only way open to the poor man is to look elsewhere to make ends meet. That is why most civil servants now augment their meagre salaries with 'trading'. At times some of the female teachers sell on credit even to their students. Tell me how such teachers will not accept bribes from their students if tempted.

Another major cause of the bad trend is the unchecked inflation that has nearly ruined the economy. The prices of most essential things like food, wears, books have gone beyond the reach of an average family. To worsen it all the local currency is silently being devalued. This makes imported materials exclusive rights of the rich, as no poor man goes near them. That is why Nigerians now go for fairly used goods.

Extravagant lifestyles of the rich in our society has not helped the situation either. Majority of them acquire their riches illegally, and turn round to engage in wasteful spending. Imagine a man that spends over fifty million naira to bury his father or for a wedding when millions of Nigerians are jobless and hungry. Such a man could have fleet of cars and estates in virtually all state capitals, yet he does nothing worthwhile to be so rich. That is why most school leavers or jobless adults now go into fraudulent means of getting money.

The major solution to the problem is provision of employment opportunities for all school leavers. Also, there should be mass education of the citizens through the media about the dangers inherent in indiscipline and immorality in our society. Moreover, salaries and wages of public servants should be reviewed like those in the private sector. Extravagant parties, particularly, night parties should be banned

outright. There should be probe panels to investigate the sources of wealth of all rich men and women in our society. Those whose handiwork cannot justify their riches should have their properties confiscated. Our educational and religious institutions should preach moral values not acquisition of material wealth. Above all, there should be ethics and moral codes for all and those who fall short of required standard should be made to face the music.

In conclusion, the problem of indiscipline and immorality in our society will soon become a thing of the past if my suggestions are well looked into and honestly implemented.

Yetunde Ogunmodede,
P.O. Box 22,
Agege - Lagos

5. P. M. B. 2,
3 Abeokuta,
Ogun State,
14th June, 1997.

Dear Akin,

It was last week I received information that you've started playing truant and keeping bad company. In fact I got two letters to that effect apart from personal contact a concerned person had with me. It's irredible to learn that you of all people can still indulge in such obnoxious acts. I now know the reason why you keep repeating every class.

You see, the consequences of your attitude are great and many. You may not know that such can make you join a secret society. Our parents told you before going to Kaduna that 'bad company corrupt good manner' and that a rotten fruit spoils the whole in the basket'. The current problem among students in Nigeria today is that of secret cult. This has led to the death of almost a hundred students in Nigerian universities this year alone. You can still remember the violence at LASU where our cousin lost his life just because he was in secret cult which was brought about by bad company.

Furthermore, your bad habit can lead to rustication by the authorities. Last week the federal government gave each vice chancellor a wide range of power to deal with anti-social habits in higher institutions. Anyone caught, the consequence will be expulsion and nothing less. Being the first to see the four walls of a university in the family, you need to show good example as good example is 'better man precept. You should

turn over a new leaf and be a good ambassador of our family.

If you don't know, a good number of students from LASU have been put behind bars while others are declared wanted. Some of those students we learnt, did not physically commit any offence but were known friends of 'criminals' among students. The police want them to make useful statements to enable security agents get to the core of clashes between rival groups in the institution of higher learning. You may become a victim of circumstance if you don't turn a new leaf before nemesis catches up with you.

Akin, playing truant and keeping bad company lead to mass failure. Those who attend leacutres punctually cannot remember all they have been taught, what about you who hardly go to school? I have now seen why you repeat and carry-over courses every now and then. If you can still recollect when last you've ill, the doctor diagnosed intake of hard drugs as the cause of your sickness but you denied it all. Now the cat has been let out of the bag. This shows that your illness was as a result of your bad company and truancy. Remember, hard drugs lead to madness.

I now urge you to remember the son of whom you're and always remember our parents' moral talks before you left for the university. Those who indulge in such bad habits end up frustrated but it is not too late to change for the better. I can't tell our parents, as you know they are hypertensive. You as the only child to be trained to have gone astray, is enough to make them develop high blood pressure. Now, start going to church and pray fervently for spiritual power to enable you overcome. Attend classes punctually, write your assignments, study much and avoid keeping bad company.

Your reply to this letter is very necessary before it's too late. Be a source of joy to the family. Till you reply, bye for now.

Yours sincerely,
Babs

6. THE FATAL ACCIDENT

It was at about 6.30 a.m on Saturday 7th April, 1997 that the ill-fated journey began. I was going to attend an interview for employment at Okokomaiko, a suburb of Lagos. The interview was scheduled for ten O'clock in the morning. The anxiety of the interview so much overwhelmed me that I couldn't sleep the previous night. I prayed for much of the time and equally guessed at the most likely questions. At least I was confident of

leaving the queue of the unemployed after three years of joblessness. Getting to the motor park at Pen Cinema, I climbed into a loading bus and not long after, the journey began.

I prayed for a short while before I could even look at the faces of co-passengers who were mostly market women. In fact I was the only male and the youngest of the lot. I perceived the odour of Indian hemp from where I sat by the driver, asked him whether he smoked and he replied in the affirmative. Shortly after, he lit a wrapped substance which he referred to as 'Kukuye'. As soon as I noticed this, I demanded my fare of one hundred naira and decided to join another vehicle. However, the passengers warned me against being stranded as that place was not the garage and petrol was scarce. What really tempted me to get down were two: the driver's vulgar language and his reckless driving.

His style of driving was more than dangerous. He had no respect for traffic codes. On two occasions he was ordered to stop by VIOs and the police but he waved them aside. My heartbeat increased more than ever before, while my only prayer was to get to my destination. Meanwhile, most passengers were deeply asleep. In fact, I knew the driver was much under the influence of alcohol when he almost ran into a coming truck. My heart jumped out of my mouth when suddenly he applied his brakes without any warning signal. This made all passengers already asleep to wake up and start exchanging words with the driver.

As that happened, it was the prayer of all passengers to get to where they could see a policeman who would order him to stop, so they would get down, and join other vehicles. The driver completely neglected our side. In a twinkling of an eye he was driving too recklessly towards a narrow bridge near Iba Village. We shouted, but to no avail. Consequently, he collided with an oncoming lorry. That was about seven.

Of all the fifteen passengers, only three of us sustained minor injuries. Others had deep cuts and broken legs and arms, but the driver escaped unhurt. Thank God a good Samaritan used his vehicle to convey us to the nearest public hospital at Iba. On arrival at the hospital, both the nurses and doctors on duty refused to treat us except a police report was tendered. It took over thirty minutes before the good Samaritan and I, an eye witness, could convince the hospital authorities that the man who brought us was not the culprit but a good citizen with good intention. Later, we were all adequately treated.

Finally, the accident was caused by our own driver's notorious, wicked and arrogant attitude.

Coupled with these was his drunkenness that made him to drive under the influence of alcohol and drug. We learnt there at the hospital that he had been arrested by law enforcement agents. I am ready to testify against his bad driving if called upon to do so. His type should be banned from the highways if accidents are to be drastically reduced.

PART B [SECTION 1] COMPREHENSION

- (a) The theory is that Africans are suffering from a curse inflicted on them by the Almighty God for some wicked sins committed centuries ago.
 (b) (i) That African mosquito inflicts deadly malaria but British mosquito does not bite. (ii) That British snakes aren't poisonous but African snakes are deadly (iii) That sickle cell disease is peculiar to the black race
 (c) The extra argument was that some few white men, some of them British would prefer our brilliant sunshine to their horribly cold winter
 (d) This was because he knew the boy was armed with more facts to counter his arguments
 (e) (i) metaphor (ii) causes disruption
 (f) (i) Adjectival clause/(non-defining) relative clause (ii) it qualifies the noun 'poor boy' or boy'
 (g) (i) used to (ii) very wicked (iii) unavoidable (iv) bright (v) stormed.

(a) The eye-witnesses panic and stand there looking in dismay

- (b) (i) They should assist in rescuing trapped victims (ii) They should administer first-aid treatment to victims (iii) They should convey injured victims to the nearest hospital
 (c) The two factors are (i) High speed at which the motor vehicle travels. (ii) The wreckage of the car may trap people inside
 (d) They do not have a solid motor-car body to protect them from the direct impact of an on-coming vehicle
 (e) He suggests this so that he could use
 (g) (i) general (ii) carrying (iii) speed (iv) likelihood (v) dangerous.

SECTION II SUMMARY

- (a) (i) An infant discovers the meaning of a family or parent except by daily experiences (ii) All he knows is his comfort and satisfaction or discomfort
 (b) He begins to know who caters for his needs when he cries out, the hand that holds him and who soothes and signs for him
 (c) (i) The parents learn their child's developing personality as he grows up (ii) The parents observe their child's intellectual and physical abilities and possibly his future career
 (d) A responsible parent should daily have loving care and show responsiveness of parental feelings to the child

WASSCE JUNE 1997 ENGLISH LANGUAGE 3 TEST OF ORALS (OBJECTIVE TEST)

SECTION 1

From the words lettered A to D, choose the word that has the **same vowel sound** as the one represented by the letter(s) underlined.

An example is given below.

Example: seat A. sit B. cite C. set D. key

The correct answer is D because only key contains the same vowel sound as the one underlined in seat. So, answer space D would be shaded

[A] [B] [C] [D]

Now answer the question that follows:

1. leagues A. lick B. pleasure C. people D. learn
2. shall A. shk B. hail C. shale D. shadow
3. watch A. war B. luck C. water D. hot
4. chilled A. build B. child C. heel D. lied
5. could A. cold B. cod C. pull D. cool

6. pool A. book B. suit C. pole D. shock
7. sell A. eel B. ate C. seal D. wanted
8. hunt A. hurt B. hot C. hoot D. run
9. car A. cat B. chat C. chide D. father
10. short A. but B. shoot C. shot D. jaw
11. high A. ghost B. buy C. way D. hither
12. oil A. yell B. buoy C. quay D. toll
13. make A. plant B. afraid C. mark D. met
14. coat A. no B. knew C. gnaw D. now
15. cheer A. chair B. ear C. check D. cheat

SECTION 2

From the words lettered A to D, choose the word that has the **same consonant sound(s)** as the one represented by the letter(s) underlined. An example is given below

Example: vice A. cat B. dress C. show D. chalk

The correct answer is B because only dress contains the same consonant sound as the one undetiined in vice. So, answer space B would be shaded.

[A] [B] [C] [D]

16. packet
A. psychology B. physics C. pseudonym
D. sparkle
17. tin
A. thin B. tent C. then D. hitch
18. king
A. known B. knight C. sink D. ring
19. obey
A. plumber B. tomb C. rubber D. comb
20. cheated
A. kicked B. begged C. locked D. heater
21. ag~~h~~ast
A. gnash B. begged C. locked D. heater
22. ch~~a~~llenge
A. archives B. machine C. match D. chemistry
23. oblige
A. journey B. gory C. prestige D. plague
24. half
A. halves B. cough C. though D. hoe
25. sword
A. word B. occasion C. boys D. Pass
26. ath~~l~~ete
A. let B. breathe C. tell D. both
27. ment~~i~~on
A. mentor B. mason C. minstrel D. ocean
28. cave
A. vale B. calf C. has D. fail
29. then
A. den B. thin C. ten D. brother
30. boys
A. sick B. voice C. zeal D. shop

SECTION 3

From the words lettered A to D choose the word that thymes with the given word. An example is given below.

Example: detain

A.obtain B. detail C. daim D. relay

The correct answer is A because only obtain rhymes with detain. So, answer space A would be shaded

[A] [B] [C] [D]

Now answer the questions that follow:

31. return
A. borne B. burn C. become D. thunder
32. laugh
A. life B. light C. ghost D. half
33. sweet
A. sweat B. suit C. twice D. suite
34. unharmed
A. hammer B. unarmed C. unmannered
D. hurried
35. heart
A. hurt B. tear C. curt D. Part

SECTION 4

In each of the following questions the main / primary stress is indicated by writing the syllable on which it occurs in capital letters.

From the words, lettered A to D, choose the one that has the **correct stress**. An example is given below

Example: democratic

A. DE-mo-cra-tic B. de-MO-cra-tic
C. demo-CRA-tic D. de-mo-cra-TIC

The correct answer is C because the main/primary stress of the word democratic is on the third syllable. So answer space C would be shaded

[A] [B] [C] [D]

Now, answer the questions that follow

36. recuperate
A. RE-cu-pe-rate B. re-CU-pe-rate
C. re-cu-PE-rate D. re-cu-Pe-RATE
37. ambassador
A. am-BAS-sa-dor B. am-bas- SA-dor
C. am-bas-sa-DOR D. AM-bas-sa-dor
38. stupidity
A stu-PI-di-ty B. STU-pi-di-ty
C. stu-piDI-ty D. stu-pi-di-TY
39. resurrection
A. re-sur-rec-TION B. RE-sur-rec-tion
C. re-SUR-rec-tion D. re-sur-REC-tion

40. advertisement
 A. ad-ver-TISE-ment B. ad-ver-tise-MENT
 C. ad-VER-tise-ment D. AD-ver-tise-ment

SECTION 5

In the following options lettered A to D, all the words except one have the same stress pattern. Identify the one with the different stress pattern and shade your answer in the usual way. An example is given below.

Example: A. away B. apart C. behind D. river
 Options A, B, C are all stressed on the second syllable while option D is the only one stressed on the first syllable. So D is the correct answer and answer space D would be shaded.

[A] [B] [C] [D]
 Now, answer the questions that follow

41. A. commit B. compare C. complete D. column
 42. A. afraid B. allow C. always D. attempt
 43. A. decision B. continue C. plantation D. continent
 44. A. monitor B. register C. possible D. promotion
 45. A. leader B. judgement C. money D. report

SECTION 6

*In each of the following sentences: the word that receives the **emphatic stress** is written in CAPITAL LETTERS. From the questions lettered A. to D, choose the one to which the given sentences is the appropriate answer. An example is given below.*

Example: My mother's FRIEND hates pets
 A. Does your mother's boss hate pets?
 B. Does your mother's friend love pets?
 C. Does your mother's friend hate toys?
 D. Does your father's friend hate pets?

The correct answer is A. because My mother's FRIEND hates pets answers the question, Does your mother's boss hate pets? So answer space A would be shaded

[A] [B] [C] [D]
 Now, answer the questions that follow:

46. Last week's football match was very EXCITING
 A. Was yesterday's football match very exciting?
 B. Was last week's tennis match very exciting?
 C. Was last week's football match very dull?
 D. Was last year's football match very exciting?
47. Mary stole the HISTORY teacher's pen?
 A. Did Anne steal the History teacher's pen
 B. Did Mary borrow the History teacher's pen?
 C. Did Mary steal the Geography teacher's pen?
 D. Did Mary steal the History teacher's book?

48. My FATHER arrived from London yesterday
 A. Did my mother arrive from London yesterday?
 B. Did my father leave for London yesterday?
 C. Did my father arrive from Accra yesterday?
 D. Did his father arrive from London yesterday?
49. The judge CAUTIONED the prosecution witness
 A. Who cautioned the prosecution witness?
 B. Did the judge praise the prosecution witness?
 C. Did the judge caution the defence witness?
 D. Did the judge caution the prosecution counsel?
50. Our SCHOOL won the debating competition
 A. Did our club win the debating competition?
 B. Did our school lose the debating competition?
 C. Did your school win the debating competition?
 D. Did your school win the swimming competition?

SECTION 7

From the words lettered A to D, choose the word that contains the sound represented by the given phonetic symbol.

An example is given below:

Example: / ɔ i / A. yell B. holy C. boy D. idiot

The correct answer is C because only boy contains the sound represented by the given symbol. So answer space C would be shaded.

[A] [B] [C] [D]
 Now, answer the questions that follow:

51. / e / A. wet B. key C. wanted D. eke
 52. / i / A. heel B. sit C. high D. bite
 53. / l : / A. say B. seize C. kill D. ill
 54. / æ : / A. cart B. bail C. hate D. cat
 55. / ʌ / A. cot B. cut C. curt D. caught
 56. / d / A. wig B. judge C. cake D. death
 57. / ʊ / A. thin B. tin C. dose D. those
 58. / f / A. hop B. shop C. stop D. kiss
 59. / ʒ / A. zebra B. leisure C. missing D. mission
 60. / h / A. hour B. power C. honour D. how

WASSCE JUNE 1997 ENGLISH LANGUAGE 3 TEST OF ORALS

OBJECTIVE TEST ANSWERS

- | | | | | | | |
|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|
| 1.C | 2.D | 3.D | 4.A | 5.C | 6.B | 7.B |
| 8.D | 9.D | 10.D | 11.B | 12.B | 13.B | 14.A |
| 15.B | 16.D | 17.B | 18.C | 19.C | 20.B | 21.C |
| 22.C | 23.A | 24.B | 25.D | 26.D | 27.D | 28.A |
| 29.D | 30.C | 31.B | 32.D | 33.D | 34.B | 35.D |
| 36.B | 37.A | 38.A | 39.D | 40.C | 41.D | 42.C |
| 43.D | 44.D | 45.D | 46.C | 47.C | 48.A | 49.B |
| 50.A | 51.A | 52.B | 53.B | 54.D | 55.B | 56.B |
| 57.A | 58.B | 59.B | 60.D | | | |

SENIOR SCHOOL CERTIFICATE EXAMINATION (SSCE 1988 – 2015)

Past Questions with Solutions

English Language

(Theory / Objectives with Oral English) 1998

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WASSCE JUNE 1998 ENGLISH LANGUAGE 2 OBJECTIVE TEST QUESTIONS

SECTION 1

From the words lettered A to E below each of the following sentences, choose the word that is opposite in meaning to the underlined word

1. By nature armed robbers are ruthless I have never seen a.....one among them
A. humane B. barbarous C. ferocious D. mean
E. decent
2. The taxi driver slowed while overtaking the lorry when the proper thing to do was for him to have.....
A. throttled B. despatched C. pedited
D. negotiated E. accelerated
3. The probationary workers do not have the same rights as.....staff
A. approved B. dismissed C. postponed
D. confirmed E. provoked
4. The journey by road.....where the rail journey ended
A. conduded B. orginated C. commenced
D. established E. meandered
5. Instead of laughing about this serious matter, you should be
A. whimpering B. sober C. bitter D. indifferent
E. unconcerned
6. After years of hostility the two communities now live in.....
A. bondage B. security C. enmity D. equanimity
E. amity
7. Mrs. Apata is always moody while her husband is for ever.....
A. cheerful B. willing C. tender D. loving
E. petulant
8. The judge ruled that the first transaction was valid while the second was.....
A. abnormal B. legal C. valueless D. void
E. proper

9. Ebere's.....contrasts with his brother's indolence
A. indulgence B. laziness C. labour D. abstinence
E. diligence
10. Elders are expected to be..... where youths are green
A. rash B. red C. experienced D. callous
E. impetuous

SECTION 2

From the words lettered A to E, choose the word that best completes each of the following sentences

11. The officer expressed his..... at being unfairly dismissed
A. indignity B. indigestion C. indiscretion
D. indignation E. indiscipline
12. It gives me much.....to welcome you to the beginning of the new session
A. relish B. enjoyment C. pleasure D. indulgence
E. vexation
13. Miss Anieke is very.....with her pupils because she loves them all
A. prevalent B. familiar C. plain D. current
E. popular
14. He added a brief.....to his letter
A. postscript B. postmark C. postmortem
D. posture E. postdate
15. The.....that the hospital should be upgraded was warmly welcomed
A design B. purpose C. proposal D. undertaken
E. theorem
16. The visitors expressed appreciation for the..... shown to them during their stay
A. hostility B. charity C. enjoyment D. generosity
E. hospitality
17. The judge.....her to two year's imprisonment
A. pronounced B. commended C. tried
D. condemned E. sentenced
18. The principal.....the studens for performing brilliantly in the examinations
A. rebuked B. remarked C. condoned

D. commended E. admonished

19. Akpan is generally.....as the most experienced mason in the town
A. recommended B. recognized C. selected
D. fulfilled E. infcrme
20. The Board of Directors is discussing now the company can be run more.....
A. effeminately B. effusively C. effortlessly
D. affectionately E. efficiently

SECTION 2

*After each of the following sentences, a list of possible interpretations of the sentence is given. Choose the interpretation that you consider **most appropriate** for each sentence*

21. My Gajere is generous to a fault with everything he has..... This means that he is.....
A. just a little generous B. not generous at all
C. excessively generous D. very stingy
22. What I have told you is the gospel truth. This means that the information is
A. false B. unconfirmed C. partly true
D. completely true
23. Walter is the dictator's hatchetman. This means that Walter
A. discredits or eliminates the dictator's opponents
B. placates those that are offended by the dictator
C. explains the dictator's policies to the people
D. finds out the dictator's enemies
24. Yekini scored a brilliant hattrick in the final match of the football competition. This means that he
A. scored the winning goal
B. was the best player
C. deceived the defenders before scoring the goal
D. scored three goals in the match
25. When Audu took that step, he was on the horns of a dilemma. This means that he
A. was calm and composed
B. faced a choice between two unpleasant alternatives
C. had many attractive options
D. slept over the matter before he took the step
26. Mary told John to put his own house in order before correcting her. This means that John should
A. solve his own problems first
B. rearrange his house
C. repaint his house
D. has been banned not be harsh on her

27. Amuneke has decided to hang his boots. This means that he
A. is leaving his club for another one
B. wants a new pair of boots
C. is about to stop playing the game
D. has been banned from playing football
28. The famous film star found dancing a pretty kettle of fish. This means that
A. he enjoyed it
B. it was an awkward experience
C. he found dancing as interesting as acting
D. dancing gave him as much pleasure as a meal of fish
29. The minister's explanation begged the question. This means that the minister's explanation
A. avoided the real issue
B. addressed the issue
C. was false
D. was convincing
30. The principal's quarters are out of bounds to students. This means that the quarters are
A. outside the school boundary
B. too far for students to go there
C. not open to students
D. for binding students

SECTION 4

*From the words lettered A. to below each of the following sentences, choose the word that is **nearest in meaning** to the underlined word*

31. He eventually found the ising book
A. soon B. lately C. subsequently D. frequently
E. finally
32. The evidence of the witness corroborates that of the accused
A. negates B. reinforces C. opposes D. disdaims
E. nullifies
33. The attacker advanced on his opponent in a menacing fashion
A. threatening B. unforgettable C. fascinating
D. crucial E. wonderful
34. The man retired after thirty-five years of meritorious service to the nation
A. patriotic B. notorious C. commendable
D. beautiful E. regrettable
35. The story he told was incredible
A. indelible B. acceptable C. horrible
D. unbelievable E. permissible

36. The bond of unity in his country is fragile
A. strong B. weak C. ductile D. attractive
E. laudable
37. If I have erred, I hope the error is pardonable
A. excusable B. intelligible C. reparable
D. redeemable E. questionable
38. We were treated to a very sumptuous meal at the party
A. meager B. prominent C. famous D. common
E. expensive
39. Charles' concern for Diana is affected
A. genuine B. serious C. pretended D. worrisome
E. half-hearted
40. We need an expert to decipher the code
A. understand B. explain C. demystify
D. normalize E. interpret

SECTION 5

*From the words or group of words lettered A to D, choose the one that **best completes** each of the following sentences.*

41. The two warring parties met for five days to iron.....their differences
A. of B. in C. up D. out
42. The business tycoon's daughter was carried...by the flattery of her suitor
A. on B. out C. along D. away
43. The reasures taken were intended to bring.....the prices of consumer goods
A. out B. off C. away D. down
44. I was still explaining my action when Tina rudely cut.....
A. on B. off C. away D. in
45. The girl thought that she would get.....with her stubbornness
A. over B. up C. away D. around
46. We asked him to come with us and.....
A. he comes B. he did C. did he D. he does
47. Although he greeted her.....
A. but she did not answer
B. she does not answer
C. she did nDt answer
D. but she was yet to answer
48. The thief died shortly after...shot at by the police
A. been B. having C. becoming D. being

49. If you don't withdraw the defamatory statement, I shall have noi alternative.....seek redress in a court of law
A. till I B. until I C. than I D. but to
50. She said that she heard Julie.....
A. sing B. song C. sang D. sung
51. It is useless.....with a fool
A. argue B. arguing C. to arguing D. to argued
52.committed the offence will be dealt with
A. Whichever B. Whomever C. Whatever
D. Whoever
53. Hardly had he completed narrating the story.....the poor woman collapsed
A. then B. as C. when D. nevertheless
54. Four rnen,one of.....wore a sunshade, entered the room
A. which B. whose C. whom D. them
55. No sooner had Uche arrived at the meeting.....the proceedings began
A. than B. when C. as D. while
56. I am sorry to bother you.....I have something important to tell you
A. because B. but C. when D. and
57. I was not only tired.....sick
A. but also B. or also C. and also D. nevertheless
58. Idi is neither too tall..... short
A. and too B. nor too C. or too D. or very
59. There will be no trouble...you do the assignment
A. in case B. because C. as long as D. as soon as
60. 60. Nda won't like it.....?
A. has he B. would he C. wouldn't he D. will he
61. She hurt herself.....?
A. does she B. isn't it C. didn't she D. doesn't she
62. Aliyu can change his mind.....?
A. can't he B. does he C. will be D. doesn't he
63. The vehicle wasn't serviceable.....?
A. it was B. didn't it C. is it D. was it
64. He wasn't unanimously elected president.....?
A. was he B. didn't he C. did he D. does the

65. These old tables and chairs are very valuable.....
A. items of furnitures B. furniture
C. item of furnitures D. item of furniture
66. We lost because we.....cope with the pace of the game
A. cannot B. could not be able C. could not
D. cannot be able
67. Your contribution is not.....for you to share in the profit
A. sufficient enough B. enough C. insufficient
D. enough sufficient
68. The teacher's.....of the word is faulty
A. pronouncement B. promulgation
C. prolongation D. pronunciation
69. The sole occupant of the car was injured in theaccident
A. fatal B. ghastly C. incredible D. trivial
70. The woman walked.....fast that the little girl couldn't catch up with her
A. too B. very C. so D. quite

SECTION 6

In the following passages, the numbered gaps indicate missing words. Against each number in the list below each passage, five options are given in columns lettered A to E. Choose the word that is the **most suitable** to fill the numbered gap in the passages.

PASSAGE A

Words in English Language, and any other language for that matter, have one —71— A word —72— has more than one meaning —73— on its usage in the —74— Also, a particular thing or situation may be —75— using many —76— words of groups of words. Yet two words—77— ever have exactly the same meaning. Thus, although a word may have many —78— these do no mean exactly the same thing —79—, it is important that the writer should be very —80— in his —81— of words. Students should be advised not to put —

82— the first words that come to their minds. Any writer needs time to —83— the context and —84— suitable words from the very many —85— options that can be used to describe any situation.

71.	A. semblance	B. likeness	C. similarity	D. thing	E. peculiarity
72.	even	equally	usually	rarely	never
73.	relying	depending	particularly	reflecting	especially
74.	context	paragraph	phrase	content	essence
75.	quoted	scribed	quoted	procured	described
76.	divergent	opposing	direct	different	difficult
77.	sometimes	often	hardly	always	occasionally
78.	metaphors	synonyms	antonyms	homonyms	analogies
79.	Finally	Eventually	Additionally	Consequently	Similarly
80.	effective	worried	agitated	relaxed	careful
81.	choices	articulation	description	expression	option
82.	up	down	across	over	on
83.	investigate	look	examine	take	see
84.	about	in	within	against	select
85.	practicable	adequate	viable	possible	excellent

When Mrs Dada took her sick baby to the hospital, the doctor told her that the baby didn't have much—86— to the parasites which the laboratory —87— identified in the blood —88—. He told her to give the baby the prescribed drugs and keep out the mosquitoes that —89— the disease. The disease was in its early —90— but the most evident, symptom was the —91— of the eye membranes. This was caused by the trachoma virus, which could not be seen under a —92— because it is even smaller than bacterial —93—. Trachoma could cause blindness, so Mrs Dada had to protect her family from this —94— disease. She should keep up a high standard of —95— by —96— her personal towels and face cloths. The doctor also wrote out a —97— of antibiotic drugs and vitamin A tablets which should be got from a —98—. She was assured that this treatment would —99— the baby and restore him to good —100— in two or three days.

86.	A. reaction	B. opposition	C. energy	D. ornament	E. resistance
87.	doctor	technician	nurse	side	marion
88.	sample	type	exhibit	group	portion
89.	maintain	give	carry	deliver	transport
90.	circumstances	positions	stages	stages	levels
91.	protection	rheumatism	nervousness	inflammation	eye-sore
92.	microscope	horoscope	stethoscope	radioscope	microscope
93.	organisms	fungi	venom	pests	chironomides
94.	pathogenic	parasitic	contagious	noxious	poisonous
95.	protection	hygiene	immolation	vigil	sterilizing
96.	immunizing	cooking	refining	clarifying	prescription
97.	curriculum	curriculum	curriculum	curriculum	curriculum
98.	pharmacist	physiotherapist	scientist	virologist	dermatologist
99.	revive	cleanse	heal	repair	cure
100.	health	manners	health	life	condition

WASSCE JUNE 1998 ENGLISH LANGUAGE 2 OBJECTIVE TEST ANSWERS														
1. A	2. E	3. D	4. C	5. B	6. F	7. A	8. D	9. C	10. C	11. D	12. C	13. B	14. A	15. C
16. C	17. E	18. D	19. B	20. E	21. C	22. D	23. A	24. C	25. B	26. A	27. C	28. B	29. A	30. C
31. E	32. E	33. A	34. C	35. D	36. D	37. A	38. E	39. C	40. E	41. D	42. D	43. D	44. D	45. C
46. B	47. C	48. B	49. C	50. A	51. B	52. D	53. C	54. C	55. A	56. B	57. A	58. B	59. B	60. B
61. A	62. B	63. C	64. A	65. D	66. A	67. A	68. A	69. C	70. B	71. C	72. C	73. D	74. A	75. E
76. D	77. C	78. B	79. D	80. D	81. D	82. B	83. B	84. C	85. A	86. B	87. A	88. B	89. C	90. E
91. C	92. C	93. D	94. A	95. C	96. D	97. D	98. A	99. A	100. C					

WASSCE JUNE 1998 ENGLISH LANGUAGE 1 THEORY QUESTIONS

PART A

1. You have been sent on indefinite suspension for the part you played in a recent disturbance in which valuable school property was damaged. Write a letter to the principal of your school describing the part that you played and apologizing for your involvement.
2. Write an article for publication in a national newspaper on why you think a woman should be your country's next president
3. Write a letter to your elder brother working abroad describing the hardship you and your parents are facing at home and requesting him to give some financial assistance.
4. You are the chief speaker in a school debate, the topic of which is "Public secondary schools are better than the private ones. "Write your speech for or against the topic
5. Tell a story that ends with the advice: "Cut your coat according to your cloth."
6. You have just taken part in a local festival in your village. Write an article for publication in a cultural magazine describing the festival, its origin and importance to your people, and the role you played.

PART B SECTION I COMPREHENSION

Read the following passage carefully and answer the questions on it

7. The most memorable experience of my life was an incident that occurred some thirty years ago when I was in the fourth form in the secondary school. In those days, the speech-making and prize-giving day was always a great event. It was always a day when the results of the promotion examinations were announced to the students after weeks of suspense.

The afternoon commenced with all the students taking their seats in the large hall, and the members of staff, led by the principal, filing in. There were also three guests, each of them an important figure in the town. The principal and the dignitaries made speeches admonishing the students to work hard in order to attain their goals. Then the prize-giving commenced.

Soon, it was the turn of my class. For the overall best student, my name was called. This

was not unexpected, the position having become almost identified with me. Amidst the clapping, I stood up and moved towards the principal whose outstretched hand held a fat book I was already before him when he peered through his heavy spectacles, surveyed my figure and held back the book. There was a sudden silence. Students were amazed at this turn of events. Then he explained 'You'll have your prize when you pay your outstanding fees'

I stood there, almost petrified. Had I been warned of this disgrace, I would simply not have stood up, let alone bothering to go forward. There I was, the sorry focus of attention I wished my legs would refuse their function but they did no such thing. On the other hand, they refused to beat a retreat, at least, for those burning seconds. Then suddenly, spontaneously, the students started clapping and hailing me. Thus, my return journey was more loudly cheered than the outward journey.

For the prize in English Language, my name was also called. Of course I sat still, but the students hailed on. The prize was kept. For Mathematics, it was the same drama. Somehow the students' behaviour saved the day for me.

Poorly clothed, in torn tennis shoes and being a debtor, I was the talk of the school. The little fee I had paid that year was earned through doing menial jobs at weekends, supplemented with donations from some school mates. Father's financial difficulties had been aggravated by a protracted court case. He had no alternative but to ask me to withdraw from school and look for a job. This I had refused to do.

I had borne the cross gallantly until that day when the principal's action threatened to kill whatever courage remained in me, I ordered the tears to gush out to flood my sad face, but the ovations forced the spring to remain dry. I had the loudest ovation that day, the students' response to my plight was my own prize.

- (a) Why were the students usually in suspense before the prize-giving day?
- (b) Why was the announcement of the writer's name as the winner of the best student prize not a surprise?
- (c) What two proofs are there in the passage to show that the writer was liked by his school mates?
- (d) Why was his father unable to pay his school fees?
- (e)whose outstretched hand held a fat book" (i) What grammatical name is given to this

expression as it is used in the passage? (ii) What is its function in the sentence?

(f) "I had borne the cross gallantly....." (i) What figure of speech is this expression? (ii) What does it mean as it is used in the passage?

(g) For each of the following words, find another word or phrase which means the same and which can replace it as it is used in the passage

(i) memorable (ii) figure (iii) amazed (iv) maniac (v) portrayed (vi) plight

8. *Read the following passage carefully and answer the questions on it.*

A candidate in an examination hall is a close cousin of the boxer in the ring. Both are fighting for a prize or at least, for some commendation. Their goal is to win, and victory brings fame while failure leads to disaster and frustration. Each victory paves the way for a promotion up the ladder, and the higher one climbs the more exposed to the public glare one gets. A world boxing champion is like a Nobel Prize winner among academics, each is at the top of his career, but the route to that position can be tortuous and rough.

The examination candidate is not a very normal person for the simple reason that he is under severe pressure. Although he is alert and his pulse is fast, he is liable to commit elementary errors without knowing it.

Thus, he may repeat or omit one word, miss the spelling of another or interchange the positions of two words, if he reads over, which he hardly ever does, he may see what was originally in his brain rather than what is on paper. So most errors escape him.

More alert than at ordinary times though his brain maybe, it can play funny tricks in the examination hall. Thus, while struggling with the question, he may suddenly recall an old joke or a long forgotten and obscure incident. Right there in the examination hall, while his pen is dancing furiously on the paper the candidate may remember a beautiful tune as if his mind is saying. "Forget this task, enjoy some music" Happily, these do not usually disrupt the exercise at hand: the task goes on while the candidate may smile to himself at the strange recall of the joke or music

The brain can play a different type of trick. A fact long stored up and remembered a short while before the examination can suddenly evaporate. All attempt to recall it may prove unsuccessful. Usually, till the paper ends, the fact remains exclusive only to resurface much later when not needed.

The candidate does not fare better in an oral examination. His problems are heightened by the

fact that his fate depends entirely on the examiner's assessment of him rather than what he writes down himself. The facial appearance of the examiner is also a strong factor since a stern unsmiling examiner can be intimidating. Yet, an examination candidate need not be frightened. He needs all the calmness he can muster. He should sleep soundly before the exercise trusting that all the preparations he made earlier will not fail him at the hour of need. The fact is that one forgets more when one is tired especially when one panics unnecessarily.

(a) In what two ways is an examination candidate similar to a boxer?

(b) Identify two direct results of pressure on the candidate

(c) Give two examples of the "funny tricks" the brain can play on the candidate

(d) Give two reasons why a candidate may have a greater problem at an oral examination than at a written paper

(e) while his pen is dancing furiously on the paper
(i) What figure of speech is this? (ii) What does it mean?

(f) A candidate in an examination hall " (i) What is the grammatical name given to the expression above as it is used in the passage? (ii) What is its function in the sentence?

(g) For each of the following words, find another word or phrase which means the same and which can replace it as it is used in the passage:
(i) paves; (ii) apex; (iii) severe; (iv) elusive; (v) stern; (vi) calmness

SECTION II SUMMARY

Read the following passage carefully and answer the questions on it.

We have often heard students making wild assertions that the public examining bodies are their worst enemies. Some, in fact, see the officials of these public examining bodies as wicked souls scheming day and night to devise ways of failing them. How correct are these assertions? The facts will speak for themselves.

The task of setting an examination paper begins long before the examination day. Indeed, months or years before the, seasoned experts in the various subjects are given the teaching and examinations syllabuses and requested to set questions. These are compiled for subsequent scrutiny. Then a second set of experts is invited to examine the questions critically, make necessary modifications and come up with questions that conform with acceptable standards. The result of this exercise is a set of polished and unambiguous questions that are very fair to those being

examined. These questions are then securely stored.

The next stage is the registration of candidates. This stage involves not just the examining body, but also the candidates, their parents, their principals and some other members of the public. This is so because apart from the candidates having to fill in the forms, his principal has to endorse them while the parents have to provide the registration fee. Any mistake or inaction on the part of any of these may ruin the candidate's chances. If for instance, the candidate makes a mistake in his choice of subjects or in completing his forms, or if the principal does not forward the registration fee at the right time, his chances in the examination may be jeopardized.

Next is the conduct of the examination itself. Again, more officials from outside the examining body than from within it are involved. Think of the supervisors, the invigilators and even the security officials. They are definitely more in number than the staff of the examining body and any one of them could take an action that might result in the failure of candidates. Take the invigilator for instance. If he is negligent candidates could swap answer scripts under his very nose, and when this is detected by the markers, as is often is, the results of the candidates may be cancelled.

Probably, the most hated person to the candidate is the marker whom they in their ignorance, regard as a wicked drunkard who delights in failing candidates. What candidates do not realize is that an examiner is trained to score points strictly according to a carefully prepared marking scheme from which he must not deviate. It is his constitution. Besides, his work is consistently checked by his team leader and the chief examiner. Should he be discovered to have marked inaccurately, he could be removed. So, contrary to candidates' opinion, the examiner is a seasoned teacher, a careful scorer, a person always on his guard.

The final stage comes with the collation of results. This stage is mainly computerized, and computers do not make mistakes. A candidate's results may not be processed if he is involved in a malpractice, has used a wrong examination number or no number at all, or if he fails to write all the papers that make up a subject. So when a result is withheld, the fault is mostly that of the candidate.

How then should we view the activities of the public examining bodies? Definitely, we should view them with understanding sympathy and appreciation.

(a) In one sentence, summarize the writer's purpose in this message

(b) In two sentences, one for each, state how the actions of the candidate and the invigilator can jeopardize the candidate's chances of success

(c) In three sentences, one for each summarize the steps taken by examining bodies to ensure that candidates are given a fair chance of success.

WASSCE JUNE 1998 ENGLISH LANGUAGE 1 THEORY ANSWERS

1. Ifako High School,
P.O. Box 20,
Agege,
10th July, 1998

The Principal,
Ifako High School,
Agege,

Dear Sir,

APOLOGY OVER THE RECENT RIOT IN THE SCHOOL

It is a pity a violent demonstration erupted in our school on 3rd July, 1998. The riot was quite an unfortunate incident as what was planned to be a peaceful demonstration was hijacked by the hoodlums and eventually escalated to a full scale act of vandalism. I am writing this letter to describe the part I played and at the same time apologize for my involvement.

Right from the commencement of this academic session, feeding system in the boarding house has left much to be desired. In fact, it is nothing to write home about at all. The food issue is not only the question of quality but quantity as well. Whenever it is bread and tea, what we are given is mere coloured water, if rice, it is half rice and half stones. The soup issue is the worst. It is as watery as water from the Atlantic Ocean, yet our parents pay a sum of ten thousand naira per term per child in the boarding house. This problem has led to the outbreak of several diseases traced by hospital authorities to malnutrition.

Consequently, we convened a prefects' meeting - after morning assembly on that fateful day. There, a lot of complaints surfaced ranging from poor feeding to lukewarm attitude of teachers to teaching. It is resolved that a delegation of prefects be led by my humble self as the Deputy Senior Prefect should lodge our complaints with the school authority once again as had been done several times before without any solution. However, we went as proposed and met with the vice principal due to the absence of the principal.

Instead of reasoning with us, he rather turned a deaf ear and accused us of bad intentions. All effort to make him reason with us that our action should be seen as consultation rather than confrontation was ignored. He said that we were being used by some members of staff to cause chaos. He called us several names such as agents of vandalism, sowers of seeds of discord and the like. He refused that anyone of us should make any comment.

Before we got to the dining hall where the students, mostly the seniors had gathered, the atmosphere was already charged as they had heard how ruthlessly and rudely the vice principal had treated us. Infact, he treated us with contempt. I narrated to the students who had eagerly awaited our arrival the position of the vice principal, how he tagged us a9ents' of disgruntled elements among the teachers. I equally told them that he said we were being used by some people within and outside the school to cause unrest. However, I told them to be calp, that the principal would soon come to settle the matter.

As I was addressing them, a gang of hoodlums from neighbouring schools trooped into our school compound and accused me of playing to the gallery of the authority by rot alowing students to take laws into their hands. Before I knew what was happening, our students had joined the hoodlums to prepetrate violence, stealing arson and destruction of school property. Eventually, the library complex, laboratory block and the vice principal's office were burnt to ashes and a good number of people including the vice principal and a host of teachers wounded.

Consequently, I now tender my unreserved apology to the authority to please temper justice with mercy and cancel my indefinite suspension. This is due to the fact that my action was not intended to aggravate the situation but to douse it, but instead, I was singled out as the principal culprit. In view of the fact that our final eaminaiton is very much at hand, I implore the authority to set up an investigative panel to look into the causes of the causes of the uprising with a view to bringing the original culprits to book.

In conclusion, I will be very grateful if my suspension is cancelled and the authority looks into the matter. Thank you very much for taking time to read my own side of the matter.

Yours faithfully,
Babatunde Ojo,
SS2A

2. WE NEEDAWOMAN PRESIDENT

Nigeria, the giant of Africa gained her independence from Britain in 1960 and all our political leaders, military and civilian have been men up to date. However, I think the time has come when we have to consider a woman option as our president I know that Nigerian men will think otherwise and argue against such a proposition. From independence to date, ten men have ruled Nigeria at different times. It is time we had a woman president in our nation.

First, a woman president is urgently needed right now because men have disappointed Nigerians hence, we need a change. It ten men have ruled and there is no positive change, let us try a woman and see what happens. This method has been tried in some countries such as Britain and India to mention but a few, and they recorded a great deal of success. This is to further buttress the saying that what a man can do a woman an do it better". We need a change and a radical departure from the primitive idea that a woman cannot rule a country.

Secondly, a woman is naturally endowed with sympathy and this is what is needed to overcome our problems in the country. Most of the military rulers who have ruled us in recent years were dubious, inhuman and callous. Indeed, they had no sympathy for their fellow countrymen and women. If they had, no single individual would hold the whole nation to ransom by irresting and detaining hundreds of targeted opposition leaders. In fact we need a womam president to heal the wounds inflicted by our past men leaders. A woman president will not promulgate draconian decrees to either punish certain people or cow experienced Nigerians from constructive cnticism which is an ingredient of growth in modern society.

Furthermore, a woman president is needed if we need accountability as our watchword. Nigerian men leaders, both military and civilians have not lived up to expectation as far as this is concerned. They get to the revered position only to loot our treasury. They amass wealth by keeping fat foreign bank accounts in nearly all the developed countries of the world, yet they deceive us by advising us to show transparent honesty in whatever we do. We have had enough of deceit and financial impropriety from our men leaders, no woman can behave the way they have done. This is because women naturally show human feeling as mothers.

In addition, women are endowed with wisdom. That is why they run the affairs of their various homes with dedication and uprightness. They are the ones who bring up children and

embark on commercial activities to maintain their families. This sense is needed today in the country so that a woman president will help us manage our financial and material resources to take our country to the Promised Land. Unless this is done, we are doomed because a man-president in the new political dispensation will continue to marginalise women who have the technical solutions to our national problems.

Finally, if democratic principle and ideology are to be followed, then we need a woman president. Our population now is about a hundred million and females account for about sixty-five per cent. Also statistics have shown that female-voters account for over seventy per cent of voters at any election in the country. If all these are factual what then prevents a woman from becoming a president in Nigeria? Notting of course, except the few disgruntled male politicians who deceive the populace that only men have the magic wands to bring prosperity to the nation. May be that is why male politicians bribe the electorate to the tune of billions of naira to win electforis at all costs. No woman will ever spend or bribe to win elections, as they see it as a call to service.

In conclusion, it is my hope and aspiration that the Nigerian electorate in their millions will now reconsider their stands and elect a woman as our next president. This becomes quite mandatory if only we need transparent, honesty, accountability and service to humanity to dcmiriate our life as a nation.

Solomon Ogunmodede,
Ifako International School,
Ifako-Agege.

3. P.O.Box1728,
Agege, Lagos-State.
6th June, 1998.

Dear Brother,

It's a pity you haven't redplied to any of the letters I've written to you in recent time. At least, I've written two within the last five weeks, but who knows what must have happened to the letters in transit. This is so when one considers the deplorable postal system in the country in recent years. I'm writing this letter mainly to describe the hardship my parents and I are currently facing here in Nigeria, and to request for financial assistance from you.

Infact things have changed generally in the country from what they used to be. Our greatest hardship is lack of accommodation. Since December 1997, when both Dad and Mum were

retrenched by their respective companies, they have remained jobless. Dad was given only a month to vacate his official residence at Ikoyi. This threw the whole family into a wilderness of doubt as there was nowhere to pack to as my parents had least expected this. To worsen the situation, no gratuity was paid as Dad's employers claimed that he borrowed the sum of two hundred and fifty thousand naira two years before. We were unduly ejected from our five-bedroom flat at Ikoyi to nowhere in particular. When things got to the climax, we had to pack our belongings to our church at Agege. A lot of things were stolen and others damaged due to the fact that our properties were kept in an open space in the church. That was how my parents and I became tenants of circumstance in the church. We have become a laughing stock to the congregation as they often refer to us as homeless members of the church.

Another notable hardship is feeding. As I said beofe, Dad has borrowed more than he was entitled to as gratuity from his company. He spent the money purchasing a plot of lend at Ikoyi to build his own private house like some of his mates did but the whole icea backfired. This is because the land owners also sold the same plot of land to a military officer who had warned Dad to leave it for him or face the ccnsequence. Infect the matter is still in court and Dad has no money to hire an experienced legal practitioner to defend him. The little savings my parents had before their ill-fated retrenchment has been spent on the land case and so no money to feed. We have no alternative but to fast like prcphets. We now eat once or twice daily,. We now suffer from malnutrition according to our doctor's diagnosis of our ailment last rronth. Only God knows when last I took milk, meat and rice becaue of their prices. Breakfast is now cancelled.

My education has come to an abrupt end as I could not afford to register for the last SSCE. I was the only candidate who couldn't register due to financial difficulty. My parents tried all they could but to no avail. Before I left the school abruptly, I owed school fees to the tune of fifty thousand naira as I never paid a kobo for two sessions. I've left school to work as a truck pusher at Daleko Market. Yet I had a dream of becoming the first medical doctor not only in the family but in the entire village. Before I finally bowed out of school, 1 had no school uniform, no sandals, no books, even writing materials I couldn't afford.

Brother, things have come to the point that we have no alternative but to turn to you for assistance. For now, you are our messiah. We have been pushed to the wall by economic crisis as a result of our parents' unemployment. Both of

them are now hypertensive as a result of too much thinking over peculiar domestic problems. For the first time, I now solicit your help - a financial assistance to alleviate our problems which have degenerated into a mess.

As at now we need money to rent at least a room and a parlour for accommodation, for me to go back and complete my secondary education; to feed and finally, money for Dad and Mum to embark on trading so that they can overcome their plight which has been prolonged by their unemployment. All these are their heart desires and they will be very happy if you could send a sum of five thousand dollars through the 'Western Union Money Transfer' of the First Bank. This is enough as our currency has been greatly devalued. It is now eighty naira to a dollar. It will be my pleasure if you act fast before death will deal a blow on us all here. I hope your family is enjoying the U.S I pray for good health and prosperity for you and your family.

Your brother,
Femi,

4. My Chairman, Distinguished Listeners, Ladies and Gentlemen, I stand before this august gathering to oppose the motion which states that public secondary schools are better than private ones. The public secondary schools are the government-owned ones while the private ones are those secondary schools belonging to private individuals. As we shall see soon private schools are the only hope of secondary education in the country. My stand is based on the points discussed below.

First, public schools lack the much needed qualified, dedicated and experienced teachers needed for effective and efficient teaching. This is very much unlike the private schools where the reverse is the case. Most teachers in public secondary schools, perhaps as a result of poor wages and lack of incentives, pay lip service to their work. They work half-heartedly as they see urban centres are more of traders than teachers. They are known by what they sell not by what they teach as they hawk from staff room to staff room and from school to school. Those who are not traders sit tight in the staff room even when they have lessons. All these rubbish can hardly happen in private secondary schools. This is because the teachers are well remunerated and there are incentives for hardworking ones, so there is a challenge.

Second, learning facilities are well equipped in private secondary schools unlike in private ones. For example, laboratories are well equipped in private secondary schools where each science subject has its own laboratory. This is not so in public schools where in most cases a single laboratory is available for all science subjects in the school. In fact, items or apparatuses needed to perform experiments are not there. Most of their chemicals are expired as they were bought decades ago. Unlike private schools where experiments are performed on daily basis in public schools, it is like Christmas which is once in a year. No wonder students run away from science subjects in public schools while they rush them in private ones.

Every private secondary school has a library with modern and recommended textbooks unlike the public ones. A library is a tale of the unknown land in public schools. This has made students from private secondary schools to cultivate reading culture. This is so because their libraries are open from morning till late in the evening, unlike in public secondary schools where such a facility is non-existent. Yet in public schools teachers no longer teach well nor give notes, and to worsen the situation, parents cannot afford to buy books for their children due to their prohibitive prices. This makes the difference between the performances of private and public secondary school students very clear.

Mr Chairman, Ladies and Gentlemen, I heard my learned opponent say that the tuition fee in private secondary schools is too much but I beg to disagree. This is because whoever wants superior goods and services in modern day Nigeria should be ready to pay for them. Moreso, those who believe that education is too costly should try ignorance. Fees charged by an average private secondary school in an urban area is about five thousand naira per term and they provide good and qualitative education. In public secondary schools, at times they pay more than this in the name of education levy, examination fees, PTA levy, practical levy, test fees and so on. At the end of the term what parents pay in public schools is almost the same with what parents pay in private schools. The difference is not much except that with so much paid, public schools have nothing to show for it.

In conclusion, there is no doubt in my mind that private secondary schools, are of course, centres of excellence. I hope the audience, my learned opponent and the doubting Thomases are convinced beyond any iota of doubt that private secondary schools are by far superior to public ones.

Thanks you immensely for granting me audience. God bless you all.

Yetunde Ogunmodede,
Community High School,
Dopemu

5. Once upon a time, there lived a boy called Timo in the village of Akura. He was from a poor home. The parents found things extremely difficult yet they did their best to get him educated although they had nothing. At the village primary school, Timo was a wonderful boy as he came first in all his examinations. In fact, the first position had almost been identified with him. This position he maintained till he entered secondary school in a distant town called Oja.

His entry to a secondary school marked a turning point in his life. For the first time they bought new clothes, tennis shoes and a wrist watch for him. He was indeed happy to be among the pioneers of Oja Government Secondary School. Of course, due to his old age and intelligence he was appointed a prefect. Things were reasonably all right for him until he got to the penultimate class (SSII) when he started, keeping bad company. He forgot all the advice his parents gave him before he entered secondary school. He had forgotten all those stories his mother used to tell him to justify the saying that 'bad company corrupts good manners.'

He had identified with a gang of boys and girls who were best known for flamboyant and prodigal lifestyles. He no longer remembered the son of whom he was. The members of the gang were all from affluent homes, whereas he was the only one from a poor home. Each boy had a girlfriend in the gang and he too could not afford to miss this. He too wooed a girl from the gang and the girl (Bola) told him there was no problem provided he could satisfy her needs and wants because she was quite an expensive girl. Timo gave assurance that he was up to the task. That was how they started.

Bola whose taste was high had the habit of demanding anything new on daily basis. At first, Timo was able to keep her reasonably satisfied by deceiving his father that the authority demanded certain sum of money, yet he was on full scholarship. Things came to a crisis point during the third term in SSII when things began to fall apart. He could no longer concentrate on his studies as Bola had introduced him to night parties here and there. Indeed, he had become a prodigal

son, there was nothing he couldn't do provided it brought money to satisfy Bola. His academic performance had deteriorated so much as he had no time to study any longer.

One day Bola called Timo and told him she wanted to celebrate her birthday in two weeks time and that a sum of fifty thousand naira was needed for the D-day. Timo had no option but to seek for the money elsewhere. He contacted members of his gang to bail him out but to no avail. He went to his parents to tell a lie but that was no solution as his parents were poorer than church rats. Something came to his mind that he should conspire with his gang to get the money by hook or crook means. They came together to hatch a plan to rob nearby community bank in the wee hours of the night. They spent extra hours to plan this with foolproof devices. They co-opted one of the clerks of the bank into their fold for the evil machination.

Unknown to Timo, the clerk had let the cat out of the bag by telling the manager what was about to happen and the manager had taken appropriate measure by reporting to the security agents. The bank premises were combed by military operatives as early as midnight, an hour before the operation. Unfortunately, other gang members were drunk and slept off. They couldn't wake up until 6 O'clock in the morning. It was indeed a disaster as Timo had gone to his designated operation base 1.30a.m with some rounds of ammunition, thinking that all other gang members had taken positions. He first shot into the air to scare away the unarmed security guards and bring them to their knees before the operation. All as he was doomed to fail. Instead of his expectation of getting his gang members, it was the men of the security outfit. Operation Sweep' that greeted him with more superior firearms. He was instantly disarmed and arrested. It was then he knew that the game was up. He tried to bribe the security operatives but to no avail. He was then led to the other gang members who were also arrested and detained.

However, the news spread like fire during harmattan. It was even exaggerated in some quarters that Timo had robbed a bank of millions of naira. Within days, other gang members were bailed and their parents arranged for lawyers to get their children off the hook but there was nobody to do that for Timo. He was subsequently transferred to Kirikiri Maximum Prison. He has been there for over a year and he is soon to face the Armed Robbery and Firearms Tribunal of which, if found guilty, he faces capital punishment. Last week when his gang members who are now free went to tell him the recent development, he

opened his mouth wide and said: "if I had known it would end up this way wouldn't have contemplated doing it at all. I now believe more than ever before in the saying: "Cut your coat according to your cloth".

6. NEW YAM FESTIVAL AT ABULE OJA

The new yam festival, otherwise called "Ogun Festival" is to Abule Oja what Christmas is to Jerusalem. It comes up once a year. It is the greatest and most celebrated traditional festival in Abule Oja. It is celebrated in honour of Ogun - the Yoruba 'god of iron and war'. It is the only festival that brings together the people in the village both those at home and abroad as well as all those who belong to different religions - be they christians, moslems or traditional worshippers all unite as one during Ogun Festival at Abule Oja. The last one was celebrated from 10th to 12th August 1998. It was the most celebrated in recent years as new age grade of which I was an active member was formed during the festival.

The origin of Ogun in Abule is shrouded in obscurity as no one can remember when it actually began. The only legacy left is the oral tradition that Ogun was a powerful god of Olodunmare (supreme god) who was given the power over farming activities and war Ogun was known all over Yorubaland to be a hot-tempered god (no wonder people pray against his hot temper). He was said to be on a long journey to the present day Ekiti area of South-West Nigeria when he was provoked at Ire-Ekiti by an empty gourd of palm wine and those gathered there made jest of him because he could not get anything to cool his thirst. Ogun killed all those gathered who were then playing 'ayo game' one by one. Till today, Ire-Ekiti is known as the permanent home of Ogun.

Ogun is important to an average Yoruba man living or dead. They have the belief that Ogun has power over war, accidents and any form of danger or catastrophe. Consequently, Ogun is worshipped by all even Christians and Moslems alike. The belief is that if adequate sacrifices which include - dogs roasted yam, snails, palm oil, and kolanut and of course palmwine are made to Ogun, he would be appeased and dangers can be kept at bay. It is equally believed that Ogun is the god of productivity and so has to taste the first set of harvested yam. It is a taboo to exhibit new yam tubers in the town before Ogun festival. Infact, certain chieftains of Ogun called priests never taste new yam until a day after the Ogun festival.

I played a significant role in the just concluded Ogun Festival at Abule. On the eve of the festival, all those to be initiated into a new age grade were assembled early in the morning at the of the festival as well as our roles. Each was told to make available by evening a calabash-full of pounded yam, a male dog, cock, kolanut, roasted yam and a gourd of palmwine for sacrifice to Ogun. All these my parents had provided as they were full of enthusiasm that their first male child would enter into the age grade system of the village.

By evening, the population of the village has swollen by a large number because of visitors and indigenes from far and near. It was a re-union of all members of many families. In our family alone, I could count over ten members who arrived because of the ceremony. They bought a lot of things for my parents and myself who was the cynosure of all eyes in the family. For the first time they bought for me a wrist watch and expensive clothes which perhaps, would have remained a wishful thinking if not for the festival. Before dusk new, yams began to emerge from various farms into the village. The village wore a festive look in readiness for the festival. Not quite long, the town crier indicated through a gong that all Ogun - age grade candidates for the year should fall in and I quickly carried my own materials including a male dog to the Chief Priest's house. I was perhaps, the last to get there as all was set.

As I got there, the Chief Priest was briefing them to avoid fighting and rancour as Ogun had warned against such. Then a skilled Ogun priest, after the necessary sacrifice was made, cut into two the dog I bought. The whole thing is still a mystery to me how he did it. The legs were held by a young man and the head by another person. Before I knew what was to happen, the skillful priest came from the shrine as if he was to give an instruction, then cut the dog into two by the neck. I never witnessed an occasion like that before. In no time, the new age graders were led into dancing and singing in praise of Ogun. The dancing was both collective and individual. I have never danced like that before. After that, we ate all the food brought and the dog was prepared for eating. I never tasted it before but I had no alternative but to eat with them. I also took some large quantity to my father as a chief.

Around ten in the evening, the new age graders were to lead the whole village in dancing and singing against those who has done abominable acts like stealing, fighting, adultery and so on. The rule was when they sang against you, you had to provide kolanut, salt grade. I led this group for some hours before I was exhausted.

By dawn, the king dressed in his traditional regalla and his crown, followed us with other chiefs to dance round the Ogun shrine seven times each time with a special song. In the afternoon, all visitors who came for blessings were prayed for but with a promise of what to bring for Ogun the following new age grade year. I could see those who brought cows, rams, and cocks in multiples. I learnt that Ogun had answered their prayer. It was wonderful was fantastic as if the day should never end.

By noon, it was to be rounded off and each of us in the new age grade had to dance with fresh palm leaves round our waists. I managed to dance well as I was exhausted to the extreme. I got many presents from my parents and well wishers. Infact, I would have prayed that another one should come soon but it only happens once in one's life time. It was colourful as television crews from both private and public media covered the ceremony. I was the centre of attraction as I was the one interviewed as the only one among the actors who could speak English fluently. It was recommended by the media men that covered the festival that such should be integrated into the nation's tourism.

Bola Oni,
Eda - Ilejemeje - Ekiti,
Ekiti State.

PART B

SECTION 1

COMPREHENSION

7. (a) The result of the promotion examinations were not announced beforehand,
(b) The announcement was not surprising because the writer had won it many times before
(c) (i) Some of his mates helped him financially.
(ii) The whole school hailed him (even when he was denied his prizes)
(d) His father was unable to pay because of his financial crisis and a prolonged court case
(e) (i) Non-defining relative clause (ii) It qualifies the noun "principal".

- (f) (i) Metaphor (ii) I had endured the suffering courageously".
(g) (i) memorable-unforgettable, remarkable, striking (ii) figure-person, personality (iii) amazed - surprised, astonished, flabbergasted (iv) menial - mean, degrading, humiliating (v) protracted - prolonged, unending, long-drawn, (vi) plight - predicament, difficult situation.

8. (a) The two are similar because (i) both are struggling for a prize (ii) victory for both brings fame while failure brings disaster
(b) (i) He is liable to commit elementary errors (ii) Most errors escape him
(c) (i) He forgets some information needed in the examination (ii) He recalls irrelevant information
(d) (i) His fate depends entirely on someone else's assessment of him. (ii) The facial expression of the examiner may scare/frighten him
(e) (i) Metaphor/Personification. (ii) While he is writing fast/desperately! seriously
(f) (i) Noun Phrase (ii) Subject of the verb 'is'
(g) (i) paves - prepares, smoothens, opens, clears, (ii) apex - top, zenith, acme, peak, climax
(iii) severe - great, heavy, intense, tremendous,
(iv) elusive - evasive, difficult to recall.
(v) calmness - coolness, tranquility, composure.

SECTION II SUMMARY

9. (a) The writer's purpose in this passage is to show that: (i) examination bodies are not candidates' enemies (ii) allegations against public examination bodies are incorrect (iii) candidates' belief that officials of public examination bodies are wicked is wrong. (Any one of the above),
(b) (i) The candidate can jeopardize his chances of success - if he fills his form wrongly - if involved in examination malpractices (Any one of the above) (ii) Invigilator's negligence can jeopardize candidate's chances success
(c) (i) Examination questions are fair to candidates (ii) Candidates' scripts are marked based on the marking scheme (iii) The collation of examination results is done by computers

WASSCE JUNE1998 ENGLISH LANGUAGE 3 TEST OF ORALS OBJECTIVE TEST

SECTION 1

From the words lettered A to D, choose the word that has the **same vowel sound** as the one represented by the letter(s) underlined. An example is given below

Example: seat A. sit B. cite C. set D. key

The correct answer is D because only key contains the same vowel sound as the one underlined in seat. So, answer space D would be shaded

[A] [B] [C] [D]

Now answer the questions that follow:

1. police A. lice B. list C. least D. lest
2. feather A. meat B. feeder C. fate D. meant
3. cot A. coal B. hot C. cut D. curt
4. about A. pat B. part C. patent D. father
5. soul A. cope B. coup C. corps D. couch
6. boil A. south B. sower C. sound D. coy
7. sick A. spike B. sake C. peak D. women
8. rude A. room B. rout C. rum D. role
9. birth A. colonel B. bath C. egg D. colour
10. bait A. bat B. bark C. bake D. back
11. fare A. here B. hear C. heir D. are
12. tight A. bait B. bite C. bit D. bitch
13. out A. though B. cough C. cow D. bought
14. act A. ample B. park C. law D. class
15. part A. pack B. hat C. watch D. heart

SECTION 2

From the words lettered A to D, choose the word that has the **same consonant sound(s)** as the one represented by the letter(s) underlined. An example is given below:

Example: vice A. cat B. dress C. show D. chalk

The correct answer is B because only dress contains the **same consonant sound** as the one underlined in vice. So, answer space B would be shaded

[A] [B] [C] [D]

Now answer the questions that follow:

16. lorry A. calm B. walk C. palm D. kill
17. kite A. chaos B. cheap C. knife D. cheese
18. shadow A. flash B. century C. chess D. ass
19. dose A. those B. sudden C. packed D. toes
20. apt A. rapid B. raped C. listen D. programmed
21. axe A. ask B. ached C. lax D. kiss
22. cheek A. chemist B. campaign C. sharp D. cheque
23. scope A. school B. scene C. saint D. cellist
24. zero A. days B. cease C. seizure D. measure
25. sing A. examiner B. sinner C. miner D. fling
26. gas A. ledger B. examine C. bring D. gist
27. earth A. caught B. heart C. those C. thank
28. George A. goggle B. edge C. gnash D. guide

29. flame A. plane B. pillar C. psychologist D. philanthropist
30. although A. doughnut B. Thomas C. there D. thief

SECTION 3

From the words lettered A to D, choose the word that **rhymes** with the given word.

An example is given below:

Example: detain A. obtain B. detail C. claim D. relay

The correct answer is A because only obtain rhymes with detain. So, answer space A would be shaded

[A] [B] [C] [D]

Now, answer the questions that follow:

31. letter A. gather B. either C. wetter D. ladder
32. head A. shed B. heed C. herd D. heard
33. penal A. senile B. rationale C. renal D. personel
34. diction A. dictionary B. fiction C. mixture D. fusion
35. numb A. plumb . bomber C. climb D. camp

SECTION 4

In each of the following questions the main/primary stress is indicated by writing the syllable on which it occurs in capital letters.

From the words lettered A to D choose the one that has the **correct stress**. An example is given below.

Example: democratic A. DE-mo-cra-tic
B. de-MO-cra-tic C. de-mo-CRA-tic
D. de-mo-cra-TIC

The correct answer is C because the main/primary stress of the word democfatic is on the third syllable. So, answer space C would be shaded.

[A] [B] [C] [D]

Now, answer the questions that follow:

36. confidently
A. CON-fi-dent-ly B. con-FI-dent-ly
C. confi-DENT-ly D. con-fi-dent-LY
37. incompetent
A. IN-com-pe-tent B. in-COM-pe-tent
C. in-com-PE-tent D. in-com-pe-TENT
38. matriculate
A. ma-TRI-cu-late B. ma-tri-CU-late
C. MA-tri-cu-late D. ma-tri-cu-LATE
39. mobility
A. MO-bi-li-ty B. mo-bi-li-TY
C. mo- BI-li-ty D. mo-bi-LI-ty

40. confidential
A. con-fi-DEN-tial. B. CON-fi-den-tial
C. con-FIn-tial D. con-fi-den-TIAL

SECTION 5

In the following options lettered A to D, all the words **except** one have the same stress pattern. Identify the one with the different stress pattern and shade your answer in the usual way. An example is given below

Example: A. away B. apart C. behind D. river

Options A, B, C are all stressed on the second syllable while option D is the only one stressed on the first syllable. So, D is the correct answer and answer space 0 and be shaded

[A] [B] [C] [D]

Now, answer the questions that follow:

41. A. exalt B. higher C. return D. arrive
42. A. grumble B. laughter C. forgive D. southern
43. A. deduction B. reduction C. damagogue D. advantage
44. A. guarantee B. excursion C. expertise D. saboteur
45. A. demarcate B. dedicate C. benefit D. examine

SECTION 6

In each of the following sentences, the word that receives the **emphatic stress** is written in CAPITAL LETTERS. From the questions lettered A to D, choose the one to which the given sentence is the appropriate answer. An example is given below

Example: MY mother's FRIEND hates pets

- A Does your mother's boss hate pets?
B. Does your mother's friend love pets?
C. Does your mother's friend hate toys?
D. Does your father's friend hate pets?

The correct answer is A because My mother's FRIEND hates pets answers the question, Does your mother's boss hate pets? So, answer space A would be shaded.

[A] [B] [C] [D]

Now, answer the questions that follow

46. The old man is a MESSENGER
A. Who is the messenger?
B. Is the young man a messenger?
C. Is the old woman a messenger?
D. Is the old man a typist?
47. Our junior team won the football competition LAST YEAR
A. When old our junior team win the football competition?
B. Did your senior team win the football competition last year?
C. Did our junior team win the athletics competition last year?

D. Who won the football competition last years?

48. The DRIVER has taken John away
A. Whom did the driver take away?
B. Who took John away?
C. What did the driver do?
D. Where did the driver take John?
49. Jane PREPARED a delicious meal
A. Did Mary prepare a delicious meal?
B. Did Jane prepare a delicious drink?
C. Did Jane prepare a tasteless meal?
D. Did Jane serve a delicious meal?
50. Laraba's poems MAY win the first prize
A. Whose poems may win the first prize?
B. Will Laraba's poems win the second prize?
C. Will Amin's poems with the first prize?

SECTION 7

From the words lettered A to D, choose the word that contains the sound represented by the given phonetic symbol. An example is given below

Example: / ɔ i / A. yell B. holy C. boy D. idiot

The correct answer is C because only boy contains the sound represented by the given symbol. So, answer space C would be shaded.

[A] [B] [C] [D]

Now, answer the questions that follow

51. / t / A. listen B. carried C. action D. walked
52. / ʌ / A. love B. about C. coup D. know
53. / f / A. match B. missive C. harsh D. measure
54. / ɔ : / A. hut B. hot C. fought D. fort
55. / t / A. shame B. character C. sure D. church
56. / θ / A. therefore B. Thompson C. health D. dear
57. / e / A. hide B. realm C. real D. hate
58. / ʒ / A. them B. through C. tied D. thank
59. / a l / A. cake B. bye C. mail D. mark
60. / / A. laugh B. cough C. lava D. stay

WASSCE JUNE1998 ENGLISH LANGUAGE 3 TEST OF ORALS OBJECTIVE TEST ANSWERS

1.B	2.D	3.B	4.D	5.A	6.D	7.D
8.A	9.A	10.C	11.C	12.B	13.C	14.A
15.D	16.D	17.A	18.A	19.B	20.B	21.C
22.D	23.A	24.A	25.D	26.B	27.D	28.B
29.D	30.C	31.C	32.A	33.C	34.B	35.A
36.A	37.B	38.A	39.C	40.A	41.B	42.C
43.C	44.B	45.D	46.D	47.A	48.B	49.D
50.B	51.D	52.A	53.C	54.D	55.D	56.C
57.B	58.A	59.B	60.C			

SENIOR SCHOOL CERTIFICATE EXAMINATION (SSCE 1988 – 2015)

Past Questions with Solutions

English Language

(Theory / Objectives with Oral English) 1999

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WASSCE JUNE1999 ENGLISH LANGUAGE 2 OBJECTIVE TEST QUESTIONS

SECTION 1

*In each of the following sentences there is one word or group of words underlined and one gap. From the list of words or group for words lettered A to D, choose the one that is **most nearly opposite in meaning** to the underlined word or group of words and that will at the same time, correctly fill the gap in the sentence.*

1. To encourage productivity we must reward industry and.....laziness
A. withhold B. withdraw C. punish D. oppose
2. I took the drug to relieve my headache only for it to.....my condition
A. alleviate B. provoke C. abate D. aggravate
3. An optimist wears a smile most of the time but..... goes about with a long face
A. an oculist B. an activist C. a pacifist D. a pessimist
4. You will make a good counsellor by listening to your clients rather than.....them
A. offending B. ignoring C. mishandling D. threatening
5. Tell Chike something confidential and he makes it.....the next minute
A. public B. personal C. popular D. private
6. You will succeed fairly well with adolescents If you coax rather than.....them
A. coerce B. punish C. pamper D. curse
7. While Adjoa is attentive to her duties, Kofi is.....
A. curious B. negligent C. punctual D. realistic
8. Life has become a misery for many due to the harsh economic conditions, but a few are still able to live in.....
A. satisfaction B. extravagance C. peace D. comfort

SECTION 2

*From the words lettered A to D, choose the word that **best completes** each of the following sentences.*

9. He is a young man of.....character
A. stable B. permanent C. transient D. Recognized
10. My parents do not.....late night parties
A. indulge B. suffer C. tolerate D. create
11. I have known him only recently so I cannot..... for his honesty
A. sign B. stand C. vouch D. support
12. In some cultures, dead people are buried, but in others they are.....
A. cremated B. baked C. fired D. flamed
13. The lady is a.....beauty
A. raging B. ravaging C. ravenous D. ravishing
14. It is bad manners to regard a stranger as an.....
A. ignoramus B. ignorant C. ignorance D. ignominy
15. In some countries, it is an offence to describe a child born out of wedlock as.....
A. illegal B. illegitimate C. illicit D. illiterate
16. In hazy weather, air travel is.....
A. harmful B. foggy C. misty D. risky
17. He has since taken over the.....of power
A. reins B. rains C. regins D. realms
18. The government has promised to.....the road construction project
A. repair B. enforce C. execute D. fascinate

SECTION 3

*After each of the following sentences, a list of possible interpretations is given. Choose the interpretation that you consider **most appropriate** for each sentence.*

19. I am sure you didn't know that the lady is light-fingered. This means that the lady is
A. careless in handling things B. fair-skinned
C. prone to stealing D. skilful with her hands

20. Unfortunately nowadays most young persons do not see eye to eye with their parents over matters of friendship and fashion. This means that parents and their children.
A. can't look one another in the face
B. hold strong view on friendship and fashion
C. have clothes different from their friends
D. hold different views about friendship and fashion
21. It is alleged that the accountants doctored the accounts of the company. This means that the accountants
A. called in the company doctor
B. falsified the accounts
C. became sick on account of the bribe they received
D. improved the accounts of the company
22. He has just been made the new Chief Executive so he will need sometime to learn the ropes. This means that with time he will
A. fix new gadgets in his new office
B. clear the abandoned things on the site
C. master the demands of his new office
D. learn the use of ropes in his new office
23. After the investigation many of the workers were given their marching orders. This means that the workers
A. were dismissed
B. were ordered to march
C. received fresh instructions about their job
D. were given orders similar to the first ones.
24. In his last days in office, the ruler was behaving like a bull in a China shop. This means that the ruler
A. loved the bull because he brought it from China
B. behaved in a manner that pleased the people
C. did not want to leave office
D. was acting in a manner unsuitable for his position.
25. Before alt the election results were announced it was clear that the leader of the opposition was home and dry. This means that the leader of the opposition
A. was very exhausted
B. won the election
C. lost the election
D. has arrived home before the rain
26. Whenever you discuss nuclear physics Ali is in his elements. This means that Ali
A. does not like nuclear physics
B. hates people who discuss nuclear physics
C. enjoys discussing nuclear physics

D. knows that nuclear physics is difficult

27. I am not going to say yes or po until you come out into the open. This means that I will not give an answer until
A. we both go outside
B. we agree on a position
C. you go outside
D. you reveal your own position
28. We shall understand him better by and by. This means that we shall know him better
A. much later
B. before long
C. by getting closer to him
D. without his realizing it.

SECTION 4

*From the words lettered A to D below each of the following sentences, choose the word or group of words that is **nearest in meaning** to the underlined word as it is used in the sentence*

29. Her parents have endorsed her mamage to the widower.
A. examined B. cnticised C. approved D. refused
30. I went through his work, it was all gibberish
A. maeaningness B. meaningful C. brutal
D too simple
31. Corporal punishment is still used in some schools as a deterrent to undisciplined students
A. remedy B. measure C. discouragement
D. prevention
32. Occasionally he rises to a level of rare excellence in his academic performance
A. unusual B. common C. scarce D. temporary
33. His contribution to the development of the hospital remains unrivalled
A. unbroken B. undisputed C. unparalleled
D. undisclosed
34. I have a feeling that he is doing some shady business outside the country
A. dishonest B. undisclosed C. unknown
D. shadowy
35. The decision I have taken is irrevocable
A. irreproachable B. irrefutable C. irreversible
D. irresponsible
36. Young children seldom engage in gainful activities
A. rewarding B. accredited C. advantageous
D. prevailing

37. The bank that started operations last year is now_ insolvent
A. prosperous B. attractive C. bankrupt
D. buoyant

SECTION 5

*From the words or group of words lettered A to D, choose the word or group of words that **best completes** each of the following sentences*

38. I think she..... her mother
A. takes from B. takes to C. takes after
D. takes for
39. The next national league match will.....
sometime next month
A. come in B. come along C. come about
D. come off
40. With the recent police action we expect the high
incidence of crime to.....
A. die down B. die away C. die off D. die up
41. No matter how much a bully tries to intimidate
you just.....him
A. stand up before B. stand up against
C. stand up to D. stand up for
42. The two men.....each other
A. fell out for B. fell out with C. fell out from
D. fell out on
43. The intervention forces have successfully.....
the rebels' supplies
A. cut in B. cut off C. cut up D. cut away
44. She.....to his overtures after much delay
A. gave out B. gave up C. gave away
D. gave in
45. He.....not retort when I am speaking
A. dare B. dares C. are D. will dare
46. It is you and John who.....wanted
A. is B. are C. was D. will
47. Please go on I.....you
A. am hearing B. hear C. can hear D. was hearing
48. By this time next year, I.....here for ten years
A. have worked
B. had been working
C. would have worked
D. will have been working
49. The seeds.....in the nursery before they
were transplanted last week
A. germinate B. had germinated
C. have germinated D. would germinate
50. It is hoped that the new house.....completed
next year
A. has been B. is being C. had been D. will be
51. I can't see him anywhere so he.....
A. can have gone B. shall have gone
C. must have gone D. would have gone
52. I wish Hassana.....at the birthday party yesterday
A. would have been B. is C. have been D. were
53.here, the case would have been settled
long ago
A. Had my mother been
B. Were my mother to be
C. If my mother were to be
D. My mother having been
54. The clown made everybody in the market.....
A. to be laughing B. to laugh C. laugh D. laughed
55. These days.....wealth appears to be easy
A. acquiring B. to be acquiring
C. having acquired D. to have acquired
56. The Principal is really a kind person.....heart
A. in B. at C. by D. off
57. Hi, lady, don't you ever get tired of
dancing.....?
A. I don't ever B. Yes, I don't C. No, I do
D. No I don't
58. As things are now, I have to look for.....tyre
A. a cheap, second-hand, rubber
B. a cheap, rubber, second-hand
C. a rubber, cheap, second-hand
D. a second-hand, rubber cheap
59. He breathed a sigh of relief when the examination
came to.....
A. end B. the end C. an end D. ended
60. Meet Ibrahim a special friend of.....
A. me B. my C. I D. mine
61.travelled together for the holiday
A. Themselves and their friends
B. They and their friends
C. Their friends and them
D. Their friends and themselves

62.of the players is to receive a gift of N1m
A. Each B. Ali C. Every D. Some
63. His visit has become an.....affair
A. every day B. every day's C. everyday
D. every day's
64. If I were you I.....to the police
A. would report B. In reporing C. have reported
D. shall report
65. My own house is just a.....from here
A. stone thrown B. stonethow C. stone's throw
D. stone-throw
66. He has promised to pay me.....later
A. sometimes B. some times C. some time
D. any times
67. He has not got.....the shock of his wife's death
A. through B. over C. off D. after
68. The money given to.....players is inadequate
A. we B. they C. that D. us
69. As I hurried to dress up for school, one of my
buttons came.....
A. off B. out C. up D. apart
70. The workers.....payment of their leave allowance
A. demanded for B. demanded over
C. demanded D. demanding
71. Some people find it difficult to hold.....a job for
a long while
A. off B. down C. out D. up
72. Please put.....the fire before sleep
A. back B. out C. up D. away
73. The.....of the NATO countries have been
alerted about the possibility of an attack
A. commanders in-chiefs
B. commander-in-chiefs
C. commanders-in-chief
D. commander-in-chief
74. I prefer drinking.....
A. than eating B. from eating C. to eat
D. to eating
75. I didn't know his illness was.....serious
A. that much B. much that C. so that D. that so

SECTION 6

*In the following passages, the numbered gaps indicate missing words. Against each number in the list below each passage, four options are offered in columns lettered A to D. For each question, choose the option that is the **most suitable** to fill the numbered gap in the passage*

PASSAGE A

The human brain is the most—76— organ in the body. Small and delicate, it is —77— in a bony fortress called the —78—. The brain controls the emotions, the —79—, and indeed all the functions of the body. Though we hear with the ears, see with the eyes and smell with the nose, it is in the brain that all —80— are sent and there they are —81—. No modern computer has the —82— of the brain. It —83— vast amounts of information. It works —84— from second to second, twenty-four hours of everyday. Yet the brain is very—85—; reduce or stop its supply of—86— and blood, and its owner dies or suffers a —87—

76.	A	B	C	D
77.	Conspicuous	constructive	compound	complicated
78.	Captured	imprisoned	housed	locked
79.	skull	head	ligament	cerebellum
80.	cells	corpuscles	intestines	nerves
81.	signals	signals	sounds	signs
82.	revealed	discovered	interpreted	collected
83.	invincibility	versatility	strength	responsibility
84.	stores	keeps	filters	produces
85.	intermittently	frequently	continuously	regularly
86.	wonderful	fragile	twofasting	crucial
87.	air	gas	nitrogen	oxygen
	neurosis	breakdown	stroke	tumor

PASSAGE B

As soon as I took the newspaper from the —88—, I quickly —89— through the pages, and stopped at the sports page. There, the picture of Marvin Hagler, the boxer, attracted me. — He was preparing for the—90— of his title. The —91— harped on Hagler's previous fights and —92— an easy victory over his —93—, I then read through the — 94— which usually states the paper's opinion on current issues. The —95— were very many, with some of them taking up full pages. There was only one —96— by an artist whose intention was clearly to —97— readers. There was also a full page —98— announcing the death of a prominent chief. In the column for serious-minded readers was a —99— on political transition, one of the —100— issues of the time.

88.	A	B	C	D
89.	trader	dealer	vendor	printer
90.	perused	studied	stared	flipped
91.	victory	trick	protection	defence
92.	correspondent	writer	editor	publisher
93.	predicted	prophesied	imagined	expressed
94.	antagonist	opponent	protagonist	attacker
95.	communique	propaganda	editorial	resolution
96.	commercial	announcements	advertisements	exhibits
97.	drawing	cartoon	sketch	caricature
98.	amuse	abuse	annoy	stimulate
99.	in memoriam	requiem	obituary	funeral
100.	caption	commentary	edition	feature
	contemporary	controversial	competitive	debatable

WASSCE JUNE 1999 ENGLISH LANGUAGE 1 THEORY QUESTIONS

SECTION A

1. You are in the final year in secondary school. Write a letter to your uncle, who is an influential person in society, telling him what you intend to do next and asking for his assistance.
2. You have just returned to the city from your village where you spent the last holiday. In an article suitable for publication in your school magazine, compare life in your village with that in the city.
3. There was a riot in your school resulting in extensive damage and the Ministry of Education ordered your school to be shut down. Write a letter to the Commissioner for Education, explaining the causes of the disturbance, and appealing for the school to be re-opened.
4. As your contribution to a debate, write arguments for or against the proposition. "We are happier than our fore-fathers"
5. Narrate an experience you have had or heard about that illustrates the saying. "Where there is a will, there is a way"

SECTION B COMPREHENSION

Read the following passage carefully and answer the question on it.

6. One of the puzzles to which I had no solution as a child was how my cousin could seal an envelope with his saliva. Each time he wrote a letter for my illiterate father; he merely ran his tongue over the inner edge of the flap of the envelope, folded it and then sealed it. Just like that! In my puzzlement I tried the same trick repeatedly with two pieces of paper but my saliva failed to hold them together. I then theorized that my cousin's saliva must be gummy. If that was so, why wasn't mine? My studied search for a solution led to the very sound conclusion that my cousin's saliva was gummy because he was the only educated man in the family. By extension, I reasoned that all educated people had sticky saliva.

But it didn't take me long to wonder why my cousin's lower jaw was not stuck to the upper jaw. Indeed, I wondered how morsels of food could roll

down to his gullet without sticking to the tongue and the palate. Each time I was around when he ate. I watched him put one morsel after another into his mouth without experiencing any problem in getting it down. After many days indeed weeks, of pondering over this thorny issue, I decided that while all educated men had sticky saliva, they had developed a special mechanism for neutralizing the stickiness when eating.

My theory received a severe jolt one day when father had to get a letter written, but my cousin was not around. Father sent to the next house for his niece, the nearest educated person around. After the lady had written the letter, father brought out an old envelope which had probably been lying forgotten for months on his cupboard. But, to my amazement, the flap would not stick well to the body of the envelope, no matter how many times she applied her saliva. In the end, father used some pap as gum. With this, my new puzzle was: Why was the educated man's saliva sticky while the educated woman's saliva was not?" Before long, I decided that the woman's saliva was not so sticky because she was not as the man. So, I updated my theory: the more learned a person was, the more gummy his saliva would be. Fine theory.

The death knell sounded on my latest theory one day when father sent me to buy an envelope from a nearby shop. Having bought it, I studied its flap closely and discovered that its inner edge had some glossy material. It felt sticky to my touch. Curious, I ran my tongue over it and sealed the envelope. That was it! It got stuck, refusing to be parted no matter how much I tried. When I delivered it that way, father rightly guessed that I had tampered with it. Although I received a spanking, I was consoled that at last, I had unravellled the mystery.

- (a) State the writer's original theory
- (b) State the modification to the original theory
- (c) What incident gave rise to the modification of the theory?
- (d) Why didn't the flap stick to the envelope when the woman tried to seal it?
- (e) What lesson did the writer finally learn?
- (f) "The death knell sounded on my latest theory"
- (i) What type of figurative expression is this?
- (ii) What does it mean?

- (g) "which had probably been lying forgotten for months on his cupboard" (i) What grammatical name is given to this expression? (ii) What is its function as it is used in the sentence?
- (h) For each of the following words, find another word or phrase

7. Read the following passage carefully and answer the questions on it.

The black ant is indisputably one of the smallest visible insects on earth. Except with the aid of a very powerful microscope, it is difficult if not impossible to locate the eyes, the mouth, the nostrils (if it ever has any) or any other part of the body. An air of mystery surrounds the existence of this little creature.

Have you ever taken time off your programme to watch these ants move in a row? What gives them the sense of direction, we do not know. Indeed. Whoever sends them on an errand and how they even know their destination and the type of errand to run we are yet to be told. But they are an extremely well-organized lot.

Certainly, there are no defined routes for them on walls or trees, yet they move in an orderly manner, almost in a straight line. The beautiful thing about these insects is that even when their line of movement is disorganized, they soon regroup and connect themselves again end to end. If in the process, one of them is killed, they quickly recognize that fact from their various positions. Then one sees them running helter skelter with a seeming insistence on getting at the comrade to confirm its death.

When this has been done, some of them run zigzag at a tremendous speed to alert the others on the route. Soon, they disappear completely. Later, as if everything were over and forgotten, they reappear and form a new route and continue their movement transporting food or going on one errand or the other as before. Bring your ears close to them and you hear nothing and you wonder what their means of communication could be.

Perhaps, most surprising is their high sense of understanding the weather and the climate. They are just like men in this area. They know when it is the rainy season and when the dry season comes. In fact, it is true to say that they prepare better for the future than man.

During the dry season, they file out to different places gathering food which they store underground. At the slightest sign of the approach of the rainy season, they all get into the hole and seat it up. Surprisingly they re-emerge when the dry season sets in. And whoever tells them that the dry season has come we do not know. You

can now see the sense in the injunction, "Go to the ant, thou sluggard, learn her ways and be wise".

(a) Why does the writer regard the black ant as one of the smallest insects on earth?

(b) Give two reasons why the writer thinks that the way ants live is interesting?

(c) (i) What is the writer's attitude towards the black ant? (ii) Quote an expression from the passage to support your answer

(d) 'When has been done'. What does 'this' refer to?

(e) "The beautiful thing about these insects

(f) What grammatical name is given to this expression? (ii) What is its function in the sentence? (i) What quality of the ant is implied in the last sentence of the passage?

(g) For each of the following words or phrases, find another word or phrase that means the same and can replace it as it is used in the passage:

(i) indisputably; (ii) row; (iii) helter skelter, (iv) a tremendous (v) area; (vi) approach

SECTION C SUMMARY

8. Read the following passage carefully and answer the questions on it.

In all school systems of the world, some schools are considered 'better' than others. Infact, based on such a judgement parents often go to great lengths to have their children enrolled in one school rather than another. One yardstick for making this judgement is student achievement especially general performance in public examinations. Furthermore, among some experts in education, opinions about schools are further narrowed down to subject areas. For example, one often hears that school A is better than school B in Mathematics and Science while the later is better than the former in English Language and the Liberal Arts. Whatever the focus of these comparative statements, there remains the fact that schools do vary in terms of average student achievement.

Why is it then that some schools have high average student achievement while others have low average student achievement? The reasons are not far-fetched.

The first reason is that some schools are located in privileged areas in the sense that the students come from homes where parents care about their children's education, ensure that the children are well-fed, show interest in their school work and provide easy access to books in the home. On the other hand, there are schools which serve less privileged communities and whose students come from homes where parents are unable to provide the necessary support services

for good academic work. Students in the first type of school would generally have a higher rate of achievement than those in the second type.

Another reason for the difference in academic achievement between schools is how well the schools are equipped. Schools that have good laboratories and libraries, ample space, places to sit and write for every student and optimum-sized classrooms usually record a higher standard of student achievement than those where the basic equipment is lacking or where the students are crammed into inadequate spaces.

The quality of the teachers also has to do with the differences in student achievement between schools. A teacher that does not have a good grasp of his subject matter nor is committed to his job cannot produce an outstanding student. On the other hand, students will generally attain a high standard where the teacher is an expert in his field, knows how to structure the material to be learned, demands a lot from his students and motivates them. Also, school management has been found to have a relationship with student achievement. Students perform better in schools where the leadership is enthusiastic and creative than in schools where the principals and teachers adopt a casual attitude to their job.

Finally, discipline cannot be divorced from the learning process, and this is often seen from the perspective of general student behaviour. Where students show a disregard for the rules and regulations that guide good learning by disobeying their teachers; neglecting their homework, or playing truant, they cannot make any reasonable academic progress. On the other hand, students who comport themselves well have laid a good foundation for academic success

(a) In one sentence summarize the yardsticks used to make a distinction between one school and another

(b) In five sentences, one for each, summarize the factors responsible for the different levels of achievements in schools.

WASSCE JUNE 1999 ENGLISH LANGUAGE 1 THEORY ANSWERS

SECTION A

1. Sonmori Comprehensive College,
P. M. B. 21106,
Agege,
Lagos State.
24th June, 1999.

Dear Uncle Bola,

It's a pity you couldn't reply to any of my letters. At least I have written two of them within the last three weeks. I begin to wonder what must have gone wrong, this is because you are not the careless type who is reluctant at replying to letters in good time. But who knows what must have happened to the letters in the process as our postal system is nothing to write home about. Ours is perhaps the most hopeless and corrupt the world over. It's highly deplorable.

I am writing to inform you that I am in the final year in secondary school and about to start the final examinations in no long a time. Also I want to discuss what I intend to do next and to solicit your support for my future undertakings. As at now, I am fully preparing for my WASSCE to enable me pass with flying colours. In view of this, I want to enrol for extra-mural lessons not for my final exams alone but also to pass the forthcoming UME to secure admission into a reputable university come this October.

I have just been told of a very good pre-university evening study centre here in Agege. It has a wide range of programmes that can cater for my needs. It was introduced to me by a friend who attended the centre last session and who is now at University of Lagos. According to him it doesn't cost much to attend lesson at the centre as what it takes is five thousand naira for the two courses I intend to study there.

While I am getting ready for the extra lessons, I will also ask for your moral, material and financial assistance to make the programme a huge success. I will solicit moral support from you, I want your advice because, as you know advice is best heeded when needed. I once told you I wanted to become a medical doctor but of late my performance in Physics leaves much to be desired. I need your advice urgently before I obtain JAMB form.

Uncle, I will equally request for material assistance. As you promised during Easter, I want those textbooks you used for Advanced Level in science subjects. They will be very useful for my UME as the questions are a little bit above O'level standard. One needs to score very high marks to

go into university on merit. Also, in case of any eventuality in the UME, your assistance will be very much needed to secure admission. By your status and influence in the society, you will get me a rightful course at University of Lagos as a member of the Governing Council of the institution.

Most important is the financial support. I need money now more than ever before. Apart from the lesson fees of five thousand naira, I intend to obtain JAMB and GCE forms which cost another four thousand naira. As the bread-winner of the family, you are the only one I can turn to for solution, I quite appreciate your support for the family at large particularly since my father save up the ghost. May God in his infinite mercy bless you abundantly and grant you long life and prosperity. I implore you to send my greetings to your dear wife and children. I expect your reply soonest with the requests made.

Yours sincerely,
Fisayo

Bye for now

2. For long I had anticipated going to spend some of my holidays in the village but my parents always turned a deaf ear. I was opportuned to travel to my village during the last Christmas holiday, I had dreamt of the village for weeks before we set for the journey. Interestingly, that was my first long journey outside Lagos since I was born. The journey started off at Ojota Motor Park in Lagos at eight O'clock in the morning. The bus was half-full of passengers as it was during the week. We arrived Ibadan at ten O'clock when we had breakfast. We continued the journey until we reached our village, Ero Ekiti in Moba Local Council of Ekiti State at four O'clock. It was a great welcome for me. It was this day I started noticing the sharp difference between the city and the village life. It is that of a sharp contrast.

First, it was time to bath before I would eat. The water they gave me was coloured and just a third of what I normally use in Lagos. I could not use the water because I feared it could cause water borne diseases. However, the villagers said it is better than your Lagos water. I had to purify the little water before I could bath. Even to bathe was another problem as there was no bathroom except the inwrccl one made of palm leaves and fronds. It was like one was bathing in the open. Later the water I thought was bad used by many children and adults to bathe. It was incredible as they all bathed in the open without feeling shy.

Groups of boys and girls too even bathed together without any misgivings. Such will never happen in Lagos where people live civilized life.

The night came and darkness enveloped the earth. There was no electricity of any kind. When I asked if there was NEPA blackout, my pedl meaning of NEPA. Thank goodness my grandmother later brought a traditional hurricane lamp. It was the smokey type. It made me to develop catarrh before daybreak. Throughout my one week stay, I never had the opportunity to watch television or listen to radio if at all there was any in the village. Yet I never set my eyes on any newspaper— — either national or local. Infat, this made me to conclude that the villagers were dead to their world. This is unlike Lagos where we watch a good number of channels on television, many stations on radio or even watch video the whole day. The newspapers and magazines are uncountable.

The following day I wanted to ease myself. I was led to the backyard bush where I was expected to defecate. It was unbelievable the heaps of excreta I saw, were deposited there on daily basis by children and adults. The maggots were celebrating perhaps a festival. I had no alternative but to join in the act reluctantly. It was a strange event to me but to the villagers it was a common occurrence as they had not known the toilet system used in the city. Refuse in the city is emptied at a central place where it is outside the city by refuse vehicles but it is dumped at the back of each house in the village. I wondered whether there was no cholera in the village because half of what I saw there can bring cholera epidemic that will ravage the vast area in the city. The villagers are indeed very lucky.

However, the village is better than the city in the area of feeding. I followed my uncle to the farm on the eve of my departure to Lagos. We worked till about noon and then stopped. We started preparing food. I was actively involved in every process as I wanted to know all because I would get back to the city. Every food item was fresh—the palm oil was just extracted from the fruits, the vegetable was 'fresh the meat of grasscutter was equally fresh. Infact, it was from the village I tasted corn fresh from the farm, unlike in the city where no-fooditem is fresh. By the time the food was ready I began to think whether some special visitors were on their way as the pounded yam for only four of us was quite enough for twenty in the city. No wonder the villagers are robust, stronger and healthier than city dweller. I came to the conclusion that the villagers eat better food but the city dwellers enjoy better life in terms of basic amenities.

In conclusion, there is a sharp difference between the village and city life in various ways of life. None has monopoly of everything. While the city dwellers have monopoly of infrastructural facilities, the villagers boast of better food. So if I hate the village due to lack of basic amenities, I cannot but admire it for the food I ate which will for a long time remain green in my memory.

3. Oniyo Community College,
P. O. Box 1,
Ogba,
Lagos State.
20th May, 1999.

The Honourable Commissioner,
Ministry of Education,
Alausa.
Lagos.

Dear Sir,

THE SCHOOL RIOT AND CALL TO RE-OPEN THE SCHOOL

I write this letter with a high sense of responsibility and duty to discuss the causes of the demonstration that occurred in the school lately and appeal to the Honourable Commissioner to temper justice with mercy and re-open the school at least for the sake of the innocent ones.

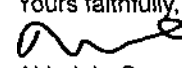
The major cause of the riot, though a remote one, was the illegal fees charged by the school authorities. In the whole state, it is only in our school that illegal fees are charged and failure on the part of any student to pay leads to summary dismissal. For instance, every student was charged five hundred naira as science levy, two hundred naira as sports levy and another five hundred naira as levy for practicals. All these are not part of the PTA levy of one hundred naira and three hundred naira Educational Development Levy. To worsen the situation, most of these illegal levies were not discussed at PTA meetings. This created a fertile ground for a possible riot.

Secondly, the state government refunded half of this year's SSCE fees to all final year students in public schools in Lagos State. Two months after the rest of the schools refunded theirs to the final year students, ours is yet to do so for reason best known to the school authorities. To aggravate the situation, the authorities illegally signed on our behalf and collected the money and the principal said that the money would be spent on school development. This was the last straw

that broke the camel's back. Some parents came to confirm this story from the principal but he talked rudely to them. The parents called a PTA meeting to discuss the fundamental issue affecting the school but the principal refused to attend

On 1st April, 1999 when the principal announced to the students that they were to pay a compulsory levy of one thousand naira to build the new principal's office, the students openly told him they will not pay until the levies they had paid were well accounted for and that he should obey the directive from the Ministry of Education to refund half of SSCE fees to each prospective candidate. It was at this juncture that some expelled students confronted him and before we knew what was happening there - was riot. As the Senior Prefect, I was calling for calm among the rank and file of the students but those expelled students took laws into their own hands and disrupted the peace in the school. Before the arrival of the police, the laboratory was already burnt down, and the principal's car and office vandalized. Consequently, the school was dosed with tear gas to prevent further destruction of properties. In view of the foregoing, I will implore the Honourable Commissioner to set up an independent probe panel to probe the incident and submit its recommendations. More importantly, the vast majority of the students are innocent, particularly the final year students whose final examination is at hand. I implore the authorities to re-open the school and make the students to pay for the damage done to the school property and also to transfer the principal and his senior lieutenants from the school for peace to reign.

In conclusion, there is no doubt in my mind that if my suggestions are well followed and implemented peace will reign in the school.

Yours faithfully,

Akindede Ogun.

4. Mr Chairman, Distinguished Ladies and Gentlemen, I rise at this august occasion to propose the motion which states. "We are happier than our fore-fathers", We are the present generation of men and women while our fore-fathers were those our ancestors who lived and died hundreds of years ago. My stand is based on the points stated below.

Firstly we are happier than our fore-fathers because the present generation enjoys sound

health brought about by science and technology. In the olden days, many people died rather untimely due to some undiagnosed diseases but today, medical "technology has improved tremendously that it now postpones death. Recently, computer technology has been brought into medical field and so future diseases can be easily detected and prevented. Today, little children are immunized against childhood diseases and this has brought about rising population at a geometric progression. It was very much unlike the era of our fore-fathers when outbreak of any epidemic could nearly wipe out a whole area. You see, our fore-fathers lived rather sad life due to a very high death rate brought about by their primitive herbs which has less value.

Secondly, we live happier life than our fore-fathers in the area of agriculture. In the olden day our ancestors practised crude form of agriculture. They were wandering fruit gatherers. At their best they practised subsistence agriculture. However, the modern generation practises mechanised and intensive agriculture. Today, the government allocates huge sums of money every fiscal year to boost agriculture. We now engage in co-operative farming to raise enough capital to buy sophisticated machinery to boost production as against crude implements of the old. Today we export cash crops such as cocoa and coffee, to other advanced countries of the world. This is a means of taking part in international trade thereby getting industrial goods from advanced countries, unlike our ancestors who never enjoyed all these. So, we live a happier life than them because we enjoy better standard of living.

Thirdly, in the area of telecommunication technology, the modern generation lives a happier life than our fore-fathers. In the olden days the means of communication was not only manual but primitive. Information was disseminated by trekking long distances as against today when modern information systems are in place. These among others, include computers, television, radio, fax and others. It is not uncommon today to watch live a football match played thousands of kilometres away. Today, we can telephone Russia or America, distance notwithstanding, and get reply within few minutes. All these were, unknown to our forefathers. The modern telecommunication technology has brought about cross fertilization of ideas which fosters economic development of the modern world. This perhaps has brought about inter-dependence in the modern economic system. With this, one knows very well that we live a happier life than our fore-fathers.

Ladies and Gentlemen, I heard my learned opponent say that our fore-fathers lived happier

life because they ate fresh food and lived longer life but I disconcur. This is because today, we get variety of food from all over the world even those food items not produced in our continent. Also, modern medicine has brought about longevity due to the contents and components of imported food items which were not available to our fore-fathers who did not enjoy balanced diet as we do. Our fore-fathers only ate what they produced locally so the modern generation lives a happier life.

In conclusion, there is no shadow of doubt in my mind that I have convinced the audience, including my learned opponent and the doubting Thomases beyond doubt, that we live a happier life than our fore-fathers who only lived primitive life by crude and unscientific means, and had no contact with modern civilization. Thank you very much for giving me your attention.

Solomon Akiridele,
African Church Couege,
Ifako.

5.

FROM GRASSTOGRACE

Once upon a time, there lived a man named Okoro who had a post-humous child. Okoro was a hardworking man but died two weeks before Momoh was born. Folarin, the widow decided not to marry but work assiduously to train Momoh to any level of education. Momoh had poor upbringing as the family lived in poverty and penury. Infact, they could not make ends meet as they were always in debt. Momoh, despite all odds was an industrious boy. He was not deterred by all shortcomings but rather had zeal and determination to succeed despite all odds. There was no good food to eat, he lacked school materials and had no useful dresses to wear except those given to him by other students who pitied him.

One fateful day when Momoh was in final year in secondary school, the struggling mother slept and never woke up. It was indeed a bombshell that was enough to end Momoh's hope of living. He cried bitterly but that would not bring back the mother. He imagined the bitter life he would live after the death of his mother. Infact, fate was somewhat unkind to Momoh as this disaster cut him to size. He hadn't paid the examination fees before the demise of the mother, plus thousands of naira he was owing the school authority. He was neck deep in debt as he hadn't paid any fees since he entered into senior secondary. However, his financial impotence didn't

affect his academic ability. He always passed any examination in flying colours and more determined than ever. At the close of registration, the school registered him on credit with the hope that when he finished from school he would engage in menial job to repay the loans granted. He was made to sign some undertakings which he did. Fortunately for him he passed all the nine subjects with distinctions. Infact, he had the best result in the whole federation and consequently, the Minister for Education awarded him automatic scholarship for the rest of his education. Not only that he equally passed UME and was admitted to study Medicine at Obafemi Awolowo University. It was no problem for him as a result of the scholarship he had won based on his academic performance in final examinations at secondary school.

Life at OAU was average at least as the scholarship only covered tuition and books. He had to engage in some menial job to raise some money for feeding and to purchase other necessary materials. He went through fire as a medical student in preclinical years due to lack of funds for most of his needs. He applied to various social organisations for help but to no avail as they claimed, that would amount to duplication of awards as he had already gotten one from the federal government. Despite his academic work load, he had to take a part-time employment at a nearby factory as a factory worker. He earned at least a little to meet his emergency needs. At long last, he finished and qualified as a medical doctor. To crown it all, he bagged a first class honours degree in medicine (MBBS) and was given another automatic scholarship for post graduate medical course. He spent two years at postgraduate medical course and ended it successfully.

At the completion of his course he was attached to OAU Teaching Hospital for his national service. After the service year he was retained for his deep knowledge of the profession and humanitarian activities. He worked for reasonable length of time before he set up his own medical practice. He had more patients than any other known doctor around. One day his former principal travelled to attend a conference at OAU but was involved in a fatal accident. He was rushed to Momoh Private Hospital. Dr Momoh had to battle tooth and nail to save the life of his former principal. By the time the former principal regained his consciousness, he recognised his former indigent student and asked the question How did you make it?' The answer Dr Momoh gave was 'Where there is a will there is a way.

SECTION B COMPREHENSION

6. (a) The writer's original theory was that his cousin's saliva was gummy I sticky. Or that educated persons had sticky! gummy saliva
(b) The modification of the original theory was that the more learned a person was the more sticky! gummy his saliva would be
(c) The woman's saliva did not seal the envelope
(d) The flap did not seal because the envelope was old. Or its gum was no longer effective
(e) The lesson the writer finally learnt was that the envelope had gum on its flap. Or that it was not the saliva that was sticky
(f) (i) Metaphor (ii) My latest theory was disproved
(g) (i) Adjectival Clause I Relative Clause (ii) It qualifies the noun 'envelope'
(h) (i) Puzzlement, amazement, wonderment, surprise (ii) thorny: difficult, tricky, (iii) severe, serious, real, damaging (iv) theory: belief; assumption, conclusion: (v) unravelled: resolved; solved.
7. (a) The writer regards the black ant as one of the smallest insects on earth because: It is difficult to locate the parts of the body with the naked eyes. Or: It is almost impossible to locate the parts of the body
(b) The two reasons why the writer thinks that the way ants live is interesting are: (i) Ants are well organized (ii) Ants can sense danger (iii) Ants have sense of direction (iv) Ants have a high sense of understanding the weather (just any two from above)
(c) (i) The writer's attitude towards the black ants that of admiration/surprise!amazement (ii) "well organized", learn her ways and be wise" , "Prepare better for the future than man", "the beautiful thing about these insects"
(d) 'This' refers to the confirmation of death (of a comrade or one of them)
(e) (i) Noun phrase (ii) Subject of the verb 'is'
(f) The quality of the ant implied in the last sentence of the passage is — wisdom / Industry /I hard work
(g) (i) indisputably: undoubtedly, certainly, unarguably, clear (ii) row: line, file (iii) helter skelter: in a disorderly manner, in disorder, in a disorganised way (iv) a tremendous: a great, an enormous, top (v) area: sense, aspect, respect, regard (vi) approach: arrival, commencement, coming, beginning.

SECTION C

8. (a) The yardsticks used to make a distinction between one school and another are: students' performance in public examinations and performance in subject areas
(b) The factors responsible for the different levels of achievement in schools are (i) Some schools are located in privileged areas while others are not. Or some schools are located in areas where

parents care for students (their children) while others are located where students are not cared for (ii) Some schools are well equipped while others are ill-equipped (iii) Some schools are well staffed than others (iv) Some schools have good management while others do not (v) Students in some schools are disciplined while others are not.

WASSCE JUNE 1999 ENGLISH LANGUAGE 3 TEST OF ORALS OBJECTIVE TEST

SECTION 1

From the words, lettered A to D, choose the word that has the **same vowel sound** as the one represented by the letter(s) underlined. An example is given below;

Example: seat A. sit B. cite C. set D. key

The correct answer is D because only key contains the same vowel sound as the one underlined in seat. So, answer space D would be shaded.

[A] [B] [C] [D]

Now answer the questions that follow:

1. how A. low B. surd C. plough D. rock
2. met A. eight B. hate C. at D. says
3. pack A. adverb B. park C. acre D. wake
4. luck A. lack B. lucid C. hut D. put
5. port A. cot B. dawn C. part D. done
6. seen A. live B. set C. leave D. save
7. pull A. wall B. ulcer C. pool D. book
8. wo A. could B. tomb C. wood D. toe
9. about A. boat B. fable C. candle D. doctor
10. heart A. earth B. hat C. last D. ear
11. say A. afraid B. high C. buy D. says
12. coat A. hot B. woke C. taught D. coarse
13. chair A. care B. tar C. here D. aim
14. tyrant A. libel B. typical C. year D. weird
15. beard A. bared B. word C. cheer D. read

SECTION 2

From the words lettered A to D, choose the word that has the **same consonant sound(s)** as the one represented by the letter(s) underlined. An example is given below.

Example: vice A. cat B. dress C. show D. chalk

The correct answer is B because only dress contains the same consonant sound as the one underlined in vice. So, answer space B would be shaded.

[A] [B] [C] [D]

16. tap A. kicked B. both C. wicked D. killed
17. hulk A. walk B. talk C. like D. silk
18. loose A. lose B. whose C. zoo D. toss
19. clash A. sarp B. cheap C. leisure D. school
20. pleasure A. assorted B. measure C. ease D. sure
21. castle A. bustle B. chuckle C. dazzle D. missile
22. village A. lag B. get C. agree D. just
23. film A. column B. palm C. elm D. lamb
24. gain A. singe B. figure C. ring D. gnaw
25. architect A. church B. ash C. parch D. quay
26. choir A. queue B. question C. unique D. chair
27. thought A. though B. taught C. dose D. strength
28. cause A. zoom B. course C. measure D. bats
29. knew A. goose B. sinew C. wink D. damn
30. tough A. bough B. dough-nut C. plough D. offer

SECTION 3

From the words lettered A to D, choose the word that rhymes with the given word. An example is given below:

Example: detain A. obtain B. detail C. claim D. relay

The correct answer is A because only obtain rhymes with detain. So, answer space A would be shaded.

[A] [B] [C] [D]

Now, answer the questions that follow:

31. chair A. there B. fear C. fiery D. cheer
32. fuel A. quail B. field C. duel D. freak
33. sour A. pour B. sore C. drawer D. power
34. corps A. queue B. corpse C. coup D. core
35. table A. status B. label C. tablet D. cater

SECTION 4

In each of the following questions the main/primary stress is indicated by writing the syllable on which it occurs in capital letters. From the words lettered A to D, choose the one that has the correct stress. An example is given below

Example: democratic

- A. DE-mo-cra-tic B. de-MO-cra-tic
C. de-mo-CRA-tic D. de-mo-cra-TIC

The correct answer is C because the main/primary stress of the word democratic is on the third syllable. So, answer space C would be shaded

[A] [B] [C] [D]

Now, answer the questions that follow

36. information
A. IN-for-ma-tion B. in-FOR-ma-tion
C. in-for-MA-tion D. in-for-ma-TION
37. manipulate
A. ma-ni-pu-LATE B. MA-ni-pu-late
C. ma-ni-PU-late D. ma-NI-pu-late
38. circumstantial
A. cir-CUM-stan-tial B. CIR-cum-stan-tial
C. cir-cum-STAN-tial D. cir-cum-stan-TIAL
39. apologize
A. a-POL-o-gize B. A-pol-o-gize
C. a-pol-O-gizo D. a-pol-o-GIZE
40. economic
A. E-co-no-mic B. e-CO-no-mic
C. e-co-NO-mic D. e-co-no-MIC

SECTION 5

In the following options lettered A to D, all the words except one have the same stress pattern. Identify the one with the different stress pattern and shade your answer in the usual way. An example is given below

Example: A. away B. apart C. behind D. river
Options A, B, C are all stressed on the second syllable while option D is the only one stressed on the first syllable. So, D is the correct answer and answer space D would be shaded.

[A] [B] [C] [D]

Now, answer the questions that follow

41. A. morale B. open C. offer D. moral
42. A. madam B. wardrobe C. classroom D. resent
43. A. beautiful B. fortunate C. important D. barrister
44. A. assault B. concise C. crusade D. canvass
45. A. athletics B. depression C. dignity D. dumbfounded

SECTION 6

In each of the following sentences, the word that receives the **emphatic stress** is written in CAPITAL LETTERS. From the questions lettered A to D, choose the one to which the given sentence is the appropriate answer. An example is given below.

Example: My mother's FRIEND hates pets

- A. Does your mother's boss hate pets?
B. Does your mother friend love pets?
C. Does your mother's friend hate toys?
D. Does your father's friend hate pets?

The correct answer is A. because My mother's FRIEND hates pets answers the question, Does your mother's boss hate pets? So answer space A would be shaded.

[A] [B] [C] [D]

Now, answer the questions that follow

46. Akpan is ALWAYS late to school
A. Is Akpan always late to bed?
B. Is Olu always late to school?
C. Is Akpan seldom late to school?
D. Is Akpan always early to school?
47. The President toured the ENTIRE country by helicopter
A. Did the first lady tour the entire country by helicopter?
B. Did the President tour the entire state by helicopter?
C. Did the President tour the country by train?
D. Did the President tour part of the country by helicopter?
48. Kofi's father returned home LAST WEEK.
A. Did Kofi's father return home yesterday?
B. Did Ade's father return home last week?
C. Did Kofi's mother return home last week?
D. Did Kofi's father leave home last week?
49. MY YOUNGER brother was accused of committing the offence.
A. Was your elder brother accused of committing the offence?
B. Was Ngozi's younger brother accused of committing the offence?
C. Was your younger brother suspected of committing the offence?
D. Was your younger sister accused of committing the offence?
50. Hassan's FATHER bought me an expensive wristwatch
A. Did Hassan's father buy him an expensive wristwatch?
B. Did Hassan's father buy you an expensive calculator?
C. Did Hassan's mother buy you an expensive wrist-watch?
D. Did Hassan's father buy you a cheap wrist-watch.

SECTION 7

From the words lettered A to D, choose the word that contains the sound represented by the given phonetic symbol. An example is given below

Example: /ɔɪ/ A. yell B. holy C. boy D. idiot

The correct answer is C because only boy contains the sound represented by the given symbol. So, answer space C would be shaded

- | | | | |
|-----|-----|-----|-----|
| [A] | [B] | [C] | [D] |
|-----|-----|-----|-----|
- Now, answer the questions that follow
51. /i:/ A. bee B. height C. third D. sit
 52. /ə/ A. buy B. sack C. dark D. area
 53. /ʌ/ A. cock B. earth C. pond D. lunch
 54. /eə/ A. fare B. bird C. wed D. dear
 55. /ei/ A. aisle B. eat C. wait D. dirt
 56. /j/ A. you B. just C. wedge D. ditch
 57. /z/ A. brochure B. mason C. quiz
D. leisure
 58. /ɪ/ A. thrash B. vision C. assume D. cheat
 59. /ɒ/ A. dozen B. weight C. worth D. bathe
 60. /dʒ/ A. just B. ghost C. dose D. dogged

WASSCE JUNE 1999 ENGLISH LANGUAGE 3 TEST OF ORALS OBJECTIVE TEST ANSWERS

- 1.C 2.C 3.A 4.C 5.B 6.C 7.D 8.B 9.D 10.C 11.A 12.B
13.A 14.A 15.C 16.A 17.D 18.B 19.A 20.B 21.A 22.D 23.C
24.B 25.D 26.B 27.D 28.A 29.B 30.D 31.A 32.C 33.D 34.D
35.B 36.C 37.D 38.C 39.A 40.B 41.A 42.D 43.C 44.D 45.C
46.C 47.D 48.A 49.A 50.C 51.A 52.B 53.D 54.A 55.A 56.A
57.D 58.A 59.D 60.A

SENIOR SCHOOL CERTIFICATE EXAMINATION (SSCE 1988 – 2015)

Past Questions with Solutions

English Language

(Theory / Objectives with Oral English) 2000

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WASSCE JUNE 2000 ENGLISH LANGUAGE 2 OBJECTIVE TEST QUESTIONS

SECTION 1

*In each of the following sentences, there is one underlined word and one gap. From the list of words lettered A to D, choose the one that is most **nearly opposite in meaning** to the underlined word and that will, at the same time, correctly fill the gap in the sentence.*

Answer all the questions.

1. "Hello Musa" is a..... opening for a friendly letter, but it is inappropriate for a formal letter
A. casual B. serious C. happy D. suitable
2. We blamed Obi for breaking the door, but when Ade confessed that he did it, Obi was.....
A. rewarded B. exonerated C. released D. jailed
3. Parking on this street is.....on weekdays, but permitted at weekends
A. rejected B. sanctioned C. abolished D. prohibited
4. They had to.....the old buildings to construct the five-star hotel
A. close B. remove C. demolish D. damage
5. If we can commence the meeting on time, we should be able to..... by 4.00 p.m
A. return B. vacate C. convene D. adjourn
6. The children expected to be praised for putting out the fire, but they were.....for taking such risk
A. rebuked B. accused C. despised D. sentenced
7. A child got stuck trying to squeeze through an iron fence, but some adults managed to..... him
A. extract B. push C. save D. extricate
8. They ended the discussion on amicable terms though they were.....to each other at the beginning
A. unacceptable B. hostile C. unknown D. annoying

SECTION 2

*From the words lettered A to D, choose the word that **best completes** each of the following sentences*

9. The class prefect's..... of the quarrel is different from yours
A. statement B. account C. outline D. summary
10. I refused to.....my statement because it was true
A. retract B. make C. withhold D. voice
11. But for the timely.....of the police, there would have been a riot
A. interference B. intrusion C. intervention D. interruption
12. The boys were about to trade blows, but I managed to hold one of them back while my friend.....the other
A. restrained B. subdued C. coaxed D. captured
13. We are waiting to hear the weather.....for tomorrow
A. broadcast B. declaration C. report D. forecast
14. I will tell you the secret if you promise not to..... it
A. divulge B. show C. scatter D. relay
15. The hilltop was a hundred metres above sea level and from that..... the whole town could be seen beautifully laid out
A. magnitude B. altitude C. latitude D. longitude
16. Until now Etim has always started the fights, but this time Adamu is dearly the..... oppressor
B. fighter C. aggressor D. underdog
17. If found guilty, a person may appeal to a higher court in the hope that it will..... the verdict
A. discharge B. revise C. dismiss D. reverse
18. The visit of the patron of the club.....the morale of the players
A. elated B. induced C. boasted D. boosted.

SECTION 3

*After each of the following sentences, a list of possible interpretations of the sentences is given. Choose the interpretation that you consider **most appropriate** for each sentence.*

19. Although Aliyu was acquitted by the court for want of evidence, the police still kept a tab on him. This means that they
- kept him under close observation
 - set a trap to catch him again
 - attached a tag to his clothes
 - kept him behind bars.
20. When it came to the question of an increase in allowances, the striking workers spoke with one voice. This means that the workers
- became frightened
 - appointed one of them as their spokesman
 - repeated their demand in a chorus
 - were unanimous in their position
21. The restaurant owner offered Olu a drink on the house. This means that
- the drink was taken to Olu's house
 - Olu was invited to the owner's house
 - the drink was free of charge
 - Olu was served inside the restaurant
22. When the Choir Master introduced Jane as a brilliant singer, everyone knew that he was speaking with his tongue in his cheek. This means that he
- was ignorant of the quality of Jane's singing
 - did not intend to be taken seriously
 - wanted to deceive Jane
 - wanted to deceive everyone but failed.
23. When the accountant made those remarks he knew that he was putting his job on the line. This means that the accountant was
- risking losing his job
 - announcing his resignation
 - urging people to take to his profession
 - revealing secrets about his job
24. The newly acquired air-bus plane is a white elephant. This means that the plane is
- very costly but worthless
 - very useful
 - as big as an elephant
 - the biggest plane on the fleet
25. Despite the measures taken by the government, the economy of the country is still in the doldrums. This means that
- the economy is recovering
 - the government is tackling the problem vigorously
 - the economic problems are widely known
 - the economy is not making any progress
26. The new teacher urged the lazy students to turn over a new leaf. This means that the teacher urged the students to
- improve their behaviour
 - turn to the next page of their book
 - stir the leaves in the compost pit
 - strike a balance between play and hardwork
27. Amina always flies off at a tangent when a serious matter is being discussed. This means that Amina
- get overexcited
 - keeps digressing
 - keeps the discussion lively
 - has nothing to contribute
28. You should take what he tells you with a pinch of salt. This means that you should
- reject everything he says because he is a liar
 - pay close attention to him
 - doubt what he says
 - question him closely

SECTION 4

*From the words lettered A to D below each of the following sentences, choose the word that is **nearest in meaning** to the underlined word*

29. The bride was praised by her mother-in-law for her impeccable behaviour
- spotless
 - appropriate
 - beautiful
 - faultless
30. Ogene was not the least cowed by the bully's threats
- intimidated
 - worried
 - encouraged
 - distracted
31. The dissidents held several clandestine meetings before the attack
- secret
 - important
 - impromptu
 - exclusive
32. The Principal warned the final-year students about the consequences of procrastination
- haste
 - delay
 - protesting
 - rioting
33. The incessant chatter of the pupils irritated the teacher
- excited
 - meaningless
 - unceasing
 - illogical
34. With his cogent argument in favour of the proposal he was able to check further opposition
- insistent
 - urgent
 - convincing
 - uncompromising
35. The professor's explanation of that point was quite lucid.
- lengthy
 - complicated
 - clear
 - surprising

36. The foreman believed that with the augmented workforce, the construction job would take one more month to complete
A. skilled B. enlarged C. hired D. determined
37. The children were warned not to be unduly inquisitive
A. naughty B. playful C. troublesome D. curious
38. The accused vehemently denied the charges against him
A. ignorantly B. stupidly C. deliberately D. strongly

SECTION 5

*From the words or group of words lettered A to D,, choose the one that **best completes** each of the following sentences*

39. The man advised his children not to give..... to the temptations of the city
A. off B. up C. in D. out
40. Ebieri turned.....all the advances made by the men
A. aside B. off C. away D. down
41. Ada is..... to do that kind of thing
A. too intelligent much B. too much intelligent
C. intelligent too much D. much too intelligent
42.were sent to the library by the English teacher
A. I and Udoh B. Udoh and me C. Udoh and I
D. Myself and Udoh
43. The teachers.....politics when I entered the staff room
A. are discussing B. were discussing about
C. are discussing on D. were discussing
44. The quarrel between the two men soon resulted.....a fight
A. to B. in C. towards D. into
45. You're not too tired to continue.....?
A. are you B. isn't it C. can't you D. is it
46. The hunter, with his dogs,..... going into the forest
A. was seen B. are being seen
C. have been seen D. were seen
47. Mother could not prepare the dish because there was..... oil available
A. small B. little C. a little D. some
48. Because it had been raining heavily all morningpeople turned out o welcome the august visitor
A. few B. quite a few C. only fewer D. a few
49. Unfortunately, his plans to go abroad fell.....
A. off B. down C. under D. through
50. The man asked me.....
A. who am I? B. that who are you? C. who I am
D. who I was
51. "It is high time you.....crying" the woman told her daughter gently
A. stop B. should stop C. stopped D. must stop
52. He would rather resign.....part in such a dishonest deal
A. instead of taking B. than taking C. than takes
D. than take
53. Those who owe the company were urged to.....theirdebts
A. makegood B. payout C. runin D. paylbr
54.home, his dead uncle's burial had already taken place
A. Getting B. As he gets C. On getting
D. When he got
55. Luck.....the robbers on that fateful day
A. came down on B. ran out on C. ended up with
D. made away with
56. He never seemed to get it right.....
A. however he tried hard
B. he tried hard however
C. he however tried hard
D. however hard he tried
57. The day that Musa's uncle died was the..... day of his life
A. more sadder B. cadder C. saddest
D. most saddest
58. With his reading glasses on, he could see the words.....
A. much more clearly
B. clearly much more
C. much clearly more
D. much more clearer
59. Neither Obi nor Jumoke..... present at the meeting
A. was B. were C. have been D. are

60. Hardly had the journey started.....the car engine developed a fault
A. that B. when C. than D. soon
61. At the end of this year, Grandmother..... with us for seven years
A. is living B. has lived C. will have lived D. has been living
62. One of the robbers who snatched the car..... been arrested by the police
A. have B. was C. is D. has
63. A student at the back of the class complained that he..... the teacher
A. was not hearing B. could not hear C. does not hear D. is not hearing
64. The little boy could not move the heavy stone.....he tried
A. as much as B. how much C. no matter that D. however hard
65. The two girls have not been speaking..... since their quarrel
A. one to the other B. to themselves C. to each another D. to each other
66. We received.....that the workers would soon go on strike
A. an information B. informations C. those information D. information
67. He dabbles.....politics from time to time
A. in B. with C. through D. into
68. The government has set up a.....panel to investigate that fire incident
A. five- men B. five men C. five-man D. five man
69. The Students Week was rounded...with a dance
A. off B. up C. out D. through
70. The factory workers refused to take the matter of their sacked colleagues lying.....
A. about B. low C. down D. idle
71. After a while, we noticed that the unconscious accident victim was coming.....
A. round B. on C. up D. through
72. Seun accepted the conditions we gave him..... for my liking
A. quickly too much B. too much quickly C. much too quickly D. much quickly too

73. The careless manager has caused his bank to..... millions of naira
A. loosed B. losing C. lose D. lost
74. Both questions are alternatives; you answer..... one.....the other
A. neither, nor B. both, and C. neither, or D. either, or
75. The sick man.....in bed for three months
A. lay B. lain C. lied D. lie
76. Ogugua has always.....me as a good mannered child
A. strike B. struck C. stricken D. striking

SECTION 6

*In the following passages, the numbered gaps indicate missing words. Against each number in the list below each passage, four options are given in columns lettered A to D. Choose the word that is the **most suitable** to fill the numbered gap in the passages.*

PASSAGE A

For thousands of years, man lived in a very primitive way. Before the recent —77-- in agriculture, medicine and industry, life was difficult. It was hard to --78-- a living from —79-- without modern farming —80— , and a sinfe year of crop —81— could mean famine and therefore death illnesses as —82— and as —83— as influenza could kill a Ston—Age man weakened by hunger, appendicitis was always —84— before the days of modern —85— Even childbirth was ahazardous process. Under these conditions, the human race needed to —86— at a high —87— just to keep in existence.

However, with a sharp fall in the —88— rate relative to the —89—, the world's population is now increasing very rapidly. This increase needs to be put in —90—ta avoid the looming consequence of population —91—

	A	B	C	D
77.	development	growths	adventures	experiments
78.	get	realize	make	extract
79.	ground	soil	world	earth
80.	methods	procedures	steps	ways
81.	collapse	withdrawal	decrease	failure
82.	meek	weak	mild	benign
83.	common	ubiquitous	omnipresent	numerous
84.	vanquished	fatal	killing	deadly
85.	medication	counseling	therapy	surgery
86.	recreate	regional	reproduce	reproduce
87.	speed	rate	pace	frequency
88.	maternity	morality	paternity	mortality
89.	birth-rate	living	healthy	women
90.	deflation	bandage	check	reverse
91.	enlargement	explosion	bank	expansion

PASSAGE B

When my elder brother decided to —92— a current account with United Bank for Africa, he walked into one of its —93— and obtained the necessary —94— which he completed and returned to the —95—. He was then given paying-

in --96—. Soon, he started issuing —97-- to people with whom he transacted business. Whenever his signature was irregular, his cheque was not —98—. Once, he wanted to obtain a —99— and the bank insisted on —100--.

92.	A	B	C	D
93.	start	open	begin	close
94.	branches	offices	premises	houses
95.	bills	booklets	applications	forms
96.	principal	director	manager	chairman
97.	papers	bonds	tailies	slips
98.	cheques	money	numbers	contracts
99.	sceoted	honoured	paid	received
100.	credit	debit	loan	balance
	e w.lness	a guarantor	collateral	interest

WASSCE JUNE 2000 ENGLISH LANGUAGE 2 OBJECTIVE TEST ANSWERS

1.D 2.B 3.D 4.C 5.D 6.A 7.D

8.B 9.B 10.A 11.C 12.A 13.D 14.A
15.B 16.C 17.D 18.D 19.A 20.D 21.C
22.B 23.A 24.A 25.D 26.A 27.B 28.C
29.D 30.A 31.A 32.B 33.C 34.C 35.C
36.B 37.D 38.D 39.C 40.D 41.D 42.C
43.D 44.D 45.A 46.A 47.C 48.A 49.C
50.D 51.C 52.D 53.B 54.C 55.B 56.D
57.C 58.A 59.A 60.B 61.C 62.D 63.B
64.D 65.D 66.D 67.D 68.C 69.A 70.B
71.D 72.C 73.C 74.D 75.A 76.B 77.A
78.C 79.B 80.A 81.D 82.C 83.A 84.B
85.A 86.C 87.D 88.D 89.A 90.C 91.B
92.B 93.A 94.D 95.C 96.D 97.A 98.B
99.C 100.C

WASSCE JUNE 2000 ENGLISH LANGUAGE 1 THEORY QUESTIONS

PART A

Answer one question, from this part

1. A nagging problem in your family has so far defied all solutions. Write a letter to an uncle of yours stating what the problem is and giving reasons why he should intervene.
2. Write an article for publication in your school magazine on the topic: "Why I should like to be....." Choose an occupation or career and give at least three reasons why it appeals to you
3. Write a letter to the Director of the Environmental Protection Agency in your country complaining about the environmental pollution of your area and requesting that urgent action be taken to improve the situation.
4. Write a story ending with the words, "Indeed, it was a blessing in disguise"
5. You are a speaker in an inter-school debate on the topic: "It is better to attend a school near your home than one outside your neighbourhood". Write your speech for or against the proposition.

PART B COMPREHENSION

Answer all the questions in this part

6. Read the following passage carefully and answer the questions on it.

It seemed that Joe had just about had it with his wife of three years. He no longer thought her attractive or interesting: he considered her a poor housekeeper who was overweight, someone he no longer wanted to live with. Joe was so upset that he finally decided on divorce. But before he

served her the papers, he made an appointment with a psychologist for the specific purpose of finding out how to make life as difficult as possible for his wife.

The psychologist listened to Joe's story and then gave his advice. "Well, Joe, I think I've got the perfect solution for you. From tonight when you get home, I want you to start treating your wife as if she were a goddess. That's right, a goddess. I want you to change your attitude towards her completely. Start doing everything in your power to please her. Listen intently to her when she talks about her problems, help around the house, take her out to dinner on weekends. I want you to pretend that she's a goddess. Then after two months of this wonderful behaviour, just pack your bags and leave her. That should get to her".

Joe thought it was a tremendous idea. That night he started treating his wife as if she were a goddess. He couldn't wait to do things for her. He brought her breakfast in bed and had flowers delivered to her for no apparent reason. They read books to each other at night and Joe listened to her as never before. It was incredible what Joe was doing for his wife. He kept it up for the two full months. After the allotted time, the psychologist gave Joe a call at home. "Joe" he asked, "How's it going? Did you file for divorce? Are you a happy bachelor once again?" "Divorce?" asked Joe in surprise "You must be kidding! I'm married to a goddess. I've never been happier in my life. I'd never leave my wife in a million years. In fact, I'm discovering new, wonderful things about her every single day. Divorce? Not on your life!". The psychologist hung up wearing a knowing smile.
(a) Why did Joe consult the psychologist?

- (b) What did Joe think he would achieve by following the psychologist's advice?
- (c) What is ironical about Joe's answer to the psychologist's question toward the end of the passage?
- (d) From this episode, what do you think had really been wrong with Joe's marriage?
- (e) "...it was a tremendous idea." (i) What grammatical name is given to this expression as it is used in the passage? (ii) What is its function in the sentence?
- (f) "I'd never leave my wife in a million years". What figure of speech is contained in the sentence above?
- (g) Why do you think the psychologist "wore a knowing smile"?
- (h) For each of the following words, find another word or phrase which means the same and which can replace it as it is used in the passage
- (i) attractive (ii) upset; (iii) solution; (iv) wonderful; (v) apparent (vi) allotted

7. *Read the following passage carefully and answer the questions on it.*

I vividly remember that Thursday morning, some twenty-two years ago, when I was operated upon to have an abnormality corrected. For months, the doctors had combated the ailment with drugs of various kinds, many of which sent me on long excursions into slumberland. Yet the ailment had seemed to defy all medical entreaties. Then a few days later, two senior surgeons called on me to discuss their decision. They made it clear that only a surgical operation held any hope, otherwise the downward trend was sure to continue until the inevitable quiet end. So, they sought my consent which I promptly gave, stating that at my age I was old enough to accept any eventuality.

For days, I was gradually prepared for the great event. I took various drugs to build me up physically, and I was encouraged to eat well. Besides, a clergyman came regularly to talk to, and pray for me. He assured me that I would sail through the operation safely as God, the greatest of surgeons, would join the medical team. Gradually I steeled myself to face the exercise.

Then the day came. My wife came very early into the ward, looking as if she bore the burdens of all the world. I told her to be a good girl and cheer up. But all my jokes fell flat. So, when a senior nursing sister, came and told my wife to go and buy one of the drugs needed, I was somehow relieved. Moments later, my eldest son, came, and I told him to brace up for any eventuality. I said I was proud of his achievements as a young engineer, and of his immediate younger brother

as a pharmacist. So if the end should come, they should both rise to the occasion and steer their other brother and sister to good careers, I had not quite concluded when the stretcher was wheeled in and I was helped on to it. As the journey to the theatre commenced, with my son by my side. I held his hand firmly and smiled. This was the only way I could reassure him that all was going to be well. The stretcher moved on. Then, suddenly, I saw my wife hurrying to catch up with us. As she came along. I told the ward attendants to slow down so that she could catch up with us. I took her hand and put it in my son's. Apparently, this gesture disturbed rather than strengthened her. She burst into tears. Before I could say anything else to mother and son, the theatre doors were flung open; and the stretcher was wheeled in.

- (a) What did the surgeons seek from the patient?
- (b) In what two major ways was the man prepared for the operation?
- (c) What do the man's words to his eldest son suggest about his state of mind?
- (d) (i) What message did the man intend to convey to his wife by putting her hand in his son's? (ii) What was his wife's reaction?
- (e) "Before I could say anything else" (i) What grammatical name is given to this expression as it is used in the passage? (ii) What is its function in the sentence?
- (f) ".....the inevitable quiet end" (i) What figure of speech is used in the expression above? (ii) What does it mean?
- (g) How do you know that the patient survived the operation?
- (h) For each of the following words, find another word or phrase which means the same

PART C SUMMARY

8. *Read the following passage carefully and answer the questions on it.*

Are you scared of speaking before a large audience or even making a few suggestions in public?. This need not be. You can make effective speeches in public. Here are a few pointers.

Perhaps the most important step is to be sure of what you are going to say. This sound obvious enough, but it is amazing how many people get up to speak when in fact, they have very little to say. After one inconsequential point they discover they have run out of steam. So to ensure you can speak well, get enough points to speak about examine them in depth and digest them thoroughly. The more points you have, the more conversant you are with them, the more confident you will be.

How do you present your speech? Certainly before you begin, you will be a little uneasy. Even the most experienced speaker feels the same way before beginning his speech. This is not bad; in fact, it is a good tonic for a successful speech. To overcome this, do not rush headlong into the task. Rather, it pays to breathe in and out, heavily, deeply, calmly. Then begin the speech, slowly calmly, carefully, with a clear, confident voice. This is when you are going through the salutation. "The Chairman, Honourable Guests of Honour, Distinguished Ladies and Gentlemen" "By the time you finish this and go through the usual ritual of stating that it gives you "great pleasure to stand before this august gathering to discuss a few points , you would have reached a point of emotional equilibrium. You should now be sufficiently calm to go on with the speech.

Somewhere at the beginning, and at strategic points in your speech, you should introduce flavour into what you are saying. You would not want to serve tea without sugar rafter all. So, you should inject some humorous remarks once in a while. But this calls for skill. To start with, you cannot introduce humour indiscriminately, otherwise you might sound like a jester. Experienced speakers most often introduce humour early in their speeches presumably to ease the tension in the hall. But these jokes must be brief, purposeful and closely related to the point.

Many speakers are scared by the countenances of the listeners. Not all their looks are friendly. However, there are bound to be a few friendly ones, and it is advisable to pick them out, look at them from time to time, and ignore the hostile ones. Looking at the friendly faces keeps you at ease.

You are advised to write out your speech in full after which you should read it several times before the day. You could get a willing listener to criticize your delivery. Do this several times until you can almost recite it. Notice that we are not advising you to memorize it, because you could forget vital areas due to anxiety. Writing out and practising the speech would make you much familiar with the content, indeed with every word.

Speech making is an art. While it is true that some are gifted in speech making, it is more correct that any one who doesn't suffer from speech handicaps can learn to deliver effective speeches. And you can become a master in this art.

(a) In one sentence, state the intention of the writer.

(b) In five sentences, one for each, summarize the five steps for making a good speech and the reason for each step.

WASSCE JUNE 2000 ENGLISH LANGUAGE THEORY ANSWERS

African Church School,
P. M. B. 2112
Agege,
Lagos State.
26th June, 2000.

1. Dear Uncle Babs,

It's quite a long time I heard from you last. I begin to wonder if anything has gone wrong from your end. I have written two letters to you about a nagging problem in the family but no reply, yet you are not the careless type who is lackadaisical about replying to letters. But who knows what must have happened to the letters in transit? This is consequent upon the deplorable postal system and corrupt postal staff in our country. All efforts made to solve the nagging problem have proved abortive.

The nagging problem is our father's illness coupled with poverty. The problem started some five years ago when Daddy was involved in a ghastly accident. Our father escaped death by hairs breadth as he was the only survivor in the accident. The accident occurred along Lagos - Ibadan expressway. Daddy had a compound fracture which rendered his legs useless. He was admitted at University of Ibadan (UCH) for months but there was no improvement. In fact, things got to the head when in December 1997, the hospital management proposed to amputate the legs. We disapproved the proposed amputation, rather we sought for cure elsewhere.

A concerned family friend informed us of a trado-medical doctor in Kumasi, Ghana. We had no alternative than to sell Daddy's only plot of land at Ikeja to take the trip to Ghana. We arrived Ghana in April, 1998 for the cure. The herbalist billed daddy the sum of one hundred and fifty thousand naira in our own naira' equivalence. He tried his best possible but to no avail as he was not completely cured. He left Gh&na for Nigeria in October 1999 to seek for total cure. All along, Mummy has sold nearly all her personal property to maintain the family up till January this year when she decided to work for someone as a house-help.

Right now, the Medical Director of Oropaedic Hoptical, Igbobi, Lagos has promised to treat the rest bone problem within three months. This was a cheering news except that the bill is eighty thousand naira. This is likely to make the mission impossible due to inability of the family to raise the fund. Now, the family has been ejected from where it has lived for two decades. Poverty is the order of the day. Indeed things have fallen apart and the centre can no longer hold.

Your timely intervention in the current crisis is the only solution. We need a total of one hundred and eighty five thousand naira (two thousand, five hundred dollars) to complete all expenses including medical and the rest. You are the messiah sent to this family to bring us out of the chronic predicament. The reasons why you need to intervene in this matter are numerous. First, you are the only member of the family working abroad and who has the means. Also, you are the next to our daddy in the family. Finally, you are the only one who is enlightened to know the duties Daddy has performed and can still perform.

In conclusion, there is no doubt in my mind that you are convinced beyond any shadow of doubt why you need to intervene in no time. Please, send the money through the First Bank - Western Union Money Transfer to the family account at First Bank at Agege. Mr and Mrs J. O. Ojukuku Acc. No 229220. The earlier the money is sent the better. Good bye and God bless.

Yours,
Godwin.

2. WHY I SHOULD LIKE TO BE A MEDICAL DOCTOR

There are over a million different professions in the world today but the one I cherish most is to be a medical practitioner. Being a medical practitioner is my life ambition right from when I was in primary school about a decade ago. Even while in primary four, I could still remember when our teacher asked for our cherished future professions, most of my mates said they would like to become lawyers, engineers, journalists and teachers. In fact, I was the only one that preferred to study medicine to become a medical practitioner.

Medicine as a career appeals to me for many reasons. The first reason why I am motivated to study medicine is to save life. Saving life is the primary aim of my likeness for medical profession. If I become a medical expert, I would be in a good

position to save lives of several hundreds of Nigerians who would have died. It is obvious that my membership of the noble profession will bring succour to the lives of those who suffer from many deadly diseases.

Another notable reason for my likeness for medicine is to make a name for myself through scientific investigations. The most notable professionals in the world today are those who are involved in finding solutions to safety of lives. In no small way I will work assiduously to find permanent cure to some diseases that tend to defy medical knowledge. For example, I will want to go into the area of finding medical solutions to the dreaded AIDS which is the greatest medical problem of the last millennium. I will want to make it a great challenge to break new ground in medical technology.

Moreover, medical practice appeals to me because one can easily establish one's own. Of all professions today, the easiest to set up on one's own is medical practice. I will want to work in a University Teaching Hospital where I can undertake specialised and post-graduate professional courses in medicine after my general degrees in medicine. Having worked for some years in such a specialised hospital, acquiring chains of post-graduate degrees in medicine, I will like to establish a specialist hospital for treatment of AIDS and heart-related problems. I will spend a lot to make the centre a masterpiece and the best of its kind in the whole of Africa.

In addition, I will want to go into medical practice so that I can be an employer of labour in the medical line. I will like to employ both new and experienced medical doctors and nurses. If God crowns my effort, I will establish a private nursing school, the first of its kind in the country. This, to a large extent, will bring about competition between public and private nursing. This will pose a challenge to public nursing schools with a view to achieving professional excellence.

In conclusion, I pray fervently to have the ability and luck to carry out my life ambition and dream career. I have started in a little way by making science subjects my daily songs. Of course medicine as a profession appeals to me more than any other profession in the world.

3. P.O. Box 1112,
Ikeja,
Lagos State,
22nd July, 2000.

The Director,
Environmental Protection Agency,
Wuse - Abuja.

Dear Sir,

ENVIRONMENTAL POLLUTION OF LAGOS AREA

I write this letter with a deep sense of duty and responsibility to bring to the notice of the authority the environmental pollution in most parts of Lagos State. The environmental hazard is in no small measure bringing health problems to the vast majority of the populace in the state. Yet, the state has the highest population in the country.

The first of this problem is the heavy industrial smoke that pervades the atmosphere in Lagos area. This is consequent upon the localization of industries in many parts of Lagos metropolis. Industrial smoke brings ill-health to the populace as well as accidents on our roads. The heavy industrial smoke is detrimental to the lives of people as it contains toxic components which bring about lung cancer according to medical research. Over ten thousand Lagosians are treated for this disease weekly. The thick smoke poses visibility headache to motorists as it leads to compound motor accidents regularly on Lagos roads. A good number of road users have died premature death due to industrial smoke.

Another source of environmental problem in the state is the poor handling of refuse and wastes. As a result of population explosion in Lagos area, the refuse and waste is much but the disposal is badly managed. Lagos streets during rainy season are better called refuse dump sites. This is because everywhere is littered with refuse and waste materials. This in no small way acts as agent of spreading diseases during rainy season. Unfriendly odour fills everywhere in the city and it leads to outbreak of diseases once in a while. A similar occurrence was an outbreak of cholera epidemic in 1998. It was so much widely reported in the international media that FIFA had to withdraw the soccer hosting rights earlier granted Nigeria, it was a calamity and national disgrace.

This is not all. During dry season, due to poor management of waste, heaps of refuse are set ablaze by residents as a means of disposal. The smoke emanating from such exercise is yet another source of environmental pollution. It poses threat to life as it causes lung-related

problems which are costly to treat medically. It equally affects the sight of people particularly, the motorists and pedestrians. Many road accidents are reported yearly due to this havoc.

To overcome this environmental nuisance, all industrial establishments in the area should be made to treat their industrial wastes with the aim of reducing the toxic nature of such wastes. Also, the state Waste Disposal Board should be decentralised and private companies employed by the state to clear the city of refuse. Finally, only noiseless planes should be allowed to fly, instead of the current ones that are too noisy. There should be acts of parliament by both the National Assembly and Lagos State House of Assembly so as to bring environmental pollution to the barest minimum. Finally, the state should compel individuals and corporate bodies to clear their refuse through agents appointed by the state.

In conclusion, there is no doubt in my mind that the issue of environmental pollution in Lagos area will be a forgotten issue if my suggestions are well looked into and systematically implemented. I thank you very much for your co-operation.

Yours faithfully,
Ben Ogunmodede.

4. THE BLESSING IN DISGUISE

Once upon a time in the land of Tabuluka, there was a boy named Songa. Songa was well behaved and was of transparent honesty. He had a great problem, in that he was an orphan, having lost his father three months before he was born, and the mother six months after he was born. He had faced the problem of lack of care. He withdrew from school at the age of seven when there was nobody to sponsor his education any longer. He had no alternative than to seek for a menial job. He secured a job as a messenger to the king of Tabuluka.

He was diligent in the discharge of his duty to the king. Unlike the rest of the messengers, he was very trustworthy and an embodiment of honesty. To crown it all, he was very handsome but remained very poor. The only solace he had was that he was very much admired by the king and the queen. After working with the king for twenty-five years he was faced with the greatest temptation of his life. By this time he was fully grown up and had learnt a lot through the king's high chiefs who formed the cabinet. Indeed, it was a monarchy, that is, a government headed by the

king. He was sufficiently lettered and could communicate in the language of administration. He had undergone various diplomatic courses. He had been promoted from a messenger to the position of the king's protocol officer. The promotion was rather very fast considering his background.

Songa had acquired a new status as he had become the cynosure of all eyes. He was loved by the queen but she could not openly tell him. The queen made several attempts with the hope that Songa would sleep with her but he couldn't get the signal. The queen who had been instrumental to the boy's rapid promotion formally called Snga and told him how much she loved him due to his level of honesty, diligence and sense of responsibility. She said she would give him an assignment at a later date and failure to carry out such would lead to death. Songa was ready to carry out any assignment provided it was not to kill.

One day when the king was on tours of his vassal states, the queen called Songa, the king's protocol officer to her bedroom. The queen then locked the door after Songa had entered. Songa was afraid thinking that the queen might use him for rituals but he had no alternative than to obey. The queen then told Songa her age-long secret love for him and then requested that he sleep with her. Songa couldn't believe his ears as he struggled to run out of the room. Having noticed Songa's attempt, the queen raised an alarm to attract the people in the neighbourhood. She said that Songa attempted to rape her. Songa had no defence as he was given no time for that. Nobody gave it a second thought. The king arrived from his tour and was told what Songa wa3 up to. The court of the land sentenced Songa to death after confirmation by the king. That was how he became a prisoner of conscience.

He was in the prison for another ten years during which his honesty and faith in God waxed stronger than before. He was not deterred by the death sentence. He was loved by all prisoners and warders. Songa was reputed to be a dream translator'. He would analyse any dream droamt by anybody in the prison and beyond. One day the king dreamt a dream and was confused as he didn't know the significance. The director of prison in the land told the king that there was a prisoner who could analyse the king's dream. The king vowed to divide his kingdom into two for anyone who could analyse the dream. In no long a time Songa was brought and he absolutely resokcc1 and analysed the dream. The king was joyful and granted Songa a monarchical amnesty and pardon and was subsequently appointed the

Prime Minister of Tabuluka Kingdom. So you see every disappointment is a blessing in disguise.

5. IT IS BETTER TOAENDA SCHOOL NEAR YOUR HOME THAN ONE OUTSIDE YOUR NEIGHBOURHOOD

Mr. Chairman, Distinguished Listeners, Ladies and Gentlemen, I say good day to you all. I rise at this August occasion to move the motion which states that: It is better to attend a school near your home than one outside your neighbourhood. My stand is based on the points discussed below.

First, there is no traffic problem when one attends a school near one's home in cities like Lagos, Ibadan, Kano and Kaduna, traffic jam makes students to get to their schools late. At times, students get to school after two hours of lessons. Consequently, the students are given corporal punishment which acts as cog in the wheel of progress of the affected students as it leads to falling standard of education. Ladies and Gentlemen, living very near one's school will prevent truancy. In short, there is punctuality to schcal.

Unnecessary transportation fare is out of the way when one attends a school near one's home. In cities like Lagos and Kaduna transport fare is too high. In Lagos alone, a journey from Agege to University of Lagos costs as much as two hundred naira to and fro. That means, it costs one thousand naira weekly and over four thousand naira monthly. At the end of the day, the cost of transportation alone is higher than the tuition fee. The fare is higher during fuel scarcity. The alternative is to rent a room and rentage in Lagos is the highest in the country.

A child who lives near the school he attends is more beneficial to the family than a child who attends school far away from home. A child whose school is near his home will wake up early to help the parents to wash their cars, cook, sweep and mop before going to school, while a child who goes to school outside his neighbourhood will have to wake up as early as 4.30 a.m to beat the traffic jam. Many atime, he would sleep while lessons are going on while the one who attends nearby school will have full concentration on his studies.

Parental care is enjoyed for students who attend school near their homes. Their parents will monitor their movement and prev' it them from joining bad gangs. Such students cannot join secret cults. This is very much unlike students who attend sr'ools far away. The latter are either

living in hostels or rent houses on their own. This is the major factor responsible for autism in schools. School children believe in the adage that 'out of sight is out of mind'. So they misbehave as soon as they leave their parents. Students who are far removed from their parents indulge in bad habits such as smoking, drug abuse and secret cult. We all know that bad company corrupts good manners.

In conclusion, there is no doubt in my mind that I have been able to convince the audience including the learned opponent and of course the doubting Thomases that it is better to attend a school near one's home than to attend a school outside one's neighbourhood.

I thank you very much for giving my speech attentive audience.

Abiola Ogunmodede,
International School,
Ifako.

6. (a) To find out how to make life difficult for the wife
(b) Divorce his wife
(c) Joe who had said he would divorce his wife initially later said he would never divorce her
(d) Lack of understanding
(e) (i) Noun clause (ii) Object of the verb 'thought'
(f) Hyperbole
(g) He had succeeded in saving the marriage that was at the brink of divorce

- (h) (i) Beautiful, Pretty (ii) Disturbed, Confused
(iii) Remedy, Answer (iv) Strange, Special
(v) Obvious, Just (vi) Given, Recommended.

7. (a) Approval to carry out surgical operation on the patient
(b) (i) He took drugs to build him up physically (ii) The man of God prayed for him
(c) He was not sure of the success of the operator
(d) (1) To let her know that the son will take care of her in case of any eventuality (ii) She burst into tears
(e) (i) Adverbial clause (ii) It modifies the verb 'were flung'
(f) (i) Metaphor (ii) The unavoidable death comes
(g) He told the story 22 years after it took place
(h) (i) Treated, (ii) Treatments, attempts
(iii) Occurrence, result, outcome (iv) Encouraged
(v) Help, aid (vi) Action.
8. (a) The intention of the writer is to show the guidelines to making acceptable public speeches. OR The intention of the writer is to suggest how to make effective public speeches.
(b) The steps for making a good speech and the reason for each step are: (i) Get enough points on the topic to be conversant with them. (ii) Start the speech slowly to reach a point of emotional equilibrium. (iii) Introduce flavour into the speech at intervals to ease the tension in the hall. (iv) Look at friendly faces at regular intervals to keep the reader in advance and rehearse it so as to be familiar with the content.

WASSCE JUNE 2000 ENGLISH LANGUAGE 3 TEST OF ORALS OBJECTIVE TEST

SECTION 1

From the words lettered A to D, choose the word that has the **same vowel sound** as the one represented by the letter(s) underlined. An example is given below

Example: seat A. sit B. cite C. set D. key

The correct answer is D because only key contains the **same vowel sound** as the one underlined in seat. So, answer D would be shaded

[A] [B] [C] [D]

Now answer the questions that follow

1. Month A. boss B. bone C. rust D. for
2. Should A. wrote B. put C. flood D. foul

3. kill A. enough B. machine C. conceal D. achieve
4. board A. roster B. dog C. suck D. afford
5. crude A. crust B. gold C. hoot D. rout
6. pack A. wander B. dancer C. back D. pass
7. red A. leopard B. people C. legal D. veto
8. least A. vehicle B. leisure C. pleasant D. peasant
9. purse A. duck B. scourge C. forge D. cough
10. shark A. lack B. fact C. herd D. class
11. tame A. plait B. cadet C. heavy D. neighbour
12. motor A. foster B. tollgate C. doctor D. novel
13. mouse A. fount B. bought C. could D. soul
14. here A. bare B. wore C. beer D. pair
15. bear A. fare B. dear C. near D. mere

SECTION 2

From the words lettered A to D, choose the word that has the **same consonant sound(s)** as the one represented by the letter(s) underlined. An example is given below.

Example: vice A. cat B. dress C. show D. chalk

The correct answer is B because only dress contains the same consonant sound as the one underlined in vice. So answer space B would be shaded

[A] [B] [C] [D]

Now answer the following questions

16. ring A. lounge B. bang C. sin D. cringe
17. those A. cloth B. smooth C. wealthy D. healthy
18. cheat A. chef B. sachet C. watch D. brochure
19. kettle A. cell B. kingthood C. centre D. archeve
20. feast A. phase B. bough C. vase D. pave
21. measure A. pressure B. mission C. explosion
D. extension
22. lose A. race B. coats C. loose D. boys
23. wet A. dogged B. warmed C. dazed D. stopped
24. cast A. touched B. passed C. axe D. asked
25. moth A. wealth B. clothe C. smooth D. world
26. new A. own B. column C. autumn D. damn
27. please A. princely B. happily C. supply D. surprise
28. cash A. question B. ancient C. chestnut D. nature
29. boat A. climb B. plumber C. tomb D. tuber
30. youth A. pay B. grey C. new D. toy

SECTION 3

From the words lettered A to D, choose the word that **rhymes** with the given word. An example is given below.

Example: obtain A. detain B. detail C. daim D. relay

The correct answer is A because only detain rhymes with obtain. Therefore, answer space A would be shaded

[A] [B] [C] [D]

Now answer the following questions

31. averse A. rehearse B. revise C. reverts D. reviews
32. mountain A. country B. fountain C. bounty D. contain
33. tension A. season B. prison C. equation D. mention
34. father A. platter B. further C. rather D. later
35. labour A. cater B. neighbour C. mirror D. terror

SECTION 4

In each of the following questions, the main/primary stress is indicated by writing the **syllable** on which it occurs in capital letters

From the words lettered A to D, choose the one that has the correct stress. An example is given below.

Example: democratic

- A. DE-mo-cra-tic B. de-MO-cra-tic
C. de-mo-CRA-tic D. de-mo-cra-TIC

The correct answer is C because the main/primary stress of the word democratic is on the third **syllable**. Therefore, answer space C would be shaded

[A] [B] [C] [D]

Now answer the following questions

36. circumstances
A. CIR-cum-stan-ces B. cir- CUMstan-ces
C. cir-cum-STAN-ces D. cir-cum-stan-CES
37. contribution
A. CON-tri-bu-tion B. con-TRI- bu-tion
C. con-tri-BU-tion D. con-tri-bu-TION
38. criticism
A. CRI-ti-ci-sm B. cri-ti-CI-sm
C. cri-TI-ci-sm D. cri-ti-ci-SM
39. inadequate
A. in-ad-E-quate B. IN-ad-e-quate
C. in-ad-e-QUATE D. in-AD-e-quate
40. manipulate
A. MA-nip-u-late B. ma-NIP-u-late
C. ma-nip-U-late D. ma-nip-ULATE

SECTION 6

In the following options lettered A to D, all the words except one have the same **stress pattern**. Identify the one with the different stress pattern and shade your answer in the usual way. An example is given below

Example: A. away B. apart C. behind D. river
Options A, B, C are all stressed on the second syllable while option D is the only one stressed on the first syllable. So, D is the correct answer. Therefore answer space D would be shaded

[A] [B] [C] [D]

41. A. comment B. despite C. purchase D. genuine
42. A. diverse B. defer C. challenge D. profess
43. A. exhibit B. confident C. satisfy D. devastate
44. A. refugee B. referee C. understand D. importance
45. A. continent B. opponent C. exciting D. ingredient

SECTION 6

In each of the following sentences, the word that receives the emphatic stress is written in CAPITAL LETTERS. From the questions lettered A to D, choose the one to which the given sentence is the appropriate answer. An example is given below

Example: My mother's FRIEND hates pets.

- A Does your mother's boss hate pets?
- B. Does your mother's friend love pets?
- C. Does your mother's friend hate toys?
- D. Does your father's friend hate pets?

The correct answer is A because My mother's FRIEND hates pets answers the question. Does your mother's boss hate pets?. Therefore, answer space A would be shaded

[A] [B] [C] [D]
Now answer the following questions

46. Tunde is visiting his UNCLE in Abuja next month?
A. Is Tunde visiting his aunt in Abuja next month?
B. Is Tunde visiting his uncle in Kaduna next month?
C. Is Tunde visiting his uncle in Abuja next week?
D. Is Olu visiting his uncle in Abuja next month?

47. Yemi scrubs the floor every SATURDAY
A. Does Ngozi scrub the floor every Saturday?
B. Does Yemi sweep the floor every Saturday?
C. Does Yemi scrub the floor every Saturday?
D. Does Yemi scrub the wall every Sunday?

48. The PASSENGER boat docked at Accra yesterday
A. Did the passenger boat dock at Accra last week?
B. Did the cargo boat dock at Accra yesterday?
C. Did the passenger boat dock at Tema yesterday?
D. Did the cargo boat sail from Accra yesterday?

49. Kemi's watch is made of GOLD
A. Is Bisi's watch made of gold?
B. Is Kemi's necklace made of gold?
C. Is Kemi's watch plated with gold?
D. Is Kemi's watch made of silver?

50. The FINAL match of the hockey competition was exciting

- A. Was the final match of the hockey competition boring?
- B. Was the final match of the football competition exciting?
- C. Was the preliminary match of the hockey competition exciting?
- D. Was the final match of the football competition boring?

SECTION 7

From the words lettered A to D, choose the word that contains the sound represented by the given phonetic symbol. An example is given below

Example: /ɔ i / A. yell B. holy C. boy D. idiot

The correct answer is C because only boy contains the sound represented by the given symbol. Therefore, answer space C would be shaded

[A] [B] [C] [D]
Now answer the following questions:

- 51. /e / A. people B. heinous C. ewe D. jeopardy
- 52. /ʌ / A. wonder B. dough C. wander D. cough
- 53. /ɜ / A. pour B. clerk C. journal D. surprise
- 54. /əʊ / A. folly B. toll C. curly D. bout
- 55. /a / A. sack B. card C. search D. fact
- 56. /ə / A. bathe B. faith C. month D. length
- 57. /t / A. mission B. shoe C. attach D. character
- 58. /t / A. begged B. carved C. urged D. attend
- 59. / / A. equation B. addition C. impression D. pressure
- 60. /z / A. consist B. insist C. design D. reverse

WASSCE JUNE 2000 ENGLISH LANGUAGE 3 TEST OF ORALS OBJECTIVE TEST ANSWERS

1.C	2.B	3.A	4.D	5.C	6.C	7.A
8.A	9.B	10.D	11.D	12.B	13.A	14.C
15.A	16.B	17.C	18.C	19.D	20.A	21.C
22.D	23.D	24.D	25.A	26.A	27.A	28.B
29.D	30.C	31.A	32.B	33.D	34.C	46.A
47.C	48.B	49.D	50.C	51.B	52.A	53.C
54.B	55.B	56.A	35.B	36.A	37.C	38.C
39.D	40.B	41.B	42.A	43.B	44.C	45.C
57.C	58.D	59.A	60.C			

SENIOR SCHOOL CERTIFICATE EXAMINATION (SSCE 1988 – 2015)

Past Questions with Solutions

English Language

(Theory / Objectives with Oral English) 2001

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WASSCE JUNE 2001 ENGLISH LANGUAGE 2 OBJECTIVE TEST QUESTIONS

*In each of the following sentences, there is one word or group of words underlined and one gap. From the list of words or group of words lettered A to D, choose the one that is most **nearly opposite in meaning** to the underlined word or group of words and that will, at the same time, correctly fill the gap in the sentence. Answer **all** the questions.*

1. The leader of the delegation was commended for the manner in which he handled the matter, while their hosts were.....
A. applauded B. praised C. criticized
D. sanctioned
2. Musa is very frugal, whereas his friend Audu is.....
A. miserly B. thrifty C. precocious D. extravagant
3. Taiwo's flamboyance and Kehinde's..... often keep people wondering if they are really twins.
A. modesty B. arrogance C. timidity D. pretention
4. People enjoy stories with.....settings rather than those with far-fetched backgrounds.
A. practical B. realistic C. artificial D. undefined
5. We were asked to reach a compromise and not start another.....
A. accusation B. concession C. controversy
D. issue
6. He was promoted for his efficiency, while his colleague was demoted for.....
A. ability B. lateness C. incompetence
D. capability
7. Okon's business is flourishing while his father's is.....
A. declining B. progressing C. withering
D. vanishing
8. You should be.....so as not to be caught unawares.
A. serious B. sober C. ready D. Alert
9. The manager who was sacked last month has been.....

A. retired B. suspended C. reinstated D. Promoted

10. The school authorities expected the contributions to be..... rather than compulsory.
A. wilful B. voluntary C. deliberate D. outright

SECTION 2

*From the words lettered A to D, choose the word that **best completes** each of the following sentences.*

11. The.....programme against childhood diseases has ended.
A. injection B. vaccination C. immunization
D. harmonization
12. The accused stated.....that he was innocent of the crime.
A. unequivocally B. feebly C. ashamedly
D. excitedly.
13. The doctor's.....was that the patient was suffering from cancer.
A. prediction B. verdict C. diagnosis D. analysis
14. I was advised to open a..... account with the bank if I wanted to pay in cheques.
A. savings B. deposit C. loans D. current
15. The pastor addressed his..... in a sonorous voice.
A. audience B. masses C. spectators
D. congregation
16. Many African leaders try to cling.....to power.
A. tenaciously B. judiciously C. economically
D. socially
17. The civilian head of state was.....in a military coup d'etat.
A. discharged B. ousted C. empowered
D. enthroned
18. After much debate on the controversial issue, the meeting was.....All the next morning.
A. postponed B. proscribed C. adjourned
D. delayed.
19. The company distributed gifts to its staff as an..... to hard work.

A. ricentive B. inception C. interest D. induction

SECTION 3

*After each of the following sentences, a list of possible interpretations is given. Choose the interpretation that you consider **most appropriate** for each sentence.*

20. Bukola has an infectious smile. This means that Bukola
A. spreads infection when she smiles.
B. has sores in her teeth.
C. makes others smile when she smiles
D. becomes infected when she smiles.
21. It is cold comfort to tell a hungry man that starvation improves heaah. This means that telling a hungry man this is
A. frightening. B. consoling C. unhelpful
D. hypocritical.
22. Nonso's father gave him a free hand to run the family business. This means that his father
A. assisted him freely
B. allowed him to make his own decisions.
C. made him sole owner of the business
D. allowed him freedom of movement in the premises.
23. Audu was certainly born with a silver spoon in his mouth. This means that
A. he was born into a rich family
B. his parents gave him a silver spoon when he was born.
C. he was born in the age of miracle
D. his parents could not help him.
24. You must be speaking with your tongue in your cheek. This means that you
A. must be very serious
B. must be thinking of something else
C. have food in your mouth
D. don't mean what you are saying.
25. The manager hit the roof when he was presented with a huge estimate for the new project. This means that the manager
A. became very suspicious
B. threw an object at the roof.
C. became very angry
D. ordered the project to be started at once.
26. Her reproaches cut him to the quick. This means that he
A. was made to act quickly
B. was wounded
C. was deeply hurt
D. began to speak angrily

27. The girl went scot-free even though she started the fight. This means that the girl was
A. punished
B. unpunished
C. expelled from school
D. free to move about

28. The secretary's vote of thanks did not ring true. This means that the vote of thanks was
A. full of praise B. not audible C. not sincere.
D. well delivered

29. Mary Onyali won the race by a hair's breadth. This means that Mary won
A. convincingly B. narrowly C. comfortably
D. luckily.

SECTION 4

*From the words lettered A to D below each of the following sentences, choose the word that is **nearest in meaning** to the underlined word as it is used in the sentence.*

30. The criminal was incarcerated.
A. arrested B. pardoned C. imprisoned
D. cautioned
31. The Manager soon found out that my sister was a competent typist.
A. patient B. capable C. hardworking D. careless.
32. At the inception of his administration, the Governor was very popular.
A. end B. beginning C. dissolution D. peak
33. The businessman anticipated the collapse of the bank
A. prevented B. caused C. foresaw D. pre-empted
34. The plaintiff was dissatisfied with the decision of the court.
A. solicitor B. accused C. complainant
D. respondent
35. The judge was incorruptible.
A. frank B. unreliable C. incorrigible D. honest
36. Mr. Preye is a stern father.
A. wicked B. loving C. conservative D. Strict
37. My first son is an unusually audacious boy.
A. daring B. clever C. cowardly D. mischievous
38. Amina often makes derogatory remarks about her husband.
A. arrogant B. belittling C. laudable D. Discreet

SECTION 5

*From the words or group of words lettered A to D, choose the word or group of words that **best completes** each of the following sentences.*

39. For such a serious offence, Etim was lucky to..... with a fine.
A. get over B. get on C. get away D. get off
40. The members of the Association were just rounding.....their discussion when the police arrived.
A. up B. off C. of D. in
41. I could not attend the meeting, so asked my sister to stand.....for me
A. up B. by C. in D. on
42. I tendered for that contract, but my application.....
A. fell in B. fell off C. fell through D. fell down
43. He is Mr. Bello's son.....?
A. isn't he B. isn't it C. is it D. he is
44. You will help me with my assignment,.....?
A. can you B. could you C. would you D. won't you
45. I bought my..... today.
A. very green first party dress
B. green very party first dress
C. first green very party dress
D. very first green party dress
46. Although he was not born in Yorubaland.....
A. he can't speak the language
B. he can't write the language
C. he can speak the language
D. but he can speak the language
47. Adaku and Udoka were curious.....who was coming to see their father.
A. at B. about C. in D. Of
48. Moji says she is better at Maths.....
A. as me B. than I am C. as I am D. with me
49. I have never.....humiliated in my life.
A. being so B. so being C. been so D. so been
50. He.....the scene before the accident occurred.
A. leaves B. has left C. left D. had left
51. The proposer's argument was.....convincing than that of his opponent.
A. much more B. most C. much D. more much
52. The cloth is.....bright for my liking.
A. very B. so C. quite D. too
53. By the time they arrive, we.....the work.
A. shall have finished
B. could have finished
C. will finish
D. have finished
54. This engine is..... that one.
A. superior than B. more superior than
C. more superior to D. superior to
55. Janet could not attend the party because she.....with the flu over the weekend.
A. came up B. came down C. came away D. came in
56. The new student made a good impression..... the rest of the class.
A. with B. at C. on D. for
57. Could I borrowcash please?
A. a little B. a few C. much D. few
58. It is.....this background that we can understand the issues clearly.
A. for B. against C. with D. on
59. The teacher told the pupils to commit the poem..... memory
A. to B. in C. onto D. inside
60.we waited, Ayo read the letter over again.
A. While B. When C. Where D. Why
61. I expect everybody to respect.....
A. itself B. ourselves C. himself D. oneself
62. You are.....for having that painful experience
A. none the best B. none the worst
C. none the worse D. Nonetheless
63.is not good for children
A. To have skipped breakfast
B. Skip breakfast
C. To have been skipping breakfast
D. Skipping breakfast
64. The manager is leaving the company to.....a new appointment elsewhere.
A. take over B. take on C. takeover D. takeoff
65. Since we were not given all the things we requested, we should.....with what we have.
A. make up B. make out C. make do D. make over

66. Nigerians will have.....to blame for withdrawing from the competition at the last minute.
A. themselves B. one another C. each other
D. ourselves
67. Many people do not.....their religious professions
A. live by B. live to C. live with D. live on
68.a new teacher, she does not know much about the behaviour of the students.
A. Being B. Having been C. Been D. Having being
69. The principal hoped that he..... to help the students.
A. can be able B. is able C. would be able
D. must be able
70. The lecturer arrived exactly.....time to give the talk.
A. on B. with C. by D. In
71. Olumide initially disliked Mathematics, but..... time he began to like it.
A. by B. on C. with D. at
72. The judge says that no one is..... the law.
A. over B. above C. after D. Across
73. The officer..... that he was not supposed to talk to the press on the matter.
A. will know B. shall know C. could have known
D. should have known
74. He is a dare-devil; I really.....be surprised that he has escaped.
A. ought to B. oughtn't C. could D. couldn't
75. This is Bisi's handwriting; there.....be no argument about it.
A. will B. may C. might D. can

SECTION 6

In the following passages, the numbered gaps indicate missing words. Against each number in the list below each passage, four options are offered in columns lettered A to D. Choose the word that is the **most suitable** to fill the numbered gap in the passages.

PASSAGE A

Jide bought his car last year and now there is the need to renew the — 76 —. The first time he went to Mr. Olumide, the — 77 —, he was

advised to — 78 — a — 79 — rather than a ---- 80----- cover. Mr. Olumide had carefully explained the merits and demerits of both type which included the fact that one was far more — 81 — than the other.

Now Jide has cause to smile because of his entitlement to a no-claim — 82 —. Being a careful owner-driver, he had not been involved in any — 83 — during the period. Unfortunately, the same could not be said for his friend, Jackson, whose car was a total — 84 — after a — 85 with a truck. He could not even make any claim for — 86 —, because he was not — 87 — at all.

Jackson's experience clearly points to the need for insurance — 88 — to educate prospective — 89 — on the benefits of insurance.

76. road worthiness	77. road superintendent	78. take out	79. yearly licence	80. reduce rates	81. expensive	82. deduction	83. incident	84. knock-out	85. collision	86. damages	87. insured	88. agents	89. customers
chassis	insurance broker	take of	cheaper deal	third party	exclusive	dividend	accident	knock-out	contact	repair	recognized	vendors	buyers
insurance policy	driving instructor	take of	cheaper deal	third party	exclusive	dividend	accident	knock-out	contact	repair	recognized	vendors	buyers
vehicle dues	licensing officer	take of	comprehensive policy	third rate	impressive	reward	quarre	write-off	confrontation	improvement	authorities	colours	applicants

PASSAGE B

The persistent fuel — 90 — in the country paralysed all aspects of life especially in the cities. The streets were often — 91 — of the usual hustle and — 92—that characterized city life. A visitor might erroneously think it was a public holiday, until he came near a — 93 —. There he would find long — 94 — of haphazardly parked vehicles waiting to buy the non-existent fuel from the idle — 95 —.

Another look at the bus stops would reveal groups of people anxiously trying to get to their places of work. Even car owners used the few — 96 — buses, the drivers of which had increased the — 97 — by anything from 100 to 500 percent.

Though this could be very annoying, — 98 — should not blame the drivers for the — 99 — rates because the drivers had to pay through the nose to procure fuel at the — 100 —.

90. paucity	91. full	92. struggle	93. market place	94. columns	95. hards	96. inaccessible	97. firms	98. transporters	99. exorbitant	100. back door
scarcity	derailed	bustle	park	crowds	pumps	available	levies	voyagers	moderate	black market
withdrawal	deserted	juggle	filling station	lines	motors	agreeable	fares	conductors	exquisite	fuel depot
subsidy	devoid	tussle	fuel depot	queues	tanks	pliable	money	passengers	fair	open market

**WASSCE JUNE 2001 ENGLISH
OBJECTIVE TEST ANSWERS**

LANGUAGE 2

1.D	2.D	3.A	4.B	5.C	6.C	7.A
8.D	9.C	10.B	11.C	12.A	13.C	14.D
15.D	16.A	17.B	18.C	19.A	20.C	21.C
22.B	23.A	24.D	25.C	26.A	27.B	28.C
29.B	30.C	31.B	32.B	33.C	34.C	35.D
36.D	37.A	38.B	39.C	40.B	41.C	42.D
43.A	44.D	45.D	46.C	47.B	48.B	49.C

50.D	51.A	52.D	53.A	54.D	55.A	56.C
57.A	58.B	59.A	60.A	61.C	62.C	63.D
64.C	65.C	66.A	67.A	68.A	69.C	70.A
71.C	72.B	73.D	74.B	75.D	76.C	77.B
78.C	79.D	80.C	81.A	82.C	83.C	84.D
85.A	86.C	87.C	88.A	89.C	90.B	91.D
92.B	93.C	94.D	95.B	96.B	97.C	98.D
99.A	100.B					

WASSCE JUNE 2001 ENGLISH LANGUAGE 1 THEORY QUESTIONS

SECTION A

Answer one question only from this section.

1. Write a letter to your father, who has been on a long course abroad, telling him how the family has been faring in his absence.
2. Write an article suitable for publication in a cultural magazine on the advantages and disadvantages of the extended family system.
3. The last nation-wide strike by secondary school teachers affected your school adversely. Write a letter to the Minister of Education suggesting at least three ways of preventing future strike actions.
4. You are a speaker in a debate on the topic: "Civilian rule is better than military rule." Write your contribution for or against the motion.
5. Write a story, real or imagined, which illustrates the saying: "Make hay while the sun shines."

**SECTION B
COMPREHENSION**

Answer all the questions in this section.

6. Read the following passage carefully and answer the questions on it.

Bitrus, a middle-aged man, was speeding along the hot tarmac one afternoon, oblivious of the countryside. By his side, reading a magazine was his first son, a twenty year old university computer science student. On the man's mind was the contract he was pursuing in the capital city. It was worth several million dollars. Although he had handled bigger contracts before, Bitrus was preoccupied with this new challenge, his mind far away from the road before him. His son too was buried in the magazine he was reading. So, neither saw the goat crossing the road early enough. Like an automaton, Bitrus jammed on the brakes. In a flash, there was a skid and a

somersault. The villagers worked for almost an hour to clear the wreckage of the huge Mercedes before rescuing the two.

There, in the casualty ward, the duo lay on the stretchers. Bitrus was soon in a fairly stable condition, but anybody would know that the son needed prompt specialist medical attention. The doctor was sent for, a surgeon who regularly handled such cases. Soon enough, the doctor came. The nurses heaved a sigh of relief. But then..... "Oh no I can't handle this case. He's my son!," Everyone was shocked. One of the nurses pleaded, "But doctor, you must do something, otherwise,....." "No, he's my son. I'll have to transfer this case." And so, tearfully, more agitated than anybody around, the doctor hurried away to call a colleague.

Here was Bitrus, with multiple injuries, but not in danger. In the adjoining room was his son, still comatose. How then could a doctor come in and say, "This is my son"? Wasn't Bitrus the father after all? Most people would reason that the doctor was truly the secret biological father. Others, reasoning hard, would conclude that the doctor was Bitrus's father and thus was right in describing his grandson as his son. But for how long would people continue to think that all doctors must be male? Couldn't the doctor have simply been Mrs. Bitrus?

(a) (i) What was the remote cause of the accident? (ii) What was the immediate cause?

(b) What does the passage suggest about doctors' attitude to the cases they handle?

(c) Describe the conditions of Mr. Bitrus and his son at the hospital.

(d) What assumption about doctors does the passage illustrate?

(e) "His son too was buried in the magazine he was reading."

- (i) What type of figurative expression is this?
- (ii) What does it mean?

(f) that the doctor was truly the secret biological father". ,

- (i) What grammatical name is given to this expression?
- (ii) What is its function as it is used in the sentence?

(g) For each of the following, find a word or phrase that means the same and can replace it as it is used in the passage:

- (i) oblivious; (ii) prompt; (iii) regularly; (iv) pleaded;
- (v) agitated; (vi) adjoining

7. *Read the following passage carefully and answer the questions on it.*

In the 1960s and 1970s undergraduates did not need to apply for employment. Employers usually wooed them by depositing offers of jobs in their halls of residence for those interested to pick and choose from as soon as they finished writing their degree examinations. How things have changed! We have since "progressed" from this age of abundance in which unemployment was hardly heard of to one of economic recession and widespread unemployment. The problem is so acute nowadays that one finds unemployment even among engineers and doctors.

What are the causes of this phenomenon? For one thing, our educational system does not train its products for self-employment. Everybody expects the government or the private sector to provide them with a job at the end of their studies. As we have now realized, the government and the private sector combined cannot create enough jobs to go round the y of graduates turned out annually by our universities. For another, many parents encourage their children to enrol in courses leading to prestigious and lucrative professions for which they may be, intellectually unsuited. They end up obtaining poor degrees or none at all. Such graduates cannot compete on the job market, so they swell the ranks of the unemployable and the unemployed.

Perhaps the most important single cause of unemployment is economic recession. During periods of boom, economic activities are generated in abundance and these make plenty of jobs available. But the reverse is the case in times of economic recession.

There is no simple solution to the problem. Everyone in the society has a role to play here. The government has a duty to ensure that the economy is buoyant, thus providing the right environment for the creation of jobs. The

educational authorities have to orientate the process of education towards the production of job creators rather than job seekers. Guidance and counselling services should be made available in all secondary institutions. Parents, too, should stop misdirecting their children into choosing careers for which they are ill-suited.

- (a) (i) What was the employment situation like in the 1960s and 1970s?

- (ii) What is the situation now?

(b) In what ways do the educational system, the parents and the students contribute to the unemployment situation?

(c) Mention three suggestions given in the last paragraph for solving the problem.

(d) Why does the writer enclose the word progressed (first paragraph) in quotation marks?

(e) for which they may be intellectually unsuited."

- (i) What grammatical name is given to this expression?

- (ii) What is its function as it is used in the sentence?

(f) For each of the following words, find another word or phrase that means the same and can replace it as it is used in the passage:

- (i) recession; (ii) acute; (iii) army; (iv) lucrative;
- (v) boom; (vi) orientate

SECTION C SUMMARY

8. *Read the following passage carefully and answer the question on it.*

Poverty! Can anyone who has not really been poor know what poverty is? I really doubt it. How can anyone who enjoys three square meals a day explain what poverty means? Indeed, can someone who has two full meals a day claim to know poverty? Perhaps, one begins to grasp the real meaning of poverty when one struggles really hard to have one miserable meal in twenty-four hours. Poverty and hunger are cousins, the former always dragging along the latter wherever he chooses to go.

If you are wearing a suit, or a complete traditional attire, and you look naturally rotund in your apparel, you cannot understand what poverty entails. Nor can you have a true feel of poverty if you have some good shirts and pairs of trousers, never mind that all these are casual wear. Indeed, if you can change from one dress into another, and these are all you can boast of, you are not really poor. A person begins to have a true feel of what poverty means when, apart from the tattered clothes on his body, he doesn't have any other, not even a calico sheet to keep away the cold at night.

Let us face it, how can anyone who has never slept outside, in the open, appreciate the full, harsh import of homelessness? Yet that is what real, naked poverty, is. He who can lay claim to a house, however humble, cannot claim to be poor. Indeed, if he can afford to rent a flat, or a room in a town or city, without the landlord having cause to eject him, he cannot honestly claim to be poor. The really poor man has no roof over his head, and this is why you find him under a bridge, in a tent or simply in the vast open air.

But that is hardly all. The poor man faces the world as a hopeless underdog. In every bargain, every discussion, every event involving him and others, the poor man is constantly reminded of his failure in life. Nobody listens attentively when he makes a point, nobody accepts that his opinion merits consideration. So, in most cases, he learns to accept that he has neither wisdom nor opinion.

The pauper's lot naturally rubs off on his child who is subject not only to hunger of the body but also of the mind. The pauper lacks the resources to send his child to school. And even in

communities where education is free, the pauper's child still faces an uphill task because the hunger of the body impedes the proper nourishment of the mind. Denied access to modern communications media, the poor child has very little opportunity to understand the concepts taught him. His mind is a rocky soil on which the teacher's seeds cannot easily germinate. Thus embattled at home and then at school, the pauper's child soon has very little option but to drop out of the school.

That is still not all. Weakened by hunger, embattled by cold and exposure to the elements, feeding on poor water and poor food, the pauper is an easy target for diseases. This is precisely why the poorest countries have the shortest life expectancies while the longest life expectancies are recorded among the richest countries. Poverty is really a disease that shortens life!

In six sentences, one for each, summarize the problems of the poor man.

WASSCE JUNE 2001 ENGLISH LANGUAGE 3 TEST OF ORALS OBJECTIVE TEST

SECTION 1

From the words lettered A to D, choose the word that has the **same vowel sound** as the one represented by the letter(s) underlined. An example is given below.

Example: seat A. sit B. cite C. set D. key

The correct answer is D because only key contains the **same vowel sound** as the one underlined in seat. So, answer space D would be shaded

[A] [B] [C] [D]

Now answer the question that follow:

1. work A. port B. talk C. nurse D. lock
2. grew A. sew B. who C. pull D. know
3. deep A. police B. twice C. kick D. spill
4. hill A. chief B. hike C. save D. fit
5. best A. regale B. vehicle C. many D. burnt
6. hunt A. rough B. cough C. hunger D. saw
7. flock A. love B. onion C. bottle D. jam
8. force A. worse B. pause C. bus D. jam
9. cat A. last B. cut C. bank D. plate
10. car A. derk B. man C. plait D. quay
11. buy A. bury B. buoy C. heinous D. height
12. float A. oven B. hoard C. poll D. hop
13. way A. says B. great C. plaque D. height
14. about A. round B. dough C. thought D. country

15. fair A. dear B. hear C. beer D. rare

SECTION 2

From the words lettered A to D, choose the word that has the **same consonant sound(s)** as the one represented by the letter(s) underlined. An example is given below.

The correct answer is B because only dress contains the **same consonant sound** as the one underlined in vice. So answer space B would be shaded.

[A] [B] [C] [D]

Now answer the following questions

16. bang A. sand B. singe C. hung D. bug
17. these A. clothe B. worth C. thank D. path
18. vision A. attention B. repression C. intention D. illusion
19. Physics A. verse B. faction C. shepherd D. psychic
20. check A. choir B. chaos C. chimney D. machine
21. cool A. accuse B. ocean C. censure D. cellar
22. slap A. phase B. post C. corps D. coup
23. shame A. bench B. toss C. nation D. yacht
24. toast A. begged B. warned C. listen D. capped
25. thin A. length B. tin C. thyme D. there
26. asked A. axed B. grasped C. masked D. taxed
27. apply A. help B. please C. tulip D. print

28. pneumonia A. damn B. solemn C. hymn D. knew
 29. zoo A. resign B. assist C. converse D. rice
 30. baby A. dumb B. lamb C. stab D. climb

SECTION 3

From the words lettered A to D, choose the word that **rhymes** with the given word. An example is given below.

Example: detain A. obtain B. detail C. claim D. relay
 The correct answer is A because only obtain rhymes with detain. Therefore, answer space A would be shaded.

[A] [B] [C] [D]

Now answer the following questions:

31. serial A. carrier B. serious C. unreal D. rally
 32. deceit A. receipt B. appeal C. resit D. conceive
 33. could A. food B. blood C. wooed D. wood
 34. curtail A. until B. fail C. defile D. feel
 35. while A. buy B. boil C. bile D. boy

SECTION 4

In each of the following questions, the main/primary stress is indicated by writing the **syllable** on which it occurs in capital letters.

From the words lettered A to D, choose the word that has the **correct stress**. An example is given below.

Example: democratic

- A. DE-mo-cra-tic B. de-MO-cra-tic
 C. de-mo-CRA-tic D. de-mo-cra-TIC

The correct answer is C because the main/primary stress of the word democratic is on the third syllable. Therefore, answer space C would be shaded.

[A] [B] [C] [D]

Now answer the following questions:

36. matrimony
 A. ma-TRI-mo-ny B. ma-tn-MO-ny
 C. ma-tn-mo-NY D. MA-tn-mo-ny
37. advertisement
 A. ad-ver-TISE-ment B. ad-ver-tise-MENT
 C. ad-VER-tise-ment D. AD-ver-tise-ment
38. formidable
 A. FOR-mi-da-ble B. for-MI-da-ble
 C. for-mi-DA-ble D. for-mi-da-BLE
39. category
 A. ct-E-go-ry B. CAT-e-go-ry
 C. cat-e-GO-ry D. cat-e-go-RY
40. delicacy
 A. del-i-ca-cy B. del-i-CA-cy
 C. del-i-ca-CY D. DEL-i-ca-cy

SECTION 5

In the following options lettered A to D, all the words except one have the same stress pattern. Identify the one with the different **stress pattern** and shade your answer in the usual way. An example is given below.

Example: A. away B. apart C. behind D. river
 Options A, B, C are all stressed on the second syllable while option D is the only one stressed on the first syllable. So, D is the correct answer. Therefore answer space D would be shaded.

[A] [B] [C] [D]

Now answer the following questions:

41. A. success B. extent C. colleague D. acute
 42. A. despite B. petrol C. vomit D. wardrobe
 43. A. component B. importance C. distribute D. revenue
 44. A. benefit B. deposit C. difficult D. prevalent
 45. A. schedule B. country C. finance D. fountain

SECTION 6

In each of the following sentences, the word that receives **the emphatic stress** is written in CAPITAL LETTERS. From the questions lettered A to D. Choose the one to which the given sentence is the appropriate answer. An example is given below.

Example: My mother's FRIEND hates pets.

- A. Does your mother's boss hate pets?
 B. Does your mother's friend love pets?
 C. Does your mother's friend hate toys?
 D. Does your father's friend hate pets?

The correct answer is A because My mother's FRIEND hates pets answers the question, Does your mother's boss hate pets? Therefore, answer space A would be shaded.

[A] [B] [C] [D]

Now answer the following questions:

46. Tamuno confessed that he STOLE the car.
 A. Did Thomas confess that he stole the car?
 B. Did Tamuno confess that he borrowed the car?
 C. Did Tamuno deny that he stole the car?
 D. Did Tamuno confess that he stole the lorry?
47. Dad requested the DRIVER to open the door?
 A. Did Mum request the driver to open the door?
 B. Did Dad order the driver to open the door?
 C. Did Dad request the gardener to open the door?
 D. Did Dad request the driver to shut the door?
48. The housemaid locked the baby in the FRIDGE.
 A. Did the steward lock the baby in the fridge?
 B. Did the housemaid cool the baby in the fridge?
 C. Did the housemaid lock the cat in the fridge?
 D. Did the housemaid lock the baby in the toilet?

49. Musa found the money UNDER Mum's mattress.
 A. Did Musa find the money inside Mum's mattress?
 B. Did Musa steal the money under Mum's mattress?
 C. Did Ayo find the money under Mum's mattress?
 D. Did Musa find the wristwatch under Mum's mattress?
50. The AMBASSADORS are visiting Nigeria tomorrow.
 A. Are the ambassadors visiting Ghana tomorrow?
 B. Are the athletes visiting Nigeria tomorrow?
 C. Are the ambassadors visiting Nigeria next week?
 D. Are the ambassadors leaving Nigeria tomorrow?

SECTION 7

From the words lettered A to D, choose the word that contains the sound represented by the given **phonetic symbol**. An example is given below

Example: /ɔ i/ A. yell B. holy C. boy D. idiot

The correct answer is C because only boy contains the sound represented by the given symbol. Therefore, answer C would be shaded.

[A] [B] [C] [D]
 Now answer the following questions:

51. /ə / A. increase B. perform C. tidy D. divert
 52. /ʌ / A. colour B. loss C. though D. collar
 53. /ʊ / A. rude B. fun C. push D. rush
 54. /ɜ:/ A. heart B. clerk C. part D. earth
 55. /ɪ / A. amoeba B. woman C. rescind D. police
 56. /ʃ / A. cheat B. match C. clash D. forge
 57. /ɜ/ A. regime B. fragile C. huge D. gender
 58. /o / A. writhe B. smooth C. northern D. worth
 59. /s / A. resound B. cease C. houses D. design
 60. /z / A. worse B. goose C. bats D. whose

WASSCE JUNE 2001 ENGLISH LANGUAGE 3

TEST OF ORALS OBJECTIVE TEST ANSWERS

1.C	2.B	3.D	4.D	5.C	6.A	7.B
8.B	9.C	10.A	11.D	12.C	13.B	14.A
15.D	16.C	17.A	18.D	19.B	20.C	21.A
22.B	23.C	24.D	25.A	26.C	27.B	28.D
29.A	30.C	31.C	32.A	33.D	34.B	35.C
36.A	37.D	38.A	39.B	40.D	41.C	42.A
43.D	44.B	45.C	46.B	47.C	48.D	49.A
50.B	51.B	52.A	53.C	54.D	55.C	56.C
57.A	58.D	59.B	60.D			

WASSCE JUNE 2001 ENGLISH LANGUAGE 1 THEORY ANSWERS

SECTION A

1. 6, Agarawu Street

Mushin
 Lagos State
 Nigeria
 16th May, 2001.

My dear father,

I don't know how to express our feelings at home. We miss you a lot. I had thought you will come back in good time. What we thought would take just six months has taken two complete years, yet we don't know when you will return.

Home has not been the same since you left. I now realise the importance of a father at home. The moonlight stories and plays. The collection of one money or the other from you. Words cannot express how much we're missing you. We are all anxiously waiting for the time when the prolonged course shall end.

The position of the family since you left has been mixed. Though, our mother has been trying,

yet I still believe that there is no person who can replace your fatherly role at home. Uncle Tayo comes in once in a while to play with us. He even assisted us in making Sola secure an admission.

Another important thing that happened during your absence is mummy's promotion. God is wonderful. It would have been difficult to finance our education, shelter us, but for the promotion. She is now the Assistant Executive Officer in the Local Government.

Educationally, we are steadily progressing. None of us has failed since you left. I was the best overall student in the last promotion from SS2 to SS3. Sola was able to secure an admission to Federal Government College, New Bussa. Also, our elder sister, Funmilola is in the University of Lagos. Even if you're here, we couldn't have surpassed this achievement.

However, there are two major things that have happened which made your absence felt. First, the plots of land you bought at ORe Odo have been taken over by trespassers. Second, the landlord has given us a quit notice. We are

presently looking for an alternative accommodation.

Uncle Tayo and Bola sent their greetings. Extend my warm regards to your fellow course mates. Hoping to read from you soon.

Yours affectionately,
Ade

2. THE ADVANTAGES AND DISADVANTAGES OF THE EXTENDED FAMILY SYSTEM.

The family is the single, most important unit of any society. This explains why God created the first family after he had established the earth. There are many advantages inherent in the extended family system. The nuclear family does not exist in isolation, it comes from a larger system which is the extended family.

The extended family consists of the husband, wife, children and the relatives of the husband and wife. These relatives are the uncles, cousins, nephews, aunts, etc. It is a system which ensures communal help to be rendered to the other members of the extended family. The help includes taking the children of other family members into one's immediate family. It extends to providing free labour when one family member is constructing a house.

One of the advantages of this system is fostering unity amongst the family members. Everybody is his brothers' keeper. The concerted efforts of all members of the family make the extended family system have an edge over the nuclear family system. Problem shared is problem solved. Psychologically, a member of the extended family whose burden is shared by many is likely to have a less burden to carry. This can be exemplified with this illustration. Roofing of the house of a member of the extended family is shared by all those concerned. The children carry planks and nails while their parents contribute money to support the completion of the work.

Child-rearing in the extended family system is most suitable. Any other member of the family who is capable of assisting in raising children of those in need accepts the child. The children are also better trained because there are many people watching the behaviour of the children. If a child misbehaves, other members of the family will correct him even when the blood parents are not there.

However, the extended family system does not conform with the present economic reality. It does not logically follow that because a person was trained by another, he is bound to train other people's children. This may cause disaffection

among the family members. In addition, it is a known fact that no matter what you do to satisfy someone else's child, he may not be contented. The child may be feeding his blood parents with packets of lies which in turn may cause disunity. The truth of the matter is that no matter what is done, it is by far better to leave parents to raise their children in their own way.

Finally, the extended family system may encourage indolence. Lazy members of the family can indulge in laziness. All he needs to do is to become an itinerant beggar, moving from one house to the other with complaints. He collects money only to move to another house.

Adewale Bolanle,
25, Karimu Street,
Lagos.

3. A.U.D. Girls' High School,
P.M.B. 2026,
Mushin,
Lagos State.
25th July, 2001.

The Honourable Minister,
Federal Ministry of Education,
Abuja.

Dear Sir,

THE CAUSES AND PREVENTION OF SECONDARY SCHOOL TEACHERS' STRIKE

I wish to intimate you with the serious consequences of the last nation-wide strike by secondary school teachers in the country. There are many students who did not resume after the strike was called off. The most affected are the female students in the senior classes who were reported to have been pregnant. Infact, our senior prefect was one of these students.

The unfortunate effect of the strike action also affected the male students. The devil found work for some idle hands as there were reports that some secondary school students joined gang of armed robbers while others became gamblers. Academically, most of us have forgotten practically all the things we were taught before the strike commenced. The strike made us duller and lazier. I pray that God will give our teachers strength to make up for the lost time.

Prevention they say is better than cure. It is better to identify the causes of the strike so as to offer ways of preventing it. One of the causes of the teachers' strike was the non-payment of their

salaries promptly. The Nigeria Union of Teachers (N.U.T). scribe claimed that sometimes their salaries are paid on the fifteenth of the following month. He also stated that in some states, teachers were owed arrears of up to three months.

In addition, secondary school teachers are being molested by parents and hooligans; just because they discipline erring students. Also, the proscription of the umbrella body of teachers by the ministry was the last straw that broke the camel's back. The government detained the executive members of the union, dissolved the cabinet and later proscribed it. I wish to suggest some possible ways to curb this type of situation. First, teachers, just like other civil servants are entitled to reward of labour. They have rendered their service and as such should be paid their salaries. You should use your good offices to constitute a probe panel to look into the reasons for the delay in payment of the teachers' salaries.

Teaching profession is the oldest profession in the world. There should be a code of conduct governing it. The ministry should come out with categorical statement condemning all acts of molestation and intimidation of teachers. I also wish to suggest that a liason committee be formed. This committee will have mnrters from both the ministry and the teachers where problems and agitations can be discussed. It is going to be of imm.ene bhëit to the nation at large and to the students in particular if there are no more strikes. I wish the ministry looks into these suggestions with a view to finding lasting solution to incessant strikes.

Yours faithfully,



Adeleke Bolanle

4. CIVILIAN RULE IS BETTER THAN MILITARY RULE

Good morning, the chairman, the moderator, the panel of judges, the time keeper, my co-debaters, and my attentive audience. The topic to be proposed this morning is 'Civilian Rule is Better Than Military Rule'

First, one has to give the meanings of key words in this topic — Civilian and Military Rule. Civilian rule can be defined as a type of governance undertaken by the civil society. It can also be referred to as government by the people's representatives. Military rule on the other hand is governance by members of the armed forces.

They usually force themselves on the people. Civilian rule is referred to as democratic while military rule is tagged autocratic. The process of choosing the representatives of the people is most often done through voting while the military come to power through another process called coup d'etat.

At this juncture, I have to come out boldly by supporting the proposal, having these points to buttress my stance. One of the most important reasons why civilian rule is better is what we are doing today—debate. The freedom guaranteed all citizens to air their views. My opponeids cannot deny the fact that you dare not publicly critisize a military regime. You will be rounded up by the state security agents if such happens.

The process of becoming the peoples' representative is another reason for my preference of civilian rule to military rule. All intending participants will come out to campaign. They will give highlights of what they wish to accomplish if they are voted for. Some will employ campaign managers, print leaflets, advertise on bill boards, etc. All these will provide employment to some Nigerians. The most important of all these is the choice. The opportunity given to the electorate to vote for the best candidate.

In addition, civilian rulers tend to govern better than military rulers. This is simply because of the fear of reprimand by the people who elected them. The civilian rulers know clearly that should they fail to perform, re-election will be difficult. It may even spell doom for their political party if they are elected through the platform of a political party. Above all, they live amongst us, they begged us to vote for them and they are our people. It seems logical that they are easily accessible to us than any group of people who forced themselves on us.

Moreover, there are checks rind balances embedded in civilian rule to ensure smooth running of government. The legislative houses and the press oftentimes cry out to check the excesses of civilian rulers. My opponents can testify to the fact that there are no legislative houses during military regime. Again, the press is viewed by the military as their enemy, thus leading to the closure of media houses and detention of journalists.

In conclusion, I wish to state categorically that the armed forces are established to defend the territorial integrity of the nation ag3inst internal and external aggression. They should face their job rather than rule.

5. MAKE HAY WHILE THE SUN SHINES

Aduke, the toast of the moment. Born with the proverbial silver spoon. She was given everything imaginable for a young child. The sky was the limit. Money and influence, two things necessary to make a man are in her possession without any struggle.

She was the only child of Mr. and Mrs. Adoye. The family was blessed with wealth. It would be considered a shame if they don't use this abundant wealth to train just a child. In fact, many a time, neighbours and relatives were often bailed out of financial difficulties through their philanthropic gestures. There was a particular couple in the neighbourhood who could not afford to pay their children's school fees. It was the generous assistance of the Adoyes who responded to their distress call.

One would have thought that with all these opportunities, Aduke will prosper. In addition, her parents have no choice than to make do with what they have. They are indeed ready to train her to the highest level. The process began with the enrolment into a nursery and primary school in their locality at the age of three. Some dissenting tongues started wagging at first because of the age of the child. The explanation from the Adoyes was that she will get used to the situation.

Aduke graduated from the nursery/primary school to another private secondary school. She was put in a boarding school. This was the rare opportunity given to her on a platter of gold. It was misused. She stopped attending classes altogether. She soon joined the gang of bad girls. All vices which one could think of were her stock-in-trade. She abused all drugs within her reach. It was in the last year in the secondary school that it started to dawn on her that she must do something to pass her examination. Meanwhile, cheating is impossible, hence she decided to try another method.

She consulted some of her mates on her predicament and the solution offered her was to consult a native doctor who will give her a "remembering potion". She had forgotten that without reading, the potion will not work. She failed her examination. After three unsuccessful attempts, she gave up.

SECTION B COMPREHENSION

6. (a) (i) The remote cause of the accident was that Bitrus was not concentrating on the driving.
(ii) The immediate cause was the goat crossing the road.

(b) The passage suggests that doctors' attitude to the cases they handle depends on their relationship with the patient.

(c) Mr. Bitrus had multiple injuries, his son was unconscious.

(d) People think that all doctors are male.

(e)(i) It is a metaphor.

(ii) It means the boy was engrossed in what he was reading.

(f)(i) Noun Clause

(ii) Object of the verb (would) reason

(g)(i) Oblivious - unmindful, forgetful, unaware.

(ii) Prompt - immediate, urgent, quick.

(iii) Regularly - normally, consistently, usually.

(iv) Pleaded - begged, appealed, implored

(v) Agitated - shaken, disturbed, moved.

(vi) Adjoining - next, adjacent.

7. (a)(i) In the 1960s and 1970s, there was no unemployment.

(ii) Now, there is unemployment.

(b)(i) The educational system does not train students to be self-employed.

(ii) Parents enroll their children for courses that they are not suited for.

(iii) Students obtain poor degrees or none at all.

(c)(i) Government should provide the right environment for the creation of jobs.

(ii) The educational authorities should channel the process of education towards producing job-creators.

(iii) Guidance and counselling services should be made available in all secondary schools.

(d) He has used it ironically.

(e)(i) Adjectival/Relative clause

(ii) It qualifies the noun "professions"

(f)(i) Recession — depression, slump, decline

(ii) Acute — severe, serious, enormous

(iii), 'my — large number, multitude, legion.

(iv) Lucrative — Profitable, paying, rewarding

(v) Boom — growth, buoyancy, abundance.

(vi) Orientate — direct, steer, guide.

SECTION C SUMMARY

8. (i) The poor man goes hungry.
(ii) The poor man hardly has any clothes to wear.
(iii) The poor man has no roof over his head.
(iv) The poor man's opinion is not recognized.
(v) The poor man is unable to send his child to school.
(vi) The poor man has a short life-span.

SENIOR SCHOOL CERTIFICATE EXAMINATION (SSCE 1988 – 2015)

Past Questions with Solutions

English Language

(Theory / Objectives with Oral English) 2002

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WASSCE JUNE 2002 ENGLISH LANGUAGE 2 OBJECTIVE TEST QUESTIONS

SECTION 1

*In each of the following sentences, there is one word or group of words underlined and one gap. From the list of words or group of words lettered A to D, choose the one that is **most nearly opposite in meaning** to the underlined word or group of words and that will, at the same time, correctly fill the 'ap in the sentence:*

1. The workers expected management to be..... rather than indifferent to, their welfare.
A. different from B. interested in C. opposed to D. careful of
2. Words spoken in the heat of an argument could offend rather than.....
A. pacify B. amuse C. inspire D. irritate.
3. Although they have declared the student a suspect, he may turn out to be.....
A. culpable B. innocent C. safe D. ignorant
4. Some outspoken social critics live a..... family life.
A. reserved B. happy C. boisterous D. still
5. While the manager was prudent in his expenditure, his deputy was.....
A. miserly B. careful C. thoughtful D. extravagant
6. The cultured and the.....are known by their conduct.
A. barbaric B. ignorant C. clean D. lazy
7. Many Africans now live in abject poverty instead of enjoying the.....of their countries.
A. comfort B. greatness C. possessions D. affluence
8. Tunde seldom asks questions in class and was..... very careful when he did.
A. hardly B. sometimes C. often D. never

SECTION 2

*From the words or group of words lettered A to D, choose the word or group of words that **best completes** each of the following sentences:*

9. Tests revealed that the winning athlete had taken performance-enhancing.....
A. drugs B. tablets C. vitamins D. capsules.
10. The lawyer's client was.....under oath in the law court
A. investigated B. interrogated C. cross-fired D. cross-examined
11. That Fulani man has a large.....of cattle.
A. herd B. flock C. multitude D. swine
12. The relationship between the couple is.....for lack of communication
A. tense B. strained C. relaxed D. uneasy
13. Many players have complained about biased..... by referees.
A. officiating B. contro C. direction D. handling
14. Government officials have to swear to.....of secrecy
A. an oath B. a vow C. a pledge D. an Act
15. The students.....the planned meeting with the new principal.
A. refused B. neglected C. boycotted D. rejected
16. She won by.....because her opponent refused to play.
A. defeat E. default C. defiance D. defence
17. Some candidates have developed the.....for cheating in examinations.
A. instinct B. addiction C. knack D. habit
18. The secretary was.....from her job for absenteeism.
A. ev.cted B. dismissed C. rejected D. eliminated

SECTION 3

*After each of the frlki wing sentences, a list of possible interpretations is given. Choose the interpretation that you consider **most appropriate** for each sentence.*

19. Peter was on tenterhooks until the examination results were announced. This means that Peter was
 - A. unhappy about the examination
 - B. suspended from school
 - C. anxiously waiting for the results
 - D. detained by the police.
20. The military leader blazed the trail by handing over power to civilians. This means that the leader
 - A. resigned from the army
 - B. supported civilian ideals.
 - C. was against the army
 - D. set an example
21. Life is all about "give and take". This means that
 - A. people should be willing to compromise
 - B. life gives and takes
 - C. life is about gifts
 - D. any gift should be accepted.
22. Jumai's life was in danger but now she has turned the corner. This means that Jumai
 - A. has given up hope of recovery
 - B. has worsened her situation
 - C. is recovering
 - D. has died.
23. It is unwise for politicians to make off-hand statements to journalists. This means that politicians
 - A. should insist on their interviews being recorded.
 - B. would be wise not to speak to journalists.
 - C. should not make any statement to journalists.
 - D. should be sure of whatever they say.
24. The dentist told his patient that the toothache would pass off when he took some aspirins. This means that
 - A. the tooth would automatically drop off.
 - B. the pains would subside.
 - C. the pains would spread to other teeth.
 - D. the pains would worsen.
25. The students made such a noise in the class that the teacher read them the Riot Act. This means that the teacher
 - A. punished all the students.
 - B. instigated the students to riot.
 - C. warned the students to stop the noise or get punished
 - D. read the school's rules and regulations to the students.
26. When I went on leave I asked Mr. Bamson to hold the fort. This means that I asked him to
 - A. defend me
 - B. act in my absence

- C. protect my position
- D. be strong in my absence

27. The senator's house is the last word in comfort. This means that the senator
 - A. has the most comfortable house
 - B. speaks about the comfort of his house.
 - C. owns the last house on Comfort Street
 - D. has a house that is not comfortable.
28. I was given a standing ovation for my outstanding performance. This means that
 - A. everyone stood up to clap for me
 - B. everyone stood to catch a glimpse of me
 - C. everyone congratulated me
 - D. I was asked to stand up.

SECTION 4

*From the words lettered A to D below each of the following sentences, choose the word that is **nearest in meaning** to the underlined word or group of words as it is used in the sentence.*

29. His father's death derailed his plans to enter the university
 - A. discouraged
 - B. failed
 - C. moved
 - D. ruined
30. Adamu inadvertently shot his friend dead.
 - A. deliberately
 - B. spontaneously
 - C. accidentally
 - D. inappropriately
31. The students made scathing remarks about the vice chancellor.
 - A. critical
 - B. positive
 - C. mild
 - D. damaging
32. Several cabinet ministers joined the president's retinue for the summit conference.
 - A. entourage
 - B. vehicle
 - C. followers
 - D. enemies
33. The manager refused his deputy's request in reprisal for his disloyalty.
 - A. compensation
 - B. annoyance
 - C. retaliation
 - D. exchange
34. She spurned the advances of her boss
 - A. accommodated
 - B. accepted
 - C. rejected
 - D. discouraged
35. Whatever he says is irrevocable
 - A. final
 - B. false
 - C. debatable
 - D. unclear
36. Lunatics have some lucid moments.
 - A. troubled
 - B. quiet
 - C. noisy
 - D. sane
37. Don't expect anything but hypocrisy from politicians.
 - A. promises
 - B. manifestoes
 - C. insincerity

D. dishonesty

SECTION 5

*From the words or group of words lettered A to D, choose the word or group of words that **best completes** each of the following sentences:*

38. The secretary needs to run.....two hundred copies of the previous minutes for the next meeting.
A. off B. on C. out D. over
39. Let us keep.....the plans we made earlier.
A. away B. to C. off D. on
40. To be alive after such a serious accident.....a celebration
A. is called for B. calls for C. has been called for D. call for
41. She does not remember ever.....a tiger
A. to see B. to have seen C. seeing D. having to see.
42. The Commissioner for Education with his secretary.....expected yesterday.
A. are B. was C. were D. is
43. After rigorous interrogation, the thief had no alternative.....to confess the truth.
A. except B. unless C. but D. rather
44. The director is open.....criticism
A. for B. to C. on D. about
45. Tunji divided the money between David and.....
A. he B. him C. himself D. themselves
46. The jury gave.....verdict
A. it's B. its C. his D. her
47. No.....person will do that
A. matured B. maturing C. mature D. matures
48. She stabbed her friend.....the back
A. on B. at C. upon D. in
49. I am not accustomed.....on an empty stomach
A. to sleep B. to have slept C. for sleeping D. to sleeping
50. Take your share and give them.....
A. their B. there C. there's D. theirs
51. My uncle was not sure.....the strange guests were
A. which B. who C. whom D. what
52. The Principal has already summoned all the..... on the matter
A. heads of departments
B. head of department
C. heads of department
D. head of departments
53. But for the timely intervention of the police, the kidnapper.....by the angry mob.
A. will be lynched
B. would have been lynched
C. would be lynched
D. will have been lynched
54.she was tired when we arrived, Mummy prepared a delicious dinner for us.
A. Despite B. If C. Since D. Although
55.Science and Technology many African countries have not made significant progress since their independence
A. With regards to B. In respect to C. As far as D. With regard to
56. If I.....your father, I would call the police
A. have been B. am C. will be D. were
57. I hate..... waiting,
A. to be keeping B. have been kept C. being kept D. to have been kept
58. You had better.....the examination
A. written B. write C. wrote D. be writing.
59. The policeman tried to cash in.....the driver's ignorance
A. under B. against C. on D. with
60. Yesterday, I.....on the beach for half an hour.
A. lain B. lay C. lie D. lied
61. We were told to mind our business during the examination and not.....
A. somebody's else B. somebody else's
C. somebody's else's D. somebody else
62. Whenever you travel buy me.....please
A. a trouser B. one trouser C. a pair of trousers D. trouser
63. The Housemaster asked Ekene whether he had ever.....the marathon
A. run B. ran C. running D. runs
64. The maid denied.....her mistress' money
A. to stealing B. stolen C. to have stolen D. stealing

65. One of the victims.....rushed to the nearest hospital
A. was B. have been C. were D. were being
66. Bachelors find it convenient to buy..... pepper.
A. grind B. grinding C. ground D. grounded.
67. I heard the news.....the radio
A. from B. by C. on D. through
68. The invigilator had hardly turned her back.....
the candidate was caught cheating.
A. than B. when C. hence D. that
69. Of the three girls, Yetunde is the.....
A. tallest B. taller C. most tall D. tall
70. It was Peter that I saw..... ?
A. wasn't it B. didn't I C. isn't it D. wasn't he
71. They finally broke..... after years of being together.
A. up B. away C. out D: in
72. When I was in school, boarders.....very early every morning.
A. are rising B. have risen C. had to rise
D. have to rise
73.of the two girls sang sweetly.
A. Every one B. Each C. Some D. All

SECTION 6

In the following passages, the numbered gaps indicate missing words. Against each number in the list below each passage, four options are offered in columns lettered A to D, choose the option that is the **most suitable** to fill the numbered gaps in the passages.

PASSAGE A

Last month our school marked her diamond jubilee with a double celebration: an interhouse sports competition in the morning and a football match later in the afternoon. The former was very exciting as many — 74 — were broken and several new ones were set. The most exciting were the — 75 — events, especially the 100 metres — 76 — the 200 metres hurdles and the — 77 — races. The — 78 — did not seem particularly interested in the — 79 — events.

Expectedly, the football match drew a very large crowd because of the reputation of the two contesting teams. The — 80 — was taken by the State Administrator who was the special — 81 —. Our team played excellent soccer; the — 82 —

were accurate and our players displayed such — 83—that the spectators were not surprised when, by the end of the —84—, they had scored three goals to nil. In the second half, one of our players was shown a — 85— for...rough.— 86 —. Although our opponents were awarded a — 87 — our — 88 — was so smart that he did not concede a goal.

74. records	B trophies	C titles	D events
75. path	track	road	race
76. run	lap	dash	finish
77. fast	single	group	relay
78. audience	congregation	spectators	mob
79. athletic	field	sport	house
80. kick-off	shot	kick-up	pass
81. chief of ceremonies	guest of honour	institute of ceremonies	guard of honour
82. shootings	moves	passes	criticism
83. combination	understanding	cooperation	team work
84. break	half-way	interval	first-half
85. blue card	white card	red card	green card
86. dribbling	passing	rushing	tackle
87. penalty-kick	throw-in	back-pass	corner-kick
88. mid-fielder	goal-keeper	defender	striker

PASSAGE B

The airport had a big tarmac and a wide — 89 —. Departure time of our flight was announced and all the passengers — 90—to —91 —the plane. Soon the aircraft began to —92 —for— 93—and in a few moments, we were —94—. In no time, we were lost in the — 95 —. A beautiful young — 96 — was meanwhile standing in the — 97 —, close to the cockpit, demonstrating security — 98 — in the event of an emergency. All along, the engines of the plane — 99 — and provided a background of sinister — 100 —.

89. air-strip	B runway	C stretch	D expressway
90. stretched out	fell out	queued up	moved up
91. ascend	climb	board	embark
92. race	speed	fly	taxi
93. take-off	take-up	departure	flight
94. floating	coasting	air-borne	air-lifted
95. atmosphere	clouds	skies	heavens
96. lady	waitress	maid	air-hostess
97. aisle	corridor	stair	passage
98. methods	programmes	measures	plans
99. burned	clattered	creaked	hummed
100. sound	droning	cacophony	disturbance

WASSCE JUNE 2002 ENGLISH LANGUAGE 2 OBJECTIVE TEST ANSWERS

1.B	2.A	3.B	4.A	5.D	6.A	7.D
8.C	9.A	10.D	11.A	12.B	13.A	14.A
15.C	16.B	17.C	18.B	19.C	20.D	21.A
22.C	23.D	24.B	25.C	26.B	27.A	28.A
29.D	30.C	31.D	32.A	33.C	34.C	35.A
36.D	37.C	38.A	39.B	40.B	41.C	42.B
43.C	44.B	45.C	46.B	47.C	48.D	49.D
50.D	51.B	52.C	53.B	54.D	55.D	56.D
57.C	58.B	59.C	60.B	61.B	62.C	63.A
64.D	65.A	66.C	67.C	68.B	69.A	70.D
71.A	72.C	73.B	74.A	75.B	76.C	77.D
78.C	79.B	80.A	81.B	82.C	83.D	84.D
85.C	86.D	87.A	88.B	89.B	90.C	91.D
92.D	93.A	94.C	95.B	96.D	97.A	98.C
99.B	100.A					

WASSCE JUNE 2002 ENGLISH LANGUAGE1 THEORY QUESTIONS

SECTION A

Answer one question only from this section.

1. Your sister wants to marry a man from another ethnic group against your mother's wishes. Write a letter to your mother giving at least three reasons why she should accept your sister's decision.
2. The rising incidence of road traffic accidents nowadays is alarming. In an article suitable for publication in an international magazine, discuss at least three factors responsible for this and suggest ways of dealing with the problem.
3. There has been public outcry against the escalating prices of foodstuffs in your area. Write a letter to your representative in the House of Assembly, stating the causes of the increase and suggesting ways of improving the situation.
4. Your school's Literary and Debating Society has organized a debate on the topic: "The Television is Doing More Harm Than Good to Our Youths." Write your contribution for or against the topic.
5. Write a story which ends with the words: "Had I known, I wouldn't have believed him."

SECTION B COMPREHENSION

Answer all the questions in this section. You are advised to spend about 50 minutes on this section.

6. *Read the following passage carefully and answer the questions on it.*

When health workers first came to the village and talked about family planning, no one took them seriously, including Amusa, whose young wife was then pregnant with their first baby. Had their fathers and forefathers before them not had as many wives and children as they desired? And had they not been able to take care of their families? So everyone shunned the family planning clinic which was established in the village shortly afterwards.

Twelve years later, Amusa was a clerical assistant in the city and lived with his wife and eight children in a single room because he could not afford larger quarters. For as long as he could remember, his large family had been going through difficult times, which appeared to be worsening lately. Only yesterday, his third child had been sent away from school because her

parents could not replace her old and torn school uniforms. Last year, their first son could not proceed to the secondary school as the family could not afford the cost. Then recently, the landlord had announced his intention to increase the rent.

Amusa found himself thinking about the days when he was himself a young child. His own father had had two wives and thirteen children, yet as far as he could remember, the family had not faced anything similar to what he was going through now. He suddenly realized that this was because the times had changed and that the requirements of modern living put great pressure on large family sizes. His father's time and age had been different: he had been a successful farmer in the village, had lived in his own house, employed members of his large family as farm hands and fed everyone from the abundance of the farm. On the other hand, Amusa lived, in the city on a limited income. He had no farm land not even a vegetable garden, and had to pay for everything, from his rented room to the smallest domestic need of his family. And at four or five times what they cost a few years before! It was then that he sadly remembered the health workers and their gospel of family planning. How he wished he had listened and taken their advice! Unfortunately, he had not. And what was even more unfortunate was that the millions in Amusa's shoes became wiser only when it was too late.

(a) What advice do you think the health workers gave to the villagers?

(b) Give two reasons why the villagers did not take the health workers seriously.

(c) Give two indications of Amusa's financial difficulties.

(d) Mention any two differences between Amusa's condition and his father's.

(e) "And what was even more unfortunate..."

(i) What grammatical name is given to this expression as it is used in the passage?

(ii) What is its function?

(f) "And had they not been able to take care of their families?"

(i) What literary device is used in this expression?

(ii) What does it mean?

(g) For each of the following words or phrases, find another word or phrase which means the same and which can replace it as it is used in the passage:

(i) shunned; (ii) established; (iii) announced;

(iv) going through; (v) limited; (vi) shoes

7. Read the following passage **carefully** and answer the questions on it.

The great white shark is at the top of the marine food chain. In the shark family, it is the king, it will eat anything, even other sharks. But as it gets older, bigger and slower, it develops a preference for seals, penguins and camon, especially dead whales.

In locating their food, most sharks use all their senses, including excellent visior. Their sense of smell is incredible and their ears are aided by pressure-sensitive cells along each side of their body. Nothing escapes this eavesdropping system, which is attuned to vibrations in the water. Sharks also have a sixth sense which enables them to detect the weak electrical fields emanating from the beating heart or the swimming muscles of a potential prey.

The white shark's most fearsome assets are its huge head, its black eyes, and its razor-sharp, serrated teeth. The circulatory system of the white shark is different from that of most other sharks. Its blood temperature is about three to five degrees celsius above water temperature; this speeds up digestion and adds to its strength and endurance.

It is known that the white shark spits out its wounded prey after an initial, potful bite. Then it waits for the victim to die before eating it. Why does it use this bite-and-spit strategy? Experts speculate that this is because of its eyes. Unlike other sharks, the white shark has no eyelid-like membrane to protect its eyes; rather, it rotates them in their sockets when a collision is imminent. At the moment of impact, the eye is left exposed, perhaps to the flaying claws of a seal. Therefore, for the white shark, a quick mortal strike and release is common behaviour.

The public image of sharks has been greatly coloured by the novel Jaws which was turned into a popular movie. Overnight the white shark became evil incarnate. However, it is not a demon craving human flesh. The smell of blood does not drive it into a feeding frenzy as it does certain other sharks. Nevertheless it is a dangerous animal that should be treated with caution and respect.

- (a) How do sharks use their sixth sense?
- (b) In what significant way is the circulatory system of the white shark different from that of other sharks?
- (c) What, according to the passage, is the probable reason why the white shark waits for its victim to die before eating it?

(d) (i) What is the writer's attitude to the white shark? (ii) Quote an expression from the passage to support your answer.

(e) 'At the moment of impact...'

(i) What grammatical name is given to this expression as it is used in the passage? (ii) What is its function?

(f) "However, it is not a demon craving human flesh." What figure of speech is contained in this expression?

(g) For each of the following words, find another word or phrase which means the same and which can replace it as it is used in the passage:

- (i) preference; (ii) incredible; (iii) emanating;
(iv) speculate; (v) mortal; (vi) coloured.

SECTION C SUMMARY

You are advised to spend about **50 minutes** on this section.

8. Read the following passage **carefully** and answer the questions on it.

Scientists have made spectacular advances in genetic engineering in the last fifty years. The benefits of this genetic revolution to mankind are immense and almost limitless. In the field of medicine, many of the diseases that have hitherto proved incurable can now be eradicated using genetic engineering. It is now possible to identify the specific gene responsible for any given disease and to replace the diseased gene with a healthy one. This new technology can now be used to cure such serious diseases as diabetes, sickle-cell anaemia and cancer. Geneticists (specialists in genetic science) claim that there are several other medical benefits that can be derived from this new science. They assert that by increasing the neurons in the brain, we could slow down the ageing process.

Scientists are now on the threshold of being able to redesign the human body to make it function more efficiently. This interesting aspect of preventive medicine involves the intervention of the doctor to ensure that the foetus contains no diseased gene that can develop into a disease later on. Moreover scientists can now build or develop organs for transplant surgery. Patients who need heart or kidney transplants no longer have to wait endlessly for donors or be worried that the donated organs would be rejected by their body's immune system.

Perhaps the greatest benefits of the genetic revolution are in the areas of crop and livestock production. Cloning, or the creation of a new plant or animal from the genetic information carried in

one cell, has already been done with plants and animals. The result is the production of grains that yield their own fertilizer or can be grown in factories without sunshine and soil. Already in the United States of America, genetically modified (GM) potatoes, tomatoes, apples, etc. are on sale in supermarkets. The main difference between these GM products and their conventionally produced counterparts is that the former are usually bigger and have a longer shelf-life than the latter. Consequently, most shoppers would rather go for the GM products, other things being equal. GM livestock are usually a good bargain. Imagine being offered a chicken the size of a turkey or a sheep almost as big as a cow! If the price and the taste are comparable, then the housewife would naturally prefer the GM breed, just as we now prefer the so-called "Agric" fowls to our smaller, local breed.

There are, however, serious potential dangers. The greatest risk is the escape—by accident or by design — of harmful microbes from the laboratory into a world that has no defences against them. Some scientists have speculated that the HIV virus may have originated from such an accidental escape. The world has not forgotten the case of Adolf Hitler who, in furtherance of his project of creating "a superior race," abused scientific knowledge and plunged the world into World War II. For this reason, many governments have been cautious, or even reluctant, to give the geneticists the necessary approval to implement the results of their researches. There is no guarantee that man can be trusted not to use this newfound "power" for destructive ends.

(a) In four sentences, one for each, summarize four benefits of genetic engineering to man.

(b) In two sentences, one for each, state two dangers inherent in genetic engineering.

WASSCE JUNE 2002 ENGLISH LANGUAGE 1 THEORY ANSWERS

SECTION A

1. 28, Onitire Street,

Itire,
Lagos State.

5th July, 2002.

Dear Mother,

Thank you for the beautiful gifts you sent to me. I have no doubt in my mind that you're caring. We are always proud of you. Mummy, I don't think

I will be able to wear the sandal in the school, it is not brown. I can only wear it after school hours and weekends.

Sister Kehinde sent an unclear message to me because I don't believe that in our time such a dispute can ensue. The choice of who to marry should not cause a conflict. As a mother, you're still playing your conventional role of guiding us. However, there are reasons why you should accept her decision. First, she is the one who will live wherever she chooses as her matrimonial home, so, I wish you respect her decision. Second, I would have loved it if you stop the issue of the man's ethnic group. We have to join hands together to foster Nigerian unity. She is contributing her quota towards this.

Lastly, the future is very important. You need to be very careful on this type of issue. What if she accepts your proposal and the choice fails, who gets the blame? The entire blame will be on you. Blessings, prayers and positive thinking are what you need to support her.

Please, don't forget to send the items you promised the other time. I shall be expecting your favourable reply on this issue.

Yours sincerely,
Bola.

2. ROAD ACCIDENTS: CAUSES AND SOLUTIONS

There are many means of transportation namely road, rail, water and air. Road transport appears to be the most commonly used among them. It is affordable when compared with both water and air transport. Flexibility in its routes and simple construction mode make it most convenient.

Road accidents are no more news because of their frequency. The carnage on our roads has become worrisome to the citizenry. One now wonders why what ought to benefit us is causing untimely death of all and sundry. The causes of road accidents are many and something urgent should be done to stem the tide.

Many drivers are illiterate. They are unable to read and write. This explains why unnecessary overtaking at corners, zebra crossings, etc. happens. The problem is further compounded by the nature of road signs which cannot be easily deciphered by these group of drivers.

Another cause of road accidents is drug abuse. Drivers are often intoxicated with alcohol and some hard drugs before driving and

sometimes during journeys. Drug peddlers are many, hawking one drug or the other. Local gin sellers place their wares openly at bus stops waiting for potential buyers.

The state of our roads is another cause. In developed world, roads are regularly maintained but the reverse is the case in Nigeria. In fact, some portions of our so called express roads are often swept away by erosion yet, these portions are left unattended to until accidents happen. Potholes are so numerous that we have taken them as part of our roads. Before everybody dies in numerous fatal accidents, something constructive ought to be done. The solution to the problem must be collective rather than being put on the hands of government alone.

The licensing authority should ensure that before a driver's licence is issued the applicant must be taught all the road signs and symbols and he must show practical evidence of understanding. Hawking of drugs, and local gins in and around motor parks must be banned. It is not enough to legislate against its sale but it must be enforced. Government on her part should maintain our roads, road safety corps should be drafted to patrol our roads and toll gates may be erected on some major roads with a view to using the proceeds for the repair of roads.

Gbenga Oshikoya
Lagos, Nigeria.

3. 2, Fasanmi Street,

Mushin,
Lagos State.
5th August, 2002.

The Hon. (Chief) Bawa Ana,
Rep. BADE/AJADIA Ward 86,
Lagos State House of Assembly Complex,
Alausa,
Ikeja.

Dear Sir,

ESCALATING PRICES OF FOODSTUFFS IN BADE/AJADIA

There has been a public outcry against the escalating prices of food stuffs in BADE/AJADIA constituency in recent time. As our representative, I feel that if this rising cost of food stuffs is brought to your notice, you will use your good offices to find a suitable solution to it. One of the reasons for the sharp increase may not be unconnected with the introduction of the sales tax imposed on

farmers. Consequently, in an attempt to pay the tax, many farmers increased the prices of their produce.

The poor state of rural roads coupled with the high cost of transportation may be the other reason for the high cost of food stuffs. Well, if you permit me I wish to suggest some ways of improving the situation. One of the ways is to slash the sales tax by half or cancel it entirely because farmers are complaining and the masses too. Rather than the sales tax, fertilizers and other farming inputs should be given to encourage them.

The Public Works Bureau (PWB) should be made to construct and reconstruct rural roads. This has two advantages. It makes the road motorable and also makes the foodstuffs get into the market faster than it would have been. I wish to state our unflinching support for you and your party.

Yours faithfully,



Ade Adediran

4. THE TELEVISION IS DOING MORE HARM THAN GOOD TO OUR YOUTHS

Good day Mr. Chairman, Panel of Judges, Accurate Time Keeper, Ladies and Gentlemen. I wish to vividly support the motion which says "The television is doing more harm than good to our youths". The television is a powerful medium which combines both the visual and audio functions into one system. The colour television is even more attractive than its black and white counterpart but you will also agree with me that in its strength of attraction lies its weakness. Youths are no more themselves. The television is their teacher. Even materials not meant for them are openly shown to them unrestricted such as sexual acts, hooliganism, and drugs. "Cigarette is good for you", "Beer is your best companion" — these are advertisers' choice of words in television. I am sure that you will agree that these are potential harm to the youths.

Moreover, education is the best legacy our parents can bequeath to us. The education which we can only get in the school is also being taken away from us by television. Many students live home in the morning pretending to go to school but they soon return home after their parents might have gone to work or merely branch at a friend's place from where they go to a place of their choice to watch television.

It is possible for my opponent to claim that the television is educative and informative. These facts are true but after these functions, it becomes destructive and facilitates dropouts among our youths who become truants because they want to watch other programmes on television.

I will not conclude this debate without asking my opponents these few questions. Do you wish to be a dropout? Would you want your children to be drug addicts?

Thank you all for your attention.

5. "HAD I KNOWN, I WOULDN'T HAVE BELIEVED HIM"

It was incredible yet it happened to me in broad daylight! I have heard, I've seen but never believed it can happen to me.

As a young school leaver, I'm proud to say that I'm exposed to a certain level worthy of pride among my mates. I also live in the heart of Mushin in Lagos. It is a known fact that I am no longer a noVice who could be taken for a ride because I see myself as an enlightened fellow.

It was on a fateful Saturday. The morning came early as usual, the sun was out as early as 10:O'clock. The hustle and bustle of Lagos was at its peak. Shop owners beckoning on potential buyers, hawkers already on the streets. I was on my way to see one of my friends when the unexpected happened. A youngman in his teens approached me. He looked troubled and ruffled. I listened to his story. He was from one of our neighbouring countries and he lost the address of his destination but he remembered the area. He stated that many Lagosians had turned down his pleas for help.

I wanted to break the jinx that Lagosians don't help. I have heard the area he mentioned, and I thought by the time we go from the first house to last house, we would locate the house. After three hours of searching, I gave up the chances of getting the address.

"My friend I have some dollars with me that is what is bothering me" He retorted. I developed instant interest in him. I wanted to shield him from the con men of Lagos who will take advantage of his predicament. He suggested a hotel along the airport road where he can lodge for the night.

At the Lord's Hotel, he collected a key to one room and I followed him upstairs. He sat on the bed, opened his briefcase and behold thousands of dollars were well arranged in rows. He told me that somebody taught him the act of making dollars. He told me that he only needed one chemical and I would become a millionaire. I went home, took my few belongings, my father's colour

television for auction to raise the ten thousand naira (₦10,000) meant for the purchase of the all-important chemical. Alas! I got a buyer, collected the money and off I went to my friend. He collected the money and told me to come back thenextday.

I came as early as 8.O'clock the next day, the hotel room was opened, nobody was able to say anything about my friend's whereabouts and my ₦10,000 was gone. Had I known, I wouldn't have believed him.

SECTION B COMPREHENSION

6. (a) The health workers advised the villagers to practise family planning.
(b) (i) Their fathers and forefathers had large families. (ii) They were able to take care of them.
(c) (i) Amusa could rent only one room for his large family.
(ii) He could not replace their child's old and torn school uniform.
(d)(i) His father had been a successful farmer (in the village) while Amusa was a poor clerical assistant (in the city).
(ii) His father had owned his own house while Amusa was a tenant.
(e)(i) Noun clause. (ii) Subject of the verb "was"
(f)(i) Rhetorical question.
(ii) They took care of their families.
(g) Find another word or phrase which means the same and which can replace it as it is used in the passage:
(i) Shunned — rejected, avoided, disregarded, ignored.
(ii) Established — built, set up, constructed, founded.
(iii) Announced — disclosed, stated, declared, made known, expressed
(iv) Going through — enduring, suffering, experiencing
(v) Limited — meagre, low, poor, little, small
(vi) Shoes — position, predicament, circumstances, situation, plight, condition, state.
7. (a) They use it to detect electrical fields coming from a prey.
(b) Their blood is warmer.
(c) The shark waits for its victim to die because a victim can cause damage to the shark's unprotected eyes.
(d) (i) Fear (ii) "...Fearsome assets or "It is a dangerous animal".

OR

(d)(i) Admiration.

(ii) "Its eavesdropping system..." "...excellent vision..."

(e) Adverbial phrase of time

(ii) Modifying the verb "is left"

(f) Metaphor

(g)(i) Preference — liking, taste, desire, fondness.

(ii) Incredible — unbelievable, wonderful, excellent, amazing.

(iii) Emanating — coming, issuing, originating, arising, resulting.

(iv) Speculate — think, guess, opine, assure, claim.

(v) Mortal — fatal, deadly, lethal (vi) Coloured — influenced, distorted, prejudiced, affected.

SECTION C SUMMARY

8. (a)(i) It can be used to cure serious or incurable diseases.
(ii) It can slow down the ageing process (in man).
(iii) Doctors can now prevent many diseases before the child is born.
(iv) It can produce cheaper varieties (of crops/livestock)
- (b)(i) Harmful microbes may escape from the laboratory (into the world).
(ii) This knowledge can be used by man for destructive purposes.

WASSCE JUNE 2002 ENGLISH LANGUAGE 3 TEST OF ORALS OBJECTIVE TEST

SECTION 1

From the words lettered A to D, choose the word that has the same **vowel sound** as the one represented by the letter(s) underlined. An example is given below:

Example: seat A. sit B. cite C. set D. key

The correct answer is D because only key contains the same vowel sound as the one underlined in seat. So, answer space D would be shaded.

[A] [B] [C] [D]

Now answer the questions that follow:

- bark A. mass B. ant C. pass D. ward
- story A. drought B. spot C. fought D. through
- sack A. back B. dark C. task D. false
- look A. fool B. could C. boulder D. bloody
- best A. leopard B. regal C. saying D. legal
- cool A. foot B. cook C. pull D. brute
- sit A. creature B. colleague C. wanted D. police
- rush A. bush B. plough C. put D. rough
- worse A. sort B. urge C. worn D. gorge
- mother A. perky B. mercy C. surprise D. purchase
- fair A. wear B. dear C. here D. mere
- make A. height B. weight C. says D. plait
- rear A. pear B. heir C. fear D. swear
- know A. sew B. grew C. vow D. how
- cloud A. route B. bouquet C. bowl D. growl

SECTION 2

From the words lettered A to D, choose the word that has the **same consonant sound(s)** as the one represented by the letter(s) underlined. An example is given below.

Example: Vice A. cat B. dress C. show D. chalk

The correct answer is B because only **dress** has the same consonant sound as the one underlined in vice. Therefore, answer space B would be shaded.

[A] [B] [C] [D]

Now answer the following questions

- hang A. stingy B. tinge C. sing D. hinge
- with A. healthy B. wealthy C. breath D. feather
- find A. handsome B. sandwich C. sandpaper D. handkerchief
- pain A. coup B. report C. corps D. receipt
- pleasure A. vision B. mansion C. regiment D. pressure
- baker A. debt B. lamb C. plumber D. humble
- count A. civil B. pact C. cease D. indict
- wash A. nation B. occasion C. treasure D. equation
- ten A. depot B. listen C. attack D. christmas
- zebra A. assign B. design C. insist D. persist
- path A. there B. smooth C. warmth D. soothe
- see A. cats B. clause C. wars D. boys
- loud A. walk B. shoal C. yolk D. should
- plant A. price B. pistol C. riddle D. couple
- marks A. exist B. exhaust C. axe D. masque

SECTION 3

From the words lettered A to D, choose the word that **rhymes** with the given word. An example is given below.

Example: obtain A. detain B. detail C. claim D. relay

The correct answer is A because only obtain **rhymes** with detain. Therefore, answer space A would be shaded.

[A] **[B]** **[C]** **[D]**

Now answer the following questions:

31. diverse A. reverts B. devise C. reverse D. excess
32. abound A. confound B. counted C. recount D. amount
33. sweet A. white B. sword C. quit D. suite
34. shout A. nought B. crowd C. drought D. thought
35. permit A. enlist B. commit C. dismiss D. profit

SECTION 4

In each of the following questions, the main/primary stress is indicated by writing the syllable on which it occurs in **capital letters**.

From the words lettered A to D, choose the one that has the **correct stress**. An example is given below.

Example: democratic

- A. DE-mo-cra-tic B. de-MO-cra-tic
C. de-mo-CRA-tic D. de-mo-cra-TIC

The correct answer is C because the main/primary stress of the word democratic is on the third syllable. Therefore, answer space C would be shaded.

[A] **[B]** **[C]** **[D]**

Now answer the following questions:

36. omnipotent
A. om-nip-o-TENT B. om-nip-O-tent
C. om-NI P-o-tent D. OM-nip-o-tent
37. accuracy
A. AC-cu-ra-cy B. ac-cu-RA-cy
C. ac-CU-ra-cy D. ac-cu-ra-CY
38. dependable
A. DE-pen-da-ble B. de-PEN-da-ble
C. de-pen-DA-ble D. de-pen-da-BLE
39. exhibition
A. Ex-hi-bi-tion B. ex-HI-bi-tion
C. ex-hi-bi-TION D. ex-hi-BI-tion
40. advantageous
A. AD-van-ta-geous B. ad-VAN-ta-geous
C. ad-van-TA-geous D. ad-van-ta-GEOUS

SECTION 5

In the following options lettered A to D, all the words except one have the **same stress pattern**. Identify the one with the different stress pattern and shade your answer in the usual way. An example is given below.

Example: A. away B. apart C. behind D. river

Options A, B, C are all stressed on the second syllable while option D is the only one stressed on the first syllable. So, D is the correct answer. Therefore answer space D would be shaded.

[A] **[B]** **[C]** **[D]**

Now answer the following questions

41. A. decsert B. colour C. instinct D. risky
42. A. persist B. advice C. wardrobe D. request
43. A. understand B. pacify C. afternoon D. comprehend
44. A. satisfy B. revenue C. benefit D. contribute
45. A. constitute B. devastate C. magazine D. difficult

SECTION 6

In each of the following sentences, the word that receives the **emphatic stress** is written in CAPITAL LETTERS. From the questions lettered A to D, choose the one to which the given sentence is the appropriate answer. An example is given below.

Example: My mothers FRIEND hates pets.

- A. Does your mother's boss hate pets?
B. Does ybur mother's friend love pets?
C. Does your mother's friend hate toys?
D. Does your father's friend hate pets?

The correct answer is A because My mother's FRIEND hates pets answers the question. Does your mother's boss hate pets? Therefore, answer space A would be shaded.

[A] **[B]** **[C]** **[D]**

Now answer the following questions:

46. The teacher praised Udoh for CHALLENGING the robbers.
A. Did the teacher blame Udoh for challenging the robbers?
B. Did the Principal priase Udoh for challenging the robbers?
C. Did the teacher praise Obi for challenging the policeman?
D. Did the teacher praise Udoh for defeating the robbers.
47. The doctor examined the patient with a STETHOSCOPE.
A. Did the doctor examine the patient with a microscope?
B. Did the doctor examine the matron with a stethoscope?

- C. Did the nurse examine the patient with a stethoscope?
D. Did the doctor cure the patient with a stethoscope?
48. The Nigerian soccer team DEFEATED their opponents last year.
A. Did the Ghanaian soccer team defeat their opponents last year?
B. Did the Nigerian cricket team defeat their opponents that year?
C. Did the Nigerian soccer team lose to their opponert last year?
D. Did the Nigerian soccer team defeat their opponents this year?
49. My father BOUGHT a new Mercedes Benz car.
A. Did your mother buy a new Mercedez Benz car?
B. Did your father hire a new Mercedes Benz car?
C. Did your father buy an old Mercedes Benz car?
D. Did your father buy a new Peugeot car?
50. Ngozi loves POUNDED yam with fish stew.
A. Does Nkechi love pounded yam with fish stew?
B. Does Ngozi hate pounded yam with fish stew?
C. Does Ngozi love pounded yam with vegetable soup?
D. Does Ngozi love boiled yam with fish stew?

SECTION 7

From the words lettered A to D, choose the word that contains the sound represented by the given phonetic symbol. An example is given below

Example: /ɔ i / A. yell B. holy C. boy D. idiot

The correct answer is C because only boy contains the sound represented by the given symbol. Therefore, answer space C would be shaded.

[A] [B] [C] [D]

Now answer the following questions:

51. /ə / A. enact B. insist C. survive D. surname
52. /ʌ / A. mountain B. country C. bottle D. sofa
53. /ʊ / A. woo B. spoon C. flood D. book
54. /ɪ / A. silly B. rival C. police D. ravine
55. /ɜ:/ A. source B. court C. journey D. fourth
56. /ʃ / A. watcher B. torture C. question D. tension
57. /ɜ / A. commission B. composure C. pressure D. attention
58. /ʊ / A. bother B. without C. path D. bathe
59. /s / A. ceaseless B. disease C. houses D. resign
60. /z / A. science B. handsome C. reserve D. assert

WASSCE JUNE 2002 ENGLISH LANGUAGE 3 TEST OF ORALS OBJECTIVE TEST ANSWERS

- | | | | | | | |
|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|
| 1.C | 2.A | 3.A | 4.B | 5.A | 6.A | 7.C |
| 8.D | 9.D | 10.C | 11.A | 12.B | 13.C | 14.A |
| 15.D | 16.C | 17.D | 18.C | 19.B | 20.A | 21.D |
| 22.B | 23.A | 24.C | 25.B | 26.C | 27.A | 28.B |
| 29.D | 30.C | 31.C | 32.A | 33.D | 34.C | 35.B |
| 36.C | 37.A | 38.B | 39.D | 40.C | 41.A | 42.C |
| 43.B | 44.D | 45.C | 46.D | 47.A | 48.C | 49.B |
| 50.D | 51.C | 52.B | 53.D | 54.A | 55.C | 56.D |
| 57.B | 58.C | 59.A | 60.C | | | |

SENIOR SCHOOL CERTIFICATE EXAMINATION (SSCE 1988 – 2015)

Past Questions with Solutions

English Language

(Theory / Objectives with Oral English) 2003

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WASSCE JUNE 2003 ENGLISH LANGUAGE 2

OBJECTIVE TEST QUESTIONS

Answer all the questions.

SECTION 1

In each of the following sentences, there is one word or group of words underlined and one gap. From the list of words or group of words lettered A to D, choose the one that is most **nearly opposite in meaning** to the underlined word or group of words and that will, at the same time correctly fill the gap in the sentence;

1. Angela is a very indolent but her sister Mary is one of the most..... girls in the school.
A. perfect B. trustworthy C. diligent D. Devoted
2. Rather than support the Chairman, the members of his board expressed.....to his plans.
A. denial B. opposition C. indifference D. doubt.
3. In any group there are people who display apathy and others who show a lot of.....
A. enthusiasm B. patience C. respect D. Tolerance
4. Femi was very.....about his political ambition but his sister was open about it
A. silent B. withdrawn C. closed D. secretive
5. Ngozi's beauty is natural but her sister's is rather.....
A. unnatural B. artificial C. awkward D. fake
6. The testimony of the witness was so vague that it was difficult to learn the.....details of the case
A. specific B. minute C. transparent D. hidden
7. It is amazing how Jide became so proud, his parents have always been.....
A. humble B. friendly C. generous D. reserved
8. The workshop was intended to.....the workers who had been confused by management's decisions
A. train B. enlighten C. address D. confound.
9. Johnson is consistently assertive but his twin brother is rather.....
A. cautious B. cowardly C. reserved D. respectful.

SECTION 2

From the words lettered A to D, choose the word that **best completes** each of the following sentences.

10. The country's aviation industry has lost at least four.....this year alone.
A. vessels B. aircraft C. coaches D. equipment
11. My cousin has been mamed ior fourteen years but he has no.....
A. siblings B. brothers C. offspring D. survivor
12. Corruption is one of the ills in this country which must be.....
A. exterminated B. eradicated C. destroyed D. broken.
13. The boys covered their noses because of the.....dour in the area.
A. annoying B. smelling C. offensive D. repressive
14. It is.....on parents to advise their children against keeping bad company
A. incumbent B. necessary C. imperative D. required.
15. The man said that he would no longer.....his stepson because of his bad behaviour
A. condone B. accommodate C. concede D. bear.
16. The accused was charged with.....because he caused his brother's death.
A. killing B. fratricide C. fraud D. negligence.
17. Thejudge acquitted Musa because he was a first.....
A. defendant B. accused C. complainant D. offender.
18. He rendered.....assistance to the community.
A. variable B. invaluable C. intrusive D. valued.
19. The team manager looked.....when his boys lost the match.
A down B. denied C. dejected D. deserted.

SECTION 3

*After each of the following sentences, a list of possible interpretations is given. Choose the interpretation that you consider **most appropriate** for each sentence.*

20. We left Kaduna one year ago to the day. This means that we left Kaduna.
A. exactly one year ago
B. one year minus a day
C. one year and a day
D. about a year ago.
21. Tamuno's statement is true to a degree. This means that his statement is
A. very true B. very wrong C. not yet proved
D. partly true.
22. Both the doves and the hawks agreed on this issue. This means that there is agreement by both
A. those who prefer peace and those who want the use of force
B. the poor and the rich
C. the government side and the opposition
D. those supporting changes and those against them.
23. Japan has blazed a trail in the production of electronics. This means that in the production of electronics, Japan
A. has learnt a lot
B. is leading others
C. is making more inventions
D. is competing with others.
24. Mohammed Ali won the fight hands down. This means that Mohammed Ali won
A. after a very tough fight
B. only narrowly
C. without using his hands
D. very easily.
25. The scientist has broken new ground in his research. This means that the scientist has
A. made a new discovery
B. taken up a new interest
C. changed his laboratory
D. offered a new explanation for his discovery.
26. The chief decided to obtain the land by hook or by crook. This means that the chief decided to get the land
A. through negotiation
B. by paying for it
C. by any means possible
D. through litigation.

27. The lady swallowed the whole story hook, line and sinker. This means that the lady
A. totally disbelieved the story
B. totally believed the story
C. had her doubts about the story
D. thoroughly enjoyed the story.
28. He went too far by insulting the Director's wife. This means that
A. he went out with the Director's wife and insulted her
B. he walked too long for the Director's wife
C. he was too close to the Director's wife
D. he should not have gone to the extent of insulting the Director's wife.
29. The decision to dismiss the night watchmen was taken in my absence. This means that the decision was
A. taken as I was leaving
B. taken at my back
C. taken without my knowledge
D. not disclosed to the night watchman.

SECTION 4

*From the words or group of words lettered A to D below each of the following sentences, choose the word or group of words that is **nearest in meaning** to the underlined word or group of words as it is used in the sentence.*

30. You have failed to heed the warning about your marriage
A. consider B. notice C. ignore D. disregard.
31. The scholarship committee has endorsed the student's bursary
A. reduced B. increased C. approved D. revised
32. All my efforts to settle the quarrel between the two friends were futile
A. fruitful B. clumsy C. baseless D. unproductive.
33. My uncle made the right choice of career as a detective because he is a very observant man
A. watchful B. sensitive C. cautious D. intelligent
34. I cannot continue the argument because you are biased.
A. stupid B. convinced C. prejudiced D. worried
35. Guidance counsellors should regard all the information given by students as confidential.
A. secret B. reliable C. authentic D. malicious.
36. It is advisable to buy durable clothes nowadays.
A. expensive B. lasting C. fashionable

D. comfortable.

37. There are various options open to you on this matter.
A. doors B. choices C. skills D. factors.
38. To drive on through the red light is an infringement of the law
A. a trespass B. an offence C. a breach
D. an invasion.

SECTION 5

*From the words or group of words lettered A to D, choose the word or group of words that **best completes** each of the following sentences:*

39. Kate.....tears of joy when she heard about her success
A. broke into B. broke out C. broke up in
D. broke with
40. The worker's strike was.....as a result of the Director's intervention
A. called back B. called in C. called off
D. called out
41. Mrs. Jallow has bought a.....bag
A. black new leather B. new leather black
C. leather black new D. new black leather.
42. The breakdown of our marriage was no fault of.....
A. me B. my C. mine D. I
43. He did it, but not.....in the way I had expected
A. as B. quite C. hardly D. so
44. The driver.....nearly caused an accident
A. rather B. almost C. very D. quite
45. The teachers are not likely.....promoted until next year
A. to be B. to have been C. to have D. to being
46. Haven't you got a football field in your school?.....we haven't
A. Yes B. No C. So D. Never
47. I could not distinguish the twins.....each other
A. with B. to C. by D. from.
48. He..... be fat, but he still runs fast
A. could B. might C. may D. can.
49.I come in, please?
A. Might B. May C. Should D. Must.

50. "You won't tell Daddy.....you?"
A. will B. would C. can D. shall.
51. Joe.....graduated from one of the best universities
A. will have B. shall have C. would have
D. must have.
52. The boys were fighting..... their sisters were eating
A. until B. since C. while D. besides.
53. Isn't it high time we.....?
A. started eating B. start eating
C. had started eating D. start to eat.
54. The group is committed to.....for international peace
A. work B. worked C. working D. be working.
55. God always.....us when we pray
A. bless B. blessing C. blessed D. blesses
56. Since he failed the examination, he could not.....miss the admission
A. though B. but C. then D. however.
57. Sometimes minor incidents in our lives stand out because we cherish
A. it B. many C. none D. them
58. You.....get to the meeting in time
A. had better B. better C. have better
D. may better
59. One does not normally expect problems but.....come
A. it does B. they do C. they did D. it will.
60. Her handbag is made.....genuine leather
A. in B. with C. of D. by.
61. To persist.....sin is spiritual death
A. on B. at C. with D. in.
62. You wouldn't have come if you had known,.....?
A. would you B. isn't it C. wouldn't you
D. will you.
63. Many people were invited to the party but..... were catered for
A. a few B. several C. a little D. few.
64. All the.....are holding an emergency meeting behind closed doors
A. Heads of States B. Heads of State
C. Head of States D. Head of State.

65. The novel makes..... interesting reading
A. very B. mostly C. much D. almost.
66. He eats.....
A. quite rather fast B. rather too fast
C. rather very fast D. quite very fast.
67. Daughters confide..... their fathers more than sons do
A. in B. on C. to D. about.
68. The secretary was directed to bring.....the matter during the next meeting
A. back B. up C. about D. out
69. The contractors set the ladder..... the wall
A. at B. on C. against D. by
70. Bola,won the beauty contest, is my sister.
A. which B. that C. who D. whom.
71. Interest in education has fallen..... because of unemployment
A. off B. down C. through D. out.
72.I prepare the food, please set the table
A. While B. When C. Although D. Since.
73. "Ladies and gentlemen, let us come together to know..... better"
A. each other B. one another C. us D. ourselves.
74. The national basketball team.....expected back from England this evening
A. is B. are C. were D. was.

SECTION 6

In the following passages, the numbered gaps indicate missing words. Against each number in the list below each passage, four options are offered in columns lettered A to D, choose the word that is the **most suitable** to fill the numbered gap in the passages.

PASSAGE A

For fixed fees, insurance companies will help a firm insure against — 75 — and provide some — 76 — Most firms often seek —77—against fire, theft, fraud and other —78— happenings for which they pay —79—to the insurance companies. The payments usually vary according to the — 80 — to be —81 —. Some of these happenings may be —82—sustained during work or — 83 — debts arising from business transactions.

A —84—number is given to the insured for proper— 85.—. If you have just bought a new car,

it is advisable to take a —86— policy rather than a —87 —' for more risks are covered in the former than in the —88 —.

A	B	C	D
75. events	accidents	occurrences	emergencies
76. discounts	bonuses	compensation	help
77. protection	provision	advice	aid
78. insurances	risks	unknown	unforseeable
79. premiums	charges	taxes	tariffs
80. dangers	risks	events	items
81. agreed	entered	negotiated	covered
82. deficit	damage	harm	injury
83. overdraw	illegal	careless	overdrawn
84. significant	policy	typical	contract
85. recognition	identification	accounting	auditing
86. conditional	total	full	comprehensive
87. second hand	one party	third party	subsidiary
88. letter	first	other	previous

PASSAGE B

Communication is a way of sharing information, ideas or jokes with somebody by talking, writing or using signs. Without communication, no one can learn or teach.

The various means of — 89 — communication include letter writing, telephone, telex, fax and so on. The telephone is one of the — 90 — means of communication without the risk of travelling. One can make a telephone call from a home or a public telephone — 91 —. Telephones are connected to each other by wires that transmit — 92 — by electric — 93 —. The type of telephone common to people is the — 94 — telephone. There are local and international — 95 —. To telephone someone, you have to — 96 — a number.

A ringing —97— indicates that the line is through. As soon as the receiver is lifted at the other end, the ringing stops and communication begins. The communication is — 9C — as soon as the receiver is put back on its cradle. Telephone — 99— usually pay their — 100 — through specified banks.

A	B	C	D
89. excellent	moderate	moderate	update
90. topmost	house	both	additional
91. symbols	energy	current	office
92. desk	dials	digital	sound
93. tap	sound	transmitted	wire
94. called off	dealers	callers	wall
95. bills		toils	trunks
			dial
			signal
			cut off
			offenders
			less
			regular
			lastest
			post
			subscriptions
			flare
			extended
			calls
			ring
			bell
			relieved
			subscribers
			dues

WASSCE JUNE 2003 ENGLISH LANGUAGE 2 OBJECTIVE TEST ANSWERS

1.C	2.B	3.A	4.D	5.8	6.B	7.A
8.B	9.B	10.B	11.C	12.B	13.C	14.A
15.B	16.B	17.D	18.B	19.C	20.A	21.D
22.A	23.B	24.D	25.A	26.C	27.B	28.D
29.C	30.A	31.C	32.D	33.A	34.C	35.A
36.B	37.B	38.C	39.A	40.C	41.D	42.C
43.B	44.A	45.A	46.B	47.D	48.C	49.B
50.A	51.D	52.C	53.A	54.C	55.D	56.B
57.D	58.A	59.B	60.C	61.D	62.A	63.D
64.B	65.A	66.B	67.A	68.B	69.C	70.C
71.A	72.A	73.D	74.A	75.B	76.C	77.A
78.D	79.A	80.B	81.D	82.D	83.A	84.B
85.B	86.D	87.C	88.A	89.B	90.D	91.B
92.C	93.B	94.A	95.D	96.C	97.B	98.C

WASSCE JUNE 2003 ENGLISH LANGUAGE 1 THEORY QUESTIONS

SECTION A

Answer **one** question **only** from this section.

Your answer should **not be less than 450 words** long.

1. Your brother is about to enter secondary school. Write a letter to him, stating at least three problems he is likely to face in school and suggesting ways of solving them.
2. Write an article for publication in your school magazine on: "The evil effects of eximination malpractice in our socieW".
3. Write a letter to your Local Government Authority commenting on three health hazards in your area. Make suggestions as to how the situation can be improved.
4. You are the main speaker in an inter-school debate. Write your speech for or against the motion: "Corrupt Public Officers, too, Deserve Capital Punishment".
5. Write a story ending with: "He reaped what he sowed". The story should be suitable for publication in your school magazine.

SECTION B COMPREHENSION

Answer **all** questions from this section.

6. Read the following passage **carefully** and answer the questions on it.

Among the giraffes, zebras and gazelles that roam the vast African savanna, perhaps the most remarkable creature is the ostrich. Standing about 2.5 metres tall and weighing up to 155 kilograms, the ostrich is the largest bird in existence. No one can fail to be awed and fascinated by the bird's great height, powerful legs and beautiful fluffy feathers.

Like the camel, the ostrich is tolerant of high temperatures and thrives in desert country. It also has long luxuriant eyelashes which protect its large eyes from the dust of the bushveld. Its legs are long and sinewy and its feet are strong and fleshy. Seeing the ostrich strutting about in the open plains, observers are amazed at its agility and endurance.

The ostrich is omnivorous, feeding on almost anything that creeps or crawls. It also dines on insects, snakes, rodents, roots and most vegetation. Because of its great size and weight, it cannot fly. However, its muscular legs are powerful enough to make it one of the fastest creatures on earth. Running across desert country, it can attain speeds of up to 65 kilometres an hour. This extraordinary swiftness and its long-distance stamina enable it to outrun many of the fastest four-legged predators with ease.

The eggs of the ostrich are the largest in the world and can weigh up to 1.5 kilograms each. Prized for its size and delicious taste, each egg is the equivalent of 25 hens' eggs. The shell is hard and glossy and has a glazed porcelain-like finish. The empty shell is sometimes used as a container by BUshmen for storing water.

In the 14th century, ostrich feathers became highly valued by fashion-conscious Europeans. Yet, hunting the ostrich was not easy, since the bird has very keen eyesight and swiftly flees from danger. Consequently, the ostrich was in no danger of extinction at that time.

But in the 19th Century, armed with modern weapons, hunters slaughtered ostriches by the millions. And today the noble ostrich has become an endangered species.

- (a) Give three reasons why the ostrich egg is considered valuable.
- (b) How does the ostrich survive attack by predators?
- (c) What common characteristic of birds does the ostrich lack?
- (d) Why did the Europeans value ostrich feathers?
- (e) "The eggs of the ostrich"
 - (i) What is the grammatical name given to this expression?
 - (ii) What is its function as it is used in the sentence?
- (f) What is the writer's attitude to the ostrich?
- (g) For each of the following words, find another word or phrase that means the same and can replace it as it is used in the passage:
 - (i) vast; (ii) remarkable; (iii) fascinated; (iv) thrives; (v) outrun; (vi) extinction.

7. Read the following passage **carefully** and answer the questions on it.

Chief Ibezim and the District Officer were good friends. Ibezim was the Chief Priest of Ani, the earth goddess, in Ndiuzo, and although the District Officer was stationed in far-away Umueke and the Chief Priest by his calling should not travel out of Ndiuzo, their friendship remained as solid as a rock.

They became friends after Ibezim had testified before the District Officer in the land dispute between Ndiuzo and Umueke. He was the only man to testify against his own people in that dispute, and had struck the District Officer as an honest man who was telling the truth.

This was what earned Ibezim the admiration and friendship of the District Officer. Consequently, the District Officer advised him to send his son to the new school and the new religion that held out so much promise of positive change in the future. And when the system of indirect rule necessitated the appointment of a warrant chief at Ndiuzo, the District Officer also promptly thought of his honest friend as the most suitable candidate.

On the other hand, Ibezim's testimony in the land dispute earned him the wrath of many of his own people. They not only held him responsible for their loss of the disputed land but also resented his friendship with the District Officer and his patronage of the new education and religion, which were threatening to erode the old ways of the land. So, when the District Officer wanted Chief Ibezim at Umueke, and he sought to confer with his people on what to do, his detractors quickly turned their backs on him and left him alone in his dilemma. Some even secretly hoped that he was going to be arrested and detained.

After a long period of hesitation, Ibezim finally decided to break with tradition and go to Umueke. The times were changing and he was sure the earth goddess would understand and condone his going away from the village.

When he came back, those who had wished him the worst got the shock of their lives. They now had a new Warrant Chief to rule over them!

- (a) What had earned Chief Ibezim the District Officer's friendship?
- (b) State two ways in which Ibezim benefitted from his friendship with the District Officer.
- (c) Give two reasons why the villagers were unhappy with Chief Ibezim.
- (d) State the dilemma in which Chief Ibezim found himself.
- (e) "the eggs of the ostrich...."

- (i) What is the grammatical name given to this expression?
- (ii) What is its function as it is used in the sentence?

(f) What is the writer's attitude to the ostrich?

(g) For each of the following words, find another word or phrase that means the same and can replace it as it is used in the passage:

- (i) vast; (ii) remarkable (iii) fascinatefd
(iv) thrives (v) outrun; (vi) extinction

(h) For each of the following words, find another word or phrase that means the same and can replace it as it is used in the passage:

- (i) calling; (ii) consequently; (iii) promptly;
(iv) wrath; (v) detractors; (vii) condone.

SECTION C SUMMARY

8. Read the following passage **carefully** and answer the question on it.

The dramatic increase in life expectancy globally towards the end of the twentieth century has generated renewed interest among scientists and laymen alike in the subject of longevity and the ageing process. This lengthening of life expectancy has been one of the greatest achievements of humanity. It was in recognition of this fact that the United Nations formally designated 1999 as the "International Year of Older Persons". Demographers tell a surprising story: octogenarians and older people, instead of the young, now form the fastest growing population group on earth.

What then are the factors that determine man's health and the length of his life? Recent studies have identified some of these.

It is known that the sounder your habits the longer your life may last. Nutritionists have told us that we are what we eat, that is to say, that what we eat influences the state of our health. Instead of over-eating, one should eat a balanced diet including fruit and plenty of vegetables. Moderate physical exercise on a regular basis is of immense benefit. The family doctor should be consulted on how much exercise and what type are most appropriate for each individual. Studies have shown that simple exercises in and around the home help the elderly to regain strength and vitality.

The adage "use it or lose it" applies not only to the muscles but also to the mind. Mental exercise keeps the brain's "telephone lines" alive whereas mental decline Or serenity starts the moment a person retires and decides to take

things easy in the erroneous belief that he doesn't have to keep up with the world any more. Many retired civil servants fall into this bad habit. They can change this unhealthy habit by being actively engaged in reading, travel, education, clubs, professional associations etc. It is believed that such activities not only lift the spirit but also "rewire" the brain.

In addition to these is the environment. In many developing countries, the environment poses grave dangers to health, often resulting in preventable deaths. Access to clean safe water is severely limited. There are huge mountains of refuse breeding vermin, cockroaches and disease causing germs in both rural and urban areas. All this contributes to the low life expectancy in these countries. Better sanitation, safer water for all and a reduction of vermin in the home will improve man's environment, bolster his health and extend his life-span.

The next factor is the state of medical care available in our countries. In the developed countries, advances in medical science have dramatically improved health care delivery. Unfortunately, the reverse has been the case in the poor countries of Africa and Asia. For example, in the USA, only one woman in 12,500 dies from pregnancy-related causes whereas one in 21 dies in Africa from the same cause! That speaks volumes about the deplorable state of our medical services.

Finally, man has made a breakthrough in controlling his genetic make-up. A decade or so ago, he had no control whatsoever over his genetic engineering. Now, he can re-design his genetic constitution to ensure better health and longer life.

In six sentences, one for each, state the factors that improve man's health and life-span.

WASSCE JUNE 2003 ENGLISH LANGUAGE 1 THEORY ANSWERS

1. 32 Monebi Street,

Papa Ajao,
Lagos.

26th June, 2003.

Dear Dele,

How are you and the people at home? I hope everything is rosy. The news has got to me that you have been offered admission to Opu Model College. Congratulations. I really rejoice with you over your brilliant performance in the entrance examination to the famous college which has

been the exclusive preserve of only the exceptionally brilliant students. Once more, accept my appreciation.

I would seize this opportunity to intimate you of the possible problems that you may encounter in the college. First of all, you need to know that you have to be up and doing as regards your academics. Since you are aware that CPU Model College (OMC) boasts of the best brains in our state, you must work extra hard to make a positive mark amidst your mates. This feat requires burning the night candle always.

Furthermore, bullies are very many in OMC. So expect their unpleasant treatment of new students in the school. They will surely attempt to snuff life out of you through their endless punishment and errands they will send you. You dare not disobey any of their orders!

Moreover, the financial requirements of being a boarder are greater than those of a day-student. As you know that our mother who is now the breadwinner of the family may not be able to cope with the huge bills you are likely to be given. I therefore appeal to you to guard your loins and be prepared to do some menial jobs which could augment whatever she gives you.

Another problem you may face in OMC is frequent rioting of students. There is hardly any term that students of this college don't go on one form of demonstration or rioting or another. This at times leads to occasional closure of the college or the disruption of their academic programmes. At the end of the day, a whole session may be lost to the riots and demonstrations thereby causing students to lag behind in their academic pursuits.

Dele, the only way to overcome this problem is to always pray to God for his intervention so that the six years you are to spend in the college will be crisis-free.

May God help you. I will be with you next week. Do not join bad gangs. Instead, I want you to regularly attend the activities of the students fellowship union.

I wish you the best of luck. May we meet in peace, Amen.

Bye for now.

Yours sincerely,

Kola.

2. "THE EVIL EFFECTS OF EXAMINATION MALPRACTICE IN NIGERIA"

Examination malpractice' has consistently remained a bane of Nigeria's educational system. No wonder the academic certificates being issued graduates in Nigeria are no more valuable than the pieces of paper on which they are printed, according to the view of most foreigners.

What then is examination malpractice? Examination malpractice is a situation in which candidates for an examination are given undue advantages before, during or after the examination so that the candidates win cheap success thereafter. Hence, the sanctity of the examination is broken or violated. Examination malpractices portend grave dangers for the nation. In the first place, our graduates of educational institutions cannot stand the test of time. They are ill-baked because there was no thoroughness in their training and the process of academic acquisition.

Also, the negative trend can be seen in employees being engaged in jobs they are not suited for since the certificates they claim to possess are not merited. In addition, seriousness is thrown to the wind. Students have little time for their studies as they attend parties, engage in drug addiction and other untoward behaviours.

Furthermore, bribery and corrupt practices accompany examination malpractices. This is so because the cheats offer money and atimes their bodies to get illicit assistance in the examination hall. Bribes are offered invigilators and supervisors so that they may connive with the examination cheats to have a field day in the hall.

Creativity and resourcefulness are hampered or discouraged in a nation where examination malpractices thrive. The cankerworm named examination malpractices should be stamped out of the country before they wreak greater havoc on the social, religious, economic and political lives of Nigeria. God help Nigeria to accomplish just this.

3. 8 Awolesi Street,
Shomolu Palmgrove,
Lagos.
14th July, 2003.

The Chairman,
Sh. molu Local Government Authority,
Palmgrove Estate,
Lagos.

Dear Sir,

HEALTH HAZARDS IN SHOMOLU

I wish to draw your attention to the deplorable health condition in our area and seek your urgent attention in arresting the ugly situation. It is common knowledge that most public roads are now refuse dumps. Refuse lines the major roads and streets, so much so that passers-by now use handkerchiefs to block their nostrils from offending stench which emanates from the wastes.

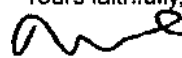
This poses great health risk to inhabitants of Shorolu. A visit to our Health Centre reveals a rise in the number of patients who suffer from one form of lung disease or another. Some of the patients have died since they had no means to buy the expensive drugs prescribed for them. The situation is so pathetic that one sees corpses in every corner of the hospital unattended to. Moreover, the local authority morgue is filled to the brim and this is worsened by the epileptic supply of electricity in recent times.

Sir, you know that the only 500 KV generating plant in the Health Centre mortuary broke down last month. The environment now stinks to heavens. Only your timely intervention can save our community from an outbreak of air-borne diseases as a result of the decomposing corpses in the morgue. A stitch in time saves nine. Furthermore, our community is being threatened by the constant industrial fumes from a few factories and firms. The fumes pose greater health hazards to us. The air in the locality is continually saturated with the industrial fumes, even late in the evenings.

I would like to suggest that you immediately call the erring factories to order. They should adopt a more civilized and decent way of waste disposal, enough of the wastes and fumes dispersal which is done with reckless abandon. If this practice persists, I advise you to use the big stick to bring the factories to compliance. I would appreciate your timely response and action in tackling the health risks threatening our very existence.

I am confident that you will use your good offices to reverse the ugly situation.

Thank you for your usual co-operation.

Yours faithfully,

Ibrahim Sali.

4. "CORRUPT PUBLIC OFFICERS, TOO, DESERVE CAPITAL PUNISHMENT"

Good day Mr. Chairman, the able panel of incorruptible judges, members of the high table, distinguished guests, the time keeper, my co-debaters, ladies and gentlemen. I stand this morning, before you to assert the motion which says: "Corrupt Public Officers, too, Deserve Capital Punishment."

What is capital punishment? It is the maximum or the greatest punishment meted out for an offence or crime. In this case, it is punishment by death which could be by any means electrocution, execution by firing squad, hanging, beheading, etc.

Other offences or crimes which carry death sentences are not more heinous than acts of corruption among public office holders. So, what is sauce for the goose is sauce for the gander. The corrupt public officers use various methods to defraud you and I Money which is meant for the public use, that is for providing social amenities is diverted to private pockets or accounts. The level of Nigeria's underdevelopment can easily be traced to these corrupt officials. For instance, there are cases of some projects which have been awarded ten times over, and yet have not been executed. On each occasion, the money earmarked for such projects end up in these corrupt officers' accounts. Why would anybody then suggest that they be spared from capital punishment?

Moreover, the pen is the ready weapon of the public officers who are known to be corrupt. They use the tool (pen) to change financial figures from hundreds to thousands, to millions and even billions or trillions of naira, thus enriching themselves in a fraudulent way. You and I are then left in the cold to suffer unemployment, lack of provision of basic social amenities, abject poverty, diseases, etc. Indeed, the agents of these misfortune deserve even more than capital punishment.

Money realized by the corrupt public office holders are kept in overseas banks, leaving Nigerian citizens to wallow in abject poverty. I therefore recommend capital punishment to them.

Armed robbers most often do not get as much loot as corrupt public officials. Yet, they are executed on arrest and conviction.

The ill-gotten wealth of the officials are daily openly displayed on our streets in the form of throwing parties lavishly and riding in posh and luxurious cars which are worth millions of naira. They constitute the bug sucking the riches of the country at the detriment of the poor majority.

With these cogent points of mine, I believe corrupt public office holders deserve death punishment to serve as a deterrent to others who may wish to tread their path. This is my submission.

Thank you.

Biola Aramide

5. THE WICKED STEP-MOTHER

Once upon a time, there lived a rich man whose name was Bade. He had two wives who were always at each other's throats. The younger wife was named Bisola while the elder was called Usong and they both had two children each, a male and female. Usong was very accommodating, sincere and friendly with everyone who came her way. But Bisola was not only selfish but jealous of Usong whom she tried by all means to displace in the polygamous family of seven. She felt she had the grace and support of their husband to do whatever she wanted. In fact, she dictated what Bade should do and not do, what he should give Usong and what he must not give. He was at her beck and call. People in the vicinity came to believe that Bisola must have charmed their husband.

Bisola sought all possible means to exterminate Usong and her children but on each occasion, the latter escaped unhurt. Most herbalists in the town knew Bisola because she had consulted them on one occasion or another with a devilish mission. The last straw which broke the camel's back was when Bisola went to a neighbouring village and collected a very potent food poison to kill Usong and her children so that her husband and the home would be hers alone. "Just a little portion is enough to do the deed," the herbalist had told her. "But make sure there is no grain of the powder left on your palm", he concluded. "Thank you Papa", she retorted. "Have this money and I will report back to you in two days time", Bisola said as she left the herbalist's hut.

The next day, the children had all gone to school when Bisola executed her deadly plan. She prepared two different pots of porridge. The first stuff was spiced with several condiments while the second was a dry whitish dish with no ingredients. Having served the different meals, she put some of the poisonous powder in the delicious dish meant for Usong's children so that they could eat it and die instantly. The white porridge, she reserved for her own children whom she knew always arrived home late.

Unfortunately, Bisola's plan did not work out. On her children's arrival from the school, they were enticed by the aroma of the poisoned porridge which was not kept for them. Minutes after they took the meal, they started vomiting and stooling until they died without any help from anybody. When Usong's children came back from school, they took the white porridge which was free of any poison. Having been satisfied, they went to the field to play football. Bisola wept bitterly when she found out that her trap had caught her children. She confessed her evil deeds. Angry sympathizers beat her mercilessly, tore her clothes and even attempted to lynch the wicked step-mother. Many on-lookers and passersby concluded that she reaped what she sowed.

COMPREHENSION ANSWERS

6. (a) (i) It is delicious/tasty (ii) Its shell can serve as a (water) container (iii) It is very big/It is as big as 25 hens' eggs put together/It is the largest egg in the world.
 (b) It outruns them/by out-running them
 (c) It cannot fly
 (d) They used them for fashion
 (e) (i) Noun phrase (ii) Subject of (the verb) "are"
 (f) Admiration/He admires it. He is fascinated by it.
 (g) (i) Vast-large, extensive, wide, expansive (ii) remarkable - striking, notable, extraordinary, outstanding.
 (iii) fascinated-attracted, impressed, enthralled, captivated, excited. (iv) thrives-survives, prospers, does well (v) outrun-flee from, run faster than, beat. (vi) extinction-being wiped out, being destroyed, annihilation, extermination, going out of existence.
7. (a) Chief Ibezim's honesty (in testifying against his own people in the land dispute) the District officer believed that he was honest.

- (b) (i) He was appointed a warrant chief (ii) The District Officer's advised him to send his son to the new school (and religion.)
 (c) The villagers were unhappy with Chief Ibezim because: (i) he testified against them/they held him responsible for the loss of the disputed land (ii) he patronized the new education and religion (iii) he was friendly with the District Officer.
 (d) The dilemma is that accepting the District Officers invitation (to visit Umueke) would break the tradition of his village.
 (e) The tradition is that the Chief priest of Ani (the earth goddess) should not travel out of Ndiuzo.
 (f) (i) Adverbial clause (of time) (ii) Modifying (the verb) "got"
 (g) Simile
 (h) (i) Calling — role, function, office.
 (ii) Consequently — therefore, as a result, thus, so, hence.
 (iii) Promptly — quickly, immediately, instantly, without delay, without hesitation. (iv) Wrath -- anger, resentment, annoyance, indignation, fury, dislike. (v) Detractors — enemies, critics, opponents, foes, adversaries.
 (vi) Condone — tolerate, pardon, accommodate, permit, allow, approve, overlook.

SUMMARY ANSWERS

8. The factors are:
1. Eating good food/a balanced diet or avoiding overeating.
 2. Regular/moderate/simple physical exercise.
 3. Mental exercise/exercising the mind.
 4. Maintenances of sanitation / good / clean / healthy environment.
 5. Good health care/medical services.
 6. Man now has the ability to control/re-design his genetic make-up/constitution.

WASSCE JUNE 2003 ENGLISH LANGUAGE 3 TEST OF ORALS OBJECTIVE TEST QUESTIONS

SECTION 1

From the words lettered A to D, choose the word that has the **same vowel sound** as the one represented by the letter(s) underlined. An example is given below:

Example: seat A. sit B. cite C. set D. key

The correct answer is D because only key contains the **same vowel sound** as the one underlined in seat. Therefore, answer space D would be shaded.

[A] [B] [C] [D]

Now, answer the questions that follow:

1. bill A. seal B. need C. bit D. ninth
2. bag A. lack B. was C. pass D. class.
3. heat A. wife B. beard C. legal D. sieve
4. fed A. pays B. regal C. face D. says
5. mark A. lad B. morale C. ballot D. vocal
6. good A. wool B. fool C. hoot D. boot
7. sun A. coat B. lock C. gone D. rot
8. port A. word B. board C. pod D. tough
9. purge A. bus B. fork C. bush D. worm

10. plot A. wonder B. border C. ponder D. month
11. now A. bough B. mow C. snow D. though
12. cheer A. dare B. wear C. bear D. mere
13. know A. how B. show C. allow D. brow
14. care A. dear B. leer C. pair D. hear
15. fire A. sheer B. tyre C. pier D. gear

SECTION 2

From the words lettered A to D, choose the word that has the **same consonant sound(s)** as the one represented by the letter(s) underlined. An example is given below.

Example: vice A. cat B. dress C. show D. chalk

The correct answer is B because only dress has the same consonant sound as the one underlined in vice. Therefore, answer space B would be shaded.

[A] [B] [C] [D]

Now, answer the questions that follow:

16. dim A. stopped B. walked C. shamed D. asked
17. post A. receipt B. heap C. pneumonia D. psalm
18. yase A. off B. ferry C. of D. leafy
19. rain A. wretch B. park C. light D. surge.
20. leisure A. sugar B. pressure C. compulsion D. decision
21. charge A. nonchalant B. chagrin C. chapter D. brochure
22. journal A. gentle B. guess C. goose D. colleague
23. zone A. horse B. verse C. hacte D. cause
24. filth A. though B. wrath C. worthy D. those
25. pass A. pose B. cesult C. menace D. dissolve
26. ash A. chamber B. monarch C. moustache D. chasm
27. tailor A. walk B. lamb C. calm D. talk
28. gold A. guide B. gem C. gist D. gene
29. ask A. gasp B. tax C. scene D. masque
30. toast A. added B. rushed C. tossed D. posed

SECTION 3

From the words lettered A to D, choose the word that **rhymes** with the given word. An example is given below.

Example: obtain A. detain B. detail C. claim D. relay

The correct answer is A because only obtain rhymes with detain. Therefore, answer space A would be shaded.

[A] [B] [C] [D]

Now, answer the questions that follow:

31. garnish A. tarnish B. finish C. punish D. girlish
32. purge A. budge B. wage C. scourge D. forge
33. toll A. dull B. goal C. wall D. holly
34. hurry A. glory B. sorry C. gory D. curry
35. extension A. evasion B. intrusion C. mention D. decision

SECTION 4

In each of the following questions, the main/primary stress is indicated by writing the syllable on which it occurs in capital letters. From the words lettered A to D, choose the one that has the **correct stress**. An example is given below.

Example: democratic

A DE—mo—cra—tic B. de-.MO—cra--tic
C. de—mo--CRA—tic D. de—mo--cra--TIC

The correct answer is C because main/primary stress of the word democratic is on the third syllable. Therefore, answer space C would be shaded.

[A] [B] [C] [D]

Now, answer the questions that follow:

36. impediment
A. im-ped-I-ment B. im-PED-i-ment
C. IM-ped-i-ment D. im-ped-i-MENT
37. tribalism
A. TRIB-a-li-sm B. trib-a-LI-sm
C. trib-a-li-SM D. trib-A-li-sm
38. laboratory
A la—bor--a—TORY B. LA-bor-a-tory
C. la—BOR—a—tory D. la-bor-A-tory
39. politician
A. pol—i--ti—CIAN B. pol—I—ti—cian
C. POL—i—ti—cian D. pol—i—TI—cian
40. manipulate
A. ma—nip—u—LATE B. MA-nip-u-late
C. ma—NIP—u—late D. ma-nip-U-late

SECTION 5

In the following options lettered A to D, all the words except one have the **same stress pattern**. Identify the one with the different stress pattern and shade your answer in the usual way. An example is given below.

Example: A. away B. apart C. behind D. river

Options A, B, C are all stressed on the second syllable while option D is the only one stressed on the first syllable. So, D is the correct answer. Therefore answer space D would be shaded.

[A] [B] [C] [D]

Now, answer the questions that follow.

41. A. contact B. success C. bazaar D. deceit
42. A. purpose B. reason C. doctor D. condole
43. A. immediate B. examine C. partisan D. component
44. A. reservoir B. importance C. contribute D. deposit
45. A. saboteur B. quantify C. registrar D. disagree

SECTION 6

In each of the following sentences, the word that receives the **emphatic stress** is written in CAPITAL LETTERS. From the questions lettered A to D, choose the one to which the given sentence is the appropriate answer. An example is given below.

Example: My mother's FRIEND hates pets.

- A Does your mother's boss hate pets?
- B. Does your mother's friend love pets?
- C. Does your mother's friend hate toys?
- D. Does your father's friend hate pets?

The correct answer is A because My mother's FRIEND hates pets answers the question. Does your mother's boss hate pets? Therefore, answer space A would be shaded.

[A] [B] [C] [D]

Now, answer the questions that follow:

46. The motor car crashed INTO the building.
A Did the motor lorry crash into the building?
B. Did the motor car park in front of the building?
C. Did the motor car crash beside the building?
D. Did the motor car crash into the electric pole?
47. Mother has invited TEN guests to dinner tonight.
A. Has father invited ten guests to dinner tonight?
B. Has mother invited ten guests to dinner tomorrow?
C. Has mother invited ten guests to lunch tomorrow?
D. Has mother invited twelve guests to dinner tonight?
48. HE asked John to come today.
A. Did she ask John to come today?
B. Did he order John to come today?
C. Did he ask Dad to come today?
D. Did he ask John to come next week?
49. Jane RARELY wakes up before seven o'clock.
A Does Susan rarely wake up before seven O'clock?
B. Does Jane rarely wake up after seven o'clock?
C. Does Jane usually wake up before seven O'clock?

D. Does Jane rarely sleep before seven o'clock?

50. SOME children are afraid of the dark.
A. Are some adults afraid of the dark?
B. Are all children afraid of the dark?
C. Are some children afraid of the light?
D. Are some children in love with the dark?

SECTION 7

From the words lettered A to D, choose the word that contains the sound represented by the given **phonetic symbol**. An example is given below.

Example: /ɔ i/ A. yell B. holy C. boy D. idiot

The correct answer is C because only boy contains the sound represented by the given symbol. Therefore, answer space C would be shaded.

[A] [B] [C] [D]

Now, answer the questions that follow:

51. /ɑ:/ A. plait B. brand C. badge D. balm
52. /D/ A. lost B. come C. pot D. horse
53. /ə/ A. copper B. bell C. motto D. nonsense
54. /ʒ:/ A. chart B. skirt C. shell D. gull
55. /əʊ/ A. doll B. null C. role D. hail
56. /k/ A. scheme B. scene C. known D. knee
57. /h/ A. vehicle B. khaki C. rhyme D. hammer
58. /ŋ/ A. reign B. bring C. strange D. plunge
59. /ʒ/ A. garbage B. ledger C. measure D. knowledge
60. /ə/ A. resume B. dispense C. recess D. perspire

WASSCE JUNE 2003 ENGLISH LANGUAGE 3 TEST OF ORALS ANSWERS

1.C	2.A	3.C	4.D	5.B	6.A	7.C
8.B	9.D	10.C	11.A	12.D	13.B	14.C
15.B	16.C	17.B	18.C	19.A	20.D	21.C
22.A	23.D	24.B	25.C	26.C	27.B	28.A
29.D	30.C	31.A	32.C	33.B	34.D	35.C
36.B	37.A	38.C	39.D	40.C	41.A	42.D
43.C	44.A	45.C	46.C	47.D	48.A	49.C
50.B	51.D	52.C	53.A	54.B	55.C	56.A
57.D	58.B	59.C	60.A			

SENIOR SCHOOL CERTIFICATE EXAMINATION (SSCE 1988 – 2015)

Past Questions with Solutions

English Language

(Theory / Objectives with Oral English) 2004

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WASSCE JUNE 2004 ENGLISH LANGUAGE 2 OBJECTIVE TEST QUESTIONS

SECTION 1

*In each of the following sentences, there is one word or group of words underlined and one gap. From the list of words or group of words lettered A to D, choose the one that is **most nearly opposite in meaning** to the underlined word or group of words and that will, at the same time, correctly fill the gap in the sentence:*

1. The man refused to accept the offer of a job in the.....rural area; he preferred one in the area.
A. local B. urban C. township D. municipal
2. He is quite an outspoken young man but his father is.....
A. humorous B. sober C. taciturn D. silent
3. One of the twins was as daring as the other was.....
A. morose B. timid C. secretive D. rational
4. A gully, which is a natural phenomenon should not be mistaken for a tunnel, which is.....
A. supernatural B. false C. artificial D. modern
5. The crops the farmer planted will be.....in three months' time
A. sold B. weeded C. uprooted D. harvested
6. He intentionally hid the document but his secretary.....burnt them
A. carelessly B. willingly C. accidentally D. foolishly
7. It is curious how Bayo can be so carefree in his ways while his younger brother is so.....
A. meticulous B. eccentric C. indifferent D. active
8. Personally, I give in rather easily when it comes to arguments, but Emeka will always.....to his opinion
A. hold in B. hold on C. hold up D. hold back
9. He didn't lose the fight because of his bravery but for his.....
A. ignorance B. strength C. cowardice D. rashness

10. If you do not drive with care you may be charged for.....
A. recklessness B. drunkenness C. overspeeding D. ignorance

SECTION 2

*From the words lettered A to D, choose the word that **best completes** each of the following sentences.*

11. When you.....an opponent's point in a debate, you must do so politely
A. refute B. rebuke C. reject D. refuse
12. Mr Collins does not allow his name to be published in connection with his philanthropy because he.....publicity
A. wields B. lacks C. detests D. denies
13. I should be as.....as Kofi if I were so rejected by a close friend
A. conscious B. timid C. aggrieved D. courteous
14. The press will no longer be free when the new government starts to.....the newspapers
A. censure B. edit C. publish D. censor
15. Everyone was disappointed to see the pastor doing those things that were.....with the morals he preached
A. complacent B. inconsistent C. conducive D. incompetent
16. That boy is mentally unbalanced, so you should be.....of his behaviour
A. tolerant B. tolerable C. apologetic D. careful
17. The president complained that too many doctors have.....for better remuneration
A. repatriated B. exiled C. emigrated D. immigrated
18. The doctor listened to my heart-beat with a.....
A. microscope B. scalpel C. chronometer D. stethoscope
19. She was.....and it was not clear to me what she meant.
A. unknown B. unintelligible C. indefinite D. illegible

20. Clara, your writing is difficult to read; you must try to make it.....
A. easier B. legible C. large D. eligible

SECTION 3

*After each of the following sentences, a list of possible interpretation is given. Choose the interpretation that you consider **most appropriate** for each sentence.*

21. Despite their newness on the job, the workers were remunerated rather handsomely. This means that
A. the salaries were poor
B. those paid were handsome in appearance
C. the salaries were attractive
D. the workers were paid by handsome accountants.
22. The plan to upgrade the dispensary to a general hospital did not materialize. This means that
A. the arrangements did not work out as wished
B. the plan was badly executed
C. it was difficult to obtain the materials
D. the plan did not meet the required specifications.
23. The robbery suspect said he made his earlier confessional statement under duress. This means that he made it
A. because he was forced to
B. in the presence of a judge
C. because he took an oath
D. with the help of his lawyer.
24. Despite their unrefined behaviour, the visitors were given preferential treatment. This means that the visitors were
A. ill-treated because of their coarseness
B. treated with caution
C. well-treated despite their crudity
D. attended to first by the doctor
25. Onome's father blew his top at the news of his performance in the examination. This means that he
A. was overjoyed B. whistled loudly
C. was very angry D. was impressed
26. 'There is no question of either of you getting the job,' the manager said, This means that
A. the manager would not ask any question about the job
B. both of them would get the job
C. only one of them would get the job
D. neither of them would get the job.

27. Jumoke knew that her husband had had a drop too many when he asked her to pack out. This means that her husband was
A. sleepy B. confused C. drunk D. joking

28. It was quite impossible for him not to have noticed that Lola had arrived. This means that he
A. should have known that Lola had arrived
B. found it impossible to say that Lola had arrived
C. said that Lola had not arrived
D. pretended not to know that Lola had arrived
29. My father advised us to go with the crowd. This means that he advised us not to
A. stay in the crowd
B. have many friends
C. travel with many people
D. be unduly influenced by others
30. We would grant your request if we had money. This means that
A. we have the money but will not grant your request
B. we have the money and will grant your request
C. we do have the money and will grant your request
D. we do not have the money and cannot grant your request.

SECTION 4

*From the words or group of words lettered A to D below each of the following sentences, choose the word or group of words that is **nearest in meaning** to the underlined word or group of words as it is used in the sentence.*

31. The government has approved a new salary structure as an incentive for workers
A. a reward B. an encouragement
C. a package D. an advance
32. The accident victim was bleeding profusely
A. slowly B. excessively C. extremely
D. abundantly
33. They have tried to circumvent the restriction on the importation of scarce commodities
A. by-pass B. confront C. oppose D. challenge
34. The company had satisfied itself that the project was feasible before embarking on it
A. easy B. attractive C. capable D. practicable
35. Though there is no riot on the campus, the students are restive
A. quiet B. chaotic C. restless D. busy

36. The prosecutor was accused of obstructing justice.
A. hindering B. retarding C. stopping D. interrupting
37. The man preaches humility without matching it with action
A. salvation B. honesty C. kindness D. modesty
38. Mr. Haruna plays the piano with great dexterity
A. wisdom B. pride C. force D. skill
39. The college officer insisted that I show him my credentials before I could be registered
A. books B. qualifications C. statements D. identity
40. Amina said that she married a doting man
A. loving B. uncaring C. funny D. nagging

SECTION 5

*From the words or group of words lettered A to D, choose the word or group of words that **best completes** each of the following sentences.*

41. Ayal citizen ought not to abstain.....voting
A. in B. against C. from D. by
42. She set..... preparing lunch when I came
A. on B. at C. about D. for
43. The.....engineer designed a new machine
A. brilliant Nigerian young
B. Nigerian brilliant young
C. young Nigerian brilliant
D. brilliant young Nigerian
44.were asked to represent the school at the quiz competition
A. I and Ngozi B. Ngozi and me
C. Ngozi and I D. Myself and Nozi
45. I am not going to the stadium with you as I that team play before
A. am seeing B. have seen C. had seen D. was seeing
46. I won't be able to come to the party as the day's work has tired me
A. through B. down C. out D. on
47. It's been rough so far,.....?
A. hasn't it B. hadn't it C. isn't it D. wasn't it
48. The suspect..... when I entered the office
A. has been questioned B. have been questioned
C. was being questioned D. is being questioned

49. Ada had only.....time to spend with her family before the plane took off
A. a little B. some C. little D. Small
50. The calculations looked.....simple that he thought he would not get any of them wrong
A. very B. quite C. so D. much
51. The story she was reading made her.....
A. laughed B. to laugh C. laugh D. laughing
52.people turned out for the rally because of the poor publicity
A. Few B. Quite a few C. Only fewer D. A few
53. The two brothers fell out and refused to live..... the same roof.
A. inside B. beneath C. in D. under
54. The teacher asked,".....will have the courage to try and lift that heavy log?"
A. whom B. which C. who D. whomever
55. My friend said I quarrelled last week and haven't.....yet
A. made it out B. made up C. made out D. made it
56. After two years of courtship, Jide is.....
Nkechi next Sunday
A. getting married to B. marrying
C. to marry to D. being married by
57. The visitor was very uncomfortable because of hisnose
A. runny B. watery C. flowing D. running
58. My friend's car has..... to a halt.
A. grinded B. grounded C. ground D. grind
59. It's time we.....for the party
A. leave B. left C. have to leave D. will leave
60. Bassey was..... by the girl's story
A. taken away B. taken on C. taken in D. taken up
61., you should put in some effort to show that you are interested
A. However you are tired
B. However tired you are
C. However tired are you
D. However are you tired
62.ride a bicycle but he also drives a car
A. He not only does B. Not only he does
C. He only does not D. Not only does he

63. Our plans for the trip fell.....because we had no money
A. down B. through C. off D. Out
64. My brother.....studying in England for two years now
A. is B. has been C. was D. had been
65. I am not going to the cinema tonight, neither.....you
A. would B. are C. do D. Have
66. No sooner had we started the journey..... we had a flat tyre
A. then B. that C. when D. than
67. In this letter there.....good news about your elder brother
A. is some B. are C. is a D. are some
68. There were men on the job day and night all the time that this hotel.....
A. was building B. was being built
C. was built D. is being built
69. I shall have to start work.....I can after leaving school
A. so soon as B. as soon C. so soon that D. as soon as
70. Mary and Jane are always fighting.....
A. each other B. themselves C. another D. the other
71. Don't let him bully you: you must stand up.....him!
A. for B. before C. to D. against
72. The plane..... at 2 O'clock yesterday
A. take off B. took up C. take up D. took off
73. It was a long time before his surprise wore.....
A. out B. off C. through D. down
74. The bananas weren't.....ripe enough to use today
A. almost B. scarcely C. nearly D. hardly
75. I'm sorry I can't find.....of the two books you lent me
A. neither B. each C. either D. any
76. When she visited us we asked her if she.....pounded yam for lunch
A. want B. wants C. wanted D. has wanted

SECTION 6

In the following passages, the numbered gaps indicate missing words. Against each number in the list below each passage, four options are offered in columns lettered A to D. Choose the word that is the **most suitable** to fill the numbered gap in the passages.

PASSAGE A

Oil is perhaps the most sought - after of all —77—. However, a major difficulty in its —78— is that oil —79— are very often below the sea —80—. As a result, the search for oil is very expensive, and unless oil is found there in —81— quantities the companies or governments involved are liable to lose heavily. Therefore, before —82— starts, extensive surveys are carried out to see how much oil, or —83— gas the rock formation is likely to yield. If the results are favourable an oil rig stowed into position. The rig consists of a main —84— on which the men work and a derrick which supports the drill. This drill goes down thousands of feet until oil or a —85— of gas is reached. The next stage is to transport the gas or oil to the shore. In the case of gas this is normally done by laying a —86— below the sea, but oil on reaching the top of the well is more often transported in its —87— state by —88—. On shore it is —89— into different fuels or it is treated chemically to turn it into a variety of —90— materials such as polythene.

A	B	C	D
77. products	77. commodities	77. liquids	77. natural resources
78. manufacture	78. exploitation	78. research	78. investigation
79. fields	79. plants	79. mines	79. holes
80. surface	80. shaft	80. shores	80. bed
81. usable	81. seizable	81. commercial	81. practical
82. mining	82. prospecting	82. drilling	82. digging
83. natural	83. gaseous	83. flammable	83. inflammable
84. ramp	84. foundation	84. scaffold	84. platform
85. pocket	85. marsh	85. balcony	85. stratum
86. cable	86. tunnel	86. pipeline	86. channel
87. raw	87. crude	87. liquid	87. impure
88. tanker	88. boat	88. transporter	88. tug
89. made	89. refined	89. produced	89. manufactured
90. processed	90. industrial	90. artificial	90. synthetic

PASSAGE B

Publishing is a fast growing business and there are therefore many publishing houses all over the country. When —91— is submitted by an author, the publisher sends it to —92— to know if it is actually publishable. This step is important because the publisher wants to make sure that the book catches the —93— when it is actually published. In a good publishing house, there is —94— section which is concerned with —95— the manuscript and correcting both the spelling and typing errors. After this, the manuscript is —96— in readiness for —97—. The printed —98— are then stored in the warehouse and a few of them may be sent to the author as —99— copies. Since it is not just the aim of the publisher to offset the cost of production but also to make some profit, there is a strong marketing division which

promotes sales. A certain percentage of the cover price of the book is paid to the author as —100—.

91. A	D.	C.	D.
an article	an essay	a book	a manuscript
an assessor	an evaluator	a cracker	an examiner
market	audience	students	stop
an error-proof	an editorial	litographs	an evaluation
price/hearing	reading over	scanning	skimming
typewriter	typeset	double spaced	single spaced
92. photocopying	zoning	binding	printing
93. review	bulletin	curious	specimen
94. complimentary	honorarium	acknowledgement	sample
95. royalty		dividend	interest

WASSCE JUNE 2004 ENGLISH LANGUAGE 2 OBJECTIVE TEST ANSWERS

1.B	2.C	3.B	4.C	5.D	6.C	7.A
8.B	9.C	10.A	11.A	12.C	13.C	14.D
15.B	16.A	17.C	18.D	19.B	20.B	21.C

22.A	23.A	24.C	25.A	26.D	27.C	28.D
29.D	30.D	31.B	32.B	33.A	34.D	35.C
36.A	37.D	38.D	39.B	40.A	41.C	42.C
43.D	44.C	45.C	46.C	47.A	48.C	49.C
50.C	51.C	52.A	53.D	54.C	55.B	56.A
57.A	58.C	59.B	60.C	61.B	62.D	63.B
64.B	65.B	66.D	67.A	68.B	69.D	70.A
71.C	72.D	73.B	74.D	75.C	76.C	77.D
78.B	79.A	80.C	81.C	82.B	83.A	84.D
85.D	86.C	87.B	88.A	89.B	90.D	91.D
92.A	93.A	94.B	95.A	96.B	97.D	98.C
99.B	100.A					

WASSCE JUNE 2004 ENGLISH LANGUAGE 1 THEORY QUESTIONS

SECTION A

Answer one question only from this section.

1. Your father insists that you must study medicine at the University, but you have an entirely different course in mind. Write a letter to him explaining why you prefer this other course and why he should allow you to make your own choice.
2. Write an article suitable for publication in a national newspaper on the benefits that will be derived from the government showing interest in agriculture.
3. The poor state of the facilities in your school is causing the students great concern. As the Senior Prefect, write a letter to the Chairman of the Board of Governors highlighting the problems and requesting him to come to the aid of the school.
4. You are the chief speaker in a debate on the topic: "Wealth is more important than health". Write your speech for or against the topic.
5. Write a story on the topic: "An experience I'd love to have again".

SECTION B COMPREHENSION

Answer all the questions in this section. You are advised to spend about 50 minutes on this section.

6. Read the following passage carefully and answer the questions on it.

When Eze was invited to spend his Easter holidays with Uncle Chike in Lagos, he jumped for Joy! He had always pictured Lagos as a wonderland of bright lights, paved roads, elegant

people riding by in their expensive cars, and beautiful residential quarters. This invitation was the wonderful opportunity for him to leave his small village for the first time and experience first-hand the good life of the city that he had imagined so much about!

The fateful day came and Eze, happy as a lark, bid an excited good-bye to his family. The first leg of his trip started modestly in the back of the rickety lorry that plied the dirt road linking his village to the rest of the world, but Eze was sure that he would later ride triumphantly into Lagos on one of those legendary luxury buses that he admired so much. This was also an experience to look forward to!

When he arrived in Lagos, it was almost dark. The first things that struck him as he alighted from the bus were the teeming crowd with their desperate unsmiling faces, the deafening noise of the ceaseless traffic, the polluted air with its acrid smell of exhaust fumes and decay, the endless rows of dirty and crumbling concrete buildings, and the filth everywhere. What a sharp contrast with the city he had built up in his imagination! But surely there must still be much to look forward to. Back in the village, Uncle Chike was regarded as a well-to-do trader. So Eze was further surprised and disappointed to find that he lived in a single room in a sleazy part of the city. At night, it got hot and stuffy, but they dared not open the windows as this would bring an invasion of mosquitoes.

Eze woke up the next morning feeling clammy, but he could still not have a bath. As his uncle took him to a shack across the street for a hurried breakfast of thin tea and mouldy bread, he

explained that they usually bought water from a mobile tanker that had not come, around for some time. Eze was still recovering from his surprise at this information when they rushed off for his uncle's market stall: and he had his first unpleasant ride in one of the notorious molue buses of the city.

As they struggled, down from the bus, shoving against the solid mass of desperate, bad-tempered commuters, Eze thought of his village, and the city suddenly lost whatever was left of its attraction for him. True, the village was small; life there was monotonous, and it lacked some essential amenities. But it was peaceful; you drank clean water and ate what you wanted fresh; you moved about freely and breathed clean air; and everyone was friendly and helpful. Greatly disillusioned with the city, Eze longed to return to his beloved village!

- (a) State two experiences that Eze looked forward to.
- (b) Mention any two features of the city that Eze noticed at once.
- (c) What two discoveries surprised and disappointed Eze when he arrived in the city?
- (d) Mention any two experiences in the city that Eze found unpleasant.
- (e) What conclusion did Eze draw from his experiences in the city?
- (f) i"" happy as a lark What figure of speech is contained in this expression?
- (g) "When he arrived in Lagos"
 - (i) What grammatical name is given to this expression as it is used in the passage?
 - (ii) What is its function?
- (h) For each of the following words, find another word or phrase which means the same and which can replace it as it is used in the passage.
- (i) pictured (ii) stuffy; (iii) invasion; (iv) hurried; (v) attraction; (vi) monotonous

7. Read the following passage carefully and answer the questions on it.

It is no longer news that the social and economic problems of African countries continue to worsen. What we experience daily are the vicious consequences of unemployment, inadequate health and educational facilities, urban squalor resulting from a population bursting at the seams and, most frightening of all, the rate at which crime is rising.

It is also no longer news that many Africans now see "checking out" of their countries for other supposedly better ones abroad as the only solution to the problems. In this regard, the United States, Britain, Canada, Germany and Italy are the hot favourites. Most of these Africans are

usually so desperate to leave that they fall easy prey to all sorts of passport and visa fraud, and often end up smuggling themselves abroad at all costs. In such countries, they have to do all manner of menial jobs, sometimes resorting to criminal activities, and are often cut off completely from families and relations back home. Young girls who have been enticed with assurances of a rosy future often end up in forced prostitution, with all its unpleasant consequences!

Is "checking out", the ideal solution to Africa's social and economic problems? Of course not! What is baffling is why Africans cannot see abandoning their countries as a step that holds out no solution at all. All that they achieve, in fact, is the substitution of one set of problems for another!

What then should we do? We must look inwards for a more realistic solution. First, we must develop the will to tackle our problems. Where there is a will, it is said, there is a way. If we abandon our problems instead of tackling them head on, we will simply be leaving an unpleasant legacy for future generations. Secondly, we must orient ourselves towards self-reliance and self-employment, instead of looking helplessly to our embattled governments for salaried employment. Finally, we must seek a long-term solution by addressing the population question. It is obvious that Africa's outsize population is at the root of the problems. The question we should ask ourselves is, if the average family size in America or Britain were to be as large as the average African family, would these countries still be as attractive to us as they are now? The big puzzle is that we have adopted the white man's lifestyle in all other respects, but have made an exception of family size.

- (a) Mention two consequences of the usual desperation of Africans to leave their countries.
- (b) The writer argues that escaping abroad is not the ideal solution to Africa's problems. Quote one sentence from the passage that sums up the writer's recommended solution.
- (c) According to the writer, why should Africans solve their problems rather than avoid them?
- (d) What does the writer consider the most serious cause of Africa's problems?
- (e) What does the writer imply by using the word "supposedly" in the second paragraph?
- (f) "What we experience daily"
 - (i) What grammatical name is given to this expression as it is used in the passage?
 - (ii) What is its function?
- (g) "..... a population bursting at the seams" What figure of speech is contained in this expression?

(h) . For each of the following words or phrases, find another word or phrase which means the same and which can replace it as it is used in the passage

(i) prey; (ii) enticed; (iii) ideal; (iv) holds out; (v)tackle; (vi) head-on

SECTION C SUMMARY

You are advised to spend about 50 minutes on this section.

*Read the following passage **carefully** and answer the questions on it.*

For some, grass is just the green stuff outside the house that they have to mow. For farmers and football players, it is indispensable. For children, it is the ideal playground. And those who live in most urban areas assume they have very little to do with grass of any sort. However, almost all of us have daily contact with some type of grass and the product made from it.

Grass makes up a major part of the vegetation that covers the earth. And no wonder, since it is one of the most adaptable plant groups on earth, growing in polar regions and deserts, in tropical rain forests, and on wind-swept mountain slopes. Entire vegetation areas are dominated by grass.

Unlike many other plants, grass grows, not at the tip, but in growth areas above the nodes. New shoots might start from stems growing horizontally on or under the ground. So when the lawn mower or the cow cuts away the tip, or fire rages through a field, grass keeps growing, whereas many other plants stop. Furthermore, with most grasses, if the stem is bent over by the wind or trodden underfoot, it can raise itself erect by growing faster on the side facing the ground. For these reasons, grass usually recovers quickly after being damaged, which gives it an edge over other plants in the fight for sunlight.

Grass is not only the most abundant but also the most important flowering plant family on earth. A botanist once described grass as the foundation of our food. It is "like a dam protecting mankind from famine. "Try to remember what you ate today. Did you start with a bowl of cereal made with millet, rice, oats or sorghum? Well, then, you ate grass seeds. Or perhaps you had a roll or other kind of bread. The flour used was made from grass kernels-wheat, rye, barley, and other grains are all grasses. Cornflakes and other corn products are no exception, as corn or maize is a grass too. You had sugar in your tea or coffee? More than half of all sugar is made from sugarcane, a grass.

Grass is not only good for food, however. If your house has walls made of clay and straw; it is grass that gives them the necessary strength. In different parts of the world, roofs are thatched with grass. One of the advantages of such roofs is that they keep the interior of the buildings cool regardless of the external temperature.

Grass covers and adorns much of the earth. Apart from the beautiful, peaceful, and relaxing sight of a green meadow or a well-kept lawn, grass is a major oxygen supplier, because of the sheer mass of the green vegetation that it produces.

Finally, its fine roots perform the all-important function of protecting the soil from erosion. Keeping its versatility in mind, we are not surprised to learn that the usage and cultivation of grass has a long history. The next time you see a waving cornfield, a lush green meadow, or just humble blades of grass growing between stones in a sidewalk you might stop and think of this marvellous and most versatile plant family!

(a) In two sentences, one for each, summarize the two reasons why grass forms a major part of the earth's vegetation.

(b) In four sentences, one for each, summarize the four ways in which grass is useful to humans.

WASSCE JUNE 2004 ENGLISH LANGUAGE 1 THEORY ANSWERS

SECTION A

1. 23 Ajao Street,
Maryland State,
Lagos.
20th June, 2004

Dear Dad,

I'm pleased to write this letter to you. I hope it will get to you in good health. How are my mother, siblings and friends in the village? I have the belief that everyone is in a perfect state of health.

The main reason why I am writing this letter to you is to bare my mind to you on the topic we had the last time I came home. Then you insisted that I must study medicine at the university.

Dad, as I told you earlier, my choice is not medicine but law. The legal profession has been my favourite since my childhood. I need to appeal to you to allow me to actualize my dreams as far as my proposed career is concerned I don't like to be a doctor for whatever reason. First, you know that I'm naturally timid and cannot stand the sight of blood.

Besides, I don't like having contact with the sick especially when they are patients at the hospital. You remember the last time we had to visit uncle Bayo at the General Hospital in Ibadan, I waited for you at the security post at the gate. I did not see my uncle until he was discharged from the hospital.

Moreover, the medical profession is not only time-demanding but also very strenuous. For instance, one spends close to eight years to get qualified as a doctor.

But my favourite profession requires me to spend only four years in the university before I go for the national service. The law profession gives room for creativity. You know very well, Dad, that I am an art student. I do very well in English language, Literature, Government and other art subjects. And you equally are aware that I am very weak in science subjects. Without a good mastery of Physics, Chemistry and Biology, one cannot cope with medicine in the university.

Please Dad, make it possible for me to realize my life ambition of being a lawyer. I will feel fulfilled if you allow me to accomplish just this.

My siblings can still study medicine when their time comes. Ade, especially, is science-inclined. I know he will be a good doctor as you know.

Moreover, Dad, I will like you to know that if you insist on my studying medicine, I might turn out to be a frustrated man in my later years as a man. I believe you will not like this to be my portion.

Finally, I appeal to you in the name of the Almighty God to allow me to study my preferred course which is law.

May God bless you and prolong your life to reap the fruits of all labour over me.

I hope to come home next month after my exams.

Bye for now Dad.

Yours sincerely,
Babafemi

2. THE BENEFITS THAT WILL BE DERIVED FROM THE GOVERNMENT SHOWING INTEREST IN AGRICULTURE

Agriculture is one of those means which the government of any country that knows its value can use to improve the lives of her citizens and the economy. Unfortunately, the government of Nigeria is yet to show serious interest in agriculture which would have been a major source of revenue than the so-called black gold, that is, crude oil.

If the government can show interest in agriculture, there is a lot to benefit from it. Some of these benefits are stated in the following paragraphs.

First, the major benefit of agriculture to the people of the country is the availability of cheap and quality food for all. When the government develops interest in agriculture and promotes it, there will be large production of food crops. Then, there will be good food for all and the problem of malnutrition is solved; poverty is also partly tackled.

Another benefit to be derived from government's interest in agriculture is that there will be a huge amount of money generated as income or revenue from the sales of the agricultural produce within the country and even from the international market.

The agricultural sector requires large labour force; so employment opportunities are other benefits which are created to Nigeria's teeming unemployed graduates and able-bodied men and women who are not gainfully employed. This can therefore solve the problem of unemployment facing our country today.

Furthermore, since agriculture provides cheap food and employment, then the menace of crime in our society can be solved. When government does everything necessary to make agriculture interesting, then there will be food for people to eat and money to spend. This therefore reduces crime rate in the society.

Moreover, agriculture helps to improve the other sectors of the economy. The agro-allied industries will have enough raw materials to carry out their production processes. This will in turn develop the entire economy.

With agriculture being focused on there will be a reduction on the dependence of the nation on crude oil as a major source of revenue in our economy.

If the government can consider the above-mentioned benefits and act positively towards their attainment, she will be fulfilling her social responsibility to the populace or the masses.

Lasisi Lukman
Bukuru,
Benue State.

3. Queen of Apostles Seminary,
Afaha Obong,
Abak,
Akwa born State.
27th October, 2001

The Chairman,
Board of Governors,
Queen of Apostle's Seminary,
Afaha Obong,
Abak.

Dear Sir,

THE POOR STATE OF FACILITIES IN MY SCHOOL

As a concerned student of the above-named seminary, I deem it necessary to intimate you of the deplorable condition of facilities in the school.

By virtue of being the Senior Prefect, I have been able to observe that most of the facilities in the school are in deplorable conditions and a few others lacking.

Firstly, I thank you, Mr Chairman, members of your cabinet and those of the past regime for establishing this noble institution with sophisticated facilities and equipment provided in it. I want to bring to your awareness that most of those facilities are now in shambles.

To start with, the school library is nothing to write home about. There are only few books contained there. Most of these books are outdated. These books are not beneficial or very useful to students because they are not the recommended textbooks in the syllabus.

This predicament has caused the students a great deal. The students can no longer carry out some researches due to the scarcity of modern textbooks.

Also, the vocabulary development of the students are very low because there are no new novels, magazines and newspapers. I call on you to look into this issue urgently because a school without a library is just like soup without salt.

Furthermore the administrative block of the school is not in a good condition. The classrooms are not properly ventilated. There are very few desks and chairs and the chalkboard is no longer useful. The worst of it all is that the classrooms cannot accommodate the growing number of students who enrol in the school every year. Normally, a classrooms which should have only thirty-five students is over-stressed to contain about sixty students.

These problems hinder effective and efficient learning / teaching tasks. Moreover, the hostels cannot accommodate the increasing number of

students. The hostels now stink to heavens as a result of over-population of students.

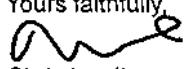
Also, the rainstorm which occurred some weeks ago has contributed immensely to the deplorable condition of the hostels. During the storm, louvres were shattered, a part of the roof was removed and some electric poles uprooted.

Moreover, it is worthy of note that this school does not have a well-equipped laboratory. Numerous number of equipment and chemicals are not available. Some equipment and apparatuses like Kipp's apparatus, conical flask and test tubes are not provided in the Chemistry laboratory.

Some chemicals like hydrochloric acid and sodium hydroxide solutions are also insufficient in the laboratory. The Physics laboratory lacks equipment like metre rule; and instruments like ammeter, voltmeter, etc.

The Biology laboratory has nothing but some dead and preserved animals like snakes and fishes. Sporting facilities are also in short supply in our school and this has negatively affected our performances and rating in sporting activities in the state

Sir, I appeal to you to urgently look into these problems with a view to finding solutions to them to promote the school's academic, economic, social and physical well-being and rating among schools and colleges across the state and the nation as a whole.

Yours faithfully,

Christian Ibanga.

4. WEALTH IS MORE IMPORTANT THAN HEALTH

Mr. Chairman,
Panel of Judges,
Co-debaters,
The accurate time-keeper,
Ladies and gentlemen.

I stand before you today to speak against the motion which says "Wealth is more important than health". What is wealth and what is health?

Wealth is a condition in which a person is richly endowed both materially and financially. To be wealthy means not just being rich but having great property as well. The property could include estates, cars, landed property, etc.

Health is a good physical and mental conditions of a person. That is to say that the

person that is healthy enjoys mental soundness and physical excellence.

I do not agree that wealth is more important than health for the following reasons: First of all, health is a necessary condition that gives rise to wealth. Without health, wealth cannot be got or sustained.

Besides, health and wealth are both desirable but health is more important since a wealthy man cannot enjoy his wealth if he is unhealthy. In fact, the wealth can thin out or disappear if he has a chronic sickness which gulps his wealth in the name of medication.

I heard my opponent say that wealth can get or buy anything in this world. This assertion may appear true but there is a limit to which wealth can thrive. A childless parent can, for instance, adopt a child, but this does not mean he/she is the biological parent of the child. It is a common knowledge that the rich also cry. Sorrow and misfortune cannot be averted by wealth.

So it is evident that health is more important than wealth from the foregoing.

Furthermore, health enables its possessor to be at ease with his creator. If one is at ease with his creator, he will be at peace with Him and be able to serve Him in truth and in spirit.

Conversely, a wealthy person, most of the times, thinks about his riches. The Bible has rightly stated that, "where your riches are, there will your mind be". This explains the fact that it will be very difficult for a rich man to enter into the kingdom of God.

Is there anybody here present who would want to forfeit his health simply because he desires to be wealthy? Definitely not. Hence, health is more important than wealth.

5. AN EXPERIENCE I'D LOVE TO HAVE AGAIN

I spent my last holiday in Cameroun and the experience was a very memorable one for me.

It all started when I got a letter from my elder sister whose husband works as a sales representative to a Swiss firm in Yaounde. She asked if I would spend the xmas holiday with her. I was all too happy to wait for my parents' consent before I could send a letter through speed-post to accept the offer. The idea of staying at home throughout each holiday was becoming unbearable. Often, when we go back to school, other boys recount their experiences. This was my own opportunity and I was becoming so much determined not to let it slip.

Luckily for me, my parents sluggishly agreed. The holiday came. I was to travel by air on the 24th. The 23rd seemed to crawl.

At last, the D-day came. It was an early morning flight. My father mumbled something about seat belts, safety jackets and other things. But I was too happy to understand or listen attentively. It was slightly cold, so I put on my red leather jacket.

There were smiles and envious eyes around me. We boarded a bus that was to take us to the airport. Soon the engine roared and we took off. In another ten seconds, we were air-borne. It was a very wonderful experience. It was my first experience in an aeroplane and also the first time I would travel alone, not only outside the town but outside the country. None of the other boys would have a better story to tell when the holidays end. Would they? No, I thought.

I was still basking in my admiration when all of a sudden, my seat seemed to give way under me. I almost melted with fear, hence I clutched the seat in front of me. I was relieved when the voice on the microphone announced that we were on descent for landing. It was a most surprising experience, most especially seeing all these beautiful cities, villages that looked like specks, valleys, hills and mountains from above. I was still enmeshed in my great excitement when my sister swept me off my feet in a warm embrace. I got several pats on the back from her husband.

We finally got to their apartment where we were met by a horde of children's voices giggling and shouting at us. I enjoyed myself immensely throughout my stay there as I played a lot and was taken on a tour of Yaounde.

At last, came the day that I dreaded: the day of departure. I was not happy that I was leaving so soon but leave I must. So, I returned to Nigeria.

When I sit sometimes and remember this enjoyment and fantastic trip, it dawns on me that it is an experience I'd love to have again.

SECTION B COMPREHENSION

6. (a) (i) The good life of the city. (ii) A ride in a luxury bus.
(b) (i) The large number of (desperate) people.
(ii) The deafening noise of ceaseless (endless) traffic/the noise of traffic / the careless traffic.
(iii) Pollution / decay. (iv) Many dirty and or crumbling (concrete) buildings. (v) Filth (everywhere).
(c) (i) The city of Lagos was not as beautiful as has imagined (ii) His uncle lived in only one room.
(iii) His uncle lived in an unpleasant part of the city.
(d) (i) He had a hot and or stuffy night. (ii) There was no water for him to have a bath.

- (iii) He had a poor breakfast
 (iv) He had an unpleasant ride in a motor bus/he encountered unpleasant fellow passengers in a motor bus.
 (e) He concluded that life in his village was better than life in Lagos / the city of Lagos / the city
 (f) Simile (simile)
 (g) (i) Adverbial clause of time (ii) Modifies the verb "was"
 (h) (i) Pictured — imagined, thought of (ii) Stuff — airless. (iii) Invasion — attack, influx
 (iv) Hurried — quick, rushed, hasty (v) Attraction — fascination, charm, allure, lure, appeal
 (vi) Monotonous — dull, boring, uninteresting, unexciting, drab, humdrum
7. (a) (i) They fall victim to passport and visa fraud.
 (ii) They smuggle themselves out of their country.
 (b) "We must look inward for a more realistic solution"
 (c) To avoid leaving an unpleasant legacy (for future generations).
 (d) Its large or overpopulation OR overpopulation
 (e) The author implies that these countries are not better than African countries.

- (f) (i) Noun clause / Nominal clause.
 (ii) Subject of the verb "are"
 (g) Metaphor
 (h) (i) Prey — victim (ii) enticed — Lured, attracted, seduced.
 (iii) ideal — best, perfect, most suitable, most appropriate
 (iv) holds out — offer, proffers, promises.
 (v) tackle — face, confront, deal with, battle with, grapple.
 (vi) head-on — directly, with determination, in earnest, seriously, squarely.

8. (a) (i) Grass is an adaptable plant OR grass grows / can grow everywhere on earth.
 (ii) Grass recovers quickly
 (b) (i) Grass serves as food for humans / grass is a source of food.
 (ii) Grass is used for building houses.
 (iii) Grass supplies oxygen
 (iv) Grass adorns / beautifies the earth (environment)
 (v) Grass or the roots of grass prevent / check erosion

WASSCE JUNE 2004 ENGLISH LANGUAGE 3 TEST OF ORALS OBJECTIVE TEST

SECTION 1

From the words lettered A to D, choose the word that has the **same vowel sound** as the one represented by the letter(s) underlined. An example is given below.

Example: seat A. sit B. cite C. set D. key

The correct answer is D because only key contains the **same vowel sound** as the one underlined in seat. Therefore, answer space D would be shaded.

[A] [B] [C] [D]

Now answer the questions that follow:

1. tick A. busy B. freak C. police D. caprice
2. bet A. pretty B. leisure C. exact D. penal
3. card A. sand B. talk C. guard D. mad
4. book A. pool B. brush C. food D. push
5. rude A. wool B. bull C. hook D. tool
6. bus A. pocket B. donkey C. money D. bottle
7. curve A. surprise B. bury C. word D. course
8. about A. message B. seizure C. respect D. rescue
9. fork A. work B. story C. worry D. hilly
10. seat A. marine B. measure C. click D. pleasant

11. later A. gauge B. latter C. laud D. crab
12. tie A. eight B. height C. piece D. carries
13. near A. pear B. wear C. mere D. bear
14. fare A. cheer B. pier C. pair D. here
15. tap A. can't B. dance C. plant D. land

SECTION 2

From the words lettered A to D, choose the word that has the **same consonant sound(s)** as the one represented by the letter(s) underlined. An example is given below.

Example: vice A. cat B. dress C. show D. chalk

The correct answer is B because only dress contains the **same consonant sound** as the one underlined in vice. Therefore, answer space B would be shaded.

[A] [B] [C] [D]

Now, answer the questions that follow:

16. boat A. climb B. cab C. comb D. tomb
17. deaf A. hummed B. slapped C. stopped D. orsed
18. chest A. chassis B. chagrin C. chasm D. hunch
19. sick A. days B. pants C. boots D. sure
20. breathe A. throw B. them C. width D. mirth
21. measure A. mission B. extension C. conclusion

- D. mention
22. cat A. knee B. cell C. chaos D. knight
23. laugh A. calm B. talk C. yolk D. goal
24. hat A. holy B. honour C. honest D. hour
25. novel A. bank B. danger C. long D. singer
26. simple A. prevent B. appeal C. supply D. climate
27. waste A. cursed B. surtax C. paused D. washed
28. groom A. gland B. giraffe C. single D. grand
29. expect A. exist B. exam C. excite D. exhaust
30. asked A. gasped B. axed C. coaxed D. tasked

SECTION 3

From the words lettered A to D, choose the word that **rhymes** with the given word. An example is given below.

Example: obtain A. detain B. detail C. claim D. relay
The correct answer is A because only obtain **rhymes** with detain. Therefore, answer space A would be shaded.

[A] [B] [C] [D]

Now answer the questions that follow:

31. burst A. worst B. marshed C. perched
D. guessed
32. hunting A. buikiing B. bunting C. shouting
D. seething
33. balmy A. musty B. slimy C. chummy
D. palmy
34. suspected A. unwanted B. repented C. protected
D. congested
35. brake A. start B. stuck C. steak D. slick

SECTION 4

In each of the following questions, the main/primary stress is indicated by writing the syllable on which it occurs in capital letters.

From the words lettered A to D, choose the word that has the **correct stress**. An example is given below.

Example: democratic

- A. DE-mo-cra-tic B. de-MO-cra-tic
C. de-mo-CRA-tic D. de-mo-cra-TIC

The correct answer is C because the main/primary stress of the word democratic is on the third syllable. Therefore, answer space C would be shaded.

[A] [B] [C] [D]

Now answer the questions that follow:

36. presidency
A. PRE-si-den-cy B. pre-SI-den-cy
C. pre-si-DEN-cy D. pre-si-den-CY
37. autocratic
A. AUT-o-cra-tic B. aut-O-cra-tic
C. aut-o-CRA-tic D. aut-o-cra-TIC

38. facilitate
A. FA-cil-i-tate B. fa-CIL-i-tate
C. fa-cil-l-tate D. fa-cil-i-TATE
39. information
A. IN-for-ma-tion B. in-FOR-ma-ton
C. in-for-MA-tion D. in-for-ma-TION
40. intensify
A. IN-ten-si-fy B. in-TEN-si-fy
C. in-ten-SI-fy D. in-ten-si-FY

SECTION 5

In the following options lettered A to D, all the words except one have the **same stress pattern**. Identify the one with the different stress pattern and shade your answer in the usual way. An example is given below.

Example: A. away B. apart C. behind D. river
Options A, B, C are all stressed on the second syllable. So, D is the correct answer. Therefore answer space D would be shaded.

[A] [B] [C] [D]

Now answer the questions that follow:

41. A. tenure B. digress C. invite D. express
42. A. colleague B. success C. challenge D. vomit
43. A. response B. despite C. respite D. crusade
44. A. prevalent B. simplify C. opponent D. sacrifice
45. A. recession B. component C. important D. magazine

SECTION 6

In each of the following sentences, the word that receives the **emphatic stress** is written in CAPITAL LETTERS. From the questions lettered A to D, choose the one to which the given sentence is the appropriate answer. An example is given below.

Example: My mother's FRIEND hates pets.

- A. Does your mother's boss hate pets?
B. Does your mother's friend love pets?
C. Does your mother's friend hate toys?
D. Does your father's friend hate pets?

The correct answer is A because My mother's FRIEND hates pets answers the question, Does your mother's boss hate pets? Therefore, answer space A would be shaded.

[A] [B] [C] [D]

Now answer the questions that follow:

46. Uche ADMITTED that he stole the necklace
A. Did Mba admit that he stole the necklace?
B. Did Uche deny that he stole the necklace?
C. Did Uche admit that he kept the necklace?
D. Did Uche admit that he stole the money?

47. Olu's father travelled by air to ABUJA last week
 A. Did Musa's father travel by air to Abuja last week?
 B. Did Olu's father travel by road to Abuja last week?
 C. Did Olu's father travel by air to Kaduna last week?
 D. Did Olu's father travel by air to Abuja last month?
48. The visiting team WON the cricket match last year
 A. Did the home team win the cricket match last year?
 B. Did the visiting team lose the cricket match last year?
 C. Did the visiting team win the hockey match last year?
 D. Did the visiting team win the cricket match this year?
49. The police caught FIVE of the robbers yesterday
 A. Did the police release five of the robbers yesterday?
 B. Did the neighbours catch five of the robbers yesterday?
 C. Did the police catch all the robbers yesterday?
 D. Did the police catch five of the robbers last week?
50. Dad has invited SIX guests to dinner.
 A. Has Mum invited six guests to dinner?
 B. Has Dad invited ten guests to dinner?
 C. Has Dad invited six colleagues to dinner?
 D. Has Dad invited six guests to lunch?

SECTION 7

From the words lettered A to D, choose the word that contains the sound represented by the given **phonetic symbol**. An example is given below.

Example: /ɔɪ/ A. yell B. holy C. boy D. idiot
 The correct answer is C because only boy contains the sound represented by the given symbol. Therefore, answer space C would be shaded.

- | | [A] | [B] | [C] | [D] |
|--|------|------------|----------------|----------------------|
| <i>Now answer the questions that follow:</i> | | | | |
| 51. | /ɪ/ | A. courage | B. meat | C. again D. alike |
| 52. | /e/ | A. legal | B. settler | C. pea D. vehicle |
| 53. | /ʌ/ | A. cough | B. dog | C. wonder D. ponder |
| 54. | /ɜ:/ | A. port | B. surprise | C. recourse D. worm |
| 55. | /ə/ | A. pantry | B. disturb | C. luggage D. terror |
| 56. | /t/ | A. subtle | B. warmed | C. worth D. depot |
| 57. | /d/ | A. regime | B. forge | C. barrage D. forget |
| 58. | /ʒ/ | A. mirage | B. knowledge | C. hedge D. join |
| 59. | /z/ | A. bats | B. cars | C. cups D. crickets |
| 60. | /j/ | A. blue | B. jug | C. new D. gist |

WASSCE JUNE 2004 ENGLISH I. LANGUAGE 3 TEST OF ORALS OBJECTIVE TEST ANSWERS

- | | | | | | | |
|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|
| 1.A | 2.B | 3.B | 4.C | 5.B | 6.D | 7.C |
| 8.B | 9.A | 10.C | 11.D | 12.B | 13.B | 14.C |
| 15.C | 16.A | 17.A | 18.D | 19.B | 20.B | 21.C |
| 22.C | 23.D | 24.A | 25.B | 26.C | 27.B | 28.D |
| 29.C | 30.A | 31.A | 32.B | 33.D | 34.D | 35.C |
| 36.A | 37.B | 38.B | 39.C | 40.B | 41.A | 42.B |
| 43.C | 44.D | 45.D | 46.B | 47.C | 48.B | 49.D |
| 50.B | 51.A | 52.B | 53.A | 54.D | 55.D | 56.A |
| 57.A | 58.A | 59.B | 60.C | | | |

SENIOR SCHOOL CERTIFICATE EXAMINATION (SSCE 1988 – 2015)

Past Questions with Solutions

English Language

(Theory / Objectives with Oral English) 2005

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WASSCE JUNE 2005 ENGLISH LANGUAGE 2

OBJECTIVE TEST QUESTIONS

SECTION 1

*In each of the following sentences, there is one underlined word and one gap. From the list of words lettered A to D, choose the one that is most **nearly opposite in meaning** to the underlined word and that will, at the same time, correctly fill the gap in the sentences.*

1. The management has neither _____ nor denied the rumour that it was going to lay off some workers
A. pronounced B. confirmed C. rejected D. advertised
2. Instead of _____ the issue, the speaker digressed to unimportant matters
A. summarizing B. describing C. revealing D. addressing
3. The telephone booths were all _____ and I had to wait for more than ten minutes for one to become vacant
A. locked B. busy C. occupied D. ringing
4. While the first battalion halted its march at nightfall, the second _____ to the barracks
A. returned B. set out C. proceeded D. turned up
5. His father is an _____ driver but he is only a novice
A. enlightened B. aged C. excellent D. experienced
6. The arrival of the police at the scene _____ rather than mitigated tension
A. provoked B. heightened C. created D. prolonged
7. Roses are common in May but _____ in November
A. dead B. strange C. rare D. extinct
8. A bank clerk should be able to tell easily the difference between _____ notes and counterfeit one
A. crisp B. good C. correct D. genuine

9. Last night, Uncle Joe was blind drunk but this morning he is as _____ as a judge
A. alert B. saintly C. strong D. sober
10. What I have is only a _____ of the famous painting; the original is in the National Museum
A. duplicate B. model C. fake D. drawing

SECTION 2

From the words lettered A to D, choose the word that **best completes** each of the following sentences

11. If the jury's verdict is "not guilty," the defendant will be _____
A. acquitted B. indicted C. pardoned D. forgiven
12. When all the items on the agenda had been discussed, _____ the _____ meeting was _____
A. adjourned B. dismissed C. postponed D. dissolved
13. Because the new venture was _____ many businessmen and women went into it
A. rich B. manageable C. lucrative D. satisfying
14. We saw a _____ of lions at the game reserve
A. pride B. family C. band D. group
15. Many educationists feel that _____ punishment should still be retained in schools
A. capital B. corporal C. corporate D. physical
16. Freedom of movement is a _____ right of every citizen
A. fundamental B. negotiated C. privileged D. respected
17. The river _____ towards the sea
A. meandered B. rolled C. ran D. trickled
18. I _____ that our team will win the match tomorrow
A. certify B. conclude C. announce D. Predict
19. If found guilty, he will _____ all the wealth he has amassed illegally
A. forgo B. abandon C. repay D. forfeit

20. At a _____ of 200 kilometres an hour, the hurricane swept away everything in its path
A. movement B. flow C. velocity D. Drive

SECTION 3

*After each of the following sentences, a list of possible interpretations is given. Choose the interpretation that you consider **most appropriate** for each sentence*

21. Ladies and gentlemen, the worst may be over, but we are not out of the woods yet. This means that we are
A. still in the forest
B. not yet ready to celebrate our success
C. likely to encounter more difficulties
22. When I leave this country it will be for good. This means that I will
A. never come back
B. leave for better conditions elsewhere
C. become an adventurer
D. improve my ways
23. When she confronted her husband, he hung his head and didn't answer her questions. This means that he was
A. defiant
B. ashamed and embarrassed
C. caught unawares D. angry with her
24. All our plans fell through at the last moment. This means that we
A. were exposed B. delayed C. were abandoned
D. failed
25. The police knew that the suspect was not being straight with them. This means that the suspect was
A. not telling the truth B. not friendly C. afraid
D. timid
26. After his prison experience, Etim decided to go straight. This means that he decided to
A. hold his head up and walk with defiance
B. change his religion C. live an honest life
D. stop using drugs
27. The teacher spoke with his tongue in his cheek when he said that lazy Ade was the best pupil. This means that the teacher
A. did not mean what he said
B. was disappointed C. was angry
D. tried to encourage Ade

28. They did not know what to expect and so decided to play it by ear. This means that they decided to
A. listen attentively to everyone
B. act according to circumstance
C. pretend to be deaf
D. prepare for the worst

29. Ojo decided that the best course of action was to play along with them for the time being. This means that he decided to
A. join their team temporarily
B. entertain them for a while
C. pretend to agree with them
D. be playful with them
30. The conference was attended by people from all walks of life. This means that the conference was attended by people
A. of all races
B. who had travelled widely
C. from all professions
D. from different parts of the world

SECTION 4

*From the words lettered A to D, below each of the following sentences, choose the word that is **nearest in meaning** to the underlined word as it is used in the sentence.*

31. Amina is the one who initiated the quarrel, not Nike!
A. started B. stopped C. settled D. fuelled
32. She was reprimanded by her boss for negligence
A. sacked B. rebuked C. punished D. surcharged
33. Why should I retract my statement when it is nothing but the truth?
A. alter B. deny C. withdraw D. condemn
34. The doctor diagnosed the tumour as malignant
A. deadly B. painful C. infectious D. minor
35. In tropical Africa, mosquitoes are ubiquitous
A. dangerous B. harmful C. troublesome
D. everywhere
36. It soon became obvious that a confrontation was inevitable
A. disastrous B. unavoidable C. desirable
D. imminent
37. They insisted that the omission of my name had been inadvertent
A. unintentional B. unconditional C. improper
D. unfortunate

38. The police announced that they were yet to apprehend the criminals
A. interrogate B. charge C. prosecute D. arrest
39. He is easily recognizable because of a conspicuous birthmark on his face
A. dark B. beautiful C. prominent D. natural

40. The fishing boat was imperilled by high winds, but it managed to reach port safely
A. pushed B. endangered C. disturbed D. blown

SECTION 5

*From the words or group of words, lettered A to D, choose the word or group of words that **best completes** each of the following sentence*

41. Surprisingly, Musa turned _____ the job
A. away B. in C. out D. down
42. We have no choice _____ to do what they demand
A. except B. than C. unless D. but
43. The committee has submitted its report the students' riot
A. in B. for C. about D. on
44. The chairman told members that he was open suggestions
A. to B. for C. about D. on
45. The policeman shot the escaping robber _____ the leg
A. on B. in C. at D. into
46. For the management, your remarks amount to a slap _____ the face
A. on B. upon C. at D. in
47. She does not remember _____ to anyone at the part
A. to talk B. to be talking C. talking D. to have talked
48. This portion is to be shared between _____
A. us and them B. we and them C. us and they D. we and they
49. Joel is one of those fanatical sports fans _____ about nothing else,
A. who talks B. who talked C. who talk D. who is talking
50. I will see you _____ tomorrow
A. when I return B. after I have returned

- C. after I might have returned
D. when I have returned

51. But for the night guard's vigilance, the factory _____ burgled
A. would be B. will be C. would have been D. will have been
52. No sooner _____ it started to rain
A. did he arrive home when
B. had he arrived home than
C. than he arrived home
D. when he arrive home
53. Hardly a day goes by _____ he doesn't think of her
A. that B. when C. while D. without
54. Scarcely had I opened the door _____ the dog came running in
A. as B. before C. than D. when
55. Several _____ attended the two-day summit
A. head of state B. heads of states
C. heads of state D. head of states
56. You haven't seen this mn before _____?
A. isn't it so B. have you C. is it so D. isn't it
57. I saw him again _____ last week
A. some time B. sometimes C. one time D. sometime
58. She bought a _____ handbag
A. red beautiful leather
B. beautiful leather red
C. beautiful red leather
D. leather beautiful red
59. It was the headboy that took the book away _____?
A. didn't he B. wasn't he C. wasn't it D. isn't it
60. _____, my father took me to England
A. At the age of ten B. Being ten years old
C. When I was ten D. At ten years old
61. The teacher wanted to know if all our homework submitted
A. have been B. has been C. had been D. is being

62. The man denied _____ the company's property
A. stolen B. to have stolen C. to be stealing D. stealing
63. The day I won a visa lottery was the _____ day of my life
A. happy B. very happy C. happiest D. happier
64. Ebieri invited _____ to her birthday party
A. Bola and I B. myself and Bola
C. Bola and me D. Bola and myself
65. The company employs only experienced . mature workers
A. and B. but C. well D. very
66. Adamu looked at his watch and said; "It's high time we _____ home"
A. must go B. went C. should go D. go
67. She claims _____ a ghost last night
A. seeing B. to be seeing C. to have seen D. having seen
68. We had better _____ now, or we'll miss the train
A. left B. leave C. be leaving D. to leave
69. She _____ the sleeping baby on the bed
A. lay B. lies C. lied D. laid
70. _____ we rather go home?" he asked
A. Shouldn't B. Can't C. Won't D. Mustn't
71. I know that song very well; we _____ it everyday when I was in primary school
A. sang B. had sung C. have sung D. Sing
72. They _____ the competition when we arrived
A. begun B. have begun C. had begun D. begin
73. If you _____ early, you will get there before nightfall
A. left B. are leaving C. had left D. leave
74. The test was so difficult that _____ students passed
A. some few B. a few C. few D. fewest

75. Please can you _____ money?
A. lend me little B. borrow me a little
C. lend me some D. borrow me some
76. _____ at 5 o'clock every morning was one of the regulations he detested most at school
A. To be waking up B. Waking up
C. Having to be waking up D. To be waking
77. If you had waited five minutes longer, you _____ her,
A. would be able to see
B. will be able to see
C. would have been able to see
D. will have seen
78. She asked the driver to _____ at the school gate
A. drop her B. drop her down C. drop her out D. drop her in
79. She told me that she always _____ the television before going to bed,
A. switch off B. off C. switched off D. switches off
80. I _____ the new principal,' Obi said
A. look forward to meet
B. look forward to having met
C. am looking forward to meeting
D. am looking forward to meet

SECTION 6

*In the following passages, the numbered gaps indicate missing words. Against each number in the list below each passage, four options are offered in columns lettered A to D, choose the word that is the **most suitable** to fill the numbered gap in the passages*

PASSAGE A

Birds are instantly recognizable —81—, perhaps because of their ability to —82—. Some people might consider their shape the most distinguishing —83—. Everyone, however, agrees on the characteristics that a bird possesses: two —84—, feathers, two legs, a toothless —85—, warm blood, and the ability to —86— eggs. The modern system of —87— birds is like a pyramid, with the base formed by 8,514 different —88—. A convenient —89— of this system recognizes a group of birds which does not normally —90— with other groups.

81.	A	B	C	D
82.	beings	creatures	things	mammals
83.	scar	dive	glide	fly
	possession	mark	feature	sign
84.	arms	flaps	forearms	wings
85.	mouth	lip	beak	gum
86.	produce	provide	lay	give
87.	classifying	arranging	ordering	numbering
88.	species	birds	types	varieties
89.	judgment	explanation	statement	name
90.	agree	mate	fly	go

PASSAGE B

One of the most precious gifts human kind has been given is the power to —91—. With it, we pass vital —92— to one another either —93— or by non-vocal methods, such as —94—. Freedom of —95— is, in fact, a widely contested issue throughout the world. Some have therefore, assumed that communication is the —96— of only humans.

Yet, research shows that animals —97— information in intricate ways that often baffle humans. Yes, they “speak,” not with words, but through visual signals such as —98— tails, twitching ears, or —99— wings. Other forms of animal communication may involve the use of voice, such as a bark, a roar, a snarl, or—100—-. Some of the “languages” are obvious to humans, while others require much scientific study to detect.

91.	A	B	C	D
92.	communicate	inform	tell	say
93.	news	words	things	information
94.	quickly	verbally	secretly	symbolically
95.	smiling	nodding	gestures	winking
96.	speaking	speech	saying	expressing
97.	perceive	belonging	property	policy
98.	give	receive	handle	exchange
99.	shaking	moving	wagging	showing
100.	rotating	flapping	raising	hearing
	noise	music	whistling	song

WASSCE JUNE 2005 ENGLISH LANGUAGE 2 OBJECTIVE TEST ANSWERS

1.B	2.D	3.C	4.C	5.D	6.B	7.C
8.D	9.D	10.A	11.A	12.A	13.C	14.B
15.B	16.A	17.A	18.D	19.D	20.C	21.C
22.B	23.A	24.D	25.A	26.C	27.A	28.B
29.C	30.D	31.A	32.B	33.C	34.A	35.D
36.B	37.A	38.D	39.C	40.B	41.D	42.B
43.D	44.A	45.A	46.A	47.C	48.A	49.A
50.A	51.C	52.B	53.B	54.D	55.B	56.B
57.D	58.C	59.C	60.A	61.C	62.D	63.C
64.C	65.A	66.B	67.C	68.B	69.B	70.A
71.A	72.B	73.D	74.C	75.C	76.C	77.C
78.A	79.A	80.C	81.8	82.D	83.C	84.D
85.C	86.C	87.A	88.A	89.B	90.B	91.A
92.D	93.B	94.C	95.B	96.A	97.D	98.C
99.B	100.C					

WASSCE JUNE 2005 ENGLISH LANGUAGE 1 THEORY QUESTIONS

SECTION A

Answer one question only from this section.

1. Your friend in another school has requested some information about your school to enable him to decide on moving over to your school. Write a letter to him discussing at least three areas in which your school excels.
2. Write an article for publication in your school magazine, discussing the reasons why children in your area drop out of school and suggesting ways of minimising this negative trend.
3. There has been a continuous discussion on the evils of unemployment. Write a letter to the Commissioner for Labour highlighting at least three of these evils and ways of addressing them
4. You are one of the speakers in a debate on the topic: Women should not be in paid employment while they are still bearing children. Write your contribution for or against the proposition
5. Write a story ending with the words: I wish I had listened to my father.

SECTION B

COMPREHENSION

Answer all the questions in this section. You are advised to spend about 50 minutes on this section

6. Read the following passage carefully and answer the questions on it.

The chalkboard is by far the commonest teaching aid used at virtually all levels of education from the nursery to the university. It is the most enduring teaching aid and perhaps will be the most difficult to replace. In the advanced countries of the world, it is being threatened by the overhead projector. However, the overhead projector requires constant supply of electricity — which is one reason we cannot rely on it yet. The chalkboard used to be black, which was why the name “blackboard” stuck for ages; but today, there are boards for various colours: blue, green, even white.

Now, most chalkboards are made of wood nailed to the wall, instead of the concrete board made of cement and fine sand that was more common. Some are also made of metal. The chalkboard has the advantages of low cost,

availability and ease of maintenance, usually involving mere cleaning and occasional retouching of the surface with the renovator. However, if the board is metal, the felt marker should be protected against drying by replacing the AP when it is not in use. The major drawback in the use of the chalkboard is that the information on it can only be temporary. If that the information on it can only be temporary. If there is only one board for the class, it is usually impossible to leave the information there for more than a few hours, since other teachers would want to use it.

It is not easy to draw complex diagrams showing minute details, such as part of the body and contours, unless one is a good artist. Where one has succeeded with the laborious illustrations, using different colours, it could be painful when the board has to be cleaned by the next teacher. However, there are nowadays various innovations, including foldable boards made of plywood, which allow teachers more room to leave their material for longer period.

Finally, it is a great disadvantage that during the course of teaching, much more time is spent writing on the board than when one is using the overhead projector. So, in all, more time is needed for any lesson when one uses the board rather than the overhead projector.

- (a) Why does the writer use the word chalkboard rather than blackboard most of the time?
- (b) Mention two different types of chalkboard that have been in use.
- (c) Mention two disadvantages of the chalkboard
- (d) Why should the cap of the felt pen be replaced when the pen is not in use?
- (e) The major drawback in the use of the chalkboard
 - (i) What grammatical name is given to the expression as it is used in the passage?
 - (ii) What is its function?
- (f) It is being threatened by the overhead projector.
 - (i) What figure of speech is used in this expression?
 - (ii) What does it mean?
- (g) For each of the following words, find another word or phrase which means the same and which can replace it as it is used in the passage
 - (i) virtually; (ii) constant; (iii) various;
 - (iv) temporary; (v) laborious; (vi) room

7. *Read the following passage carefully and answer the questions on it.*

Dele groaned and got out of bed. There was no clock on the mantelpiece and the room was still dark, but he knew that he was already late for work probably by up to an hour. He was a commercial bus driver and had to get started as early as 5.00 am and go almost non-stop until about 9.00 p.m to be able to make the daily returns that the bus owner demanded.

On the previous day, he had drunk himself almost senseless before crawling home in the early hours of the morning. Now he got up shakily, splashed water on his face and hurried off to work, but not before carefully fastening on his upper left arm the amulet he had always worn for protection against accident. A similar amulet hung concealed under the steering column of his bus. On his way, still feeling groggy, he caught his left toe against a stump and had some misgiving. It was a bad sign, and he was supposed to go back home and then set out again. But there was no time for that now, so he hurried on.

At the bus station Dele quickly loaded his bus and sped off without any of the necessary checks on the vehicle. He had to make up for lost time. It was the rush hour, so the bus was overloaded as it often was, with many passengers hanging on to the doors. The tyres were threadbare, the brakes were faulty and the road was wet, but, still feeling a little sleepy, Dele sped on. Many passengers protested about his reckless driving, but he would not listen. After all, didn't he have protection against accident?

As the vehicle took the last turn before its destination, Dele saw a broken truck blocking his side of the road. Under normal circumstances, he could have brought the bus safely to a halt, but the circumstances were far from normal. The careering bus hit the parked vehicle, swerved wildly across the road and plunged into a ditch.

Dele's surprise before he sank into oblivion was the failure of his supposedly protective amulets.

- (a) Why did Dele wake up late?
- (b) he caught his left toe against a stump and had some misgiving. What does this tell us about Dele?
- (c) Give two reasons why Dele drove recklessly.
- (d) Why was Dele unable to stop his faulty vehicle?
- (e) What was Dele's condition after the accident?
- (f) After all; didn't he have protection against accident? What literary device is used in this expression?
- (g) wildly across the road

- (i) What is the grammatical name given to the expression as it is used in the passage?
- (ii) What is the function?

(h) For each of the following words, find another word or phrase which means the same and which can replace it as it is used in the passage.

- (i) probably; (ii) returns; (iii) groggy; (iv) misgiving;
- (v) threadbare; (vi) reckless;

SECTION C SUMMARY

You are advised to spend about 50 minutes on this section

8. *Read the following passage carefully and answer the question on it.*

You cannot expect to go through life without meeting problems. Difficulties, perplexities and frustrations are an inevitable part of human experience. Accepting this idea of the inevitability of problems will help you to approach them in a robust frame of mind rather than thinking that you are a victim specially singled out by a malignant fate.

When confronted with a problem, the first thing to do is to gather all relevant data to get acquainted with all the facts of the case. Then write down exactly what the problem is, stating it simply in black and white. This gives you something definite with which to come to terms. The problem is assessed and you will now have something concrete to deal with.

Next, give serious thought to the problem, making sure that such thought does not degenerate into worry as worry accomplishes nothing. Aim at clear, dispassionate thought, viewing the problem as if it were a friend's and not your own. Look at it from all angles and from the view point of all concerned. You court disaster if you are entirely selfish in your outlook. The single important purpose of all this is to discover all possible solutions to the problem.

Having examined the problem broadly and impartially, carefully examine all the possible solutions or courses of action. The knowledge that you have done this will keep you from useless regrets later, when you can remind yourself that all possible courses of action were examined and

you chose what appeared to be the best. Next, eliminate all proposed solutions which are seen on further thought to be impracticable.

You will now find that your list has been whittled down to two or three possibilities. At this stage it is often a good plan to get out into the open air. Go for a walk or a ride, preferably somewhere with wide horizons. There out in the open, review the problem afresh. You will find it appears much less formidable. Ask yourself how the difficulty will appear in ten years' time, or even one! This fresh review will enable you to make a final choice as you turn to the remaining solutions and, before you return home, decide which you are going to adopt. As you go to sleep that night, let your last thoughts be upon your decision. If, in the morning, you still feel it is the best one to take, go ahead.

If you have a friend you think is capable of giving sound advice, consult him. Do this before your final decision, so that you will have the benefit of his views before you decide. Talking things over with another is always a great help. It enables you to isolate the problem and to decide which are the important factors. Even if the friend offers no advice, a sympathetic ear will help you. Furthermore, as you describe to your friend the courses open to you, you will see them in a clearer light. Some will appear impossible even while you speak. Alternatively, one will appear most attractive.

In dealing with problems, remember the time factor. Although some problems solve themselves in time, and delaying tactics are therefore the best form of action for them, most other problems generally get more complicated the longer they are left. You should therefore get to grips with problems immediately they occur.

All told, reasonable foresight and imagination can prevent many problems, ever arising. Tact, thoughtfulness and responsible conduct can also keep life largely problem-free.

In six sentences, one for each, summarise the steps to be taken when faced with a problem and state why each step is necessary.

WASSCE JUNE 2005 ENGLISH LANGUAGE 3 TEST OF ORALS

OBJECTIVE TEST

From the words lettered A to D, choose the word that has the **same vowel sound** as the one represented by the letter(s) underlined. An example is given below

Example: seat A. sit B. cite C. set D. key

The correct answer is D because only key contains the same vowel sound as the one underlined in seat. Therefore, answer space would be shaded

[A] [B] [C] [D]

Now, answer the questions that follow:

1. kit A. parted B. regal C. key D. routine
2. red A. paid B. leahard C. eole D. rua
3. car A. gaunt B. rank C. aunt D. hand
4. thought A. lock B. purse C. wander D. laudable
5. crude A. rush B. gust C. full D. hew
6. turn A. worn B. sweat C. dirt D. born
7. lawyer A. party B. nature C. venue D. limbo
8. act A. mass B. pass C. class D. lark
9. seed A. receive B. leisure C. neighbour D. eight
10. love A. courses B. country C. boutique D. rout
11. day A. says B. meat C. great D. beat
12. no A. how B. bout C. canoe D. blow
13. cow A. plough B. arrow C. shallow D. root
14. light A. piece B. believe C. tie D. besiege
15. care A. steer B. flair C. here D. beer

SECTION 2

From the words lettered A to D, choose the word that has the **same consonant sound(s)** as the one represented by the letter(s) underlined. An example is given below:

Example: vice A. cat B. dress C. show D. chalk

The correct answer is B because only dress has the same consonant sound as the one underlined in vice. Therefore, answer space B would be shaded

[A] [B] [C] [D]

Now, answer the questions that follow

16. sand A. dance B. sandwich C. handkerchief
D. adjective
17. tea A. cared B. flogged C. nursed D. slammed
18. chance A. sail B. starch C. outslaid
D. nonchalant
19. see A. wise B. cows C. his D. peace
20. was A. devise B. converse C. reverse D. mice
21. vision A. pension B. tension C. collusion
D. attention
22. barrage A. stoige B. camouflage C. passage
D. haulage

23. call A. cellar B. achiever C. brochure D. archaic
24. luck A. rally B. walk C. balm D. should
25. purse A. coup B. cupboard C. paper D. receipt
26. bring A. hinge B. hunger C. stranger D. manager
27. street A. petrol B. stark C. beast D. straight
28. supply A. compel B. ripple C. practice D. palaver
29. voice A. phase B. feed C. of D. off
30. spray A. spirit B. separate C. splendid D. offspring

SECTION 3

From the words lettered A to D, choose the word that **rhymes** with the given word. An example is given below

Example: obtain A. detain B. detail C. claim D. relay

The correct answer is A because only obtain rhymes with detain. Therefore, answer space A would be shaded

[A] [B] [C] [D]

Now, answer the questions that follow

31. done A. pun B. don C. dawn D. gone
32. shook A. hoot B. hook C. roof D. soak
33. count A. hunt B. bounty C. fountain D. amount
34. amend A. rescind B. abound C. depend D. resent
35. foolish A. polish B. tarnish C. childish D. ghculish

SECTION 4

In each of the following questions, the main/primary **stress** is indicated by writing the syllable on which it occurs in capital letters.

From the words lettered A to D, choose the one that has the **correct stress**. An example is given below.

Example: democratic

- A. DE-mo-cra-tic B. de-MO-cra-tic
C. de-mo-CRA-tic D. de-mo-cra-TIC

The correct answer is C because the main/primary stress of the word domorratic is on the third syllable. Therefore, answer space C would be shaded

[A] [B] [C] [D]

Now, answer the questions that follow

36. difficulty
A. DIF--fi-cul-ty B. dif-FI-cul-ty
C. dif-fi-CUL-ty D. dif-fi-cul-TY
37. electrify
A. E-lec-tri-fy B. e-LEC-tri-fy
C. e-lec-TRI-fy D. e-lec-tri-FY
38. category
A. CAT-e-go-ry B. cat-E-go-ry
C. cat-e-GO-ry D. cat-e-go-RY

39. interference
A. IN-ter-fer-ence B. in-TER-fer-ence
C. in-ter-FER-ence D. in-ter-fer-ENCE
40. contribution
A. CON-tri-bu-tion B. con-TRI-bu-tion
C. con-tri-BU-tion D. con-tri-bu-TION

SECTION 5

In the following options lettered A to D, all the words except one have the same stress pattern. Identify the one with the different **stress pattern** and shade your answer in the usual way. An example is given below:

Example: A. away B. apart C. behind D. river

Options A, B, C are all stressed on the second syllable while option D is the only one stressed on the first syllable. So, D is the correct answer. Therefore answer space D would be shaded.

[A] [B] [C] [D]
Now, answer the questions that follow

41. A. proffer B. interest C. physique D. suburb
42. A. genuine B. debate C. effect D. device
43. A. extent B. purchase C. morale D. concern
44. A. colonize B. devastate C. comprehend D. pacify
45. A. important B. distribute C. exhibit D. cigarette

SECTION 6

In each of the following sentences, the word that receives the **emphatic stress** is written in capital letters. From the questions lettered A to D, choose the one to which the given sentence is the appropriate answer. An example is given below

Example: My mother's FRIEND hates pets

- A. Does your mother's boss hate pets?
B. Does your mother's friend love pets?
C. Does your mother's friend hate toys?
D. Does your father's friend hate pets?

The correct answer is A because My mother's FRIEND hates pets answers the question, Does your mother's boss hate pets? Therefore, answer space A would be shaded.

[A] [B] [C] [D]
Now, answer the question that follow:

46. Uncle Ben bought Ngozi a new COMPUTER
A. Did Uncle Nick buy Ngozi a new computer?
B. Did Uncle Ben lend Ngozi a new computer?
C. Did Uncle Ben buy Ngozi an old computer?
D. Did Uncle Ben buy Ngozi a new stereo set?
47. Mary scrubs the TOILETS on Saturdays
A. Does Mother scrub the toilets on Saturdays?
B. Does Mary sweep the toilets on Saturdays?
C. Does Mary scrub the kitchen on Saturdays?
D. Does Mary scrub the toilets on week-days?

48. Mummy loves FRIED RICE for lunch
A. Does Aunty love fried rice for lunch?
B. Does Mummy hate fried rice for lunch?
C. Does Mummy love pounded yam for lunch?
D. Does Mummy love fried rice for dinner?
49. The judge ORDERED the suspect to be locked up
A. Did the police order the suspect to be locked up?
B. Did the judge request the suspect to be locked up?
C. Did the judge order the defence counsel to be locked up?
D. Did the judge order the suspect to be released?
50. Men are USUALLY strict in official matters
A. Are women usually strict in official matters?
B. Are men rarely strict in official matters?
C. Are men usually carefree in official matters?
D. Are men usually strict in private matters?

SECTION 7

From the words lettered A to D, choose the word that contains the sound represented by the given **phonetic symbol**. An example is given below

Example: /ɔɪ/ A. yell B. holy C. boy D. idiot

The correct answer is C because only boy contains the sound represented by the given symbol. Therefore, answer space C would be shaded

[A] [B] [C] [D]
Now, answer the questions that follow

51. /ɑ:/ A. can't B. brand C. act D. mat
52. /d/ A. story B. novel C. war D. hoard
53. /ɔ:/ A. gone B. nod C. water D. fond
54. /z:/ A. cousin B. judge C. month D. attorney
55. /ʌ/ A. cough B. lock C. clerk D. tough
56. /n/ A. sign B. damn C. longing D. hanger
57. /f/ A. half B. film C. chalk D. talk
58. /v/ A. cars B. loose C. cease D. lace
59. /t/ A. whistle B. walked C. bustle D. castle
60. /g/ A. gender B. gym C. ghastly D. gem

WASSCE JUNE 2005 ENGLISH LANGUAGE 2 ORA ANSWERS

1.A	2.B	3.C	4.B	5.C	6.A	7.B
8.A	9.A	10.B	11.D	12.A	13.B	14.C
15.C	16.A	17.B	18.B	19.C	20.D	21.C
22.A	23.C	24.B	25.A	26.A	27.B	28.C
29.D	30.A	31.B	32.C	33.C	34.D	35.D
36.A	37.D	38.C	39.C	40.C	41.A	42.A
43.C	44.D	45.D	46.C	47.A	48.B	49.D
50.B	51.D	52.B	53.C	54.B	55.A	56.A
57.B	58.A	59.B	60.C			

MODEL ESSAY ANSWERS

Lagos City College,
4, Commercial Avenue,
Sabo, Yaba,
Lagos.
6th August, 2005.

1. Dear Turide,

Your letter was delivered to me only yesterday when I returned from school. I was very happy when I saw it because I know

I would hear from you since I have left the village to Lagos. How are you now? I hope you are doing fine with your studies.

In your letter, you requested me to furnish you with information about my school to enable you decide on moving over to my school. Somehow, here are what we are enjoying in my school here in Lagos.

Firstly, the environment of my school is conducive for learning for it is so quiet and adorned by flowers all over the well catered lawns making the beautifully painted proto-type building stand out.

Besides, there is a well equipped laboratory where the different sciences i.e. Physics, Chemistry and Biology practicals can be taken with each student having his or her own cubicle.

Another notable facility in my school that distinguishes it from yours has to do with the ever-cool computer room where we are taught computer studies. In fact, I can now use computer and chat or surf, due to my E-mail address. My E-mail address is:
Fineboy@yahoo. corn.

Whatever you might be thinking, I am assuring you that if finally you decide to come to my school, I shall be helping you to meet up with the use of the computer.

Greet your friends over there for me. How is your sister Mary? I hope she is doing well in her studies. Till I hear from you, I say bye-bye for now.

Your friend,
Olayemi.

2. CHILDREN DROPOUT OF SCHOOL: REASONS AND POSSIBLE SOLUTIONS

The rate at which children are dropping out of school nowadays calls for a big concern on the part of parents and the general public. It is in the light of this, that I write this article for the school magazine so that children still in school would see

to the need for them to study hard enough to achieve their future desires.

Having pondered over the issue with particular reference to my area here in Lawanson, Surulere, the following have been observed as the reasons for this act.

First, the poor economic power of parents makes it impossible to provide for children's school needs thereby impacting negatively on the child in terms of academic performance which makes them to willingly drop out of school.

Apart from this, the need for quick and easy money easily lures the child into becoming a bus conductor where he would earn quick money on daily basis. If he could collect this type of money and spends freely, the next thing would be to drop out and continue to receive such till he graduates to 'Agbero' (passenger seeker).

Furthermore, child labour to which most of the children found themselves is also one of the reasons children drop out of school nowadays. Where a child lives with supposed parents or aunts, there is every tendency for such a child to drop out of school when he or she has a misunderstanding with the supposed parents who consider the child's education as a waste of time. Where this happens, such a child drops out of school.

Looking at this problem, the following would serve as solutions to it. Basically, where there is enough provision of jobs to the people by government and wealthy individuals, parents, especially the poor ones who have children in schools, will be empowered economically to cater for their children in terms of providing for them.

Besides, supportive efforts by parents in providing extra effort by employing good teachers for their children or sending them to a good extra-mural class to complement the school work.

The issue of child-conductors can be solved with the constant arrest of such children who should be taken to a juvenile settlement centre where they would be made to complete their studies.

Finally, efforts should be geared towards full-scale enlightenment on this social problem.

OLUKOSI, SB.,
Lagos.

3. 7, Olukosi street,
Shomolu,
Lagos.
12th AUGUST, 2005.

Honourable Commissioner,
Lagos State Ministry of Labour & Productivity,
State Secretariat,
Alausa, Ikeja,
Lagos.

Dear Sir,

THE EVILS OF UNEMPLOYMENT

I consider it a point of duty on my part to contribute to the on-going discussion of the evils of unemployment in our country. It pains to see the youths of today falling preys to the vices of the society which they would lead in the future. Having considered the various factors that serve as the causes, and pondering on the evils, the following are thus identified:

There is the evil of the youths who are unemployed becoming drug addict where idleness controls their lives. An idle mind is often the workshop of the devil, thus most of the youths nowadays have turned to be devil's handiwork. They are found in armed robbery gangs, in secret cult and most of them become rapists simply because they are unemployed. Where there is a regular trade or work for them to do, all the evils they perpetrate would not have been done.

Sir, you would be surprised that most of the political thugs in our society today are the by-products of the evils of unemployment. They see thuggery as a profitable venture hence none of them is interested in any honourable job that nonetheless do not exist.

Another evil of unemployment is a social menace of husbands becoming incapacitated in their duties as the head of the family. They then become wives' as a result of unemployment. Where this continue for a long time, women become uncontrollable by their husbands and this leads to families breaking up. What do the society gain from this? Increase in population of single women and the resultant effect is increase in prostitution and abandoned babies all over the places.

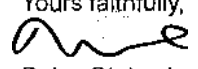
In the light of the above mentioned evils of unemployment, the following serve as solutions. The government should endeavour to establish a youth camp where juvenile delinquents would be rehabilitated and trained on a particular trade that they can be self-employed when they leave the camp.

The public should also be well informed on the need for parents to train their wards properly before they could be influenced into becoming miscreants.

Enough job opportunities should be made available for youths and adults so as to be less dependent on the government.

Women should be educated or well informed of their positions as wives and mothers so as to see the need to assist their husbands in catering for the family. Where all these suggestions are put into consideration, I hope the society would be helped out of the evils of unemployment.

Thank you and God bless.

Yours faithfully,

Babs Olukosi

4. "WOMEN SHOULD NOT BE IN PAID EMPLOYMENT WHILE THEY ARE STILL BEARING CHILDREN"

Mr. Chairman, panel of judges, accurate time keeper, co-debaters, ever attentive listeners, ladies and gentlemen. My name is Bayo Olukosi, a student of Eko Boys High School, Yaba. I am here to support the motion that women should not be in paid employment while they are still bearing children.

The following account for the reasons why I took to this stand. First and foremost, if a woman still bearing children is engaged in a paid employment, there would be lack of proper attention towards the child she is weaning and for the job she is engaged in. The reason for this is obvious, if her child is sick before coming to work, all her attention and thinking would be on the child and she would not concentrate on her paid job and vice-versa i.e. when under pressure in the office.

Secondly, there is the problem of inadequate performance that would definitely lead to low output. This will come up as a result of loss of working hours that would be utilized, most especially when the woman go on maternity leave.

Another reason why women should not be in paid employment while they are still bearing children is that if they are put in this type of job, they would be subject to stress and fatigue arising from expectations from her boss on the job thereby reducing their productivity.

Mr. Chairman, co-debaters, my attentive listeners, I hope I have been able to convince you

and not confuse you on why women should not be in paid employment while they are still bearing children. Don't you think all these reasons are necessary for proper child-weaning process? Finally, I am saying it again that women should not be in paid employment while they are still bearing children.

Thank you.

Yours faithfully,

Bayo Olukosi.

5. I WISH I HAD LISTENED TO MY FATHER

The words of our elders are words of wisdom' so says an adage. All youths who may be opportuned to read this story of mine should always take to whatever their fathers say to them because it is for their own good.

It all started last year towards the end of my final examination i.e. the G.C.E. 'O' Level which I used to test my ability before I finally write the SSCE. I came in contact with a girl that has same centre with me. Her name is Joke. She was so pretty that almost every boys in that centre wished her as their girlfriend.

I love her too but hasn't got the effrontery to woo her. Somehow in one of the periods of waiting for the paper to start, this girl came to me where I was discussing with some other candidates. She excused me out of their midst and we went to another corner to discuss.

At first, I thought she wanted to discuss about the exam or that she wanted to talk about something else, but to my surprise, she told me about her love for me that she loved me so much that she would be following me back home so that she can be coming to me. I was so happy within me that such a beautiful girl other guys had been running after now professed her love for me — a lucky boy I am, I thought.

The excitement in me was so great that I rushed my paper that day and after I took her home. When we got home, my mother saw her and I lied to her that she was just a friend. Not quite thirty minutes my mother asked about her was when my father called me possibly to send me on errand. When I got to him, the first thing he said was that I should close my eyes which I did and he asked if I saw anything. I told him that I saw nothing. He told me to open my eyes, I did this and he said to me that if I should fall prey to what the young ones of today are doing, I would find myself in trouble that no one would rescue me.

My father advised me so strongly to desist from going after girls that I should face my studies. I lied to him that I heard him. I pondered over all these things and I came to the conclusion that my parents don't want me to enjoy myself so I resumed playing with the girl Joke.

Our relationship started very well and not quite long, I have had my ways i.e. I had gone into Joke and the result is what gave me the need to write this story of mine. Unknown to me, Joke has AIDS and since I have had sex with her, I had contracted AIDS. I went for a check-up and was told it was positive. Since then I wasn't myself because I have been thinking when my death will come. The irony of it was that since I informed Joke about my AIDS problem, she had stopped coming to me.

I don't know how my father knew about it and when he asked me how I got it I could only manage to say, thinking aloud, "I wish I had listened to my father".

SECTION B

COMPREHENSION PASSAGE 1

6.

(a) The writer used the word chalkboard because there are boards of different colours; for not all boards are black.

(b) Two different types of chalkboard that have been in use are concrete board and metal board.

(c) The disadvantages of chalkboard are:
(i) information on it is usually temporary — For few hours.
(ii) Too much time is spent on using it.

(d) The cap of the felt pen must be replaced when the pen is not in use to prevent dryness of the tip.

(e) (i) Noun Phrase (ii) It function as the subject of the verb 'is'.

(f) (i) The figure of speech used is a metaphor.
(ii) It means that the overhead projector may soon replace the chalkboard.

(g) (i) Virtually — almost, nearly, or practically
(ii) Constant — regular, stable, consistent
(iii) Various — different, assorted, diverse
(iv) Laborious — tedious, tiresome, tasking
(v) Temporary — for a while, for a short time.

7.

(a) Dele went to bed late the previous night

(b) This told us about Dele that he was superstitious

(c) Dele drove recklessly because he was trying to make up for his lost time and that he believed that his amulets will offer him protection against accident.

(d) Dele was unable to stop his faulty vehicle because

(i) He was speeding (ii) He was still sleeping.

(e) (i) He was unconscious and sank into the oblivion.

(f) This is a rhetorical question.

(g) (i) The grammatical name of the given expression is the adverbial phrase of manner.

(ii) It modifies the verb swerved.

(h) (i) Probably — may be, possibly or perhaps.

(ii) Returns — revenue, amount of money, income

(iii) Groggy — sleepy, drowsy, weak, dizzy.

(iv) Misgiving — doubt, fears, apprehension, foreboding

(v) Threadbare — worn-out, bald, old, worn.

(vi) Reckless — dangerous, rough, careless or bad.

SECTION C SUMMARY

8. First identify the problem and define its definite nature. Think serious over the problems so as to reveal all the likely solutions. By so doing, it will help in choosing the best solutions. Looking at the problem afresh helps to make a final choice.

Consulting a friend so as to clarify the problem. Dealing with the problem promptly helps to avoid complications.

SENIOR SCHOOL CERTIFICATE EXAMINATION (SSCE 1988 – 2015)

Past Questions with Solutions

English Language

(Theory / Objectives with Oral English) 2006

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WASSCE JUNE 2006 ENGLISH LANGUAGE 2 OBJECTIVE TEST QUESTIONS

SECTION 1

*In each of the following sentences, there is one word or group of words underlined and one gap. From the list of words or group of words lettered A to D, choose the one that is **most nearly opposite** in meaning to the underlined word or group of words and that will, at the same time, correctly fill the gap in the sentence:*

1. My uncle is a prosperous businessman: my aunt, unfortunately, is quite.....
A. unskilful B. dishonest C. unsuccessful
D. unqualified
2. The university has a large yearly intake: very few.....take place.
A. turnouts B. rejections C. expulsions
D. obstructions
3. Rather than make derogatory remarks about the host, a guest should make ones.
A. polite B. complimentary C. interesting
D. honest
4. Our mechanized services contrast sharply with the..... operations we had before.
A. electrical B. controlled C. original D. manual
5. After Ade had listened to some advice, his rigid ideas became more.....
A. friendly B. compromising C. flexible
D. democratic
6. The policies of this government favour the elite rather than the
A. masses B. oppressed C. public D. unemployed
7. God opposes the and rewards the
A. poor B. honest C. humble D. Faithful
8. The pilot says that it is easier to take off from the airport than to.....on the tarmac.
A. land B. come down C. alight D. drop
9. Although Chide's manners are quite refined, his colleague's are rather.....
A. bold B. crude C. hostile D. rash
10. I am quite outspoken but my brother is.....

A. dumb B. indolent C. taciturn D. modest

SECTION 2

*From the words lettered A to D, choose the word that **best completes** each of the following sentences.*

11. All the people in the bus died in that..... accident.
A. serious B. reckless C. fatal D. dangerous
12. What a.....! The more you look, the less you see.
A. wonder B. miracle C. challenge D. paradox
13. The soldiers pledged their.....loyalty to the new government.
A. enduring B. tireless C. complete
D. questionable
14. There is an interesting article in the..... issue of WestAfrica.
A. existing B. current C. contemporary D. actual
15. After interrogation, the police.....the information from the suspect.
A. exposed B. wrung C. received D. Obtained
16. Mr. Cham will never tell you everything; he's very.....
A. secretive B. quiet C. reserved D. realistic
17. The two trade unions decided to.....in order to form a stronger organization.
A. intermix B. amalgamate C. consolidate D. Join
18. Many countries no longer have.....punishment as the penalty for murder.
A. mortal B. corporal C. capital D. fatal
19.packages should always be handled with care.
A. Insecure B. Fragile C. Weak D. Boxed
20. Because of the hard times, many workers live in..... poverty.
A. repulsive B. ridiculous C. abject
D. unpardonable

SECTION 3

After each of the following sentences, a list of possible interpretations is given. Choose the interpretation that you consider **most appropriate** for each sentence.

21. It's obvious that John set little store by our friendship. This means John
 - A. does not value our friendship
 - B. does not remember our friendship
 - C. thinks we've been friends for too long
 - D. thinks it's easy to make friends.
22. The general wondered whether the new recruits were equal to the task ahead. This means that the general wasn't sure whether the new recruits
 - A. were sufficient in number
 - B. were old enough
 - C. had enough experience
 - D. could do the job
23. Not a single member of the board put in a good word for him. This means that
 - A. all the members criticized him
 - B. none of the members said anything favourable about him
 - C. some of the members disliked him
 - D. none of the members spoke kindly to him.
24. Joe is very down to earth. This means that Joe is
 - A. a good farmer
 - B. rather short
 - C. practical and sensible
 - D. rough and dirty.
25. Mary kept her fingers crossed about hearing from John. This means that Mary
 - A. had her fingers crossed all day long
 - B. waited to see John
 - C. hoped that John would contact her
 - D. refused to write to John
26. Researchers leave no stone unturned in their quest for solutions. This means that researchers
 - A. overturn everything
 - B. do everything possible
 - C. disturb everybody
 - D. need a lot of help.
27. Ebrima's stepmother keeps his nose to the grindstone. This means that Ebrima's stepmother
 - A. makes Ebrima grind things all the time
 - B. makes Ebrima work all the time
 - C. keeps her hand on his nose
 - D. forces him to grind stones
28. Most people usually steer a middle course in all they do. This means that most people
 - A. travel quite slowly
 - B. work very hard
 - C. live and do things moderately

D. do not drive very fast

29. She delivered her speech without turning a hair. This means that she delivered her speech without
 - A. any emotion
 - B. combing her hair
 - C. nodding
 - D. looking up.
30. Although wrestling is popular, it is not my cup of tea. This means that wrestling
 - A. is rough
 - B. is a primitive game
 - C. does not interest me
 - D. is not lucrative.

SECTION 4

From the words lettered A to D below each of the following sentences, choose the word or group of words that is **nearest in meaning** to the underlined word as it is used in the sentence.

31. The marathon is a gruelling race.
 - A. powerful
 - B. exhausting
 - C. interesting
 - D. distant
32. The works of art in this gallery are priceless.
 - A. irreplaceable
 - B. precious
 - C. invaluable
 - D. durable
33. The detective was perplexed when the clues pointed to several suspects.
 - A. excited
 - B. worried
 - C. confused
 - D. discouraged
34. My father was sceptical about the story I told him.
 - A. ignorant
 - B. doubtful
 - C. embarrassed
 - D. lukewarm
35. The suspect refused to divulge the source of his information.
 - A. confirm
 - B. disclose
 - C. extract
 - D. affirm
36. My uncle was so engrossed in his work that he didn't hear me come in.
 - A. fascinated
 - B. thrilled
 - C. absorbed
 - D. overwhelmed
37. The politician has an inordinate desire to become president.
 - A. unproven
 - B. excessive
 - C. incessant
 - D. incredible
38. The chairman was given a tumultuous welcome.
 - A. strange
 - B. pleasant
 - C. noisy
 - D. well-organized
39. Mr Okoro has implicit confidence in his son's ability.
 - A. absolute
 - B. normal
 - C. partial
 - D. faithful

40. The evidence of the witness was corroborated by the accused.
A. verified B. alleged C. confirmed D. signed

SECTION 5

*From the words or group of words lettered A to D, choose the word or group of words that **best completes** each of the following sentences.*

41. Do you speak French? Only....., I'm afraid'.
A. small B. negligible C. a little D. few
42. Whatever you buy, always look for the..... bargain.
A. good B. best C. better D. more
43. We heard grandfather.....the organ.
A. plays B. played C. play D. to play
44. Are you sure this is.....shop?
A. John's and Elizabeth
B. John and Elizabeth's
C. John's and Elizabeth's
D. John and Elizabeth
45. The driver risked.....the car ahead of him.
A. overtaking B. to overtake C. overtake D. overtaken
46. You can count on.....boys to finish the work.
A. we B. us C. they D. them
47. You think I'm being difficult.....?
A. am I B. isn't it C. aren't I D. don't you
48. It took him ages to get.....his father's death?
A. through B. past C. over D. by
49. I have never read..... book in all my life,
A. the more frightening B. the frightening
C. a most frightening D. a more frightening
50. Mbinki runs.....as fast as I.
A. indeed B. pretty C. much D. just
51. This is an improvement..... your last report
A. of B. on C. over D. against
52. He threw the banana skin..... the window.
A. by B. over C. at D. through
53. Each of the footballers.....to receive \$1000.00.
A. are B. is C. have D. were
54. Our tour of the tower came to an end all.....soon
A. much B. rather C. too D. more
55. How I wish they.....the note before coming
A. receive B. had received C. have received D. received
56. You.....to me when you were away.
A. have not written B. had not written
C. did not write D. are not writing
57. No matter.....you look at it, her lawyer will lose the case.
A. how B. when C. however D. whichever
58. By the time school opens, I..... here for eight weeks.
A. worked B. will work C. will be working D. will have worked
59. Your mobile phone has.....ten times in the last hour.
A. rang B. rung C. been ringing D. being rung
60. The manager wanted to study the document.....the background of the latest development
A. against B. with C. in D. over
61. As soon as he heard the bell, he.....to the door.
A. was hurrying B. hurries C. hurried D. has to hurry
62. The Principal made us.....the work again.
A. do B. to do C. to be doing D. doing
63.an ambulance, the child's life would have been saved.
A. Did we have B. Have we had
C. Have we had D. Had we had
64. Really, I wouldn't say this to.....
A. no other B. each other C. any other D. another
65. If I had known that he was going home..... him some money for my mother
A. I could have given B. I should give
C. I must give D. I ought to have given
66. He said he was looking forward to.....them next year
A. visit B. visiting C. have visited D. be visiting
67. The customer complained about.....on the shirt delivered to him.
A. grease B. plenty grease C. little grease D. more grease

68. The surgeon was in a hurry to operate.....
the patient
A. over B. in C. on D. with
69. She added.....vegetables to her stew.
A. little B. some C. plenty D. much
70. Please include.....sites for our excursions
A. all the interesting, many, historical
B. the many, all interesting, historical
C. the all historical, many, interesting
D. all the many interesting historical
71. Only one of the contestants.....able to
answer the question correctly.
A. can be B. are C. was D. were
72.to school, it began to rain heavily.
A. Walking B. As I was walking C. I was walking
D. when walking
73. Since they started this assignment, they.....
any success.
A. did not have B. are not having
C. have not had D. do not have
74. The President.....his wife and children
is leaving for Paris
A. or B. and C. with D. despite
75. Johnson was glad.....of your success
A. for hearing B. with hearing C. by heart
D. to hear
76. You can accompany me if you to my terms.
A. agree B. are agreeing C. had agreed
D. agreed
77. He told his family that he in three weeks.
A. is returning B. would return C. has returned
D. will return
78. It is.....important that you stay indoors
tonight
A. extremely B. too C. very much D. very well

SECTION 6

In the following passages, the numbered gaps indicate missing words. Against each number in the in the list below each passage, four options are offered in columns lettered A to D, choose the word that is the **most suitable** to fill the numbered gaps in the passages.

PASSAGE A

The problem of unemployment is very great in many African countries. The —79— of labour is always far greater than the number of— 80—

provided. Consequently, there are armies of job seekers roaming the streets. It is the responsibility of the government to create jobs and organize — 81 — programmes in order to achieve greater employrn I WI -all be sunk into these ---83—, which can absorb more — 84—. A man with a regular job will be able to feed himself and save a little in the bank which will earn him some — 85 — —The government could raise money through a rational economic-----86-----, whereby undue consumption of luxury and foreign goods is discouraged. The country's — 87 — structure can also be planned so that nationals are encouraged to work harder for adequate irrcentives. The government can also protect 88----- industries.

79	A	B	C	D
80	circulation	distribution	stock	supply
81	work	jobs	careers	activities
82	impact	crash	turnover	remedial
83	Capital	Salaries	Reserves	income
84	plans	arrangements	projects	concepts
85	effort	officers	labourers	workers
86	incentive	interest	credit	surplus
87	objective	goal	policy	solution
88	salary	tariff	insurance	family
	poor	infant	competing	complementary

PASSAGE B

My country is considered to be an industrialized nation. Out of its 25 million — 89 — only about a million are employed in — 90 —. A very large portion of its surface consists of 91 — areas. The rest of the land is used for the 92 — of food. In the north there is wide open land to which owners of — 93 — have grazing — 94 —. The greater part of this area consists of — 95 — land ploughed up for crops of grain, roots or just grass fields used for permanent — 96 —. Our agriculture does not follow any uniform pattern. There are different types of — 97 —. About a third of them — 98 — the farms which they occupy. The rest are tenant farmers who have — 99 — their farms from big — 100 —.

89	A	B	C	D
90	citizens	townsman	occupants	squatters
91	harvesting	agriculture	gardening	mining
92	urban	city	rural	cultured
93	manufacture	output	production	distribution
94	rancheries	poultry	tractors	livestock
95	capacity	rights	authority	possibilities
96	fertile	arable	rocky	waterlogged
97	lawns	plots	pasture	patches
98	farmers	growers	breeders	grazers
99	monopolize	keep	reserve	own
100	landlords	hired	leased	borrowed
		landowners	plot holders	house owners

WASSCE JUNE 2006 ENGLISH LANGUAGE 2 OBJECTIVE TEST ANSWERS

1.C	2.C	3.B	4.D	5.C	6.A	7.C
8.A	9.B	10.C	11.C	12.B	13.C	14.B
15.D	16.A	17.B	18.C	19.B	20.C	21.A
22.D	23.B	24.C	25.C	26.B	27.B	28.C
29.A	30.C	31.B	32.C	33.C	34.B	35.B
36.C	37.B	38.C	39.A	40.C	41.C	42.A
43.B	44.B	45.A	46.A	47.D	48.C	49.D
50.D	51.B	52.D	53.B	54.C	55.B	56.C
57.A	58.D	59.A	60.A	61.C	62.A	63.D
64.C	65.A	66.B	67.A	68.C	69.A	70.D

71.C 72.B 73.C 74.C 75.D 76.A 77.B
78.A 79.D 80.B 81.D 82.A 83.C 84.D
85.B 86.C 87.A 88.B 89.A 90.B 91.C

92.C 93.D 94.B 95.B 96.C 97.A 93.D
99.B 100.B

WASSCE JUNE 2006 ENGLISH LANGUAGE 1 THEORY QUESTIONS

SECTION A

1. The government of your country has recently introduced a new means of communication which has had many positive effects on the lives of the majority of the people. Write a letter to your brother who is away from the country, stating how it has affected the lives of your people.
2. The rising cost of tertiary education in your country has become a serious problem. Write an article for publication in a national newspaper discussing this problem and suggesting measures that could be adopted to deal with it.
3. Write a letter to the chairman of the P.T.A. of your school suggesting three ways in which parents can work together with the teachers to create a better learning environment in the school.
4. You have been invited to take part in an inter-school debate, the topic of which is: Schooling in a village is more advantageous than schooling in a city. Write your speech for or against the motion.
5. Write a story to illustrate the saying: As one makes one's bed, so one must lie on it.

SECTION B COMPREHENSION

6. *Read the following passage carefully and answer the questions on it.*

Late one night Mr Oliver was returning to his school on the outskirts of the hill station of Simla. He had been teaching in this school for many years. A bachelor, he usually strolled into the town in the evening, returning after dark, when he would take a shortcut through a pine forest. Whenever there was strong wind, the pine trees made moaning, eerie sounds that kept most people to the main road. But Mr Oliver was not a nervous or imaginative man.

He carried a torch on this particular night and its pale gleam — the batteries were running down — moved fitfully over the narrow forest path. When its flickering light fell on the figure of a boy who was sitting alone on a rock, Mr Oliver stopped. Boys were not supposed to be out of school after 7p.m., and it was now well past nine.

"What are you doing out here, boy?" asked Mr Oliver sharply, moving closer so that he could

recognize the miscreant. But as he approached the boy, he sensed that something was wrong. The boy appeared to be crying. His head hung down, he held his face in his hands and his body shook convulsively. It was a strange soundless weeping, and Mr Oliver felt quite uneasy.

"Well, what's the matter?" he asked, his anger giving way to concern. "What are you crying for?" The boy would not answer or look up. His body continued to be rocked with silent sobbing "Come on, boy, you shouldn't be out here at this hour. Tell me the trouble. Look up." The boy looked up. He took his hands from his face and looked up at his teacher. The light from Mr Oliver's torch fell on the boy's face, if it could be called a face.

He had no eyes, ears, nose or mouth. It was just a round smooth head— with a school cap on top of it, and that's where the story should have ended, as indeed it has for several people who have had similar experiences and dropped dead of unexplainable heart attack. But for Mr Oliver, it did not end there.

The torch fell from his trembling hand. He turned and scrambled down the path, running blindly through the trees and calling for help. He was still running towards the school building when he saw a lantern swinging in the middle of the path. Mr. Oliver had never before been so pleased to see the night watchman. He stumbled up to the watchman, gasping for breath and speaking incoherently. What is it, Sahib?" asked the watchman. Has there been an accident? Why are you running?"

"I saw something something horrible — a boy weeping in the forest, and he had no face!" "No face, Sahib?" "No eyes, nose, mouth, nothing!"

"Do you mean it was like this, Sahib?" asked the watchman and raised the lantern to his own face. The watchman had no eyes, no ears, no features at all, not even an eyebrow. The wind blew the light out, and Mr Oliver had his heart attack

(a) Why did Mr Oliver take the pine forest route to his school?

(b) What did Mr Oliver think when he first saw the 'boy'?

(c) What was the first indication to Mr Oliver that all was not well?

(d) What did the night watchman turn out to be?

(e) Mr Oliver had never before been so pleased to see the night watchman. What is ironical about this sentence in the light of the rest of the story?

(f) "Do you mean it was like this, Sahib?" What does "this" refer to?

(g) ".....who have had similar experiences and dropped dead of unexplainable heart attack"

(i) What grammatical name is given to this expression as it is used in the passage?

(ii) What is its function?

(h) For each of the following words, find another word or phrase which means the same and which can replace it as it is used in the passage:

(i) miscreant; (ii) sensed; (iii) concern;

(iv) rocked; (v) scintillated

7. *Read the following passage carefully and answer the questions on it.*

Children today are being hurried through childhood, rushed into taking on adult tasks at a very early age. Granted that the effects are not always so dramatic or so tragic, they can be profound and long lasting. Parents are understandably eager to see their children succeed. When that eagerness turns into anxiety, parents may overload their children, pushing them too fast too soon. For instance, it is becoming increasingly common for parents to enrol young children in after-school activities. Often, special tutoring is added.

Of course, it is not wrong to encourage a child's talents or interests. There is a danger of excess when some children seem to have as many pressures as hurried adults do. Before their children are born, parents are already enrolling them in preschool, hoping to improve their prospects of success. In some countries, children are assessed for reading and Mathematics skills before they are six years old. Such practices have raised concern about emotional damage. Many parents seem to think it normal, even advisable, to teach their children that winning is everything.

Some parents work extremely hard to provide every possible material comfort for the children, believing that they are working to ensure their children's happiness — but they may well be doing the opposite. Often, more than a few children raised this way are involved in drinking, drugs and sullen rebellious behaviour as many fume with resentment because they feel neglected. The children often pay a high price. Although they may have many material luxuries, they lack the most essential ingredients of a good childhood: parental attention and love. Without guidance, discipline and direction they take adult

questions too soon, with little or no preparation. They will likely obtain their own answers from peers or TV or movie characters. The results often bring childhood to an abrupt, even tragic end. Without a doubt, rushing children through childhood is a dangerous practice that should be avoided.

(a) Why do parents rush their children through childhood?

(b) Give two examples of how parents rush their children through childhood.

(c) State two sad effects of bringing up children in extreme luxury.

(d) Why do children raised in luxury become angry?

(e) What is ironical about parents' efforts to make their children happy?

(f) "The children often pay a high price". What is the meaning of this expression?

(g) "Although they may have many material luxuries...."

(i) What grammatical name is given to this expression as it is used in the passage?

(ii) What is its function?

For each of the following words, find another word or phrase which means the same and which can replace it as it is used in the passage:

(i) effects; (ii) eager; (iii) prospects; (iv) raised;

(v) essential; (vi) resentment.

SECTION C SUMMARY

You are advised to spend about 50 minutes on this section

8. *Read the following passage carefully and answer the questions on it.*

Although world agencies have made numerous efforts to stop malnutrition, achievements have fallen short of hopes. For example, in 1996 the United Nations set the goal of reducing by half the number of the world's undernourished some 400 million people — by the year 2015. Commendably, some progress has been made. But the report of the Food and Agricultural Organization of the United Nations for 2001 acknowledges that unfortunately there has been a slowdown in the projection, and that the number of undernourished people has actually increased considerably in the majority of developing countries.

Malnutrition is usually triggered by a combination of two factors, namely: an insufficient intake of proteins, calories, vitamins, and minerals; and frequent infections. Such illnesses as diarrhoea, measles, malaria, and respiratory diseases tax the body heavily and cause loss of nutrients. They reduce appetite and food intake, thus contributing to malnutrition. The

undernourished child is in turn more susceptible to infections. Thus a vicious circle is formed that increases the mortality rates for protein-energy malnutrition. Children are at greater risk of suffering malnutrition because they are in a period of rapid growth that increases the demand for calories and proteins. For similar reasons, pregnant and nursing women are vulnerable to malnutrition.

Malnutrition has far-reaching effects. First, it wreaks havoc on the body, particularly that of a child. Every organ and system - including the heart, kidneys, stomach, intestines, lungs, and brain - may be affected. Various studies have shown that poor growth in a child is closely associated with impaired mental development and poor scholastic and intellectual performance. Secondly, for children who survive malnutrition, the aftermath can linger on into adulthood. Recent research relates undernourishment in infancy to a tendency toward such chronic illnesses in adulthood as heart disease, diabetes, and high blood pressure.

How can children be best protected from malnutrition? It is essential to improve the diet of the mother. Pregnant and nursing women need to consume more calories and proteins. Proteins in particular help in the production of the mother's milk. So when there is little food, preference should be given to women of childbearing age and to little children. Secondly, in almost all cases, the best possible food for a baby is its mother's milk. This is especially so during the first days after birth because mother's milk contains antibodies that protect the baby from infection. During the first four months or so, breast milk provides all the nutrients that the baby needs in order to grow and develop properly. But breastfeeding should be continued for as long as necessary, which could be up to two years. And after the baby is weaned, the greatest possible variety of foods in different combinations should be introduced to provide nutrients that protect the baby. The mother should focus on providing the child with good-quality food, neither forcing the child to eat after it is full nor withholding food from the child when it appears to want more.

- (a) In one sentence summarize the causes of malnutrition.
- (b) In two sentences, one for each, summarize the two major effects of malnutrition.
- (c) In three sentences, one for each, summarize the three preventive measures against malnutrition recommended in the passage

WASSCE JUNE 2006 ENGLISH LANGUAGE 1 THEORY ANSWERS

SECTION A

1. 16, Awoniyi Street,
Baruwa,
Ipaja,
Lagos.
13th May, 2006.

Dear brother Cole,

I am indeed very happy to write this letter to you. How are you? I hope you are finding things easy. How are your friends? Well, we are feeling fine here too. In fact, daddy had just bought a mobile phone and bought one for mummy and myself. This is one of the latest means of communication the government introduced to us in our country.

The recently introduced new means of communication forms the basis of my letter to you, since its positive effects would help everybody in one way or the other when it comes to contact. I will like to inform you about the few effects of this "Global System of Mobile Communication - G.S.M.

Firstly, there is a quick contact to people who have the handset. It makes it possible to get in touch with people wherever they may be. This in effect eliminates the fear of unknown of a dear one.

Apart from the above, brother Cole, the G.S.M. made it easy for everybody now to have access to information. This is helping us in the area of sending information to the police whenever the need arises. One of such needs is the quick information from the people about the whereabouts of armed robbers after their operation.

Another positive effect of the newly introduced means of communication is affordance it gives in sending and receiving of text messages. With this format, one can send and receive instant messages outside the country now.

Besides the above mentioned positive effects of the new communication system, there is also the aspect of sending and receiving of voice messages in and around the world. Brother Cole, all these makes it for me and other members of our family to get to you and you to us anytime we wish to.

Anyway, it is my prayer that you record many achievements in the place you are now. Greetings from everybody at home. Till I hear from you next, I am saying bye for now.

Yours sincerely,



Tunde Cole

2.

82, Randle Avenue,
Surulere,
Lagos.
17th June, 2006.

The Editor,
Punch Newspapers,
1 - 7, Olu - Aboderin Road,
Onipetesi,
Ikeja.

Sir,

THE RISING COST OF EDUCATION IN NIGERIA

Considering the rate at which youths of today are becoming nuisance to the society at large calls for concern as the major cause of this problem is the ever rising cost of education in our country Nigeria.

First and for3most, many Nigerian youths who would have become a useful manpower for the advancement of the country could not achieve their aims as a result of the inability of their parents to pay their school fees.

A case study is that of Lagos State University - LASU - where school fees were increased from four thousand five hundred naira to forty-five thousand naira. Despite the hues and cries of both students and parents, the institution went ahead to implement the hike with an ultimatum for payment. This of course sent many of the youths back to the streets - what a pity!

Besides, the failure of many students to secure admission into the university of their choice resulted into majority of them going for the part-time studies. This in essence led many institutions of higher learning to increase their school fees since the demand for admission became explosive. The explosion in the rush for admission was properly utilized hence parents had to pay through their nose.

The various tertiary institutions in Nigeria today are going through various forms of renovation in terms of lecture halls and residential halls. It became obvious that majority of the tertiary institutions are doing this to find means of increasing their fees through the hostel accommodation which one thought at first was a way of making life easier for stujents. What do we come to realize at the end? Increase of courser No sooner the renovated halls are ready, the university or polytechnic or college of education will go plc, and private individuals would manage the halls of residence with high cost of rentage. This of course is not good enough for our tertiary education as most candidates and students in such institutions will find life meaningless when they can't get their desired goals.

The above causes of ever rising cost of tertiary education would not be complete if the high cost of Joint Admissions and Matriculation Examination JAMB which is for only one day is not mentioned. Compare the cost of JAMB examination of only one day to that of the GCE that runs for a month or so, one would see that the rising cost of education in Nigeria calls for remedy.

The following, I believe, would serve as solutions to the rising cost of education. In the first place, all tertiary institutions should build more hostels to accommodate students with moderate fees. This in no small way will help students who live off- campus and on-campus alike.

There should also be a reduction in the form fees, scratch card and that of other expenses incurred by students.

Government should fund the tertiary education to perform better. Government should sanction banks that charge higher rate for their scratch card. All these done, I believe the cost of education in our tertiary institutions will become low.

Yours faithfully,



Babatunde Olu.

3.

82, Randle Avenue,
Surulere,
Lagos.
17th June, 2006.

The Chairman,
Parents Teachers Associatcn,
Ideal Girls' Senior High School,
Surulere.

Sir,

SUGGESTIONS ON WAYS OF WORKING TOGETHER

Over the years, I have been thinking in my mind on how parents and teachers in my school could work together for the overall improvement of my school.

I am a student of Ideal Girls' Senior High School, Surulere. I am in SS3H and of course the Assistant Class Captain in the school you are the chairman.

Considering the state of the school two and half years ago, I am disturbed now in my mind over the situation of things in my school. It is on the basis of this that I have written this letter to you to find a lasting solution to the problems of

working together with the teachers to move the school forward and better.

To do this, however, sir, I am suggesting that parents should in their meetings agree to contribute certain sum of money to effect some repairs of some classrooms especially that of the SS1 classes. These classes are in the state of disrepair. Where this is done, there would be an improvement in learning among the students.

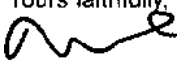
Another area the P.T.A could work together is in the area of employing a P.T.A teacher that would complement the government employed teachers. This is needed as a result of insufficient teachers in key subjects like Mathematics, Biology and Accounts where there are no teachers. Where this is done, I believe, there would be improvement in the overall result of the students.

There should of course be a point of the P.T.A working together with the teachers in the area of socials. I am saying that the P.T.A should work with the teachers by encouraging them through identifying BEST TEACHER' of the year and rewarding such a teacher by given a cash reward to encourage others to work better.

Doing this however, would help the school as a whole to move bDttar towards achieving good results by the students in the WAEC exams.

In conclusion, working together of the P.T.A and the teachers would, in no small measure, enhance your good name and that of the school to be written on gold.

Thank you for your usual co-operation.

Yours faithfully,

Babatunde Olu.

4. The Chairman, Panel of Judges, co- debaters, fellow students, accurate time keeper, distinguished ladies and gentlemen. I am here to support the motion that says; Schooling in a city is more advantageous than schooling in a village. Yes, this is my stand and this stand is based on the following reasons which, I believe, would make you agree with me.

First and foremost, most schools in the village lack major social amenities which are very much abundant in the city. This enhances the use of electrical gadgets such as tape-recorder for lectures, the computer where other information can be got through the net to enhance proper understanding and enlightenment.

Secondly, there are various qualified teachers in the city schools. The reason for this is not far-fetched. They are here because they have

the stuff and would want to deliver it to students instead of teaching in the village where there are no challenges either on the part of the students or other colleagues who are local champions.

Besides the earlier mentioned reasons, there is, of course, the availability of textbooks old and modern editions that would help complement the teachers' teachings or rather the classroom activities. All these are not available in the village schools.

Ladies and gentlemen, don't get me wrong. I am not saying there are no schools in the village with all their noted advantages, but in this context, you will agree with me that where the schooling there is good, there is no real competition because the teachers see themselves as champions but here, in the city, if you have the Masters degree, you have someone who is a holder of Ph.D in whatever subjects who is teaching the real stuff to students.

To conclude, my ever attentive listeners, I hope with the points raised, you have the conviction now that schooling in a city is better or more advantageous than schooling in the village. If not so why are students in the village coming to the city to school?

Your answer is as good as mine. Thank you.

5. AS ONE MAKES ONE'S BED, SO ONE MUST LIE ON IT

Looking closely at this topic, I felt the kind of feelings I got when my father was advising us his children when we were about going back to our boarding school after tLie holidays last year. He was encouraging us to ead very well so that we can pass our examinations to the next class. He informed us that the extent of our reading will surely show in our marks and truly, it did. How it did was the basis of my story.

It came to pass when I was in school. There was this boy who came from Lagos. His name is John but because of his actions in the hostel, everybody calls him Lagos boy. This boy will always show that he is around and that he knows the answers to all questions. As a result of this attitude, nobody discusses any question about class work with him.

John would always come first in the socials and sports but was always lagging behind in academics. It came to the examination time and John now faces his problems. He could not read even for an hour, he would always be sleeping when we would be swotting. So when the real writing of the exam started, he couldn't write and finally, when the result was pasted, John failed

and it dawn, on him that as one makes one's bed, so one must lie on it.

SECTION B COMPREHENSION

6. (a.) He wanted a shortcut back to school.
(b.) He thought he had come upon a schoolboy, who had broken a school rule
(c.) The boy appeared to be crying.
(d.) The night watchman turned out to be a creature resembling the one which Mr Oliver encountered in the pine forest.
(e.) The irony is that it was the night watchman he was happy to see that brought about his heart-
Qualifying / modifying (the noun 'people')
h.(i) Miscreant — culprit, offender, wrong-doer (ii) Sensed — felt, thought, perceived. (iii) Concern— worry, anxiety, uneasiness (iv) Rocked — shaken, agitated, convulsed. (v) Scrambled — stumbled, staggered.
7. (a.) They are determined to see their children to succeed.
b(i) They enrol their young children to succeed or they would like their children to succeed.
(ii) Special tutoring is given to children.

- (c.) The children get involved in drugs and become rebellious.
(d.) Because they feel neglected or they lack parental attention or love.
(e.) The effort results in the children's unhappiness.
(f.) What the children lose is more valuable than what they got from their parents.
g(i) Adverbial clause of concession (ii) Modifying the verb "lack"
(h.) (i) Effects — results, consequences (ii) Eager - anxious, determined, keen. (iii) Prospects - opportunities, chances. (iv) Raised — brought up, reared, nurtured, bred.
(v) Essential - important, valuable. (vi) Resentment - bitterness, annoyance, anger, indignation.

SECTION C SUMMARY

8. (a.) Malnutrition is caused by infections and a deficiency in the intake of nutrients.
b(i) Malnutrition damage the body. (ii) Malnutrition gives rise to chronic diseases in adulthood.
c.(i) Pregnant women of childbearing age and children should feed well.
(ii) The baby or child should be breast-fed for as long as is required.
(iii) The baby or child should be given enough balanced diet after he has been weaned.

WASSCE JUNE 2006 ENGLISH LANGUAGE 3 TEST OF ORALS (OBJECTIVE)

SECTION 1

From the words lettered A to D, choose the word **that has the same vowel sound as the one represented by the letter(s) underlined.** An example is given below:

Example: seat A. sit B. cite C. set D. key

The correct answer is D because only key contains the same vowel sound as the one underlined in seat. Therefore, answer space D would be shaded.

[A] [B] [C] [D]

Now answer the questions that follow:

1. sit A. guilt B. clique C. marine D. sardine
2. wed A. days B. says C. meal D. deal
3. card A. bat B. hat C. class D. glad
4. bought A. grouse B. loss C. worse D. horse
5. who A. bull B. wood C. rush D. lose
6. serve A. harp B. come C. journey D. beg
7. man A. dam B. basket C. parch D. park
8. bottle A. holy B. prowess C. grower D modern
9. cut A. butcher B. touch C. pouch D. pull
10. should A. push B. mould C. cousin D. gush
11. great A. neighbour B. meat C. lead D. peasant

12. boat A. comfort B. host C. golf D. mother
13. boil A. mail B. sour C. coin D. mayor
14. fair A. sheer B. here C. heir D. fear
15. ear A. chair B. wear C. cheer D. earnest

SECTION 2

From the words lettered A to D, choose the word **that has the same consonant sound as the one represented by the letter(s) underlined.** An example is given below.

Example: vice A. cat B. dress C. show D. chalk

The correct answer is B because only dress has the same consonant sound as the one underlined in vice. Therefore, answer space B would be shaded.

[A] [B] [C] [D]

Now, answer the questions that follow.

16. huge A. bug B. fog C. hug D. joy
17. wanted A. reduce B. handsome C. sandwich D. handkerchief
18. match A. machine B. charade C. moustache D. chunk
19. gas A. debris B. reverse C. island D. aisle
20. those A. thrive B. scathing C. worthless D. threat

21. knife A. sink B. bank C. gnaw D. single
22. feather A. victor B. vendor C. physics D. brave
23. face A. lose B. shoes C. tease D. rats
24. nation A. anxious B. decision C. explosion
D. equation
25. cool A. ceiling B. architect C. attache D. brochure
26. cause A. course B. sauce C. pores D. toss
27. thread A. bath B. booth C. writhe D. northern
28. flood A. plead B. fillip C. burglar D. ruffle
29. exact A. exceed B. excess C. exhaust D. excel
30. conduct A. attached B. resist C. indict D. impact

SECTION 3

From the words lettered A to D, choose the word that **rhymes** with the given word. An example is given below.

Example: obtain A. detain B. detail C. claim D. relay

The correct answer is A because only obtain **rhymes** with detain. Therefore, answer space A would be shaded.

[A] [B] [C] [D]

Now answer the questions that follow.

31. money A. honey B. monkey C. donkey D. Yankee
32. country A. mountain B. bounty C. country
D. shanty
33. shallow A. hallowed B. mellow C. callow
D. gallows
34. rushed A. washed B. dashed C. stashed
D. hushed
35. arrival A. recited B. convivial C. survival
D. retrieval

SECTION 4

In each of the following questions, the main/primary stress is indicated by writing the syllable on which it occurs in capital letters. From the words lettered A to D, choose the word that has the **correct stress**. An example is given below.

Example: democratic

- A. DE-mo-cra-tic B. de-MO-cra-tic
C. de-mo-CRA-tic D. de-mo-cra-TIC

The correct answer is C because the main/primary stress of the word democratic is on the third syllable. Therefore, answer space C would be shaded.

[A] [B] [C] [D]

Now answer the questions that follow.

36. intimacy
A. IN-ti-ma-cy B. in-TI-ma-cy
C. in-ti-MA-cy D. in-ti-ma-CY
37. indigenous
A. IN-di-ge-nous B. in-DI-ge-nous
C. in-di-GE-nous D. in-di-ge-NOUS

38. participate
A. PAR-ti-ci-pate B. par-TI-ci-pate
C. par-ti-CI-pate D. par-ti-ci-PATE
39. fundamental
A. FUN-da-men-tal B. fun-DA-men-tal
C. fun-da-MEN-tal D. fun-da-men-TAL
40. constitution
A. CON-sti-tu-tion B. con-STI-tu-tion
C. con-sti-TU-tion D. con-sti-tu-TION

SECTION 5

In the following options lettered A to D, all the words except one have the same stress pattern. Identify the one with the different **stress pattern** and shade your answer in the usual way. An example is given below.

Example: A. away B. apart C. behind D. river
Options A, B, C are all stressed on the second syllable while option D is the only one stressed on the first syllable. So, D is the correct answer. Therefore answer space D would be shaded.

[A] [B] [C] [D]

Now answer the questions that follow.

41. A. pursue B. local C. river D. country
42. A. review B. surplus C. surprise D. concise
43. A. cruel B. moral C. humane D. terror
44. profession B. proposal C. agreement D. resolute
45. condolence B. suspicion C. attachment
D. personnel

SECTION 6

In each of the following sentences, the word that receives the **emphatic stress** is written in capital letters. From the questions lettered A to D, choose the one to which the given sentence is the appropriate answer. An example is given below

Example: My mother's FRIEND hates pets.

- A. Does your mothers boss hate pets?
B. Does your mother's friend love pets?
C. Does your mother's friend hate toys?
D. Does your father's friend hate pets?

The correct answer is A because My mother's FRIEND hates pets answers the question, Does your mother's boss hate pets? Therefore, answer space A would be shaded.

[A] [B] [C] [D]

Now answer the questions that follow.

46. Tamuno bought his WIFE an expensive car.
A. Did Musa buy his wife an expensive car?
B. Did Tamuno buy his daughter an expensive car?
C. Did Tamuno buy his wife a cheap car?
D. Did Tamuno buy his wife an expensive necklace?

47. Father REBUKED Kemi for being dishonest
 A. Did Mother rebuke Kemi for being dishonest?
 B. Did Father praise Kemi for being dishonest?
 C. Did Father rebuke Tunde for being dishonest?
 D. Did Father rebuke Kemi for being honest?
48. Bola's mother is a very PATIENT teacher.
 A. Is Amina's mother a very patient teacher?
 B. Is Bola's mother a barely patient teacher?
 C. Is Bola's mother a very impatient teacher?
 D. Is Bola's mother a very patient doctor?
49. Chinwe is usually HOSPITABLE to strangers
 A. Is Ada usually hospitable to strangers?
 B. Is Chinwe seldom hospitable to strangers?
 C. Is Chinwe usually hostile to strangers?
 D. Is Chinwe usually hospitable to foes?
50. LAZY workers often fail as bosses
 A. Do industrious workers often fail as bosses?
 B. Do lazy workers sometimes fail as bosses?
 C. Do lazy workers often succeed as bosses?
 D. Do lazy workers often fail as subordinates?

SECTION 7

From the words lettered A to D, choose the word that contains the sound represented by the given phonetic symbol. An example is given below.

Example: /ə/ A. yell B. holy C. boy D. idiot

The correct answer is C because only boy contains the sound represented by the given

symbol. Therefore, answer space C would be shaded.

[A] [B] [C] [D]

Now answer the questions that follow.

51. /æ/ A. mango B. market C. branch D. plant
 52. /d/ A. border B. bother C. boring D. brother
 53. /u:/ A. full B. bush C. shampoo D. wool
 54. /ʒ/ A. courage B. favour C. perhaps D. scourge
 55. /ə/ A. warning B. party C. exhaust D. grandeur
 56. /d/ A. handsome B. adjust C. round D. passed
 57. /w/ A. write B. world C. wrestle D. wring
 58. /ʃ/ A. rush B. chimney C. vision D. charity
 59. /dʒ/ A. beige B. gorge C. prestige D. barrage
 60. /k/ A. champion B. chief C. chorus D. champagne

WASSCE JUNE 2006 ENGLISH LANGUAGE 3 TEST OF ORALS (OBJECTIVE) ANSWERS

1.B	2.B	3.C	4.D	5.D	6.C	7.A
8.D	9.B	10.A	11.A	12.B	13.C	14.C
15.B	16.D	17.A	18.D	19.B	20.C	21.C
23.C	24.A	25.B	26.C	27.A	28.D	29.C
30.D	31.A	32.B	33.C	34.D	35.C	36.A
37.B	38.B	39.C	40.C	41.A	42.A	43.D
44.C	45.C	46.C	47.D	48.A	49.A	50.C
51.A	52.B	53.C	54.D	55.D	56.C	57.B
58.A	59.B	60.C				

SENIOR SCHOOL CERTIFICATE EXAMINATION (SSCE 1988 – 2015)

Past Questions with Solutions

English Language

(Theory / Objectives with Oral English) 2007

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WASSCE JUNE 2007 ENGLISH LANGUAGE 2 OBJECTIVE TEST QUESTIONS

SECTION 1

*In each of the following sentences, there is one word or group of words underlined and one gap. From the list of words or group of words lettered A to D, choose the one that is **most nearly opposite in meaning** to the underlined word or group of words and that will, at the same time, correctly fill the gap in the sentence.*

- At first we found life in the town very exciting but soon it became rather.....
A. tiring B. disturbing C. burdensome D. boring.
- By working hard, Benjamin outshone his elder brother instead of being.....
A. overshadowed B. defeated C. demoted D. submerged.
- When we were busy discussing weighty matters, James introduced a..... issue.
A. light B. meaningless C. common D. trivial.
- The delegates found it better to resort to consultation rather than.....
A. conflict B. confrontation C. reconciliation D. consent.
- This house which was sealed off years ago has now been.....
A. re-opened B. rebuilt C. re-roofed D. restored.
- The government has decided that, from next year military service will no longer be compulsory, it will be.....
A. free B. optional C. open D. conditional.
- Co-operating with teachers promotes learning, it does not help to be.....
A. destructive B. confrontational C. defensive D. irrational.
- Only two months after the honour was conferred on the Minister, his dishonesty made the Head of State.....it.
A. recall B. reverse C. revoke D. reclaim.
- Despite all my attempts to refute the charges against me, my sister tried to.....them.

A. defend B. prove C. investigate D. maintain.

- The government's efforts to improve the economy of the country rather.....it.
A. destroyed B. spoilt C. complicated D. worsened.

SECTION 2

*From the words lettered A to D, choose the word that **best completes** each of the following sentences.*

- I really like working in that office: I found thevery friendly. A. condition B. atmosphere C. air D. situation.
- Our teacher's main aim was to.....us with his good work. A. impress B. influence C. instruct D. improve.
- Problems in the city have multiplied with theof people from the rural areas
A. entrance B. influx C. intrusion D. admission.
- It was so hot in the house that the boys rushed to the beach to enjoy the.....
A. breath B. wind C. breeze D. air.
- The thief ran so fast that my attempt to get him was in.....
A. failure B. waste C. futile D. vain.
- The hungry refugees had to queue for their.....
A. allowances B. needs C. supplies D. parcels.
- This land is very dry: we have to.....the plants
A. wet B. sprinkle C. shower D. water.
- It is not right for you to insult your parents: you will just.....trouble for yourself.
A. invite B. increase C. create D. produce
- The meeting of the warring factions ended on a.....note. A. cautious B. prosperous C. conciliatory D. definite
- We cannot tell which of the historian's is true.
A. narrations B. versions C. comments D. suggestions

SECTION 3

After each of the following sentences, a list of possible interpretations is given. Choose the interpretation that you consider **most appropriate** for each sentence.

21. Now that Michael has become rich, Nancy has begun to make much of him. This means that Nancy
 - A. now rules Michael
 - B. now gets a lot of money from Michael
 - C. only recently married Michael
 - D. no longer wants to leave Michael.
22. We wanted to arrive early so we decided to leave at 10 o'clock at the latest. This means that we
 - A. must leave at 10 o'clock exactly
 - B. should not leave later than 10 o'clock
 - C. should not leave before 10 o'clock
 - D. must leave about 10 o'clock.
23. My brothers drunkenness often got on my nerves. This means that my brother's drunkenness
 - A. disgraced him
 - B. made him ill
 - C. made me angry
 - D. offended me.
24. The government has decided to freeze student grants. This means that the government intends to
 - A. reduce grants meant for students
 - B. resume paying grants to students
 - C. make students repay the grants
 - D. stop paying grants to students.
25. The first time Paul met Ngozi, her beauty caught his eye. This means that
 - A. Ngozi admired Paul
 - B. Paul recognized Ngozi
 - C. Ngozi attracted Paul
 - D. Paul surprised Ngozi.
26. Mr. Juma kept his class on their toes so that they might not fail the examination. This means that Mr. Juma made his pupils
 - A. work very hard to pass
 - B. keep standing in class
 - C. prepare for the examination
 - D. eager to take examinations.
27. The President did everything he could not to lose face the Parliament. This means that the President tried to
 - A. retain his government's popularity
 - B. continue looking very attractive
 - C. win the respect of the people
 - D. gain more seats in the next elections.

28. Drought, for the first time, brought the poor farmers face-to-face with famine. This means that the farmers had never
 - A. expected to meet hungry people
 - B. thought the season would be dry
 - C. prepared for famine
 - D. experienced hunger in their lives.
29. You can be sure that Sule will hold his own in this dispute. This means that Sule will
 - A. claim victory in the case
 - B. insist that he owns the property
 - C. maintain that his opinion is right
 - D. prove that he won the argument.
30. The captain must have been really ill to ask the coach not to include him in the team. This means that the
 - A. captain demanded not to be excluded by the coach
 - B. coach would not have dropped the captain
 - C. coach had decided to exclude the captain
 - D. captain requested to be dropped from the team.

SECTION 4

From the words lettered A to D below each of the following sentences, choose the word or group of words that is **nearest in meaning** to the underlined word as it is used in the sentence

31. It was callous of you to have turned down the poor man's request. A. heartless B. stupid C. rude D. skilful
32. After a long walk, the travellers suddenly saw lights blazing ahead. A. burning B. shining C. glowing D. beaming.
33. John said nothing during the meeting: he just sat there fuming. A. thinking B. lonely C. mumbling D. angry
34. The employees hated him because he often abused his authority. A. insulted B. misdirected C. misapplied D. exaggerated.
35. The minister abridged his speech since he had to leave early. A. shortened B. hurried C. abandoned D. stopped.
36. For rescuing the boy, the policewoman was promoted for her gallantry. A. generosity B. bravery C. risk D. duty.
37. Nora's goal was to become a doctor. A. intention B. vision C. ambition D. mission

38. Our staff was very proud when the school clinched all the prizes. A. took B. won
C. possessed D. cornered
39. Mamie complains that her husband often relegates her to the position of a housemaid.
A. compares B. relates C. forces D. reduces
40. There is no vacancy so the company no longer recruits staff. A. position B. opening C. room
D. place.

SECTION 5

*From the word or group of words lettered A to D, choose the word or group of words that **best completes** each of the following sentences.*

41. The police are committed to.....safety of citizens. A. ensure B. have ensured C. ensuring
D. be ensuring.
42. No sooner had the thief seen the policemen.....he escaped. A. then B. when
C. that D. than.
43. Our teacher kept us kneeling.....the whole period. A. since B. for C. in D. from.
44. I know you now: I..... that you could be trusted.
A. am thinking B. think C. had thought D. have been thinking.
45. The chief, together with his elders.....welcomed to the durbar. A. was B. is C. were D. are.
46. Our car broke down so we had to go.....foot.
A. by B. with C. on D. through
47. Funke's mother prefers Jane..... Ama.
A. for B. than C. from D. to
48. You haven't shown any interest.....providing for yourself. A. towards B. for C. in D. at.
49. All workers are expected to be answerable.....their bosses.
A. for B. to C. through D. Towards
50. The hall was virtually empty; we had expected one hundred people at the very.....
A. lowest B. most C. least D. highest.
51. We did not have enough room so daddy turned the garage.....an additional bedroom
A. into B. as C. for D. to.

52. I was looking forward to.....from you.
A. hear B. be hearing C. have heard D. hearing
53. Most governments sink large sums of money.....devaloping their countries.
A. for B. into C. by D. in.
54. It was on Wednesday that we met in Accra? A. wasn't it B. didn't we C. haven't we
D. isn't it.
55. We have waited for too long: its high time we..... A. have left B. leave C. left D. had left.
56. I don't believe Banjul is far from here: it must be ten kilometres,.....
A. more and less B. rimore or less
C. more than less D. less or more.
57. You should not blame me; it is no fault of.....
A. me B. I C. my D. mine.
58. Our mother asked whether we.....our meal.
A. wilt be having B. will have C. have had
D. had had.
59. The coffee is still bitter; you have not added.....sugar. A. plenty B. some C. enough
D. much
60. You haven't seen them for a long time.....?
A. have you B. did you C. had you D. isn't it.
61.taxes is a civic responsibility. A. To be paying B. To have paid C. Having paid D. Paying
62. John and James are good friends: they are very fond of..... A. themselves B. each other
C. one and another D. them.
63. No wonder Pabi is now in the national team: he..... very well since his youth. A. is playing
B. played C. has been playing D. had played.
64. You may hate Mathematics hut you must stick..... it if you intend to study Physics.
A. by B. to C. at D. on
65. I never knew I could be so fast..... I entered the competition. A. if B. unless C. while D. until
66. The students are complaining.....management's high-handedness.
A. for B. on C. about D. after.
67. My aunt said that she would not buy me..... of those two books for school.

A. neither B. either C. all D. each.

68. I am quite sure that I did not see.....in the classroom last night. A. nothing B. anyone C. none D. no one.
69. I pointed to an object in the sky, but they..... it. A. can't see B. weren't seeing C. aren't seeing D. couldn't see
70.average, 1000 vehicles cross this bridge daily. A. In B. On C. By D. With.
71. A dictator often lives..... fear of assassination. A. in B. to C. with D. for
72. Jumai lives in a small street.....Murtala Muhammed Way. A. in B. off C. from D. on
73. I impressed..... him the necessity of his going overseas. A. with B. upon C. towards D. to

SECTION 6

In the following passages, the numbered gaps indicate missing words. Against each number in the list below each passage, four options are given in columns lettered A to D. Choose the word that is the **most suitable** to fill the numbered gaps in the passages.

PASSAGE A

The radio news is a significant challenge to newspapers these days. At any time, we can — 74 — to different local and international stations and be entertained or informed. The evening news — 75 — gives a valuable summary of the day's events. Also the popularity of television is increasing rapidly with — 76 — designed to reach a wide viewing — 77 —.

The announcer's job, whether on the television or over the radio, is very difficult especially for the novice who lacks the necessary self-confidence to speak clearly into the — 78 —, but he soon learns to relax. Disc jockeys often have regular fans who ---79 — special — 80 —. If

you own a good and efficient transistor radio with several — 81 — and an — 82 — you can easily — 83 — worthwhile programmes from overseas — 84 —. Important international events are often —85—by satellite all over the world and can be — 86 — live on television in your home.

74	A	B	C	D
75	tune up	tune out	dial out	tune in
76	entertainment	bulletin	announcement	event
77	items	programmes	plans	schedules
78	crowd	speakers	public	assembly
79	microphone	megaphone	telephone	amplifier
80	send out	despatch	put out	send in
81	answers	enquiries	queries	requests
82	colours	loud-speakers	wave-bands	metres
83	aerial	ear-phones	indicator	element
84	pick off	pick up	collect	turn out
85	voices	stations	operators	systems
86	transferred	sent	transmitted	spread
	caught	perceived	glimpsed	watched

PASSAGE B

Sally and Jake had to share the same house because of— 87—difficulties. After some time, they found themselves — 88— and fell in love. They then decided to —89— to cement their relationship. Sally —90— her boyfriend to her parents, who approved of their getting — 91 —. Jake in turn took his — 92 — to his parents. They too gave their blessing to the relationship and the — 93 — day was fixed. Both families then set about preparing for the great day. There was a large attendance that day and the — 94 — priest advised the — 95 — to remain — 96 — to each other all their lives and never — 97 —. A grand — 98 — was held during which friends and relatives showered — 99 — on them. The newly-wed then left on their — 100 —.

87	A	B	C	D
88	accommodation	residence	house	rent
89	compatible	adequate	compatible	admirable
90	cooperate	unite	join	many
91	introduced	disclosed	revealed	admitted
92	connected	engaged	admitted	accepted
93	compulsion	choice	partner	colleague
94	unification	blessing	marriage	wedding
95	presiding	praying	officiating	celebrating
96	lovers	friends	couple	two
97	withdrawn	close	loving	faithful
98	collapse	divide	divorce	break
99	celebration	reception	party	go-together
100	gifts	prices	valuable	offerings
	holiday	retreat	leave	honeymoon

WASSCE JUNE 2007 ENGLISH LANGUAGE 2 OBJECTIVE TEST ANSWERS

1. D	2. A	3. D	4. B	5. A	6. B	7. B	8. C	9. D	10. D
11. B	12. A	13. B	14. C	15. D	16. C	17. D	18. A	19. C	20. B
21. A	22. B	23. C	24. D	25. C	26. A	27. C	28. D	29. C	30. D
31. A	32. D	33. D	34. C	35. A	36. B	37. C	38. B	39. D	40. D
41. C	42. D	43. B	44. C	45. A	46. C	47. D	48. C	49. B	50. C
51. D	52. D	53. B	54. A	55. C	56. B	57. A	58. D	59. C	60. A
61. D	62. B	63. C	64. B	65. D	66. C	67. A	68. B	69. D	70. B
71. A	72. B	73. B	74. D	75. B	76. B	77. C	78. A	79. D	80. D
81. C	82. A	83. B	84. B	85. C	86. D	87. A	88. C	89. D	90. A
91. B	92. B	93. D	94. C	95. C	96. B	97. C	98. B	99. A	100. D

WASSCE JUNE 2007 ENGLISH LANGUAGE 1 THEORY QUESTIONS

SECTION A

- You had a quarrel with your best friend and have not been on speaking terms ever since. Now that you are about to leave secondary school, write to your friend giving at least three reasons why you should become friends again.
- Write an article for publication in your school magazine on the problems of indiscipline in schools.

- Write a letter to me iJairman of your school's Board of Governors on the need for a library in your school, requesting him to build and equip one for the school.
- You are the chief speaker in a debate on the topic: It is the home and not the school that contributes more to moral laxity among students. Write your argument for or against the topic.

5. Write a story to illustrate the saying: Strike while the iron is hot.

SECTION B COMPREHENSION

6. Read the following passage carefully and answer the questions on it.

Mr Cissey pulled on his trousers very hurriedly and dragged himself to the verandah. He was bent on getting to his office before his workers. The previous day, he had reprimanded his staff for regularly coming to work late, and threatened to give the sack to any of them who would repeat the offence. Today, he must get to work in time, not only to serve as a role model but also to show that he really meant what he had said.

He managed to squeeze himself behind the wheel of his car which was at least two sizes too small to accommodate his paunch. He inserted the ignition key and turned it but the car would not start; the engine just grumbled. On the second attempt, it coughed and finally roared to life on the third. It moved grudgingly to the gate and stopped. Cissey immediately realized that he would be caught in a traffic jam. It was evident that he would arrive at his workplace late.

For about two hours, Cissey just sat, glued to his seat, fuming. Hard as he tried to control his temper, the misbehaviour of other drivers once prompted him to bawl at them. Then suddenly, after the interminable wait, the street cleared and Cissey sped off. It was almost three hours after leaving home that he got to his workplace. The staff were already there and when he entered the building, he found his secretary and the clerical staff apparently immersed in their assignments, with an air of dutifulness. One look at their boss warned them that they had better keep quiet to save their skin. But as soon as he closed the door to his office he heard soft voices mumbling words he could not understand. Worst of all, he heard subdued laughter from his secretary.

Cissey immediately shot out of the chair ready to vent his spleen on these underlings but suddenly plopped back into his seat. On second thoughts, he changed his mind. How could he castigate them for what they had not caused?

- (a) Why was Mr. Cissey in a hurry to get to his office?
(b) What two indications are there in the passage that Mr. Cissey was a huge man?
(c) How did Mr. Cissey express his anger while caught in the traffic?
(d) Why did Mr. Cissey become angry with his staff?

(e) What was the attitude of the staff towards their boss?

(f) ... when he entered the building...

(i) What grammatical name is given to this expression as it is used in the passage? (ii) What is its function?

(g) How could he castigate them for what they had not caused?

What literary device is used in the expression above?

(h) What is meant by the expression vent his spleen in the last paragraph?

(i) For each of the following words, find another word or phrase which means the same and which can replace it as it is used in the passage.

(i) reprimanded; (ii) evident; (iii) prompted; (iv) interminable; (v) immersed; (vi) subdued.

7. Read the following passage carefully and answer the questions on it.

Whenever I ask myself the question why I have not left this country for good, many answers rush to my mind, each striving to be recognized as being the most convincing. I am reminded of the popular slogan that this country belongs to us, for which reason every one of us must join hands in trying to salvage it. I try to dismiss the argument by reasoning that it is foolhardy attempting to lend a helping hand where one's services are apparently not required. Then I am reminded that if I leave the country in a hurry just because of our political instability and economic hardship, my commitments to my nuclear family and extended family at home will suffer. I reply by saying that as soon as I get settled abroad, I would arrange for my family to join me. Other financial problems at home would be taken care of by my regular remittances. Would I then never think of going back home in future? Not until the situation in the country improved considerably, I would answer. And who do I expect to carry on with the task of national rehabilitation, when the likes of me are all out of the country? Those who messed up the country in the first place, I would argue. And so on. This self-examination has been going on for the last ten years or so; meanwhile, I am yet to leave the country.

When I wonder how many people think as I do, I realize that we must be very few. Indeed, not many have the slightest opportunity of absconding from the country; they do not have the place to run to, nor do they have the means of escape. Even among the elite who consider this possibility, the uncertainty of a future outside their fatherland intimidates them. And so we all end up staying and grumbling.

- (a) Why would the writer like to leave his country?

- (b) Why does the writer believe that he should not join in salvaging his country?
- (c) What would make the writer return to his country?
- (d) Who does the writer suggest should carry on the task of national rehabilitation?
- (e) Give two reasons why it has not been easy for him and others to leave the country.
- (f) ... many answers rush to my mind... What figure of speech is used in this expression?
- (g) ... the uncertainty of a future outside their fatherland
- (i) What grammatical name s given to this expression as it is used in the passage? (ii) What is its function?
- (h) For each of the following words or phrase, find another word or phrase which means the same and which can replace it as it is used in the passage:
- (i) for good; (ii) slogan; (iii) foolhardy; (iv) commitments; (v) absconding.

SECTION C SUMMARY

You are advised to spend about 50 minutes on this section.

8. Read the following passage care fully and answer the questions on it.

Have you always thought that insects are nothing more than a nuisance? Would you like the world to be free of these 'annoying pests'? Do you spray them, swat them, or step on them at every opportunity? Before declaring war on every bug that crosses your path, why not try to learn something about their world? After all, with a population that outnumbers humans by about 200 million to one, you can e sure that insects are here to stay' A brief look at just a few of these amazing creatures might well convince you that insects deserve your respect.

Consider flying insects for example. Mosquitoes can fly upside down. Some can even fly through the rain without getting wet — yes actually dodging the raindrops! Some tropical wasps and bees buzz around at speeds of up to 72 kilometres per hour. One monarch butterfly of North America logged 3,010 kilometres on its migration flight. Hover flies can beat their wings more than a thousan1 times per second — much faster than humming-birds and dragon flies can fly backwards. Clearly then, insects are such accomplished fliers, unmatched by any other winged creature.

The eyes of many insects serve as a compass, Bees and wasps, for instance, can detect the plane of polarized light. This enables them to locate the sun's postion in the sky - even when it is hidden by clouds. Thanks to this ability,

these insects can forage far from their nests and still navigate their way home unerringly.

In the insect world, sounds and aromas are often used to find a mate - no small achievement when prospective mates are few and far between. Female emperor moths find a suitor by emitting a scent that is so potent that a male can home in on its source from nearly 11 kilometres away. Crickets, grasshoppers, and cicadas prefer to make themselves heard. Even we humans can hear the amorous cicada as it converts its whole body into a sounding board. A large group of courting cicadas can create a noise louder than that of a drilling machine!

Insects play a vital role in our daily life. Indeed, about 30 percent of the foods we eat results from pollination by them. But pollination is only one of their useful functions. Insects keep the earth clean by means of an efficient recycling system, as they reprocess dead plant and animals. Scientists have observed that without insects the earth will be inun3ted with dead plant and animal matter. Insects also enrich the soil by liberating nutrients that make things grow. They are sorely missed when their work is not done. Consider what happened in Australia. which has become home to millions of cattle. Herds scattered dung everywhere. Besides being unsightly, the dung provided a breeding site for the bush fly — a plague to both humans and cattle. So dung beetles were imported from Europe and Africa, and the problem was solved!

Admittedly, some insects eat crops and carry discse. But only about one percent of the world's insects is considered as pests, and many of these cause damage because of the way man himself altered the environment. Even with their rcwbacks, insects are an integral part of the natural world on which we depend. Scientists have pointed out that while iflsects can survive without us, we cannot survive without them.

(a) In three sentences, one for each, summarize the characteristics of insects discussed in the passage.

(b) In three sentences, one for each, summarize the important functions of insects discussed in the passage.

SECTION A

1. 3, Amodu Street,

Itire, Lagos.
12th June, 2007

Dear Sam,

It's been a long time since we heard or write to each other. How are you? I hope you are finding things easy with your studies. How is everything there in Ibadan? They are fine I supposed. Well, I'm fine here too, except that I'm seriously planning how I will come to Ibadan before you finish your final examination.

This letter may come to you as a surprise as we have not been in good terms for the past two years. The reason for this is you. I have made up my mind that we should stop that idea of sealed lips and turn a new leaf. I have reasons for this decision of mine and that is why I have written this letter to you as a long standing friend.

First and foremost, I have decided to forgive and forget as the scriptures have made us to behave as good christians. I don't want us to go back to that again. Let us continue with our friendship.

Secondly, due to the fact that the girl that caused the fight is no more, i.e I heard that she planned to elope with one man who I later learnt was arrested for armed robbery, and the girl thus committed suicide when she learnt of this. So let us continue our friendship.

Apart from the above reasons, the effect of the fight affected me last year that I had a carry-over in one of my courses, but when I put it off my mind, I was able to do well. I know it also affected you, but now I believe you are more mature, we need to be friends like before.

Sam, I know this letter will keep you alive again. Please send me your reply so that I would be totally relieved. Keep fit and God bless.

Yours sincerely
TUNDE

2. **PROBLEMS OF INDISCIPLINE IN SCHOOLS**

The rate at which discipline is going down the drains is not encouraging at all, most especially in our schools. It is in the light of this, that this article is written. This is to serve as an eye-opener, so that indiscipline would be eradicated in our schools.

Indiscipline has been the source of various problems in schools nowadays. Among the problems of indiscipline in schools is the issue of laziness. Most students in schools today are lazy, even very lazy. They are lazy in doing things. They can't read for a whole hour or two, they get bored and want to play. This attitude of course is why they lack facts that are required of them in a test or examination. Since they lack facts for any question asked, they often resort to examination malpractices.

It is a known fact that students are always in uniform of their various schools. Most of the uniforms are supplied by the school, but when there's the need to sew another one by the students, the next thing they do is to instruct the tailor to sew a style different from the pattern approved by the school. There you'll see a mini-skirt, bell-bottom trousers, and other forms of indiscipline exhibited by the students. They no longer put on sandals. The in-thing now is slippers worn to schools. They will not enter the school compound so as not to be caught and be corrected.

Another notable problem of indiscipline in schools is the eat-and-drop habit of the students. It is pertinent to note that most students nowadays are gluttons i.e they eat at every second in the school and drop the wrappers of what they eat anywhere - along the road, in their classrooms, thereby making the school compound dirty all the time despite the rules that forbids that habit.

All the attitudes mentioned above constitute what is known as indiscipline because they are against school rules and regulations. Any thing that goes against the school rules and regulations is an act of indiscipline and so since these problems are rampant in schools now, any student involved in them is an undisciplined student.

In conclusion, for the problems to be removed, proper and adequate actions should be taken on any erring student.

Tunde Olukosi
SS 3^A.

3. 82, Randle Avenue.

Surulere,
Lagos.
12th June, 2007.

The Chairman,
Board of Governors
Ideal Girls' Senior High School,
Yaba Lagos.

Dear Sir,

REQUEST FOR A LIBRARY FOR MY SCHOOL

I considered it a point of duty on my side as the senior prefect of Ideal Girls' Senior High School to bring to your notice a request for the need to build or renovate one of the old buildings that are no more in use to serve as a library for our school.

For any school to be fully operational at all, there must be a corresponding library to complement the academic activities of students in the school. We are in a dire need of a school library so that the generality of the students will be able to be very sound in what our teachers teach us.

I am making this request to your sir, because realisation of the library is much at hand in respect of the abandoned building known as store. The store had been in use during the era of Teacher Training Schools that were no more.

Sir, if this building is renovated, it will be appropriate for the library I am talking about. It will not require building of a new block from the inundation. I am suggesting that whatever money needed to building, can then be used in equipping it to become a befitting modern library.

Sir, if this request is granted, our students will be happy and our school will be proud of us all and the credit will go a long way in projecting your good works towards the school.

Thank you for the various works you have done towards the uplift of the school.

Yours faithfully,

Bayo Olukosi.
SS 3 Good.

4. IT IS THE HOME AND NOT THE SCHOOL THAT CONTRIBUTES MORE TO MORAL LAXITY AMONG STUDENTS

Good morning, Mr. Chairman, panel of judges, accurate time-keeper, co-debaters, distinguished ladies and gentlemen, fellow students. I felt highly honoured to be chosen as the chief speaker in this special discussion. I am as a matter of opinion saying that

It is the home and not the school that contributes more to moral laxity among students.

First and foremost, the known agencies of socialization are five in which the home happened to be the first. This is to say that a child's first contact is the home which includes the parents of the child. The parents are expected to serve as the first teacher of the child and the mother

especially, is in the best position to train the child on how best to behave in the society. So if the child should behave negatively outside, it is a reflection of his home training.

Secondly, the number of time a child uses in the school is very short to the number of hours he uses in the home. This amounts to the fact that most of what the student needs to have to behave in the society, lies at home and so it is the home and not the school that contributes more to moral laxity among students.

Ladies and gentlemen, is there anybody here whose parents is the school? No! of course is the answer because the home has permanent people who are there to train the students. If this is so, there is no gainsaying that when a student behaves badly outside; it is the home and not the school that contributes more to moral laxity among students.

The school in its role is there to reshape whatever behaviour a child exhibits, negatively to a positive change. Ladies and gentlemen, students and others, I hope I've been able to convince you and not to confuse you that it is the home and not the school that contributes more to moral laxity among students.

In conclusion, if the home wakes up to its responsibility, the child will behave morally and would not be blamed again. Thank you.

5. STRIKE WHILE THE IRON IS HOT

It was one of the busy days in the hostel - the manual Labour Day in the boarding school. It was the usual Saturday morning when all students would have to assemble at the school compound to make a general cleaning which includes cutting of grasses, weeding of grown lawns, sweeping of surroundings, cutting of trees and all other works that the labour prefect deemed fit.

There was this boy who came from Lagos whose name is Akinsola. We generally call him Akin. While everybody was busy cutting, weeding, sweeping, Akin was busy sleeping at a corner behind the mango tree in the middle of the school compound where the library was. I went to wake him up that morning for we are friends. All he said was that he would cut his own portions when others would have finished, for he would not want anybody to disturb him.

No sooner had we all finished our different portions of the manual labour than Akin rose to his own portion.

Those of us that are not used to cutting or farming work from Lagos were helped out by those other students from the Western part of the country.

Akin could not be helped out for those people were tired and so he was in the hot sun wallowing solitarily. Had it been that he came out to cut while others were cutting, he would have been helped out. So my advice to people like Akin is: Strike while the iron is hot.

SECTION B COMPREHENSION

6. (a) Mr. Clssey was in a hurry to get to his office to show an example of punctuality.
- (b) The two indicabons in the passage that show Mr. Cissey was a huge man are:
He had a paunch - He squeezed himself behind the wheels.
- (c) Mr. Clssey expressed his anger while caught in the traffic by shouting at the other drivers and fumed with anger.
- (d) He became angry wth his staff because they laughed at him and mumbled.
- (e) they feared him (f)(i) Aclverbld clause of time
(ii)it modifides the verb 'found
(g) Rhetorical question
(h) it means show his anger
(i)(a)reprimanded-rebuked, scolded (b)evident-clear, obvious (c)prompted-caused, led, forced, provoked (d)interminable-long (very), endless, unending (e)immersed-buried, engulfed, absorbed

(f)subdued-suppressed, restrained, stifled, muffled.

7. (a) His country is going through political instability and economic hardship.
(b) He believes that his services are not required.
(c) A considerable improvement of conditions in his country.
(d) The writer suggested those who caused the political instability and economic hardship.
(e) Absconding from the country has not been easy for them because: (i)They lack theopportunity of where to go and means ofgoing.
(ii) They are intimidated by the uncertainty of a future outside home. (f) Metaphor.
(g) (i) Noun phrase. (ii) Subject of the verb (intimidates). (h)(i) For good-for ever, permanently.
(ii) Slogan-saying, belief, motto, (iii) Foolhardy - stupid, risky, senseless, foolish, ridiculous.
(iv) Commitments-responsibilities, duties, obligations. (v)Absconding-running away, escaping, fleeing.

SECTION C SUMMARY

8. (a)Insects have good sense of direction.
(iii)Insects have keen senses of (i) Insects carry out pollination. (ii) Insects enrich the soil.

WASSCE JUNE 2007 ENGLISH LANGUAGE 3 TEST OF ORALS (OBJECTIVE)

SECTION 1

From the words lettered A to D, choose the word that has the **same vowel sound** as the one represented by the letter(s) underlined. An example is given below.

Example: sat A. sit B. cite C. set D. key.

The correct answer is D because only key contains the same vowel sound as the one underlined in seat. Therefore, answer space 0 would be shaded.

[A] [B] [C] [D]

Now answer the questions that follow:

1. park A. thank B. heart C. fact D. mass
2. cause A. work B. cork C. mock D. double
3. bat A. plant B. pass C. rank D. taste
4. bull A. shook B. root C. crude D. bulk
5. bread A. please B. head C. bead D. great
6. ooze A. ruse B. blood C. good D. took
7. lick A. police B. women C. machine D. seek
8. hum A. fond B. don C. onion D. romp

9. curse A. luck B. brought C. courteous D. fault
10. away A. doctor B. angry C. addict D. banking
11. wear A. bait B. pair C. d3ar D. near
12. faith A. weight B. piety C. said D. guide
13. deer A. dare B. merely C. hair D. fairly
14. goat A. mount B. board C. hoard D. whole
15. fowl A. sow B. tow C. now D. know

SECTION 2

From the words lettered A to D, choose the word that has the **same consonant sound(s)** as the one represented by the letter(s) underlined. An example is given below.

Example: vice A. cat B. dress C. show D. chalk

The correct answer is B because only dress has the same consonant sound as the one underlined in vice. Therefore, answer space B would be shaded.

[A] [B] [C] [D]

Now, answer the questions that follow.

16. strange A. vague B. mirage C. logic D. legume
17. who A. vehicle B. khaki C. rhyme D. hammer
18. hang A. cringe B. strange C. mango D. plunge
19. leisure A. sure B. ledger C. treasure D. judge
20. zoom A. recess B. consume C. dispense
D. perspire
21. thunder A. smooth B. throb C. writhe D. breathe
22. perch A. chemistry B. sachet C. character
D. chimney
23. heap A. receipt B. people C. cupboard D. coup
24. king A. cool B. cell C. knife D. knew
25. should A. mission B. mishap C. dishearten
D. occasion
26. tongue A. begged B. seat C. bustle D. soften
27. gas A. arise B. consent C. resign D. resort
28. Lamb A. mild B. could C. talk D. calm
29. mugs A. examine B. excellent C. except
D. exceed
30. grasp A. spiritual B. supply C. grips D. mumps

SECTION 3

From the words lettered A to D, choose the word that **rhymes** with the given word. An example is given below.

Example: obtain A. detain B. detail C. claim D. relay

The correct answer is A because only detain rhymes with obtain. Therefore, answer space A would be shaded.

[A] [B] [C] [D]

Now answer the questions that follow.

31. accurst A. least B. worst C. cost D. bust
32. number A. tumbler B. sombre C. slumber
D. plumber
33. plenty A. beauty B. twenty C. scientist D. entity.
34. ground A. behind B. contend C. profound D. grind
35. honey A. funn B. tourney C. journey D. puny

SECTION 4

In each of the following questions, the main/primary stress is indicated by writing the syllable on which it occurs in capital letters.

From the words lettered A to D, choose the word that has the **correct stress**. An example is given below.

Example: democratic

- A. DE-mo-cra-tic B. de-MO-cra-tic
C. de-mo-CRA-tic D. de-mo-cra-TIC

The correct answer is C because the main/primary stress of the word democratic is on the third syllable. Therefore, answer space C would be shaded.

[A] [B] [C] [D]

Now answer the questions that follow:

36. arbitrary
A. AR-bi-tra-ry B. ar-I-tra-ry
C. ar-bi-TRA-ry D. ar-bi-tra-RY

37. ambivalent
A. AM-bi-va-leot B. am-BI-va-lent
C. am-bi-VA-lent D. am-bi-va-LENT
38. palatable
A. PAL-a-ta-ble B. al-A-ta-ble
C. pal-a-TA-ble D. pal-a-ta-BLE
39. initiative
A. I-ni-tia-tive B. i-NI-tia-tive
C. i-ni-TIA-tive D. i-ni-tia-TIVE
40. constitution
A. CON-sti-tu-tuoru B. con-STI-tu-tion
C. con-sti-TU-tion D. con-sti-tU-TION

SECTION 5

In the following options lettered A to D, all the words except one have the same stress pattern. Identify the one with the different **stress pattern** and shade your answer in the usual way. An example is given below.

Example: A. away B. apart C. b'ehind D. river
Options A, B, C are all stressed on the second syllable while option D is the only one stressed on the first syllable. So, D is the correct answer. Therefore answer space D would be shaded.

[A] [B] [C] [D]

Now answer the questions that follow.

41. A. elite B. schedule C. canoe D. abuse
42. A. advice B. absence C. concise D. submit
43. A. respite B. review C. despite D. deplore
44. A. quantify B. component C. religion D. disaster
45. A. benefit B. registrar C. sacrifice D. comfortable

SECTION 6

In each of the following sentences, the word that receives the **emphatic stress** is written in capital letters. From the questions lettered A to D, choose the one to which the given sentence is the appropriate answer. An example is given below.

Example: My mother's FRIEND hates pets.

- A. Does your mother's boss hate pets?
B. Does your mother's friend love pets?
C. Does your mother's friend hate toys?
D. Does your father's friend hate pets?

The correct answer is A because My mother's FRIEND hates pets answers the question, Does your mother's boss hate pets? Therefore, answer space A would be shaded.

[A] [B] [C] [D]

Now answer the questions that follow.

46. Nigeria is the largest PRODUCER of petroleum in Africa
A. Is Ghana the largest producer of petroleum in Africa?

- B. Is Nigeria the largest importer of petroleum in Africa?
 C. Is Nigeria the largest producer of petroleum in the world?
 D. Is Nigeria the largest producer of cocoa in Africa?
47. Ngozi passed the Cambridge examination at the THIRD attempt.
 A. Did Chimezie pass the Cambridge examination at the third attempt?
 B. Did Ngozi fail the Cambridge examination at the third attempt?
 C. Did Ngozi pass the UME at the third attempt?
 D. Did Ngozi pass the Cambridge examination at the first attempt?
48. OUR school is the best in MathemaJcs in Nigeria.
 A. Is our school the best in English in Nigeria?
 B. Is our school the best in Mathematics in Africa?
 C. Is our school the worst in Mathematics in Nigeria?
 D. Is their school the best in Mathematics in Nigeria?
49. Fathcr praised CHIKE for winning the BEST-STUDENT award
 A. Did Auntie praise Chike for winning the best-student award?
 B. Did father blame Chike for losing the best-student award?
 C. Did father praise Chidi for winning the best-student award?
 D. Did father praise Ctiike for winning the runners-up award?
50. The visiting team won the GOLD cup in the cricket competition
 A. Did the national team win the gold cup in the cricket competition?
 B. Did the visiting team win the silver cup in the cricket competition?

- C. Did the visiting team win the gold cup in the football competition?
 D. Did the visiting team lose the gold cup in the cricket competition?

SECTION 7

51. From the words lettered A to D, choose the word that contains the sound represented by the given phonetic symbol. An example is given below.

Example: /ɔ:/ A. yell B. holy C. boy D. idiot

The correct answer is C because only boy contains the sound represented by the given symbol. Therefore, answer space C would be shaded.

[A] [B] [C] [D]

Now answer the questions that follow.

51. /e/ A. pays B. says C. weight D. heinous
 52. /i/ A. sit B. people C. hymn D. jeopardy
 53. /æ/ A. mad B. pass C. class D. dance
 54. /u:/ A. douse B. route C. rough D. dough
 55. /ɒ/ A. lock B. nought C. drought D. watch
 56. /tʃ/ A. chest B. equation C. chauffeur D. moustache
 57. /ɜ:/ A. ethics B. gather C. athlete D. both
 58. /r/ A. harm B. rhyme C. bark D. pure
 59. /n/ A. thank B. fang C. fringe D. hunger
 60. /s/ A. cause B. goes C. second D. island

WASSCE JUNE 2007 ENGLISH LANGUAGE 3 TEST OF ORALS (OBJECTIVE) ANSWERS

1.B	2.B	3.C	4.A	5.B	6.A	7.B
8.C	9.C	10.A	11.B	12.A	13.B	14.D
15.C	16.C	17.D	18.C	19.C	20.B	21.B
22.B	23.B	24.A	25.A	26.B	27.B	28.A
29.A	30.A	31.B	32.C	33.B	34.C	35.A
36.A	37.B	38.B	39.C	40.C	41.B	42.B
43.D	44.C	45.B	46.B	47.D	48.D	49.D
50.B	51.A	52.B	53.A	54.B	54.B	55.D
56.A	57.B	58.B	59.C	60.C		

SENIOR SCHOOL CERTIFICATE EXAMINATION (SSCE 1988 – 2015)

Past Questions with Solutions

English Language

(Theory / Objectives with Oral English) 2008

WASSCE JUNE 2008 ENGLISH LANGUAGE 2 OBJECTIVE TEST QUESTIONS

SECTION 1

*In each of the following sentences, there is one underlined word and one gap. From the list of words lettered A to D, choose the one that is **most nearly opposite in meaning** to the underlined word and that will, at the same time, correctly fill the gap in the sentence.*

1. Good teaching stimulates the interest of students, whereas bad teaching.....it
A. dampens B. encourages C. supersedes D. retracts.
2. Some youths of this generation are often hard-hearted compared to those of past generations who were.....
A. indifferent B. fastidious C. proficient D. compassionate.
3. The doctor does not think the patient will recover; the signs are ominous rather than.....
A. encouraging B. feasible C. obvious D. gloomy.
4. The purpose of education is to enhance progress and not to..... it.
A. proscribe B. intercept C. impede D. confuse
5. The teacher gave him high marks and wrote complimentary remarks in the margin, which surprisingly gave him.....feelings.
A. doubtful B. secret C. unpleasant D. serious.
6. Many people find cod liver oil disgusting but soldiers find it.....
A. refreshing B. medicinal C. pleasant D. bitter.
7. The investigators relied solely on conjectures, which were not as reliable as.....
A. facts B. hearsay C. figures D. fabrications.
8. It was obvious that Modou committed the crime, but his friends were still.....
A. unhappy B. doubtful C. suspicious D. confident.
9. The government was blamed for implementing policies that favoured the elite at the expense of the.....
A. workers B. wealthy C. masses D. oppressed.

10. His suggestion on how to deal with the thief was invaluable, but the police considered it.....
A. useless B. impossible C. necessary D. timely.

SECTION 2

*From the words lettered A to D, choose the word that **best completes** each of the following sentences.*

11. The woman's behaviour clearly shows that her love for her husband was merely.....
A. superstitious B. superlative C. elusive D. superficial
12. The man was told in his own interest to..... the statement he had made.
A. cancel B. recast C. erase D. retract
13. Mum made soothing remarks in order to..... dad
A. incense B. pacify C. rekindle D. protect
14. Ebou maintained his stand in.....of the principal's orders.
A. defiance B. deference C. obedience D. defence
15. The outgoing president warned his successor to beware of..... who praise every action of government, good or bad.
A. enthusiasts B. sycophants C. radicals D. favourites
16. Salimata came into.....when she won the beauty contest.
A. public B. limelight C. focus D. view
17. The current economic crisis has led to the.....of many workers.
A. rejection B. retrenchment C. isolation D. ejection.
18. We all agree that the television is a more powerful.....of communication than the radio
A. agent B. way C. instrument D. medium
19. He won the election by a.....of 500 votes.
A. consensus B. margin C. surplus D. gap
20. Daylight armed-robbery is a common..... in big cities.
A. plan B. site C. exercise D. phenomenon

SECTION 3

After each of the following sentences, a list of possible interpretations is given. Choose the interpretation that you consider **most appropriate** for each sentence.

21. When Joe was threatened with suspension he made a clean breast of his offence. This means that Joe
A. ran away
B. made friends with the other offenders
C. told the whole truth
D. pleaded innocence.
22. When Eunice was discharged from hospital she was a shadow of her former self. This means that she
A. looked like a shadow B. was withdrawn
C. had changed a little D. was thin and weak.
23. Chinwe can be stubborn yet I have a soft spot for her. This means that I
A. am fond of Chinwe even though she is stubborn
B. alone know how to control Chinwe
C. dislike Chinwe for stubbornness
D. have a cure for her stubbornness.
24. The principal is high-handed with his staff. This means that the principal
A. respects his staff highly
B. is very friendly and easy-going with his staff
C. shakes hands with his staff frequently
D. uses his authority over his staff sternly.
25. The loan was taken on a gentleman's agreement. This means that
A. there was no documentation of the loan
B. two gentlemen witnessed the loan
C. the loan was granted
D. the loan was not to be repaid.
26. Constructing the road along the coast was difficult but the men had already broken the back of the work before the rains. This means that they had
A. completed the preparations
B. completed the most difficult part of it
C. completed it altogether
D. broken the road.
27. Whenever Nkoyo finds herself at a loose end, she goes visiting people. This means that Nkoyo goes visiting people whenever she
A. is happy
B. feels worried and confused
C. has nothing to occupy her
D. has no visitors.

28. Kola will get the job because his father will surely pull strings for him. This means that his father will
A. give him useful information
B. remove some of his difficulties
C. influence the right people
D. attract attention towards him.
29. To give a bronze medal to the athlete who was deliberately intercepted on the track was cold comfort. This means that the bronze medal was
A. acceptable to him
B. too cold
C. not adequate compensation
D. rejected by him.
30. The students planned to confront the principal with their grievances but as they got closer to his office, they developed cold feet. This means that
A. they could no longer walk
B. they lost courage
C. they lost interest
D. their feet became numb.

SECTION 4

From the words lettered A to D below each of the following sentences, choose the word or group of words that is **nearest in meaning** to the underlined word as it is used in the sentence.

31. The woman stifled a cry of astonishment as she discovered the identity of the robber.
A. suppressed B. shouted C. forced D. hid.
32. That rock is a potential danger to fishing boats.
A. a possible B. an unexpected C. an obvious D. a serious.
33. His contribution to the development programme in the village remains unrivalled
A. unbroken B. unparalleled C. undisputed D. unknown.
34. Members of the party agreed that some serious thinking is required before a final decision can be taken.
A. meetings B. consultation C. consideration D. appraisal.
35. Our chief is very intelligent but he could be parochial in his judgements.
A. deep B. broad C. narrow-minded D. kind-hearted.
36. All that was left after the riot were the charred remains of the victims.
A. burnt B. black C. broken D. scattered.

37. The incessant chatter of the pupils irritated the visitor.
A. unceasing B. meaningless C. excited D. loud.
38. Musa won the debate because he articulated his arguments convincingly.
A. pronounced B. presented C. arranged D. summarized.
39. I was surprised at the gallantry of the Senegalese peace-keepers.
A. cowardice B. strength C. bravery D. height.
40. The clerk was dismissed for derelection of duty.
A. ignorance B. lateness C. carelessness D. negligence.

SECTION 5

*From the word or group of words lettered A to D, choose the word or group of words that **best completes** each of the following sentences.*

41. This is a bad case,.....hard you try to defend the accused.
A. however B. whatever C. whichever D. whenever.
42.pain has been taken to make the party a success
A. Such B. Much C. Every D. Many.
43. School children are advised to refrain.....smoking
A. with B. against C. to D. from.
44. The principal, as well as the teachers,.....in school
A. is B. were C. all are D. are all.
45. Fatima..... come to work today since she is still sick.
A. needn't had B. needn't have C. needn't has D. needn't to.
46. Aminata has.....her engagement to Sule.
A. broken off B. broken up C. broken away D. broken down.
47.who knows the times will not open his door to strangers at night.
A. Somebody B. Nobody C. Anybody D. Everybody
48. All the final year students will attend.....party.
A. tomorrow's B. tomorrows' C. tomorrows D. tomorrow

49. My friend's son stole the.....briefcase.
A. director's-general B. director-general's
C. directors-general D. director-generals'
50. This isn't your ring; it is your.....
A. daughter- in-law B. daughter-in-law's
C. daughters- in-law D. daughter- in-laws
51. He brought us.....
A. a good news B. many good news
C. some good news D. several good news.
52. I was asked whether I.....to go on the outing.
A. would intend B. intended C. have intended D. intend
53. Our teacher is leaving our school in July to..... a new job.
A. take in B. take to C. take on D. take up
54. The old woman had no children and no real friends.....
A. too B. again C. either D. Neither
55. Certain tasks may be unpleasant at first, but gradually one may get.....them.
A. to liking B. to like C. to be liking D. to have liked
56.in their youth is a source of pleasurable reminiscence for elderly persons
A. To be travelling B. To travel C. By travelling D. To have travelled.
57. The minister told his congregation that one day.....would be rewarded
A. the faithfuls B. the faithful C. any faithfuls D. a faithful
58. Maram liked the exhibits at the trade fair but she really enjoyed.....the most
A. the amusements B. amusements
C. the amusement D. amusement
59. The jury gave.....verdict of guilty in the murder case.
A. it's B. tis C. it D. its
60. The room in.....they lived was quite large and well-lit.
A. where B. that C. which D. there.
61. The great gates of the ancient palace were.....
A. beautiful pieces of iron works
B. the beautiful pieces of iron works
C. beautiful pieces of iron work
D. a beautiful piece of iron works

62. The report said that although the country was rich.....formed a substantial part of the population.
A. old and neglected
B. the old and neglected
C. some old and some neglected
D. the olds and neglected
63. I had a phone call from her yesterday, so shehave found out my telephone number.
A. can B. could C. must D. might
64. I cannot imagine that a man.....his standing could stoop so low as to accept bribes.
A.with B.at C.of D.on
65. Lamin and Michael washed.....but mummy washed Yeanie.
A. himself B. themselves C. one another
D. the other
66. The principal has gone to Freetown and will come back in.....time.
A. two weeks B. two week C. two week's
D. two weeks'
67. The students have not come back from their school farms,..... ?
A. isn't it B. hadn't they C. didn't they D. have they
68. We haven't confirmed.....signature this is.
A. what B. whose C. who's D. which
69. I said "John saw Mary,".....?
A. didn't I B. didn't he C. hadn't he D. do I
70. The moon seemed to be sailing through the clouds.....a ship thrusting its way through a stormy ocean.
A. as B. as to C. as for D. like
71. The school's high jump champion has been.....
A. off very much form most of the time
B. very much off-form most of the time
C. very most off-form most of the time
D. off-form most of the time very much
72. The new bridge was a complete waste of money and..... built in the first place
A. need not have been
B. needs not have been
C. needed not to have been
D. need not to have been
73. Araba took up an appointment as a part-time instructor as a means.....his meager income.

- A. to supplement B. of supplementing
C. to supplementing D. for supplementing

74.opportunity we now have to rid the nation of corruption!
A. What excellent B. What an excellent
C. How excellent D. So excellent an

SECTION 6

*In the following passages, the numbered gaps indicate missing words. Against each number in the list below each passage, four options are given in columns lettered A to D. Choose the word that is the **most suitable** to fill the numbered gaps in the passages.*

PASSAGE A

One of the indicators of — 76 — underdevelopment in this country is the backward state of the transport sector. This is typified by the poor state of the railway — 77 —. In advanced countries, commuter trains carry passengers from city to city and within suburbs. The — 78 — train goes a lot faster connecting major cities and even states; such trains have — 79 — only.

In the intra-city trains, it is only shelter and seats that are provided. There are no — 80 —. In some cases, and because of the long hours of service of inter-city or inter-state trains, — 81 — and — 82 — are available in addition to coaches.

Apart from the very fast electric trains, there are passenger trains that are — 83 — powered. There are others that use coal or steam as — 84 —. Some trains offer — 85 — services, transporting goods. Such trains stop at specific — 86 — to deliver goods or to refuel. Most trains have — 87 — to push or pull them to prevent them from turning around.

A	B	C	D
76. structural	infrastructural	fiscal	systematic
77. system	framework	industry	cash fares
78. intra-city	inter-city	inter-city	sub-city
79. wagons	coaches	cabins	decks
80. book-shops and libraries	bars and clubs	meals and refreshments	bars and salons
81. dining cars	lunch tables	refectories	bars
82. closets	sleeping cars	cloakrooms	control suites
83. battery-	engine-	diesel-	solar-
84. petrol	alternative	converter	fuel
85. freight	delivery	postal	courier
86. check-points	outposts	stations	centres
87. gurdwaras	locomotives	compasses	bearings

PASSAGE B

It is interesting to watch a modern — 88 — spring up and get completed in a matter of months. A few months ago, a building company brought some — 89 — to the virgin forest next to our school. The trees were — 90 — the ground was cleared and — 91 —, and the workers brought out various — 92 — with which they measured and marked the — 93 —. Then the — 94 — was dug and the — 95 — were brought from somewhere else. — 96 — was made from a

mixture of sand, cement and water, and the walls grew before our very eyes. Before the end of the second month, we realized it was not going to be a —97 — but a storeyed building. The — 98 — was cast in only one day by the workers who — 99 — for the whole day. Thereafter, things moved even faster. By the end of the third month, the whole — 100 — was in place.

88	A	construction	B	building	C	erection	D	tabrication
89		trailers		bulldozers		tractors		machines
90		felled		pulled		cut		broken
91		levelled		paved		demolished		destroyed
92		apparatus		items		machinery		equipment
93		plan		franchises		ground		space
94		base		foundation		pavement		gutter
95		boresholes		linels		teraces		blocks
96		Concoction		Grave		Mentor		Compound
97		basement		mansion		bungalow		sky scraper
98		roofing		decking		floor		beam
99		struggled		grumbled		suffered		toiled
100		roof		edifice		wall		apartment

WASSCE JUNE 2008 ENGLISH LANGUAGE 2 OBJECTIVE TEST ANSWERS

1.A	2.D	3.A	4.C	5.C	6.C	7.A
8.B	9.C	10.A	11.D	12.D	13.B	14.A
15.B	16.B	17.B	18.D	19.B	20.D	21.C
22.D	23.A	24.D	25.A	26.B	27.C	28.C
29.C	30.B	31.A	32.A	33.B	34.C	35.C
36.A	37.A	38.B	39.C	40.D	41.A	42.B
43.D	44.D	45.B	46.A	47.C	48.A	49.B
50.B	51.A	52.B	53.D	54.C	55.B	56.D
57.A	58.C	59.D	60.C	61.C	62.B	63.C
64.C	65.B	66.A	67.D	68.B	69.A	70.D
71.B	72.D	73.B	74.B	75.	76.B	77.A
78.C	79.B	80.C	81.C	82.C	83.D	84.D
85.D	86.C	87.C	88.B	89.B	90.A	91.A
92.D	93.C	94.3	95.D	96.C	97.C	98.B
99.D	100.B					

WASSCE JUNE 2008 ENGLISH LANGUAGE 1 THEORY QUESTIONS

SECTION A

- You have learnt that your younger brother intends to involve himself in examination malpractice during the WASSCE. Write a letter to him warning him of the dangers of such an action and urging him to concentrate on his studies instead.
- Write an article suitable for publication in one of your national dailies discussing the vandalism of public facilities in your country and its effects.
- Write a letter to the Minister of Works in your country complaining about the deplorable condition of the roads in your area and the effects this has on the lives of your people.
- You are the chief speaker in a debate on the topic: The television has done more harm than good. Write your speech for or against the topic.
- Write a story to illustrate the saying: The early bird catches the worm.

SECTION B COMPREHENSION

- Read the following passage carefully and answer the questions on it.

I have great sympathy for the common fear that is suffered by young people when examinations are looming ahead. Sometimes it is the actual examination they fear but equally likely

to excite fear are the expectations of the parents who are keen on their offspring achieving good results. Pressure in these circumstances only leads to more fear and often results in failures which could be avoided.

My very last examination was an oral and I knew that everything depended on the kind of impression I made on the government representative who I expected, had difficult questions for me. This, though, was not the only reason for my apprehension. As a youth, I was often teased because I was small in stature. I was obsessed with it. I was very self-conscious, therefore, about meeting this important man. Fortunately, the previous day I had learned another lesson from nature, one which was to help me in my face-to-face encounter with the examiner.

I had been staying with my aunt and uncle in order to do some last-minute preparations. I went through my books that afternoon, sitting outside in the sunshine until about three o'clock, when the weather took a turn for the worse. The sky looked menacing and, as the clouds gathered in the distance, I heard the rumble of thunder. The lovely sunny afternoon was changing to a dark and dismal evening. Several times I broke my concentration to look at a very beautiful water lily in the pond. As I quickly gathered up my books, I remembered the lily and went over to see it for the last time that day. I was just in time to see the

flower close its petals as the rumble of the distant thunder grew louder. I didn't mind getting wet as I realised that the rain could do nothing to damage the delicate, inner beauty of the lily.

This simple act of nature restored my confidence and I realised that I too could muster courage to face the examiner. I could, in fact, protect the inner me from the outside world. My new-found philosophy worked! Of the eight people who sat for the examination that day, only two succeeded and the government representative congratulated me on being the youngest candidate ever to have passed.

I was lucky for I had learnt to control my obsession with my stature

(a) According to the writer, what two things excite fear in young people going for examinations?

(b) Give two reasons for the writer's apprehension before the examination.

(c) Why was the writer almost obsessed with his small stature?

(d) How did the observation of the lily affect the writer?

(e) What proof is there in the passage that the writer actually passed the exam?

(f) The sky looked menacing.....

What figure of speech is contained in this expression?

(g)because I was small in stature.

(i) What grammatical name, is given to this expression as it is used in the passage?

(ii) What is its function?

(h) For each of the following words, find another word or phrase which means the same and which can replace it as it is used in the passage:

(i) excite; (ii) offspring; (iii) apprehension; (iv) dismal; (v) delicate; (vi) muster.

7. *Read the following passage carefully and answer the questions on it.*

Work can be an essential part of children's education and a means of transmitting vital skills from parent to offspring. In some countries, children are often involved in workshops and small-scale services, and gradually become full-fledged workers later in life. In other countries, teenagers work a few hours a week to earn pocket money. Such work is beneficial as it enhances a child's physical, mental, spiritual, moral and social development without interfering with his schooling, recreation and rest.

Child labour, on the other hand, is about children who work long hours for low wages, often

under conditions harmful to their health. This type of work is destructive and exploitative. Child labour takes different forms. By and large, most child workers are in domestic service. Domestic service need not be hazardous, but it often is. Children in domestic service are poorly paid or not paid at all. Their masters set the terms and conditions of their work entirely to their whim. They are deprived of affection, schooling, play and social activity. They are also vulnerable to physical abuse.

Poverty is the most powerful force driving children into hazardous labour. For poor families, the small contribution of a child's income at home can make the difference between hunger and survival. The parents of child workers are often unemployed or underemployed. They are desperate for a secure income. In developing countries, for example, classrooms do not have seats, half of the students have no textbooks and half of the classrooms have no blackboards. It is not surprising that many children who attend such schools abandon schooling for work.

Child labour is aggravated by a modern society that is preoccupied with the demand for low-priced products. Few people seem to care that these may have been produced by millions of anonymous, exploited children. The effects of child labour on the psychological, emotional and intellectual growth of the victims are grave. Such children are deprived of affection. Beatings, insults and punishment by being deprived of food are very common. Ultimately, most child labourers are condemned to lifelong poverty, misery, sickness and illiteracy.

(a) Identify two types of work that are beneficial to children.

(b) According to the passage, what is child labour?

(c) Give two causes of child labour.

(d) In one word, describe the effect of child labour on the child.

(e) According to the passage, why do children drop out of school?

(f)who work long hours for low wages.....?

(i) What is the grammatical name given to this expression as it is used in the passage?

(ii) What is its function?

(g)most child labourers are condemned to lifelong poverty... What is the meaning of this expression?

(h) For each of the following words, find another word or phrase which means the same and which can replace it as it is used in the passage:

- (i) transmitting; (ii) enhances; (iii) vulnerable;
(iv)preoccupied; (v) anonymous; (vi) grave.

SECTION C SUMMARY

8. *Read the following passage carefully and answer the questions on it.*

Many cities in the world have now become overcrowded because everyday people migrate to them from the countryside in search of work and better living conditions. This problem is far worse in Third World countries, where the harsh living conditions and the lack of gainful employment opportunities in rural areas usually compel a ceaseless and massive rural-urban drift.

This desperate state of affairs is not without its dire consequences for the cities. Facilities like accommodation, schools, hospitals, water supply and public transport cannot cope with the demands on them from increased numbers of people, and so they are under severe strain. House rents soar astronomically, and so too many tenants crowd into inadequate spaces. Markets, streets and motor ways are congested with people and vehicles. And as the garbage disposal is inefficient, the garbage piles up everywhere, contributing to environmental pollution.

Many of the migrants come to the big cities in the hope of finding employment. However, because a majority of them are unskilled workers or fresh school-leavers not equipped in any way for gainful self-employment, they simply end up swelling the ranks of the desperate unemployed in the city.

The devil, they say, makes work for idle hands. With no means of livelihood in the relatively more expensive cities, many of these disillusioned young people resort to prostitution, fraud and crime in order to survive. No wonder the crime rate in the cities is for ever rising, and there are daily reports of victims who lose their money, possessions or even their lives to dare-devil robbers.

How can this deplorable state of affairs in the cities be reversed? Since the search for jobs accounts for much of the rural- urban drift, one way is to encourage the creation of jobs outside the cities. For example, certain businesses such as banks and manufacturing industries could be encouraged to set up branches in rural areas. If rural dwellers have ready access to the same jobs they go to look for in the city, the need for migrating will be reduced.

It should be admitted that in this modern age, life without the basic amenities of pipe-borne water, electricity, good roads, schools and hospitals is just not good enough. Many rural

dwellers are lured to the cities because of the lack of amenities, so providing them in these rural communities will not only contribute to stemming the tide of migration but also create a favourable environment for investment.

It has also been argued that rural farming is gradually being abandoned to the aged. The primitive, labour-intensive methods and the relatively low yields have made it unattractive to the youth, who would rather seek their fortune in the cities. If farming is made attractive, for example, through mechanization, it will become another source of employment for rural dwellers and thus reduce the necessity to migrate to the city.

Rural-urban migration causes a serious population imbalance, and has all sorts of attendant problems that can get worse if not tackled effectively. So the sooner a solution is sought the better.

(a) In three sentences one for each, summarize the three negative consequences of rural-urban migration discussed in the passage.

(b) In three sentences, one for each, summarize the writer's suggestions for tackling the problem.

WASSCE JUNE 2008 ENGLISH LANGUAGE 1 ESSAY ANSWERS

SECTION A

1. 3, Amodu Street,
Ehin-Iga Oba,
Itire,
Lagos.
12th June, 2008.

Dear Bayo,

How are you and your studies? I hope you are preparing very well for your coming final exams. It is my prayer that you record a sounding success in the exams.

The purpose of my writing you is to express and warn you against the dangers in examination malpractice.

As you must have been told several times before now that, examination malpractice which is a common phenomenon in most public examinations carries a penalty of twenty-one years jail term under decree of our constitution, I hereby warn you not to fall a victim because it will affect you so much and the plans on the ground daddy has for you.

Besides, where there is a report of examination malpractice, such centre stands the risk of cancellation of results and so you might not

be able to fulfil your desire of moving to the university. This would give a big set-back to the candidates concerned.

Bayo, I have known you as a serious and hard-working brother of mine, the moment you put yourself in the position of those seeking shadows in terms of runs' or certain help instead of sweating, you'll just discover that you will become a lazy drone in academics and you may end up as a failure. So, try and read your books and pray to your God for a big success in your exams and I believe God is able.

Let m not waste your precious time with too much talk on exam malpractice; I have sent the sum of five thousand naira to your account to help you buy necessary things as well as keep you buoyant throughout the period of y' ir exams. Spend wisely and face your studies. Greet your friends for me. My wife and children greet you. For now I say bye-bye.

Yours sincerely,
TUNDE

2. 17, Adedeji Street,
Surulere,
Lagos State.
24th July, 2008

The Editor,
Punch Newspapers,
1-7, Olu-Aboderin Street,
Onipetesi
Ikeja.

Dear Sir,

VANDALIZATION OF PUBLIC FACILITIES

I hereby write with deep sense of purpose and responsibility on mj person to first commend your news-paper - THE PUNCH for a job well-done in dishing out news and other information at the right time of expectation. I therefore write this article for publication as usual to discuss the spate of vandalization of public facilities in this country of ours.

It is a pain to see various public facilities being vandalized with impunity by some citizens of this country under the guise of saying "its the government property" without realising that we all appeared to suffer for such vandalization. A good example is the rate at which vandals vandalize pipes conveying petroleum products. It is now so rampant that instead of accosting or apprehending such people at the onset of their operations, nobody will care until the effect of such vandalization becomes a disaster, that is when we

would all cry foul, pushing the fault on government.

I felt dismay also at the rate people spoil public toilet. The public toilets provided by the government is to help ease the pains of those on the move to answer the call of nature. But to my surprise, most of those that are badly pressed earlier no sooner they are relieved, forget to flush thcir mess to leave room for others to also be relieved. They leave the 'thing' there and the accumulation of such leads to epidemic such as cholera, vomitting and other related diseases.

There is also the vandalization of portabe drinking water in most public taps. The cause of this is the over-turning of the tap knobs thereby making the tap lose grip of control and you find water spilling, over-flowing gutters and at the end shortage of water for the people themselves. All these are daily happenings of public facilities.

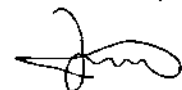
In view of these and other ones not mentioned, I hereby suggest possible solutions to the problem of vandalization of public facilities.

Firstly, people around where any public facility is should form vigilante groups o oversee the usage of such facilities to forestall vandalization.

Secondly, the government should give S.O.S telephone numbers around such facilities, these days of G.S.M phones, for concerned people to call in case of apprehending a vandal.

I think there would be a reduction in vandalization of public facilities if this write-up is looked into with a view to implementing it.

Yours faithfully,



Olukosi Babatunde

3. P.O. Box4210,
Marina,
Lagos State.
15th July, 2008.

The Director,
Environmental Protection Agency,
Block 6, Room 21,
Lagos State Secretariat,
Alausa
Ikeja.

Dear Sir,

**POOR CONDITION OF ROADS IN
IKATEAREAOF SURULERE**

It is pertinent to note that among the worst hit of the roads in Lagos State is that of Ikate area of Surulere Local Government. This is my area and to be candid we in this area have suffered so much that majority of us have learnt to do distant and long jumps perfectly that one of our recent bronze medalists of the 2008 Olympics emerged from Ikate area.

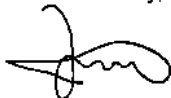
This is not a matter of laughter, it a matter that calls for concern and the well-being of my people in Ikate. Most of the gutters in Ikate have over-flowed into the streets and as such have left the roads always water-logged throughout the year.

Motorists and pedestrians are always at loggerheads over the splashing of black water on people. As a result of the linkages of most of the roads to various parts of Surulere and Mushin local government areas, there is always heavy traffic of vehicles on the waterlogged streets deepening the streets and roads as they make through it all the year round. The effect of this is the various potholes, gullies and dilapidated gutters where people often fall into always.

Most car-owners in Ikate have parked their cars in front of their houses due to constant change of spare parts most especially absorbers, bearings, brake pads and other related parts that almost ruined them.

In view of the above, I hereby call on the director of Environmental Protection Agency to come to the aid of my area as economic activities are almost grounded. Where this is done, I believe more revenue would accrue to the purse of the government and the life of the people safer.

Yours faithfully,



Olukosi Babs.

4. A speech delivered by Olukosi Babatunde on the proposition that the television has done more harm than good at a public symposium organised by Amodu Youths Club of Itire on the 26th December, 2008 at Itire community hall at 10.00am.

Mr chairman, president and members of Amodu Youths Club, distinguished ladies and gentlemen. I welcome you all to this symposium and at the same time thanking everybody for sparing your time at this yuletide to attend the activities of greater citizens of this town in years to come who have thought it wise and rightly too to

have chosen the topic: "The Television Has Done More Harm Than Good".

The television is a powerful medium that combines both the visual and audio functions into one system of communication. Many years back, it was the black and white television set with programmes that teach and entertain such as the cow-boy films and historical theatres on stage. But today, the colour television is even more attractive than its black and white type. It is beautiful, sleek, attractive and so powerful that its visuals lend credence to its weakness, you will agree with me.

The youths are no more focused, they are no more themselves, they can't think deeply again so far it is shown on television. The television has assumed the role of teacher. They learnt all sorts of things from the television. In this regard it is doing more harm than good. For example, the kind of dresses put on for shows on stage only are now the new thing in vogue exposing sensitive parts of their body leading to many exposed to sexual harassment, in this wise it has done more harm than good.

Materials not meant for them are openly shown to them unrestricted such as blue films, kidnappings, hooliganism and drugs. In a way of advert, they have learnt bad habits. For example, "cigarette is good for you", "Beer brings out the best in you". Considering the various choice of words of the advertisers, the television had done more harm than good.

I agree the television is a medium of education but where a student leaves home in the morning and branches at a friend's house or sneaks out of school to visit a friend that has video films and only selects pornographic ones via the television because the video can't show on its own, there they learnt various sexual acts with a resultant effect of a girl of fourteen years giving birth today — the one we call baby-mother. You'll agree with me that the television had done more harm than good to our youths in the society today. I am not saying that the television is bad, I have it at home. It is educative and informative but when it lost its credence to destructive tendencies, many of our youths become drop-outs, drug addicts, bullies and hooligans. These are bad effects of television that is why I say that the television has done more harm than good when we compare the behaviours of the youths in the society today than what it was in the past. Thank you for your attention.

5. *The Early Bird Catches the Worm*

Going back memory lane, the above saying reminded me about my recent past when I was in the junior secondary school where I came across two other boys that became my friends. My name is Tunde and my friends' names are Monday and Yakubu. We all wrote the 'Junior WAEC' and proceeded to the senior secondary.

The incident I am recollecting occurred on one of us Monday to be precise. At first, we were all hoping to become one professional or the other and consequently, we started to work towards such desires. Where we were thinking of becoming computerists, Monday was planning to become a computer technician. We asked him 'to be a computerist like us his friends i.e Tunde and Yakubu but he insisted he would want to be a computer technician.

As usual, and what students are in terms of pranks, we started making jest of Monday to the extent that other students in the school began to make jest of him too. They were calling him "computer mechanic". Myself and Yakubu thought we are the best.

Monday, to our surprise had begun lessons on computer technician course everyday after school. By the time we got to SS3, he had already started repairing faulty computers and had started making money.

No sooner we finished writing our final examinations, he had opened an office courtesy of his wealthy father. Today we thought he was foolish, we are the ones that are foolish for we too called on him in his office to effect repairs on our computers. We decided to learn the trade from him and because we were friends, he taught us and by the time we decided to open our own office, he had been well-known and we became underdogs because "The Early Bird Had Caught The Worm".

SECTION B COMPREHENSION

6. (a) The two things are:
(i) The examinations themselves
(ii) The pressure from parents
- b) Among the reasons are these two:
(i) The writer was conscious of his stature.
(ii) The writer expected to be asked difficult questions
- (c) This is because he was often teased.
- (d) It gave him confidence or courage.

(e) On passing the examination, the government representative congratulated him.

(f) It is a metaphor

(g)(i) Adverbial clause of reason (ii) It modifies the verb teased.

(h)(i) Excite-cause, arouse, create, bring about

(ii) Offspring — children.

(iii) Apprehension — fear, anxiety, worry

(iv) Dismal — gloomy, sombre, dull, dreary.

(v) Delicate — fragile, tender, frail (vi) Muster-gather, gather, summon, pluck up

7. (a)(i) Work that is a means of transmitting vital skills. (from parent to offspring) (ii) Work for earning pocket money
- (b) Child labour is when children work for long hours and for low wages under harmful conditions
- (c) The two causes are: (i) Poverty (ii) The demand for low priced goods
- (d) Harmful or devastating
- (e) The schools are ill-equipped or lack basic facilities
- (f)(i) Adjectival clause (ii) It qualifies the noun children
- (g) It means that most child labourers live in want throughout their lives.
- (h)(i) Transmitting - passing on, transferring
(ii) Enhances - improves, boosts, advances, reinforces, promotes
(iii) Vulnerable - prone, exposed, open, susceptible (iv) Preoccupied - engrossed, obsessed, concerned, engaged
(v) anonymous - nameless, unnamed, unidentified, unknown (vi) Grave - serious, profound, tremendous.

SECTION C SUMMARY

8. (a) (i) Rural-urban migration leads to congestion in cities (ii) It puts a strain on the facilities in cities.
(iii) It worsens unemployment in cities
(iv) It increases crime rate in cities.
- (b) (i) Jobs should be created in rural areas
(ii) Basic amenities should be provided in rural areas
(iii) Farming should be made more attractive in rural areas.

WASSCE JUNE 2008 ENGLISH LANGUAGE 3 TEST OF ORALS

(OBJECTIVE)

SECTION 1

From the words lettered A to D, choose the word that has the **same vowel sound** as the one represented by the letter(s) underlined. An example is given below.

Example: seat A. sit B. cite C. set D. key.

The correct answer is D because only key contains the same vowel sound as the one underlined in seat. Therefore, answer space D would be shaded.

[A] [B] [C] [D]

Now answer the questions that follow:

1. feast A. head B. caprice C. suffice D. practice
2. apple A. carry B. rather C. can't D. market
3. cost A. country B. associate C. month D. bother
4. sick A. marine B. tribunal C. knowledge D. vital
5. bullet A. bush B. hoof C. rude D. cull
6. mood A. crux B. crude C. book D. took
7. bed A. weight B. receive C. leisure D. height
8. supper A. don B. dove C. hovel D. super
9. lawn A. word B. purse C. wan D. sword
10. car A. aunt B. rack C. plan D. gaunt
11. tie A. chief B. relief C. buy D. belief
12. shout A. tough B. should C. drought D. mould
13. say A. heifer B. heinous C. either D. says
14. know A. stroll B. cloth C. rot D. loss
15. hear A. swear B. bear C. pear D. fear

SECTION 2

From the words lettered A to D, choose the word that has the **same consonant sound(s)** as the one represented by the letter(s) underlined. An example is given below.

Example: vice A. cat B. dress C. show D. chalk

The correct answer is B because only dress has the same consonant sound as the one underlined in vice. Therefore, answer space B would be shaded.

[A] [B] [C] [D]

Now, answer the questions that follow.

16. bang A. plunge B. singe C. mangle D. danger
17. smooth A. without B. ethics C. tooth D. panther
18. fad A. adjust B. adjective C. double D. adjourn
19. court A. city B. ocean C. cell D. hike
20. garb A. thumb B. stab C. limb D. climb
21. lump A. pain B. coup C. receipt D. phase
22. flash A. lunch B. choose C. ancient D. question
23. boat A. watch B. battled C. mortgage D. wrestle
24. gaze A. debris B. routes C. ways D. corpse
25. thick A. writhe B. weather C. rather D. wrath

26. sed A. reason B. resign C. mouths D. consult
27. pale A. luck B. alms C. chalk D. half
28. fact A. indict B. impact C. function D. diction
29. judge A. grandeur B. vision C. measure D. mirage
30. print A. fritter B. pleat C. blanket D. problem

SECTION 3

From the words lettered A to D, choose the word that **rhymes** with the given word. An example is given below.

Example: detain A. obtain B. detail C. claim D. relay

The correct answer is A because only detain rhymes with obtain. Therefore, answer space A would be shaded.

[A] [B] [C] [D]

Now answer the questions that follow. -

31. shirt A. hut B. surpass C. curt D. short
32. worry A. lorry B. curry C. awry D. furry
33. coven A. covenant B. oven C. cover D. covert
34. greenish A. foolish B. rakish C. tarnish D. churlish
35. wonder A. louder B. border C. neither D. asunder

SECTION 4

In each of the following questions, the main/primary stress is indicated by writing the syllable on which it occurs in capital letters.

From the words lettered A to D, choose the word that has the **correct stress**. An example is given below.

Example: democratic

- A. DE-mo-cra-tic B. de-MO-cra-tic
C. de-mo-CRA-tic D. de-mo-cra-TIC

The correct answer is C because the main/primary stress of the word democratic is on the third syllable. Therefore, answer space C would be shaded.

[A] [B] [C] [D]

Now answer the questions that follow.

36. moisturizer
A. MCI S—tur—iz—er B. mois—TUR—iz—er
C. mois—tur—I—Z—er D. mois—tur—iz—ER
37. neutrality
A. NEU—tral—i—ty B. neu—TRAL—i—ty
C. neu—tral—I—ty D. neu—tral-i—TY
38. catastrophic
A. CA—ta—stro—phic B. ca—TA—stro—phic
C. ca—ta—STRO—phic D. ca—ta--stro—PHIC

39. information
A. IN—for--ma—tion B. in-FOR--ma—lion
C. in—for—MA—tion D. in—for—ma -TION
40. electrify
A. L—lec--tri--fy B. e—LEC—tri—fy
C. e.—lec—TRI—fy B. e—lec—tri—FY

SECTION 5

*In the following options lettered A to D. all the words except one have the same stress pattern. Identify the one with the different **stress pattern** and shade your answer in the usual way. An example is given below.*

Example: A away B. apart C. behind D. river

Options A, B, C we all stressed on the second syllable while option D is the only one stressed on the first syllable. So, D is the correct answer. Therefore answer space D would be shaded.

[A] [B] [C] [D]

Now answer the questions that follow.

41. A. forfeit B. expert C. succour D. extent
42. A. concise B. defer C. exchange D. comment
43. A. entity B. decision C. attention D. expressway
44. A. satisfy B. congregate C. implicit D. bastardize
45. A. partisan B. prophecy C. millionaire D. saboteur

SECTION 6

*In each of the following sentences, the word that receives the **emphatic stress** is written in capital letters. From the questions lettered A to D, choose the one to which the given sentence is the appropriate answer. An example is given below*

Example: My mother's FRIEND hates pets.

- A. Does your mother's boss hate pets?
B. Does your mother's friend love pets?
C. Does your mother's friend hate toys?
D. Does your father's friend hate pets?

The correct answer is A because My mother's FRIEND hates pets answers the question, Does your mother's boss hate pets Therefore, answer space A would be shaded.

[A] [B] [C] [D]

Now answer the questions that follow

46. The principal often flogs ERRING pupils.
A. Does the principal often flog disciplined pupils?
B. Does the principal often ignore erring pupils?
C. Does the matron often flog erring pupils?
D. Does the principal often flog erring teachers?
47. My elder brother was appointed Minister of FINANCE.
A. Was your younger brother appointed Minister of Finance?

- B. Was your elder sister appointed Minister of Finance?
C. Was your elder brother appointed Commissioner for Finance?
D. Was your elder brother appointed Minister of Works?

48. Uncle Ben was FALSELY accused of stealing the money.
A. Was Auntie Sophia falsely accused of stealing the money?
B. Was Uncle Ben rightly accused of stealing the money?
C. Was Uncle Ben falsely accused of stealing the cheque?
D. Was Uncle Ben falsely accused of hiding the money?
49. The village head lived to be A HUNDRED years.
A. Did the family head live to be a hundred years?
B. Did the village priest live to be a hundred years?
C. Did the village head live to be ninety years?
D. Did the village head live to be a hundred months?
50. John told the old man to LEAVE the room.
A. Did Paul tell the old man to leave the room?
B. Did John tell the young man to leave the room?
C. Did John tell the old man to remain in the room?
D. Did John tell the old man to leave the compound?

SECTION 7

*From the words lettered A to D, choose the word that contains the sound represented by the given **phonetic symbol**. An example is given below.*

Example: /ɔ:/ A. yell B. holy C. boy D. idiot

The correct answer is C because only boy contains the sound represented by the given symbol. Therefore, answer space C would be shaded.

[A] [B] [C] [D]

Now answer the questions that follow.

51. /i:/ A. favourite B. police C. rice D. chief
52. /æ/ A. land B. dance C. task D. basket
53. /ɜ:/ A. judge B. month C. surprise D. surface
54. /ʊ/ A. water B. host C. model D. home
55. /ə/ A. hostel B. bone C. roster D. dove
56. /b/ A. amber B. doubt C. crumbs D. debt
57. /s/ A. resign B. deserve C. sense D. lose
58. /ɜ:/ A. gradual B. gender C. badge D. barrage
59. /tʃ/ A. chart B. chassis C. chemist D. choose
60. /h/ A. hospital B. vehicle C. honest D. hour

**WASSCE JUNE 2008 ENGLISH LANGUAGE 3
TEST**

1.D	2.C	3.D	4.A	5.A	6.B	7.C
8.B	9.D	10.B	11.C	12.C	13.B	14.A
15.D	16.C	17.A	18.C	19.D	20.B	21.A
22.C	23.B	24.C	25.D	26.D	27.A	28.B

29.B	30.D	31.C	32.B	33.B	34.C	35.D
36.A	37.B	38.C	39.C	40.B	41.B	42.D
43.D	44.D	45.B	46.A	47.D	48.B	49.C
50.C	51.B	52.A	53.A	54.C	55.B	56.A
57.C	58.D	59.B	60.A			

SENIOR SCHOOL CERTIFICATE EXAMINATION (SSCE 1988 – 2015)

Past Questions with Solutions

English Language

(Theory / Objectives with Oral English) 2009

WASSCE JUNE 2009 ENGLISH LANGUAGE 2 OBJECTIVE TEST QUESTIONS

SECTION 1

*In each of the following sentences, there is one underlined word and one gap. From the list of words lettered A to D, choose the one that is **most nearly opposite in meaning** to the underlined word and that will, at the same time, correctly fill the gap in the sentence.*

1. It was a very harmonious meeting, without one..... note.
A. divergent B. adverse C. discordant D. strident
2. The man was accused of premeditated murder but he pleaded that it was.....
A. determined B. accidental C. planned D. contrived
3. We nearly lost the trend of his argument because of its complexity but the.....of his language was our Saving grace
A. simplicity B. correctness C. openness D. naivety
4. Uche achieved ultimate success after overcoming many.....difficulties.
A. grave B. challenging C. first D. initial
5. I should know what to do in normal circumstances but this is a very..... situation.
A. different B. unlikely C. unusual D. improbable
6. Bola is quite extravagant whereas his wife is.....
A. considerate B. ordinary C. wasteful D. thrifty.
7. This is quite surprising, you cannot differentiate between the authentic and the..... receipt.
A. false B. fake C. wrong D. illegal
8. Many people objected to the demolition of the toll gates whose.....cost millions of dollars.
A. contruction B. formation C. maintenance D. design
9. To some people, that custom is repugnant but to others it is.....
A. captivating B. delightful C. popular D. acceptable

10. While the armed robber remained unruffled after he had been arrested, his wife became.....
A. defiant B. rude C. agitated D. energetic

SECTION 2

*From the words lettered A to D, choose the word that **best completes** each of the following sentences.*

11. Many people were seriously injured in the..... accident, fortunately, nobody died.
A. ghastly B. fatal C. reckless D. dangerous
12. The editor decided not to publish the..... article since the writer did not indicate his name.
A. unmarked B. unlabelled C. anonymous D. stamped
13. Dende did not fulfil the requirement for admission and so was..... from taking the entrance examination.
A. removed B. disqualified C. convicted D. implicated
14. The murder suspect derved the grave allegations against him but the evidence so far has..... him.
A. corroborated B. impeached C. convicted D. implicated.
15. It was quite.....to have invested in that new business.
A. prosperous B. sufficient C. profitable D. successful
16. The President granted the condemned prisoner a.....
A. reprieve B. remission C. bail D. chance
17. It was difficult for the doctor to..... the patient's ailment.
A. discover B. decide C. divine D. diagnose
18. They wished her..... of the season.
A. compliments B. compliment C. complement D. complements
19. Chief Koko never allows his name to be published in connection with his philanthropic activities because he..... publicity.
A lacks B. cherishes C. detests D. understands

20. A befitting.....was paid to the memory of the departed renowned professor, playwright and cramatist.
A. tribute B. reward C. contribution D. praise

SECTION 3

*After each of the following sentences, a list of possible interpretations is given. Choose the interpretation that you consider **most appropriate** for each sentence.*

21. The accused was caught red-handed by the police. This means that the accused was
A. made to wear red gloves.
B. thought to be in danger.
C. found in the very act.
D. found covered with blood.
22. The greatest problem of the leader is that he can see no further than his nose. This means that the leader
A. lacks foresight. B. has bad sight.
C. is easily deceived. D. has no self-confidence.
23. He left the country to avoid loss of face. This means that he left the country to
A. make his fortune somewhere else.
B. seek revenge. C. seek refuge.
D. avoid being publicly humiliated.
24. John was not really angry with Janet but she seems to have taken the matter very much to heart. This means that Janet
A. does not like him.
B. is very upset about the matter.
C. has taken the matter very lightly.
D. has had a serious talk with him.
25. His driving made my hair stand on end. This means that his driving was
A. delightful. B. frightening. C. interesting.
D. excting.
26. When the riot broke out in th school, only the Principal kept his head. This means that only the Principal
A. was not injured. B. held his head high.
C. remained calm. D. hid himself.
27. Grace failed Mathematics last year but she has promised to turn over a new leaf this year. This means that this year Grace will
A. be more vigilant.
B. work harder.
C. cling to her books.
D. examine both sides of a leaf.

28. The woman supported her husband through thick and thin. This means that she supported her husband
A. in both good and bad health.
B. when he was fat and when he got thin.
C. whether he was behaving well or badly.
D. in both good and bad circumstances.
29. Jumai thinks she is always right but I am determined to catch her out. This means that I am determined to
A. arrest her.
B. confront her.
C. prove that she can make a mistake.
D. make her agree that I am right.
30. The preacher advised those who lost their property in the fire disaster not to lose hope as every cloud has a silver lining. This means that
A. there is a good side to all misfortunes.
B. when there is life there is hope.
C. to lose is a common occurrence.
D. everybody must encounter misfortune in life.

SECTION 4

*From the words or group of words letterred. A to D below each of the following sentences, choose the word or group of words that is **nearest in meaning** to the underlined word or group of words as itis used in the sentences.*

31. I concede that I am wrong on this point.
A. admit B. pledge C. declare D. conclude
32. Within a short time, what was meant to be a peaceful demonstration escalated into a riot,
A. rose B. elevated C. expanded D. developed
33. The students were incensed to hear that their school fees had been substantially increased.
A. enraged B. disappointed C. displeased
D. frightened
34. The flood that swept away the whole village was a catastrophic event.
A. an unfortunate B. a disastrous C. a devilish
D. an infuriating
35. The box contains the most valuable of all his possessions.
A. beautiful B. costly C. useful D. admirable
36. The decision I have taken is irrevocable.
A. inapplicable B. unacceptable C. irreversible
D. irregular

37. I am delighted to speak before this august assembly.
A. monthly B. popular C. crowded D. honourable
38. The chairman ended the meeting of the Cooperative society with a fitting speech.
A. a short B. an improved C. an appropriate D. a brief
39. That class is unusually disorderly today.
A. unruly B. lawless C. unrestrained D. aggressive
40. The report given by the boy is sustaintially correct and we have to decide what to do about it.
A. completely B. largely C. probably D. understandably

SECTION 5

*From the word or group of words lettered A to D, choose the word or group of words that **best completes** each of the following sentences.*

41. The new economic policy took—— last year.
A. out B. off C. of D. up
42. I'll look out..... you at the stadium.
A. for B. at C. to D. on
43. The men were reported.....the money fraudulently.
A. to take B. to have taken C. to having taken D. to be taking
44. The boy's father made him.....the medicine against his will.
A. swallow B. to swallow C. .wnllowcd D. to have swallowed
45. The bridge wasx blown.....by enemy soldiers.
A. out B. off C. through D. up
46. Chukwurni explained that he..... home early yesterday to be able to catch the early bus.
A has to leave B has left C. had to leave D. was leaving
47.he comes, tell him I have left.
A. Should B. Should in case C. In case D. Whether
48. Many a player.....to score a goal so as to be highly honoured.
A. is wanting B. wants C. want D. have wanted
49. You.....to know that you cannot succeed without hard work.

A. are supposed B. supposed C. uppc.
D are suppose

50. By the time I left the police station, the suspect.....
A. was been questioned
B. was been question
C. was lwing questioned
D. was being question.
51. Mary has two dwsses, one is dirty,.....is wet
A. either B. another C. each D. the other
52. That house across the road is.....isn't it?
A. their B. theirs C. their's D. theirs'
53. Mr. Bellow with his wife and children,..... to the United States
A. are travelling B. have travelled C. is travelling D. had travel
54. The studnns refused to appeam before the..... panel set up to investigate the cause of the riot.
A. to-men B. ten-man C. ten-man's D. ten-men's
55. The hardened criminal was convicted.....the charges.
A. of B. on C. for D. over
56. I enjoy.....my grandson to school everyday.
A. to drive B. to driving C. driving D. drive
57. It seems that 'he children are not paying attention.....?
A. aren't they B. doesn't it C isn't it D. dent they
58. We knew you were not averse to.....new friends.
A. meeting B. meet C. having met D. have met
59. We should have a special proqramme for..... in this country.
A. the disableds B. disabled C. the disables D. the disabled
60. Neittwr these girls nor that boy.....to blame for the error.
A. are B. were C. is D. have
61. The peppel ha been ——-. by my sister.
A ground B. grind C. grounded D. grinding
62. Mr. Jab r a regular visitor of.....
A. our own B. our's C. ours' D. ours.
63. I got into the room and discovered that there wasn't.....there.

A. no one B. someone C. anyone D. none

64. It is too abstract.....concept for them to understand.

A. of a B. as C. for a D. a

65. Emmanuel is a man.....great courage.

A. about B. of C. by D. for

66. The lady enjoyed the dance.....the fact that she had a fever.

A. knowing B. in spite C. even D. despite

67. The children are alt very enthusiastic.....the forthcoming festival.

A. for B. about C. on D. with

68. Hardly had the family settled down for Mummy's special dinner.....the lights went off.

A. and B. than C. so D. When

69. The African eytended family system gves security to.....members.

A. his B. her C. its D. their

70. The philanthropist has donated a..... machines to the village school.

A. modern duplicating large
B. large modern riuclicating
C. large duplicating modern
D. modern large duplicating

71. Perhaps what Akin told us..... true after all.

A. may not be B. should not be C. must not be
D. shall not be

72. The nurse inoculated..... pupil in the class.

A. all B. every C. many D. those

73. Well, lye only got —— naira notes, hut you can have twenty naira.

A. small B. few C. a few D. little

74. Sub hs been trying hard to live.....to his parent's expectations.

A. up B. over C. on D. in

SECTION 6

In the following passages, the numbered gaps indicate missing words. Against each number in the list below each passage, four options are given in columns lettered A to D. Choose the word that is the most suitable to fill the numbered gvaps in the passages.

PASSAGE A

The main — 73 — of malaria are regular — 76 — of high — 77 —. The — 78 — is caused by — 79 —, which are carried by the . 80 — anophles mosquito. The mosquito is infected when it bites a man who is already carrying malaria parasites in his — 81 - if the mosquito bites another person after about two weeks, the disease is immediately — 82 — to him. After about ten days, the man experiences general weakness, — 83 —, fever and sweating. In order to prevent malaria. moquitoes must be — 84 — ' and their — 85 — grounds must be completely destroyed. Patients must be treated promptly, and people who travel to regions of malaria should take prophylactic — 88 — to prevent - —.

	A	B	C	D
75.	Weaknesses	signals	symptoms	signs
76.	graps	attacks	problems	disturbances
77.	penicure	inasion	mood	fever
78.	disease	discomfort	plague	upset
79.	germs	worms	parasites	flies
80.	male	female	injure	one way
81.	body	brain	blood	eyes
82.	turned	transmitted	directed	supplied
83.	handicaps	headache	dislocation	spasms
84.	new, old	weakened	crushed	eliminated
85.	breathing	living	breeding	growing
86.	action	checks	treatment	directed
87.	affection	infection	collapse	stress

PASSAGE B

Fishing is one of the overlooked sports in this part of the world. It really requires very little and inexpensive — 88 —. While you enjoy the sport, you will be getting food for your efforts as — 89 — is highly nutritious. A fisherman can use a simple pole and — 90 — which are not expensive or a rod and reel, to fish. The standared fishinj method is to put a — 91 — or — 92 — on a hook. The fish will see this and nibble at it, strike it or snap.at it. When the fish tries to eat it, the — 93 — catches it in the throat.

It is also good to use — 94 — for fishing equipment. These indicate when a fish is nibbling at the bait. This method is more reliable than to watch for — 95 — on the water surface. Fishermen who fish on a small — 96 — do so from the river — 97 — and some row in boats to the middle of the river. Large-scale fishing needs the use of fishing—98 — which go to sea and — 99—are used to — 100 — big fishes. Alot of hazards are faced by fishermen on sea.

	A	B	C	D
88.	equipment	machinery	implements	apparatus
89.	salmon	fish	markorel	sardine
90.	rope	wire	cord	thread
91.	gnat	bait	worm	fly
92.	fish	meat	chaff	lure
93.	needle	hook	pin	line
94.	floats	rats	rafts	planks
95.	waves	bulbles	flum	signs
96.	land	sea	scale	base
97.	embankment	bank	cliff	bridge
98.	ships	trawlers	canoes	boats
99.	crates	baskets	nets	cages
100.	catch	get	kil	attract

1.C	2.B	3.A	4.D	5.C	6.D	7.B	8.A	9.D	10.C
11.A	12.C	13.B	14.D	15.C	16.A	17.D	18.A	19.C	20.A
21.C	22.A	23.D	24.B	25.B	26.C	27.B	28.D	29.C	30.A
31.A	32.D	33.A	34.B	35.B	36.C	37.D	38.C	39.A	40.B
41.B	42.A	43.B	44.A	45.D	46.C	47.C	48.B	49.A	50.C
51.D	52.B	53.C	54.B	55.A	56.C	57.C	58.A	59.D	60.C
61.A	62.D	63.C	64.D	65.B	66.D	67.B	68.D	69.C	70.B
71.A	72.B	73.B	74.A	75.C	76.B	77.D	78.A	79.C	80.D
81.C	82.B	83.A	84.D	85.C	86.C	87.B	88.A	89.B	90.A
91.B	92.D	93.B	94.A	95.A	96.C	97.B	98.B	99.C	100.A

WASSCE JUNE 2009 ENGLISH LANGUAGE 1 THEORY QUESTIONS

SECTION A

1. You have been staying with your elder brother for sometime and a misunderstanding has ensued. Write a letter to your father giving, at least, three reasons why you feel you can no longer live with your brother.
2. You recently took part in an excursion to a part of the country you were visiting for the first time. Write an article for publication in your school magazine narrating your experiences.
3. As a concerned student, write a letter to the Principal of your school informing him of recent acts of bullying by senior students and suggesting ways of arresting the situation.
4. You are the Chief Speaker in a debate on the topic: Parents should allow their children to choose their own careers. Write your speech for or against the topic. .
5. Write a story, real or imaginary which ends with: I then realized that it pays to be disciplined."

SECTION D COMPREHENSION

6. **Read the following passage carefully and answer the questions on it.**

I can vividly remember my predicament in my first year as a new teacher. On the first day in class, I told my students that they were mature enough to comport themselves in an exemplary manner without burdening them with stringent rules. I wanted them to like me and so I allowed them a lot of freedom. Unfortunately, I lost class control, and the students exploited the situation to disrespect me. Some would leave their seats without permission; freely throw objects like pens, rulers or crumpled pieces of paper to mates or talk with others.

During the long vacation, I busied myself reading books on discipline and consulting seasoned colleagues for help. When we resumed school the next session, I had formulated strategies on maintaining discipline. There were laid-down rules such as "students are to be courteous and silent when the teacher or a

student is speaking to the class." "Students are to ask for the teacher's permission to leave their seats for anything", "Students are not to leave the class during lessons."

After giving the class the rules that I knew were essential for class control, I made sure the students followed them to the letter. I virtually enforced discipline myself instead of sending students to the Principal's office for disciplinary action as I did the previous year. After about a month, I realized that my efforts were yielding results.

Then, two months before the Christmas holidays, I began to relax some of the rules. One of them read as follows:

"Whenever any student wants to leave the class for any reason, he should come up for permission, provided he does this without disturbing other students." About one week later, I told the students that because they were not disruptive, they could whisper to one another, open or shut windows quietly without my permission.

Indeed, before the second term holidays, we had a classroom where students would come in and go on recess as they finished their class assignments and also where small group discussions on project work took place. Where a student in one group talked too loudly to disturb others, he was cautioned by the group, not me. Teaching then became a pleasure and I felt my students had matured greatly by learning to conduct themselves in a more acceptable way.

(a) Why did the writer not give his students rules initially?

(b) What was the outcome of the writer's desire for the students to like him?

(c) How did the students react to the writer's loss of class control?

(d) What did the writer do to change the unfortunate development in the class?

(e) What helped the writer to formulate measures to maintain discipline in class?

(f) "..... before the second term holidays..."

- (i) What grammatical name is given to this expression as it is used in the passage?
(ii) What is its function?
- (g) "... I made sure that the students followed them to the letter."
What does the writer mean by this statement as it is used in the passage?
- (h) For each of the following words, find another word or phrase which means the same and which can replace it as it is used in the passage:
(i) stringent: (ii) strategies: (iii) courteous:
(iv) essential: (v) yielding: (vi) cautioned.

7. *Read the following passage **carefully** and answer the questions on it.*

There is a fierce war going on in Africa which has attracted little public attention, but is nonetheless a serious business for all concerned. It is a war of Man versus Baboon. The conflict started when engineers built the magnificent bridge which skirts Victoria Falls and crosses the Zambesi River. That, apparently, gave the baboons the opportunity they were looking for. They swarmed from the jungle across the bridge in such numbers that trains were held up by chattering families of baboons. They swung from the girders and barked defiance at everyone — driver, guard and passenger.

Recently, guests at the new tourist hotel at Victoria Falls have complained that trousers and other articles of clothing have been disappearing mysteriously at night. Socks, with suspenders attached, were found dangling from tree-tops in the nearby bush and it was realized that the baboons, not thieves, were the culprits. From that time, baboons became the declared enemy: Guests were entreated not to give them buns on the lawn at tea-time or encourage them in any other way.

A period of comparative peace followed, and then, a few weeks later, the baboons embarked on a new campaign at the new international airport at Livingstone. At first they confined themselves to racing across the runways when planes were coming in to land, but when one of them was found asleep in the cockpit of a southbound airliner, it was felt that the time had come for a drastic action. Then the authorities installed electric flares embedded in concrete alongside the runways. Only once did the baboons demonstrate in full force against the glare of the lights, attacking with sticks, stones and fists: but the light stood up to the onslaught and the attackers retreated.

The next stage in this strange conflict will be the erection of an electrified fence round the perimeter of the airport. Such shock tactics, it is expected, will result in the baboons conceding defeat and completely abandoning their guerilla warfare. But grey-headed Matabeles who have dwelt all their lives in the Zambesi Valley shake their heads gloomily. They have a legend that if the baboons disappear from Victoria Falls the river will dry up, and 'The smoke that Thunders' will thunder no more.

- (a) What was the reaction of the baboons after the new bridge had been built?
(b) What incident caused those in control at the airport to deal seriously with the baboons?
(c) What did the airport authorities do to forestall further intrusion by the baboons?
(c) What does the writer suggest as the final solution to the baboon problem?
(e), What fear do the Matabeles have about the efforts to get rid of the baboons?
(f) "...the lights stood up to the onslaught..."
What figure of speech is contained in the expression above?
(g) ".....guests at the new tourist hotel at Victoria Falls..."
(i) What grammatical name is given to this expression as it is used in the passage? (ii) What is its function?
(h) For each of the following words, find another word or phrase which means the same and which can replace it as it is used in the passage:
(i) magnificent; (ii) culprits: (iii) entreated:
(iv) drastic; (v) conflict; (vi) gloomily

SECTION C SUMMARY

8. *Read the following passage **carefully** and answer the questions on it*

The press is a general term for all types of printed newspapers and periodicals. It is an asset as well as a menace to society. Like many things in this world, it has its good and bad sides. Even though it has its bad sides, no society can shut it down and thrive.

The press has its aims and objectives which it follows, come what may. Anyone who wants to be abreast of current affairs or notable events in his society must resort to reading printed material, apart from watching the television. In fact, the press sees more people than the electronic media do. Newspapers and periodicals go where the television cannot. Printed material goes even to the remotest areas of a country.

Institutions of learning disseminate information. However, not all cities, towns and

villages have these institutions, but the print media can be used to disseminate information to people in these areas.

Governments, institutions and organizations have their policies, programmes and activities for the smooth running of their affairs. At times, those in authority reap the benefits. Subordinates are often afraid to criticize the authorities. Their best bet is to resort to the print media which become their mouthpiece. Thus, what the oppressed cannot do, the print media do without fear or favour.

The press is also at the beck and call of anybody who wants its services. Many a time one sees people going job-hunting. They roam the streets of cities and towns, go from one office to the other, move from one employing authority to another only to be told that vacancies do not exist. To be candid, they do not need to waste such time and energy seeking jobs. All they need to do is comb the advertisement columns of newspapers and periodicals and they will be informed about available jobs.

However, the press can be a nuisance in a society. How many times have we not found newspapers and periodicals publishing false and unauthenticated stories? Such stories spread like wild fire. They stir trouble and bring about disunity in societies. The publishers are often out to enrich themselves by churning out false information. For some newspapers and periodicals, reckless and dangerous gossip is their stock-in-trade.

No one can deny the fact that moral decadence has gripped our present world. It is true that even adults contribute to this menace in our societies. Many of our children and youths go for that which is morally low. However, the truth is that the press contributes, to a very large extent, to the loss of morality in our societies. There are publishers who specialise in the production of pornographic material which even our children and youths can afford to buy.

Publishers of newspapers therefore should constantly be conscious of their crucial roles in the society and should always strive to use the medium for the promotion of peace, orderliness, progress and prosperity and not for negative or destructive ends.

(a) In four sentences, one for each, state four positive roles of the press according to the writer

(b) In two sentences, one for each, state two negative roles of the press

WASSCE JUNE 2009 ENGLISH LANGUAGE 1 ESSAY ANSWERS

SECTION A

1. 3, Amodu Street,
Itire,
Mushin,
Lagos,
7th July, 2009.

Dear Father,

I'm indeed very happy to write this letter to you. How are you and my mummy sir? I hope you are all fine; if so glory be to God.

Dad, I am writing this letter with sadness because my staying with brother Femi is becoming something I never bargained for. First and foremost, his wife whom you think is the one teaching him all bad things he's doing to me is not the one after all. Though she has her own problems but brother Femi himself is a big case.

As you have known before, the last time we fought over food that I refused to eat what his wife gave me to eat because it was an eyesore, a left over, you settled it and we continued. This time around, brother Femi has changed to drinking beer and he always come home dead drunk. The problem associated with this drinking and late arrival from work goes beyond my imagination.

Every morning of the second day of his drunkenness is a problem of "somebody has stolen my money". He would not remember how he had spent the previous night and start accusing myself and his wife. Before I know what is happening, barrages of slaps would have poured on me. This has happened so many times that I have become a laughing stock in our house.

The third reason why I would no longer live with them again is that my brother no more trust me over his escapades with women whenever his wife catches him. The wife sees me as his errand boy to the women and if this continues, I might cause, a fight between the two of them.

Finally dad, I am using this medium to inform you that, now that I have finished my school certificate examination, I shall by the grace of God return to you and leave my brother and his wife alone.

Greetings to my junior ones and everybody over there. Till I return, bye for now.

Your lovely son,
Tunde Olukosi

2. AN EXCURSION TO EPE ALARO

It was a dream come true to majority of us who believed that we know more about Lagos State where we came to school for our Secondary education from Abeokuta in Ogun State when our Agricultural teacher Mr. Odaranile popularly known as "T. J." by his colleagues told us that we would be visiting Epe town on excursion as part of our studies in fishery in aquaculture.

Epe town was chosen due to its environment where fish farming is prominent. There was so much of excitement in school that day that even those who are not Agricultural Science students also wanted to go. The reason for the excitement was that we are going to have much fun at Epe in terms of seeing the farmers fishing in their canoes and local trawlers with plenty of fish for us to eat and study.

We left the school compound in a hired Luxury bus with lots of songs and chattering of the girls who perhaps are agoraphobia but like the sight of big water that is in Epe as we were told.

Our bus has a little hitch with the traffic on Eko Bridge as a result of traffic jam but by the time we got to Marina in Lagos towards Bonny Camp, the road became free and we were right there on the road to Lekki Epe road.

We saw a lot of high rise buildings with various beautiful scenes on the road at the express road after the third roundabout.

Before we know it, we came to the Julius Berger Bridge which was used as the road office of those that built the road and after about five to seven minutes, we entered the ancient town of Epe.

Because arrangement had been made by our Agric teacher, we were taken to the sea side straight by a guide - an old man whose name we later knew as Mr. Olukosi who the people around called Baba Kekere Eleja Aro. Our Agric. class captain Miss Tooki was the first to ask him the question of why Epe was called Epe Alaro. He laughed before he gave his answer that the term 'eleja aro' is not complete if one fails to add the name of the founder of Epe town to the term and that he gave a Ogunmodede; so it was "Epe Eleja Aro Omo Ogunmodede" The old man told us that Eleja Aro-"Cat fish" is so many their are'á that it became part of its name.

There was this woman Mama Falade who was the leader of the fish sellers there at Epe. She told us that she has been in the business of the catfish for over thirty years. Our teacher Mr. Odaranile requested from her to have a taste of what they have She obliged but that we should be taken round the sea in an engine boat. At first, I was scared with some students but when others

got into the boat, I joined them. The boat ride was so interesting. We came across many canoes, boats, and fish trawlers on each catching fish.

After about one hour on the sea, we came back to the shore only to meet Mama Falade with fresh catfish soup with hot eba to go with it as her gift to us as school children. Our teacher gave us the order to eat as many of us were already hungry. In fact, I ate to my satisfaction with chunk of fish in my mouth unable to drink water again.

If not for the Oro festival that was to take place at Epe that day, we would have slept there and have a trip round the town. but it was too late and we thanked all the people for their warm reception and their parting gifts of plenty Aro (catfish) back to our school and truly it is really Epe Alaro Omo Ogunmodede.

3. Hostel 'A', Room 5,
Jakande Block,
Gbaja Community High School,
Surulere.
14th August, 2009.

The Principal,
Gbaja Community High School,
Surulere,
Lagos.

Sir,

BULLYING BY SENIOR STUDENTS

I write to inform you as a concerned student of this our great school 'Gbaja Community High School of the kind of bullying by the senior students, to their juniors.

It started as a child's play when a senior student will call a junior and beg for money or provision such as milk, butter, sardine or students' saviour-garri. Willingly, such junior will give out but now, it has become a force by the senior ones to take those things from their junior students. Where this is not given, such a junior will be punished on flimsy excuses such as bringing garri to school that it is against the rules.

Recently, this habit has now escalated into petty-robbery by senior students calling on any junior that passes through the senior block to be 'arrested' and ransacked during which any money found on them becomes 'impounded' as a bail to their offence of going through the senior block.

Most of the juniors are now wise and are thus forming groups to forestall trouble with the seniors anytime from next week Monday. It is in

the light of this that I write to you to nib the problem in the bud before it grows into fruition.

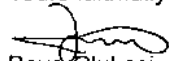
I therefore suggest that one, before any senior should punish a junior student, report must first be made to the hostel master or the class teacher who will investigate and take the right action.

Secondly, junior students should have access to the hostel masters so as to report directly what used to happen to them.

Finally, sir call all the seniors to order so as not to make the junior students become wild so that they will not disrupt all academic works because of their annoyance.

I thank you for your good work in the school and I know action will follow this letter of mine.

Yours faithfully


Bayo Olukosi
SS 3A

4. PARENTS SHOULD ALLOW THEIR CHILDREN TO CHOOSE THEIR OWN CAREERS

Good day Mr. Chairman, Panel of Judges, Accurate Time Keeper, Co-debaters, ever attentive audience, Distinguished Ladies and Gentlemen. My name is Olukosi Adebayo, I stand before you today to lend credence to the topic which says that" Parents Should Allow Their Children to Choose Their Own Careers.

It is pertinent to note nowadays that majority of parents are the ones choosing careers for their children with so many reasons of theirs that border on their advantages and not that of the children concerned. A good example are the beliefs of lawyers and Accountants who are forcing their children to take up their careers. That is why majority of their children are always hand in glove with their parents. The result of this is failure of so many ventures because the children lack the essential interest and personal connectivity require, so parents should allow their children to choose their own career.

Apart from this, self confidence that is needed to be the driving force of the child whose career was chosen for to carry on in later years when his or her parents are no more would only satisfy their parents' wish and after changed to his heart desired career and would be well known in that career. There are so many like that and a good old memory example is the Late Afro-beat King Fela Anikulapokuti whose parents wanted him to become a Medical Doctor but satisfied their dictate till he got to London where he changed to music. Is this not so my ever attentive audience?

So parents should allow their children to choose their own career.

Ladies and gentlemen, I want you to know that "a thing of beauty is a joy for ever "If parents should allow their children to choose their own careers, an everlasting joy is what is being sowed but where it is a force of career, my question is, "are you the parents that would do the job for him or her? For this is a piece of thought because I am quite sure that no parent wants a failure as a child, if my thinking is the same with yours, then allow your child to choose his or her own career because when in the future ere is the otherwise, no parent will be blamed as it is t'day with even some parents that used to say if not my parents, I would have been something else.

In conclusion, I hope you'll agree with me that parents, should allow their children to choose their own careers. Thank you

5. IT PAYS TO BE DISCIPLINED

Before my father answered the glorious call, he used to call us together and advised us his children to be disciplined for as he said, discipline should be our watch word. Most of what he used to say that time were not fully understood until when he is no more that everything stared me and others in the face. That is why I base my story on the fact that it pays to be disciplined.

It came to pass as a child's play to an adult when it comes to reality of life as against all our desires while in school that I wanted to be this and that in life.

This story reminded me and those of my friends from other states who are classmates of mine that as soon as we pass out of secondary school, we shall be into business. What business entails we don't know but the ultimate desire then was to be rich, live in flats and drive what is known today as state of the art cars.

To God be the glory, today many of those my mates are in various jail homes across the globe. They went into the fast lane and no sooner that we finished than they secured clerical work in the Ministry of Agriculture and Minerals. I was still looking for two other papers - Economics and Mathematics to make up my five papers for JAMB admission.

Each time they visited me, it would be enjoyment galore and when leaving, they will give me dash of at least ten-ten thousand each. Sometimes it would be twenty or thirty thousand cash. At a time, I nearly lost the interest of schooling.

Not quite sometime when they visited me last was when one of them came to me for shelter in the night that the police were after them. I asked of his and their offences he only told me you'll soon know. True to his talk, I later realised that they are into drug peddling across some border.

I became so much afraid and wanted them to leave me alone but when they reminded me of their past 'gifts' I allowed them. After some weeks, they sort their ways and the next I heard was that they had travelled to Saudi-Arabia that they continued their drug deals and were arrested and sentenced to death.

If not my restrained and self-discipline, I would have joined them but I remember my father's advice and I then realised that it pays to be disciplined.

SECTION B COMPREHENSION

6. (a) He thought that the students were mature to comport themselves well in class.
(b) He allowed them a lot of freedom.
(c) The students misbehaved in class.
(d) The writer gave the students rules and enforced them.
(e) The writer read books on discipline and sought help from his colleagues.
(f)(i) An adverbial phrase of time. (ii) It modifies the verb "had"
(g) It means that he made sure that the students obeyed the rules strictly
(h)(i) Stringent — strict, severe, stiff, rigid, tight
(ii) strategies — plans, measures
(iii) Courteous — respectful, well-mannered
(iv) essential — important, necessary, useful, crucial

(v) Yielding — producing, showing. (vi) Cautioned — warned, reprimand, call to order.

7. (a) The baboons swarmed across the bridge.
(b) The sleeping of a baboon in the cockpit of a plane.
(d) They installed electric flares along side the runways.
(d) The writer suggested the building of an electrified fence round the airport
(e) The Matabeles fear that if the baboons are got rid of, the river will dry up and the smoke that thunders will cease.
(f) Personification
(g) Noun phrase (ii) Subject of the verb 'have complained'
(h)(i) magnificent — Attractive, beautiful, admirable, impressive, wonderful
(i) culprits — offenders, wrongdoers, delinquent
(iii) entreated — implored, requested, persuaded, asked
(iv) drastic — serious, severe, stringent (v) conflict — confrontation, war, fight, strife, combat
(vi) gloomily — sadly, unhappily, sorrowfully, grief, pessimistically

SECTION C SUMMARY

8. (a)(i) It gives information on current affairs.
(ii) It gives information to societies without institutions of learning.
(iii) It speaks for the oppressed.
(b)(i) It causes trouble among people.
(iv) It advertises information on jobs.
(ii) It contributes to moral decadence.

WASSCE JUNE 2009 ENGLISH LANGUAGE 3 TEST OF ORALS (OBJECTIVE)

SECTION 1

From the words lettered A to D, choose the word that has the **same vowel sound** as the one represented by the letter(s) underlined. An example is given below.

Example: seat A. sit B. cite C. set D. key.

The correct answer is D because only key contains the same vowel sound as the one underlined in seat. Therefore, answer space D would be shaded.

[A] [B] [C] [D]

Now answer the questions that follow:

1. member A. lorry B. country C. tailor D. expect

2. levy A. lever B. weaver C. weapon D. reader
3. fool A. foot B. book C. push D. move
4. bottle A. watch B. cover C. son D. water
5. lawn A. pot B. love C. paltry D. laugh
6. worry A. story B. honey C. sorry D. roster
7. cart A. panel B. wrap C. plant D. scam
8. grow A. lock B. novel C. hostel D. gross
9. soil A. joyful B. chamois C. abattoir D. onion
10. grey A. sew B. parent C. gauge D. pause
11. leap A. peasant B. vehicle C. stealth D. mess
12. good A. room B. loom C. full D. null
13. serve A. curtsy B. surprise C. currant D. courtship
14. hear A. rare B. learn C. beef D. deer
15. cow A. arrow B. low C. how D. mow

SECTION 2

From the words lettered A to D, choose the word that has the same consonant sound(s) as the one represented by the letter(s) underlined. An example is given below.

Example: vice A. cat B. dress C. show D. chalk
The correct answer is B because only dress has the same consonant sound as the one underlined in vice. Therefore, answer space B would be shaded.

[A] [B] [C] [D]

Now, answer the questions that follow.

16. look A. talk B. calm C. roll D. yolk
17. coal A. cent B. picnic C. ceiling D. indict
18. rash A. vision B. leisure C. equation D. station
19. dead A. adjust B. locked C. bogged D. adjourn
20. slept A. stopped B. wedded C. ebbed D. stabbed
21. face A. race B. phase C. vase D. of
22. rich A. nonchalant B. chassis C. chef D. posture
23. rose A. lice B. taps C. wise D. bats
24. song A. tongue B. cringe C. singe D. hinge
25. beg A. gym B. gin C. egg D. gentle
26. truth A. writhe B. theatre C. leather D. wither
27. forge A. regime B. beggar C. mirage D. package
28. those A. bathe B. breath C. thug D. three
29. rope A. receipt B. physics C. pest D. corps
30. table A. often B. nestle C. debut D. butter

SECTION 3

From the words lettered A to D, choose the word that rhymes with the given word. An example is given below.

Example: detain A. obtain B. detail C. claim D. relay

The correct answer is A because only obtain rhymes with detain. Therefore, answer space A would be shaded.

[A] [B] [C] [D]

Now answer the questions that follow.

31. blamed A. calmed B. pressed C. ashamed D. slammed
32. fork A. hawk B. rot C. work D. murk
33. smelly A. melee B. belly C. real D. sorcery
34. browse A. mice B. draws C. cows D. gross
35. fasted A. impressed B. lasted C. harvest D. practised

SECTION 4

In each of the following questions, the **main/primary stress** is indicated by writing the syllable on which it occurs in capital letters.

From the words lettered A to D, choose the word that has the correct stress. An example is given below.

Example: democratic

- A. DE-mo-cra-tic B. de-MO-cra-tic
C. de-mo-CRA-tic D. de-mo-cra-TIC

The correct answer is C because the main/primary stress of the word democratic is on the third syllable. Therefore, answer space C would be shaded.

[A] [B] [C] [D]

Now answer the questions that follow.

36. expatiate
A. Ex-pa-ti-ate B. ex-PA-ti-ate
C. ex-pa-TI-ate D. ex-pa-ti-ATE
37. memoranda
A. MEM-o-ran-da B. mem-O-ran-da
C. mem-o-RAN-da D. mem-o-ran-DA
38. competitive
A. COM-pet-i-tive B. com-PET-i-ti'e
C. com-pet-I-tive D. com-pet-i-TIVE
39. mechanism
A. MECH-a-ni-sm B. mech-A-ni-sm
C. mech-a-NI-sm D. mech-a-ni-SM
40. negotiation
A. NE-go-tia-tion B. ne-GO-tia-tion
C. ne-go-TIA-tion D. ne-go-tia-TION

SECTION 5

In the following options lettered A to D, all the words except one have the same stress pattern. Identify the one with the different stress pattern and shade your answer in the usual way. An example is given below.

Example: A. away B. apart C. behind D. river
Options A, B, C are all stressed on the second syllable while option D is the only one stressed on the first syllable. So, D is the correct answer. Therefore, answer space D would be shaded.

[A] [B] [C] [D]

Now answer the questions that follow.

41. A. surface B. neglect C. marshal D. reason
42. A. purchase B. vomit C. country D. irate
43. A. despite C. bias C. respite D. triumph
44. A. ascertain B. registrar C. interpret D. interrupt
45. A. mpressivc B. conviction C. revenue D. approval

SECTION 6

In each of the following sentences, the word that receives the emphatic stress is written in capital letters. From the questions lettered A to D, choose the one to which the given sentence is the appropriate answer. An example is given below.

Example: My mother's FRIEND hates pets.

- A. Does your mother's boss hate pets?
B. Does your mother's friend love pets?
C. Does your mother's friend hate toys?
D. Does your father's friend hate pets?

The correct answer is A because My mother's FRIEND hates pets answers the question, Does your mother's boss hate pets? Therefore, answer space A would be shaded.

[A] [B] [C] [D]

Now answer the questions that follow.

46. Many BRILLIANT students drop out of school because of poverty

- A. Do many unintelligent students drop out of school because of poverty?
 B. Do many brilliant students drop out of school because of excessive wealth?
 C. Do few brilliant students drop out of school because of poverty?
 D. Do many brilliant apprentices drop out of school because of poverty?
47. Few Nigerian politicians are ALTRUISTIC
 A. Are many Nigerian politicians altruistic?
 B. Are few Ganaian politicians altruistic?
 C. Are few Nigerian businessmen altruistic?
 D. Are few Nigerian politicians selfish?
48. Six European ambassadors ARRIVED yesterday
 A. Did ten European ambassadors arrive yesterday?
 B. Did six Indian ambassadors arrive yesterday?
 C. Did six European ambassadors depart yesterday?
 D. Did six European ministers arrive yesterday?
49. George plays FOOTBALL on Saturday afternoons.
 A. Does Jim play football on Saturday afternoon?
 B. Does George play cricket on Saturday afternoons?
 C. Does George play football on Sunday morning?
 D. Does George play football on Sunday afternoons?
50. The accident did irreparable damage to Daddy's HEART
 A. Did the acid do irreparable damage to Daddy's heart?
 B. Did the accident do minor damage to Daddy's heart?

- C. Did the accident do irreparable damage to Daddy's lungs?
 D. Did the accident do irreparable damage to Mummy's heart?

SECTION 7

From the words lettered A to D, choose the word that contains the sound represented by the given phonetic symbol. An example is given below.

Example: /ɔɪ/ A. yell B. holy C. boy D. idiot

The correct answer is C because only boy contains the sound represented by the given symbol. Therefore, answer space C would be shaded.

[A] [B] ☒ [C] [D]

Now answer the questions that follow.

51. /ə/ A. music B. mouthful C. problem D. colleague
 52. /ɪ/ A. expert B. extort C. exile D. exercise
 53. /ɜ:/ A. port B. cord C. sort D. work
 54. /ʊ/ A. should B. rude C. boom D. doom
 55. /ʌ/ A. ozone B. orange C. oven D. glory
 56. /s/ A. champion B. nose C. archives D. moustache
 57. /j/ A. June B. dew C. grew D. blue
 58. /ɜ:/ A. explosion B. compulsion C. pressure D. extension
 59. /z/ A. reverse B. consist C. result D. price
 60. /w/ A. once B. languor C. ewe D. sew

WASSCE JUNE 2009 ENGLISH LANGUAGE 3 TEST OF ORALS (OBJECTIVE) ANSWERS

1.C	2.C	3.C	4.A	5.B	6.B	7.C
8.D	9.A	10.C	11.B	12.A	13.A	14.A
15.C	16.C	17.B	18.D	19.C	20.A	21.B
22.C	23.C	24.A	25.C	26.B	27.D	28.A
29.C	30.D	31.C	32.A	33.B	34.C	35.B
36.C	37.C	38.B	39.A	40.C	41.B	42.D
43.A	44.B	45.C	46.A	47.D	48.C	49.B
50.C	51.C	52.B	53.D	54.A	55.C	
56.B	57.B	58.A	59.C	60.A		

SENIOR SCHOOL CERTIFICATE EXAMINATION (SSCE 1988 – 2015)

Past Questions with Solutions

English Language

(Theory / Objectives with Oral English) 2010

WASSCE JUNE 2010 ENGLISH LANGUAGE 2 OBJECTIVE TEST QUESTIONS

SECTION 1

In each of the following sentences, there is one underlined word and one gap. From the list of words lettered A to D, choose the one that is most **nearly opposite in meaning** to the underlined word and that will, at the same time, correctly fill the gap in the sentence.

1. The handsome profit from her fish business made Mrs. Uba stop complaining about her husband's..... salary. A. ugly B. rnaagre C. modest D. lowly
2. Chief Osa prefers fame in the village to..... in the city. A. neglect B. ignorance C. poverty D. obscurity
3. The media houses should employ both the novice and the.....journalist. A. apprentice B. probationer C. newcomer D. Veteran
4. While the Registrar considers the matter insignificant, his deputy sees it as..... A. minute B. crucial C. compulsory D. marvellous
5. It pays to be firm rather than...in a case like this. A. flexible B. frank C. irresponsible D. careless
6. Usually, Joseph is articulate in his speech, but today he sounds..... A. clear B. turgid C. timid D. incoherent
7. The man's first wife is loyal while the second is..... A. unfaithful B. unkind C. selfish D. hostile
8. Rather than convict him, the impartial judge..... him. A. blamed B. dismissed C. upheld D. acquitted
9. Instead of reconciling her parents, Roxanne worked hard at..... them. A. dividing B. destroying C. separating D. isolating
10. We thought that Uncle Sam's health had improved but it had rather..... A. persisted B. deteriorated C. deepened D. decreased

SECTION 2

From the words lettered A to D, choose the word that **best completes** each of the following sentences.

11. Onevery importantaspectof human relationship is.....trust. A. communal B. individual C. mutural D. personal
12. The two tasks were performed.....and we were able to finish early. A. alternatively B. simultaneously C. consecutively D. separately
13. The committee is charged with finding a..... solution to the crisis. A. lengthy B. current C. lasting D. strong
14. We are worried by the.....that exists between the two factions of the party. A. distraction B. Commotion C. confusion D. rivalry
15. Our teacher was not speaking.....when he said that the bursar was under a cloud. A. literally B. simply C. frankly D. directly
16. The signature on the document lacked.....; so it was rejected A. clarity B. authenticity C. formality D. simplicity
17. Everyone could tell that Binta was happy from the.....on her face. A. picture B. appearance C. expression D. sight
18. His last novel was.....by his visit to the prisons. A. inspired B. generated C. conceived D. revealed
19. As a result of the power cut, production at the paint factory came to a..... A. hold-up B. blockade C. stand still D. suspense
20. Several.....were passed at the meeting. A. memoranda B. decisions C. resolutions D. actions

SECTION 3

After each of the following sentences, a list of possible interpretations is given. Choose the interpretation that you consider **most appropriate** for each sentence.

21. James and Henry were at daggers drawn when I knew them. This means that they A. were always angry with each other. B. always wore daggers. C. were good at drawing daggers.

D. were fighting everybody.

22. My book has become dog-eared through use. This means that A. the corners of the pages of my book are crumpled. B. my book is designed like dog's ears. D. my book is torn. C. my book is indispensable.
23. Musa does not believe that there is poverty in Africa; he is a dyed-in-the-wool capitalist. This means that Musa is A. a kind capitalist. B. a thoughtful capitalist. C. an old capitalist. D. an unbending capitalist.
24. Whenever my cousin comes to realize that I am telling the truth, she will eat humble pie. This means that my cousin will A. respect me. B. hate herself. C. apologize. D. be ashamed.
25. I had dinner with Tony and Nick and they talked shop the whole time. This means that they talked A. about buying things from the shop. B. about their job. C. all the time. D. about taking me to the shop.
26. His decision to reconcile with his former agent paid off. This means that the reconciliation A. yielded positive results. B. cost him a lot of money. C. was unsuccessful. D. caused him some trouble.
27. The beauty of Bimpe's garden shows that she has green fingers. This means that Bimpe A. always paints her finger green. B. is good at growing plants. C. turns everything she touches to green. D. likes keeping green objects.
28. I would have visited you but for my father's ill health. This means that my A. father's ill health would have made me to visit you. B. father's ill health prevented me from visiting you. C. father threatened to fall ill if I visited you. D. father did not fall ill, so I couldn't visit you.
29. Her husband's death has forced her to tighten her belt. This means that she has A. become more economical, B. adjusted her belt. C. become very aggressive. D. become very greedy.
30. Some candidates take examinations in their stride. This means that they A. prepare hard for them. B. do not worry about them. C. find them insurmountable. D. are familiar with them.

SECTION 4

From the words or group of words lettered A to D below each of the following sentences, choose the word or group of words that is **nearest in meaning** to the underlined word or group of words as it is used in the sentences.

31. The provocation had an instantaneous effect on him. A. a lasting B. an immediate C. a terrifying D. a momentous
32. I woke up feeling rather queer. A. fine B. strange C. strong D. tired
33. If he declines the offer, it will be better for him. A. ignores B. denies C. snubs D. rejects
34. Our club encourages benevolence. A. affluence B. sincerity C. charity D. association
35. Such utterances are inimical to the peaceful co-existence of the two communities. A. unhelpful B. unimportant C. harmful D. useless
36. The chairman observed that Andrew was the most qualified candidate for the job. A. suitable B. accommodating C. responsible D. interesting
37. What do you intend to do with these inanimate objects? A. lively B. fascinating C. precious D. lifeless
38. Everybody noticed that the chairman's excuse was lame. A. verbose B. precise C. unsatisfactory D. unconditional
39. The president appointed staunch supporters of his policies as advisers. A. trusted B. critical C. affluent D. strong
40. The little boy gave his candid opinion of the incident. A. quick B. brief C. frank D. hurried

SECTION 5

From the word or group of words lettered A to D, choose the word or group of words that **best completes** each of the following sentences.

41. Why are you always jealous..... other people? A. of B. at C. about D. with
42. It is sad that the rich..... pity the poor. A. doesn't B. don't C. do D. did
43. The motorcycle nearly hit Jane and..... A. me B. I C. myself D. mine

44. I found my friends sitting.....the beach. A. in B. at C. under D. on
45. It is a about time you..... to bed. A. go B. have gone C. went D. should go
46. We shall not.....WASSCE next May. A. sit in B. sit at C. sit D. sit to
47. One of his close friends.....a soldier. A. is B. are C. have been D. were
48. Does Omar.....in the city? A. lives B. lived C. live D. living
49. The meeting of the..... will come later today. A. secretaries general B. secretary generals C. secretaries generals D. secretary generals'
50. His father has a..... A. round wooden beautiful table B. wooden round beautiful table C. beautiful wooden round table D. beautiful round wooden table
51. The teachers don't teach us,.....? A. do they B. don't they C. didn't they D. isn't it
52. We are no.....friends. A. more B. longer C. again D. always
53. Can you tell us how the accident came.....? A. up B. by C. out D. about
54. She wondered if the water was not.....hot for drinking. A. very B. too C. so D. much
55. The robbers were subjected.....a thorough beating by the irate mob. A. to B. by C. with D. for
56. The cook should have.....the pepper and the tomatoes together. A. ground B. grind C. grinds D. grounded
57. My friends would not believe me if I..... them this story. A. tell B. told C. am telling D. will tell
58. Even before his burial, Okoye's family members were already planning how to share his wealth.....themselves. A. between B. with C. among D. to
59. The principal advised all the students to be of help to..... A. one other B. themselves C. the other D. one another
60. Mr. Ackon needed.....help to succeed in the business. A. a little B. a few C. little D. few
61. Susan has been urging me to join the..... A. Girl Guides B. Girls Guide C. Girls Guides D. Girl Guide
62. Three kilometres.....quite a long distance. A. are B. have been C. is D. were
63. If they had known us, they..... A. will not treat us like that B. would not treat us like that C. will not have treated us like that D. would not have treated us like that
64. The teacher made us.....five poems each. A. recite B. recited C. recites D. reciting
65. Each one of the ten chosen contestants..... lunch with the patron. A. has had B. have had C. are having D. have
66. The teacher needs.....to write the note on the chalkboard. A. chalks B. chalk C. some chalk D. many chalks
67. Madam Abike turned.....13 bags of friiàize at the first harvest. A. On B. but C. up D. in
68. The teacher, as well as his students,..... working very hard. A. is B. have been C. are D. were
69. My mother remarked that it was high time we.....preparing the supper. A. were starting B. had started C. started D. should start
70. All we need.....dedicated teachers. A. are B. was C. is D. were
71. Though Yusuf is a much younger lawyer, you cannot compare his eloquence.....his master's. A. by B. with C. from D. for
72. The student wondered why the sun constantly rises.....the east. A. in B. by C. from D. within
73. Mrs. Kofi is angry.....her daughter's lack of interest in her business. A. at B. with C. for D. by
74. Until I heard him myself, I..... imagined that he said that. A. did not B. could not have C. should not have D. will not have
75. No sooner had the war started.....the soldiers deserted the village. A. that B. when C. as D. than

SECTION 6

In the following passages, the numbered gaps indicate missing words. Against each number in the list below each passage, four options are given in columns lettered A to D. Choose the word that is the **most suitable** to fill the numbered gaps in the passages.

PASSAGE A

The prefectural system is one of the most 76 — ways of involving students directly in the — 77 — of the school. In the system, the students are 78 — certain — 79 — connected with the day-to-day life of the school: for instance, the organization and co-ordination of all sorts of — 80 — activities, such as games, societies, clubs, or dealing with some minor cases of — 81 —, taking responsibility for students' welfare, — 82 — of learning after school hours, arranging advisory services for junior students and checking — 83 —. Properly — 84 —, the prefectural system helps to 85 — the work of the administrator and set a good — 86 — for the school. The operation of the system and the exact — 87 — performed by prefects differ from institution to institution; the important thing is to adapt the system in such a way as to make it a useful — 88 — of the day-to-day administration of your — 89 —.

	A	B	C	D
76.	routine	effective	serious	necessary
77.	movement	ruling	construction	administration
78.	delegated	promised	allowed	stated
79.	work	jobs	duties	choices
80.	social	academic	extra-curricular	special
81.	association	discipline	relationship	behaviour
82.	supervision	assignment	administering	planning
83.	evaluation	interference	diligence	studies
84.	operated	ruled	manipulated	evolved
85.	limit	duplicated	decrease	minimize
86.	forming	sign	take	design
87.	record	courses	decide	functions
88.	implement	feature	tool	device
89.	union	village	community	group

PASSAGE B

Mrs. Agu decided to — 90 — her friend. She picked up her — 91 — and — 92 — her friends — 93 —. There was no response. However, after a few trials she discovered from the — 94 — that she was not in — 95 — and so, the — 96 — could not go — 97 —. That was surprising because she had bought some — 98 — cards the previous day and did not — 99 — any call. However, she could not remember — 100 — them into her phone.

	A	B	C	D
90.	contact	ring	stir	wake
91.	card	message	line	set
92.	received	dialled	inserted	scrolled
93.	hardset	call	number	phone
94.	operator	receiver	caller	subscriber
95.	credit	money	account	fund
96.	tone	phone	sound	call
97.	on	in	through	out
98.	application	recharge	charging	ordering
99.	make	by	receive	register
100.	billing	fixing	leading	applying

WASSCE JUNE 2010 ENGLISH LANGUAGE 2 OBJECTIVE TEST ANSWERS

1.B	2.D	3.D	4.B	5.A	6.D	7.A
8.D	9.C	10.B	11.D	12.B	13.C	14.D
15.A	16.B	17.C	18.A	19.C	20.C	21.A
22.A	23.D	24.A	25.C	26.A	27.B	28.B
29.A	30.A	31.B	32.B	33.D	34.C	35.C
36.A	37.D	38.C	39.D	40.C	41.A	42.6
43.A	44.B	45.C	46.A	47.A	48.C	49.A
50.D	51.A	52.B	53.D	54.B	55.A	56.A
57.B	58.C	59.D	60.A	61.B	62.C	63.D
64.A	65.A	66.C	67.B	68.A	69.C	70.C
71.B	72.C	73.A	74.B	75.D	76.B	77.D
78.A	79.C	80.C	81.B	82.A	83.B	84.A
85.D	86.C	87.D	88.C	89.C	90.B	91.D
92.B	93.C	94.A	95.A	96.D	97.C	98.B
99.A	100.C					

WASSCE JUNE 2010 ENGLISH LANGUAGE 1 THEORY QUESTIONS

SECTION A

- You have recently moved into a new neighbourhood with your parents. Write a letter to your sister who is studying overseas giving, at least, **three reasons** for disliking the new place.
- Write an article for publication in a national newspaper on the topic: Vocational Training is the answer to unemployment among the youths.
- Your country's Public Transport System is not functioning properly. Write a letter to the Minister of Transport highlighting the causes and suggesting, at least, two measures to remedy the situation.
- You are the Chief Speaker in a debate on the topic: The youths of today are more interested in the pursuit of pleasure than in academic work. Write your speech for or against the topic.

- Write a story to illustrate the saying: A good name is better than riches.

SECTION B COMPREHENSION

- Read the following passage **carefully** and answer the questions on it.

It was a little past 10am, but the medium-sized hall that served as a prayer house was already brimming with people from different parts of the metropolis, who had come to seek cure or answers to their problems. The majority of this lot were those with seemingly intractable mental health conditions. The superintendent of the prayer house in question was often spoken of in whispers as possessing uncanny spiritual powers to exorcise evil spirits. It was also believed that he

had answer to numerous illnesses that defied orthodox medication. Wednesday of each week was set aside for these healing sessions.

On this particular Wednesday, noisy supplications to the Most High and ceaseless invocation of His name to free those supposedly held captive by alleged evil spirits had reached fever pitch. Suddenly, a middle-aged man broke loose from the crowd and ran as fast as his wobbly legs could permit. Some male workers from the prayer house gave him a hot chase.

At first, bemused by-standers rained curses on the fleeing man, wondering why a man in his right senses would in broad daylight rob a house of God. They obviously mistook the man for a robber fleeing from the scene of his crime. But he was not. Minutes later, he was caught and chained hands and feet, despite his struggle against his captors who intermittently lashed him with horse-whip. As he was being violently dragged along the street, the man ceaselessly muttered incomprehensible words that sounded like the muttering of a colony of baboons. Then, a clearer picture of the situation dawned on the on-lookers. The man, after all, was not a thief and had stolen nothing; rather, his ability to think and reason properly had taken flight of him. Simply put, he was mentally deranged.

The above incident is a common occurrence in many parts of the country. It aptly underscores the devastating mental health conditions plaguing a sizeable number of people in recent times. It also points to the unspeakable and inhuman treatment which people with such health disorders suffer at the hands of self-styled spiritualists. This is the usual lot of mental patients whose family members refuse to take advantage of orthodox treatment.

- (a) What brought the people to the prayer house?
- (b) State the functions of the superintendent of the prayer house.
- (c) What was wrong with the on-lookers' assessment of the run-away man?
- (d) Mention two instances of inhuman treatment in the passage.
- (e) What is the writer's attitude towards the treatment of lunatics at prayer houses?
- (f) like the muttering of a colony of baboons". What figure of speech is contained in this expression
- (g) "..... whose family members refuse to take advantage of orthodox treatment".
- (i) What grammatical name is given to this expression as it is used in the passage?
- (ii) What is its function?

(h) For each of the following words, find another word or phrase which means the same and which can replace it as it is used in the passage.

- (i) intractable; (ii) supplications; (iii) wobbly; (iv) bemused; (v) intermittently; (vi) deranged.

7. *Read the following passage carefully and answer the questions on it.*

Miss Williamson announced in class one day that she wanted one of us to live with her to help her with her domestic work after school. There was a rush to volunteer which took her completely by surprise. When she recovered and had quietened our excited shouting, there was a moment during which none of us dared breathe, as she scanned the eager faces. What made her choose me I have never found out, but I had noticed before that she was partial to me. 'All right Karimu', she said. 'You can come; but first run along and get your father's consent'.

My parents were only too glad to have one mouth fewer to feed and my brothers and sisters to see the back of one who inevitably had begun to assume an air of superiority in talking to them. Miss Williamson's bungalow was a stone's throw from the school. That very evening saw me installed on a mat in a corner of her back veranda. I was unable to sleep, excited of the thought of the good fortune that had come my way. To be within earshot of Miss Williamson's English all day, to have access to her books, to nurse the possibility, overwhelming even in thought, of going with her frequently to Rofunkti — all these visions kept my eyes wide open and my brain racing until very late that night. With my 'lapa' pulled right over my head and happy beyond all description in my heart. I smiled myself to sleep.

I learnt a very great deal in Miss Williamson's bungalow. Apart from improving my English, I learnt about the world outside, and began to sense that there were barriers much higher and much less easily gauged than those of mere language and colour, between my own people and those from whom she sprang. The smiling teacher in the daytime often became the brooding restless, ill-tempered spinster in the evening. Her bungalow was shared by another lady, a doctor, also a Scot, who travelled to and fro between the two villages on a bicycle. I noticed that when not at their work or talking about it, these two women showed no signs of being happy. As I grew up with them, I found myself wondering what had made them leave their own country and come to live this strange life among a people whose ways were totally different from theirs.

- (a) Why was Miss Williamson completely surprised?

- (b) Why was Karimu's family happy to see him go to stay at the bungalow?
- (c) State the overwhelming thought that kept Karimu awake.
- (d) What did Karimu find difficult to understand about the two ladies?
- (e) Mention the identical trait in these two ladies' behaviour.
- (f) "What made her choose me..."
- (i) What grammatical name is given to this expression as it is used in the passage?
- (ii) What is its function?
- (g) "I smiled myself to sleep" What is the meaning of this expression?
- (h) For each of the following words, find another word or phrase which means the same and which can replace it as it is used in the passage.
- (i) scanned; (ii) inevitably; (iii) nurse; (iv) visions; (v) gauged; (vi) brooding.

SECTION C SUMMARY

8. Read the following passage **carefully** and answer the questions on it.

No one can deny the fact that anyone who wants to be successful in learning the English language needs a good English dictionary. Such a dictionary should be a source of information about the language — information that is not generally available in grammar books. It should not only contain a list of words and their meanings, but also a lot of information that can help a learner to speak and write good English.

In order to use a word correctly, the reader needs to know how to link it with other words in a sentence. He should also know the structures that often precede or follow it, and whether it is formal or informal. This will help him to choose what word is appropriate for a particular context. The dictionary is, therefore, an invaluable aid to reading as well as writing skills.

If the meaning of a particular word in a passage impedes the overall comprehension of the main ideas presented in it, then a dictionary should be used. Most teachers must have observed a widespread tendency among their students to attack a new passage by reading it word by word, stopping to reach for a dictionary whenever they come across a word they do not know. This is a wrong approach, the dictionary should be used only as a last resort. The main objective of reading a passage is not to define specific words but to understand the ideas and concepts of the passage. The frequent use of a dictionary tends to focus the reader's attention on words when he should be concentrating on understanding the main ideas of the passage.

Efficient reading implies obtaining the greatest amount of information from the passage in the shortest time possible. The frequent use of a dictionary takes too much time that can better be employed in getting an overall understanding of the passage.

Instead of turning to the last resort, the reader should continue reading. Very often, the meaning of an unfamiliar word can be guessed from the context in which it is used. The passage may give a definition, cite examples or describe the circumstances surrounding the use of such a word well enough for him to know what it means. After reading the whole passage, the reader may realize that he has understood the important ideas presented without knowing the meaning of every word. If, after reading the entire passage, the reader is still unable to guess the meaning of a word from the context, then he should study the structure of the word. The word may be a compound word which, when broken into its component parts, can be easily understood.

If after exhausting these approaches, the reader still does not understand the meaning of a word, and if this word is vital to the comprehension of the whole passage, then and only then, should he refer to a dictionary.

(a) In one sentence state the purpose of a good dictionary.

(b) In two sentences, one for each, state the two disadvantages of constantly referring to a dictionary when reading a passage.

(c) In three sentences, one for each, summarize the three Steps that a reader should take before referring to a dictionary.

WASSCE JUNE 2010 ENGLISH LANGUAGE 1 ESSAY ANSWERS

SECTION A

1. 99, Nwosu Street,
Off Akingbela Avenue,
Ajegunle,
Lagos.
16th March, 2010.

Dear Aunt Lydia,

How are you and everybody over there? Oh! it's been long since I wrote to you last and so I am very sorry and thus ask for forgiveness.

Aunt, I sincerely hope that you have been studying hard because you know how strenuously Daddy and Mummy are struggling to make the money they are sending to you. It is my prayer you pass out in flying colours.

Well, since you are my only sibling, I cannot but continue to chat with you through this medium as United States of America a distance, hence the reason for missing you so much.

Did you even notice the address on this letter? Well, don't bother much, that is the address of our new apartment as we have relocated to a new area which I dislike due to its loneliness being a developing area. Besides, our house is far from the road where things can be bought. You have thick bushes along the road and most of the time offensive odours of pigs, goats and other domestic animals fill the air. People are few, as it is a new area. The houses are scanty and dotted the whole area.

Coupled with the above reason for my not liking the area is the absence of friends to play with. Most of my friends find it difficult to pay me visits as they often complain of high transport fare to the place hence my loneliness.

Apart from this, I don't like the place because most of the roads are marshy and rough. Most of the time the streets are always flooded anytime it rains especially when it rains heavily. I will not be able to go outside because if I do, I will surely slip off and fall into muddy water. I just feel sad each time it is getting dark because I know the usual darkness will descend for the Power Holding Company of Nigeria (P.H.C.N) often manages to give us light but it won't last up to fifteen minutes and it is off again.

I had wanted to phone you before this letter but because of the service providers' network challenges. This is making life boring for me. I cannot browse on the computer, I cannot charge my phone and other related matters. I am really fed up. I cannot wait for my result to be released I will also go to the University just like you did.

Aunt Lydia, don't blame daddy but the stupid 'Agent' that told him a different story about the house that daddy had to pay for the rent. Anyway, don't let me bother you again with my stories, I will call you anytime my phone picks the network signal. Greet your friends, neighbours and your course mates for me. Till I hear from you, I say bye for now.

Your dearest brother,
Blaise.

2. VOCATIONAL TRAINING IS THE ANSWER TO UNEMPLOYMENT AMONG THE YOUTHS

I considered it a point of duty especially to my fellow youths to bring to their notice through this edition of a widely read Newspaper, the concept of VOCATIONAL TRAINING.

As the topic of this write-up says, I am also confirming it that Vocational Training Is The Answer To Unemployment Among The Youth

What is vocational training you will ask? Well, vocational training could be defined as the process of going through a learning of skills that involves the use of both machines and other devices and materials to produce things that can be used to better the living condition of oneself and Others in the society at large by specialists in fields such as Computer, Bread-making, Fashion designing, Barbering skills, Cake baking, Brick laying, Beads making, Mechanical (motor) repair Vehicle body repair and other kinds of crafts that would keep the youths out of the unemployment market.

Going further, you will realise that the idea of vocational training is not a child's play when it comes to someone making himself or herself available for any of the vocations one so desires so as to derive benefits therein

It would be observed that where one is engaged in a meaningful skill or skills that would uplift life expectancy and avoid engaging in gangsterism, robbery, cultism, pilfering, unhealthy argument on foreign football and other vices that would endanger the lives and future of the youths, then vocational training is the answer to unemployment among the youths.

Many of the youths that finished their Senior Secondary Certificate Examinations and have no good result to show for the years spent in school are advised to go for vocational training that would empower them against the future so that they too can become respected citizens of this great country and contribute immensely to the economic and social cum political growth of our great country Nigeria. Go for yours today for vocational training is the answer.

3.

4, Arewa Street,
Mafoluku-oja,
Oshodi,
Lagos.
2nd April, 2010.

Honourable Minister,
Federal Ministry of Transport,
Area 6, Wuse Quarters,
Abuja.

Dear Sir,
THE PUBLIC TRANSPORT SYSTEM IN NIGERIA

I am writing you this letter as an indigene of Lagos State who has a deep sense of commitment and responsibility to my people and

the government at large over their good works. I am thanking you and your colleagues there in the Ministry of Transport for the good job you are doing in the country with particular reference to various road projects you embarked upon since you assumed office.

Simply put, transportation is the process of moving goods and persons from one place to another. This in essence shows the importance of transport in the economy of a nation. The modes of transport as known all over the world include the Land, Air, Rail, Sea, and that of Beasts of burden such as the Ass, Camel, Donkey and Horses. You will agree with me that goods and services are moved from one place to another through the modes mentioned above.

The irony of these modes of transportation is that the land transportation is the most important because whatever the other means carry would still be taken to the final destination through cars, lorries, motorcycles and even bicycles.

The use of Lorries, Cars, Trailers and others is very common in all parts of the federation, hence the deplorable conditions of most of the roads in Nigeria today.

First and foremost, we must consider the factors responsible for the poor transport system in the country. In that regard is the high cost of petrol and diesel which makes it inconvenient these days to go about when it comes to the movement of goods and people from one place to the other. This high cost emanates from the incessant fuel scarcity that results from the activities of NNPC and damage to vehicles resulting from bad roads. These add to the causes of malfunctioning of the transportation systems put in place.

Most of The roads built are in poor state due to impact of overloaded trailers. The roads easily give way due to the weight of the vehicles thereby making movement slow and most vehicles get spoilt with attendant high cost of spare parts to fix them back.

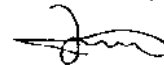
However, the problems can be assuaged with some measures. One of which is the general repair of the roads with proper maintenance culture imbibed by vehicle drivers especially the tanker and trailer (goods) drivers.

Provision of traffic light to curb excessive speed and bye-laws to sustain the use of the roads should be put in place to check heavy traffic of vehicles that may soon spoil the roads

Where this is in place, light traffic would ensure smooth movement of people and goods which will in turn create more revenue for the government.

In conclusion, I am sure that if you can lock into these suggestions, it will aid the transportation system in the country.

Yours faithfully,



Adams Falilat Olukosi

4. Good day Mr. Chairman, panel of Judges, accurate time-keeper, co-debaters, fellow students and distinguished ladies and gentlemen. It gives me pleasure to stand before you today to air my view as a supporter of the motion that 'The Youths of today are more interested in the pursuit of pleasure than in academic work.'

Some people are of the opinion that the youths should enjoy their youthful days and so in enjoying 'their days' they forget the future and reel in the euphoria of today. You hardly go around the town today without seeing average teenage boys and girls alike blocking their ears with ear-pieces of their phones listening to the music they have recorded in the phone. Sometimes, they are carried away by such music and before you know it they have become the victims of hit-and-run drivers. The way they quickly get used to the rhythm of the music is at an alarming rate while their responses to their academic work is nothing to write home about.

Another notable reason why the Youths of today are more interested in the pursuit of pleasure than in academics is the general belief of the Youths that even when you study and acquire the needed knowledge with a degree to cap it, there would not be the work to do with it. They argue that the only way to secure a job is to have a godfather who will push you through. Well, it may be so, but the way out for them is too long that they may not be able to get the desired pleasure again. The way forward they don't know is the self-employment through trainings from the vocational schools all over the places.

Another reason why I support the motion is the bad influence of the peer group. Take 'Da Green', the late rap-musician for instance, who was a teenager. He became a worldwide rapper for some years and displayed his affluence till death. So the youths saw him as part of them, they wanted to be rich like him forgetting that without their academics they are nowhere.

Ladies and gentlemen, you will agree with me that it is true that the youths of today are interested in the pursuit of pleasure than in academic work and that if nothing is done to arrest the situation, the country shall be the worst

for it when the useless youths should assume the mantle of leadership.

Thank you.

Olukosi Babs
S.S.3B

5. A GOOD NAME IS BETTER THAN RICHES

While I was going through the questions to ascertain the topic to choose and write on, my mind just couldn't forgo the above topic because it reminds me of what happened two years ago which I would like to narrate here. It is a life long lesson for me and others who might read this story.

One sunny afternoon when returning from school after the end of the second paper of the day in the school on the promotion examination, I came across one woman who was neatly dressed and dangling a car key which I assumed was her car's. True to my assumption, she had a car— a Toyota Camry LXE.

The woman approached me and said, Young boy, what's your name? and before I could give her my name, Emeka: who was with me then just greeted her and told her my name, Oluwaseun. The woman laughed and said that she needed a house help and that the way she saw me, I would serve her purpose.

I told her my parents would not allow me, that she could instead call on Emeka. She said no, that she would go home with me and inform my parents. In order not to prolong the matter, we were already in her car on the way to my parents.

When we got home, my mother was the first to be seen. She was surprised to see me in the car for she thought I had damaged something in the school.

Before I could say anything, the woman introduced herself as Dr. Mrs. Giwa who used to travel always but wanted somebody to take care of her house whenever she was not around. That she wanted Seun. My mother was baffled and called on my father who was enjoying his Beans and Garri for that afternoon.

My father called her in and in no time she gave him huge sum of money and my father consented to her request. That was how I got to the woman's house. She told me I would be working with her and so my movement should not be more than the furnished sitting room.

When it was time to sleep, mummy' for that's how I started to call her, she called me in and when I entered her bedroom, I ran out saying sorry ma. She shouted at me "come in here!" I went in and she was half naked asking me to scratch her back for her. I was thinking of how to

scratch and before I knew it, she pounced on me and pressed much on me asking me to sleep with her that, that was my job there but I told her, "a good name is better than riches" and I ran back to my parents crying.

SECTION B COMPREHENSION

6. (a) People came to the prayer house in order to seek cure and find answers to their problems.
(b)(i) The superintendent of the prayer house is to cure illnesses that defied orthodox treatment.
(ii) He is also to exorcise evil spirits.
(c) The or-lookers mistook him for a thief.
(d)(i) The chaining of the lunatic.
(ii) The dragging of the lunatic along the street.
(e) The writer condemns the treatment of the lunatic.
(f) Simile
(g) It is an adjectival clause. It qualifies the noun 'patients'
(h)i Intractable — incurable, uncontrollable
(ii) Supplications — prayers, pleas or petition.
(iii) Wobbly — weak, shaky, trembling
(iv) Bemused — confused, amazed, puzzled
(v) Intermittently — at intervals, from time to time
(vi) Deranged — sick, disturbed.
7. (a) Miss Williamson was completely surprised because many pupils volunteered to stay with her.
(b)(i) Karimu's family were happy to see him go to stay at the bungalow because they would be saved the problem of feeding him. (ii) His brothers and sisters did not like his ways.
(c) The thought of accompanying Miss Williamson to Rofunkti.
(d) Karimu finds it difficult to understand why they left their own country to live among a people whose ways were different from theirs.
(e) They show no sign of happiness when they are not at work or talking about their work.
(f)(i) Noun clause (ii) Object of the verb 'have never found out'
(g) It means that the writer smiled until he slept.
(h) Scanned — searched, scrutinized, studied
Inevitable — undoubtedly, certainly, surely
Nurse — nurture, cherish, anticipate
Visions — fancies, dreams, thoughts, hopes or imaginations
Gauged — determined, measured, assessed
Brooding — unhappy, moody, sad, depressed, melancholic

SECTION C SUMMARY

8. (a) A good dictionary gives information about the language.
9. (b)(i) It distracts the reader's attention from following the main ideas of the passage.

- (ii) It wastes time or slows down the reading speed.
- (c)(i) He should guess the meaning of the unfamiliar word.
- (ii) He should read the whole passage. (iii) He should study the structure of the word.

WASSCE JUNE 2010 ENGLISH LANGUAGE 3 TEST OF ORALS (OBJECTIVE)

SECTION 1

From the words lettered A to D, choose the word that has the **same vowel sound** as the one represented by the letter(s) underlined. An example is given below.

Example: seat A. sit B. cite C. set D. key.

The correct answer is D because only key contains the same vowel sound as the one underlined in seat. Therefore, answer space D would be shaded.

[A] [B] [C] [D]

Now answer the questions that follow:

1. teeth A. tilt B. mission C. peace D. forfeit
2. kid A. oblique B. courage C. caprice D. prestige
3. cat A. plait B. wand C. rather D. harder
4. car A. plantain B. massive C. garment D. matter
5. bond A. hound B. dove C. month D. stop
6. could A. bully B. brush C. rude D. poultry
7. cut A. song B. pull C. tongue D. lock
8. birth A. journal B. armour C. path D. tour
9. share A. hair B. clear C. tier D. ire
10. beer A. wear B. bear C. pear D. real
11. lose A. wood B. wooed C. stood D. good
12. Shout A. cough B. dough C. doubt D. bought
13. height A. knife B. neighbour C. milk D. favourite
14. eight A. take B. doze C. flower D. birth
15. hour A. course B. tower C. slower D. source

SECTION 2

From the words lettered A to D, choose the word that has the **same consonant Sound(s)** as the one represented by the letter(s) underlined. An example is given below.

Example: vice A. cat B. dress C. show D. chalk

The correct answer is B because only dress has the same consonant sound as the one underlined in vice. Therefore, answer space B would be shaded.

[A] [B] [C] [D]

Now, answer the questions that follow.

16. tea A. secret B. depot C. ballet D. match
17. beige A. gauge B. barrage C. strange D. purge
18. bats A. works B. boys C. debris D. dogs
19. crunch A. chef B. chemist C. champagne D. chart
20. forge A. June B. crude C. regime D. regard

21. decree A. adjust B. adjourn C. student D. adjective
22. hang A. singlet B. danger C. twinge D. fringe
23. gutter A. engine B. braggart C. ginger D. gender
24. throat A. writhe B. Thomas C. smith D. thyme
25. then A. feather B. thicket C. author D. athlete
26. fan A. nerve B. vandal C. of D. phrase
27. navy A. knowledge B. song C. autumn D. congress
28. steep A. cities B. pressed C. sitting D. posed
29. walked A. shocked B. cast C. doomed D. stopped
30. purpose A. pneumonia B. psyche C. psalms D. rupture

SECTION 3

From the words lettered A to D, choose the word that rhymes with the given word. An example is given below.

Example: obtain A. detain B. detail C. claim D. relay

The correct answer is A because only obtain rhymes with detain. Therefore, answer space A would be shaded.

[A] [B] [C] [D]

Now answer the questions that follow.

31. account A. surmount B. mound C. ground D. wont
32. surprise A. surplus B. concise C. arise D. entice
33. appointed A. wanted B. disjointed C. anointment D. counted
34. poster A. hostel B. duty C. frosted D. toaster
35. come A. rum B. bomb C. sun D. tomb

SECTION 4

In each of the following questions, the **main/primary stress** is indicated by writing the syllable on which it occurs in capital letters.

From the words lettered A to D, choose the word that has the correct stress. An example is given below.

Example: democratic

- A. DEmo-cra-tic B. de-MO-cra-tic
C. de-mo-CRA-tic D. de-mo-cra-TIC

The correct answer is C because the **main/primary stress** of the word democratic is on the third syllable. Therefore, answer space C would be shaded.

[A] [B] [C] [D]

Now answer the questions that follow.

36. demonstrator
A. DEMO-on-stra-tor B. dem-ONstra-tor
C. dem-on-STRA-tor D. dem-on-stra-TOR
37. parochial
A. PA-ro-chi-al B. pa-RO-chi-al
C. pa-ro-CHI-al D. pa-ro-chi-AL
38. beneficial
A. BEN-e-fi-cial B. ben-E-fi-cial
C. ben-e-FI-cial D. ben-e-fi-CIAL
39. personify
A. PER-son-i-fy B. per-SON-i-fy
C. per-son-I-fy D. per-son-i-FY
40. Cumulative
A. CUM-u-la-tive B. cum-U-la-tive
C. cum-u-LA-tive D. cum-u-la-TIVE

SECTION 5

In the following options lettered A to D, all the words except one have the **same stress pattern**. Identify the one with the different stress pattern and shade your answer in the usual way. An example is given below.

Example: A. away B. apart C. behind D. river
Options A, B, C are all stressed on the second syllable while option D is the only one stressed on the first syllable. So, D is the correct answer. Therefore, answer space D would be shaded.

[A] [B] [C] [D]

Now answer the questions that follow

41. A. repute B. bathroom C. petrol D. differ
42. A. recite B. reckon C. receipt D. response
43. A. subscribe B. succeed C. parade D. marshal
44. A. component B. dominate C. orchestra D. legalize
45. A. informal B. intercept C. mechanic D. decision

SECTION 6

In each of the following sentences, the word that receives emphatic stress is written in capital letters. From the options lettered A to D, choose the one to which the given sentence is the appropriate answer. An example is given below.

Example: My mother's FRIEND hates pets.

- A. Does your mother's boss hate pets?
B. Does your mother's friend love pets?
C. Does your mother's friend hate toys?
D. Does your father's friend hate pets?

The correct answer is A because My mother's FRIEND hates pets answers the question, Does your mother's boss hate pets? Therefore, answer space A would be shaded.

[A] [B] [C] [D]

Now answer the questions that follow.

46. The new principal deals RUTHLESSLY with lazy teachers
A. Does the new principal deal leniently with lazy teachers?
B. Does the new principal deal ruthlessly with industrious teachers?
C. Does that former principal deal ruthlessly with lazy teachers?
D. Does the new principal deal ruthlessly with lazy students?
47. Day students are NEVER appointed prefects in government schools.
A. Are day students ever appointed prefects in government schools?
B. Are boarders never appointed prefects in government schools?
C. Are day students never appointed captains in government schools?
D. Are day students never appointed prefects in private schools?
48. The Minister went to America on OFFICIAL business
A. Did the Minister go to Germany on official business?
B. Did the President go to America on official business?
C. Did the Minister go to America on private business?
D. Did the Minister return from America on official business?
49. Companies USUALLY recruit intelligent graduates
A. Do companies usually recruit intelligent craftsmen?
B. Do homes usually recruit intelligent graduates?
C. Do companies usually select intelligent graduates?
D. Do companies seldom recruit intelligent graduates?
50. Daddy plays TENNIS on Saturday afternoon
A. Does Daddy play cricket in Saturday afternoon?
B. Does Mummy play tennis on Saturday afternoons?
C. Does Daddy play tennis on Sunday afternoons?
D. Does Daddy play tennis on Saturday mornings?

SECTION 7

From the words lettered A to D, choose the word that contains the sound represented by the given phonetic symbol. An example is given below.

Example: /ə I / A. yell B. holy C. boy D. idiot

The correct answer is C because only boy contains the sound represented by the given symbol. Therefore answer space C would be shaded.

[A] [B] [C] [D]

Now answer the questions that follow.

51. /i:/ A. receive B. head C. weapon D. peasant
52. /æ/ A. father B. scandal C. harder D. worker
53. /ɜ:/ A. attorney B. surprising C. wonderful
D. abduction
54. /ɒ/ A. associate B. appropriate C. adopt
D. social
55. /əʊ/ A. rover B. rostrum C. novel D. modest
56. /b/ A. debt B. subtle C. plumber D. robber
57. /s/ A. decease B. reason C. design D. resume
58. /ʒ/ A. extension B. vision C. caution D. mission
59. /ʃ/ A. pressure B. measure C. scratch
D. sandwich
60. /dʒ/ A. entourage B. confusion C. procedure
D. regime

WASSCE JUNE 2010 ENGLISH LANGUAGE 3

TEST OF ORALS (OBJECTIVE) ANSWERS

- | | | | | | | |
|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|
| 1.C | 2.B | 3.A | 4.C | 5.D | 6.C | 7.C |
| 8.A | 9.A | 10.C | 11.C | 12.C | 13.A | 14.A |
| 15.B | 16.A | 17.B | 18.A | 19.D | 20.A | 21.C |
| 22.A | 23.B | 24.C | 25.A | 26.D | 27.A | 28.A |
| 29.D | 30.D | 31.A | 32.C | 33.B | 34.D | 35.A |
| 36.A | 37.B | 38.C | 39.B | 40.A | 41.A | 42.B |
| 43.D | 44.B | 45.B | 46.A | 47.A | 48.C | 49.D |
| 60.C | | | | | | |

SENIOR SCHOOL CERTIFICATE EXAMINATION (SSCE 1988 – 2015)

Past Questions with Solutions

English Language

(Theory / Objectives with Oral English) 2011

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WASSCE JUNE 2011 ENGLISH LANGUAGE 2 OBJECTIVE TEST QUESTIONS

SECTION 1

In each of the following sentences, there is one underlined word and one gap. From the list of words lettered A to D, choose the one that is most nearly opposite in meaning to the underlined word and that will, at the same time, correctly fill the gap in the sentence.

1. There isn't enough rice, so its importation is permitted whereas the importation of cement is..... A. suspended B. licensed C. unaccepted D. prohibited
2. The cast consisted of many famous actors and a few.....ones.
A. humble B. infamous C. unknown D. unpopular
3. My grandfather, rather than being..... was often quite prejudiced in his opinions.
A. subjective B. discriminating C. impartial D. strict
4. Both sides are very hopeful about the outcome of the peace talks, but observers are still very.....
A. realistic B. emphatic C. explicit D. pessimistic
5. The clever lawyer exposed the facts that were obscure in the case, making the judge see beyond the.....
A. open B. obvious C. illustrated D. reflected
6. It took me the whole day to summarize the lecturer's copious notes having been used to.....ones.
A. scanty B. illegible C. inaccurate D. coherent
7. The principal of that school was demoted for his incompetence while several others were commended for their.....
A. punctuality B. honesty C. efficiency D. sincerity
8. The official who disclosed the information he was supposed to.....was sacked.
A. cover B. protect C. conceal D. allow
9. The prosecutor argued his case vehemently but the defence lawyer responded.....
A. constantly B. feebly C. roughly D. hurriedly

SECTION 2

From the words lettered A to D, choose the word that **best completes** each of the following sentences.

10. While we expected it to be gradual, the process of transition to civilian rule came to an..... end.
A. abrupt B. anticipated C. unhappy D. unpleasant
11. Alfred is afraid of his wife who has a very.....size.
A. eminent B. momentous C. prominent D. intimidating
12. The government has imposed an.....on the importation of used vehicles.
A. order B. edict C. embargo D. act
13. The corpse has been taken to the.....
A. dispensary B. mortuary C. theatre D. ward
14. In spite of the vicissitudes of life, she never..... from her plan.
A. evaded B. detracted C. deviated D. detoured
15. When the solicitor told Awa to wait outside, she considered it.....to her dignity. A. a drawback B. an affront C. a strain D. a withdrawal
16. The meeting cannot start because we have not formed a.....
A. quota B. crowd C. quorum D. chorus
17. The.....of the asylum sang a song for the President.
A. inmates B. occupants C. residents D. tenants
18. His appointment was.....because of irregularities in his credentials. A. annulled B. terminated C. suspended D. dismissed
19. The seminar was held under the.....of the Government. A. jurisdiction B. arbitration C. agreement D. auspices
20. The new car is very attractive but I doubt its.....
A. style B. complexity C. durability D. longevity

SECTION 3

After each of the following sentences, a list of possible interpretations is given. Choose the interpretation that you consider **most appropriate** for each sentence.

21. Had it been possible to leave the country then, I would have done so. This means that
A. I have not left the country and nothing will make me leave.
B. I wanted to leave the country and I did.
C. I will definitely leave the country one day.
D. I would have liked to leave the country but I wasn't able to.
22. The proprietor and his accountant have had a running battle over the last financial report. This means that they have had
A. an argument which developed into a fight.
B. a series of arguments on the report.
C. to work hard to complete the report.
D. difficulties understanding the report.
23. Unless you don't want to become a teacher, there is no reason for not accepting the sponsorship. This means that you should
A. not refuse the sponsorship if you want to become a teacher.
B. refuse the sponsorship if you want to become a teacher.
C. not refuse the sponsorship if you don't want to become a teacher
D. refuse the sponsorship whether you want to be a teacher or not.
24. His chances of passing are very slim. This means that he
A. will pass. B. will not pass. C. may not pass. D. ought to pass.
25. We would never have followed his advice if we had known his reputation. This means that we
A. knew what people said about him so we refused to obey him.
B. trusted him but did not need any advice.
C. followed his advice because we didn't know him
D. trusted him but did not take his advice.
26. All the handsome men left her cold. This means that
A. she needed to wear warm clothes.
B. the men took no notice of her.
C. she was not impressed by them
D. she felt sad and lonely
27. Sulayman can't help shouting at the members of his team. This means that he
A. cannot help them without shouting at them.

- B. can't help them and can't stop shouting.
C. can't control his emotions and keeps shouting.
D. helps them by cheering them.

28. Out of the blue came his letter inviting me to stay with him. This means that the letter came
A. by air. B. in a blue envelope.
C. came unexpectedly. D. by sea.
29. Femi spends precious time building castles in the air. This means that Femi
A. wants to build castles.
B. thinks of impracticable things.
C. is a designer of castles.
D. has made a lot of money.
30. Considering his huge salary, The Director ought to have built a house by now. This means that the Director
A. is not satisfied with his salary.
B. has not built a house yet.
C. earns a lot but his house is still not ready.
D. does not have enough money to build a house.

SECTION 4

From the words or group of words lettered A to D below each of the following sentences, choose the word or group of words that is **nearest in meaning** to the underlined word as it is used in the sentence.

31. Nowadays, children are given much more latitude than before
A. advice B. freedom C. luxury D. variety
32. My neighbour lives a humdrum life.
A. busy B. careless C. monotonous D. humble
33. The Manager described the new accountant as a man of impeccable character.
A. serious B. dangerous C. faultless D. rigid
34. The teacher sent the boy out of the class for his impertinence
A. timidity B. indifference C. rudeness D. cheating
35. This book is the abridged version of the original
A. edited B. detailed C. shortened D. revised
36. After the riot, the streets were blocked with charred vehicles.
A. destroyed B. vandalized C. broken D. burnt
37. The thief's jail terms are to run concurrently.
A. consecutively B. alternatively C. immediately
D. simultaneously

38. The rapper's popularity is beginning to wane.
A. disappear B. change C. disperse D. decline
39. The doctor told his patient about all the things that could impair his health.
A. attack B. terminate C. damage D. reduce
40. The fat old woman looked comical in those trousers.
A. shabby B. ridiculous C. strange D. awkward

SECTION 5

From the word or group of words lettered A to D, choose the word or group of words that **best completes** each of the following sentences.

41. When I arrived, I noticed that he.....the kitchen.
A. had swept B. has swept C. is sweeping D. will sweep
42. He was dismissed because he.....the cheque.
A. must not issue B. ought not to issue C. should not have issued D. will have issued
43. Is there.....chalk in the classroom?
A. a B. any C. many D. plenty
44. The last election resulted.....a disaster for the Socialist Party. A. in B. to C. into D. through
45. The family.....dinner when we knocked at the door.
A. is having B. was having C. had D. has had
46. All.....the president said was reported in the dailies. A. what B. which C. that D. those
47. Which of the two questions is.....?
A. most difficult B. the much difficult
C. the most difficult D. more difficult
48. If it rains, the exhibition will be cancelled,.....?
A. wouldn't it B. isn't it C. won't it D. can't it
49. The rent is too high;.....the house is not in a suitable location. A. therefore B. besides
C. nevertheless D. inasmuch as
50. It's about time your brother.....some attention to his English. A. pays B. is paying C. paid D. had paid
51. The.....toys have all been stolen.
A. children B. childrens C. childrens D. children's
52. Olu passed his examination.....he was a determined student. A. although B. because

C. unless D. when

53. Your friend and mentor,.....his speech.
A. has finished B. is to be finishing C. have finished D. was finished
54.of you does this money belong to?
A. Whom B. Whose C. Who D. Which
55. One of the window panes.....yesterday.
A. were breaking B. was broken C. is to be broken D. have broken
56. No child.....have drawn that picture.
A. can B. will C. could D. may
57. The referee contemplated.....the players off the pitch. A. to send B. to sending C. sending D. to be sending
58. The old woman passed.....when she heard of the robbery. A. out B. by C. off D. through
59. The First Lady wore a.....ring to the reception.
A. very expensive, gold glittering B. gold, very expensive glittering C. very expensive, glittering, gold D. gold, very glittering expensive
60. The new road was completed on schedule.....the difficulties involved.
A. although B. despite C. besides D. however
61.of his evidence made no sense.
A. Many B. Few C. Much D. More
62. The celebrations were rounded.....with a firework display. A. up B. out C. off D. down
63. The members of the association were advised to cooperate with.....A. one another B. each other C. themselves D. one to the other
64. The robe is.....long for the short minister.
A. rather B. much C. very D. quite
65. The professors said that Ade was.....
A. a great student of potential B. a student of great potential C. a great potential student D. of potential a great student
66. His father saw.....that Andrew got all the answers wrong. A. in a glance B. by a glance C. with a glance D. at a glance
67. My friend asked me if I would like to go to Las Palmas for a holiday and I said I.....
A. will B. could C. would D. like

68. Ali dropped the pot accidentally and it.....
A. was breaking B. broke C. breaks D. had broken
69. Every man, woman and child.....asked to contribute. A. were B. are C. was D. have
70. That sack is.....heavy for us to lift
A. very B. so C. too D. quite
71. If the school had been destroyed, we..... home.
A. would go B. would have had to go C. would have to go D. would be going
72. The plane took off..... A. since five minutes
B. five minutes ago C. in the past five minutes
D. by five minutes
73. By Christmas, I.....for one year.
A. shall have been working B. was working
C. shall work D. have worked
74. As they.....the thieves broke into the house.
A. had slept B. are sleeping C. have been sleeping
D. were sleeping
75. All the children were inoculated..... polio.
A. from B. by C. against D. for
76. This plan is an alternative.....the last one.
A. from B. to C. on D. against
77.Ali did not win the elections, he has continued to award scholarships to the less privileged. A. Nevertheless B. However
C. Although D. Despite

SECTION 6

In the following passages, the numbered gaps indicate missing words. Against each number in the list below each passage, **four** options are given in columns lettered A to D. Choose the word that is the **most suitable** to fill the numbered gaps in the passages.

PASSAGE A

This year, the annual school — 78 — was to a workshop in a nearby village. Although it was well before mid-day, the blacksmith was already sweating from the — 79 — from the small — 80 —. He had an assistant who was energetically pumping the — 81 — that was lanning the charcoa into bright red — 82 —. There was no difference between the red-hot coar and the metal. With large — 8 — the smith lifted the hot iron from the fire and placed it on the — 84 —. Quickly, picking up a — 85 —, he began to beat it into the shape he wanted. As he did this, — 86

flew from the hot iron in all directions. After he had achieved the shape he wanted, he threw it into a wooden — 87 — filled with water, where other blackened objects lay.

78.	A	B	C	D
79.	travel	journey	festival	excursion
80.	heat	fire	warmth	energy
81.	generator	oven	furnace	incinerator
82.	valves	bellows	blowers	bligs
83.	anvils	faggots	timbers	lights
84.	pincers	logs	sensors	hooks
85.	board	table	anvil	slate
86.	rod	hammer	club	stone
87.	fragments	chip	rays	sparks
	bowl	trough	jug	pot

PASSAGE B

Man's destruction of his 88 — began to show a very long time ago as vast areas of forests were cleared for use as farmland. Recently, however, serious attempts have been made to control the — 89 — to land and protect the — 90 — of plants and animals from dying out. National — 91 — and — 92 — reserves were established. Man's effort to care for species that are endangered sometimes results in overpopulation because the — 93 — which would naturally keep animal population in — 94 — are absent. As a result of over-grazing, hundreds may die of — 95 —. Another problem is — 96 — their presence in large numbers can — 97 — the animals and disturb their very habitat that is being preserved. Children need to learn about these things. Perhaps cultivating — 98 — in schools or keeping — 99 — at home will kindle their desire to preserve life. It is irresponsible to live in a — 100 — where one cares only about oneself.

88.	A	B	C	D
89.	area	habitat	space	location
90.	damage	metamize	hazard	rot
91.	types	kinde	species	groups
92.	pitcher	sites	fields	parks
93.	recreational	game	hunting	predators
94.	prey	destroyers	victims	prey
95.	line	check	size	control
96.	thrust	starvation	malnutrition	disease
97.	vivans	guards	counties	onlookers
98.	provoke	desire	anger	excite
99.	plants	gardens	grains	toes
100.	pet	birds	various	swans
	situation	world	state	place

WASSCE JUNE 2011 ENGLISH LANGUAGE 2 OBJECTIVE TEST ANSWERS

1.D	2.D	3.C	4.D	5.B	6.A	7.C
8.C	9.B	10.A	11.D	12.C	13.B	14.C
15.B	16.C	17.C	18.B	19.D	20.C	21.D
22.B	23.A	24.C	25.C	26.B	27.C	28.C
29.B	30.B	31.B	32.C	33.C	34.C	35.C
36.D	37.D	38.D	39.C	40.B	41.A	42.C
43.B	44.C	45.B	46.C	47.D	48.B	49.B
50.C	51.C	52.B	53.A	54.D	55.6	56.C
57.C	58.A	59.C	60.B	61.C	62.C	63.A
64.A	65.C	66.D	67.A	68.B	69.C	70.C
71.B	72.B	73.A	74.D	75.C	76.B	77.C
78.D	79.A	80.C	81.B	82.C	83.A	84.C
85.B	86.D	87.A	88.B	89.A	90.C	91.D
92.B	93.D	94.B	95.B	96.C	97.D	98.B
99.A	100.B					

WASSCE JUNE 2011 ENGLISH LANGUAGE I THEORY QUESTIONS

SECTION A

1. You are about to leave secondary school and a friend of yours who is attending school in another town has written to enquire about what you wish to do after leaving school. Write a reply to him, explaining your plans.
2. Write an article suitable for publication in your school magazine on the effects of drug abuse.
3. Write a letter to the Minister of Education in your country on the poor state of schools in your area and its effect on the performance of students.
4. Your house master has just been promoted to head another school. As the house prefect, write a speech you would deliver during the send-off party organized for him.
5. Write a story to illustrate the saying: A stitch in time saves nine.

SECTION B COMPREHENSION

6. Read the following passage **carefully** and answer the questions on it.

As I watched Musa step out of the plane, I concluded that diligence, intelligence and luck had turned Musa from the rustic pauper of thirty years earlier to a highly successful professional. Here was a village boy of yesteryear, an orphan from early life, cheated out of his heritage by his half-brothers and uncles whose actions forced him to fend for himself. So, how did he become an internationally acclaimed computer wizard?

When his well-to-do father died three years after his mother, he had just gained admission to a fee-paying secondary school. Had his parents lived, that would not have been a problem. But his closest relatives were more interested in sharing assets than handling liabilities. They shared the three buildings in the city, as well as several cocoa plantations with hundreds of oil palms. None considered it right to take on the care of the poor boy.

Left in the lurch, he clung on to a classmate who had longed to work in the city as a petty clerk. They moved to the city. Both were engaged by a big-time retailer in all sorts of goods, which he gave out to the boys to hawk on the busy roads. There were no salaries; all they had were commissions from each day's sales. Musa and his friend could be out in the streets from 600a.m. till almost midnight. That way, they were able to keep body and soul together.

But Musa soon decided that his returns could cater for a little more than that. His yearning for education still very keen, he cut short his daily schedules at 400p.m. to attend an evening school organized by some secondary school teachers. And he made very rapid progress. Often, after classes, he would return to the streets. He never fared worse than any of the other learners, most of whom attended classes after normal school. In time, he sat for and passed all his school certificate papers with flying colours. Indeed, his results were among the best in the country.

An oil company which had a policy of sponsoring the university education of the best students in the various disciplines awarded him a scholarship. Thus, his university education in Computer Science was fully sponsored. Eventually, he emerged as the best graduate in the university. The training made him a top 3-D computer programmer in engineering and architectural designs.

So, as he stepped out of the plane, returning from one of his several international conferences, I could not but reach the conclusion I had made earlier.

- (a) Where was the writer when he arrived at the conclusion with which he opened the passage?
- (b) What tragedy had beset Musa early in life?
- (c) What worsened Musa's plight?
- (d) How did Musa solve the problem of acquiring secondary education?
- (e) What element of luck contributed to Musa's success?

- (f) "keep body and soul together."

- (i) What figure of speech is contained in this expression? (ii) What does it mean?

- (g) "who had longed to work in the city.."

- (i) What is the grammatical name given to this expression as it is used in the passage?

- (ii) What is its function?

- (h) For each of the following words or phrase, find another word or phrase which means the same and which can replace it as it is used in the passage: (i) fend for; (ii) considered; (iii) engaged; (iv) yearning; (v) eventually.

7. Read the following passage **carefully** and answer the questions on it.

Although rural people needed kerosene for lighting, they relied on it more for cooking. However, persistent fuel scarcity had made the commodity hardly affordable where it was available. Fetching dry wood from the forest became inevitably the order of the day.

Early one morning, Jojo and I, armed with cutlasses and axes, joined other young people, who were more conversant with the forest, in search of dry wood. It soon dawned on us that this “essential commodity had been driven so far away that we had to wander into the heart of the forest before we could find a huge branch of tree that looked dry. Convinced that it was, we went into action, each cutting from his own side.

Scarcely had we started when Jojo suddenly jumped up from her position and exclaimed “Goodness I” When I inquired what had happened, she explained that the ground on which she was standing was lifting her up. This sounded weird and I went closer to examine the ground. It appeared level and was full of dry leaves. There was no sign of anything other than the bare ground. Mockingly, I asked her to return to work, adding that her phobia about the forest was changing into an illusion. Nevertheless, I struck the ground with my cutlass, cutting through it to reassure her that there was nothing to fear. But before I could leave, we noticed blood trickling out of the cut on the ground and we scampered away, developing goose-flesh.

As we watched from the distance, we observed that there was a writhing movement and gradually, a curled creature stretched into full length of about three and a half feet. The earth but splendid design of the skin became visible and it started what was like its last struggle away from the spot. Its pace was decreasing with every effort to crawl on while more blood was being lost as a result of the deep cut it had received.

Whether it was shock or fear that prevented me from finishing up what I started, I cannot say. But though we accomplished our aim of going to the forest that day, I was haunted by the guilt of an unwilling murderer many days after.

- (a) Why was kerosene important to rural people?
- (b) State two reasons why the people sought an alternative to kerosene.
- (c) What lifted Jojo up?
- (d) What did the narrator start that he could not finish?
- (e) “the heart of the forest...”
 - (i) What figure of speech is contained in this expression? (ii) What does it mean?
- (f) ‘As we watched from the distance...’
 - (i) What is the grammatical name given to this expression as it is used in the passage?
 - (ii) What is its function?
- (g) For each of the following word, find another word or phrase which means the same and which can replace it as it is used in the passage:
 - (i) persistent; (ii) inevitably; (iii) weird; (iv) mockingly;
 - (v) splendid; (vi) accomplished.

SECTION C SUMMARY

8. Read the following passage **carefully** and answer the questions on it.

People are usually unwilling to make changes in their lives after being accustomed to a certain style of life. However, this can cause a lot of problems, as changing circumstances often make a change in lifestyle inevitable. Take for example, people who leave their country and go abroad for various reasons. Such people will inevitably face many challenges. First, they have to adapt to a new culture and habits that are completely different from what they were used to in their own country. They will also have to adapt to the weather and may need to learn a new language, or now, communicate regularly in a language other than their mother tongue, which they used more frequently before their relocation.

Again, at some point in their lives, some people may have cause to change their career. The reasons for this may be varied and need not concern us here. But career changes inevitably necessitate the acquisition of a different set of skills and experience in the new job, a new routine and adaptation to new friends and colleagues at work. In the face of economic recession and related circumstances, people may lose their jobs as the organization they work for try to adjust to the adverse situation by retrenching many of their workers. (Terms such as ‘down-sizing’, ‘right-sizing’ and ‘restructuring’ are the modern day euphemisms for this phenomenon!) A worker who suddenly loses his or her job obviously has to adjust to a new lifestyle—at least, until a new job comes along.

Closely related to job loss is retirement. Many people carry on at their jobs as if they will remain at such jobs forever. But retirement is inevitable not only for the paid worker but also the self-employed. Retirement in most cases means a change from an active working life to a more sedentary lifestyle. It often requires giving up official property such as accommodation and vehicles and the replacement of a regular salary with a modest pension, which may not be regular. Because of these, the prospect of retirement is often viewed with apprehension by many, as they are not prepared for it.

Outside the work domain, other changes inevitably continue to take place. For example, at some point in their lives, young men and women come together and get married and start their own families. The transition from bachelorhood or spinsterhood of course means adaptation to a spouse, raising children, and discarding many of

the habits, often reckless and impulsive, of unmarried life.

Finally, as painful and undesirable as it is, death is inevitable. The untimely loss of a loved one — a wife, a husband, a parent — often turns people's lives upside down, and necessitates a drastic change in lifestyle. Many people never anticipate such a loss, and if unfortunately it does occur, it can be quite devastating. In conclusion, people have to be ready for any changes that may occur in their lives, as change is inevitable and there is no guarantee for anyone that life will be stable forever.

In six sentences, one for each, summarize the six factors that can cause a change in lifestyle as discussed in the passage

WASSCE JUNE 2011 ENGLISH LANGUAGE 1 ESSAY ANSWERS

SECTION A

1. 12 Ben Carson Street,
Adelabu Road,
Surulere,
Lagos.
11th July, 2011.

Dear Bimpe,

How are you? I received your letter last Tuesday and I am very glad you wrote me. My parents are fine. They thank you and Tolu says hi. Simi and I really miss you. Simi is going to write you soon.

I am happy we are all leaving secondary school soon and our long holiday will soon begin. I understand from your letter that you are going to take music lessons and specialize in the piano and violin. Simi is also planning on taking French and Spanish classes as soon as the holidays begin.

However, let me tell you about what I wish to do after leaving secondary school. As you already know, it has been my dream to be a chef and learn how to cook and prepare international dishes. And I plan to pursue that dream once I leave secondary school.

I have also found the perfect place to do it too. It's really close to my house. It is a professional catering school. My mum and I have been there to make certain enquiries like the fees, uniform, time and so on. The place is really big and it is supported by UAC foods. I would have loved to attend the one you recommended but it is all the way in Magodo which is too far. I hope you understand.

Moreover, my classes will only last about two months, so I still have other plans after leaving school. I wish to enrol in a driving school too. There is a spare car at home and once I learn to drive it can be ours for the holiday. Simi and I can even drive down to see you in your boring town. Besides catering and driving school, I also have plans for decorating classes too. But I am happy all three of us will be doing that together!

Say hello to your parents and siblings, especially Bolu.

Yours sincerely,
Bukola

THE EFFECTS OF DRUG ABUSE

2. Drug abuse is characterised by taking more than the recommended dose of prescription drugs such as barbiturates without medical supervision, or using government controlled substances such as marijuana, cocaine, heroin or other illegal substances. Legal substances such as alcohol and nicotine are also abused by many people. Abuse of drugs and other substances can lead to physical and psychological dependence.

Drug abuse can cause a wide range of adverse physical reactions. Long term drug use may damage the heart, liver and brain. Drug abusers may suffer from malnutrition if they habitually forget to eat; most times they cannot afford to buy food or eat food that contains the proper vitamins and minerals.

Individuals who abuse injectable drugs risk contracting infections such as hepatitis and HIV from dirty needles and needles shared with other infected users. One of the most dangerous effects of illegal drug use is the potential for overdose — that is, taking too large or too strong a dose for the body's systems to handle.

A drug overdose may cause an individual to lose consciousness and to breathe inadequately. Without treatment an individual may die from a drug overdose.

Drug addiction is marked by a compulsive craving for a substance. Successful treatment methods vary and include psychological counselling or psychotherapy and detoxification programmes — medically supervised programmes that gradually wean an individual from a drug over a period of days or weeks. Detoxification and psychotherapy are often used together.

The illegal use of drugs was once considered a problem unique to residents of, poor urban neighbourhoods. Today, however, people from all

economic levels in both cities and suburbs abuse drugs to relieve stress and to forget about their problems.

Genetic factors may predispose other individuals to drug addiction. Environmental factors such as peer pressure, especially in young people and the availability of drugs, also influence people to abuse drugs.

Drug abuse can also be seen in the rate at which young people are confined to psychiatric hospitals due to overdose.

3. 10, Jinadu Street,
Aguda,
Surulere — Lagos.
June 6th, 2011.

The Honourable Minister,
Federal Ministry of Education,
WuSe F.C.T.
Abuja - Nigeria.

Dear Sir,

POOR STATE OF SCHOOLS IN MY AREA

I write concerning the poor state of schools in my area and its effect on the performance of students.

I reside in the central part of Surulere which has a large population of people living there. The area accommodates over one million Nigerians from different parts of the country. The same way, there are schools ranging from day care centres, primary schools, secondary schools to a handful of Tertiary institutions.

Among all these schools are the government owned schools popularly referred to as Public Schools". This is so because of the condition of the structures of such schools, like the large number of students in the school, the unwholesome nature of the entire vicinity as well as the laissez-faire attitude of most students in the area.

Among these public schools are: Adebola Baptist High School, Aguda Grammar School, Community Grammar School, Clegg Girls' High School, New Era Girls, Stadium High School, Gbaja Boys High School, Government College and a host of others.

Some of the problems faced by these schools include, absence of functional libraries, poor state of laboratories, insufficient number of subject teachers, open roof classrooms, thereby causing leakages; dilapidated fence and gates, absence of play ground, poor toilet condition, lack of pipe-borne water for students, insufficient food centres, broken chairs and tables, poor condition

of the classrooms, badly fenced premises, non-provision of school buses by government and so on.

Firstly, most schools in Surulere have no libraries and due to this students go as far as Ilupeju, Yaba and Municipal areas to study in the public libraries. This, on its own, is a major fault that demands urgent action by government if the saying that "the Youths are the leaders of tomorrow" is something to hold on to.

Secondly, the poor state of laboratories: in most government schools has become an eyesore. Though those laboratories exist they are nothing but empty structures with no laboratory equipment in them. For science students, most of the chemical equipment for experiments are broken while some have worn out. Even the laboratories lack most modern storage devices, computers, good fans or air conditioners, spacious environment, cupboard, First Aid equipment and other things necessary for students to use for practical classes.

Also, most of these schools in my area lack enough number of subject teachers to teach them. For this purpose, one teacher teaches about two to three subjects, and as we all know, Jack of all trade will definitely end up being master in none.

Some schools in Surulere can hardly survive hot sunny weather or rainy season due to open roof classrooms and half-fenced, buildings. Students even prefer to stay at home during rainy periods because there is no need staying in a classroom that is not better than staying outside.

Due to the bad fence and gates in these schools, students who come late jump over the fence and bypass the gate to escape punishment which is part of learning process for them. What this causes is neglect of teachers, rudeness, waywardness, stubbornness and in severe cases, some boys may end up beating the gatekeeper if he chases after them.

Playing and exercising is another way of making a child to learn, and the facility is highly absent in some schools in Surulere. Even field for football and other sporting activities are not taken into consideration in the designing of the school buildings. At the end of six years it is assumed that the child that passed through this kind of learning environment has incomplete learning procedures as the school has not passed through that child.

One of the most essential needs of man is water and a conducive place to pass out faeces. When these two facilities are not there then the environment remains non-habitable for any one. Even food canteens and centres are to be provided by government whenever a school is going to be

built, since students cannot leave their school to go back home and eat during break periods.

Another most annoying thing is for the teacher to come in to teach and find out that large number of students are either standing or petching on themselves due to broken chairs and tables or shortage of supply of furniture to some schools.

A standard classroom is one with good roofing, good chairs and tables, clean water, electricity, chilled environment, compurs, well ventilated environment as well as peacefi" atmosphere to make the school environment home away from home.

Finally, it is the duty of the government to provide for students school buses, farmland for agricultural science and other things. Since some schools are far from the homes of these students, thereby making them trek long distances to sciool, it will be advisable for government to provide, at least, two school buses to both the junior schools and senior schzols.

However, everything that has a beginning must have an end and every problem in this life has solutions to it. Government must ensure that there is a good and condusive learnin9 environment to make the government schools more attractive than privately owned schools. There is also need for the provision of good roads leading to the schools, more well-structured schools like Queen's and King's Colleges, pipe-borne water, food centres / canteens, laboratories, libraries, good roofs, well equipped classrooms, spacious environment to serve as play ground as well as sporting centres for students. When all the above mentioned amenities are put in place, schools in my area will become more attractive to attend and these would enhance the performance of students to make the nation proud.

4. Good day Mr Chairman, the Principal, Vice Principal, Heads of Department, Staff, my fellow students and distinguished ladies and gentlemen.

I am honoured to stand before this august assembly as the Senior Prefect of the school to deliver my speech on the occasion of today's send-off for Mr. Emmanuel who has been our house master for twelve years and a staff of this reputable school for twenty five years.

From the first day I came in contact with Mr. Emmanuel Olanipekun I knew there was something special about him. He exhibited so much diligence the way he managed the new students on the first day that made the students to draw closer to him.

He was always concerned about the welfare of the students and went an extra mile to see to the comfort of all students.

As the Senior Prefect, I had a great responsibility resting on my shoulders but I was determined to take it up and change the course of things in this great school of ours.

My fellow prefects and I have often encountered the unwholesome behaviour of some of our students and we have tried to use our positions to curtail the excesses of the students.

On occasions like this, Mr. Emmanuel Olanipekun contributed a great deal in helping out with the control of the students and maintained law and order in the school.

During my tenure as the Senior Prefect, the school vicinity has been adjudged as being the cleanest ever in the histo" of the school. I have, with the help of my fellow prefects, been able to provide refuse bins in every nook and cranny of the school. ta students have to pick round the shool every afternoon and this has been a deliberate punitive measure aimed at arresting the situation of dirt that litters all over the school premises.

In order not to forget the main reason for this occasion, Mr. Emmanuel Olanipekun has been an exemplary personality. His efforts will surely be missed by p11 and sundry.

Olalekan Babatunde
Senior Prefect 2010/11

5. A STITCH IN TIME SAVES NINE

This is a story of a woman who refused to train her child when she was young without knowing that a stitch in time saves nine. As I sat in the sofa in the sitting room, tears began to drop from my eyes. This has continued five years after my daughter's death. More tears would always drop from my eyes each time remember that could have saved my only daughter from dying assuming that trained my child when she was still young knowing that prevention is better than cure. Oh God, please forgive me, and please bring back my loving daughter, Lord please, I promise it will not happen again. Oh my daughter why did you do it?" As I remember all these, I could not help but cry aloud, especially as I knew that if I had trained her when she was young, she wouldn't have died.

I got married to Emma about twenty-nine years ago. He was so nice, gentle, handsome and rich that I believed no other man in life could make me happy in life. Our wedding ceremony was wonderful. People, friends and relatives did

everything possible to make sure that the wedding was fantastic. Until date, many people still say it was the best wedding they had ever attended. After our wedding and honey moon in Abuja, we both resumed work at our different places of work. Emma was a medical doctor in LUTH while I was a computer scientist with an oil company in Lagos. We were always very happy together.

Two months after our wedding, I fell sick and was admitted in the hospital. Later, the doctor confirmed that I was pregnant. Emma and I were very happy. I was very very happy because what I wanted was what I was getting through him. Six months after I became pregnant, a policeman walked into my room one day and told me that my husband had been involved in an accident and that he had died instantly. My whole world was shattered. No husband, no more joy and my comfort was gone forever. My whole world was totally changed.

About three months after Emma's death, I gave birth to a baby girl and what a beauty she was. She became the envy of the town as she grew up revealing her intelligence and beauty. I named her Jennifer but she was popularly known as Jen. I decided to pamper her, hence she was my only child. When my neighbours and friends advised me to start to train her, I felt she was too young to learn. When she began school, she performed very well in school and always on top of the class after every examination. I continued to watch her, as she progressed in her education but I never for once helped to train her, correct or even to advise her when she needed all these. Sometimes, I will see her with some boys in the night, some in an inconvenient place for a boy and girl to stay but I will not talk to her. The more she grew the worse she was in behaviour. When she was in SS2, she began to bring home different sorts of friends some of whom looked like thugs. I felt that when she enters higher institution, I would talk to her and probably change her. When she entered SS3, her behaviour became so bad that I couldn't bear it. She refused to keep my instructions. I decided to start correcting her, but it was too late for her to learn. The more I made efforts to correct her, the worse she became. She started attending parties and kept late nights. Sometimes, she might even stay the whole night without coming home until the next day. I started to shout to make her change but all the efforts I made were in vain.

On a wonderful Saturday when I came back from shopping I received a telephone call from a hospital informing me that Jen had been admitted in the hospital. I ran straight to the hospital and saw Jen my beautiful daughter crying on a sick

bed. When I met the doctor, he told me that Jen's case was very critical because a quack doctor had attempted to abort her pregnancy. The operation of the quack doctor had damaged her womb severely and her womb had been seriously infected. About an hour after I got to the hospital, my daughter was wheeled into the theatre for a major operation. I stayed in the reception. I couldn't help blaming myself because I did not train her when I was supposed to train her. I felt that she was still young to learn and when she grows up I would teach her. Now, it looked like it was too late to train her.

I began to pray earnestly as the doctor came out of the theatre. He explained that my daughter had suffered loss of too much blood and that it was too late to save her life. She died shortly before he came out. I shouted and cried as I watched my life tumble down a second time. This time, I knew it was my fault as I did not advise her when she needed motherly advice and care, I did not do what I was supposed to do at the right time, now I had shattered my whole life myself. From Jen's death, I learnt that a stitch in time saves nine.

COMPREHENSION SECTION B

6.

- (a) The writer was at the airport.
- (b) Musa (had) lost his parents.
- (c) His relatives deprived him of his inheritance/his father's wealth and did not take care of him.
- (d) He attended an evening school.
- (e) An oil company sponsored his university education/awarded him a scholarship.
- (f) Metaphor
 - (i) manage to exist/live/survive.
- (g) Adjectival/Relative clause. It qualifies (the noun) classmate.
- (h) (ii) fend for ---- take care of (ii) considered ---- thought, deemed. (iii) engaged employed, hired, take on (iv) yearning craving, desire, longing (v) eventually finally, at last, in the end, at the end of the day.
- (a) Rural people needed kerosine for lighting and cooking.
- (b) (i) kerosene was scarce (ii) it was expensive/it was hardly affordable.
- (c) A snake/a curled creature
- (d) The killing of the snake/the curled creature.
- (e)(i) Metaphor
 - (ii) The middle or innermost part of the forest.
- (f)(i) Adverbial clause, (of time) (ii) it modifies (the verb) observed.
- (g) (i) persistent ---- continual, continued, unending, frequent, prolonged. (ii) inevitably

unavoidably, certainly, inescapably. (iii) weird strange, unusual, odd, abnormal (iv) mockingly teasingly, In jest (v) splendid --- beautiful, impressive, magnificent. (vi) accomplished --- achieved, realized, fulfilled.

SECTION C SUMMARY

7. (a) Change of location/relocation (b) change of job/career status/marriage (c) loss of job/employment (d) retirement (e) change in marital (f) the loss/death of loved one.

WASSCE JUNE 2011 ENGLISH LANGUAGES TEST OF ORALS (OBJECTIVE)

SECTION 1

From the words lettered A to D, choose the word that has the **same vowel sound** as the one represented by the letter(s) underlined. An example is given below.

Example: seat A. sit B. cite C. set D. key.

The correct answer is D because only key contains the **same vowel sound** as the one underlined in seat. Therefore, answer space D would be shaded.

[A] [B] [C] [D]

Now answer the questions that follow:

1. foal A. pull B. pool C. pail D. pole
2. aw A. bale B. bore C. low D. bough
3. won A. one B. con C. wan D. clone
4. base A. reign B. bust C. chastity D. bassoon
5. wanted A. elder B. kid C. showed D. fed
6. jealous A. admit B. outside C. mousse D. pout
7. pier A. liar B. pie C. peers D. pears
8. lie A. loin B. python C. pantheon D. sieve
9. class A. chat B. curse C. last D. claims
10. tourism A. poor B. bare C. doer D. dear
11. west A. mist B. feast C. bait D. jest
12. mirth A. much B. word C. myth D. weird
13. cord A. fond B. quote C. gaunt D. quaint
14. vary A. very B. veil C. scarce D. lazy
15. queue A. quit B. chew C. quest D. church

SECTION 2

From the words lettered A to D, choose the word that has the **same consonant sound(s)** as the one represented by the letter(s) underlined. An example is given below.

Example: vice A. cat B. dress C. show D. chalk

The correct answer is B because only dress has the same consonant sound as the one underlined in vice. Therefore, answer space B would be shaded.

[A] [B] [C] [D]

Now, answer the questions that follow.

16. wives A. chose B. chokes C. verse D. noose
17. chic A. chick B. machine C. chemist D. champion
18. chiefs A. bags B. kites C. moves D. thieves
19. mate A. stand B. damn C. punt D. pawn

20. smith A. both B. boot C. clothe D. smooth
21. red A. erred B. arid C. aired D. are
22. wings A. pins B. winds C. wigs D. lungs
23. quiet A. scud B. quay C. screw D. queasy
24. oxen A. buzz B. dusk C. books D. toss
25. balcony A. talk B. local C. sulk D. colt
26. examine A. assume B. excess C. axle D. exhaust
27. guitar A. gem B. gnarl C. nought D. get
28. satchel A. sachet B. cheer C. sack D. mash
29. whom A. when B. ahoy C. dawn D. war
30. cary A. laugh B. half C. new D. vein

SECTION 3

From the words lettered A to D, choose the word that **rhymes** with the given word. An example is given below.

Example: obtain A. detain B. detail C. claim D. relay

The correct answer is A because only obtain rhymes with detain. Therefore, answer space A would be shaded.

[A] [B] [C] [D]

Now answer the questions that follow.

31. Owe A. awe B. dough C. won D. how
32. caught A. found B. laugh C. court D. cough
33. leapt A. left B. jumped C. pumped D. kept
34. write A. bright B. writ C. writhe D. brat
35. first A. pest B. worst C. next D. birds

SECTION 4

In each of the following questions, the main/primary stress is indicated by writing the syllable on which it occurs in capital letters.

From the words lettered A to D, choose the word that has the **correct stress**. An example is given below.

Example: democratic

- A. DE-mo-cra-tic B. de-MO-cra-tic
C. de-mo-CRA-tic D. de-mo-cra-TIC

The correct answer is C because the main/primary stress of the word democratic is on the third syllable. Therefore, answer space C would be shaded.

[A] [B] [C] [D]

Now answer the questions that follow.

36. mannerism

- A. MAN-ner-i-sm B. man-NER-i-sm
C. man-ner-l-sm D. man-ner-i-SM
37. intimately
A. IN-ti-mate-ly B. in-TI-mate-ly
C. in-ti-MATE-ly D. in-ti-mate-LY
38. manufacture
A. MAN-u-fac-ture B. man-U-fac-ture
C. man-u-FAC-ture D. man-u-fac-TURE
39. accidental
A. AC-ci-den-tal B. ac-CI-den-tal
C. ac-ci-DEN-tal D. ac-ci-den-TAL
40. directorate
A. DI-rec-tor-ate B. di-REC-tor-ate
C. di-rec-TOR-ate D. di-rec-tor-ATE

SECTION 5

In the following options lettered A to D, all the words except one have the **same stress pattern**. Identify the one with the different stress pattern and shade your answer in the usual way. An example is given below.

Example: A. away B. apart C. .behind D. river
Options A, B, C are all stressed on the second syllable while option D is the only one stressed on the first syllable. So, D is the correct answer. Therefore, answer space D would be shaded.

[A] [B] [C] [D]

Now answer the questions that follow.

41. A. dinner B. cardboard C. postage D. advice
42. A. picture B. doctor C. pattern D. receive
43. A. special B. revise C. molest D. sincere
44. A. invitation B. graduation C. photography D. photographic
45. A. mosquito B. recorder C. possible D. laconic

SECTION 6

In each of the following sentences, the word that receives the **emphatic stress** is written in capital letters. From the questions lettered A to D, choose the one to which the given sentence is the appropriate answer. An example is given below.

Example: My mother's FRIEND hates pets.

- A. Does your mother's boss hate pets?
B. Does your mother's friend love pets?
C. Does your mother's friend hate toys?
D. Does your father's friend hate pets?

The correct answer is A because My mother's FRIEND hates pets answers the question, Does your mother's boss hate pets? Therefore, answer space A would be shaded.

[A] [B] [C] [D]

Now answer the questions that follow.

46. Lyn SUCCEEDED in her ambitious business.

- A. Did Jane succeed in her ambitious business?
B. Did Lyn succeed in her modest business?
C. Did Lyn fail in her ambitious business?
D. Did Lyn succeed in her ambitious studies?

47. Some DECENTLY dressed men are dishonest.
A. Are some decently dressed women dishonest?
B. Are all decently dressed men dishonest?
C. Are some decently dressed men honest?
D. Are some shabbily dressed men dishonest?
48. My favourite AUNT sings like a nightingale.
A. Does my favourite aunt sing like an owl?
B. Does my favourite uncle sing like a nightingale?
C. Does my favourite aunt talk like a nightingale?
D. Does his favourite aunt sing like a nightingale?
49. Hardworking students usually PASS their examinations.
A. Do lazy students usually pass their examinations?
B. Do hardworking students usually fail their examinations?
C. Do hardworking students rarely pass their examinations?
D. Do hardworking students usually pass their interviews?
50. A fox is better than a WILD dog.
A. Is a cat better than a wild dog?
B. Is a fox worse than a wild dog?
C. Is a fox better than a domesticated dog?
D. Is a fox better than a wild cat?

SECTION 7

From the words lettered A to D, choose the word that contains the **sound** represented by the given **phonetic symbol**. An example is given below.

Example: /ɔ:/ A. yell B. holy C. boy D. idiot

The correct answer is C because only boy contains the sound represented by the given symbol. Therefore, answer space C would be shaded.

[A] [B] [C] [D]

Now answer the questions that follow.

51. /ə/ A. bother B. broader C. udder D. author
52. /æ/ A. hut B. apt C. jump D. mace
53. /ɒ/ A. rot B. wrap C. wrought D. wraith
54. /ʊ/ A. one B. punk C. none D. pawn
55. /j/ A. cut B. pay C. cute D. wire
56. /ɪ/ A. watch B. wedge C. leash D. purge
57. /ɪ/ A. calm B. could C. talk D. vale
58. /ɒ/ A. hot B. goat C. fund D. laid
59. /aɪ/ A. buy B. power C. tear D. sail
60. /aʊ/ A. laugh B. may C. tough D. plough

WASSCE JUNE 2011 ENGLISH LANGUAGE 3 TEST OF ORALS (OBJECTIVE) ANSWERS															
1.D	2.B	3.A	4.D	5.B	6.B	7.C	8.B	9.C	10.A	11.D	12.D	13.C	14.D	15.B	16.D
17.D	18.B	19.B	20.A	21.C	22.D	23.D	24.A	25.D	26.D	27.D	28.A	29.D	30.D	31.B	32.C
33.D	34.A	35.B	36.A	37.B	38.A	39.C	40.B	41.B	42.D	43.A	44.C	45.A	46.C	47.C	48.D
49.B	50.A	51.C	52.A	53.B	54.D	55.A	56.D	57.B	58.D	59.A	60.D				

SENIOR SCHOOL CERTIFICATE EXAMINATION (SSCE 1988 – 2015)

Past Questions with Solutions

English Language

(Theory / Objectives with Oral English) 2012

WASSCE JUNE 2012 ENGLISH LANGUAGE 2

OBJECTIVE TEST QUESTIONS

SECTION 1

In each of the following sentences, there is one underlined word and one gap. From the list of words lettered A to D, choose the one that is **most nearly opposite in meaning** to the underlined word and that will, at the same time, correctly, fill the gap in the sentence.

1. Although the atmosphere was hostile, the meeting ended on.....terms. A. gentle
B. unacceptable C. suspicious D. amicable
2. The company had to..... the restaurant in order to construct a hotel.
A. demolish B. abandon C. damage D. relocate
3. Five years ago the economy of our country was buoyant but nowadays it has become.....
A. profitable B. distressed C. unbearable D. low
4. We enjoy real stories not those that are.....
A. imaginary B. practical C. vague D. undefined
5. Ann's efficiency earned her a promotion while Jane's.....caused her dismissal. A. lateness
B. capability C. incompetence D. laziness
6. While Rashida's business is flourishing, Ida's is..... A. declining B. diminishing C. vanishing
D. withering
7. Clara is full of admiration for Lena but she treats me with..... A. despair B. callousness
C. carelessness D. disdain
8. The contribution would be.....not compulsory.
A. wilful B. voluntary C. deliberate D. outright
9. In those societies, the.....and the cultured lived together.
A. ignorant B. rich C. barbaric D. arrogant
10. Some people live in abject poverty while others live in.....
A. affluence B. greatness C. fame D. peace

SECTION 2

From the words lettered A to D, choose the word that **best completes** each of the following sentences.

11. When you.....someone's point of view, you should do so politely. A. refute B. rebuke C. recall
D. refuse
12. One should.....the land very well if one expects a bumper harvest
A. water B. dig C. cultivate D. clear
13. His lecture was.....and so the students did not understand it. A. indefinite B. illegible C. unintelligible D. unimpressive
14. In Botany, one is bound to.....flowers.
A. read B. know C. study D. examine
15. Harry cannot do without his.....of short stories because he loves reading.
A. file B. library C. collection D. dictionary
16. Can you.....the result of tomorrow's match?
A. conclude B. predict C. order D. certify
17. The river.....across the plain.
A. rolled B. meandered C. trickled D. passed
18. Since the army was no longer needed, it was..... A. demolished B. dismantled
C. disbanded D. fired
19. It is most.....that the company spent five million naira on that fragile fence. A. outstanding
B. wonderful C. remarkable D. astonishing
20. Matters that are confidential must not be made.....
A. public B. popular C. unreasonable D. uncertain

SECTION 3

After each of the following sentences, a list of possible interpretations is given. Choose the interpretation that you consider **most appropriate** for each sentence.

21. The boy went scot-free even though he insulted his teacher. This means that the boy was
A. not punished. B. free to move about.
C. expelled from school. D. cautioned seriously.

22. The driver escaped death by a hair's breadth. This means that the driver escaped death
A. fast. B. luckily. C. surprisingly. D. narrowly.
23. I am given a free hand to run this business. This means that I
A. am allowed to make my own decisions.
B. make my own appointments.
C. assist the workers willingly.
D. alone can choose my executives.
24. In every good transaction, there should be some give-and-take. This means that
A. transactions are about giving
B. transactions give and take.
C. any gift should be accepted willingly.
D. people should be willing to make compromises.
25. That account of the incident is true to a degree. This means that the account is
A. totally wrong. B. not clear. C. completely true. D. partly true.
26. Moses won the contest hands down. This means that Moses won
A. surprisingly. B. very easily. C. narrowly. D. with difficulty.
27. They vowed to win the race by hook Or by crook. This means that they vowed to win by
A. peaceful negotiations.
B. any possible means.
C. bribing the other competitors.
D. being honest.
28. William spent the first three months learning the ropes. This means that he
A. pulled all the ropes that should be putd.
B. learnt what the job demanded.
C. knew what to do.
D. was unwilling to learn.
29. Our teacher advised us not to go with the crowd. This means that he advised us not to
A. stay too much in the crowd.
B. travel with the crowd,
C. have many friends.
D. be unduly influenced by others.
30. Although the men weië foreigners, they were given preferential treatment. This means that the men were treated
A. better than others. B. with caution.
C. with respect. D. very quickly.

SECTION 4

From the words lettered A to D below each of the following sentences, choose the word or group of words that is **nearest in meaning** to the underlined word as it is used in the sentence.

31. John bled profusely as a result of the accident.
A. slowly B. excessively C. extremely D. abundantly
32. What you are suggesting is not feasible.
A. capable B. practicable C. attractive D. easy
33. Pa Bakary augmented his income by selling firewood. A. saved B. preserved C. increased D. economized
34. He plays the kora with dexterity.
A. wisdom B. force C. pride D. skill
35. The police could not apprehend all the gamblers.
A. charge B. interrogate C. arrest D. prosecute
36. Afa has a conspicuous nose.
A. prominent B. flat C. battered D. pointed
37. Many parents are upset by the laxity with which children treat academic work nowadays.
A. repulsed B. constrained C. confused D. troubled
38. In order to keep the peace I had to retract my statement.
A. alter B. refine C. withdraw D. deny
39. Their father is so vigilant that it is not possible for his children to play truant.
A. intelligent B. watchful C. rigid D. concerned
40. The principal endorsed my travelling documents without delay. A. corrected B. checked C. reviewed D. approved

SECTION 5

From the words or group of words lettered A to D, choose the word or group of words that **best completes** each of the following sentences.

41. Please, run.....fifty copies of this report for me.
A. off B. on C. over D. out
42. My father's seventieth birthday.....a celebration.
A. is called for B. will be called for C. calls for D. call for
43. Kojo succeeded in passing his examinationthe odds he faced.
A. regardless B. despite C. moreover D. however

44. If the police had not intervened quickly, the suspected thief.....by the mob.
A. would have been killed B. would be killed
C. wilt have been killed D. will be killed
45. Harry hates.....in suspense. A. been kept
B. keeping C. being kept D. haven been kept
46. We are not bound to believe all.....He said.
A. what B. which C. these D. that
47. Margaret forgot to buy.....
A. a trousers D. one trousers C. a pair of trousers
D. plenty trousers
48. He was charged.....stealing from the company's safe. A. about B. in C. of D. with
49. The teacher had hardly turned his back.....the class became noisy.
A. than B. when C. then D. hence
50. The hardened criminal was convicted.....breaking into Danso's house.
A: with B. in C. of D. for
51. This is Kunles handwriting; there..... be no argument about it.
A. could B. couldn't C. can D. can't
52. In Matamina no one is.....the law.
A. over B. within C. above D. outside
53. Luckily, Frank arrived just.....time to catch the plane. A. by B. within C. to D. in
54. Those boys will have to blame.....for not listening to advice. A. each other B. ourselves
C. the other D. themselves
55. This is not your book, it is.....
A. Andrew B. Andrew's C. Andrews D. Andrews'
56. John said he had never.....insulted in his life.
A. so been B. been so C. being so D. so being
57. I asked Penda to stand..... for me since I could not attend the meeting.
A. on B. aside C. in D. by
58. Femi, Tom is Aka's son,.....?
A. is he B. he is C. isn't it D. isn't he
59. You will help me lift this box,.....?
A. Won't you B. would you C. can you
D. could you
60. Salty assisted me in buying my.....yesterday.
A. very first party dress B. first very party dress
C. party very first dress D. party dress first very
61. The cook had.....oil and so could not prepare the soup.
A. little B. small C. some D. much
62. We will have to set up a.....panel to investigate this matter.
A. seven men B. seven-men C. seven man
D. seven-man
63. The workers could not move the heavy stone.....they tried.
A. how much B. as much as C. no matter that
D. however hard
64. The friendiy match will kick.....at 4.00 p.m. today as scheduled.
A. up B. on C. of D. off
65. The boys.....football when the teacherentered the class.
A. are discussing B. were discussing
C. will be discussing D. will discuss
66. Our teacher is.....to make such a mistake.
A. too much intelligent B. intelligent too much
C. much too intelligent D. too intelligent much
67. Some people find it difficult not to give..... to temptation.
A. away B. over C. in D. off
68. If your argument is not strong enough, you..... your claim to your father's property.
A. had forfeited B. would forfeit C. will forfeit
D. have forfeited
69. While he was in prison he had..... time to read a lot of books.
A. ample B. real C. few D. most
70. Anyone who wants to succeed in any endeavour should.....his lazy habits.
A. shake off. B. shake down C. shake out
D. shake in
71. No sooner had they arrived..... we left the hall.
A. than B. when C. so D. therefore
72. Any good newspaper will cater for the..... needs of the public.
A. reader, B. readers C. reading D. readable

73. The little boy found it difficult to keep pace.....
his father. A. against B. by C. with D. over

SECTION 6

In the following passages, the numbered gaps indicate missing words. Against each number in the list below each passage, four options are offered in columns lettered A to D. Choose the word that is the **most suitable** to fill the numbered gaps in the passages.

PASSAGE A

Fred loves the weekends because they afford him the opportunity to visit the popular—74—where his friend, the—75—, always allows him to go through the newspapers at no cost to him. There are usually many daily and weekly —76— of newspapers, magazines and journals on sale. Fred's habit is to quickly note from the —77— the papers that had arrived. Next, he glances at the —78— of the leading stories and then the —79— that are printed underneath the pictures on the front and back pages. Thereafter, he decides on which one to read. He has his favourite —80—and he especially loves to read the —81— which are usually written by editors. He also enjoys the —82— sent in by the —83—journalists because he believes that they write objectively. The —84— sadden him because they remind him that life is transient. However, whatever gloominess these bring about is quickly wiped away by the excitement from the —85—pages. These pages keep him informed of his favourite clubs, players and match fixtures.

	A	B	C	D
74.	newsagent	newsstand	newsletter	newscast
75.	vendor	hawker	trader	merchant
76.	reprints	impressions	units	editions
77.	machinists	names	index	title
78.	toiles	headlines	layouts	captions
79.	copies	subscrip	columns	sections
80.	extracts	columns	columns	serials
81.	feature	publications	editorials	writings
82.	articles	works	entireties	entireties
83.	amateur	lay	freelance	carefree
84.	clubhouses	dinges	pictures	entireties
85.	football	games	recreation	sports

PASSAGE B

Last week Mrs. Coker took her sick daughter to the hospital. After examining her, the doctor said that the child didn't have much —86—to the parasites, which

the laboratory —87—discovered in her blood —88. He advised her to give the child the prescribed drugs and to keep out the flies that—89— the disease. He told Mrs. Coker that the disease was in its early —90— and that the obvious symptom was the —91— of the eye membranes. This was caused by the trachoma virus, which could not be seen under a —92— because it is smaller than bacterial —93—. He made her realise that trachoma could cause blindness. Therefore, Mrs. Coker should protect her family from this —94— disease. She should maintain a high standard of —95— by —96— her towels and face cloths. The doctor then wrote out a —97— of antibiotic drugs and tablets, which should be obtained from a—98— . He assured Mrs. Coker that the treatment he had prescribed would—99— the child to good—100—in two or three days.

	A	B	C	D
86.	resistance	reaction	opposition	energy
87.	opposed	technician	nurse	acid
88.	sample	type	group	portion
89.	maintain	give	carry	deliver
90.	circumstances	positions	sleep	stages
91.	itching	enlargement	inflammation	growth
92.	telescope	endoscope	stethoscope	microscope
93.	organisms	fungi	vermin	pests
94.	parasitic	contagious	directly	potentially
95.	hygiene	upkeep	living	health
96.	sterilizing	washing	cooking	drying
97.	prescription	recommendation	description	prescription
98.	pharmacist	scientist	practitioner	nurse
99.	novice	novice	repair	curb
100.	standard	state	health	position

1.D	2.A	3.B	4.A	5.C	6.A	7.D
8.B	9.C	10.A	11.A	12.C	13.C	14.C
15.C	16.B	17.B	18.C	19.D	20.A	21.A
22.D	23.A	24.D	25.D	26.B	27.B	28.B
29.D	30.A	31.B	32.B	33.C	34.D	35.C
36.A	37.A	38.C	39.B	40.D	41.D	42.C
43.B	44.A	45.C	46.D	47.C	43.D	49.B
50.C	51.D	52.C	53.D	54.D	55.B	56.B
57.C	58.D	59.A	60.A	61.A	62.D	63.D
64.D	65.B	66.C	67.C	68.C	69.A	70.A
71.A	72.C	73.C	74.B	75.A	76.D	77.A
78.C	79.D	80.B	81.C	82.A	83.C	84.A
85.D	86.A	87.B	88.A	89.C	90.D	91.C
92.A	93.A	94.B	95.A	96.B	97.D	98.A
99.B	100.C					

WASSCE JUNE 2012 ENGLISH LANGUAGE I THEORY QUESTIONS

(SECTION A) ESSAY

- You have spent about six weeks in your new school. Write a letter to your father telling him about your experiences so far.
- Write an article for publication in your school magazine on the dangers of keeping bad company in school.
- Activities such as debates, drama and excursions are now rare in schools in your country. As the Senior Prefect, write a letter to your principal suggesting the revival of these activities and

pointing out what students stand to gain from taking part in them.

- You are the Chief Speaker i.e a debate on the topic: Violent video games should be banned. Write your argument for or against the topic.
- Write a story to illustrate the saying: Where there's a will, there's a way.

ENGLISH LANGUAGE 1 THEORY
(SECTION B) COMPREHENSION

6. Read the following passage **carefully** and answer the questions on it.

When Bademosi heard that he had some visitors from Ireti, his hometown, he concluded immediately that they must be the usual seekers of financial assistance, or jobs. He decided that this time, he would give them the rough edge of his tongue. They had come because earlier callers had not reported what he had stressed: that he was not in Kapitatown for anyone's sake.

He took his time to put his office and workshop in order, determined not to leave in a hurry just because of some stubborn fortune-seekers. He made sure that all his seventy-two workers had signed out before he signalled to his driver. There, in the huge limousine, he thought of the new multi-million dollar contract for his construction company and how he would get a helicopter from the profit. That would be the ultimate solution to the persistent problem of the traffic congestion which he faced in Kapitatown.

The five-kilometre distance to his mansion was covered in about two hours. On arrival, his youngest wife informed him that his visitors were chiefs from Ireti. He felt a revulsion as he imagined that they must have come with a king-size request. As he entered the house, he steeled his mind. However, the three chiefs disarmed him with their cheerful smiles. Each met him in the doorway with a bear hug. As soon as the chit-chat ended, they announced that the Ireti ruling council had decided to confer on him the highest traditional title of the land, and that a date had been set for the great event. He was flabbergasted: so they had come with an offer. He immediately accepted.

Thereafter, things moved very fast. He contacted all the great names in the country, among them his state governor, the top politicians in the land and his business associates from far and near. However, he did not even pay a preparatory visit to Ireti. He took everything for granted.

The great day came. Hundreds of limousines from far and near streamed into Ireti. As he was not the only awardee, the conferment ceremony began with the others. Each took about fifteen minutes: so before Bademosi's turn, all his invited guests had arrived. Just as he was called, some heavily-built youngsters appeared. Shouting into the microphone, their leader announced, "Bademosi doesn't deserve this conferment and cannot have the title, A man who has deserted his community for more than thirty years, who did not think it proper to return home to care for his ailing

parents before they died, and who has consistently turned deaf ears to the calls of our youths, cannot have the title Good day, everybody!"

With that, the youths continued to appear in their hundreds, angry and fierce, wielding all forms of weapons, warning everybody to disappear immediately, otherwise heads would roll, including theirs if the police wanted it so. Within minutes, the whole arena was deserted.

(a) How had Bademosi treated visitors from his hometown?

(b) What evidence is there in the passage that Bademosi is wealthy?

(c) Why has Bademosi planned to buy a helicopter?

(d) What should Bademosi have done before the day of the conferment of the title?

(e) Give two reasons why the youths objected to Bademosi's installation?

(f) "As soon as the chit-chat ended..." (i) What is the grammatical name given to this expression as it is used in the passage? (ii) What is its function?

(g) "...give them the rough edge of his tongue,"

(i) What figure of speech is used in this expression? (ii) What does it mean?

(h) For each of the following words, find another word or phrase which means the same and which can replace it as it is used in the passage:

(i) stressed; (ii) ultimate; (iii) flabbergasted; (iv) deserted; (v) disappear.

7. Read the following passage **carefully** and answer the questions on it.

Part of my one-year study programme in Britain involved visiting several places of historical importance, especially those related to precolonial African history on which I was researching. One was the home of William Wilberforce, the 19th century anti-slave trade statesman. The house had been turned into a museum by one of the several organizations that fought the scourge. Among the most outstanding features of the museum were the several statues of slaves in different postures: black slaves being captured in their native homes, being chained together, being led to the port for sale, on the slave ship and being forced to work on plantations. The sculptures were particularly remarkable in that they illustrated very movingly the bane which Wilberforce threw himself against.

As a black man, I could not help shedding tears when going from room to room on the two floors. Then, there was a period of pandemonium which I, unwittingly, caused. I was on the first floor, about to cross the lobby, when I came face to face with another visitor, a white man. When he

saw me, a wave of fright swept through him. His eyes were immediately bloodshot. He shouted out of fright and ran back. Quickly, he made for the staircase, sped down to the ground floor, and took to his heels.

All this while, I remained still, at a loss as to the cause of his action. He stopped shouting only when he got into the bus that brought his group. Meanwhile, others around him, realizing the cause of his fright, came to tell me that I was the cause. They laughed it off when they told me that he had thought I was one of the statues and had suddenly turned into a human being. I discovered the reason for his fright when I entered the room which he had just left and found that one of the statues looked exactly like me. Whoever did the wax model perhaps had my picture. It was my height, my shape, my complexion, indeed the exact replica of me.

I realized what had happened. I was the only black present in the building. The man had not expected a live black person to be in the museum. Thus, the sudden sight of a black person moving around, with the stature and face of one of the statues, should certainly frighten him. I wondered what could have happened if I had pursued him down the staircase.

- (a) In what capacity did the writer visit the museum?
- (b) For what was William Wilberforce famous?
- (c) Why did the writer stand out among the visitors in the museum at that hour?
- (d) Why was the other man frightened?
- (e) Why had the man assumed that the writer was a statue that had come alive?
- (f) "a wave of fright swept through him..." (i) What figure of speech is contained in the expression above? (ii) What does it mean?
- (g) "...that brought his group..." (i) What grammatical name is given to this expression as it is used in the passage? (ii) What is its function?
- (h) For each of the following words, find another word or phrase which means the same and

SECTION C SUMMARY

8. Read the following passage **carefully** and answer the questions on it.

The number of people living in slums worldwide is estimated to be more than a billion. Experts in urbanization fear that the ever-growing slums in the world will soon become more populous than the cities. Findings like these, however, do not show clearly the devastating effect which substandard living conditions have on the poor. The situation is more serious in developing countries, where many people lack

basic amenities, adequate housing and modern health care services.

It is an irony that while some of the richest nations want to build colonies on the moon and explore Mars, growing numbers of their poorest citizens cannot afford a decent place to live here on earth. It might be easy to conclude that the poor could remedy their situation if they showed more initiative, but factors involved in the housing crisis are beyond their control. The world's population is increasing at an alarming rate, such that millions of houses are needed to keep pace with this development.

It is a fact that cities provide more facilities than the rural areas. It is easier to get electricity and good water supply, pursue one's education and secure well-paid jobs in cities than villages. Very often those in the villages hanker for such opportunities. One cannot therefore blame them when they seize the first opportunity to reside in the cities. They do not mind going away from the villages to reside in congested cities, thereby contributing to over-population in the cities.

In troubled areas of the world, political disasters, civil wars and suicide bombing are common. Poor people, women and children run away from such troubled areas to preserve their lives. They seek refuge in whatever shelter they can find when existing buildings are completely destroyed. The relationship between housing and poverty cannot be ignored. People who cannot afford basic necessities as food and clothing, may not be able to rent or, build decent houses. These and other factors have forced millions of people to settle for substandard housing. They live in abandoned buses, shipping containers cardboard boxes and other unthinkable places.

The housing problems, just like many other problems facing the world, should be tackled with urgency. However, the cost of land for the erection of houses is high. Even when land is secured, the high cost of building materials is another problem to contend with. One must not therefore blame building agencies which employ methods that enable them to build inexpensive houses.

- (a) In five sentences, one for each, state the causes of the worldwide housing problems.
- (b) In one sentence, summarize the measures that poor people have adopted to solve their housing problem.

**WASSCE JUNE 2012 ENGLISH LANGUAGE 1
ESSAY ANSWERS**

SECTION A

1. 3, Efe Street,

Benin City,
Edo State,
13th July, 2012.

Dear Daddy,

I am writing you this letter to find out the state of your health and to let you know what school life is for the past six weeks. In fact, I will sincerely let you know that nearly all the teachers teaching in the school are performing very well as to the quality of materials delivered by them. I thought that I would not get a better Mathematics teacher again when I left St. Peter's International School but I must confess to you that the quality and method employed by my present teacher surpassed that of the former. So Maths as at today is becoming an interesting subject.

In my present school, the quality of food and eating environment is very okay. The quantity and quality of food they serve us when compared to my former school is far better.

The bullying which is the order of the day in my former school does not exist in this school. Senior students take the junior students as their younger brothers and sisters. The relationship that exists between the senior students and their junior one's is very cordial.

The only aspect of the school I am not too happy about is getting water to perform our domestic work. Once there is no electricity supply, the school pumps will cease to work. This will then force students to trek some kilometres to get water through narrow pathway.

Dad, the school is blessed with standard and well equipped laboratories. Students perform their tasks with ease and no rancour at all, hoping that we students make use of this opportunity and come out with good grades.

Please dad, kindly express my sincere greetings to my mother, Uncle Femi and others. To you, I really appreciate you for all that you are doing to build a self-sustained family.

Yours sincerely,
Owolabi

2. DANGERS OF BAD COMPANY

Bad company can be said to be having a set of immoral friends and taking after them, just as they are to you. Having a bad company can occur in different ways, depending on what you do most, where you are and your activities in such places like school and home.

The major effect of bad company is loss of interest in studies. Bad friends do not encourage a person to take his/her studies seriously. All they could do is either teach one how to drink and smoke or prostitute by taking to sugar daddies or mummies. If it is for a girl, she is likely to get pregnant and at the same time contract HIV and AIDS and for a boy, he is prone to becoming a drunk accompanied by HIV and AIDS which can ruin his future completely.

Bad company can also make a student to accommodate arrogance as his or her paramount behaviour towards the school authority. This can be by breaking the school rules and regulations in the sense that he or she will be coming late to school, fighting his or her mates for unreasonable issues and known to be rude to teachers in the school. He can lead in school fight against other schools, not knowing that he is likely to be suspended from school or even expelled if care is not taken. This will mark the end of his or her education and such a child can become a threat to both his neighbourhood and country and consequently become a criminal.

Bad company can bring about the initiation of a student into secret cults. This always involves taking the lives of others intentionally.

I want to advise everyone to look before you leap. This is because there is an adage which says "show me your friend and I will tell you who you are". We should try to know the kind of friends we are having, before they influence us with their bad character.

Also, I will like to advise parents to please teach their children good moral behaviour. In the case of manners, most students do not exhibit the attitude of well-trained children. It is important to call them to order whenever they are bringing up the attitude acquired from bad company.

3. 7, Irekari Street,

Surulere,
Lagos State,
14th May, 2012.

The Principal,
Adebola Baptist Senior High School,
75, Adebola Street,
Surulere,
Lagos.

Dear Ma,

LETTER OF COMPLAINT

My main intention of writing this letter is to complain and also beg on behalf of all students. When I say complain and beg, I mean we need a

change based on the fact that activities like debating, excursions, quiz competitions, etc. are gradually disappearing from the school curriculum. So, we need them to be reintroduced and also to be better than what they used to be.

As we all know, these quiz competitions, debates and excursions make students well informed. For example, a person who has never been to Olumo Rock was taken there on excursion, the sight of the rock alone will make him or her remember everything that has to do with rock. Furthermore, the most important of all these activities is that students broaden the knowledge they have about something. Debates build-up confidence in students in the sense that if a student speaks in public for the first time, such a student would have been shy and not bold enough. But when the student continues, he or she builds confidence. Also quiz competitions expose some schools and students to scholarship.

Sincerely, we do hope for some changes in the systems of our schools. Debates, quiz competitions and excursions should be brought back, reinforced and made to become something everyone would like to partake in. Like I said earlier, these activities will help build school. It is the first gigantic step to building a school with students that can truly be called the leaders of a country.

If I was to suggest ways of building these activities in our school, I would suggest that we hold a debate competition every term and prizes should be awarded to the best students. That will encourage most students to work hard. Also in the aspect of excursions, at least once a session, students should be taken out to explore and learn. The same should apply to both quiz competitions and debate. I sincerely hope my letter would be given due consideration and accorded a reply as soon as possible. I know I speak the mind of every student of Adebola Baptist Senior High School.

Yours faithfully,


Isaac Onanuga.

4. VIOLENT VIDEO GAME SHOULD BE BANNED

Violent video game does not add value to the quality of life of the youths and others alike, rather it only focuses on how evil things are learnt and done.

I strongly believe that violent video game should be banned based on the following:

Firstly, violent video game exposes the youths to immoral dealings which end up endangering the life of the people.

Secondly, it exposes the youths to corrupt practices which do not only contribute to both economic and social destruction but also affect them in both ways.

Violent video game teaches the youths the way and manner of high hybrid stealing can easily be done. In real life situation, these youths will like to emulate the various actions exhibited on the game. To this effect, it leads the youths to series of destruction of their future career such as scam or advance fee fraud.

Violent video game has led to the destruction of our cultural heritage wherein the youths do not have respect for the constituted authority as practised in the various films shown.

This when applied to our culture becomes a taboo, hence the need for it to be banned.

Violent video game does not only lead to endangering the life of the youths but also wastes a lot of their precious time that could have been used for a more reasonable things from which they can earn a better living.

5. "WHERE THERE'S A WILL THERE'S A WAY"

Being rich and happy with a wonderful family is what he had ever wanted. He had always dreamt of being a great medical doctor. He was a brilliant and hard-working student. He never stayed a day without reading his books. He finished his secondary school education with ease and he came out in flying colours. Now that he is about to enter the university, his parents agreed to surprise him. Being an obedient and well behaved child, his parents finally agreed to send him to the United States of America to complete his education. He was so happy and thanked them for the opportunity to travel and learn abroad. He also promised to make them proud.

Ever since Kingsley entered the Oxford College, he worked harder and did what was right. He did not want to let his parents down. He wanted them to be proud of him. He wanted to be a well known medical doctor. Kingsley finished his education so fast and went for his Masters degree. He was the best. After college, Kingsley worked with the white men for some time before he decided to come back home. He was so rich and when he returned, he first built a house for his parents and bought a car for each of them. He then decided to build a hospital before he settled down for marriage. All these happened and

Kingsley got married to Favour and they were living happily together.

Kingsley and his wife gave birth to twins and they were happy and gave glory to God. It was then he heard that his parents had a fatal accident and died instantly. Kingsley was so sad and devastated. He was depressed and felt lonely. But, with the help of his wife he accepted the fact that God gives and takes. The thing he did not understand that left him wondering was why God took them both. The burial was a big one. Kingsley invited his friends and co-workers. They all consoled him and told him not worry. It was a sad memory for Kingsley that his parents never lived to see their grandchildren, he however consoled himself in the pharmacy he built to immortalise them.

Kingsley's uncle took everything that belonged to his parents especially his father's property. He said Kingsley was not his late brother's child that he was a bastard. Due to the fact that Kingsley knew all what his uncle said was not true, he left him to God and did not argue with him. His uncle was surprised but his selfish desire did not stop him from what he was doing. He took everything and bribed the lawyer into changing the will. Kingsley was now a rich man and was loved by his family and staff at work. He never ceased going to church and this made him more devoted to Christ and loved by everybody in the church.

Favour and Kingsley decided to travel to the United States of America with their children, but he had an emergency in the hospital and he then asked his wife and children to go alone to the United States. Unfortunately for Kingsley the plane crashed and there were no survivor and this made him sad, depressed and wept uncontrollably. He could not concentrate anymore and did not go to office or church. He eventually got over it, got remarried, he worked harder and lived happily with his wife (Sharon). This story illustrates the saying where there's a will there's a way"

SECTION B COMPREHENSION

6. (a) He treated them shabbily or He treated them with contempt/disrespect/disdain.
(b) The evidence that he is wealthy is; (i) he lives in a mansion, (ii) he owns a limousine. (iii) he has a company that employs many workers; (iv) he has multi-million dollar contract. (v) he plans to buy a helicopter.

(c) He has planned to buy helicopter to avoid or beat the traffic congestion in Kapitatown.

(d) He ought to have visited Ireti, or his people or his hometown.

(e) The youths objected to his installation because: (i) he turned a deaf ear to the calls of the youths. (ii) he failed to take care of his parents when they were sick. (iii) he had isolated himself from his people or he had deserted his community.

(f)(i) Adverbial clause of time. (ii) It modifies the verb 'announced'

(g)(i) Metaphor (ii) It means speak angrily or hash to them.

(h)(i) Stressed — pointed out, emphasized, reiterated. (ii) Ultimate — best, ideal, final.

(iii) Flabbergasted —surprised, amazed, stunned, dumbfounded, astounded, etc. (iv) Deserted — neglected, forsaken, abandoned. (v) Disappear— vanish, leave, go away, quit.

7. (a) He visited the museum as a research student/researcher.
(b) Wilberforce was famous for fighting or opposing slave trade.
(c) He was the only black visitor at the museum at that hour.
(d) He thought that one of the statues has turned into human being.
(e) He thought so because he had just seen a statue which looked exactly like the writer.
(f)(i) Metaphor (ii) It means that he became frightened.
(g)(i) Adjectival or Relative clause. (ii) It qualifies the noun 'bus',
(h)(i) Organisation — groups, bodies, movement.
(ii) remarkable — outstanding, notable, striking.
(iii) Pandemonium —confusion, chaos, uproar, commotions. (iv) replica—image, model, likeness, resemblance. (v)Pursued—followed, chased, run after, gone after.

SECTION C SUMMARY

8. (a)(i) The population of the world is increasing
(ii) the cities are over-populated or congested
(iii) Disasters destroy existing buildings or shelters or houses.
(iv) Some people are so poor that they cannot build or rent decent houses.
(v) Land and building materials re peiv
(b) They ive in mkshjft structures or all kinds of places.

WASSCE JUNE 2012 ENGLISH LANGUAGE 3 OBJECTIVE QUESTIONS

TEST OF ORALS (SECTION 1)

From the words lettered A to D, choose the word that has the **same vowel sound** as the one represented by the letter(s) underlined. An Example is given below

Example: seat A. sit B. cite C. set D. key.

The correct answer is D because only key contains the **same vowel sound** as the one underlined in seat. Therefore, answer space D would be shaded.

- | [A] | [B] | [C] | [D] |
|--------------------|--------------|----------|--------------|
| 1. market | A. favourite | B. seed | C. margarine |
| 2. <u>man</u> y | A. marry | B. said | C. lamb |
| 3. <u>you</u> ng | A. blood | B. bound | C. found |
| 4. <u>doct</u> or | A. story | B. trial | C. alone |
| 5. <u>wa</u> ch | A. batch | B. cot | C. catch |
| 6. <u>coo</u> k | A. pool | B. pull | C. cooled |
| 7. <u>ja</u> w | A. shot | B. short | C. jam |
| 8. <u>coi</u> n | A. doing | B. coke | C. boy |
| 9. <u>se</u> w | A. dew | B. go | C. sane |
| 10. <u>peo</u> ple | A. pie | B. pole | C. key |
| 11. <u>ba</u> r | A. bat | B. chat | C. father |
| 12. <u>heir</u> | A. here | B. air | C. ear |
| 13. <u>rou</u> nd | A. fun | B. road | C. now |
| 14. <u>ear</u> | A. heard | B. cheer | C. fare |
| 15. <u>hi</u> gh | A. hill | B. heel | C. buy |

SECTION 2

From the words lettered A to D, choose the word that has the **same consonant Sound(s)** as the one represented by the letter(s) underlined. An example is given below.

Example: vice A. cat B. dress C. show D. chalk

The correct answer is B because only dress has the same consonant sound as the one underlined in vice. Therefore, answer space B would be shaded.

- | [A] | [B] | [C] | [D] |
|-----------------------|--------------|--------------|-----------|
| 16. <u>be</u> nt | A. hitch | B. catch | C. think |
| 17. <u>ki</u> ng | A. knife | B. know | C. blink |
| 18. <u>sw</u> ord | A. keys | B. star | C. poise |
| 19. <u>cha</u> grin | A. challenge | B. chemistry | C. shell |
| 20. <u>she</u> lf | A. halves | B. cough | C. shell |
| 21. <u>bo</u> th | A. these | B. them | C. theirs |
| 22. <u>ch</u> ocolate | A. shock | B. champagne | C. choir |
| 23. <u>ba</u> il | A. talk | B. folk | C. calm |
| 24. <u>bre</u> ast | A. marked | B. cream | C. star |
| 25. <u>un</u> ite | A. untie | B. uncover | C. you |
| 26. <u>brai</u> n | A. column | B. bang | C. banana |
| 27. <u>mer</u> ge | A. jerk | B. game | C. grease |
| 28. <u>fl</u> ock | A. physics | B. phlegm | C. calf |
| 29. <u>locke</u> d | A. look | B. dull | C. take |
| 30. <u>plai</u> t | A. lump | B. apply | C. police |

SECTION 3

From the words lettered A to D, choose the word that **rhymes** with the given word. An example is given below.

Example: obtain A. detain B. detail C. claim D. relay
The correct answer is A because only detain rhymes with obtain. Therefore, answer space A would be shaded.

[A] [B] [C] [D]

Now answer the questions that follow

- suite A. suit B. sweet C. suitor D. swim
- punch A. tongue B. lunch C. lunge D. lung
- whale A. where B. wail C. whelp D. well
- sawed A. sawn B. swear C. sword D. swayed
- unarmed A. unhinge B. unharmed C. unmanned D. unplug

SECTION 4

In each of the following questions, the **main/primary stress** is indicated by writing the syllable on which it occurs in capital letters.

From the words lettered A to D, choose the one that has the **correct stress**. An example is given below.

Example: democratic

- A. DE-mo-cra-tic B. de-MO-cra-tic
C. de-mo-CRA-tic D. de-mo-cra-TIC

The correct answer is C because the main/primary stress of the word democratic is on the third syllable. Therefore, answer space C would be shaded.

[A] [B] [C] [D]

Now answer the questions that follow.

- capitulate
A. CA-pi-tu-late B. ca-PI-tu-late
C. ca-pi- TU-late D. ca-pi-tu-LATE
- decorative
A. DE-co-ra-tive B. de-CO-ra-tive
C. de-co-RA-tive D. de-co-ra-TIVE
- technology
A. TECH-no-lo-gy B. tech-No-lo-gy
C. tech-no-LO-gy D. tech-no-lo-GY
- apologize
A. A-po-lo-gize B. a-PO-lo-gize
C. a-po-LO-gize D. a-po-lo-GIZE
- captivating
A. CAP-ti-va-ting B. cap-TI-va-ting
C. cap-ti-VA-ting D. cap-ti-va-TING

SECTION 5

In the following options lettered A to D, all the words except one have the **same stress pattern**. Identify the one with the **different stress pattern** and shade your answer in the usual way. An example is given below.

Example: A. away B. apart C. behind D. river
Options A, B, C are all stressed on the second syllable while option D is the only one stressed on the first syllable. So, D is the correct answer.

Therefore, answer space D would be shaded

[A] [B] [C] [D]

Now answer the questions that follow.

41. A. matter B. enshrine C. elbow D. triumph
42. A. gangster B. garnish C. garbage D. gazelle
43. A. endurance B. enterprise C. familiar D. habitual
44. A. governor B. eloquence C. genocide D. graffiti
45. A. elegy B. fellowship C. elephant D. harmonious

SECTION 6

In each of the following sentences, the word that receives the **emphatic stress** is written in capital letters. From the questions lettered A to D, choose the one to which the given sentence is the appropriate answer. An example is given below.

Example: My mother's FRIEND hates pets.

- A. Does your mother's boss hate pets?
- B. Does your mother's friend love pets?
- C. Does your mother's friend hate toys?
- D. Does your father's friend hate pets?

The correct answer is A because My mother's FRIEND hates pets answers the question, Does your mother's boss hate pets? Therefore, answer space A would be shaded.

[A] [B] [C] [D]

Now answer the questions that follow.

46. Jane borrowed her mother's HAT for the party.
A. Did Susan borrow her mother's hat for the party?
B. Did Jane steal her mother's hat for the party?
C. Did Jane borrow her father's hat for the party?
D. Did Jane borrow her mother's dress for the party?
47. The principal expects the TEACHERS to be punctual for staff meetings.
A. Does the proprietor expect the teachers to be punctual for staff meetings?
B. Does the principal expect the students to be punctual for staff meetings?

C. Does the principal expect the teachers to be late for staff meetings?

D. Does the principal expect the teachers to be punctual for school meetings?

48. Salamatu believed she would PASS the Commerce examination.
A. Did Aisha believe she would pass the Commerce examination?
B. Did Salamatu believe she would fail the Commerce examination?
C. Did Salamatu believe she would pass the Biology examination?
D. Did Salamatu believe she would pass the Commerce test?
49. Her beauty enslaved many YOUNG men.
A. Did his beauty enslave many young men?
B. Did her ugliness enslave many young men?
C. Did her beauty enslave few young men?
D. Did her beauty enslave many old men?
50. His FIRST performance as a musician was a complete failure.
A. Was her first performance as a musician a complete failure?
B. Was his last performance as a musician a complete failure?
C. Was his first performance as a teacher a complete failure?
D. Was his first performance as a musician a partial failure?

SECTION 7

From the words lettered A to D, choose the word that contains the **sound** represented by the given phonetic symbol. An example is given below.

Example: /ɔɪ/ A. yell B. holy C. boy D. idiot

The correct answer is C because only boy contains the sound represented by the given symbol. Therefore, answer space C would be shaded.

[A] [B] [C] [D]

Now answer the questions that follow.

51. /e/ A. week B. leap C. many D. receive
52. /i/ A. meal B. wanted C. reel D. fight
53. /æ/ A. plait B. mate C. came D. father
54. /ɔ:/ A. cot B. claw C. young D. plough
55. /ʌ/ A. money B. shirt C. word D. sword
56. /dʒ/ A. go B. soldier C. occasion D. treasure
57. /θ/ A. these B. those C. think D. there
58. /ʒ/ A. misery B. zoo C. church D. leisure
59. /tʃ/ A. sachet B. child C. chef D. ocean
60. /ʃ/ A. scoop B. scheque C. measure D. lash

WASSCE JUNE 2012 ENGLISH LANGUAGE 3 TEST OF ORALS (OBJECTIVE) ANSWERS															
1. A	2. B	3. A	4. C	5. D	6. D	7. D	8. C	9. B	10. C	11. C	12. B	13. C	14. B	15. C	16. D
17. C	18. B	19. B	20. B	21. D	22. C	23. D	24. B	25. C	26. C	27. A	28. B	29. C	30. B	31. B	32. B
33. B	34. C	35. B	36. B	37. A	38. B	39. B	40. A	41. B	42. D	43. B	44. D	45. D	46. D	47. B	48. B
49. D	50. B	51. C	52. B	53. A	54. B	55. A	56. A	57. C	58. D	59. B	60. D				

SENIOR SCHOOL CERTIFICATE EXAMINATION (SSCE 1988 – 2015)

Past Questions with Solutions

English Language

(Theory / Objectives with Oral English) 2013

WASSCE JUNE 2013 ENGLISH LANGUAGE 2 OBJECTIVE TEST

SECTION 1

In each of the following sentences, there is one underlined word and one gap. From the list of words lettered A to D, choose the one that is most **nearly opposite in meaning** to the underlined word and that will, at the same time, correctly fill the gap in the sentence.

1. Tom is refined but his brother is rather.....
A. arrogant. B. crude. C. unskilful. D. foolish.
2. Lions are in extinction in The Gambia but monkeys are still in.....
A. action. B. existence. C. vogue. D. custody.
3. Mary's explanation was explicit but mine was.....
A. long. B. winding. C. vague. D. irrelevant.
4. The Major demanded an unalloyed, and not a..... loyalty from his soldiers.
A. strict B. wavering. C. clumsy. D. alterable
5. The brevity of the President's speech contrasts with the..... of the Secretary's.
A. accuracy B. vagueness C. clarity D. verbosity
6. I can vouch that he broke the glass accidentally and not.....
A. forcefully. B. directly. C. carefully. D. deliberately.
7. Only question one is compulsory therefore, the rest are.....
A. easy. B. clear. C. confusing. D. optional.
8. The magistrate convicted the hardened criminal but.....and discharged the first offender.
A. acquitted. B. jailed. C. released. D. sentenced.
9. Houses built with bricks are sturdy while those built with glass are.....
A. temporary. B. fragile. C. beautiful. D. cosy.
10. The Principal is very strict but his vice is.....
A. peaceful. B. lenient. C. kind. D. efficient.

SECTION 2

From the words lettered A to D, choose the word that **best completes** each of the following sentences.

11. The brutal killing of members of the opposition provoked strong.....
A. condemnation. B. accusation. C. molestation. D. denial.
12. The doctor.....my illness as malaria.
A. discovered. B. diagnosed. C. prescribed. D. announced.
13. Since we should not disclose our identity, our letter to the principal must be..... A. unclear. B. anonymous. C. ambiguous. D. candid.
14. Although we pleaded for long with our father, he remained.....that we should not go to the stadium.
A. callous. B. curious. C. adamant. D. candid.
15. Since hard drugs are destroying our youths, our government has placed an.....on them.
A. injunction B. infringement. C. order. D. embargo.
16. Oseli's.....teacher teaches English, Physics, Economics and Technical Drawing.
A. efficient. B. jovial. C. kind. D. versatile.
17. Some political leaders love.....who always praise their governments.
A. sycophants. B. parasites. C. allies. D. favourites.
18. The.....of the new king will take place next week.
A. re-election. B. demolition. C. coronation. D. re-admission.
19. The match was a.....for Brazil because their team was stronger than the opposing team.
A. profit. B. giveaway. C. walkover. D. defeat.
20. Kofi is too..... ; he wants to know about everybody's business.
A. inquisitive. B. friendly. C. concerned. D. busy.

SECTION 3

After each of the following sentences, a list of possible interpretations is given. Choose the interpretation that you consider **most appropriate** for each sentence.

21. Ali does not let grass grow under his feet. This means that Ali
A. does not waste time in doing things.
B. is very wicked.
C. cuts the grass in his field always.
D. is very selfish.
22. The dishonest trader always palms off faulty goods on her customers. This means that the trader always
A. handles bad goods.
B. refunds money to her customers.
C. tricks her customers into accepting bad products.
D. pays the penalty for selling faulty goods.
23. Ojo's learning has gone to his head. This means that Ojo
A. has become proud because of his learning.
B. has learnt too much.
C. has been made mad by his learning.
D. feels that only learning is important.
24. When the vice principal left the school, it became a bedlam. This means that
A. every student attended school regularly.
B. punctuality was the order of the day.
C. many students boycotted classes.
D. there was noise and confusion in the school.
25. That amount Ivan donated was his widow's mite. This means that Ivan
A. gave all that the widow had. B. was miserly.
C. gave all that he had. D. could have given more.
26. Fatou's awkward behaviour shows that she is a greenhorn. This means that Fatou is
A. arrogant. B. inexperienced. C. inattentive.
D. cautious.
27. To secure more votes, the politician played to the gallery. This means that the politician
A. became over confident. B. attempted to win cheap popularity. C. was selfish. D. went to the gallery.
28. Those who think that all is well in Cascadia are living in fool's paradise. This means that
A. they are fools. B. some fools live in Cascadia.
C. they are under an illusion. D. they are almost insane.

29. While paying a visit to his uncle, Ayo intends to kill two birds with one stone. This means that Ayo
A. promises to bring two birds home.
B. takes part in a double deal.
C. hopes to achieve two aims with, one action.
D. intends to do two things at the sametime.
30. People hardly show their true colours. This means that people rarely show.
A. their abilities. B. how colourful they can be.
C. their real character. D. how noble they are.

SECTION 4

From the words lettered A to D below each of the following sentences, choose the word or group of words that is **nearest in meaning** to the underlined word as it is used in the sentence.

31. Mary was kept in solitary confinement.
A. idle B. quiet. C. lonely. D. harsh.
32. Buba has a very alluring personality. A. attractive.
B. intricate. C. deceptive. D. interesting.
33. Hard drugs are detrimental to health.
A. paramount. B. ineffective. C. necessary.
D. harmful.
34. My father remains inflexible once he has taken a decision. A. certain. B. relaxed. C. permanent.
D. unyielding.
35. Maxwell usually makes obnoxious remarks.
A. prudent. B. offensive. C. unpredictable.
D. queer.
36. We should prevail upon Kwesi to accept the job.
A. provoke. B. persuade. C. cajole. D. force.
37. The team has an arduous task ahead of it.
A. a severe. B. a heavy. C. a strenuous. D. an enjoyable.
38. The two tasks should be undertaken concurrently.
A. consecutively. B. alternatively. C. immediately.
D. an simultaneously.
39. The students were told to review their assignments.
A. re-examine. B. recount. C. inspect. D. return.
40. Marian does not have the stamina to run that race. A. courage. B. energy. C. determination.
D. ability.

SECTION 5

From the words or group of words lettered A to D, choose the word or group of words that **best completes** each of the following sentences:

41. I want just.....sugar in my tea.
A. a few. B. small. C. little. D. a little.
42. Since the opposing parties could not come to an agreement, the peace talks..... A broke up.
B. broke down. C. broke through. D. broke out.
43. Children often have implicit confidence.....
their parents. A. for B. on C. with D. in
44. If I had heard the news earlier, I.....stayed
at home. A. would have B. will have C. will not
have D. would have not
45. The order is that everyone must be.....bed by
midnight. A. on B. inside C. in. D. within
46. To succeed in any business, one must be
prepared to shake.....one's lazy habits.
A. off B. over C. down D. of
47.in his right senses will swallow live coals.
A. Anyone B. No one C. Everyone D. Each one
48. One of the clever pupils.....able to solve the
problem A. can B. was C. were D. are
49. He has stopped being foolish,.....?
A. doesn't he B. does he C. hasn't he D. isn't it
50. I maintain that the property in question is.....
A. mine B. our C. my D. their
51. Although Sylvester and John promised to be
here..... has turned up. A. both B. all C. neither
D. either
52. The house.....he lives is spacious.
A. that B. where C. by which D. to which
53. It is high time you.....this place. A. left B. leave
C. had left D. have left
54. Since you have lost your birth certificate, you have
to go.....an affidavit. A. for B. in C. on D. to
55. The musicians have not arrived from Sierra
Leone,.....? A., had they. B. hadn't they
C. haven't they. D. have they.
56. On my way home, I saw a..... A. one-legged
young mad man. B. young one-legged mad man.
C. one-legged mad young man.
D. mad one-legged young man.
57. People living in villages have a passion.....
animals. A. to B. with C. for D. of
58. Kebba and Kwame are very selfish; they care
about only.....A. themselves. B. one another.
C. each other. D. himself.
59. You had better..... your assignment now.
A. did. B. done. C. doing. D. do.
60. Our kind teacher only cautioned the bully and let
him..... A. off. B. by. C. over. D. away.
61. My.....house is on the next street A. father-in-
law's B. father's-in-law. C. fathers'-in-law.
D. father-in-laws'
62. The Mathematics teacher made us commit the
formula..... memory. A. on B. to C. into D. by
63. Momodou has been ill.....three weeks now.
A. since B. for C. through D. before
64. They kept quiet all the..... A. where.
B. period. C. while. D. interval.
65.caused the havoc, he sneaked off.
A. On B. After C. Since D. Having
66. The point on.....we disagreed was trivial.
A. which. B. whom. C. what. D. whose
67. How did you arrive at.....wonderful conclusion?
A. a such B. that a C. that such D. such a
68. The government cannot.....the decision any
longer. A. put on. B. put off. C. put up. D. put
back.
69. The teachers.....our poor performance in the
examinations. A. are discussing on B. were
discussing about C. had discussed on D. were
discussing
70. The wise thing to do is not to give.....to
the temptation. A. in. B. on. C. for. D. with.
71. My sister told me all.....was said at the meeting.
A. that B. what C. which D. who
72. The quarrel between Olu and Cla will end
up.....a fight. A. by B. in C. with D. among

73. Musa did not want to fetch water for his grandfather,.....,his mother made him do it.
A even B.otherwise C. nevertheless D. moreover
74. The citizens welcomed all the African.....
A. heads of states. B. heads of state. C. head of states. D. head of state.
75. Mother said she saw Alfred,.....? A. did she
B. she didn't C. she did D. didn't she

SECTION 6

In the following passages, the numbered gaps indicate missing words. Against each number in the list below each passage, four options are offered in columns lettered A to D. Choose the word that is the **most suitable** to fill the numbered gaps in the passages.

PASSAGE A

In recent times, more and more people have become aware of the —76— of the stock market and the possibility of making huge profits from investing in stocks and shares. The process is quite easy: a person either buys the shares directly during a public —77— or does so through professional institutions or experts known as stock —78—. Thereafter, the buyer is issued with a share —79— to show that he owns shares in a company.

Investing in stocks and shares can be for a long or short term. A long-term investor does not hurry to sell his shares at any slight increase in price but instead is satisfied with the —80—which the company sends to him and other —81— annually from the —82— it declares. This is usually paid according to the number of —83— the investor holds. Those who invest for a short term, on the other hand, sell their shares as soon as they can make reasonable profit from their investment.

However, it is advisable to be cautious because the stock market can be very —84— and occasionally there are —85—.

	A	B	C	D
76.	trading	operations	methods	transactions
77.	offer	lottery	action	sale
78.	traders	clients	brokers	marketers
79.	warrant	identification	notice	certificate
80.	dividend	reward	money	payment
81.	buyers	people	creditors	shareholders
82.	amount	profit	value	units
83.	file	papers	shares	receipts
84.	unsure	independent	elusive	unstable
85.	falls	crashes	slips	drops

PASSAGE B

One of the world's oldest —86— is teaching. There must have been —87— who were respected because they were able to guide and —88— children towards the —89— of the desired goals of their communities. The —90— ceremonies for young adults common to many cultures are part of —91— education process of those cultures. There are also many informal ways of educating the young ones. When a young girl helps her mother in preparing the family —92—, she is learning culinary skills in an informal setting. One's —93— group has a great influence on one.

In the formal set-up of our schools today, education is well —94—. There is the —95— of authority from the principal down to the class —96—. We have a fixed —97— which plays an important role in —98— our attitudes and conditioning our —99— and responses to the demands of our —100—.

	A	B	C	D
86.	tasks	activities	professions	duties
87.	societies	clubs	groups	individuals
88.	coerce	motivate	force	allow
89.	attainment	creation	enforcement	evolution
90.	secret	outing	naming	initiation
91.	formal	special	exclusive	privileged
92.	diet	dishes	menu	meal
93.	friendly	school	peer	sex
94.	fixed	formed	organized	shaped
95.	hierarchy	step	method	grade
96.	supervisors	officers	pupils	protects
97.	timetable	set-up	curriculum	calendar
98.	reviewing	snapping	creating	reparing
99.	behaviour	success	learning	objective
100.	home	area	place	society

WASSCE JUNE 2013 ENGLISH LANGUAGE 2 OBJECTIVE TEST ANSWERS

1.B	2.B	3.C	4.D	5.D	6.D	7.D
8.A	9.B	10.B	11.A	12.B	13.B	14.C
15.D	16.D	17.A	18.C	19.C	20.A	21.A
22.C	23.A	24.D	25.C	26.B	27.B	28.C
29.C	30.C	31.C	32.B	33.D	34.D	35.B
36.B	37.C	38.D	39.A	40.B	41.D	42.D
43.D	44.A	45.C	46.A	47.B	48.B	49.C
50.A	51.C	52.B	53.A	54.A	55.D	56.A
57.C	58.A	59.D	60.A	61.A	62.B	63.C
64.B	65.D	66.A	67.D	68.C	69.B	70.A
71.A	72.B	73.C	74.A	75.D	76.B	77.A
78.C	79.D	80.A	81.A	82.B	83.C	84.D
85.A	86.C	87.C	88.B	89.A	90.D	91.B
92.D	93.C	94.C	95.A	96.D	97.A	98.B
99.A	100.D					

WASSCE JUNE 2013 ENGLISH LANGUAGE I QUESTIONS

(SECTION A) ESSAY

1. Your school fees have been increased astronomically and your father has threatened to transfer you to another school. Write a letter to him giving, at least, three reasons why you would like to remain in your present school.
2. Write an article for publication in a national newspaper on the importance of education in national development.
3. The quality of food prepared for students in your school has become very poor. Write a letter to the principal complaining about this and explaining ways in which this situation can be remedied.
4. You are the chief speaker in a debate on the topic: Education is not as important as riches. Write your argument for or against the topic.
5. Write a story ending with the statement: indeed, it was the biggest lesson of my life.

WASSCE JUNE 2013 ENGLISH LANGUAGE I THEORY QUESTIONS

(SECTION B) COMPREHENSION

6. Read the following passage carefully and answer the questions on it.

Mr. Ogun it was that wooed me for school. That was decades ago. I had resisted vehemently I even ran away to hibernate with my maternal grandmother. I had told Granny that I wanted to spend a few days with her. By nightfall, my father, who suspected that I was hiding there, came to take me away. The following morning, he dragged me all the way to school where Mr. Ogun received all fresh students.

I swore secretly that I would abscond at the first opportunity, but throughout the day, Mr. Ogun kept a watchful eye on fresh pupils. He had a smiling face and looked very friendly. As soon as he had registered our names, he led us to the field to play. Of all the children, I was probably the only one who looked forward to an opportunity to abscond. Mr. Ogun seemed to have read my mind; he used my name in the songs he composed as we marched round the field. He once held me by the hand and marched along with me. As we went on, he announced, "What a smart fellow! Clap for him!"

In the classroom, Mr. Ogun told me to sit in front as he stated, "My Smartie will keep the pieces of chalk and the duster. Gradually, I was

mellowing in my plan to abscond: I began to think that I could give school a try. At the end of that day, my father was around to take me home. Perhaps he decided not to take chances.

During the first week, my father took me to school everyday.

Somehow, my resistance was softening, to his surprise. Every morning as I produced the pieces of chalk from the cupboard, Mr. Ogun smiled broadly, nodding approvingly. Before we left the classroom for recess, for games or for home, I dutifully kept the materials safe, and as soon as we returned, I produced them. It took some time before I realized that my role was crucial since the pilfering of such materials was common in all the other classes.

My father soon stopped bothering about me as I would get up from bed, take my bati and get into my uniform without any prodding. My love for school was deepening, especially when I discovered that I was among the few that always did well in most tests. And Mr. Ogun would praise me to the skies.

Towards the end of the school year, we learnt that Mr. Ogun was going on transfer to another school. How devastated I felt! Now, at last, was the time to abscond from school. But then, I simply could not take the crucial step because my bond with school had become very firm.

- (a) What evidence is there in the passage that the writer's experience took place long ago?
- (b) Mention two things that Mr. Ogun did that won the writer for school.
- (c) What was the benefit of the duty performed by the writer to his class?
- (d) What do you think the writer implies when he states that he dressed up for school without any prodding?
- (e) Why could he not carry out his plan to abscond when his mentor had left?
- (f) "... that my role was crucial..." (i) What is the grammatical name given to this Expression as it is Used in the passage? (ii) What is its function?
- (g) "... my bond with school had become very firm"
- (h) For each of the following words, find another word or phrase which means the same and which can replace it as it used in the passage: (i)vehemently; (ii) abscond; (iii) probably; (iv)gradually; (v) prodding; (vi) devastated.

7. Read the following passage **carefully** and answer the questions on it.

When the principal introduced Mr. Njobe as our new Mathematics teacher, we did not think much of him. He did not look very likeable nor did he appear to be an achiever. Nothing was spectacular about him apart from the fact that he was a South African. Most of us who knew the goings-on in his country regarded him as one of the luckless refugees from the apartheid regime. After the mild clapping, we forgot about the man with gaunt, hungry looks.

During his first lesson in our class, it struck me that not once did he consult the textbook. Rather, to teach the properties of the square and rectangle, he made us measure the top of our tables, the classroom doors and other objects around. From there, we discovered that these objects had opposite equal sides, and all the angles were equal. We did not have to learn these from books; he made us find out. When later I consulted my textbook, what Durrell, the great mathematician, wrote came very much alive. I started to see Mr. Njobe as equal to Durrell.

With time, we began to like his teaching. He taught with zeal and usually through playful methods. His class was always lively and full of jokes. For instance, to teach us the properties of a circle, he instructed us to bring out the bowls which we used for the midday meal. During the lesson, he made each one measure the distance round his bowl. Incidentally almost every bowl was different in size. We laughed at the sizes of different bowls while we meticulously measured them. Throughout the lesson, there was much laughter. Finally, he told each student to divide the distance round the bowl by the distance through the centre. Imagine our amazement when we discovered that, whatever the size of bowl, all the answers were the same. This he explained is the base in all computations regarding the circle. That was the fifty years ago and I have not forgotten. He actually tamed Mathematics for us, terrifying as it was.

Then, one day, we learnt that Mr. Njobe was on admission in Wesley Guild Hospital. Our representatives sent to convey our good wishes were refused entry into the intensive care unit: they were told that his condition was critical. We virtually went into mourning for weeks. But just as we were writing him off our mind, one hot afternoon, his car crawled into the school compound. As he stepped out, students swarmed out, carried him shoulder-high and danced round the school, chanting spontaneously, "Njobe, welcome! Mathematics welcome!"

- (a) Describe the appearance of Mr. Njobe on his first day in the school.
- (b) With what concept of South Africa did the writer associate Mr. Njobe?
- (c) What did the students' mild clapping suggest?
- (d) What impressed the writer about the new teacher during the first lesson?
- (e) What is unique about the new teacher's method of teaching?
- (f) '... that these objects had opposite equal sides
- (i) What is the grammatical name given to this expression as it is used in the passage?
- (ii) What is its function?
- (g) He actually tamed Mathematics for us
What figure of speech is used in this expression?
- (h) For each of the following words, find another word or phrase which means the same and which can replace it as it is used in the passage:
(i)luckless; (ii) consult; (iii)meticulously;
(iv)amazement; (v) terrifying; (vi) critical.

SECTION C SUMMARY

8. Read the following passage **carefully** and answer the questions on it.

Have you ever wondered how books get published before reaching the reader? Perhaps you assume that the author is solely responsible for designing, printing and getting the books distributed to readers. Actually, in most cases, it is not the author who originally conceives the idea of a book; rather, it is the publisher, based on the results of a market research, who decides on the type of book to publish. So, usually, the concept of a book begins with a market research which is an exercise carried out to establish the type of books which would sell fast among a specific group of readers.

The task of hunting for a good writer follows. The publishing house goes out to source for a writer, usually among the academics in the secondary or tertiary institutions. Sometimes, however, such a writer is found in other professions. For instance, for a good law book, a senior advocate might be the best to consult. Discussions are held with the chosen writer to map out precisely the level of the language and the size of the book.

When the manuscript is submitted to the publisher, it is subjected to rigorous screening to establish whether it is good enough. Usually, a neutral assessor is found to do a thorough critique and recommend its suitability or otherwise. If it is found unsatisfactory, it is simply returned and that is the end of the matter. However, if it is found publishable, whatever amendments

recommended by the assessor are used by the author as guidelines to update the work.

When the final manuscript has been accepted, it is further subjected to in-house editing by the editorial staff in the publishing house. Of course, most of these are themselves experts in English language as well as specialists in the particular field that the book covers. In most cases, they take a critical look at the language, as well as the currency of the content. So, where outdated facts are identified, the editorial division does the rectification. Furthermore, editors are good at economizing words; very often they cut down on the length of the material.

Whatever leaves the table of the editorial division goes into the publishing section. This has the task of doing the final typesetting, providing the pictures and illustrations where needed, and arranging for a printing press to handle the final production of the book. Contrary to what most people often assume, a printing press is not the same as a publishing company. Indeed, most publishing companies do not have printing presses. A printing press charges money for the printing and production of the number of copies demanded by the publishers. Once the payment has been made for the printing, and copies have been delivered by the printer, the role of the printer ends.

The publisher's marketing division takes over the copies, advertises the book, goes out to the potential users and makes sales. Advertisement may be done on the radio and television networks, in newspaper and on billboards. The staff of the marketing division may meet schools and the ministry of education to get the book adopted. The wider the publicity the higher the sales are likely to be.

(a) In five sentences, one for each, summarize the five stages in the publication of a book.

(b) In one sentence, state how the publishing house creates awareness for a book.

WASSCE JUNE 2013 ENGLISH LANGUAGE 1 ESSAY ANSWERS

SECTION A

1. 24 Adelabu Street,
Off Western Avenue,
Surulere, Lagos.
23rd June, 2013.

Dear Daddy,

I am aware of the increment in my school fees and I believe that my school principal and proprietor have a reason for the unexpected increase in the school fees. The principal said; the money would be used to finance our school

chemistry laboratory, food and nutrition laboratory, the school library would also be updated, new crops would be planted in the school farm and with all these reformation, the school standard of sound education would increase.

Daddy, leaving my present school would lead me to repeating a class because I am in SS2 and I have less than one school session to finish my secondary school education.

Daddy, I am used to my various subject teachers because they have all got the listening ear and I might as well not be able to cope in school you are about to take me to.

Lastly, Daddy you know the school is an agent of socialization after our family, there I would get my formal education. And my present school portrays the quality of my second home where all students pray like a family on assembly ground, interactive sessions are held, we all lend helping hands to those who are in need, and we have even formed reading groups so as to increase the students' vocabulary.

In conclusion, Daddy the astronomical increase in the school fees is for the benefit of the students, in order to have a sound and conducive learning area. I sincerely hope you change your mind.

Yours sincerely,
Nwakaego.

2. THE IMPORTANCE OF EDUCATION IN NATIONAL DEVELOPMENT

Education is the main pillar of any society. In all spheres of a nation, education plays a major role. As we all know, education simply is the process of acquiring knowledge and without the facts how do a nation develop?

In the world today some countries are called developed while others are developing or underdeveloped, as the case may be. They are categorized according to their educational statistics.

As the case may be, education helps people at the helm of the nation's affairs to plan and organize the nation.

Education brings out the best in our youths. Using Nigeria as a case study, our country is blessed with many talented and gift youths and education helps in tapping and bringing them out. Without education the youths are rendered redundant, useless and jobless.

Education reduces or eliminates the nation's dependence on expatriates. Nigeria spends a lot of money on expatriates but government spending

can be reduced when the nation is properly educated.

Education brings development to a nation. If people are educated the nation will not be talking about technology transfer because everyone will be creative and creativity brings invention while invention brings development.

Education leads to employment which wards off crimes like robbery, fraud, kidnapping and so on.

Furthermore, education bridges the gap between the "haves" and "have nots" with the reduction of this gap a nation will develop rapidly.

Therefore, for a nation to be developed education must play a vital role in the national development.

3. Adebola Baptist Senior High School,
75 Adebola Street,
Off Adeniran Ogunsanya,

The Principal,
Adebola Baptist Senior High School,
75, Adebola Street,
Off Adeniran Ogunsanya,
Surulere,
Lagos.

Dear Sir,

COMPLAINT ON BAD FOOD

We students are tired and fed up with the poor quality of food given to us in the school. The food has become so bad that most times students go hungry for days while some live on the provisions they bring from home.

We have observed that the staff in the catering department of the school are not ready to comply with the standard set by the school board because the food is always half done or it has too much pepper or salt, and sometimes it is too watery. You can distinguish the pepper from the oil in their soup.

This we noticed can lead to malnutrition because of the insufficient intake of proteins, vitamins and minerals which these food lack and as we all know; that an undernourished child is more susceptible to infections.

In order to avert the looming danger ahead, the school have to take necessary steps by first, employing a new caterer to head the catering department of the school, someone who knows a lot about nutrition and well qualified for the post.

Secondly, the school board needs to increase the money allocated for foodstuffs and make sure that the school purchases directly from the bulk market. It is pertinent to point out that a

major cause of unwarranted price increase in foodstuffs is the involvement of middlemen in the purchase of foodstuffs; this can be avoided.

Also, the school should reconsider the unanimous decision that students should serve themselves bearing in mind the interest of the weaker ones getting enough food.

Above all, the principal should supervise the food and have a taste of it before students are served.

I am more than convinced that if the above measures are taken into consideration, there will be improvement in the quality of food being served to students.

Yours faithfully
Babatunde Adewale
SSIIA.

4. EDUCATION IS NOT AS IMPORTANT AS RICHES

Good day Mr chairman, panel of judges, accurate time-keeper, my co-debators and fellow audience, my name is Babatunde Adewale and I am here to oppose the motion which says "Education is not as important as riches". To begin with, I'd like to discuss the importance of education (learning) and that of riches and I hope I'll be able to convince you that the importance of education outweighs that of riches.

The importance of education in enabling an individual to put his potentials to optimal use is self-evident. Without education, the training of the human mind is incomplete. No individual is a human being in the working world until he/she has been educated in the proper sense. Now, I am not saying one is not human being without education. The mind was made to be trained and without education, a person is incomplete in that sense. Education makes man a right thinker and a correct decision maker. It achieves this by bringing him knowledge from the external world, teaching him to reason, and acquainting him with past history, so that he may be a better judge of the present. Without education, man, as it were, is shut up in a windowless room. With education, he finds himself in a room with all its windows open to the outside world. In other words, people who are not educated have less opportunity to do what they want to do. A person that gets a good education will become a more dependable worker, a better citizen, and a stronger consumer. For example, people would rather prefer a higher and educated man rather than a non-educated man. When looking at the long-term effects of education, our economy needs these educated people to know how to keep the economy efficient

and not to get into a bind in the future. Someone asked if they were Bill Gate (since he is very educated), would he understand the economy better? Of course not, but that's not what I am trying to say. How advanced do you think the computer would be without him? The more educated someone is, the more knowledge one obtains on different subjects. Each person has a different level of understanding for each subject there is to learn about. That is why there are experts in every field you could go into and each part is a piece of the puzzle that makes the world / economy grow.

Education and riches are both important things. They are essential to support our life.

People may think money is the most important thing in our life, but in my opinion, education takes pre-eminence over money (comes before money).

Nowadays, people look at money as if it is the root of life — like you will not be able to survive without it. They are desperate to find money which they think is the most important thing in the world now.

They never realize the power of education. Our education can lead us to become successful people. We can achieve everything we want with the power of education that money will not be able to. Money can be lost (wealth can be lost) but education remains in our mind.

Education is the key to success. Also, the benefits of education to the individual are having lifetime satisfied earnings and an educated person is less likely to be unemployed because he/she has the necessary knowledge to be self-employed. People with education are also less likely to live in poverty. For example, the award-winning talk show host, Oprah Winfrey. She was born into poverty in Mississippi to a teenage single mother. She loved to read and loved learning new things. She did well in high school despite the abuse she suffered. Now, she is one of the richest and the most influential women in the world. If not for education, she would still be in Mississippi.

In addition, education may help the society to be more productive too. Educated adults are more likely to volunteer in charity services as they learn to appreciate what they have in life. They are also likely to be in the pink of health. When they are healthy, they might as well go to donate blood to those who need blood. Also, children of educated adults read more frequently and have higher cognitive and concentration skill.

With these few points of mine stated and explained above, I hope I've been able to convince you that education is more important than riches because education is the source of

wealth and riches if properly utilized. In conclusion, I'd like you to acknowledge that "intelligence plus character, is the goal of true education". Thank you.

5. "IF TIME WERE A BRIDGE"

I was standing in an open field, how did I get here? I asked myself. I glanced around the field only to find that I was alone. Snakes moved freely round the field. I was so terrified, I didn't know what to do. I moved a little only to find myself in a quick sand. The snakes started coming close to me, and I continued sinking down into the earth. No, I screamed until I was covered up by the sand.

I felt a slight touch on my hand, I opened my eyes only to find myself in a hospital bed. "My daughter, why are you screaming? Did you have a bad dream?" My loving mother asked. She came with a handkerchief to clean my face, because I was sweating profusely. "Mummy, am so glad you are here", I said, as I hugged her tightly.

My mother has been a loving and caring mother, despite the fact that my father had died before my birth, she made sure that I was well cared for.

I am the only child to my parent, I am probably spoilt because I got whatever I wanted, because my mother did not want me to feel the death of my father. Through my years in the secondary school, I lived a promiscuous life. I moved around with bad group to girls who call themselves the "big girls".

When I just got an admission into the secondary school, I was so intelligent, even the teachers always praised me during open days. I moved with friends who were equally intelligent. We usually wait after school to read, then we were always called "book worms". With all these, I was not satisfied, I wanted to be among the "big girls", so that I can live like them.

Since I joined the big girls' group, my performance in my academics began to deteriorate. My teachers who used to praise me, started complaining about me. I was too engrossed in my new image as a big girl, to care about anything. My friends told me that to be a complete big girl, you must have a boyfriend, I agreed, thinking that they knew best. In the next two weeks, I had gotten a boyfriend named Femi. Femi was tall and handsome, I saw him as a perfect match. Within weeks, we had started going out together. Femi was a student of the University of Lagos, sometimes I visited him on campus.

One faithful day, Femi invited me to a party on campus, so I sneaked out of the house so that

I could attend the night party. Meanwhile, there was no party. Femi only wanted me to spend the night with him. I was such a fool to have fallen into their trap. Femi and his friends raped me repeatedly until I became unconscious. They also went ahead to throw me into the bush. If not for the good people around who took me to the hospital, I would have been dead.

The doctor came in, and spoke to my mother in low tones. Afterward, my mother came and held me with tears in her eyes. She told me that the doctor said that my womb has been damaged due to the gang rape. How I wish I could turn the hands of time so I can change what happened. If wishes were horses, then everyone would have a ride. "Uhm! Indeed that was the biggest lesson of my life".

SECTION B COMPREHENSION

6. (a) The writer stated that the experience took place many decades ago.
(b)(i) He assigned him a responsibility by placing him in-charge of chalk and duster. (ii) He praised the writer very much. (iii) He used his name in the songs he composed.
(c) The pieces of chalk and duster for his class were not stolen.
(d) The writer implied that he was becoming interested in school.
(e) He could not carry out his plan to abscond then because he had become attached to school.
(f)(i) Noun clause. (ii) It is the object of the verb "realized"
(g)(i) it is a metaphor
(h)(i) vehemently—fiercely, strongly. (ii) Abscond —sneak away, steal away, run away (iii) probably

— maybe, perhaps, most likely, almost certainly.
(iv) Gradually — step by step, little by little, bit by bit, slowly. (v) Prodding — coaxing, urging, persuasion, prompting. (vi) Devastated — shattered, distressed, upset, worried.

7. (a) Mr. Njobe was lean, hungry-looking, gaunt and haggard.
(b) The concept was that of apartheid.
(c) The mild clapping suggested that the students did not think much of the new teacher.
(d) It was that the new teacher taught without referring to any textbook.
(e) The new teacher's method is practical.
(f) (i) It is a noun clause (ii) it is the object of the verb "discovered"
(g) It is a metaphor.
(h)(i) Luckless—hapless, ill-fated, unlucky, unfortunate. (ii) Consult— check through, turn to, refer to. (iii) Meticulously—Diligently, painstakingly, carefully. (iv) Amazement—Astonishment, surprise. (v) Terrifying—intimidating, fearful, frightening, scary. (vi) Critical — very bad, grave, serious.

SECTION C SUMMARY

8. (a)(i) A market research or survey is done by a publishing house or publisher. (ii) The publishing house searches for a good writer. (iii) An assessor determines the suitability of the manuscript. (iv) The updated or final manuscript is edited by the editorial staff of the publishing house. (v) The manuscript or book is printed.
(b) It creates awareness through advertisement or marketing.

WASSCE JUNE 2013 ENGLISH LANGUAGE 3 OBJECTIVE QUESTIONS

TEST OF RALS (SECTION 1)

From the words lettered A to D, choose the word that has the **same vowel sound** as the one represented by the letter(s) underlined. An example is given below.

Example: seat A. sit B. cite C. set D. key

The correct answer is D because only key contains the same vowel sound as the one underlined in seat. Therefore, answer space D would be shaded

[A] [B] [C] [D]

1. fussy A. buffalo B. burn C. could D. bout
2. guard A. slack B. gourd C. father D. haven
3. ship A. peep B. feat C. wine D. brick
4. purpose A. kernel B. pun C. mustache D. sage
5. flee A. sway B. creative C. breaches D. dread
6. lad A. palm B. format C. squat D. wonder

7. troupe A. cook B. paw C. push D. who
8. afford A. earn B. fern C. lead D. iatter
9. dent A. leopard B. germ C. legal D. she
10. spot A. court B. probe C. nod D. snort
11. over A. brush B. burn C. lock D. load
12. brow A. slush B. know C. now D. show
13. tray A. straw B. tyre C. sleigh D. fear
14. heir A. peer B. liar C. dire D. chair
15. spear A. feat B. heat C. weird D. where

SECTION 2

From the words lettered A to C, choose the word that has the **same consonant sound(s)** as the one represented by the letter(s) underlined. An example is given below.

Example: vice A. cat B. dress C. show D. chalk

The correct answer is B because only dress has the same consonant sound as the one underlined in vice. Therefore, answerspace B would be shaded.

[A] [B] [C] [D]

Now answer the questions that follow.

16. sober A. climb B. plumber C. lumber D. lamb
17. mate A. funny B. comb C. knew D. bran
18. chaos A. chiffon B. match C. clinic D. smash
19. note A. design B. song C. solemn D. bring
20. dose A. debris B. goes C. goose D. lose
21. days A. freeze B. island C. face D. thanks
22. cheap A. joggle B. sober C. sachet D. culture
23. insure A. pleasure B. cheap C. vision D. ocean
24. mixed A. pumped B. thronged C. climbed D. sponged
25. gear A. gesture B. germ C. ghetto D. neighbour
26. drink A. sting B. dent C. snag D. singe
27. axe A. sacks B. slumped C. school C. bask
28. whole A. whale B. hour C. hide C. heir
29. grip A. cart B. l'ning C. burnt C. courting
30. thrive A. wrealh B. thus C. though C. tooth

SECTION 3

From the words lettered A to D, choose the word that rhymes with the given word. An example is given below.

Example: obtain A. detain B. detail C. claim D. relay

The correct answer is A because only detain rhymes with obtain, Therefore, answer space A would be shaded.

[A] [B] [C] [D]

Now answer the questions that follow.

31. clone A. crown B. lawn C. brown C. loan
32. monk A. smack B. pluck C. sunk D. shock
33. pride A. sprout B. kite C. spade D. wide
34. hind A. void B. laud C. signed D. speed
35. disdain A. convey B. curtain C. avail D. ordain

SECTION 4

In each of the following questions, the **main/primary stress** is indicated by writing the syllable on which it occurs in capital letters.

From the words lettered A to D, choose the one that has the correct stress. An example is given below.

Example: democratic

- A. DE-mo-cra-tic B. de-MO-cra-tic
C. de-mo-CRA-tic D. de-mo-cra-TIC

The correct answer is C because the main/primary' stress of the word democratic is on the third syllable. Therefore, answer space C would be shaded.

[A] [B] [C] [D]

Now answer the questions that follow.

36. indoctrinate
A. IN-doc-tri-nate B. in-DOC-tri-nate
C. in-duc-1 RI-nate D. in-doc-tri-NATE

37. refinery
A. RE-fin-e-ry B. re-FIN-e-ry
C. re-fin-E-ry D. re-fin-e-RY
38. phenomenal
A. PHE-no-me-nal B. phe-NO-me-nal
C. phe-no-ME-nal D. phe-no-me-NAL
39. consistency
A. CON-sis-ten-cy B. con-SIS-ten-cy
C. con-sis-TEN-cy D. con-sis-ten-CY
40. acrobatic
A. AC-ro-ba-tic B. ac-RO-ba-tic
C. ac-ro-BA-tic D. ac-ro-ba-TIC

SECTION 5

In the following options lettered A to D, all the words except one have the same stress pattern. Identify the one with the different **stress pattern** and shade your answer in the usual way. An example is given below.

Example: A. away B. apart C. behind D. river

Options A, B, C are all stressed on the second syllable while option D is the only one stressed on the first syllable. So, D is the correct answer.

Therefore, answerspace D would be shaded.

[A] [B] [C] [D]

Now answer the questions that follow.

41. A swindle B. sandals C. bucket D. extreme
42. A convenient B. excellent C. durable D. camouflage
43. A accede B. convey C. dissuade D. closure
44. A tradition B. affiliate C. beautiful D. consistent
45. A constructive B. technical C. necessary D. plentiful

SECTION 6

In each of the following sentences, the word that receives the **emphatic stress** is written in capital letters. From the questions lettered A to D, choose the one to which the given sentence is the appropriate answer. An example is given below.

Example: My mother's FRIEND hates pets.

- A. Does your mother's boss hate pets?
B. Does your mother's friend love pets?
C. Does your mother's friend hate toys?
D. Does your father's friend hate pets

The correct answer is A because My mother's FRIEND hates pets answers the question, Does your mother's boss hate pets? Therefore, answer space A would be shaded.

[A] [B] [C] [D]

Now answer the questions that follow.

46. The playwright gave a TRIBUTE to her mother.
A. Did the playwright give a gift to her mother?
B. Did the singer give a tribute to her mother?
C. Did the playwright dedicate a tribute to her mother?

- D. Did the playwright give a tribute to her father?
47. The WRITER sold a million copies of his new book.
A Did the writer sell a thousand copies of his new book?
B. Did the writer publish a million copies of his new book?
C. Did the artist sell a million copies of his new book?
D. Did the writer sell a million copies of his old book?
48. The union congratulated the ELECTED president.
A. Did the union congratulate the ousted president?
B. Did the management congratulate the elected president?
C. Did the union reject the elected president?
D. Did the union congratulate the elected chairman?
49. A good description INCLUDES specific nouns.
A Does a good description include specific verbs?
B. Does a good description exclude specific nouns?
C. Does a poor description include specific nouns?
D. Does a good description include obscure nouns?

50. The MANAGEMENT will continue to encourage hardworking staff.
A Will the management continue to retrench hardworking staff?
B. Will the principal continue to encourage hardworking staff?
C. Will the management refuse to encourage hardworking staff?
D. Will the management continue to encourage hardworking clients?

SECTION 7

From the words lettered A to D, choose the word that contains the **sound** represented by the given phonetic symbol. An example is given below.

Example: /ɪ/ A. yell B. holy C. boy D. idiot

The correct answer is C because only boy contains the sound represented by the given symbol. Therefore, answer space C would be shaded. [A] [B] [C] [D]

Now answer the questions that follow.

51. /i/ A. dream B. seize C. fee D. funny
52. /ə/ A. coral B. draft C. then D. spleen
53. /ʊ/ A. cook B. dew C. blunt D. bloom
54. /ʌ/ A. council B. fulfil C. plunge D. wiles
55. /i:/ A. early B. pile C. putrid D. cleave
56. /j/ A. measure B. huge C. pressure D. church
57. /l/ A. helm B. calm C. palm D. alms
58. /s/ A. purse B. bees C. whose D. ways
59. /θ/ A. theme B. smooth C. method D. bath
60. /dʒ/ A. gauge B. match C. gear D. wag

WASSCE JUNE 2013 ENGLISH LANGUAGE 3 TEST OF ORALS (OBJECTIVE) ANSWERS

1. A	2. B	3. D	4. A	5. C	6. A	7. D	8. D	9. A	10. D	11. D	12. C	13. C	14. D
15. C	16. C	17. B	18. B	19. A	20. A	21. A	22. C	23. D	24. A	25. C	26. A	27. D	28. C
29. B	30. D	31. D	32. C	33. D	34. C	35. D	36. C	37. C	38. C	39. C	40. C	41. A	42. C
43. D	44. C	45. C	46. A	47. C	48. C	49. B	50. B	51. C	52. A	53. A	54. A	55. D	56. C
57. D	58. C	59. A	60. A										

SENIOR SCHOOL CERTIFICATE EXAMINATION (SSCE 1988 – 2015)

Past Questions with Solutions

English Language

(Theory / Objectives with Oral English) 2014

WASSCE JUNE 2014 ENGLISH LANGUAGE 1 OBJECTIVE TEST

SECTION 1

In each of the following sentences, there is one underlined word and one gap. From the list of words lettered A to D, choose the one that is **most nearly opposite in meaning** to the underlined word and that will, at the same time, correctly fill the gap in the sentence.

- Many parents wrongly assume that their children are ignorant whereas they are.....A. enthusiastic. B. hardworking. C. brilliant. D. knowledgeable.
- Industrious workers should be promoted and.....ones should be dismissed. A. indolent B. dishonest C. inactive D. sluggish
- While some people.....jollof rice, others enjoy it. A. rebuff B. abhor C. ignore D. condemn
- The haughty, and not the...are usually unpopular. A. friendly B. carefree C. timid D. humble
- Rather than heed the advice, the children..... it. A. defied B. countered C. ignored D. spurned
- Dishonest traders sell fake products instead of.... ones. A. costly B. durable C. genuine D. perfect
- The judge expected direct answers but the accused was..... A. illusive. B. secretive. C. delusive. D. evasive.
- Parents should persuade their children to do chores, not..... them. A. implore B. coerce C. enjoin D. cajole
- Rather than accept the blame, the manager.....the accusation. A. criticized B. refused C. addressed D. denied
- It is often easier to start a riot than to..... it. A. complete B. suppress C. quench D. quell

SECTION 2

From the words lettered A to D, choose the word that **best completes** each of the following sentences.

- The policy will.....havoc on the economy of the nation. A.wreak B.promote C. produce D.wreck
- The librarian has not entered the new books in the..... A. list B. directory C. catalogue D. roster
- The judge.....the case. A. cancelled B. dismissed C. rejected D. withdrew
- Mosquito parasites have become.....to quinine. A. resistant B. immune C. opposed D. defapt
- The unionists.....the meeting with the management. A.rejected B.hindered C.boycotted D. banned
- The company failed to pay up the loan because it had become..... A. corrupt. B. bankrupt. C. inefficient. D. unreliable.
- The newly elected chairman has been.....into office. A. sworn B. installed C. admitted D. inaugurated
- The doctor declared that the sick child needed a blood..... A. transformation. B. transfer. C. transmission. D. transfusion.
- Many slaves were.....in the 19th century. A. released B. empowered C. emancipated D. relieved
- The proprietor has promised to.....the dilapidated classroom blocks. A. erect B. renovate C. patch D. fabricate

SECTION 3

After each of the following sentences, a list of possible interpretations is given. Choose the interpretation that you consider **most appropriate** for each sentence.

- We heard that Bada has served time. This means that Bada has A. always been punctual. B. been the timekeeper. C. been to prison. D. been a faithful servant.
- Mary and I have never seen eye to eye on politics. This means that we have never A. agreed on

politics. B. engaged in politics. C. discussed politics. D. benefited from politics.

23. Helen has always been a wet blanket. This means that Helen A. always gets wet. B. betrays her friends. C. interacts freely with other people. D. stops others from enjoying themselves.
24. The new policy has come under fire. This means that the policy is A. generating controversy. B. being criticized. C. being scrutinized. D. causing a riot.
25. Please, don't let them get under your skin. This means that you should not let them A. infect you. B. defeat you. C. bully you. D. annoy you.
26. We were surprised to learn that Tom had been let off the hook. This means that Tom had A. not been punished. B. gone fishing alone. C. been sent away. D. not been dismissed.
27. He is at the crossroads of his life. This means that it is time for him to A. make a very important decision. B. retrace his steps. C. make peace with everyone. D. take his studies seriously.
28. We shall understand her better by and by. This means that we shall know her better A. without her knowing it. B. much later. C. before long. D. by spending time with her.
29. The student's story did not ring true. This means that the student's story was A. not audible B. not believable C. full of suspense D. quite thrilling.
30. Mathematics is a closed book to me. This means that I A. do not have to study Mathematics B. do not understand Mathematics. C. have never passed Mathematics. D. cannot avoid studying Mathematics.

SECTION 4

From the words lettered A to D below each of the following sentences, choose the word or group of words that is **nearest in meaning** to the underlined word as it is used in the sentence.

31. I think children are more robust than adults. A. healthy and strong. B. pleasant and cheerful. C. vital and dependable. D. plump and curvy.
32. The new law was meant to mitigate the people's suffering. A. restrain B. moderate C. stop D. alleviate

33. The judge is incorruptible. A. consistent B. honest C. responsible D. outspoken.
34. Whatever my boss decides is irrevocable. A. final. B. true. C. necessary. D. enforced.
35. The printer took a cursory look at the document. A. quick B. long C. puzzled D. careful
36. This morning, Audu arrived at the school looking dishevelled. A. worried B. terrified C. untidy D. confused.
37. Corporal punishment is meant to be a deterrent to indiscipline. A. remedy B. measure C. discouragement D. prevention.
38. The new bank is thriving. A. evolving. B. attractive. C. flourishing. D. supportive.
39. It is not safe to engage in clandestine deals. A. secret B. exclusive C. unimportant D. doubtful
40. Bola vehemently denied stealing the money. A. strongly B. fearlessly C. openly D. strictly.

SECTION 5

From the words or group of words lettered A to D, choose the word or group of words that **best completes** each of the following sentences.

41. It's been smooth so far.....? A. hadn't it B. wasn't it C. isn't it D. hasn't it
42. The test seemed.....simple that we thought we would all pass. A. too B. very C. so D. much
43. Good citizens are expected to abide the stipulated laws. A. with B. in C. to D. by
44. In the olden days, people gave cowries.....food. A. on exchange for B. in exchange of C. in exchange for D. on exchange with
45. The man tried to cash in.....the boy's ignorance. A. by B. at C. on D. with
46. Adamu studied very hard.....passing the examination. A. with a view to B. with the view of C. with a view of D. with the view to
47. No sooner had the judge read the verdict.....pandemonium broke out. A. than B. when C. and D. then
48. I could not distinguish the original.....the fake. A. from B. to C. by D. with

49. When I came home, my mother asked me if I.....
A. ate B. was eating C. have eaten D. had eaten,
50. Uncle Richard invited Naza and.....to his house.
A. me B. I C. myself D. she
51. My sister prides herself.....,her cooking.
A. on B. for C. over D. in
52. I suppose it's high time we..... attention to our studies. A.pay B. are paying C. paid D. should pay
53. We were expecting them in the evening but they arrived.....dawn. A. on Bat C. in D. for
54. Children often try to live up..... their parents' expectations. A. in B. by C.to D. on
55. He.....be fat, but he is still smart. A. may. B. could C. can D. might.
56. The students had no choice.....to do as they had been commanded. A. even B. but C. rather D. only
57. The dog was run.....by a careless driver.
A. under B. upon C. across D. over
58. When will the strike be.....? A. called off B. called back C. called out D. called over
59. I received an award.....my outstanding performance in the debate. A. for B. through C. in D. or
60. The earlier we leave.....for us. A. the best B. the much better C. the better D. it is better
61. I just couldn't..... what he was saying.
A. make do B. make out C. make up D. make by
62. The men were charged.....murder. A. of B. for C.with D. on
63. It is I who.....to blame for the lapses. A.was B. am C. is D. are
64. We had to look.....the word in the dictionary.
A. with B. on C. at D. up
65. Each of the winners.....to receive five thousand dollars. A. are B. is C. have D. were
66. Everyone was happywhen the two friends made.....after their disagreement. A off B. do C. away D. up

67. It is rude to cut..... when people are talking.
A. in B. through C. off D. from
68. I..... a song when I got my letter of promotion.
A. broke into B.broke out C.broke for D. broke in.
69. Our tour of the tower came to an end all..... soon. A. much B. rather C. too D. more
70. The.....of the various dailies attended the conference. A. Editors-in-Chiefs B. Editors-in-Chief C.Editors-in-Chief D. Editor's-in-Chief

SECTION 6

*In the following passages, the numbered gaps indicate missing words. Against each number in the list below the passage, four options are given in columns lettered A to D. Choose the word that is the **most suitable** to fill the numbered gaps in the passage.*

Let us discuss briefly one of the common means of modern transportation — the motor car. The car is a vehicle on four wheels. It is powered by - 71 - that runs on petrol, although there are a fewthat run on diesel or gas. Most cars can attain speeds of more than 120 kilometres an hpur, though you don't have to move your car that fast, especially if you are — 72 — on minor — 73 —.

A car is manned by a driver who sits in front, beside a passenger and up to three persons can sit at the rear, To determine where the car turns, the driver turns the steering — 74 — to the left or the right. To move the car forward, the driver engages the — 75 — and presses the — 76 — which some people also call the throttle. The harder you press this, the faster the car moves. In manually operated cars.g change the — 77 — of acceleration, you have to change the gear by first pressing the —76 and then shifting the gear — 79 — from the first to the second, then to the third and then the fourth. All these require a lot of — 80 — and practice. To stop the car or reduce its speed, you have to apply the brakes.

71	A. a device	B. an appliance	C. a machine	D. an engine
72	crushing	speeding	driving	racing
73	tracks	channels	roads	paths
74	car	wheel	gear	rod
75	gear	shift	knob	button
76	carburettor	generator	asrator	accelerator
77	pace	flow	speed	rate
78	throttle	clutch	brake	axis
79	switch	box	handle	lever
80	training	thinking	coaching	tuition

WASSCE JUNE 2014 ENGLISH LANGUAGE 1 OBJECTIVE TEST ANSWERS

1.D	2.A	3.B	4.D	5.C	6.C	7.D
8.D	9.D	10.D	11.D	12.C	13.B	14.B
15.C	16.B	17.D	18.D	19.A	20.B	21.C
22.C	23.B	24.B	25.D	26.A	27.A	28.D
29.B	30.B	31.A	32.D	33.B	34.A	35.A

36.C 37.B 38.C 39.A 40.A 41.D 42.B
 43.D 44.C 45.C 46.B 47.A 48.A 49.D
 50.A 51.A 52.C 53.B 54.C 55.A 56.C
 57.D 58.A 59.A 60.C 61.C 62.B 63.C

64.D 65.B 66.D 67.A 68.A 69.C 70.C
 71.D 72.A 73.C 74.B 75.A 76.D 77.C
 78.B 79.C 80.A

WASSCE JUNE 2014 ENGLISH LANGUAGE 2 THEORY QUESTIONS

(SECTION A) ESSAY

1. A friend of yours who has been living in Europe for some years has written to invite you to join him. Write a reply to his letter giving, at least, three reasons why you would like to remain in your country.
2. Write an article suitable for publication in your school magazine on the need to inculcate good moral values in the youth. .
3. Write a letter to the Minister of Education in your country discussing, at least, three ways by which the quality of education could be improved.
4. You are the main speaker in a debate on the topic: Technology has made the world a better place. Write your argument for or against the motion.
5. Write a story to illustrate the saying: The devil makes work for idle hands.

[SECTION B] COMPREHENSION

6. Read the following passage **carefully** and answer the questions on it.

The case of Dr. David Akide drives home the point that nobody should be written off as a failure as long as he has not died. As far as I can recall he was one of the weakest in class throughout our primary school career. Right from the second grade, he was the butt of most of our jokes. Indeed, whenever the teacher referred a Question to him, most of us waited eagerly to have a good laugh. But we all admired him for two things. For one thing he was the only one who never wrote with the right hand as he was a complete southpaw. Then, he endured all the jokes cheerfully and indeed referred to himself as "Mr. Why Hurry." For ever sociable, he was a friend to everybody who came close enough.

Not surprising, we left him behind in the primary school as he could not get admitted to any of the secondary schools to which he took an admission examination. That was why, from the time I entered the secondary school, I lost contact with him. Nor did any of my mates whom I closely associated with ever mention meeting him anywhere. As far as most of us were concerned, David had faded away into obscurity. I imagined

that he must have ended up in one of the low-grade vocations since he was at least good in handicraft.

Then, a few months ago, thirty-eight years after I last saw him in the primary school, while I was watching a 9 o'clock television network programme I saw David being interviewed by a team of reporters. He was introduced as a specialist surgeon who had made his mark in heart surgery in the nation's leading teaching hospital. The questions were on his recent feat in his successful correction of abnormality in the heart of a patient who had been written off by most other specialists. The patient fully recovered and was now back in his vocation as a mechanic.

I was amazed. I was pleasantly surprised. From the Interview, it became clear that he had experienced a surge in intellectual prowess late in his secondary school career and zoomed into and through the university as a medical student. Thereafter, it had been one major achievement after another for him in his chosen field.

- (a) What evidence is there that the writer is not a young person?
- (b) For what two things was David Akide admired by others in the primary school?
- (c) Why could he not move into a secondary school then along with the others?
- (d) What did the writer assume had been the fate of David after leaving the primary school?
- (e) What is established by the fact that David Akide was being interviewed by a panel of reporters on the nation's network programme?
- (f) Why was the writer amazed?
- (g) "... while I was watchin9 a 9 o'clock television network programme..." (i) What is the 9rammatical name 9iven to this expression as it is used in the passage? (ii) What is its function?
- (h) '... zoomed into and through the university (i)What figure of speech is used in this expression? (ii) What does it mean? (i) For each of the following words, find another word or phrase which means the same and which can replace it as it is used in the passage: (I)cheerfully; (ii) sociable; (iii) imagined; (iv)vocation; (v) achievement.

(SECTION C)

SUMMARY

7. Read the following passage **carefully** and answer the questions on it.

Have you ever considered the vast differences between the conventional desktop telephone and the modern handset telephone? The desktop telephone has one distinct function: that of making and receiving calls. Apart from that, perhaps the other use is aesthetic - adding some beauty to the furniture pieces in the room. The conventional telephone set was a status symbol, as only the rich and highly privileged could afford it.

To obtain it, one had to fill many forms and have three well known citizens to attest to one's sterling qualities as a highly responsible member of the society. Then after paying several fees, one had to wait for several months before the telecommunications department officials would come to install the wires, in order to get one's set connected to the national grid. After that, the applicant might count himself among the privileged ones in the community. But he must not have a sigh of relief yet: his problem may just be beginning. The inclement weather may remind him that his use of the facility is at its mercy. A rainstorm or even a strong wind can destroy some of the wire-bearing poles, thus cutting him off from other telephone users. Besides, a vehicular accident may knock down a pole or several of them. It is not even uncommon for termites to render wooden poles useless. Finally, there are the problems of the communications department officials who are noted for bringing bills late, and cutting off wires for failure to pay up promptly. Most often, the bills bear little resemblance to actual consumption. Thus, the telephone is not always there at one's service.

Like the conventional desktop telephone set, the handset has the primary function of making and receiving calls. Beyond that, there are vast differences between them. To begin with, the small handset is not much of a status symbol now. It is very easy to carry about and it can be used everywhere by all and sundry. The telephone service providers have flooded the market with lines at very low prices, such that most users can boast of two or more lines. Gone are the days when one had to apply for a set and wait for months. Today, all that it takes is to purchase the handset, which could be very cheap or very costly depending on one's preferences and purse. Once it is purchased, its user could have access to dozens of functions. Apart from making and receiving calls, one could send text messages and receive responses within minutes. The set could

be used to take pictures which could be as clear as any taken with a professional camera. One could also connect to the internet to read newspapers and send mails. Besides, the set could be used to store songs; it could also be used as a radio receiver. One could use the handset to programme schedules of activities. The reliable timepiece on it could be used as a watch. Young ones play games on their handsets and store pictures of loved ones on them.

However, with all these advantages, the handset has one obvious shortcoming: it can easily be lost or stolen. This is where the conventional desktop telephone is not vulnerable.

(a) In three sentences, one for each, summarize the problems associated with owning the desktop telephone.

(b) In three sentences, one for each, summarize the advantages which the handset telephone has over the desktop telephone.

WASSCE JUNE 2014 ENGLISH LANGUAGE 2 THEORY ANSWERS

(SECTION A) ESSAY

1. 22, Jacob Street,

Off Ojuelegba Road,
Surulere,
Lagos.
6th June, 2014.

Dear Larry,

How are you doing? I hope the prevailing economic climate in Europe is not adversely affecting you. By now you may be wondering why I have not replied to your last letter, well this letter is to let you know the reasons why I would rather remain in Nigeria than come to Europe.

To start with, the fear of natural disaster scares me, if it is not a tsunami, it is a tornado, an earthquake, hurricane volcanic eruption, a cyclone, forest fire or a meteor land from space. I often wonder if it is possible for a month to go by without a serious natural disaster in Europe. Of course not only the more serious ones make spectacular news headlines all over the world. Nigeria on the flip side, mostly experiences one kind of nature's fury which is flood. The irony of this issue is that even this can actually be avoided, if only people in crowded urban areas keep their drainage systems clean.

Secondly, there is a mad rush for Visa and this has been going on for a while, the process of obtaining a Visa is rigorous and also expensive, there are lots of documents to be submitted. The Visa application itself requires lots of money to be spent and if at the end of the day one's Visa application is declined, then one would have lost a

lot of money. Money which if invested in something else would yield maximum amount of profit.

Thirdly, in a place like Europe no one can ever escape the payment of bills and taxes which have been imposed by the European Governments on electricity, water and so on. But in Nigeria though tax is compulsory not everyone pays. It is a well known fact that fingers are not equal.

Fourthly, Larry I was given birth to in Nigeria and I have gotten so used to the weather condition and the system of surviving, I believe that relocating to another country with a different weather condition would make it difficult if not impossible to easily adapt to any new environment. .

I also have to consider my health condition, knowing fully well that I am asthmatic and will easily get sick in a cold weather environment.

To end with you need to understand that there is no place like home and Nigeria will always be my home and I would rather remain in Nigeria than come to Europe where my chances of surviving are very slim.

Take good care of yourself and extend my greetings to your younger sister Tolu. Bye for now.

Yours sincerely,
Ogbolu Nwakaego.

2. THE NEED TO INCULCATE GOOD MORAL VALUES IN THE YOUTH

I consider myself very privileged to be able to contribute gainfully to this edition of our esteemed school magazine the concept of the need to inculcate good moral values in the youth. .

What are moral values you may ask? Moral values are universally accepted ethical principles that govern the day-to-day life of individuals. Examples of moral values are clarity, commitment, diligence, endurance, flexibility, generosity and so on.

Going further, if good moral values are impacted on youths, they will be provided with the intellectual resources that would enable them to take responsible judgements about difficult matters of moral importance.

It would be observed that when the right moral values are imbibed in youths, there is a guarantee for a better future in the country, thus it helps in the quest for a greater Nigeria.

Good moral values broaden the mind of the youths to rationally analyze reasonable courses and situations they encounter.

Good moral values provide the youths with the ability to accommodate whatsoever circumstance they come across.

Moral is definitely an integral part of learning process, if good moral values are taught to youths, then we would succeed, to a large extent, in extricating our society from the deadly claws of crime.

3. 6, Martins Street,

Off Alvis Avenue,
Lagos.

26th April, 2014.

The Minister of Education,
Federal Ministry of Education,
Area 6, Wuse Quarters,
Abuja.

Dear Sir,

WAYS BY WHICH THE QUALITY OF EDUCATION COULD BE IMPROVED

I hereby write to commend you for your endless efforts in the Ministry of Education and also to suggest ways by which the quality of Education in this country, Nigeria could be improved.

It is quite obvious that the rate of unemployment and underemployment in this country is growing rapidly. The issue of students - graduates not getting employed or being self-employed in this country is nothing to write home about. Sir, it is not that there are not enough jobs anymore in this country but that most of our graduates are unemployable. That notes to say that there has been a fall in the quality of education received by most students in this country. The purpose of writing this letter is not to deliberate on the issue of unemployment so I would go straight to suggesting ways by which quality of education in this country could be improved.

Firstly the provision of infrastructural facilities like libraries, laboratories, classrooms I lecture rooms etc. both in primary, secondary and tertiary institutions would go a long way in improving the quality of education in this country. The effects of a good library (one stocked with various educational books) has on the performance of students cannot be overemphasized. As most students need absolute decorum in order to assimilate whatever it is that they are reading. The provision of good libraries would be of great benefit to them. Laboratories with various sets of apparatuses would also be of great benefits to students who

take science subjects or courses, particularly pure sciences.

Science as we know is better understood than theoretical analysis only. Also as “seeing is believing”. Laboratories will help students understand certain concepts in sciences better. Good and conducive classrooms would also aid assimilation in no small way.

Secondly teachers should be given periodical training so as to help refresh their brains. Since it is what a teacher knows that he/she impacts on the students, it would be of great help to hold programmes to help refine the teachers. This training programmes will go a long way in improving the quality of education in this country as it would make the teachers to be consistent, refined, and always at their best. Furthermore these training programmes would also help teachers to have more knowledge about new concepts or topics in their field of works as they are being added to the scheme of work of curriculum in the Educational system.

Again, teachers should be paid their salaries on time, even if the government cannot give them incentives, delaying teachers’ salaries will discourage them from their work as this will make them venture into businesses to make ends meet instead of focusing on teaching though it is not their fault as they have to provide for their families.

The Government should look into the issue of late salary payment and also teachers’ incentives to give teachers room to face their job squarely. Moreover teachers will be encouraged to work harder and pay full attention to whatever it is that they are supposed to do.

Finally, I thank you once again for your efforts in ensuring that the education system of this country is up and doing. More grease to your elbow sir I am very certain and assured that if my suggestions are put into consideration and accorded a reply of action, the quality of Education in this country will, in no small way, be improved.

Yours Faithfully,
Babatunde Adewale.

4. TECHNOLOGY HAS MADE THE WORLD A BETTER PLACE.

Good day Mr. Chairman Panel of Judges, accurate Timekeeper, my co-debators and my fellow students. I Babatunde Adewale stand before you all on this graceful occasion to throw all my weight against the motion:

Technology has made the world a better place. Before stating my reasons, let me define or

state rather the meaning of the word technology. Technology is coined from ‘Tech’ meaning machine and ‘logy’ meaning study, it is the use of scientific knowledge in practical ways mostly in the creation of machines. The advent of technology, as I see has done more harm than good. Indeed, it has not, in anyway made the world a ‘better place’ to live in.

Before the advent of Technology, our forefathers (since they lived at that time) never experienced what we call ‘road accident’ or ‘plane crash and the others during the course of transportation. Those didn’t occur to them because their mode of transportation was either trekking with their legs (in the case of short distance) or with the use of animals like Horse, Camel or Donkey (in the case of long distance).

I heard my opponent say that without the intervention of automobiles and aircraft we would not be able to cover long distances within short intervals. That might sound true but what we need are safe and reliable means of transportation and not fast, unsecure and unsafe ones.

Of course, my opponent is not ignorant of the record of about 352 motor car accidents that all took place last year in this our country, Nigeria to be specific. Also, does the whole world not know about the aeroplane that sank in the Pacific Ocean about few months back? It was stated in the news that the aircraft was conveying more than 800 passengers, all of whom are now dead. Would it be said that the earlier said motor car accidents all occurred as a result of incompetence of the drivers? Aren’t most of the motor-car accidents due to faulty car brakes? Would it be said that the pilots of the aircraft that sank suddenly lost their skills of craftsmanship? It was due to one failure or the other, car brake failure, combustion engine failure, choke failure and the likes, excuses claiming the lives of humans. Look, what technology does is that it solves one problem and creates another problem which if fortunate, would not claim lives but sadly, most aren’t. Technology has done more harm than good ever since its advent. How then has it made the world a better place?

Consequently, the knowledge of technology has made possible the creation of dangerous arms (weapons) such as atomic bombs, rocket launchers, AK-47, machine guns and the likes used for causing mass destruction. The atomic bomb that exploded in a city of Japan called Hiroshima swept the whole city. No life was spared’ Till today that region in Japan is still experiencing one problem or the other pertaining to health as a result of the dangerous chemicals

that was emitted by the atomic bomb. It is quite a lot of harm.

Yet still, it is known today that some countries create and keep what are known as nuclear weapons which are powerful enough to wipe out a whole nation. Tell me why would they create such weapons? Should one of such countries decide to attack we Nigerians, what do we do about it? Is that not something to worry about? That makes us live in fear! It is time we stop deceiving ourselves and face the truth.

Also, Technology, claiming to make communication easier and faster through the use of mobile phones, computers and the internet has caused a lot of havoc in present day society. The issue of youths nowadays going online to dupe people is a very bad influence of technology. It is not a thing of surprise that these mobile phones are now major distractions to students as the need of belonging to a social media community now becomes their priority, not their books. It is not only students that are affected, same is the case of our present day youths. Moreover, it is quite obvious that gradually the standard of Education in this country is falling as recent examination tend to put forth easy questions. Examining boards now realize that students do not read anymore and to avoid or prevent mass failure, they tend to make their exam question easier. Why is this so all of a sudden? The answer simply is because students now get distracted a lot by television, mobile phones and internet. These are few of the negative influences technology has brought upon us, thereby not making our world what it is supposed to be.

The question of if technology has made the world a better place is not an open ended one and the answer to such question, if given a deep thought, is a capital NO.

With these few points, I hope I have been able to convince you that technology has not made the world a better place.

Thank you.

5. THE DEVIL MAKES WORK FOR IDLE HANDS

A saying goes that "an idle man is the devil's workshop". This means that anyone who is jobless will definitely be used by the devil to commit a grievous offence. This makes me remember what happened to a lady called Mrs. Esther Odusanya.

Mrs. Odusanya was a woman in her thirties. She was a proud and arrogant woman. Even with the fact that she was as poor as a church rat, she still insulted people who were better off than she was. She was one of those who were always

avoided in the neighbourhood because of their sharp tongue. Whenever there were exchange of abusive words, they aroused her pleasure. In fact, she got the reputation of the composer of foul-mouthed and ugly words.

Her dirty manners and rude behaviours made her husband divorce her. Her husband opened a Supermarket for her owing to the fact that he was a Bank Manager. But her bad mouth made her lose customers. Eventually, the supermarket closed down after her husband left her for another woman. This left her jobless.

Whenever her neighbours were leaving for work, they always left her in the care of their shops, children and that made people disrespect her.

But she was not bothered because she had only a little Education. One day, she stormed upon one of her friends called Deborah who was a university graduate. Deborah was a very wealthy woman. They exchanged contacts and Esther paid her a visit. She asked her friend to assist her start a business but her friend had no money on her due to the debt she paid off. She got angry and left her friend's place thinking her friend didn't want to help her. When she got home, she started cursing and raining abuses on her friend.

Later on, she stopped and started thinking of how to pay her friend back in her own coin. Due to the many thoughts that ran through her mind, she decided that she would cut her friend's life short and see how her friend's business would continue flourishing. She arranged for hired killers to murder her friend by giving them her address.

About 10:00 a.m., when Deborah was leaving for her business place, she was strangled to death right in her car. Luckily, Mrs. Deborah's maid Abigail knew when an argument ensued between her madam and Mrs. Odusanya. While the policemen were investigating the incident, Abigail told them all that happened. Mrs. Esther Odusanya was charged to court with accomplices. She was found guilty and sentenced to life imprisonment with hard labour.

Had it been she had a petty job, she was doing, she would not even have gone to her friend for assistance. That is why I say The devil makes out work for an idle hand.

Okunade Tolulope
SS2.

SECTION B COMPREHENSION

6. (a) The evidence is that he had left primary school thirty-eight years ago. (b)(i) He (was the only pupil who) wrote with his left hand / He was a complete

Southpaw. (ii) He was sociable! Friendly / Cheerful. (C) He could not pass the entrance examinations. (d) The writer assumed that David had taken up a low grade vocation. (e) The fact that David Akide was being interviewed by a panel of reporters on the television network proves that he was an important person (an achiever). (f) He was amazed because Akide, (a weak pupil), had become a specialist surgeon.

(g)(i) It is an adverbial clause (of time). (ii) It modifies (the verb) "saw". (h)(i) It is a Metaphor (ii) It means that Akide had gone through the university quickly.

- (i) Cheerfully - Light heartedly, in good spirit, heartily, without taking offence, pleasantly.
 (ii) Sociable - affable, pleasant, outgoing, easy to get along with.
 (iii) Imagined - assumed, presumed, thought, felt, took it.

(iv) Vocation - career, job, occupation, work.

(v) Achievement - accomplishment, success, feat, attainment.

SECTION C SUMMARY

7. (a)(i) The process of obtaining a desktop telephone is difficult/cumbersome. OR It is difficult to obtain a desktop telephone. (ii) Unexpected I negative I Unfavourable incidents / occurrences may affect the telephone lines! wires (iii) The inefficient I poor billing (system) affects the use of the desktop telephone.

(b)(i) The handset telephone is easy I easier to obtain. (ii) It has a variety of uses. /it has more uses I functions! applications than the desktop telephone. (iii) It is portable. / It is more portable than desktop telephone I It is easy to carry about / it is easier to carry about.

WASSCE JUNE 2014 ENGLISH LANGUAGE 3 OBJECTIVE QUESTIONS TEST OF ORALS

(SECTION 1)

From the words lettered A to D, choose the word that has the **same vowel sound** as the one represented by the letter(s) underlined. An example is given below.

Example: seat A. sit B. cite C. set D. key

The correct answer is D because only key contains the same vowel sound as the one underlined in seat. Therefore, answer space D would be shaded.

[A] [B] [C] [D]

Now answer the questions that follow.

1. mitten A. firm B. knowledge C. vice D. marine
2. mood A. took B. look C. moon D. mode says
3. says A. end B. bay C. rain D. fern caprice
4. caprice A. bed B. matrix C. concern D. cape pse
5. purse A. currant B. leisure C. first D. sure man
6. man A. part B. hand C. market D. charade
7. month A. mug B. font C. cost D. moth bull
8. bull A. hoof B. crude C. soup D. stood feel
9. feel A. beat B. buffet C. head D. seer open
10. open A. chaos B. coin C. boar D. phone
11. drought A. drown B. draft C. should D. tough
12. fear A. bear B. swear C. spare D. beer part
13. part A. cat B. shout C. cane D. aunt by
14. buy A. supper B. bang C. coy D. tie
15. pawn A. word B. call C. won D. sown

SECTION 2

From the words lettered A to D, choose the word that has the **same consonant sound(s)** as the one represented by the letter(s) underlined. An example is given below.

Example: vice A. cat B. dress C. show D. chalk

The correct answer is B because only dress has the same consonant sound as the one underlined in vice. Therefore, answer space B would be shaded.

[A] [B] [C] [D]

Now answer the questions that follow.

16. banked A. led B. filed C. taken D. ludo zoology
17. zoology A. give B. sag C. beg D. vigil ump
18. thump A. think B. there C. breathe D. them
19. casualty A. lace B. steal C. vision D. lesson caly
20. calyx A. blinks B. eclipse C. example D. desk
21. sing A. bog B. nagged C. zonked D. game
22. paper A. physical B. psychic C. lap D. psalm
23. was A. rowdy B. bow C. quiet D. wrench
24. choose A. chimera B. chic C. soldier D. batch
25. best A. comb B. lamp C. labour D. plumber
26. disease A. decease B. case C. seats D. zeal
27. heavy A. honour B. heir C. beehive D. when
28. did A. handsome B. marked C. banked D. land
29. river A. bar B. dairy C. car D. bare
30. man A. sing B. bring C. manager D. finger

SECTION 3

From the words lettered A to D, choose the word that **rhymes** with the given word. An example is given below.

Example: obtain A. detain B. detail C. claim D. relay
The correct answer is A because only detain rhymes with obtain. Therefore, answer space A would be shaded.

[A] [B] [C] [D]

Now answer the questions that follow.

31. battle A. bitter B. latter C. kettle D. raffle great
32. great A. heat B. freight C. boast D. greet leech
33. leech A. fetch B. witch C. bleach D. lease
34. written A. bitten B. brighter C. rotting D. writing
35. coffee A. curfew B. muffle C. feeder D. toffee

SECTION 4

In each of the following questions, the **main/primary stress** is indicated by writing the syllable on which it occurs in capital letters.

From the words lettered A to D, choose the one that has the correct stress. An example is given below.

Example: democratic

- A. DE-mo-cra-tic B. de-MO-cra-tic
C. de-mo-CRA-tic D. de-mo-cra-TIC

The correct answer is C because the main/primary stress of the word democratic is on the third syllable. Therefore, answer space C would be shaded.

[A] [B] [C] [D]

Now answer the questions that follow.

36. conglomerate
A. CON-gb-me-rate B. con-GLO-em-rate
C. con-gb-ME-rate D. con-gb-me-RATE
37. defensible
A. DE-fen-sible B. de-FEN-si-ble
C. de-fen-SI-ble D. den-fen-si-BLE
38. superstitious
A. SU-per-sti-tious B. su-PER-sti-tious
C. su-per-STI-tious D. su-per-sti-TIOUS
39. bilateral
A. BI-la-te-ral B. bi-La-te-ral
C. bi-la-TE-ral D. bi-la-te-RAL
40. generally
A. GE-ne-ra-ly B. gen-NE-ra-ly
C. gen-ne-RA-ly D. ge-ne-ra-LLY

SECTION 5

In the following options lettered A to D, all the words except one have the **same stress pattern**. Identify the one with the **different stress pattern** and shade your answer in the usual way. An example is given below.

Example: A. away B. apart C. behind D. river
Options A, B, C are all stressed on the second syllable while option D is the only one stressed on the first syllable. So, D is the correct answer. Therefore, answer space D would be shaded

[A] [B] [C] [D]

Now answer the questions that follow.

41. A. gobble B. failure C. goodness D. elope
42. A. ceiling B. yoghurt C. vanquish D. career
43. A. lexical B. interview C. cardigan D. catharsis
44. A. colonel B. routine C. connive D. balloon
45. A. voracious B. congenial C. intestate D. elevate

SECTION 6

In each of the following sentences, the word that receives the **emphatic stress** is written in capital letters. From the questions lettered A to D, choose the one to which the given sentence is the appropriate answer. An example is given below.

Example: My mother's FRIEND hates pets.

- A. Does your mother's boss hate pets?
B. Does your mother's friend love pets?
C. Does your mother's friend hate toys?
D. Does your father's friend hate pets

The correct answer is A because My mother's FRIEND hates pets answers the question, Does your mother's boss hate pets? Therefore, answer space A would be shaded.

[A] [B] [C] [D]

Now answer the questions that follow

46. The Nigerian FOOTBALL team has many foreign players.
A. Does the South African football team have many foreign players?
B. Does the Nigerian volleyball team have many foreign players?
C. Does the Nigerian football team have few foreign players?
D. Does the Nigerian football team have many foreign coaches?
47. John must PAY for the broken glass immediately.
A. Must Jane pay for the broken glass immediately?
B. Must John repair the broken glass immediately?
C. Must John pay for the broken glass immediately?
D. Must John pay for the broken glass immediately?

48. The workers agreed to forgo their DECEMBER salaries.
 A. Did the workers agree to forgo their December salaries?
 B. Did the workers refuse to forgo their December salaries?
 C. Did the workers agree to claim their December salaries?
 D. Did the workers agree to forgo their March salaries?
49. The landlord refused to eject the TENANT.
 A. Did the caretaker agree to eject the tenant?
 B. Did the landlord refuse to eject the tenant?
 C. Did the landlord refuse to accept the tenant?
 D. Did the landlord refuse to eject the guest?
50. The Principal REBUKED the teachers for lateness.
 A. Did the governor rebuke the teachers for lateness?
 B. Did the principal commend the teachers for lateness?
 C. Did the principal rebuke the students for lateness?
 D. Did the principal rubuke the teachers for negligence?

SECTION 7

From the words lettered A to D, choose the word that contains the **sound** represented by the given phonetic symbol. An example is given below.

Example: /ɔɪ/ A. yell B. holy C. boy D. idiot
 The correct answer is C because only boy contains the sound represented by the given symbol. Therefore, answer space C would be shaded.

[A] [B] ☒ [C] [D]

Now answer the questions that follow.

51. /æ/ A. yacht B. yowl C. claw D. band
 52. /ʌ/ A. bush B. tough C. cop D. loot
 53. /ɒ/ A. caught B. jump C. dwaff D. problem
 54. /u:/ A. plumber B. pull C. suit D. hunger
 55. /i:/ A. fit B. seal C. sailing D. career
 56. /uə/ A. low B. sugar C. casual D. fire
 57. /k/ A. axe B. cease C. knew D. knob
 58. /s/ A. cash B. church C. slash D. bees
 59. /z/ A. lice B. exist C. leave D. measure
 60. /tʃ/ A. leaʃ B. peach C. chic D. cede

WASSCE JUNE 2014 ENGLISH LANGUAGE 3 TEST OF ORALS (OBJECTIVE) ANSWERS

- | | | | | | | |
|-------|-------|-------|-------|-------|-------|-------|
| 1. B | 2. C | 3. C | 4. B | 5. C | 6. B | 7. B |
| 8. C | 9. A | 10. D | 11. D | 12. D | 13. D | 14. D |
| 15. B | 16. C | 17. D | 18. A | 19. C | 20. A | 21. C |
| 22. C | 23. A | 24. B | 25. C | 26. D | 27. C | 28. D |
| 29. B | 30. C | 31. C | 32. B | 33. C | 34. A | 35. D |
| 36. B | 37. B | 38. C | 39. B | 40. A | 41. D | 42. B |
| 43. D | 44. B | 45. C | 46. B | 47. B | 48. D | 49. D |
| 50. B | 51. D | 52. C | 53. D | 54. C | 55. B | 56. C |
| 57. A | 58. C | 59. B | 60. C | | | |

SENIOR SCHOOL CERTIFICATE EXAMINATION (SSCE 1988 – 2015)

Past Questions with Solutions

English Language

(Theory / Objectives with Oral English) 2015

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WASSCE JUNE 2015 ENGLISH LANGUAGE 2 OBJECTIVE TEST

SECTION 1

In each of the following sentences, there is one underlined word and one gap. From the list of words lettered A to D, choose the one that is **most nearly opposite in meaning** to the underlined word and that will, at the same time, correctly fill the gap in the sentence.

1. The officer was expecting to be..... by his boss, but he was censured. A. questioned. B. praised. C. decorated. D. guided.
2. The honour that was conferred on the general has been.....A. withdrawn. B. confirmed. C. rejected D. destroyed.
3. The modest young man was rewarded while his..... brother was punished. A. intelligent B. handsome C. conceited D. wicked
4. Young people are known for their.....which contrasts with the composure of adults. A. ability B. instability C. activity D. credibility
5. It is a fact that pride is a less admirable quality than..... A. humility. B. honesty. C. affection. D. tenderness.
6. It is obvious that many people prefer affluence to.....A. scarcity. B. thrift. C. waste. D. poverty.
7. While some workers felt that the terms were amicable others thought that they were..... A. strange. B. disagreeable. C. bad. D. hostile.
8. No that the people of this community are living in comfort. I don't think they will want to go back to their days of.....A. disappointment B. hardship. C. strife. D. starvation.
9. False witnesses castigate rather than the accused. A. expose B. appease C. punish D. exonerate
10. Some teachers dissuade students from studying Mathematics, but others them. A. motivate B. lure C. instruct D. reward

SECTION 2

From the words lettered A to D, choose the word that **best completes** each of the following sentences.

11. After assuring the authorities that he would not escape, the prisoner was released on..... A. suspension. B. record. C. parole. D. probation.
12. A judge is required to.....justice fairly. A. defer. B. dispense. C. define. D. dispel.
13. The disease was.....by the doctors as pneumonia. A. diagnosed B. prescribed C. construed D. decided
14. The court granted an.....against the eviction of the tenant. A. adjournment B. injunction C. indictment D. adjudication
15. He was given a certificate of..... in English. A. efficacy B. efficiency C. proficiency D. sufficiency
16. The.....years of a child's life mould his character. A. restrained B. constructive C. conflicting D. formative
17. He bore his troubles with..... A. leniency. B. preference. C. discretion. D. patience.
18. Public money should he used only for..... purposes. A. legitimate B. discreet C. legal D. executive
19. The truth of the evidence is..... A. irreversible. B. irrefutable. C. irreparable. D. irretrievable.
20. As a millionaire, he lives in..... A. prudence. B. affluence. C. frugality. D. abundance.

SECTION 3

After each of the following sentences, a list of possible interpretations is given. Choose the interpretation that you consider most appropriate for each sentence.

21. On hearing the news, he flew off the handle. This means that he A. changed his decision, B. ran away. C. felt very disappointed D. became very angry.

22. John's money was barely enough to keep the wolf from the door. This means that A. John had killed a wolf, B. the money was just sufficient. C. the situation was desperate. D. John spent money lavishly.
23. He was given the hoot by the chairman, This means that he was A. offered a pair of boots. B. promoted. C. sacked. D. sent to buy hoots.
24. Since he left home, he has been trying to find his feet. This means that he A. has been suffering a lot. B. lost his pair of shoes. C. has forgotten about his relatives. D. has been trying to get used to his new situation.
25. He finds it difficult to put up with her behaviour. This means that he finds it difficult to A. tolerate her behaviour. B. understand her behaviour. C. determine her behaviour, D. consider her behaviour.
26. The government troops extended the olive branch to the rebels. This means that the government troops A. had reached a critical stage. B. killed a lot of rebels. C. were ready for peace. D. defended their territory bravely.
27. At the last minute, he had cold feet, This means that he A. suddenly fell ill. B. became nervous, C. lost his imagination. D. rejected the offer,
28. He was advised to pull himself together. This means that he was advised to A. keep his plans secret. B. change his mind. C. control himself D. keep the matter to himself.
29. He was sad to learn that his friend had gone round the bend. This means that his friend had A. gone overseas. B. gone mad. C. lost his job, D. been very ill.
30. The young man quickly paid his debt to save his face. This means that the young man. A. wanted to avoid disgrace. B. did not want to be slapped. C. wanted to preserve his looks. D. did not want to be a debtor.

SECTION 4

From the words lettered A to D below each of the following sentences, choose the word or group of words that is nearest in meaning to the underlined word as it is used in the sentence.

31. Modou is endowed with great potential. A. enlightened B. provided C. gifted D. inspired

32. Collaboration is essential to the success of the team. A. desired B. indispensable C. effective D. appropriate
33. I really wish to assure you that we now have a reliable leader. A. dependable B. realistic C. sensible D. resolute
34. This is a chance of a life time. A. an advantage B. a privilege C. an opportunity D. a possibility
35. Children often behave badly out of ignorance. A. illiteracy B. inexperience C. unfamiliarity D. simplicity
36. She lived a virtuous life. A. modest B. brave C. normal D. righteous
37. Olu insisted on his freedom to choose his career. A. wish B. independence C. ability D. right
38. Hindering justice may earn you a fine. A. Impeding B. Retarding C. Stopping D. Delaying
39. The professor's explanation of the point was very ucid A. long B. clear C. prompt D. complicated
40. The luminous hands of the clock attracted the baby. A. bright B. colourful C. glaring D. beautiful

SECTION 5

From the words or group of words lettered A to D, choose the word or group of words that best completes each of the following sentences:

41. That utterance is quite unlike you, please, come.....it! A. through B. of C. off D. against
42. If I.....enough money, I would buy a car. A. had B. have had C. had had D. have
43. He should take.....the appointment next week. A. in B. up C. on D. to
44. In trying to escape, the thief ran.....the police. A. upon B. by C. into D. through
45. I have always counted.....his friendship. A. in B. to C. with D. on
46. The caller was told to..... the line. A. hold off B. hold up C. hold on D. hold
47. The coach.....him to have scored a goal. A. was expecting B. expected C. had expected D. has expected

48. After eating all the mangoes, he shouldn't complain of stomach ache,.....? A. isn't it B. would he C. should he D. should it
49. Mary did her best.....failed to reach the pass mark. A. but B. however C. so D. and
50. The authorities have shown no signs of giving..... to their demands. A. off B. away C. over D. in
51. We must hurry now for there is not.....time left. A. some B. much C. plenty D. any
52. Those properties are.....sale. A. up for B. up on C. out for D. down on
53. I have always preferred unripe plantain.....yam. A. to B. than C. from D. for
54. Give it to Aminata. it is..... A. her B. their C. yours D. hers
55. Please, don't speak evil.....the dead. A. to B. of C. on D. for
56. My brother was about.....his house when I arrived. A. to leaving B. to have left C. to leave D. to be leaving
57. Neither Jack nor Jill.....there yesterday. A. are B. were C. is D. was
58. I have..... completed the task. A more and less B. more or less C. more than less D. more but less
59. After two hours of continuous work, the group broke..... lunch. A. with B. from C. for D. to
60. He finally hit..... the idea of travelling abroad. A. out B. at C. on D. up
61. The standard of education has gone..... A. out B. down C. off D. by
62. The council appointed a..... committee to look into the matter. A. five-men B. five-men's C. five-man D. five-man's
63. After the quarrel, he made it..... to his friend. A. in B. out C. on D. up
64. The task is..... for us to undertake A. much too difficult B. too much difficult C. more too difficult D. quite too difficult
65. I will always stand.....him.A.by B.with C.to D.for

66. We arrived just.....time for the grand opening. A. by B. about C. before D. in
67. Bakary can lift this heavy log,..... A. isn't it B. can't he C. does he D. doesn't he
68. The President's speech.....yesterday at 8.00p.m. A. is broadcast B. is being broadcast C. has been broadcast D. was broadcast
69. It is such a bad place.....I will never dream of going there again. A. thus B. therefore C. that D. then
70. We will leave.....you are ready. A. as when B. whenever C. as ever D. soon as

SECTION 6

*In the following passage, the nun bered gaps indicate missing words. Against each number in the list below the passage, four options are given in columns lettered A to D. Choose the word that is the **most suitable** to fill the numbered gaps in the passage.*

The life of a professional sportsman is always hectic. Consider his typical day. As soon as he wakes up in the morning, he jumps out of bed hurriedly and wears his —71—. Promptly, he goes out to —72— for an hour or so, covering a few miles. However, on some other days, he might choose to practice with the skipping — 73— at home. Having completed whichever one it is, he goes in for a shower and dresses for the day's training —74—. This phase varies according to his specialty. If he is a boxer, he goes into the — 75— to deal with the punching bag and later with a sparring partner, usually under the watchful — 76— of his coach. If he is a sprinter, he engages in continuous practice, —77—his performance with a stopwatch. If he is in football, net ball, volley ball, or lawn tennis, he can best practice with others while the coach watches, calling attention to specific skills and —78— not well mastered. In most cases, training lasts virtually the better part of a day, and often ends in discussions where certain technicalities are ironed out.

Now, when medals are —79—. most people who just watch actions on the television hardly realize what it takes to become a star. When all the —80— are considered and the high risks taken into account, one would realize that a star is worth the millions he earns.

	A	B	C	D
71.	jump suit	arcsuit	swimsuit	shell suit
72.	bat	skip	jog	jump
73.	cord	repe	string	twine
74.	practice	revisions	regime	rehearsal
75.	student	sports club	sports centre	gymnasium
76.	supervision	custody	command	charge
77.	calculating	gauging	timing	assessing
78.	techniques	systems	methods	procedures
79.	achieved	secured	won	lied
80.	struggles	pains	hurs	rigours

WASSCE JUNE 2015 ENGLISH LANGUAGE 2 OBJECTIVE TEST ANSWERS

1.B	2.A	3.C	4.13	5.A	6.D	7.B
8.B	9.D	10.A	11.D	12.B	13.A	14.B

15.C	16.D	17.C	18.A	19.B	20.B	21.D
22.C	23.C	24.D	25.A	26.C	27.B	28.C
29.B	30.A	31.C	32.B	33.A	34.C	35.B
36.D	37.B	38.A	39.B	40.A	41.C	42.B
43.B	44.C	45.D	46.D	47.B	48.C	49.A
50.D	51.B	52.A	53.A	54.D	55.B	56.C
57.D	58.B	59.C	60.C	61.B	62.C	63.D
64.A	65.A	66.D	67.B	68.C	69.C	70.B
71.B	72.C	73.B	74.B	75.D	76.A	77.C
78.A	79.C	80.D				

WASSCE JUNE 2015 ENGLISH LANGUAGE 2 THEORY QUESTIONS

(SECTION A) ESSAY

- Write a letter to your friend in another school giving him/her three reasons why your school has been excelling in academic work.
- Write an article suitable for publication in a national newspaper on the topic: The importance of national sports festivals.
- The School Hero is an award meant for the student considered to have exhibited exemplary leadership qualities. As the Senior Prefect, write a letter to the Head of your school, giving three reasons why your nominee should be given the award.
- You are the main speaker in a debate on the topic: Students in rural schools have more advantages than those in the urban centres. Write your arguments/for or against the motion.
- Write a story ending with the statement: We apologized to each other and reconciled.

[SECTION B] COMPREHENSION

- Read the following passage **carefully** and answer the questions on it.

The mansion by the roadside in my village reminds me of a similar sight in the state capital, three decades ago. Standing conspicuously by the highway in the heart of the city the mansion posed a hold challenge to road users. It belonged to Chief Koko who was regarded as untouchable in his community. Nobody dared step on his toes. Motorists had learnt to steer clear of it. It was generally assumed that moving close to it could cost one's life.

Then came a governor who decided to widen all the major roads in the capital city. He stressed

that this would involve the demolition of buildings that fell within twenty metres from the centre of the road. However, although the governor also stressed that compensations would be paid, Chief Koko was not impressed. He made it clear that nothing should tamper with his mansion, warning that whoever defied him risked dire consequences.

Not long after the governor's official proclamation, newspaper reporters had a field day speculating on the unprecedented confrontation with Chief. With time, news filtered out that he asserted that whoever dared him would certainly end up where others like them had gone. The message was clear-defiance meant death! So, reporters were pleading for a new route to circumvent the mansion. However, the governor made it clear that there would be no retreat.

Before long, work started on the project. One of the first casualties was a post office that was just some metres within the specified distance. It was cut into two. Soon, the frontage of a school nearby also followed. But, it was assumed that things would be different with the mansion whose owner tolerated no effrontery. Day by day, the project moved closer to the mansion, with the heavy machine leveling one structure after another. Then, when it was clear that the mansion was next in line, the driver of the bulldozer requested to go on leave. This got to the governor who ordered the driver to first do his duty. He sent emissaries to the governor to spare his life since his children were still very young.

The following morning, people got a shocker! The governor himself showed up at the site and asked for the key to the bulldozer, ready to assume the role of the driver. The driver, surveying the possible consequence, tearfully climbed up and pleaded that the governor should please care for his children after his demise, 'rhe

governor announced that if anything was to happen he, not the driver would be the target. So, the driver got to work and the mansion collapsed like a pack of cards, Press photographers went to town with their cameras, hoping to capture Chief Koko in action. But nothing unusual happened, and soon the whole structure became a rubble.

The aftermath? Everybody thought either or both miien would soon belong to the great beyond. But this muc'h I know: that governor is still around; and so is the driver,

- (a) What opinion did people have of' Chief Koko?
- (b) What does the expression, unprecedented confrontation tell us about the governor?
- (c) Why was it necessary to demolish buildings?
- (d) When the driver said that his children were still very young, what did he imply?
- (g) ... people got a shocker. Why was the governor's action a shocker?
- (f) What did people expect Chief Koko to do after the demolition of his mansion?
- (g) Not long after the governor official proclamation... (i) What grammatical name is given to this expression as it is used in the, passage? (ii) What is its function?
- (h) Quote a simile used in the sixth paragraph of the passage. (i) For each of the following words, find another word or phrase which means the same and which can replace it as it is used in the passage: (i) assumed; (ii) retreat; (iii) specified; (iv) showed up: (v) collapsed.

SECTION C SUMMARY

7. Read the following passage **carefully** and answer the questions on it.

Every normal human being would want to put his or her feet up once in a while and relax, but, obviously, one cannot relax all the time. A little work does not kill. Rather, it keeps one active and mentally alert, Some people think that the invention of robots is the best thing that ever happened to man. They are convinced that the invention has saved the day because robots are ideal workers who work without complaining or getting tired, Robots never reveal company secrets for any reason corruption, fame or blackmail.

The admirers of robots think that once a robot is programmed, it can do any piece of work with precision over a long period without slowing down, getting bored or even going on break or vacation, Robots can be made to perform any task. They do not grumble, protest or ask for 'inducement allowance', overtime, bonus or any of the motivations that human beings usually demand. They also work under conditions which

human beings would not accept due to either incapability or attitude,

One good thing about the robot is that any of its damaged parts can be replaced for work to go on effectively. On the other hand, if a human being loses a vital part of the body, that part may not be replaced for work to go on as effectively as before.

There is no doubt at all that the robot is useful but I strongly believe that the human being is more efficient than the robot in many ways. Human beings are sensitive, thinking beings who are flexible and can therefore control their actions. Thus, they can perform more functions than robots since human beings can think, discriminate and make value judgments, they can solve problems on the spur of the moment. The robot, on the other hand, cannot do this because what it has been programmed for is all that it is capable of doing. If a robot is wrongly programmed, it will continue to produce the wrong result until its programme is corrected.

The human being can take the initiative in many things. He can communicate or even call for assistance when need be, which the robot cannot do. The human being can be appealed to, make some crucial changes; he can also learn from observing what goes on and modify what he is doing.

It is clear that even though robots are useful, they are deficient in many ways and therefore cannot have an advantage over human beings. In crisis, the robot cannot face the challenge. It neither reacts nor reflects.

The robot is designed and programmed by human beings. I low then can the created be superior to the creator? Robots are created to assist human beings and relieve them of some of their burdens, not to take over completely from them.

- (a) In three sentences, one for each, state why the admirers of robots think that robots are more efficient than human beings.
- (b) In three sentences, one for each, state three advantages which the human being has over the robot.

SECTION A

1. Plot 30, Bola Shola's Bay,
Off Adelabu Junction,
Itire - Road,
Surulere, Lagos.
31st May, 2015.

Dear Fred,

It's been a long time since we heard or written to each other. How are you doing? I hope you are finding things easy with your studies. How is everyone in Nnewi? They are fine I supposed. Well, I'm fine here too, except that I'm seriously planning how I will come to Nnewi when I am done with my final examination.

Well, the purpose of writing this letter is to tell you why our school has been excelling. During the previous years we had only few teachers to impart knowledge on we the students but now we have new teachers and varieties of subjects such as: Further Mathematics, Technical Drawing, Geography, Yoruba and Igbo languages, including Computer studies.

Secondly, the Lagos State Government through the Ministry of Education has provided our school with infrastructural facilities, such as school library, laboratory rooms, food and nutritional rooms and technology workshop which help to facilitate learning. Fred, guess what? We now do more of practicals than theory. Moreover, our school which was dilapidated has been demolished and renovated again. This has helped in improving conducive learning amongst the students in the school.

Thirdly, the school authority has set up an afternoon lesson for SSS 3 students who are about to write their WASSCE. Subsequently, the authorities also provided "Morning Clinic" for all the schools in the same zone. We also have external classes every Saturday and also private lessons after school hours.

Fourthly, series of awards are now given to best students in each department at the end of each session. This has helped in motivating other students in enjoining themselves into the rail way of the 'Branies'.

Lastly, the new government/administration led by President Muhammad Buhari has provided us with a meal daily. Every early corner gets this free goodies and also every student that gets distinction in English language, Mathematics, Biology and any two important subjects in his/her department, gets extra reward for the whole of next session. So Fred, what more can we say!!!

We have every facility and so we must use them judiciously to keep the banner of our school flying.

Well Fred, extend my warmest greetings to the grannies and your little sister Jane. Also help me inform your mother in South Africa that I am still expecting my Easter packs. Bye for now. Write soon.

Yours sincerely,
Godwin.

2. THE IMPORTANCE OF NATIONAL SPORTS FESTIVALS

Sport is any activity that you do for pleasure and that needs physical effort or skill usually done in a special area and according to fixed rules. There are different types of sports, some of these sports are namely; track events, relay, hurdles, long jump, high jump, pole vaults, javelin, discus, hammer, short put, etc.

The importance of national sports festivals are many. National sports festivals can make the people of a country come together. As we have constantly witnessed in national, continental and global competitions, the power of sports to unite people from different backgrounds and cultures is awesome. So far, we have had eighteen experiences of sports festivals and to tap into its potential as a facilitator of social economic development.

The 19th edition of the National Sports festival which may be held in Calabar this year (2015), should enable us to discover new and budding talents with obvious potential to represent Nigeria in future. Once again, we will have the opportunity of initiating the process of using the power of sports to achieve national developmental targets.

With careful planning, sports can help to focus the attention of a country on its goals. No other part of the world is in such dire need of a facilitator, as black Africa, which has continued to be an extreme case of ethnicity, poverty and underdevelopment. The UN, the EU and FIFA have long recognized that sports can be used to reduce poverty, boost development and achieve the millennium development goals set out in 2000.

Sports go beyond recreation fitness and the pursuit of medals and trophies in a geographical expression like Nigeria, an amalgam of numerous communities with powerful ethnic sentiments, it can be invaluable in the socio-political realm as the fulcrum to leverage our national aspirations.

Unfortunately, we have not appreciated its worth, resulting in the pedestrian and short-sighted manner that we currently run it. After National Sports Festivals, can we truly say that we are at independence? Nearly a decade after the

tool kit for sports development was produced, have we even bothered to study it? Have we not been too blinded by the short-sighted craze to win by hook or by crook to see the lasting benefit of the pursuit of excellence or even the broader picture of sport as a tool for national development?

Regrettably, many state officials will not see it as a forum to proudly showcase their contributions, to the development of sports because they have not done much in that direction. It is such a shame that we have chosen not to distinguish between right and wrong, preferring not to be bothered by such niceties and as a result we cannot see that sports is more than winning and losing but that in our circumstances, it can be used as a catalyst for national integration and development.

3. Illorah Chisom
7, Ire Akari Street,
Isheri – Osu,
Lagos.
10th July, 2015.

The Principal,
Ajayi Comprehensive High School,
Surulere,
Lagos.

Dear Sir/Ma,

REASONS WHY MY NOMINEE SHOULD BE AWARDED FOR EXEMPLARY LEADERSHIP QUALITIES

My name is Chukwu Peter and I am a student of SS3, a science student of the above school. I am writing to express my views on why my nominee should be awarded for exemplary leadership qualities.

My nominee is Adewale Ajayi, a commercial student of the school as the senior prefect, I have been opportuned to socialize with my fellow students of various home backgrounds and academic disciplines but he stands out to be of good moral up bringing. He has respect for elders and fellow students. He is quiet and unassuming when it comes to issues or discussions. With this kind of behaviour, he mentors others as to how their goals and ambitions in life can be achieved hence popularly called the “counsellor”.

Adewale, as we all know in the school, is an intelligent student with mark distinctions in all subjects. He has exhibited through his series of laurels won in both local and internationally organized competitions. In SS2 days, he won for

the school the best accounting student in Lagos State organized competition. He also won in January 2015. The prestigious “Crown” of best secondary school commercial Essay Competition organized by West African Trade Union. This achievement earned not only prize for him, but paved way for other students to travel out of the country for a warm reception at the National Park. Accra, Ghana.

In the area of football, Adewale can not be left out. He has captained the school cricket team, to victory in the recently concluded Lagos State Ibile Games. The school came out with gold medals and he too won the “man of the match” as well as the “best behave player awards”.

The organizers of the competition - Ajayi Investment Company, also gave the school twenty (20) sets of computers for students use. All these through his leadership qualities.

From the above points of mine, I hereby recommend that Ajayi Adewale should be considered for the award.

Thanking everyone of you, for giving me the opportunity to nominate.

Yours faithfully,

Chukwu Peter
SS3.

4. STUDENTS IN RURAL SCHOOLS HAVE MORE ADVANTAGES THAN THOSE IN THE URBAN CENTRES

My name is Uwadia Rapheal. I am writing against the motion which says students in the rural schools have more advantages, that those in the urban centres.

Before I proceed, I would like to give honour and respect to whom is due by saying, good day Mr. Chairman, sir, panel of judges, accurate time keeper and my fellow students.

Nowadays, education is the most important aspect in societal development school plays a major role in development. As for students, they need to have good skills, and be proactive with an appropriate futuristic set of mind. Besides that, students also need to be active in co-curricular activities along with high academic achievements.

Urban areas relate to the areas that are surrounded by cities and are well populated areas compared to rural areas which are sparsely populated and are usually farmlands or country areas.

A recent educational research has examined rural and urban differences and their achievements. Many educators, researchers,

legislators and members of the general public believe that students from rural schools mostly receive an education that is inferior compared to the students that live in urban areas. Student's backgrounds also impact on their performances; many of the students that live in the rural areas have higher academic achievements when compared with the students in urban areas.

The National Education Association said that the low performing youths are in public rural schools (Brown & Swanson 2001).

The excellent performances of urban students are because of better quality in their educational information that they get from various sources like mass media and electronic media, their educated families and peer groups help them for better performance. They have many advantages and facilities compared to the students in the rural areas who are less exposed to the outside world and also lack knowledge about current issues.

Here are some facts and reasons why the students in the urban areas are better in achievements than the students in the rural areas. They are geographic location, resources, availability of technology and also quality of teachers.

Point one (family factors) in the rural areas, family is one of the factors that determine their children's performances. In this study, students in rural areas have low performances compared to students in urban areas because it relates to the education of their parents. Majority of parents in rural areas are less educated compared to parents in urban areas. The family background is the most important factor determining the academic performance of learners (Adell, 2002: 91) Survey found out that, rural students felt no pressure to attain good performance since their parents expectations are low towards education.

Point two (low socio-economic factor) the students backgrounds relate to the low socio-economic factor of their families, also one of the factors that affect their performances in education. Most of the students that live in rural areas come from low income families. The parents cannot provide them enough educational resources at home, compared to students in urban areas.

Point three (lack of facilities and resources). Education promotes human capital development as an asset that has greater or lower rates of return depending on the quality of education that is provided. Some of the factors that contribute to the poor performances are lack of resources or poor facilities in most schools in the rural areas compared to the students in urban areas, due to the unequal distribution of resources.

Point four (less quality teachers). Teachers are important in creating good performances in students. Most of the teachers do not want postings to rural areas because they think it will bring difficulty to them so the majority of teachers that are sent to the rural areas are new teachers that have less experience.

With these few points of mine, I think I have been able to clear my grounds and I have been able to convince the reader and not to confuse him/her that urban centres have more advantages than the rural schools.

Thank you.

5. WE APOLOGISED TO EACH OTHER AND RECONCILED

Once upon a time, there lived two boys named Peter and John. They lived in a small town called Lkpe. They were very good friends, through their strong friendship they connected their parents to know each other.

Peter and John looked almost alike, people kept asking whether they were twins.

They walked together, attended the same church, ate at each others home, bought similar clothes and even forced their parents to allow them change their school to attend one school together. Their friendship was a very strong one. They told people that they cannot depart from each other even in marriage they will build one house and both of their families will stay together. They agreed that if Peter has a male child and John a female or vice versa, their children will get married.

One sunny afternoon while Peter and John were playing happily as they were talking about a topic, an argument occurred. They started arguing for a very long time, it got so serious that they started to exchange words rapidly. The two boys were shouting each other over and over again to an extent that they started to fight.

People rushed to separate them, they have struck a blow into their friendship.

Whenever they see each other walking on the same street they turned their heads to the other side. They no longer walk together, play together or even visit each other.

At school hours, they don't buy food together, even their friends begged them at school to reconcile but to no avail. The whole town begged them even their own parents all to no avail. Peter had a video game and John had a bicycle. Peter loved John's bicycle and always wanted to ride it. John liked Peter's new video game and always dreamt of playing it. Because of their love for each other is it, they begged

other, embraced each other and asked for forgiveness.

Everybody was happy and glad that they have settled the grudges between them. And they said from that very day henceforth. And they said from that very day henceforth, they will never fight or quarrel with each other. They apologized to each other and reconciled.

SECTION B COMPREHENSION

6. 6(a) People regarded him as a ruthless or untouchable/merciless.
- (b) The expression tells us that the governor was the first person who dared to confront Chief Koko or that the governor was brave or fearless or bold.
- (c) It was necessary because the major roads were to be widened.
- (d) The driver implied that he was going to die and leave his children behind uncared for.
- (e) The governor's action was a shocker because people did not expect him to assume the role of driver.
- (f) People expected Chief Koko to carry out his threat of killing whoever defied him or people expected Chief Koko to kill the driver or the governor or both of them

(g)(i) It is an adverbial phrase of time.

(ii) It modifies the verb "had"

(h) The simile is "the mansion collapsed like a pack of cards",

(i)(i) Assumed-believed, accepted, thought.

(ii) Retreat — withdrawal, backing out, going back.

(iii) Specified—defined, mark out, prescribed, stipulated. (iv) Showed up — arrived, turned up, appeared. (v) Collapsed— crumbled, crashed, went-down.

SECTION C SUMMARY

7. (a)(i) Robots work well under any condition or circumstance.
- (ii) Robots work without making demands.
- (iii) Robots can be programmed to perform any task.
- (iv) Damaged parts of robots can be replaced.
- (v) Robots work tirelessly.
- (b) Human being can make spontaneous decisions. (ii) The human being is capable of controlling his actions. (iii) The human being can take initiative or face challenges or deal with crises. (iv) The human being can perform more functions than the robots.

WASSCE JUNE 2015 ENGLISH LANGUAGE 3 OBJECTIVE QUESTIONS TEST OF ORALS

(SECTION 1)

From the words lettered A to B, choose the word that has the **same vowel sound** as the one represented by the letter(s) underlined. An example is given below.

Example: seat A. sit B. cite C. set D. key

The correct answer is D because only key contains the same vowel as the one underlined in seat. Therefore, answer space D would be shaded.

[A] [B] [C] [D]

Now answer the questions that follow

- | | | | | |
|-------------------|------------|-----------|-----------|-----------|
| 1. <u>Monday</u> | A. age | B. day | C. pretty | D. heal |
| 2. <u>many</u> | A. village | B. fern | C. pap | D. friend |
| 3. <u>want</u> | A. dog | B. ant | C. wane | D. walk |
| 4. <u>woman</u> | A. woo | B. put | C. lock | D. song |
| 5. <u>blood</u> | A. cop | B. loop | C. fool | D. young |
| 6. <u>observe</u> | A. float | B. mother | C. dog | D. form |
| 7. <u>people</u> | A. quay | B. wedge | C. silk | D. pep |
| 8. <u>bought</u> | A. dough | B. could | C. saw | D. stock |
| 9. <u>heart</u> | A. ask | B. pack | C. as | D. swear |
| 10. <u>view</u> | A. could | B. pull | C. hood | D. due |
| 11. <u>eight</u> | A. height | B. face | C. west | D. fight |
| 12. <u>poke</u> | A. pork | B. look | C. snow | D. work |
| 13. <u>hound</u> | A. cold | B. load | C. shore | D. mouse |
| 14. <u>hear</u> | A. heap | B. beer | C. fare | D. chair |
| 15. <u>air</u> | A. care | B. fail | C. pile | D. cheer |

From the words lettered A to D, choose the word that has the **same consonant sound** as the one represented by the letter(s) underlined. An example is given below.

Example: Vice A. cat B. dress C. show B. chalk

The correct answer is B because only dress has the same consonant sound as the one underlined in vice. Therefore, answer space B would be shaded.

[A] [B] [C] [D]

Now answer the questions that follow.

- | | | | | |
|--------------------|------------|------------|------------|--------------|
| 16. <u>cheap</u> | A. sheep | B. lashes | C. poach | D. chemistry |
| 17. <u>liquor</u> | A. quiz | B. square | C. account | D. lizard |
| 18. <u>strife</u> | A. strive | B. strip | C. phase | D. vibes |
| 19. <u>thank</u> | A. tick | B. tank | C. stick | D. thin |
| 20. <u>then</u> | A. through | B. den | C. bathe | D. think |
| 21. <u>cease</u> | A. coat | B. back | C. chaff | D. seat |
| 22. <u>boys</u> | A. zinc | B. street | C. pots | D. keeps |
| 23. <u>show</u> | A. cheque | B. sure | C. chemist | D. church |
| 24. <u>seizure</u> | A. sink | B. usual | C. zero | D. daze |
| 25. <u>mature</u> | A. lash | B. turning | C. tube | D. ritual |
| 26. <u>giant</u> | A. girl | B. ghetto | C. joke | D. leg |
| 27. <u>paste</u> | A. physics | B. photo | C. lap | D. phlegm |
| 28. <u>team</u> | A. them | B. thyme | C. listen | D. think |
| 29. <u>moved</u> | A. drive | B. rove | C. more | D. kicked |
| 30. <u>bin</u> | A. doubt | B. debt | C. lam | D. bomb |

SECTION 3

From the words lettered A to D, choose the word that **rhymes** with the given word. An example is given below.

Example: obtain A. detain B. detail C. claim D. relay
The correct answer is A because only detain rhymes with obtain. Therefore, answer space A would be shaded.

[A] [B] [C] [D]

Now answer the questions that follow.

- 31. roam A.from B.come C.home D.loan
- 32. bought A.thought B.dough C.low D.how
- 33. rain A.frighten B.frame C.feign D.many
- 34. knight A.knife B.cite C.knot D.cent
- 35. jeer A.jeep B.gear C.gauge D.bear

SECTION 4

In each of the following questions, the **main/primary stress** is indicated by writing the syllable on which it occurs in capital letters.

From the words lettered A to D, choose the one that has the **correct stress**. An example is given below.

Example: democratic

- A. DE-mo-cra-tic B. de-MO-cra-tic
- C. de-mo-CRA-tic D. de-mo-cra-TIC

The correct answer is C because the main/primary stress of the word democratic is on the third syllable. Therefore, answer space C would be shaded.

[A] [B] [C] [D]

Now answer the questions that follow

- 36. beneficial
A. BE-ne-fi-cial B. be-NE-fi-cial
C. be-ne-FI-cial D. be-ne-fi-CIAL
- 37. Pecuniary
A. PE-cu-n i-ary B. pe-CU-ni-ary
C. pe-cu-NI-ary D. pc-cu-ni-A RY
- 38. reduplicate
A. RE-du-pli-cate B. re-DU-pli-cate
C. re-du-PLI-cate D. re-du-pli-CATE
- 39. satisfactory
A. SAT-is-fact-ory B. sat-IS-fact-ory
C. sat-is-FACT-ory D. sat-is-fact-ORY
- 40. disputatious
A. DIS-pu-ta-tious B. dis-PU-ta-tious
C. dis-pu-TA-tious D. dis-pu-ta-TIOUS

SECTION 5

In the following options lettered A to D, all the words **except one** have the same stress pattern. Identify the one with the **different stress pattern** and shade your answer in the usual way. An example is given below.

Example: A. away B. apart C. behind D. river
Options A, B, C are all stressed on the second syllable while option D is the one stressed on the first syllable. So, D is the correct answer
Therefore, answer space D would be shaded

[A] [B] [C] [D]

Now answer the questions that follow.

- 41. A.mulatto B.mystery C.pucker D.public
- 42. A. genius B. enthrone C. matron D.eager
- 43. A. multiple B. never C. rotter D.distaste
- 44. A. motivate B. invade C. concern D.inveigh
- 45. A. income B. nibble C. confirm D.muffler

SECTION 6

In each of the following sentences, the word that receives the **emphatic stress** is written in capital letters. From the questions lettered A to D, choose the one to which the given sentence is the appropriate answer. An example is given below.

Example: My mother's FRIEND hates pets.

- A. Does your mother's boss hate pets?
- B. Does your mother's friend love pets?
- C. Does your mother's friend hate toys?
- D. Does your father's friend hate pets?

The correct answer is A because My mother's FRIEND hates pets answers the question, Does your mother's boss hate pets? Therefore, answer space A would be shaded.

[A] [B] [C] [D]

Now answer the questions that follow.

- 46. The project is designed to alleviate poverty in the COUNTRY.
A. Is the constitution designed to alleviate poverty in the country?
B. Is the project designed to alleviate poverty in the city?
C. Is the project designed to increase poverty in the country?
D. Is the project designed to alleviate crime in the country?
- 47. Students are usually advised to stay out of POLITICS.
A. Are teachers usually advised to stay out of politics?
B. Are students usually advised to go into politics?
C. Are students usually advised to stay out of business?

D. Are students rarely advised to stay out of politics?

48. The angry WORKERS vowed not to return to work.
A. Did the happy workers vow not to return to work?
B. Did the angry students vow not to return to work?
C. Did the angry workers choose not to return to work?
D. Did the angry workers vow not to return to school?
49. Mr. Peter GOT his hearing aid last week.
A. Did Mr. Peter lose his hearing aid last week?
B. Did Mr. James get his hearing aid last week?
C. Did Mr. Peter get his reading aid last week?
D. Did Mr. Peter get his hearing aid last year?
50. They have been on the PHONE for an hour.
A. Has she been on the phone for an hour?
B. Have they been off the phone for an hour?
C. Have they been on the sofa for an hour?
D. Have they been on the phone for two hours?

SECTION 7

From the words lettered A to D, choose the word that contains the sound represented by the given phonetic symbol. An example is given below

Example: / əɪ / A. yell B. holy C. boy D. idiot

The correct answer is C because only boy contains the sound represented by the given symbol. Therefore, answer space C would be shaded.

[A] [B] [C] [D]

Now answer the questions that follow

WASSCE JUNE 2015 ENGLISH LANGUAGE 3 TEST OF ORALS (OBJECTIVE) ANSWERS

1.B	2.B	3.B	4.B	5.D	6.C	7.C
8.D	9.B	10.D	11.A	12.B	13.D	14.C
15.A	16.C	17.B	18.C	19.D	20.B	21.D
22.C	23.B	24.B	25.D	26.C	27.C	28.B
29.D	30.C	31.B	32.B	33.A	34.C	35.C
36.C	37.B	38.B	39.C	40.C	41.B	42.D
43.A	44.D	45.A	46.B	47.C	48.B	49.A
50.C	51.B	52.B	53.C	54.C	55.B	56.D
57.D	58.B	59.D	60.A			